A debt repaid

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/30649262.

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Mature

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Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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F/F, F/M, Gen, M/M, Multi

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra), Kyle (She-Ra), Rogelio (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)

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by Pastel101

Summary

Catra never really knew her life before Adora, she was her first memory. Catra always believed they would grow up with each other, but everything took a turn when Catra learned she could perform magic.

Notes

Just some prior information this takes place before canon and at this point in time Adora and Catra are 8 years old and Catra was found in the box at 6 years old.

Solitary confinement

"Catra are you sure this is a good idea?" A young Adora said as she started picking at her nails, a nervous habit she developed at the ripe age of 6 years old.

"Shhh!! You have to keep your voice down." Catra says in a hushed whisper

"Seriously Catra," Adora said much quieter, "it's way past curfew I don't want us getting into trouble."

"You mean me to get into trouble you'd probably get a slap on the wrist at most," Catra said with a huff.

"Catra you know that's not- mmmp!" Adora was cut off by Catra putting her hand over her mouth and pulling Adora into a darkened hallway. Adora looked at Catra about to lick her hand until she heard voices.

"Shit I'm tired. Why do we always get night shift?" The first guard complained.

"Well maybe if you weren't always falling on your ass during training you would get onto the field. But honestly from what I've heard the woods have been crazy whole squads are going missing..."

their voices began to trail off. Catra and Adora let out a collective sigh of relief.

"Okay quick before we miss it." Then Catra began to drag Adora along.

"Where are we going?" Catra turned to face Adora as they ran.

"I can't tell you or it'll ruin the surprise dummy." Her smile was so bright that it just made Adora smile.

'I think I would follow you anywhere if you asked.' Was Adora's only thought.

Adora soon realized where they were going the second she saw Catra beginning to climb up the side of their perch.

"Honestly Catra we could've come up here earlier without having to sneak around," Adora said despite already beginning her accent up after Catra.

"Well obviously but..." Catra helped pull Adora up and pointed towards the horizon "then we would've missed this."

Adora stood in awe as she saw the night sky clear of the smog that loomed over the fright zone. "Cool right?" Adora looked over and saw Catra staring at the sky with a small smile her eyes shining from the moons.

"Pretty."

After a while, Catra and Adora sat on their ledge still mesmerized by the night sky. "Thanks, Catra this is amazing." Catra smirks

"So amazing it's worth missing an hour of sleep?" Adora chuckled a bit followed by a yawn.

"Definitely." Adora couldn't tell you why but she scooted closer to Catra and leaned her head on her shoulder a content smile on her face.

"What are you doing?" Catra said a bit rushed. Adora snapped back

"Sorry I just was- umm I didn't-" Catra then started laughing her cute squeaky laugh.

"Dummy I was trying to tell you it would be better to lay your head here." She patted her lap. Adora looked up at her with bright eyes.

"Hey don't look at me like that! Shadow weaver would kill me if you got a neck cramp or something. It's not because I like you or anything." Catra said smiling. Adora didn't have to be told twice and rested her head on Catra's lap while pulling up her legs to curl under herself.

"Thanks, but just for a few minutes we have to go back soon," She said as her eyes drifted closed being lulled to sleep by the soft purrs coming from the other girl. Catra found herself staring at Adora more than the sky and subconsciously began to rake her claws through her hair. Catra slowly began to get a little sleepy herself and leaned back to rest a little convinced she'll just close her eyes for a short minute.

That short minute was cut even shorter when Catra caught a whiff of an oh-so-familiar smell of charcoal and electricity. Before Catra could even react she was dragged up by her hair coming face to face with Shadow Weaver. The scream she let out was enough to alert Adora who after blinking for a second began trying to plead with Shadow Weaver.

"Shadow Weaver it was my idea! Please she just wanted to make sure I didn't get hurt!"

She wasn't listening and mid-Adora's rant Shadow Weaver without breaking the unwavering eye contact with Catra said in her cold voice,

"Adora go back to your room this instant."

"Shadow weaver please-"

"Now."

Adora looked over at Catra and began to slowly walk away mouthing a quick "sorry" to Catra. After who knows how long Shadow weaver began dragging Catra by her hair down the

staircase leading up to their perch then down an adjacent hallway.

It wasn't by the black garnet chamber but for some reason that just made Catra even more scared. At least with the black garnet, she knew what to expect. Suddenly they were at a big iron door and Shadow weaver opened it and flung Catra inside.

"You forget your place! How dare you try to manipulate my Adora after I saved your life! I should've left you to rot like the filthy parasite you are!"

Suddenly a jolt of electricity went through Catra. "Ahh!" Shadow weaver then grabbed her chin.

"Silence!" Catra clamped her mouth shut and swallowed trying to blink back tears.

"You are to remain here until you learn you are nothing but a pet to Adora that I can and will take away when I see it becoming a hindrance, am I understood?" Catra nodded her head weakly against Shadow Weaver's icy cold grip. Another wave of shocks went through her.

Catra didn't dare make a sound.

"I said am I understood?"

"Y-yes Shadow weaver!"
Shadow weaver then let her go making Catra slump to the ground. And without another word the giant door was slammed shut and locked tight putting the room into complete darkness.

Catra's hand twitched with pain as she tried to move.

Adora's POV

I laid on my bunk my back to the door keeping my eyes on the floor the room was painted in a dark green hue from the dim

emergency lights. The only sound was Rogelio's snoring. It's been over fifteen minutes since I left. It usually never lasts this long.

Is Catra okay? I know Shadow weaver always threatened to get rid of Catra but that was just her way of motivating her she wouldn't do it... Right? I then hear the door squeak open and I instantly sit up and turn around

"Cat-" I lose all the breath in my body when I saw Shadow weaver in the doorway her hands held in front of her. She looked calm. And Catra was nowhere to be seen.

"Adora. Come" Shadow weaver said and began to walk out not even checking to see if I was following. We walked together and we came to a stop at the training simulation control area. Shadow weaver then pulled up a recording of one of the other squads.

"Adora." I instantly stood straighter,

"Yes ma'am?"

"Describe what you see here." She said as she pointed to a young girl with white hair and claws? She didn't look too good, to be honest even with the below-average camera quality I could see the exhaustion on her face, and if that didn't give it away the way she moved certainly did.

"Um, she looks tired...and-"

"Adora, what have I said about mumbling? Speak with confidence or not at all."

"She looks tired," I said more firm
Shadow Weaver began fast-forwarding the tape.

"Correct and look what is the result of one tired cadet." She said as she started the tape again, "can do."

Sure enough, it was bad. The girl got startled by her team member trying to get her attention and accidentally stung them

with her tail which caused the person to pass out which in turn made her other team member get distracted to yell at her then get knocked down by a bot. Shadow weaver paused the tape.

"Do you understand what I'm trying to tell you, Adora?" I bit my lip a bit.

"Yes, ma'am" Shadow weaver then placed her hand on my cheek.

"Adora, I do wish you would just let me help you could you imagine how much damage you could cause if you are not at your best? Imagine if because of you Lonnie got hurt, kyle or even Rogelio wouldn't that be awful?" Why didn't she mention Catra? Is she alright?

"It won't happen again, I couldn't imagine my squad getting hurt because of me...especially Catra." Shadow weaver straightened and I felt her looking down at me for a long while with silence hanging in the air.

"Go off to bed Adora, and I expect the best scores from you tomorrow...for Catra's sake." And with a wave of her hand, I was dismissed I walk silently to my bunk and felt tears come out as I notice Catra still wasn't back.

Catra's POV
I think I always hated the dark long before Shadow weaver even though I don't remember much from before but I like to dream about it. Life with a loving family and nice house like the ones I read about in stories that were stolen from the outside by older cadets. But it never ends well when I try to make a connection to a loving family to how I got here I just end up mad.

Why didn't they want me?

I already hate this room. Despite the lack of sunlight in the fright zone, there are very few spaces where it's completely dark the only place that's been this dark is when Shadow weaver wraps her shadows around me but at least there was the sound of the

hissing shadows, and the belittling comments from Shadow weaver but now it was just...

Silence.

I slowly back up to the wall and curl up on the cold floor. I might as well sleep in case Shadow weaver decides to take me to train. Besides the quiet should hypothetically make sleeping easier...

It didn't. I miss Adora. I eventually force myself to sleep trying to ignore the weird smell hanging in the air of the room.

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"Come on you can do it just concentrate and envision the energy flowing to your hands"
The young kit tries closing her eyes and doing as the woman said but nothing happened and she let out a huff.

"Sweetheart I love you but there's no way she'll learn if you teach her like that." Another woman says as she comes into the room.

"Well maybe if a certain someone wasn't so late I wouldn't have to be the one to teach her." The woman who walked in raised her hands in defense.

"I know I know but I was held up at Mystacor." She came over and gave the other woman a quick kiss on her cheek.

"Forgive me?" She pleaded with big eyes the first woman huffed a bit.

"I'm not the who you promised to teach therefore your apology is miss directed." The woman said with a smirk. For the first time, the second woman acknowledged the kit sitting at the table causing her to spring up and run to hug her.

"Hey missed me already?" The young kit nodded

"You said you'd be back 2 hours ago." The kit whined as she rubbed her face into the woman's pant leg the woman chuckled
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slightly and lifted the kit into her arms.

"Sorry some work stuff came up can you find it in your heart to forgive me?" The kit giggled then smiled.

"Only if you teach me, mom sucks at it." The first woman gives an exaggerated gasp causing the woman to smile then sit down leaving the kit on her lap.

"Alright, I want you to cup your hands like your scooping up some water." The kit did as told and then the woman began to run her claw lightly from the kit's elbow to her palm.

"Now imagine the light is right below your fur in small pieces and you need to bring them together from your elbows down to your palms." The kit closed their eyes and focused on her mother's claw slowly going up and down her arm and then when she heard a small gasp she opened her eyes. In her palm was a small ball of light. The kit's face lit up as bright as the shining orb coming from her palm and she looked at both women who were smiling at her. The light flickered as both women simultaneously hugged her tight.

"I'm so proud of you sweetie!" The kit then began to feel a rumbling of purrs and warmth. The moment was cut short however when a man came in running past the door.

"Excuse me, I'm sorry to interrupt but there's an emergency!"

Both women instantly stood on alert the kit still held in the second woman's arms.

"What is it?"

"It's the Horde."

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I woke up with a start my breathing quick and sweat clinging to my fur. What the heck was that? Maybe the silence is messing with me more than I thought. I sit in my spot for a while not having much to do. Maybe I should check the door just in case. I
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remember one time Shadow weaver shoved me into a supply closet for 3 hours only for her to come back and tell me the door was unlocked the whole time.

"Honestly what did I expect from some animal."

I slowly stood up and made my way to the back wall and walked along the edge to find the door. As I was making my way around I wondered if I had just opened the door Shadow weaver would've just yelled at me for not following orders. I feel the cold iron of the iron door and feel around for the knob or keypad only to realize it had a spinning knob like the ones I'd find on a safe. Weird I tried turning it and it didn't even budge.

Great

With nothing better to do, I decide to go around the rest of the room if only to see how big it is. As I walk I suddenly trip over something.

"Huh?" I lowered myself and felt around I only felt something skinny and long and then some fabric. I couldn't even begin to think what it was.

"Now imagine the light is right below your fur in small pieces and you need to bring them together from your elbows down to your palms."

I remember the dream, but there's no way. Despite me telling myself that I begin to cup my hands together and close my eyes imagining the soft scratch down my arm it feels so real and safe. I felt stupid. Honestly how desperate am I? Then when I see a light past my eyelids I open my eyes. Taking a second to adjust I then stare at the orb.

"Holy crap." Then I look to see what it was I touched and my body goes stiff the light flickers a bit but I refuse to let it go away completely. I then just stare at the rotting bones with their clothes in tatters. I try to keep my breathing even but as I look around I

notice there's more. About 4 in total. This wasn't a test.
I'm not supposed to make it out of here.

Adora's POV
I woke up cold and alone as the wake-up call rang. I got up quickly and got dressed. I couldn't afford to make any mistakes today. For Catra's sake. As we all made our way to the breakfast hall I couldn't help but notice a certain white hair girl with claws and a tail. I remember her. I wonder what happened to her after that train wreck of a simulation course. It doesn't matter I tell myself, Catra might be in trouble. The last time she missed breakfast she wouldn't talk to me for weeks and she looked so tired. I remember trying so hard just to see her smile again. Or to even look at me for that matter.

It probably didn't help that she was still new to the Fright Zone.

She came here when she was 6 with no memory of where she came from. I remember how scared she was when I found her in that box shivering and alone.

"Jeez, I can't believe Catra is skipping again I swear she should just up and go away since she's never around." I was brought out of my thoughts by Lonnie's voice. Then after a moment when I registered what she said I got mad.

"Lonnie come on you can't say stuff like that she's our friend!"
Lonnie just rolled her eyes.

"Yeah right maybe to you but we understand Catra's place."

"And what's that supposed to mean?"
Lonnie let out a chuckle.

"Adora I know your dense but you are not blind Catra isn't like us she isn't even supposed to be around humans you're lucky you were able to train her but she starting to get out of control. You should watch out she might start thinking she can take you on." I

found myself getting increasingly angry the longer Lonnie went on. She can't be serious right? There is no way.

"You can't believe that! Catra has shown multiple times that's she's just as capable as all of us!"

"Because she's not in the right place! She'll excel when doing things only humans are supposed to do."

"Then what about Rogelio? He's not human?"

"That's different-"

"How?!"

During this argument, Kyle was trying to keep the peace but neither of us spared him a glance. We also didn't notice the force captains working the cafeteria started to look over at us.

"You do realize Catra has wiped the floor with you multiple times right? So if Catra is lesser then what does that make you?!"

"Jeez, you're' so annoying. You know we used to be friends but you gave all of us up the second Catra came along you've just forgotten about us!" Then Lonnie just started laughing.

"Then again I guess you didn't want friends you just wanted a pet huh? Well lucky you, like always you get to have everything you want-"

I didn't even realize what I did before it was too late I just saw Lonnie knocked to the floor with blood running down her nose.

"Oh, crap."

A broken promise

Chapter Notes

> Hey I didnt really see any hate on Lonnie or anything but just wanted to clear it up. (because I love Lonnie) but remeber shes a kid so she kinda just copies what she hears so that's why she think of Catra that way.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's POV
I'm not stupid I know people die in this war I've seen videos and projections of battles but seeing a body in person just made it too real. I then backed myself up to the furthest wall from the bodies noticing that where I was sleeping was so close to the body.

I felt vomit start to rise from my throat I try to keep it down knowing it would just add to the smell but as I tried to swallow it back down I made eye contact with the black holes where the eyes should be and it comes right back up. The lack of food made it hurt even more as the stomach acid and bile rose in my throat and onto the floor. Then I went into a coughing fit and tried calming myself down. I open my eyes and realize the light is still there floating by my head.

"I almost forgot about you." My voice came out horse probably from the lack of water and the vomit. I reached my hands out and the ball levitated in my hand it felt warm. My first instinct is to curl around it I tried to keep my focus on the light and not on the smell around me. I never even knew I could do magic I thought that was something only princesses could do and Shadow weaver. Maybe if I show her she'll teach me cool stuff.

Maybe this is my chance to show I'm just as good as Adora that I'm worthy of her lo- approval. No. Bad idea. Telling her probably won't help she'll probably just use it as an excuse to banish me or something. That is if I even make it out of here. No Adora

wouldn't just leave me here she'd do something stupid just to get me back right?

I finally look towards another body. Shadow weaver can't just expect me to die of dehydration or hunger I've survived too much just to die from something as stupid as that. I only have about 5 days before I die of dehydration. And after about 3 days my body doesn't wanna do what it's told. I know from experience. So I need to find a way to get water or to get out before then. I go to stand up and begin to walk around the room now with a source of light it should be significantly easier to find something.

I wish Adora was here if not to help me get out. Just to have her be the last person I get to be with.

Adora's POV
I've never gotten into a fight and I didn't want to! I more so panicked and just punched Lonnie she seemed just as surprised as me, to be honest.

"Lonnie! Oh my gosh, I'm so sorry I didn't-" I tried to help her up but she just smacked my hand away. Then the force captains grabbed both of us and dragged us away.

"Oh wow looks like Shadow Weaver's little protege isn't perfect after all." One of the guards said with a laugh. Despite my worry over Lonnie I was more confused on what the heck a 'protege' is. All that left my mind however when I realized I was alone in front of the black garnet chamber. As the door slid open I tried taking a breath but was shoved in by the guards.

"Keep moving pipsqueak." Well, that was rude. I tried to keep my head up as I walked but the closer we got the more energy I felt from the black garnet making me subconsciously curl into myself. And Shadow weaver looked like she was working on something. Which is not good I know how she gets when someone interrupts her work even the once confident guards became hesitant when she spoke.

"This better be important." The guards stood up straighter.

"Yes- um there was a fight that broke out in the cafeteria the other cadet involved was taken to the infirmary while this one-" he punctuated it by shoving me forward. "Was the culprit. Punched her square in the nose." My breath was lost as Shadow weaver turned to face me. I used to hate the fact I could never read her face because of her mask. Now I'm grateful. As she looks at me I wanna just to turn away but I know that will just get me into more trouble.

"Leave us." The soldier seemed surprised.

"Miss Weaver it's our job for discipline we are told just to report to you-" he was suddenly cut off as he was flung back by shadows to a wall and with that, both soldiers scrambled out of the room. I didn't bother to turn my gaze away from Shadow weaver. After a few beats of silence, I tried to get out as much as I could.

"Shadow weaver I'm sorry I didn't-"

Slap

"You are not to speak without permission cadet."
My cheek burned but I just bit the inside of my cheek to keep the tears down. That's the first time Shadow weaver has ever hit me.

"I don't need excuses I need answers. One. Word. Answers. Am I understood?" I silently nod hoping she didn't expect me to speak.

"Now who was the fight with?"

"L-Lonnie."

"And why were you fighting not only a fellow cadet but a cadet from your squad?"
How was I supposed to explain that with one word?

"Adora I expect a quick answer."

"Catra!" Gosh, that sounded so wrong I should've said anything else.

"Am I expected to believe it was over Catra?"

"Yes."

"And what was said that made you believe starting a ruckus was the solution?" I finally made dead eye contact with Shadow weaver and spoke bluntly.

"Pet."

Shadow weavers eyes narrowed then she let out a sigh then bent down towards me and placed her hand where she hit me. I flinched from the slight sting.

"I will look over this one instance if your scores don't suffer and remember you're down a cadet. Don't disappoint me."

"Yes ma'am"

She kept her hand on my cheek and then a slight glow came from her hand. I held my breath waiting for the shock to come but it didn't. The sting I felt on my cheek was gone. Shadow weaver must have noticed my shock because she let out a chuckle.

"Adora you have a lot of handicaps a sore cheek shouldn't be added. Now run along you need to get ready for the simulation practice. You're dismissed." I nodded and quickly made my way out the door the second I was alone I let some tears come out.

Why did she say we'd only be missing one cadet?

Catra's POV
"Ugg"

Nothing. Nothing. There are no vents windows just one door and nothing! I finally sit down with my back to the wall. The light I

made is starting to fade. I let out a yawn as I feel my eyelids get heavy and the light goes out as I feel myself fall back asleep.

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"Come on it's not that bad!"

"No!"
The woman let out a big sigh. Giving up she put the kit back down onto the ground.

"Please? I promise it's not as bad as you think it is." The woman tried pleading with the kit that was now hiding under a big pile of towels.

"No! It makes my fur all heavy and makes me feel weighed down!" The woman banged her head against the tub of water.

"Stars, where is your mother?" As if she was spoken into existence the woman came in with her arms crossed and a smirk.

"Sweetheart I love you but you'll never get her in there with that attitude."

"Haha very funny. I don't know how you do it not even the kids in Mystacore are this impossible." The woman's ears went back. Then the lady came into the room and hugged her from behind.

"How about you stick to magic and I'll handle bath time alright?" She then kissed her head causing her ears to perk up.

"Don't have to tell me twice" and with that,t she got up and headed out of the room. "Good luck with her!"

The lady chuckled a bit then went over to the kit hidden in the towels.

"So am I not cool enough to get hugs anymore?" The kit popped her head out but only her eyes were visible but it was obvious she had a pout on her face.
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"You'll make me get into the bath."

"I won't force you but you're not leaving this room till you're clean."

With that, the kit dug herself back into the towels. Causing the woman to chuckle a bit.

"Come on darling it's not that bad. And the quicker you get in the quicker you're all done!"
This at least caused the kit to come out of her hiding hole. She went towards the woman who had her arms open in a welcoming gesture only to stop slightly away from her.

"You're not gonna throw me in right?" The woman laughed a bit and shook her head.

"No of course not." That seemed to be all the kit needed as she got into the woman's lap and started rubbing her face into the woman's fur as she wrapped her arms around the kit. Purrs were heard from both of them.

"Can you please get in?" The kit just shook their head into her mom's fur. "What if I gave you an incentive?" The kit looked at her with a tilted head confused. "How about I get one of our best mages to teach you that light spell you wanted to learn so badly?" This instantly made the kit perk up.

"Really?!" Her tail was out of control with happiness.

"Yes but only if you cooperate. Deal?" The kit looked back at the water then gave the woman a firm nod causing the woman to smile. With the kit in her arms, she stood up and went towards the tub. It was obvious the kit was still nervous as she gripped onto the woman.

"Hey, now that I think about it I might need a bath too. Do you mind if I join you?"
The kit nodded their head causing the woman to giggle.

"Alright just let me get us some clothes real quick." She left the room placing her down as the kit kept eyeing the bubbles in the bath. She didn't notice when the lady came back and placed the clothes next to the bath. She picked up the kit and place them both into the bath. The kit just hissed as she felt the water on her fur.

"I know I know but just for a little while alright?" The kit just thought about learning the light spell and nodded quickly. The woman then began to rub soap into her fur and clean all the dirt and such.

"All done!" With that said the kit jumped out of the tub and shook off as much water she could but before she could run off she was scooped up by the lady and wrapped in a towel.

"Nuh-uh. You are not going around naked and dripping wet. I also need to brush your hair before it gets too tangled."

"Ugg Then why'd you say all done?" The kit kept squirming around causing the woman to let out an exaggerated sigh.

"Oh come on don't you want to spend time with me? I barely get to see you much with all the work I'm doing." She then rubbed her cheek on the kit causing her to giggle.

"Stop! That tickles!" The woman then placed the kit in front of her as she began to work the knots out of the kit's hair. Then came a clicking from the door.
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Which was weird because it sounded metallic.

I woke up quickly noticing the clicking was the sound of the door being opened. I sat up and looked towards the door it opened and I quickly blinked to adjust my eyes to the light. Standing there is
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Shadow weaver and I don't know if it's because I've been on the end of her anger so much but I could tell she wasn't happy.

"Come." Then she turned around. I sat there for a moment. Was this a test?

"You have 5 seconds before I close this door and it will never open again."

I ran out the door on all fours and followed Shadow weaver down the hallway. I couldn't tell how long I'd been away but everything was relatively quiet. I also noticed Shadow weaver kept looking in my direction looking at me like she didn't expect me to follow her out of the dead body room. She took me to the cafeteria and I got 2 ration bars. Which kinda put me on edge. I ate them even though I didn't feel really hungry but I drank as much water as she offered with vigor. I must not be as hungry because I go so long without eating so 2 days isn't the biggest deal to my body anymore.

After the awkward lunch Shadow weaver had me follow her back to the bunks. I assume everyone is doing something because I can't hear anything on the other side. All I wanted to do was see Adora.

Shadow weaver then grabbed my wrist and looked me dead in the eyes as if she was dissecting me. Then she just dropped my hand and walked away. I let out a breath and walked into the bunk ready to just lay down on an actual bed even if it's like a rock. I was going to climb up to my own but I just found myself wrapped up in Adora's blanket.

Warm.

Adora's POV
Catra has never been gone this long and I'm getting more and more worried. I wasn't able to get the best score on my first try. But I did today I just hope that's enough for Shadow weaver. I

can't even begin to imagine where Catra is right now or what she's going through. Stop it I need to stop worrying. Shadow weaver may not like Catra but she knows she is a capable soldier and she needs her.

I need her.

I finally make my way down the hall to the bunks. Alone. Kyle and Rogelio went to check on Lonnie I tried to go with them but Rogelio just shook his head at me. I tried to apologize to Lonnie but she didn't wanna hear it. Especially after she found out I didn't get punished.

"Honestly what did I expect to happen to Shadow weavers favorite."

I never asked to be her favorite and they could take my place for all I care. Sometimes I hate that she only looks at me. I make it to the door of our bunk room and without paying much attention flop onto my bed.

"OW!!"

I quickly scramble back when I realize there was someone in my bed. Who the heck-
Then I saw the wild hair peek out from under the covers.

"Jeez, Adora you got right on my tail." She was rubbing her eyes but I didn't even get onto her about how technically she was on my bed because all I felt was a relief as I ran up to her and squeezed her tight.

"Oh my goodness you're okay!" I didn't even realize I was crying until Catra pushed me ay a bit and giggled.

"Wow, you missed me already? Careful Adora I might think you like me." How could she be joking about this?

"Catra I was so worried! Y-you weren't back for training or-or for tactical training and... I couldn't find you anywhere." I was quickly

rubbing my eyes harshly to keep the tears at bay.

"Adora come on it's not that big of a deal." All of a sudden my sadness turned to anger.

"Not that big of a deal?! Catra I thought you were dead!" She then had the nerve to laugh at me.

"Adora I was only gone for 2 days come on are you obsessed or something?" 2 days?

"2 days? Catra..."
She looked at me confused.

"Catra you've been gone for a week."

Catra's POV

A week? A WEEK?
There's no way. I could believe 3 days maybe 4 but a whole week? That's impossible I didn't even feel that hungry or thirsty. Am I dead right now?
Suddenly I'm snapped out of my thoughts by Adora shaking me.

"Catra snap out of it!"

"Stop don't do that," I said as I removed her hands. "Are you sure?" Adora nodded her head quickly.

"Of course I'm sure I've been counting the minutes since you've been gone I thought... I thought Shadow weaver sent you away. And it was all my fault." I tried to hold it in but I couldn't. I started laughing so hard. Adora's shocked face made it even better.

"Pfft, I appreciate you Adora but seriously how would it be your fault?"

"I didn't protect you and I fell asleep."

"Adora It was my idea to sneak out and I dragged you along and I let my guard down. It was 100 percent my fault so don't go taking credit for it."
This caused Adora to smile a bit.

"Are you okay?"

"Of course I'm okay."

"Catra you asked me If I was sure you were gone for a week. Why?

Should I tell her? It'll probably just make her worry but what about? I mean I'm okay right? Also, there's that whole light trick I can do. I have to tell Adora about that.

"Adora I have a lot to tell you."

"I'm listening." She put her hand on my shoulder as I looked over to her. I don't know how someone who stresses over every little thing can be so calming. As I was about to speak I heard footsteps and recognized them as Kyle and Rogelio. I quickly pulled Adora toward me and whispered in her ear.

"I'll tell you later we have to be somewhere private." She looks back at me and then gives me a serious look as she nods.

Dummy.

Later that night I was surprised that I found it so hard to stay awake considering how much I slept today and apparently for more than half a week. But I pushed myself Shadow weaver won't expect us to break curfew right after I got back. I silently lowered myself to Adora's bunk and tapped her shoulder.

"Hmm?" She turned to look at me and I nodded my head towards the door. I saw the hesitation on her face she was no doubt worried.

"We'll be back in 5 minutes," I whisper.

"Promise?"

"I promise."

With that Adora got up and I grabbed her hand as we went down the empty hallway. Sadly we don have enough time to go to our spot but luckily I knew a lot of hiding spaces. I took Adora to one of the old storage closets I knew it had to be somewhere a little dark. I quietly open the door and usher Adora inside.

"Okay now I need you to stay calm and you have to listen before you ask questions okay?" Adora gave me another firm nod. I took a deep breath and tried to do that trick again running through the steps in my mind.

Cup your hands like you scooping up water.
Imagine the light under your fur.
And pushed that light from your elbows to your hands.

I noticed the light from behind my eyelids but not before I heard a loud gasp from Adora. I open my eyes and sure enough there it was. I looked to see Adora's reaction and my breathing just stopped. Her eyes were glowing so bright reflecting the light as it highlighted her blue eyes.

"Who, you made it brighter!"

Huh? I look down and sure enough, it was significantly brighter a little too bright I dim it down a bit as to not call attention to us. I looked up and Adora was shaking trying to keep all her questions at bay.

"Shadow weaver placed me into a dark room. With no way out I had a dream where someone taught me how to do this, so I tried it and it worked. But I looked around the room and saw dead bodies that died from dehydration or hunger. I didn't believe that I was gone for a week because... Shadow weaver never gave me water or anything. I don't even know how I'm alive, to be honest." Adora was looking at me with a look of pure disbelief.

"there's no way..." as I was about to laugh she cut me off.

"I mean Shadow weaver wouldn't just refuse to feed you. Are you sure you just don't remember?"

"Are you serious?"

"Catra come on she wouldn't do that."

"Adora why would I lie to you?"

"I'm not saying you're lying it's just maybe you don't remember. How else would you have survived."

"Why are you still siding with her?!"

"I'm not siding with anyone. Come on Catra how else would you survive?"

I wanna get mad and scream at her for defending Shadow weaver again but. She's right that's the only logical explanation. I also don't remember half the time I was in there. Maybe I should just accept her explanation and move on. I let out an annoyed huff.

"Fine whatever we'll go with that." Adora flashed me her smile and I couldn't stop the smile coming to my face as well.

"So Catra let's talk about this you're doing magic now?"
Oh yeah, I completely forgot about that part.

"I mean I guess I don't think it does much though." But with the way Adora was looking at it, I might as well have taken the moons from the sky.

"Catra do you not realize what this means? You have the power to do magic! That's incredible!" I felt my cheeks burn up significantly.

"We have to go tell Shadow weaver-"

"What? No!" I said as I grab Adora's arm. "Are you crazy?! Shadow weaver would kill me!" I whisper. Adora looks back at me like I've grown an extra head.

"Catra I know you don't like her but she could help you." Adora's voice took a comforting tone as she rubbed my shoulder. I wanted to learn about it but I couldn't let this happen.

"Adora no. I know you mean well but I can't risk it."

"But-"

"No!"
I grabbed Adora's shoulders and made her look me in the eyes. The ball of light floating by my head.

"You can never. And I mean NEVER! Tell Shadow weaver." I saw Adora slightly curl into herself.

"Okay." If I didn't have great hearing I probably would've missed that it was so quiet.

"Promise me!"

"I promise."

After that, we headed back to the bunks in silence and nobody knew we left. Just as I was about to go to sleep I heard a quiet knock come from under the bed.

"Catra?" I sat up and put my head over the edge seeing Adora looking at me.

"What?"

"I'm sorry I don't want you going to bed angry with me." I let out a groan as I hopped down and sat next to Adora.

"Look I know you have this mindset that Shadow weaver just wants to help but... she doesn't ever help me so I don't want to

tell her in case she uses it as a reason to send me away." I swallowed a lump forming in my throat and looked into Adora's eyes.

"She scares me."

We sat there for a moment and I said it so quietly I thought she didn't hear me until she pulled me into her arms and held me tight.

"It's okay. I won't let her send you away." I clutched onto Adora so tightly I was almost scared I cut her.

"Promise?"

"I promise"

We both went to sleep in each other's arms and stayed that way till 5 minutes before morning call and I snuck back up to my bunk.

Adora's POV
Everything was normal me and Catra woke up and went about our day the same as always. I was still kinda in a daze as I kept thinking about the night before.

"She scares me."

Catra was never one to admit if something bothered her let alone if something scared her. Part of me felt special that she felt she could admit that to me but another part of me wondered why. I mean yeah Shadow weaver is scary but Catra is one of the bravest people I know how could she be scared of Shadow weaver when the worst she does is a quick smack or putting you in a 'time out.' But that was only if you got into trouble.

Shadow weaver does magic too so I'm sure Catra wouldn't get into trouble. Maybe it's just the thing that would make Shadow weaver see how much potential she has!

"Hey, Adora!"

I suddenly felt a weight on my back as Catra clung to me.

"Whoa!" I stumbled forward a bit but quickly adjusted myself as I grabbed her legs to keep her up. "A warning would be nice you know?"

This just caused Catra to laugh, the cute squeaky one not the sly chuckle.

"You think a princess gonna give you a warning?" I rolled my eyes at her.

"Well I also wouldn't carry a princess around so are you saying I should drop you?"

"Don't you dare!"

Now we were both laughing. However, it was cut short when I saw Lonnie enter the commons area. Part of me wanted to go up and apologize to her but by the glare, she sent to me I decided against it.

"Wow, what did I miss?"

"Huh, what do you mean?"

Catra gave me a look as she dropped from my back and looked at me dead on.

"You and Lonnie are usually all buddy-buddy. What's up?" I bit my lip a bit.

"Well, you see while you were gone we kinda got into a fight." Catra perked up instantly.

"Whoah, no way did you win? Was there blood? Did she cry? What was it about?"

"Yes. A little. And no."
Catra's pupils were dilated and her tail was waving back and forth.

"Of course you won. So what made goody two shoes go crazy?"I didn't want to tell her especially when she was so happy. But I also knew I couldn't lie for anything.

"It's nothing just some petty stuff you know." I look at Catra's face and it's obvious she doesn't believe it.

"Yeah, something petty made you get into trouble. Come to one Adora are you not gonna tell me?" I let out a breath and started picking at my nails.

"She called you a pet and that you were lesser than us..." I looked at Catra's face expecting sadness or anger but all I say was a small smile on her face.

"Adora I appreciate you trying to defend me but that's not a big deal."

"What? Not a big deal? She called you a pet!"
Then to my disbelief, Catra started chuckling.

"Adora what did you expect I'm not like everyone else even the more 'animalistic' people around here are reptiles of course people are gonna think of me that way."

"But that's not fair! You work just as hard and are way better than them! Why do they get to call you lesser?" I noticed Catra started to get frustrated.

"Jeez, Adora are you this dense? It's because that's what Shadow weaver wants them to believe! She refers to me as 'Adora's pet' to all the force captains of course cadets are gonna think like that too!"

"But-"

"Adora just stop!"

Catra looked around and noticed the attention she was getting.

"Just. Just leave it be." And then she ran away. I wanted to go after he but I could tell she wanted to be alone. I then look across the common room and see Shadow weaver. By herself. Maybe Catra just needs to show everyone what she's capable of and maybe Shadow weaver can help her get there. Before I could even try to talk myself out of it I was already next to Shadow weaver.

"Shadow weaver."
She turned quickly at the sound of my voice.

"Yes, Adora?"

I gulped down the knot in my throat and quickly gave out an answer knowing Shadow weaver doesn't like waiting long.

"Can we go somewhere private? I have something to tell you about Catra."

Chapter End Notes

I promise Adora means well...
And be prepared because Catra is about to have a rough time.

Goodbyes are never easy

Chapter Notes

> The amount of time I've spent on this series is crazy not just writing it but also drawing it. I plan on having some character art later on because I dont think I'm good at describing how characters look so yeah.
> Sorry in advance about this chapter.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV
Shadow weavers eyes widen a bit but then she suddenly has an expression of joy?

"Of course Adora come with me." I keep pace with her scared she'll just leave me behind. As we walk I keep thinking about what I said to Catra. I promised and now not only am I breaking it I'm going behind Catra's back.

No this is what's best. This way Catra won't be seen as lesser she'll be seen as an equal maybe even better!

Shadow weaver will keep her focus on her.

I physically flinched at that thought. Where did that come from? Suddenly I heard the hissing sound of the door opening and Shadow weaver extended her hand to prompt me into the room. After I walked in the door shut behind me and Shadow weaver placed her hand on my back as she escorted me further into the black garnet chamber.

"I do hope this is serious Adora you know I'm very busy." She made her way in front of me and started collecting some files.

"It is."

Shadow weaver turned to face me making eye contact. The silence stretched as she eyed me. Suddenly she put down the files she was sorting and took a seat at her desk. As if she wanted to give me her undivided attention.

"Alright, I'm listening."
I knew I didn't have long Shadow weaver doesn't like being kept waiting. I took a deep breath and as I was about to explain, I decided to try and make sure Catra would be okay.

"Um is it okay if this stays just between us? I don't want a whole lot of people knowing especially Catra." This caused Shadow weaver to gain a surprised expression.

"As long as keeping it secret doesn't go against Hordak's rule, yes. And I can assure you Catra will never hear a word of this conversation." That caused me to relax a bit.

"So Catra was telling me about her time...away and then she said she had something to show me. We hid in a closet and then... I saw her make a light source appear from her hands. She said she had a dream and it told her how to do it. I thought since you know a whole lot about magic maybe you could help her." I finally looked at Shadow weaver and she seem like she wasn't there. Her fist was clenched and I heard her trying to calm her breathing.

"Uh, Shadow weaver-" suddenly without seeing her even get up she was in front of my face. She was so close I could feel the energy coming from her rune stone shard in her mask.

"And you're sure? positive of what you saw?" I gulped a bit my palms sweating.

"Yes ma'am."

Shadow weaver stared at me for a little longer then stood up straight again. She took a breath then looked at me again.

"Thank you for letting me know Adora. Magic can be very dangerous if not used properly and for someone like... Catra her

temper could put a lot of people in danger."

Catra didn't seem like she was out of control. She was calm even looked at peace whenever she did the spell.

"I- I didn't know that."
Shadow weaver caressed my cheek.

"Hordak doesn't trust magic. He doesn't like things he can't control. So sadly we don't teach much about it." Well, I'm glad I know now. Maybe I should make sure Catra doesn't keep doing that spell. "Adora I understand Catra is your... friend but I need you to be honest with me." I instantly felt myself stand up taller. "Are there any other spells she knows? " I firmly shake my head no.

"Not that I know of." Shadow weaver let out a sigh then patted my head.

"I appreciate your initiative. Being able to decide what's best not just for your friend but for everyone is very mature. That's the behavior we look for in force captains." That made me feel better A lot better actually. "Now run along." Shadow weaver said as she patted my back. I was about to leave but I needed to just make sure.

"Catra's not in trouble right?"

"You don't have to worry." With that, I ran out of the room.

The second Adora ran out of hearing distances of the black garnet chamber all hell broke loose. Shadow Weaver was in a blind rage as she started sending electricity throughout the room. Causing files to fall to the floor making everything go into disarray. Shadow Weaver was breathing heavily as the emergency lights started flickering on and off.
Suddenly an unlucky soldier burst into the room.

"Shadow Weaver is everything-"

"Get. Out."

"I'm sorry to disturb you but-"

"GET OUT!"

A large bolt of electricity went right through the soldier's side causing them to collapse. Yet they still limped as quickly as they could out of the room deciding that being in the room with her like this is a bad idea.

Shadow weaver then went to the black garnet pulling out its power. As it started to convulse as if shying away from the sorceress.

"You will not refuse me for some parasite!" The energy started to grow until the sorceress was pushed back. "Uhg!" Shadow weaver looked at the stone with malice. "I don't know how but I know it's you finding more ways to torment me."

She then walked over to one of the files that fell to the floor. Labeled 'Catra 600132' Shadow weaver then gripped the paper and sent a wave of electricity to it causing it to turn to ash and crumble to the ground through her fingertips. Then Shadow weaver had a smile as she looked back to the garnet.

"I kept her alive for old times sake but now your interference has sealed her fate, Azar"

Catra's POV
~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~"I can't just stay here when people could be injured or worse!"

"And what about you?"

The two women were arguing but one of them was actively not looking at the other as she was packing a small bag with empty bottles and some clothes.
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"Have a little more faith in me. I'm just going to make sure everyone is okay I'll be gone two days. Tops." The woman finally looked back to her and as if seeing her face made her suddenly understand she let out a big sigh. "If. And I mean if. There's any danger I'll be okay Micah will be with me and he's one of the best." As the woman pulled the bag over her shoulder the other lady grabbed her sleeve placing her head on her shoulder. This just caused the woman to chuckle a bit.

"Honey please-"

"No."

The woman rolled her eyes as she pulled her in for a hug. "There are kids there. Young kids. And some of their parents were badly injured in the fight, some even... I can't just leave the kids there." Suddenly her ears perked up as she saw her kit in the doorway rubbing her eyes. She tapped the woman still clung onto her and tilted her head towards the door. Once the woman noticed the kit she quickly rubbed her face clean of tears.

"Hey what are you doing up?"

" I had a nightmare and I came to see you. Why are you crying? Did something happen?" both women seemed to tense up from that. How on Etheria were they supposed to explain to a six-year-old a massacre?

The woman who was once crying went over to the kit and scooped her up in her arms and rested her on her hip. And the second the kit was in her arms she started rubbing her cheek to the woman's neck causing a quiet purr to come from the woman. She then looked to the other woman and then back to her kit. 'If my kit was left alone I would hope someone would come to help her.'

With that thought, she let out a breath.

"Momma is gonna have to go away for a few days and I got sad that's all." This causes the kit to pout.

"But you promised you would teach me that light spell!" This just caused the woman to put her hands up and chuckle

"I know I know and I will we just have to do a rain check. How about this Tuesday? 2 pm sharp!" The feline punctuated her sentence with a boop to the kit's nose. Which caused the kit to giggle.

"Okay." Then she opened her arms to the kit and the kit switched over to the other woman nuzzling her neck as well.

"Are you leaving right now?" The kit asked with big eyes. The answer was yes. She needs to leave as soon as possible.

"No, I'm leaving first thing in the morning." The kit then just nuzzled further into her.

"I don't want you to leave." The woman just held her closer and pulled back to look her kit in the eyes.

"Wanna spend the night with us? I know it's been a while but for old times sake? Plus I can fight off all the mean nightmares." The kit looked to the other woman who just had a small smile on her face and then looked back and gave an eager nod. Then after the lights were off and the bed cleared off the clothes from being hastily thrown about they all got into the bed with the kit between the two women. The kit was surrounded by warmth and started purring when one of the women started scratching her ear.

"Sleep tight Elizabeth."

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My eyes snapped open. I didn't even bother acting surprised. The dreams happen almost every time I fall asleep now but I find myself wanting to sleep more and more often. Just so I can stay in that safe space these two strangers created for me. I can't even remember what they look like the second I wake up even in the dream it's like they're foggy. But the feeling of warmth lingers after I wake up.
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The only time I ever feel that is with Adora and even then it's different.

Can there be different types of warmth?

Apparently.

I look around and notice I'm in one of my dark hiding spaces under a staircase behind some crates. I summon the ball of light again. I found it was getting easier and easier my eyes glued to the sphere.

"Catra!" The light flickers out as I hear Adora. Oh yeah, that's why I'm here. I know she'll find me soon but I still don't call out to her. Suddenly I see Adora's face as she finds me.

"There you are!" How does she expect me to stay mad at her when she smiles like that?! Instead of looking at her I turned my head to the side refusing to look at her stupid face.

"Aw come on Catra don't ignore me." Adora then started poking my cheek. I scooted over a bit and of course, Adora scooted closer as well. I let out a loud huff.

"Jeez, you're so clingy!" That caused Adora to laugh. Her eyes closed and I noticed tiny little freckles. They aren't very noticeable from far away like mine so most people don't know about them. And I intend to keep it that way. With all my staring I didn't notice Adora was looking at me with a dazed expression. "What?" That seemed to snap her out of it.

"Oh nothing I was just... are you okay?"
Well, that was a topic change.

"I'm fine." Adora then looked at me with a raised brow a smirk on her face as she wiggled her fingers.

"Don't you even-"
Before I could back away Adora tackled me down and started scratching at my sides causing me to laugh.

"Adora! S-stop!" I tried pushing her away but it didn't help. Eventually, she gave up and I pinned her back trying to do the same to her but she just smiled up at me. Then burst out laughing at my annoyed expression.

"Why doesn't it work when I do it?!"

"Maybe I just have a better resistance."

Adora was laughing but I just had an ugly feeling rising in my stomach. Of course, she has better resistance. Adora must've noticed me being upset cause then she sat up with me still in her lap.

"Hey how about we go to our spot? I heard Shadow weaver would be... busy today so no chance of her finding out." Adora tilted her head at me causing me to smile.

"Wow Adora talking about sneaking around? I must be a good bad influence."

"The best."

Then all of a sudden Adora pushed me back and started running. "Last one there is a moldy ration bar!" After staring dumbfounded for a second I started chaining her on all fours.

"Come on that's only funny when I do it!"

Adora's POV

With my little head start, I was able to get well away but I know Catra will catch back up any second so I kept running.

"Honestly I don think I've ever seen Shadow weaver that pissed."

Suddenly I stopped almost face planting into the ground. What? I snuck over to where I heard people talking finding two soldiers. I tried to keep quiet as I listened.

"Shit, Jen I think this is something your gonna have to go get checked up by the real medics." I looked a bit over the corner I was hiding in and had to clasp my hand over my mouth to keep the gasp In my throat. All along the person's side are winding lines sharp and jagged. Shadow weaver did that but why? As if reading my thoughts the lady asked.

"What the hell did you do to get her all riled up?"

"Nothing! All I saw was her little protege or whatever run down the hall calling for her friend. Next thing I know I hear someone yelling and went to check it out."

No there's no way.

"But she's having the 'clean up' crew gets rid of some cadet. I heard some of the soldiers talking about how they should be out doing missions instead of just getting rid of "some mutt" or something."

No Shadow weaver wouldn't she said that Catra would be-

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"You don't have to worry."
~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

Oh no.

"Hey, Adora."

I almost screamed but Catra quickly covered my mouth and gestured to the two soldiers with her head. I nod as she removes her hand and we walk away.
As soon as we were out of earshot Catra whipped around.

"So what were they talking about?" I felt my heart stop for a moment. What if she found out I told? What if she hates me? I promised I wouldn't let Shadow weaver hurt her. They're gonna send her away and I'll never see her again. Maybe they are going

to take her somewhere she can learn magic! Or they were talking about some other cadet, or-

"Adora!"
I look up and notice Catra looking at me worried and her hand gripping my shoulders.

"Are you okay? I thought I lost you for a second."
Looking at her smile all I wanted was to just stay with Catra. They're going to get rid of her and I will never see her again.

"I'm sorry but I have to go- I just... remembered Shadow weaver wanted me to do something!" And before Catra could respond I ran. I knew I had to do something. Something rash and stupid. But it's the only thing I can think of.

I just don't want to.

Catra's POV
Well, that was weird. Didn't she just say Shadow weaver would be busy today? Well if she didn't wanna hang out she could've just said so. As much as I try to brush it off there's an obvious hurt in my stomach.

"Idiot."

So decide to just go and walk to our spot alone but I turn around and immediately walk into something. "Ow!" I look up about to start getting mad when I see Shadow weaver looking down at me.

"Catra just who I wanted to see." That can't be good. I had to push down the lump in my throat making me physically cringe a bit. Then without another word Shadow weaver turned around.

"Come." Even though I wanted to get snarky my legs started moving. Maybe she's in a good mood? I mean she didn't yell at me after I ran into her so that's a good sign. I didn't even know where we were going. But as we crossed down the hall I knew exactly where we were headed.

The black garnet chamber.

Shadow weaver walked in and I quickly followed behind trying to keep pace. She didn't seem mad and to my knowledge, I haven't done anything wrong. Nothing she would know of anyway. When I looked around I noticed that the room was kind of off. I've been here enough to know what the room should look, smell, and feel like.

It always looks annoyingly clean but still has the
obvious rust of the Fright Zone.

It always smells of leaking water and charcoal.

And it always feels suffocating.

Now, however, it was obvious things were thrown together the papers on the deserve only thrown onto the desk, not in a neat stack or residing in drawers.
It smelled of electricity and like burning. And it feels 10X more suffocating like I couldn't even breathe in a full puff of air.
Suddenly Shadow weaver was in my face making my fur go on end and I flinched as I turned my head away waiting for the impact.

It never came.

Shadow weaver just grabbed my chin and forced my head forward.

"Open your eyes." I fought the urge to fight and decided if I wanted to get out unscathed I should just listen. I looked forward with my eyes open. Shadow Weaver was looking intensely at me before she brought her hand up and covered my right blue eye then her hand went to my ear tuffs. I was trying my best to track her hands waiting for her to strike me. Suddenly she pulled my ear tuffs hard.

"Ow!" My hand instinctively went to my hair to relieve the pressure. And to my surprise Shadow weaver let me. My ear tuffs are way more sensitive than my regular hair and of course, Shadow weaver just knew.

"I want you to get your things together from the barracks. You're moving to a different cadet course first thing tomorrow morning."

"What?"

"You have proven your worth. So you will be moved to a course more suited to your kind."
My kind? Were there others like me? And she said I proved my worth does she mean that?

"I don't understand."

"it's an honor Catra you are being moved to a class that will improve your strength and challenge you with more advanced skills."
I'm being moved up?

"What about Adora?" I spoke without even thinking. This seemed to make Shadow weaver mad as she grunted out a quick answer.

"It is no longer your concern now go."
I wanted to protest but the glare she gave me just caused me to shrink back and quickly walk out the door. That was weird. I think that's the first time I left the black garnet chamber without being hurt. And I'm...

I'm being promoted.

I'M BEING PROMOTED!
I couldn't help the grin forming on my face. Finally, someone noticed. I finally walk into our barracks and I was about to pack my things when I realized I didn't have anything. I guess I have clothes but even then it's just two outfits. I mostly just share things with Adora.

Adora.

She won't be with me anymore. I should be
happy I'll finally be on my own not compared to her but she's still my one and only friend. I crawl onto her bunk and wrap the blanket around myself. Suddenly I feel my eyes start to water up as I think about Adora. I lay on my side surrounded by her scent.

I don't ever wanna leave Adora.

"Catra, psst."

Huh? I open my eyes a bit and notice the lights are off. How long was I asleep? I look forward and see Adora crouched in front of me.

"What do you want?" Adora looked skittish she kept looking around suddenly I was wide awake worried about Adora.

"Hey, you okay?" She looked back at me and I noticed the look she had on her face. I've never seen her look that upset. "Adora?"

"We have to go come on."
She was whispering that wasn't good that's when I noticed a backpack in her hands.

"Adora, what's going on?" She then looked around again.

"I don't have time to explain I need you to come with me. Please just trust me." She then offered my hand to me. I grabbed it and Adora pulled me up causing her blanket to fall from my shoulders. "Bring the blanket it's a little cold." I was gonna argue but the way Adora sounded was almost pleading.

"Okay." I grabbed it and wrapped it around myself.

Then we were sneaking down the halls Adora looking around every corner. I honestly had no idea where we were going until

we were at the skiff hanger. Without hesitation, Adora went to one of the skiffs and placed the bag on top.

"Okay, we have about 4 minutes till they get here get on." She was suddenly dragging me to the skiff.

"Wait hold on what's going on?" Adora looked at me and I saw it. Tears were coming down her face making me go still.

"Y-you have to go." She sniffed her nose getting runny. "S-shadow weaver found out about your magic. S-shes was gonna send people to take you away in the morning."

No.

There is no way. "But-"

"Catra please we don't have time." She was then pushing me onto the skiff then shoving a piece of paper into my chest. "The circled areas are all neutral towns you can hide there and someone can help you." I don't understand my brain was having a hard time keeping up.

"There are enough rations in there to last you a good week and some extra clothes in case it gets cold. The weather shouldn't that bad for a while. And I also made sure to pack a stun baton and a bow staff and-"

"Adora!"

She finally looked at me her eyes were red and she was shaking. She then whipped her head around as she heard talking.

"You have to go now." She said as she started the skiff.

"Wait you're coming with right?" The look on her face said everything. She wasn't coming.

"Catra if I go Shadow weaver will hunt us down but if it's just you..." Shadow weaver never wanted me and Adora is right. Tears

started down my face as I reached out and hugged her.

"I-I don't want to leave you.." Adora pulled me closer and tighter.

"I know and I'm so sorry but once I'm higher up I'll come back to you okay?"

"You promise?"

Adora pulls back and smiles at me and wraps the blanket around my shoulders then she placed her lips on my forehead. It was so gentle and made my heartache.

"I promise." The soldiers were getting closer. Adora turned around and then looks back at me. "As soon as I get to see active duty I'll wait at the edge of the whispering woods and the Fright zone we'll meet then okay?" I nodded not trusting my voice. Then I got up wiping my eyes and with one last look at Adora, I drove the skiff away from the Fright Zone. My home for as long as I could remember.

"Bye Adora."

Adora's POV
I was able to sneak back to my bunk without being seen. When I got there I finally let out a breath but when I saw the empty bed it took all my strength to keep my sobs down.

Catra's gone.

And it's all my fault. I grabbed the blanket from the top bunk that is seldom used and brought it down to my bed as I tried to sleep the blanket still had fur on it but it's all I have left of Catra and so I don't mind. I turn over in my bed and see the little me and Catra we had drawn and brushed my fingers over Catra's face.

"I'm so sorry."

I know this was the only way that I would have a chance to see her again. And if it means I have to wait years then I'll do it.

Suddenly I heard quiet footsteps outside of the door and I quickly closed my eyes feigning sleep.

"Come on we need to get this shit show over with."

"Shhh! She has good ears so zip it."
I heard the door open and felt the soldiers get close to my bed.

"Shit, where is she?"

"I don't know Shadow weaver said she'd be here."

"This her?" I suddenly felt my chest tighten. What if this wasn't about Catra? What if I just sent her into unknown territory with dangerous princesses all for nothing?

"No, you would know her when you see her. She's the only person in this whole place that has cat ears and a tail."

That made me feel a little better. Also worse because I know now that Shadow weaver was going to send her away. If I hadn't sent Catra I would never even have had a chance to see her again. At least this way there's a high probability. At least that's what I tell myself.

"Fuck. Shadow weavers gonna have a fit."

"Not it!" Then I heard one set of footsteps rush out of the room.

"You bitch!" The other said in a hushed yell. I finally got in a full breath of air once I was sure they left. I then clutched my pillow as tears kept falling down my face.

I miss Catra.

Catra's POV
I noticed as I was trying to fly the skiff there was an autopilot programmed to take me to the edge of the woods. How much planning did Adora do? I decided to just sit by the controls in case I need to steer it somewhere or something. I clutched Adora's

blanket closer to me as I sped along the wind blowing my hair behind me. This is the first time I've ever been out of the fright zone and everything looks kinda dead. That's until I see the edge of the woods come into view. I was waiting for the skiff to slow but it seemed to increase speed.

"Crap!" I quickly got up and tried to steer it manually but the autopilot was engaged and I didn't have enough time to turn it off. I then saw I was heading straight for a tree and jumped off the skiff tucking in my body so I get little damage. But of course, I jumped right onto a hill causing me to tumble down. I quickly reached for a log digging my claws in the bark but flinched back as sap got on my hands making me flinch my hand back continuing my descent down the hill.

I finally came to a stop when I hit a tree at the bottom of the hill. I let out a groan. I didn't even get up just stayed laying down. Somehow Adora's blanket was still on me probably because I kept such a good grip on it.
I wanna go home.

I stayed laying down bruised and I know something is twisted or broken. Not to mention the skiff was my only transportation and all the supplies Adora packed are probably long gone whether they go messed up in the crash or wild animals took what they could. Even if they were there, there's no way I can climb back up that hill. I didn't realize I was crying until I let out a choked sob.

I'm so tired. I don't want to be here anymore.

I miss Adora.

Just then I felt water droplets on my fur. Gentle at first but then started picking up quickly. Of course! I needed to find somewhere to stay and fast I finally got up with a pained groan and made my way down a random direction then I went to rub the water out of my right eye but hissed as the forgotten sap got into my fur wedging that eye shut.

Great now I lost half of my sight and depth perception.

I kept walking keeping the blanket tight around my shoulders as I made a little hood out of it trying to keep my face a little drier. Just then my stomach started to growl. Are you kidding me? Suddenly I heard something snap.

ARE YOU KIDDING ME?!

I started running well more like limping trying to get away from whatever made the sound. This is so stupid. Why is it always me? What did I ever do to deserve this? Maybe it's revenge for picking on Kyle. All of a sudden I was in a clearing and... out of the woods?

Huh?

I've heard so many stories about how hard it was to get out of the woods. I couldn't have already gotten out. I mean sure I was beaten up but nothing serious. Then I looked up and saw a giant castle.

This was Brightmoon. Crap. Crap. Crap!

I was about to scramble back into the woods to hide but noticed an open window not that high up. Not to mention all the guards were talking leaving it for free reign. I should run back into the woods but they might have food and first aid. Before I even made a real plan I went to the window.

I won't survive long without food, not to mention my injuries. This is the best action.

I hope.

Chapter End Notes

Yes the mystery woman was supposed to leave but she is absolutely smitten with her kit. Also that scene with Shadow weaver does have with Catra is significant so just remeber that.

Reunion

Chapter Notes

> Whoo sorry it so late I literally fell asleep woke up at 7 and was like crap I still gotta finish it up and edit it.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's POV
I thought laughing at Shadow weaver when she tripped was stupid but this is by far the stupidest thing I have ever done. Despite that thinking, I didn't stop climbing. Always looking over my right shoulder. Made me appreciate having two eyes.

Suddenly my hands slid down the wall. On instinct, I dug my claws in to stop myself from falling. I am not doing that again.

Why does this Castel have stupid smooth edges? And stupid high windows. After what felt like forever I made it into the window and silently landed. I was in a long hallway everything was eerily quiet. I need to hurry up and find food and get out of here.

I looked up and noticed a bunch of arches up in the ceiling and instantly jumped up to stay out of sight. But the longer I went the more I realized the security sucked.

I probably saw one guard my whole way around. And considering I'm sure I've been going in circles that's concerning. I was growing more and more frustrated as I checked rooms and found nothing important. Why have all these empty rooms? Finally, my nose caught the scent of something. It smelled different but also really good. My stomach turned and I would've been worried if there were any competent guards around.

I followed the smell and when I heard the sound of footsteps I went back to the ceiling. I then look down and see a girl with bright pink and purple hair. She looks like the definition of sparkles. The smell was coming from her I then noticed in her

hands was something that had to be food. This means the room she came out of had to be the cafeteria! I waited till she was long gone when I jumped down and walked into the cafeteria.

Only to realize once I got in and closed the door that it wasn't a cafeteria at all. Just a wide-open space with a bunch of cabinets and closets. Then a large counter in the middle of the room. Despite my shock, I acted quickly and began quietly rummaging through everything trying to find anything that resembles food. But the longer it went on the more frantic I got.
Come on come on come on!

Suddenly queen Angella woke up gasping for breath. She awoke from a nightmare. The war is taking its toll whether it be from memories or the constant looming threat of annihilation. The queen then decided to get up thinking a walk might clear her head. Before she even realized it she was back at her husband's mural.

The queen grazed her hand across it longingly the placed her head against it. The moment of silence was ruined when she heard something come from the kitchen. The woman let out a small laugh.

"I swear she has your appetite." Angella walked to the kitchen expecting her daughter to be looking for a snack but as she got closer she heard a small panicked voice.

"Come on come on come on! Please?!" Slowly she opened the door her palm glowing slightly as she prepared for an attack. Walking quietly across the room she turned across the island only to gasp when she saw a small Magicat.

The kit then whipped her head around and her eye turned to pinpricks her fur fluffing up and started hissing. Angella quickly backed up and put her now non-magical hands up.

"Hey hey it's okay. I'm not going to hurt you." This just made the kit more defensive. As Angella got a better look at her she noticed all the bruises and cuts on her thin body. As well as the horde symbol on her shirt. Angella then slowly sat on her knees in front of the kit who kept her eyes on every little thing she was doing.

"My name is Angella can I have your name?" This caused the kit to gain a look of surprise. She looked around her and noticed she had nowhere to run.

"Catra."

This caused the queen to smile.

"Well, it's nice to meet you Catra. Are you okay? You're a little young to be all by yourself." The kit just nodded. Still looking for a way out. There was silence until the sound of Catra's stomach started up. This caused the queen to laugh a little.

"If you want I can get you some food. And some medicine for your wounds." Catra's ears perked up as she looked at the queen. Even though she hesitated she understood this was her best chance and slowly nodded. Angella got up and started preparing something quick. Catra's working eye never left her as she worked. Then while the food was warming up Angella wet a rag and slowly walked to Catra causing her fur to fluff up.

"Hey it's just a wet rag it'll get that sap out of your fur." Catra thought about it and having her sight back would be ideal. Angella slowly sat in front of her.

"I'm gonna just wipe it off but it might take a little pressure so don't freak out alright?" Catra nodded and closed her other eye. The feeling was weird but not as rough as she expected and the slight dampness of her fur felt way better than the sticky sap. Then Angella stopped.
Alright, can you try opening your eye for me?" After blinking a few times to adjust Catra opened her eyes and looked at the queen.

Who suddenly gasped and dropped the rag causing Catra to tense up. Noticing Angella slowly got up.

"I'm sorry I just-- I'm gonna go get you some disinfectant for you scratches while the food cooks. Stay here alright?" Catra hesitantly nodded. Angella briskly walked out of the room. Once the door shut however she quickly flew through the castle trying to find the closest guard. 'I really should up security around here' she thought. Finally, Angella found one who saluted.

"Your majesty how may I-"

"I need you to get a first aid kit and leave it outside the kitchen door and then get Juliet to meet me in my office understood?" He saluted and ran to get what the queen asked. Angella then rushed to her office. Rummaging through everything until she got a piece of paper and pen. After writing the brief letter she heard a knock.

"Come in." Juliet was then in the room already at attention before she could even begin her pleasantries Angela placed the letter in her hand.

"I need this delivered to Halfmoon immediately. Just show them the seal and they should at least look at the letter tell them it's an emergency and if that doesn't get them to listen just tell them a lost Magicat is in Brightmoon. Understood." Juliet nodded.

"Good now get going there is an emergency pack by stable 15 get going immediately. "

Juliet nodded and practically ran down the halls. Good. Angella then rushed back to the kitchen grabbing the first aid kit left at the door took a deep breath letting her adrenaline calm down as she walked into the room.

Catra was no longer sitting where she was instead fixated on the food on the stove her tail wavering lazily behind her. Angella had a small smile show on her face.

"Ahem." Catra then turned her head around. Angella walked towards the stove making Catra back up a bit and took to food off the heat. Catra was practically drooling.

"Alright while that cools down let me treat your cuts real quick." Angella pulled out a chair and Catra hopped up making Angella relax a little. She began to disinfect her wounds expecting some type of reaction she has with Glimmer but the most Catra did was flinch a bit. 'That's a relief considering her claws.' After she finished Angella got the steamed buns off the counter and placed them in front of Catra.

"Now I'm not the best cook but they're-" while she was talking Catra had taken a bite and started munching on them happily.

"-Alright."

She laughed as she shook her head and got up to grab some napkins for Catra. By the time I came back, she had already finished one. Then she just kept looking at the rest while her eyes were sparkling.

"You can have some more if you want." Catra looked up at the queen as if she had spoken an alien language. The queen smiled but on the inside, she was hurt that the kit seemed so surprised especially since she looked so hungry. Catra then reached for another one and as she held it in her hand she looked up at the queen as if waiting for her to say no. But instead, the queen just smiled and nodded.

"I already ate so you can have all of them if you want." The look on Catra's face was bittersweet. She looked so happy her eyes practically glowing. But the constant looming of the fact she doesn't comprehend kindness hurts the queen. Catra then began to eat as much as she wanted until she was full. Which was a feeling she never remembers having.

For a moment it was just bliss with Angella watching as Catra ate. But eventually, the elephant in the room had to be addressed.

"So am I to assume your no longer with the Horde?" Catra slowly shook her head keeping her eyes on her food. "Would you mind telling me what happened?" Catra looked to the queen shocked she even considered whether she wanted to talk about it or not. Part of her wanted to keep her guard up and tell the queen nothing but even though she would never admit it she wanted to talk to someone about all the crazy stuff that happened these past weeks.

"I-I did something I wasn't supposed to and my commander found out so she was gonna send me away. My friend found out and helped me get out I've been wandering the whispering woods ever since." Angella had so many questions why does a child have a commander? She couldn't be older than ten. How did she survive so long in the woods? And her biggest question, what could she have done to cause them to want her gone? Angella asked before she could stop herself.

"What did you do?" Catra looked at Angella for a moment wondering if she should answer. Then she just cupped her hands and formed the small ball of light in her palms. Angella sat there stunned.

"Magic..." Catra looked sadly down at the source of light and clasped her hands over it causing it to disappear. After Angella got out of her state of shock she got concerned.

"They were going to send you away just because you know magic? I thought the Horde would want magic on their side." Catra let out a sad chuckle.

"They only want magic they can control. I guess I'm too unpredictable." Angella wanted to ask more questions but Catra yawned and started rubbing her eyes.

"Well, we can talk more in the morning."

"What?"

Angella began picking up the now empty plate to put away.

"I wouldn't be able to sleep at night knowing I sent a child to the whispering woods alone at night." Angella then offered her hand. And Catra took it.

Catra's POV
Luckily there weren't many guards around but the few that were kept looking at me weird. Which I guess makes sense considering I look like I just rolled around in the mud and am now holding hands with a literal queen. Which I still can't comprehend. I never really bought into all that evil princess crap as Adora did.

I miss Adora.

I never believed that the Horde is the "good guys" because I liked to believe those good guys don't hurt children for things they can't control. And judging by the way Angella acted just proved it.

"You're very quiet when you walk you know that?" I slightly flinched when I heard her voice.

"Oh uh... sorry?" Angella then started laughing.

"No that's my fault I didn't mean it as a bad thing. It's just impressive I don't know a lot of kids who can be quiet. Stars know I wish Glimmer could be quiet sometimes." I started laughing before I could stop it.

"You named her Glimmer? The one with the pink and purple hair?" The queen huffed a bit.

"Yes. You met her?"

"She was how I found the cafeteria."

"Of course."

Suddenly we were at a big door.

"Here this will be where you will stay for tonight." I went inside and wow. This is bigger than the barracks by like twenty-something. It was darker than the rest of the Castel and had deep reds and neutral colors. It feels cozy? And smelled familiar. The bed was just a bunch of blankets and pillows in a circle-type shape. It was basically like a dream room.

"I'm staying here?" The queen nodded then went to one of the drawers and pulled out something.

"Yep and here are some clothes for you to wear they might be a bit big but they'll do for now". It was just a white shirt but judging by the size it would probably be a dress on me.

"I'll go get these clothes washed so they'll be ready tomorrow." I just nodded and began to undress. I thought everything was fine till I heard Angella gasp. "What?"
I tilted my head over my shoulder to see her looking at my back. Oh.

"Don't worry they're old. They don't hurt."

"But they did."
I just ignored it and put the sleep shirt on suddenly feeling uncomfortable in my skin.

"I'm so sorry." That made my ears tilt back.

"There's nothing to apologize for. Not your fault." Angella had a look of pure guilt on her face as if she just kicked a puppy.

"Well I'll leave you to rest I'll drop your clothes off in the morning. If you need anything just ask a nearby guard and they'll bring you to my room." I just nodded and she closed the door.

I picked up Adora's blanket and went over to the bed. It was super comfy. The blankets were soft and warm and smelled comforting. I clutched Adora's blanket to my chest tightly. Adora would love it here. It feel so homey? But mostly just
Warm...

The throne room door bursts open as a heaving soldier came into the room.

"Your majesty! I'm sorry to interrupt but a message came from Brightmoon delivered by Juliet it's an emergency!" One of the queens sitting on the throne got up.

"Well, you can go to that guard and tell them to shove that message right up their ass." The words were spat out with venom as the queen looked down at the soldier. The other queen then grabbed her.

"Azar stop it. Let's at least hear them out." Queen Azar seemed to soften at her words but glared back at the soldier.

"Well? Hand it over already." The queen had her hand out and open as the guard placed the message in the queen's hand. She practically tore at the seal with her mouth then held the message as she read Angella's annoying swoopy writing. Cyra leaning over Azar's shoulder to read the letter as well.

《《Dear Queen Cyra and Queen Azar,
I know I'm the last person you ever want to talk to and I know I have said it a thousand times before but I am sorry....》》

Azar just groaned in frustration. "Please don't tell me her 'emergency' is that she is feeling guilty?" The guard just shrugged. "Uhhgggg..."

《《...but I have been given a chance to try and rectify my mistake. While in my castle I heard strange noises coming from my kitchen and I found a Magicat kitten left for dead by the Horde. I would like you to personally come and try and help her I can tell you more once you arrive.
With best regards, Angella.》》

"Damn it." Azar suddenly set the parchment a flame. Letting the ashes fall through her fingers. Her wife then came up to her rubbing her back.

"Honey are you-"

"Yeah, yeah...sorry." Cyra gave her a small smile. But it didn't reach her eyes. It never did nowadays. "I have to go." Cyra just nodded. She knew her wife had a soft spot for children and with recent events, it only increased she could never leave a child scared and alone.

"Then I'm coming with you." Azar shook her head.

" I'm not taking guards with me and I don't want to risk anyone else."

"Okay well I'm going so you can either let me go or have half your guard in the infirmary and I follow you anyway. Your choice." Azar laughed a bit when she noticed some guards tense up.

"Fine but Leo is coming with us." Leo walked forward and bowed.

"It's an honor." Cyra just laughed.

"Come on it's not that serious." Leo chuckled at the queen.

"Well?"

"We'll leave tomorrow morning."

Catra's POV
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"Shit."

"Elizabeth!" The young kit just giggled at her mother's petrified face.

"Now where on Etheria did you learn such-"
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"Ah fuck I think I tore something while training."
The mother quickly clamped her kit's mouth shut as she heard the kit start to say 'fu-'.

"Seriously!?" The other woman looked at her confused.

"What?"

The kit got out of their mother's grasp and ran to the other woman.

"Momma!" The woman caught her kit and pulled her up into her arms purring softly.

"Hey baby what's going on?"

"What's going on" the other feline intercepted
"Is Liz has gained a very colorful vocabulary. And I was just wondering where on Etheria she could've learned about it." She raised a brow as she looked at the other woman. Who just gave a strained smile. Then placed the kit in front of her face.

"Can't hit me when I have a kit in my hands." The feline walked over and plucked the kit out of her hands then placed her on the ground.

"Go play sweetie!" And then the kit giggled and ran to go play.

"Traitor!"

The kit laughed as she ran down the hall looking for someone specifically to play with. Before she could get far down the hallway though she was scooped up.

"Seems we have a runaway." The kit quickly squirmed in the feline's arms.

"Leo!" The kit then climbed up them like a tree.

"Whoah there! Careful I do not wanna be the reason you get hurt. Your moms would have my head." The kit just giggled as Leo got a hold of her and placed her safely on their shoulders.

"Better?"

"Much."They then just walked through the halls the kit explaining all the things she's learned as Leo just listened every once in a while.

"Then she said 'ah fuck-"

"Liz!"

The kit looked at Leo with a slight tilt to her head. "What?" Leo laughed as they brought the kit down from their shoulder, which was a little difficult considering the kit didn't want to leave.

"Look there are some words you just can't say okay?"

"Momma says them. And so do you!"

The guard tilted their head back rubbing a hand down their face as they tried to explain the concept of curse words.

"Um, you see... Some words can't be said till you're older-"

"But I just said it-"

"Well, you can say it but-"

"Then why is it bad?"

"Umm- fuck this is hard." Leo then clasped a hand over their mouth. The kit then got an evil look on her face that was a copy-paste of her mother's.

"I think I'll take it from here Leo." They turned around hand still clasped over their mouth.

"Your majesty!" They lept up to their feet. "I am so sorry-"

"It's fine I know it was an accident and the real culprit has been taken care of." Leo nodded.

"Okay, I'll just. Go." Then they walked fast out of sight.

"Bye Leo!" The queen then looked to her kit.

"Why do you have to scare them like that?" The kit just laughed. The queen than just rolled her eyes fondly and picked up her kit and booped her nose.

"Okay but seriously no more naughty words."

"Okay."

"Perfect. Now let's go see momma she might be all mopey."
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I woke up still a little dazed but instantly was on alert when new scents invaded my nose. I sat up quickly my chest heaving until I got a look at my surroundings. Oh yeah, I'm in Brightmoon.

The room was still nicely dark but I could see the sun peeking through the curtains. How late was it? I looked at the end of the bed and saw my clothes with a piece of paper on top of it. I slowly crawl out of the tangles of blankets and grab the piece of paper. I open it and see annoying swoopy writing.

《《Catra
Good morning! I left you your clothes but they've been stitched up and made new. Breakfast is in the kitchen. Or the cafeteria as you called it. If you need help finding it you can ask any guard and they'll be happy to point you in the right direction.
Angella.》》

Was everyone here weirdly kind? I looked at my clothes and sure enough, they looked brand new. The only difference was the Horde symbols were removed which is fair I guess. After I put them on I take a look around the room. It's very different from the rest of the Castel it's a lot less bright? But it isn't dark either
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just kinda. Warm.
I decided I should probably go see Angella before she calls someone to come get me. I'm about to leave but I look back towards the bed to see Adora's blanket. I don't need to bring it everywhere I go.

That would be weird.

Despite what I tell myself I leave the room with the blanket clutched in my arms.
I make my way back to the kitchen? Without problems, I always had a good memory, and the need to avoid all interactions was a good motivator. I saw the door but it sounded a lot more lively though I could only hear two voices. Should I knock? No that's stupid just go in. I opened the door and my ears were instantly pinned back when I heard a squeaky voice.

"Mooooom! Come on!"

"Glimmer I've already given you my answer."

"Uhhhggg" Glimmer plopped herself down on the table face first muffling her complaints. Angella just rolled her eyes and then looked over and saw me.

"Ah, Catra please come sit. How did you sleep?"

I sat down on the seat she offered and gave a weak."Good."

Then suddenly the sparkly princess was at my side.

"Whoah, you're like a cat!" She then reached for my ears. I hissed at her while backing away.

"Glimmer!"

"Ah! She hissed at me!"

Angella rolled her eyes

"We don't touch people without asking understood?" Glimmer then nodded. "What do we say?"

"I'm sorry."

Huh?

"I-its fine just don't touch me." I started eating after silently asking Angella and I noticed sparkle's eyes on me but decided to ignore it.

"So are you my new friend?"

"No." I only wanna be Adora's friend.

"Can we maybe become friends?"

"No." I only wanna be Adora's friend.

She then huffed and pouted in her chair. Angella sat next to me and whispered.
"I know my daughter can be a bit... much but she does have good intentions she sadly doesn't have many kids her age to play with so just give her a chance?" I looked over to Angella and gave a huff. She left me to eat in silence.

"So do you like... play hide and seek?"
Sparkles face lit up.

"Yeah! My mom says I'm the best. You wanna play? We have a massive garden we can play in!"

Oh brother.

"Sure."

"Yes! Come on I'll show you!" She was jumping in place. I looked back to Angella and she smiled at me then nodded. So I followed Glimmer to the gardens.

I was now just sitting on a bench in the gardens. Sparkles said I cheated when I played hide and seek. And when I tried wrestling with her she just started crying and I got into trouble. So now I was just watching her run around. I just clutched Adora's blanket tighter to myself. Adora never said I cheated. And she always wrestled with me. Maybe that's why I only want Adora as a friend. Then Angella came and sat next to me.

"Sorry about her she's very stubborn. And she doesn't like losing." I just ignored her staring forward then she let out a breath. "Look I know things were different in the Horde and you being a Magicat also means there are some differences-"

"I'm a what now?"
Angella looked shocked then gave me that stupid pity look.

"Your species is called Magicats." Now it was my turn to look shocked. There are other people like me?

"You probably have never heard of them they're very secretive but I was able to contact the Queens and they are coming to see you."
Wow. I have people like me I don't know why but the thought just made my chest ache. All those years and I wasn't just an odd one out. Maybe that means I have a family or-

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"You were left in a box somewhere in the Fright Zone and now I must take care of you because your parents didn't even want you."
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Shadow weavers words just sucked out all the happiness I had. If I found my parents would they still not want me?

"Catra?" I didn't notice Angella was talking to me as I looked up at her.

"What did you say?"

"I said they're here if you would like to talk with them." Part of me just wanted to say no and hide in some dark place but. I had to know. I had to see for myself. I nodded my head and the queen smiled as she offered her hand.

"Honestly this better not be some trick to get us to join that dumb ass alliance," Azar said as Cyra and Leo walked to the throne room. Cyra just started rubbing her back.

"Love listen please." Cyra held Azar's hand and rubbed circles on it as she placed her forehead against hers. The woman practically melted at the touch. "I know. Trust me I do. But please if there is a kit here that is scared and lost I need you to have a level head alright?" Azar just sighed and nodded and Cyra smiled and placed a kiss on her head. They were at the throne room when they heard some distinct talking behind the door when Angella came in.

"Cyra, Leo...Azar, it's nice to see you again." Azar put one finger up.

"Nope enough we're here for a reason."
Angella nodded

"Always straight to the point. She is outside but before she comes in I want you to know she has no memories before the Horde and her name is Catra. She's also very... delicate right now so please" Angella pointed her stare at Azar "be gentle." Then Angella walked back to the door.

"It's okay. I promise they won't hurt a hair on your head." Angella walked out with the tiny Magicat half of her face obscured only seeing her yellow eye. Then once she saw the three she stood up

a bit taller reveling her heterochromatic eyes which cause all three Magicats to tense up as the only thing she said was

"You look like me."

Chapter End Notes

Catra was a cursing baby you cant tell me otherwise

The truth will come out

Chapter Notes

> Hey thanks for all the support I love reading all the nice comments and I'm glad you like my story. Next chapter might be a little short because I'm kinda sick and I also have testing tomorrow so yeah.

Adora's POV
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"Mmmm come on uhhgg!! Oof!"

I fell back as I tried picking up the box of pre-packaged rations. My breath heaved from the effort. "Come on!" I kicked the box out of frustration only to hiss in pain then clutched my foot.

"Ow!" This is so stupid. Why can't I just lift the stupid box?

"Sniff."

Huh? I looked around the storage room for the source of the sound. I was about to leave and just find someone to help me with the box until I heard a choked sob. Part of me wanted to just act like I didn't hear it and run very very far away. My feet moved before I could make a decision and I went to where I heard the noises.

"Hello?"

Suddenly the noises stopped as if they were never there but I thought I knew where it was coming from but when I went around the corner there was just a box sitting on the floor.

Weird.

I was gonna leave and just pretend it was a rat when I noticed a brown appendage leaking out of the box. I slowly walked over to the box and peeked my head over only to see a girl?
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At least I think she was a girl she had big ears and that appendage was her tail. She didn't notice me she was curled in on herself covering her head and she was shivering.

"Hey, are you-"

"Hiss!"

I quickly leaped back almost losing an eye when the girl sliced with her claws. She was halfway out of the box and I was able to get a look at her. She was very small but her hair gave her a look of being taller. And she had stripes up her arm and her claws were extended. But my attention was caught when I saw her eyes. Her pupils were narrow showing her bright eyes which were a bright turquoise and a warm yellow. I blamed my beating heart on the adrenaline from almost getting my eye clawed out.

"Hey it's okay I won't hurt you. Sorry, I didn't mean to scare you." The girl just kept staring at me tracking every movement I made.

"Do you have a name?" The girl seemed to go into shock for a moment before she began shaking her head.
I then thought I was imagining it when I heard her speak.

"I-I don't remember! The lady she- she did something... There's blood..."
She then curled in on herself and she was shaking.

"Hey hey, don't cry! Umm..." I started looking around looking for something to cheer up the cat girl. I scrambled back to the box I was trying to lift and opened it. Luckily it wasn't the brown kind. I think that would make anyone's bad day way worse. I grabbed one and started walking over to her. I got close but backed away when I remembered what happened last time. I extended my arm close to the box.

"Here. Food always makes me feel better." She looked up at me from behind the box her eyes looked like they were sparkling because of the tears she was holding back. She then started to

sniff it and started to reach out her hand. Then she suddenly brought it back to herself.

"I'm not going to hurt you."

The girl looked me dead in the eye,

"promise?"

"I promise."

She then got out of the box and grabbed the bar she sniffed it then shook her head. "Blegh!" She said as she stuck her tounge out. I laughed at her a bit.

"Sorry I forgot to warn you the smell is really bad."

"I know now."

She opened the bar and ate a piece and swallowed it.

"It's bland."
I just laughed not knowing what she meant by bland.

"I'm Adora."

The girl just blinked at me. Not knowing what else to say she just said.

"Hey, Adora."
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"Adora!"

"Huh? I mean yes?"

Lonnie looked completely unamused as I smiled sheepishly back at her. "I'm sorry I spaced what were yours saying?" Lonnie let out a groan and rolled her eyes.

"Forget it."
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Well then. At least she's talking to me again. I seem to be spacing out a lot today as I go through the motions of everyday life in the Horde. Though Catra was constantly on my mind. Was she okay? Is she hurt? What if she's dea-

I quickly shook my head. No. Catra is smart and resourceful she's been through too much to let some princess take her out.

"Adora." I tensed up and stood straighter on instinct. I then turned to face her.

"Yes Shadow weaver?"

"Come with me we need to talk." And she then walked expecting me to follow. I swallowed hard as I clung to her heels down the dark halls of the Fright Zone.

Catra's POV

The throne room was in silence. I didn't understand the glances the adults were giving one another. While the silence stretched I observed the group of felines. Magicats?

The most notable one was on the far right. She had short brown hair and stripes like mine, yellow eyes, but the most noticeable feature was the lack of her right forearm. Scars could be seen in the nub that looked twisted and like it hurt. Suddenly the woman looked down at me and gave a smile as she crouched down and extended her left arm.

I instinctively flinched back behind Angella. The lady then retracted her arm. I looked up to her eyes and felt that weird familiarity though the fact that she has the same features as me might be clouding my judgment. The woman looked me in the eyes and twitched her right ear.

It's okay

I don't know how I knew what that meant but I found myself a little more relaxed. When the woman extended her arm again I didn't flinch I got a little closer. She reminded me of the room I stayed in. Like instinct, I went to sniff her hand.
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'What the hell? Don't sniff me you mutt!'
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And just like that I just shook my head and pushed the instinct down. It's not normal to go around sniffing people. Get a grip.

"It's alright."

I looked up in shock at the woman. She looked so tough and rugged. So to hear such a soft voice coming from her was a shock and that's not even mentioning the words she said. What was alright? Staring? Or-

"I assume the Horde didn't have any other Magicats right?" I nodded my head.

"Well, it's normal to want to try and get the scent of someone you've just met to establish an acquaintance with them. Especially with younger kits."

I wanted to think about the fact that she called me a kit but my mind was still reeling at the fact that it's normal. Well for me anyway. Everyone always treated me like the odd one. Even I treated myself weird wanting to just push it down and ignore it. Though I always did it to Adora she always thought it was cu-nice.

I looked at the woman's hand again and then back at her face. She looked so at peace she had a small smile on her face and her ears were lowered. And against all the self-restraint I trained over the years crumbled as I sniffed the lady's hand. I recognized it it was the same smell that lingered in the room I'm staying in.

The woman then gently caressed my ear. Part of me is surprised I didn't flinch but something about the interaction felt familiar. I

didn't even realize I began purring till the woman stopped. Despite my earlier impression her she wasn't very rugged her touch was just...

Soft.

But not in a bad way.

"Angella told me you go by Catra is that right?"
I slowly nod my head.

"Well, it's nice to meet you. My name is Azar, this is my wife Cyra, and our best guard Leo." I look over and noticed the guard first they were tall and had black fur except on their stomach and nose which were white. They had long black hair pulled in a loose ponytail with one strand in their face. They also had a good amount of scars the most prominent being two large gash marks on the right side of their face. They had green eyes but it was hard to see because they refused to look at me.

Weird.

I then looked over to the woman Azar called her wife. What the heck is a wife anyway? And she was the one that looked the most different from everyone else. Her biggest separation was that she had blonde hair that was pulled back into two braids and she had ear tuffs like mine but lighter and longer, which were also pulled into braids. Her eyes are bright turquoise and unlike the guard, she was staring straight at me. When we made eye contact I found myself turning away she had this intense stare and looking at it made me uncomfortable. Angella must've picked up on that because she gave me an out.

"Catra the queens and I have some things we need to talk about so why don't you go join Glimmer outside?"

Oh, the amusement I can just sit and watch her have fun. But I could see Azar's eyes narrow at Angella and suddenly she look a lot less nice. So I just nodded my head and left the room.
But before I left I glanced back and Azar was staring down

Angella while Cyra was looking at me. Feeling awkward I just gave her a small wave. She flinched as if finally seeing me then gave a little wave in return.

Once Catra was out of the room queen Cyra fell to her knees her hand going to her mouth to muffle her sobs. Like instinct, Azar had her arm wrapped around her pressing her face into her hair. Angella just stood in shock at the scene unfolding in front of her.

"She doesn't even know her name!" Cyra shouted before falling back into her grief tears running down her face.

"I don't know much about her time in the Horde-"

"What the hell do you mean time in the Horde?!"
Azar was angry and despite how gentle her hold was on Cyra her eyes were ignited with irritation. Angella physically flinched back.

"She- has been in the Horde and has no prior memories as I have explained-"
Azar stated letting out a laugh but it was anything but amusing.

"Of course! Honestly, how lucky for you I mean imagine how less friendly she'd be if she knew that you left us for dead!"

"I've told you a thousand times I never-"

"Bullshit!" Suddenly Azar was standing and in Angella's face.

"Azar please I understand-"

"Shut up! You understand nothing, we've lost practically everything!"

"And I'm trying to atone why can't you see that?!"
When Azar's claws started to unsheathe Cyra finally spoke up.

"Enough!" They both looked over to her as she wiped her eyes and stood up.

"Azar please just stop. Angella if you don't mind I would like to talk with you. Alone." Azar looked at Cyra about to protest but seeing her wife's face still tear-stained and pained made her back down.

"Fine. Come on Leo. Let's give them privacy." Leo just nodded their head and walked with her. Once the pair left the room Angella let out a breath of relief.

"Thank you, Cyra."

"I'm sorry about Azar she's just been under a lot of stress lately and she's been itching for a fight."
Angella just nodded.

"And thank you for taking care of Eliz- Catra."

"It's not a problem again it's the least I could do."

"Look as much as I hate it she- she doesn't remember me or- or anything so I don't want to force her back to Halfmoon. She seems comfortable here with... with you and judging by her behavior I wouldn't want to throw her into a whole new environment with a bunch of strangers."

"Cyra what are you saying?"

"I'm saying that maybe... she should just stay here." Fresh tears were rolling down her face as she tried to keep her composure. Angel then grabbed her shoulders.

"No! I just so happened to be at the right place at the right time. She just has to get to know you is all."

Cyra just shook her head.

"I-I don't think I'm strong enough..." Angella just pulled her into a hug.

"Stop it. You have a chance to get your only child back I won't let you throw it away." The woman pulled back from the hug as she wiped her eyes.

"What should I do?" This caused Angella to smile.

"Why don't you all just stay here for a while to build a relationship with her and once she forms a bond with you we can slowly introduce her to her past and culture alright?" Cyra just nodded her head as Angella wiped some tears from Cyra's face.

"I'm gonna go check on Azar make sure she hasn't broken anything." The two women shared a laugh. When Cyra left the room she saw Leo waiting outside. Cyra just sighed

" let me guess Azar told you to stay here?" Leo just nodded. They still weren't there. It was like they were in a daze millions of thoughts running through their head until it all stopped when Cyra placed a hand on their arm.

"You know we never blamed you for what happened."

"You should." Leo had to bite their lip to fight back tears and Cyra just hugged them tightly.

Catra's POV
I find myself sitting and watching again. Maybe the weird energy in the throne room would've been less boring. I clung to Adora's blanket tighter around my shoulders. I wish Adora was here she was always better at making friends.

"Hey, whatcha up to?"
I turn and see Azar walking towards me. "Mind if I join you?" I just shrugged and looked forward as she sat next to me. There was just a bit of silence before Azar just stated "soooo... are you just gonna watch or go play with Glitter?" I started laughing which

felt weird considering I don't think I've laughed much since leaving the Horde or more so leaving Adora.

Azar had that smile on her face again. It was so weird to me she could just flip from soft to scary in less than a second. "Seriously why are you sitting all by yourself? You don't seem to be very entertained."

"I can't play with her. I 'cheat' when playing hiding and seek and I play too rough." I was kinda hoping she would just give me an 'okay' so I don't have to listen to a whole speech about how I should just 'be more gentle' or 'go easy on her' or why I can't just be normal.

"Well, that's dumb." I looked at her shocked and when she saw my face she started laughing. "I swear some princesses need to learn to toughen up a little." I must've still had that dumb shocked expression on my face because Azar just sighed and sat back down a little closer to me.

"You know I didn't grow up around Magicats either. Well except my dad."

"Why?" I found myself interested.

"Well, my dad saw that I had a lot of magic potential when I was younger so he took me to Mystacor to train and I stayed there until I met Cyra."

"You can do magic?"

Azar just smirked at me then summoned a ball of light on her fingertip. "Pretty cool huh?"
I then cupped my hands and made my own. Azar's light then faded out as she looked at me with wide eyes. Suddenly my confidence started to fall. She must've noticed because suddenly she was talking kinda fast.

"Oh no! Sorry, I didn't mean to be weird I just... didn't know they taught you stuff like that."

"Oh they didn't teach me, I kinda just... taught myself?"

"Why'd you say that like a question?"

"Well I had a dream and someone told me how to do it said to cup my hands and to imagine bringing energy from my elbows to my hands and I was in a dark room with nowhere to go so I tried it and it worked." I looked up at Azar but I didn't expect her to be looking directly into my eyes.

"Hey, I actually would like to talk to you about-"

"Hey, Catra!"

My attention was pulled away as I pinned my ears back. How is her voice the perfect frequency to tick me off? I look over and I see Sparkles waving me down to the edge of the gardens. Uhhgg, I was about to run until Azar placed a hand on my shoulder.

"Go on you're gonna be staying here a while right? Might as well try and get along." I guess that's true. I decided to just nod and play along. I tie Adora's blanket around my waist as I make my way to Sparkles.

"Finally. There's someone I want you to meet."
I look over her shoulder and see a boy with short hair and half a shirt.

"Oh my gosh! You're a Magicat! Like a living breathing Magicat! I have so many questions! Oh, Look at your ears!"

And just like that, I'm done with this conversation.

"I'm Bow what's your name?"

"Ca-"

"I told you already, her name is Catra."

"I know but I wanted to ask her to introduce herself."

"But I already told you so what's the point?"
While they were arguing I kinda just backed away slowly.

I swear everyone here are weirdos.

"Hey, where are you going?"

Uhhgg

I turn back around to Sparkles.

"Umm away?"
Sparkles almost got her eyes stuck from how hard she rolled her eyes.

"Why are you being mean? I'm just trying to be your friend."

"How am I being mean? And I already said I don't want more friends. I'm perfectly fine."
Sparkles huffed and crossed her arms.

"Fine! Well, I wouldn't want you as a friend anyway! Come on Bow let's go somewhere we are appreciated!" And with that, she dragged him away to do something. I just went back to my bench only to see that guard -Leo?- and Azar talking.

"...I'll think about it but now is not the time."
Azar then noticed me and turned her attention towards me.

"Catra back so soon?" I just nodded and sat back down. I saw Azar and the guard make eye contact and it felt as if they had a whole conversation.

"Hey, Catra why don't we go to the library? Gotta be way more fun than sitting around watching other kids."

"The what?"
Azar's smile suddenly disappeared before she quickly forced it back.

"It's like a big room just for books! There is a whole lot of stories that I'm sure you would like."
Well, I don't have much else to do so I just nodded and Azar smiled at me and offered her hand.

I just took it without hesitation. Which was weird. But I just chalked it up to me not wanting to decline her offer.

She walked with me straight to the library which only confirms she's been here a lot. Considering she has a room here too. As we were walking Azar was humming some tune and she was subconsciously rubbing circles on my hand.

It felt nice.

We arrived at giant pastel doors which when opened was, sure enough, a room covered head to toe in books.

"Hey, Cyra! I brought you a reading buddy!"

Wait, a what?

Sure enough queen Cyra waiting on a windowsill that's covered in pillows and she has a throw blanket over her knees.

"Hey, Azar what's-"

Once she saw me she just cut herself off and stared me down.

The bench looks good now.

"Oh hi, Catra."

Oh, that sounded so forced I almost cringed.

"Well, Catra was just telling me how she didn't get many cool stories in the Horde so I thought you could show her some good ones?" Azar was then looking over my head at Cyra.

"Oh yeah of course... "

Azar just smiled then started guiding me towards Cyra.

"Great! While you do that I and Leo need to do some research."

Oh great so now I'm going to be alone with her.
Perfect.

Adora's POV

I followed Shadow weaver down the endless halls of the Fright zone but I get extremely uneasy as we go down to a room I've never been to before. The door opens with a loud creak as if it hasn't been open in years as Shadow weaver gestures me inside. The room was nothing big just had a steel table and a chair with a lamp resting in the middle of the table being the only light source in the room.

"Take a seat."

I look towards Shadow weaver and just nod.
I take a seat in the chair and instantly feel a chill run up my spine. Shadow weaver is then standing in front of me at the table between us. She then draws something in the air. The light looks like the one Catra summoned but this one is more of a dark magenta than the bright warm gold. She then sends the light towards me and I flinch just to find it go right through me.
Huh?

"Adora."

I look up to shadow weaver as she places her hands on the table and stares me down.

"You are going to tell me where you are hiding Catra."

Some things are better kept secret

Chapter Notes

> Just wanna make something clear I think I posted it earlier but just in case Adora and Catra are about 9 years old as of now the reason why they act a bit older (especially Adora) is because of the environment they grew up in. Also love reading all of your comments they literally make my day.<3

See the end of the chapter for more notes

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"Jeez, that was awful."

Adora then face-planted into the bed which would be fine if the mattresses weren't identical to concrete.

"Careful Adora you might get some brain damage," Catra said with a sly smirk on her face.

"Funny..."

Adora then rolled onto her back as she covered her face with her hands. A crumpled piece of paper in her hand.

"Come on it can't be that bad." Adora wordlessly handed the piece of paper to Catra which contained the scores from the latest exam.
Catra then made an exaggerated expression.

"Okay yeah, that's pretty bad."
Adora then groaned as she placed a pillow on her face.

"I'm a failure." Catra rolled her eyes.

"Adora it's one exam out of hundreds. It's not even a big deal."

"Oh yeah, what did you make?"
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"Perfect marks."

"What!"

Catra held up her paper and Adora snatched it from her. And sure enough, it had a big 10/10 on it. Compared to Adora's 0/10. Adora then pouted.

"Don't let it get to you Adora we both know you suck at lying."

"But lying is needed when we are out on the field. I just don't know how I'm so bad at it." Adora was now letting her legs dangle over the bed her head in her hands. Catra looked at her then let out a breath.

"Look the best way to lie is to not lie."

"...huh?"
Catra sat on the bed next to Adora.

"There's a way to lie without technically lying. For example, let's say I stole a ring from a market and an officer ask me what I was doing that afternoon I could say I was at the jewelry store browsing. Technically not a lie I'm just not telling the whole story." Adora looked at Catra in awe.

"That's so smart!"
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Catra's POV
If I had to describe this current situation the first word that comes to mind is awkward.
Extremely awkward.

After Azar left Cyra tried to start up a conversation but that got us nowhere so now I was just sitting at one of the library tables while Cyra was reading her book. I noticed every once in a while she would look in my direction but whenever I tried to meet her gaze she would look away. I gave up trying to meet her face after a while. Eventually, I started to feel cold so I grabbed Adora's
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blanket and wrapped it around my shoulder. It's starting to smell less and less like her.

That got Cyra's attention.

"Did that belong to a friend from the Horde?"
I was startled slightly when Cyra suddenly spoke and it took me a second to process her words.

"Uh...yeah."

I subconsciously clutched it tighter to myself. Cyra seemed to notice and closed her book.

"You miss them don't you?"

I nodded instantly. I would deny it if Adora ever asked. Cyra then clasped her hands together.

"Well you could always talk to me about them... you know if you'd like?"
I must've looked like I hated the idea because all of a sudden Cyra is backtracking.

"Oh uh... I- that sounded weird didn't it? I mean I just know that... I mean you must miss your friend if you keep their scent so close to you. So I thought I don't know talking about them might... help out. But I get it if talking with some... stranger isn't ideal but when you miss someone... not talking about them just makes it worse in the long run."

I kinda just wanted to tell her to lay off but she seemed genuinely interested and besides maybe talking about Adora will make me feel better.

"Her name is Adora."

Cyra's ears perked up a bit then she had a small smile on her face as she patted the space next to her.

Well if I denied it we would just go back to that awkward silence again. At least that's the logic I gave myself as I hopped onto the windowsill opposite Cyra.

"So Adora... what's she like?"

Where do I even start? She's the most clumsy person in the world, she always laughed at the wrong things, the biggest dork is so determined, and the most caring person I've ever known.

"She's okay."

Cyra then gave me a look.

"What?"
Cyra then started chuckling which made my cheeks heat up in embarrassment.

"I'm sorry it's just... well your pupils got so dilated and your heart started beating rapidly, then you just said 'she's okay and it just caught me off guard. I thought you were going to have a whole speech on what she was like."

Wow, am I that easy to read?

"Well is she just a friend? Or are you crushing?"
Crushing? Is that slang for murder?

"Why would I want to crush my friend?"
Then she started laughing a bit but I didn't get the joke I guess. Then she looked at me and she stopped laughing.

"Oh I thought... do you know what a crush is?"
I just shook my head.

"Oh...um. Never mind then."

"Wait what is it?" Cyra bit her lip as if trying to find a way to explain it to me.

"It's like when you're around them you get this fluffy feeling in your stomach and just want to be with them all the time."

"Isn't that just a friend? What's the difference?"

"Well with crushes you want to pursue a... romantic relationship."

"What's that?" I felt so confused with everything she was saying. Cyra then started rubbing her chin then looked down at the book she was reading. Then she got a smile on her face. She picked up the book. And showed it to me.

"This is a perfect example." I scooted a bit closer to try and read the cover. Which was difficult because it was in that stupid swoopy handwriting. Cyra noticed and read it aloud.

"It's called 'Beauty and the Beast."

"That's a dumb name." Cyra just laughed.

"Yeah your- ahem- Azar said the same thing."
The cover was really pretty it was shiny with gold vines around the spine and framing the title of the book.

"What's it about?"
Cyra just smiled at me and handed me the book.

"Why don't you find out."
I opened the book only to be met with more swoopy writing but much smaller the only letter I recognized was an 'O' at the begging of the first sentence. I just narrowed my eyes at it.

"I hate this stupid fancy writing."

Cyra blinked a few times before she just started laughing. But it wasn't that light one she always used it sounded real. She looked like she had tears in her eyes.

"S-sorry It's just- pfft."

Her laughter died down as she took a deep breath and she wiped her eyes. Then she looked at me with the most sincere smile.

"Well if you want I can read it to you." I wanted to get offended say I can do it on my own but the offer didn't sound like she doubted I could do it just saying she could if I wanted. So I wordlessly handed her the book. She crossed her legs and was about to start reading.

"Wait I wanna see."

"See what?"

"The words."
Cyra looked confused for a second before she just smiled.

"Alright come here."
She placed the book to her side and reached her hands out to me before stopping and pulling them back.

"Sorry I should've asked if you're okay with sitting with me."

Wow. Does everyone here just ask for things even when they could easily take them?

Weird.

Before Cyra could get that dumb guilty look on her face I crawled over to her and gently sat in her lap. Cyra was still for a moment but then relaxed. She pick me up gently as she pushed her legs out so she was now laying across the windowsill with her back leaning against the side and I was placed right in her lap as she adjusted the blankets and grabbed the book again. And opened it in front of me and started reading.

"Once upon a time, in a faraway land, a young prince lived in a shining castle. Although he had everything his heart desired, the prince was spoiled, selfish, and unkind. But then, one winter's night, an old beggar woman came to the castle and offered him a single rose in return for shelter from the bitter cold. Repulsed by

her haggard appearance, the prince sneered at the gift and turned the old woman away, but she warned him not to be deceived by appearances, for beauty is found within. And when he dismissed her again, the old woman's ugliness melted away to reveal a beautiful enchantress. The prince tried to apologize, but it was too late, for she had seen that there was no love in his heart, and as punishment, she transformed him into a hideous beast and placed a powerful spell on the castle, and all who lived there. Ashamed of his monstrous form, the beast concealed himself inside his castle, with a magic mirror as his only window to the outside world. The rose she had offered was truly an enchanted rose, which would bloom until his twenty-first year. If he could learn to love another and earn her love in return by the time the last petal fell, then the spell would be broken. If not, he would be doomed to remain a beast for all time. As the years passed, he fell into despair, and lost all hope, for who could ever learn to love a beast?"

"That sorceress sounds like a jerk."

"Well, technically the prince started it."

"For good reason what sane person offers a rose?" Cyra just rolled her eyes at me.

"Well then guess there's no point in continuing."

"What? No! You can't just not finish it!" Cyra then smirked down at me and I felt my face heat up a bit.

"Well, I guess you're right." I relaxed and turned back around and followed along with Cyra until I feel my eyes get heavy. I soon fell asleep when a purr started whether it be from me or Cyra.

Adora's POV
"What?"

Suddenly Shadow weaver was even closer to my face causing me to flinch and push myself farther back into the chair.

"Adora you are far too smart to play dumb. I will not ask again. I know you helped Catra escape."

Oh no. This is bad. Like really bad. I was so concerned with Catra being okay I never even thought about what would happen to me.

Again.

I could already feel my body trying to force the truth out. I knew Shadow weaver had truth spells but even thinking about lying made me feel a tight burning in my stomach. I also couldn't look Shadow weaver in the eyes, or at least where her eyes are supposed to be. She already knows I helped Catra escape there's no denying that but I can get out of this giving as little information as possible. So I just took a deep breath. That seemed to be Shadow weaver's cue.

"Where is Catra?"

"I don't know." That was easy considering I didn't know but I liked to hope she's in one of those villages I marked and that she's safe.
Suddenly Shadow weaver grabbed my chin and stared me down.

"Where. Is. Catra?"

"I-I don't know."

She let go of my jaw which I could feel tingling.
That is going to be a bruise later.

"Did you have any part of her escape?"

"Yes." The answer came out before I even think about it but before I could even beat myself up Shadow weaver asked another question.

"Did she tell you she was planning her escape?"

"No." Which is true considering I planned the whole thing for her. Shadow weaver just narrowed her eyes at me.

"When did she leave?"

"Yesterday I think." This is also true I don't remember if it was late Tuesday or early Wednesday when she left.

"So I am to believe Catra told you nothing of her escape, you have a vague idea of when she left, and you have no idea where she is?"

"Yes."

Please tell me she's done with the questioning.

"One more question and you're free to go." Oh, thank goodness.

"Do you think Catra will survive on her own?"

"No."

I clasped my hand over my mouth. Why did I say that? Shadow weaver seemed to be pleased as she stood straight up with her eyes narrowed on me.

"Alright, you're free to go Catra was going to be transferred anyway so as long as you keep this a secret no one has to know about your aid to a traitor. Keeping you on track for force captain." I just nodded. She then escorted me back to my barracks and after she left I just sat on my bed for a while.

Do I think Catra can't survive on her own?

The Castel was quiet as the night moons were high in the sky the only sound being light footsteps of Azar rushing through the halls then opening the library door.

"I'm so sorry Cy' I was gonna be back sooner but I and Leo got-"

"Shush!"

Azar looked offended about to snap back until she saw the scene in front of her. Cyra was sitting in the window nook surrounded by blankets and pillows the moonlight illuminated her in a soft glow which made Azar's heart skip a beat. Then she noticed Cyra's hand moving and in her lap was Catra sound asleep curled into Cyra's lap as she scratched her head gently.

"I swear if you wake her up you will go home a divorced woman," Cyra said in a tranquil tone but she had a soft smile on her face as she stared at the kit in her lap. Azar quietly walked across the room and squatted next to the duo.

"Guess I was worrying for nothing," Azar whispered. Cyra looked at her confused.

"What were you worried about?"
Azar raised an eyebrow at her wife.

"Seriously? You looked like you were five seconds from jumping out a window when we first came in here." Cyra huffed in response

"Yeah well, you just caught me off guard."
Azar stared wordlessly back at her causing Cyra to sigh.

"I just was worried I wouldn't be able to talk with her without comparing her to the Elizabeth I knew." Cyra then got a smile back on her face as she looked at her wife.

"But she's still the same."

Azar looked at her wife and noticed that her smile made it to her eyes. And like a big dork Azar pushed herself up from the floor and while being mindful of the sleeping kit caressed her wife's face as she gently pulled her into a kiss. Cyra sighed into the kiss as she felt herself somehow relax even more. The interaction was

cut short when Azar's hand that was on her cheek went to the back of Cyra's neck and the kiss began to get deeper. Suddenly Cyra pulled back with a laugh.

"Nuh-uh. Kid-friendly." Cyra said with a quiet laugh as she saw Azar pout. Cyra then placed a small peck on her lips and rested their foreheads together. It's all the couple could ever have hoped for they were together and reunited with their one and only child the moment was perfect. So of course Azar had to interject.

"Wow, Cy didn't know you had such a dirty mind I was just going to give you a massage." The smirk on Azar's face and her flicking tail said differently. Cyra just rolled her eyes as she continued to scratch Catra's head which just caused her to snuggle closer to Cyra. Which caused both women to gush a bit. Then suddenly Azar remembers why she was with Leo in the first place. She looks back to Catra then up to her wife.

"How hard do you think she's asleep?" Without breaking eye contact Cyra grabs Catra's limp arm and lets it fall right back down.

She didn't even flinch.

"I'd say she's out cold. Why?" Azar then crouched down again now at eye level with Catra.

"I have a suspicion and it's making me paranoid, so I want to make sure everything is alright with her." Cyra nodded prompting Azar to gently place her hand on Catra's neck and slowly lift her hair to get a better look. She observed her neck until she found what she was looking for. Right below Catra's left ear was a small mark most might assume it was a birthmark but the shape meant it was very different. "Ah shit." Cyra suddenly got concerned.

"What is it?"

Azar wiped a hand down her face as she got up and started to pace her tail waving wildly behind her. Eventually, she took a breath.

"There's a symbol on her that shows she's been subjected to a memory wipe spell."

"You mean a memory block spell?"

Azar just sighed as she looked back towards Cyra.

"No. This is different. Very different. It was outlawed a long time ago because of the consequences of the spell." Cyra then gripped Catra closer to her.

"What does that mean for Elizabeth?" Azar looked like she was about to explain but stopped when she saw Cyra clutching Catra so close making Azar sigh.

"How about we talk about this later alright?"

"But-" Azar just placed to finger to her lips and gestured to the sleeping kit in Cyra's lap which made all of her questions be temporarily silenced.

"Alright, she should probably be heading to bed by now anyway." Cyra then gently rearranged Catra and got up as she held her to her chest. She panicked slightly when Catra started squirming.

"...a-Adora..."

Cyra looked back to the floor.

"Hey, Azar can you grab that blanket for me? The blue one." Azar nodded and handed it to her. The second it was wrapped around Catra she settled again. Cyra nuzzled her hair and started walking with Azar to where Catra was staying which was also where they both used to stay back when they stayed at Brightmoon all the time. Once in the room, Azar was getting a little spot ready. Cyra walked over about to place her down but just held her closer.

"Is it wrong I don't want to let go just yet?"

"Of course not but she needs more time." Cyra looked up to Azar and silently nodded as she gently placed Catra onto the bed which she curled into immediately. After tucking her in Cyra brushed a piece of hair out of her face and kissed her head.

"Sleep tight Elizabeth."

Chapter End Notes

I love Cyra and Azar so much and I just want them to be happy forever with Catra.

We know

Chapter Notes

> Hey thanks again for all the support! I know I sound like a broken record but I love reading y'alls comments and they just make my day!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Azar watched as Cyra just sat and watched over Catra stroking her hair and looking at her with the most beautiful smile. Azar wanted to tell her they should probably leave but didn't have the heart to say it. So she silently left the room and closed the door.

She just needs a little more time.

"Oh, Azar."

And just like that, all the joy from the past few minutes was washed away as Azar's face became sour. She looked down the hall to see Angella. She looked towards the door Azar had just come out of and her lips turned up to smile.

"I was just looking for Catra to make sure she was okay."

"If only you had that mindset four years ago."
And just like that, the calm atmosphere turned bitter. Azar then walked past bumping Angella on the shoulder as she tried to retreat down the hall. She was stopped however when Angella grabbed her left wrist.

"Why can't you understand if I'd had known I would have sent the whole guard-"

"You did know! We sent a request for aid days in advance!" The hushed whispers were now becoming increasingly louder.

"You told us the Horde was taking nearby territory and yes it was wrong to not put you as a priority and I have regretted that decision every day, but no one knew they would attempt a massacre."

Azar started laughing but it sounded distorted and bitter.

"Attempt? There was no attempt! Thousands died even more injured and we had to evacuate underground! We told you we felt the Horde was preparing for an attack and you ignored us saying everything will be fine because you were too busy mourning!" Suddenly Angella's voice started to rise in volume.

"Are you saying I wasn't allowed to mourn my husband?"

"You forget he was my friend too, but I understand that war doesn't stop! I had to run an army and an evacuation, not even a day after I lost my only child! Who now doesn't even remember her name! While you were mourning one man I couldn't even have one fucking funeral for anyone because I had to find a way to feed a whole kingdom!"

"What else do I have to do to appease you!? I've apologized and reunited you with your family!"

"You never once offered us aid! Weeks after you learned of the attack!"

"You never asked!"

"I also never asked for all your bullshit apologies but you sent those multiple times and never once you thought 'huh maybe I should help the people I left to the Horde?' But no you just wanted to send bullshit apologies without actually helping."

Catra's POV
"...we sent a request for aid..."
Huh? I heard someone yelling but it was muffled. I think it was Azar. No. She doesn't seem like a yelling type. Then again she kinda looked scary when I first met her.

"Stars, they're going to wake the whole castle at this point."

I could instantly recognize that voice it sounded a lot closer than the other one. That's when my body was awake enough to recognize Cyra's hand on my head-scratching my ears. It felt nice. I started purring before I could stop it causing Cyra to let out a small laugh.

"I assume the yelling woke you?" I finally started to open my eyes blinking to let them adjust which didn't take long considering the room was already decently dark.

"Was that Azar?" Cyra looked at me then blinked a few times.

"Oh, yeah... she um...sorry." she wiped a hand down her face then looked back down at me. "She and Angella just got into an argument." I just nodded and leaned more onto her hand which had stopped scratching. Then a weird sound came out of me causing me to sit up and back up a bit clasping my hand over my mouth. Cyra didn't even miss a beat.

"What's wrong?"

"Did you make that noise?" Cyra looked at me puzzled until she got a solemn look on her face.

"It's just mewling." Cyra then replicated the sound to me though it was quieter.

"I didn't even know I could make that."

"Well, it's only used when you want something."
Well, that explains why I never heard that sound come from myself. Then when I realized why I made that sound made my face heat up.

"S-sorry I didn't mean to." I couldn't even look at her. Great finally got out of the awkward stage with her and here I go being weird. Why can't just be-

"There's nothing to apologize for, it's normal. I'm more concerned that you didn't even know about it." I didn't notice but Cyra got onto the bed at one point and is now sitting next to me. She then started scratching my ear gently and I should be embarrassed how fast I leaned into it.

"I don't know who hurt you to think so badly of yourself, but know I can speak for myself and Azar. We will do everything in our power to make sure you never have to feel you are anything but perfect." I felt her wiping at my eyes. Oh was I crying? Then I felt it all come out as I tried to take a breath but I just choked. I felt as if with so few words she completely turned my world upside down.

How could a stranger get to me like this? I wanted to scream at myself for being so weak. I've known these people less than a week and here I am collapsing at some crap Cyra had said.

Pathetic. Worthless.

"That's enough." I was in Cyra's arms and her hand was glowing beside me. I'm surprised my body didn't flinch but when I looked at it I saw it was just a light. It smelled nice. Does light have a smell? Cyra started rubbing my head and I suddenly felt really tired. I tried fighting to keep my eyes open but I couldn't. I just saw tears going down Cyra's face.

"Azar quick please!"

The two queens were still arguing in the hallway. Guards nearby in case a fight broke out but also keeping their distance.

"At least you got your daughter back my husband isn't coming back!"

"Oh! Are you gonna bring back all the others? Let me go back and tell all the kits that are orphans that queen Angella is so sorry and

magically brought all your families back!" They kept going back and forth part of the argument was just frustrations from the women, in general, being thrown back with malice.

"I've tried to apologize and I knew it wouldn't be enough because I know how it feels to lose a loved one-"

"I know Micha's dead! That fact only became a reality when no one helped us because Micha would never be such a coward and let thousands die!" Angella then went silent her face changing from angry to ashamed. Azar's face was tear-stained but she was just glaring at Angella.

"Azar quick please!"

Both of them didn't even hesitate Azar burst into the room to see Cyra crying while holding Catra.

"What happened!? What's wrong?" Azar walked over to the pair and saw Catra's face. From the mark below her ear were black veins that were around half of her face and going down her arm.

"Shit!" Cyra then looked up to Azar.

"Is she okay?" Azar looked at Cyra then Catra.

"She'll be fine we just need to act quickly. Angella do you have a good supply of healing potions?" Angella snapped out of her shock and nodded.

"Yes, they're all in the infirmary. "

"Okay come on. Did she just fall asleep?"

"No I saw it spreading and I panicked so used a spell to put her to sleep." Azar nodded. So without any time to waste they all practically ran to the infirmary with Cyra carrying Catra wrapped in the blue blanket she was now never seen without.

Once they got there Azar started rummaging all through the cupboards to find what she needed. Cyra just held Catra to her chest as she rocked her back and forth rubbing her head.

"Is there anything I can do?" Angella spoke with hesitation knowing she and Azar were not on good terms. Azar is very prideful but she knew her child was on the line.

"Start drawing the rune in that book on page three sixty-seven." Angella nodded and started working on the rune.

"What's wrong with her?" Azar didn't stop working as she answered her wife.

"She has a corruption spell on her. It's been inactive but I sensed it there I just thought it was a memory block spell- fuck! Where the hell does you keep the rosemary!" Angella then opened the cabinet next to Azar and handed it to her.

"Could've just told me." Azar then grabbed the materials and started mixing them.

"Anyway, I'm guessing whoever cast it on her has realized she's not there and is trying to kill her to keep information of the Horde's workings secret."

"But she's just a child!" Cyra clutched Catra closer.

"I know but the Horde doesn't seem to care!" Cyra then grabbed the mixture which was a paste and walked over to Catra. Azar gently grabbed her hair and pushed it to the side but it kept trying to get in her way. So Cyra intervened.

"Here." Cyra took out one of her braids and used one of the ties to tie a loose ponytail to keep Catra's hair back.

"Thanks." Azar then quickly drew some symbols around the area the scars were coming from. Suddenly Catra started squirming and groaning.

"Fuck! Get her in the center of the rune now!" Cyra walked her over to the rune and hesitated a moment before kissing Catra's forehead and laying her down in the center of the rune. The second Catra was in place Cyra started drawing a rune and hovered it over Catra.

"Come on. You're not done. Not yet."

Cyra was standing off to the side watching picking at her claws and nervously biting her lip. Angella noticed and looked to Azar. And with one look to the side, Angella understood and went to Cyra.

"Hey, she'll probably concentrate more alone. Let's go get some water for when she wakes up alright?" Cyra looked over to Azar who just smiled at her.

"Yeah, she'll be thirsty when she wakes up." Angella then walked with her to the kitchen dismissing the maids so they were alone in the room she got Cyra a glass of water and gestured for her to sit down. Cyra sipped it for a while the silence stretching.

"Your braids are nice. Last I saw, you practically had your hair down all the time." Cyra started fiddling with the hair that wasn't in a braid.

"Braids aren't a good thing for Magicats a sign of mourning. I got my first two at sixteen when my parents passed. One for my first child that I lost and the other for Elizabeth. Though I guess I have one less braid." Cyra had a soft smile on her face.

"I had no idea."

"Yeah well, you never came back to talk with me."
Angella frowned a bit but before she could say anything Cyra interrupted.

"I'm not like Azar I'm not going to get mad at you for not sending help I've already been upset and I hated it. Angella, I never

wanted your aid. I just wanted my friend back." Angella just looked down in shame.

"I'll do better from now on. I promise." Cyra seemed shocked but smiled.

"I'll hold you to that."

Suddenly Cyra's ears flicked as she heard someone come through the door. When she saw it was Azar she was on her feet.

"She's sleeping but she'll be fine. Mostly."

"What do you mean mostly?" Azar sighed and pushed her hair back as she sat down rubbing her eyes.

"I got most of it out they won't be able to hurt her but I can't take away the memory block without... without erasing all the memories she gained after the invasion." Angella seemed confused.

"Isn't that a good thing? I mean she will gain her memories and all of the hurt she endured will be erased."

"That isn't up for us to decide." Angella was about to protest when Cyra stopped her.

"She has a friend in the Horde. I don't know how close they are but judging by how she talks about her... I don't think she's going to give her memories up easily."

"Mom?" All three women looked to the door and saw Glimmer. Angella rushed over. "Glimmer what are you doing up so late?"

"Is Catra okay?"

"Of course. She's asleep right now like you should be."

"Can we still play tomorrow?"

"If Catra wants. Now come on let's get you to bed." Angella picked up Glimmer and as Angella walked away Glimmer waved to the two Magicats which they returned lazily.
Cyra then went over to Azar.

"You should head to bed you used a lot of magic." Azar just chuckled and planted a smirk on her face.

"Please I could keep going for hours you should know." Cyra flushed then smacked Azar's shoulder.

"Haha, now I know you're tired if you think that'll work."

"You say that but your face is red so I take that as a win." The two women laughed. Azar then offered her hand to Cyra and she took it and leaned her head into her neck. Purrs started, Azar's tail wrapping around Cyra they finally had a moment to breathe. Azar then noticed Cyra getting a bit fidgety and she sighed.

"We can go check on her if you want."

"Am I that easy to read?" Azar smiled

"No, I just have experience." Cyra pecked Azar on the lips and they walked to the infirmary.

Catra was now lying on the bed wrapped in multiple blankets and there were no longer black tendrils around her neck. Cyra let out a sob of relief as she sat on the bed next to her.

"I was so scared." Azar watched as Catra pulled the blue blanket closer to her and nuzzled into it.

"Do you know who that blanket belongs to?" Cyra nodded as she started scratching Catra's head.

"Belonged to a friend."

"Just a friend?"

"Oh, I have no doubt she feels more for her but she doesn't even know what a crush is." Cyra's smile was sad but she was just relieved to see Catra okay.

"That's- that's awful." Cyra just nodded.

"Figures."

~~~~~~
My ears twitch as I opened my eyes which I didn't know were open because I was in a dark room and it smelled...

Oh no.

Please I can't be back here again. I made it out I met Cyra and Azar and Angella... I couldn't have just made them upright? I tried to even out my breathing once I noticed I wasn't inhaling air and tried to back myself up to a wall or just anything to ground me then as I was slowly backing up I felt something cold come into contact with my heel.

My fur stand up as I backed away. Don't think about it, don't think about it, don't think about it.
Carefully avoiding the... thing. I found a wall and put my back against it the cold metal bringing me back to reality I took a deep breath and a familiar scent filled my nose.

"Adora!"

There was no mistaking her scent.
"Adora I'm here! Just follow my voice! Are you okay?" She wasn't responding. Maybe she fell asleep or something. I remembered my light spell and instantly summon it and look around the room. I didn't see her until I looked down.
She was lying on her stomach her arm reaching for something. She was reaching for the spot I was in. Her scent was corrupted by the smell of rot and decay.

I dropped to my knees beside her. The smell was just coming from the other bodies. She's fine. I gasped as I cradled her and
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felt her cold skin, a contrast to the normal heat she always gave off. Tears were running down my face as sobs started.

"Adora! Please come on!" I started shaking her but she didn't even twitch.

"Adora!"

Just then the large door opened and Shadow weaver was standing in the doorway. Like instinct, I covered her body. Please don't take her away she's fine. She's just sleeping.

"Look what you've caused. I've always told you you are only meant for destruction. Now Adora has suffered the consequences in your place."
~~~~~~
I woke up screaming and hyperventilating my eyes darting around for Adora.

"Hey, are you alright?" Cyra's voice didn't register.
Where's Adora? I want Adora! Cyra then sat next to me on the bed. "Sweetie I need you to look at me."

But Adora.

"You're safe. I promise but I need you to calm down. Then we can talk about Adora alright?"
I know I'm safe that's not what I'm worried about. I looked at Cyra which was hard because I had tears blurring my vision. My breath was ragged and all my senses were in overdrive making everything so loud.

"I need you to take a deep breath can you do that for me?" I tried but it got cut short by the lump in my throat and I tried again but with the same result which just made me panic more.

"Hey, hey it's okay, just try to follow my breathing okay?" I nodded and tried following it still didn't work at first but after a few times, I was getting the hang of it.
~~~~~~

"Good. Is it okay if I touch you?" I nodded without hesitation. Cyra gently cradled me in her arms and wrapped Adora's blanket around me which I appreciated. Cyra started purring and for some reason that made me relax.

After a few minutes of her purring and me getting my crying under control, Cyra started to talk to me.

"Bad dream huh?" I just nodded not even wanting to think about the dream. Cyra didn't question it just gently rubbing my head until we both hear footsteps. Azar walked in and instantly focused on me.

"Oh thank the stars you're okay!" Before I knew it I was in a three-person hug. Didn't even know that was a thing. Azar pulled back and she was crying?

"What happened?"

Azar and Cyra looked at each other with concerned glances before Azar sighed.
"You had a curse on you I thought it was... something else but I assume whoever cast it on you in the Horde must've realized you were gone and wanted to make sure... no information got out about the Horde." I didn't even bother listening to the last part. Shadow weaver knows. She'll go straight to Adora. Adora can't tell a lie to save her life and even if she could Shadow weaver could just use a truth spell.

Images of Adora's dead body flashed in my mind. Cyra must've noticed me starting to panic.

"Are you alright?"

"I need to go back." I was already starting to get up but Cyra stopped me.

"What? Go back where?"

"To the Horde!"

That's when Azar spoke up and tried to put me back on the bed.

"What! Are you crazy? Why on Etheria would you do that?" I found myself getting frustrated. They're wasting my time! I started fighting against Azar's grip but she wasn't relenting.

"Let me go! She'll die if I don't get to her in time!" Then Azra just picked me up by the scruff of my neck. My body going slack.

Didn't know that was a thing.

"Absolutely not!" I flinched as I heard her voice pick up and started hissing at her.

"Let me go!"

"We can't lose you again!"

What? Suddenly all my fight was gone. What were they saying? Azar just sighed and placed me back on the bed with Cyra who placed me back into her lap keeping a protective grip around me. Whether It was to comfort me or to keep me still I couldn't tell.

"Listen I knew you had a spell cast on you because you have a mark under your ear." I felt under both of my ears trying to feel for it but I'm guessing it's long faded and is now just a scar.

"Why didn't you say anything?" Azar just sighed.

"I thought it was just a memory wipe spell and said nothing." Memory wipe? That makes a lot of sense. I always thought I just forgot everything before the Horde. But still

"Why wouldn't you tell me? Can I get them back?" This information of being able to get my memories back suddenly has me excited. Cyra looked to Azar and shook her head.

"To give you your memories back, you would have to lose all the new ones. It's a type of fail-safe to make sure the person won't try and get their memories back." So all of the answers I've ever

wanted I can gain and forget all about Shadow weaver and the Horde and

Adora.

Oh. I looked to Cyra and it's like she read my mind. Cyra just held me tighter. Azar then spoke.
"It's okay Catra we didn't expect you to give up years of memories."

"Did- did you know me before?" Both the feline's eyes went wide before Azar nodded. That made Catra perk up.

"Then it's okay, right? Do you know where I came from? Do I have any family?" I felt both women tense.

Oh.

"If you don't wanna tell me it's okay. I doubt they would want to see me." Just then Cyra rearranged herself and looked me in the eyes cradling my face.

"You honestly can't think that." I wanted to learn into the touch but I was a little bitter.

"My parents left me in a box at the Fright Zone."
Azar and Cyra then looked at me with such sad eyes.

"Is that what they told you?" I just nodded Cyra then gripped me not hard but not as gently as before.

"There was an attack on Halfmoon four years ago and you were taken. I assure you no one willingly gave you to the Horde." I just scoffed.

"How would you know?" Cyra bit her lip and glanced at Azar and she sat beside her and nodded.

"We know because...

We are your parents."

Chapter End Notes

Duhn Duhn duhn....

Sleep

Chapter Notes

> Sorry for late update my work schedule changed so I had work. Again i know I've said it a bunch but thank you for all the support and great comments!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV

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I stared at the catgirl as she forced down the ration bar I gave her.

"So what can I call you? What about kitty!" I got excited but the girl gagged at me as if she was about to vomit. I cringed.

"Okay, so not a fan. Hmmm, what about Adora? We can match." She shook her head quickly.

"No that's stupid." I let out a huff

"Fine then what about just cat?" She just stared at me.

"Yeah, I wasn't liking it either." We sat there for a while with the catgirl eating while I was giving her name suggestions.
~~~~~~

"What about just Catra?" She seemed to perk up at that. So I kept going with it.

"It's Adora and cat put together!"

"Well, not the best but it's okay." I beamed at her.

"Then hi Catra I'm Adora. Nice to meet you"

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"Adora cadet number 367005 please report to the black garnet chamber."

Oh no. I got up from my bunk, we had just finished our tactical planning class. That was always Catra's favorite class. I noticed people whispering behind my back as I made my way to the black garnet chamber.

I was still overthinking all that happened these past few days Catra learned magic, I sent her away, and now Shadow weaver knows. Besides all of that I'm still thinking about what I said, do I think she can't make it on her own? I mean she's a little reckless, had a bit of an attitude problem, and has a hard time sleeping, but that doesn't mean she won't survive right? As I was walking I accidentally ran into a wall?
~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

"Ow!"

Why the heck is there a wall in the middle of the hallway? I look at what I ran into and see it was not a wall but a tall and muscular woman with white hair and purple skin. She then just scoffed

"Move it blondie." And left. Well, that was rude. The black garnet chamber door was open making me swallow a lump in my throat. Despite the door being wide open I still knock.

"Adora, come in." The reaction was quick which meant Shadow weaver was waiting for her.

Not good.

I walked in and see Shadow weaver leaning over her cauldron.

"Shadow weaver. You wanted to see me?" She turns around at my voice and I notice her face, or more so her mask, has a pitiful expression. She then offers her hand to me which I took with slight hesitation. I felt so cold compared to Catra's. She pulled me up on a step to look into the cauldron.

"We had a squadron return from the whispering woods this morning and sadly they found Catra." What? Is she okay? Oh no,

she'll be killed for defecating. Why the heck was she still in the woods!

"Sadly she didn't make it long."

"What?" Shadow weaver then made me look into the cauldron which showed what I assumed to be the whispering woods but there was a crasher skiff. I looked at the tag number and saw a faded 14. That's the one Catra took. It looked like it had been there for days as vines and moss began to form around it.

There's no way. It can't.

"Why are you showing me this?" Shadow weaver sighed as she placed a hand on my shoulder.

"We found evidence that Catra was killed."

And just like that, everything stopped. Catra's gone?

"No I- I would know she- she can't..." my whole body was trembling as I tried to hold back my tears. "A-are you sure? You know Catra she's sneaky and hides, surely she made it out"

"She came in contact with a princess all that was left was a lifeless husk of a body."

I couldn't tell if the shock that went through my body was from how Shadow Weaver said it or the actual information. I didn't even realize I was crying till Shadow weaver started wiping my tears.

"I know you are... hurt by this information but I assure you this is the best way it could've ended. We both know Catra wouldn't have last one day in the war and this further proves it."

That's all wrong. The best way it could've ended is we won and we got to be together forever. I want to argue but I couldn't even speak properly. Shadow Weaver was then caressing my face.

"Know that this is a tragedy but I hope you now understand why we must rid the world of tyrannical princesses. They have no remorse and kill for sport." I always knew that but why Catra? Out of everyone on Etheria, why did it have to be the one person I care about the most. It's not fair.

I need to calm down.

I can cry later,

when Shadow weaver isn't here.

Then I felt arms around me and a hand stroking my head.

"It's alright Adora." And just like that, I broke down in Shadow weaver's arms. Why did I let her go? I should've just fought for her, instead, did what would help me in the long run. Now here I am being comforted and Catra...Catra is dead. I was trying to calm my breathing but everything just hurt.

"I know you think I disliked Catra. You may even hate me for it, I know Catra did." Hearing Shadow weaver refer to Catra in past tense just made the hurt come back with force.

"I know you think I'm terrible but know I only ever do what I believe is best for you and Catra."

"I- I know." I pulled back and started wiping my eyes and trying to wipe off my snot. Shadow weaver then offered me a tissue which I took graciously.

"There is still something you can do for Catra." I looked up at her hope burning in my chest.

"You can become the best and not only avenge her death but end the war entirely."

Catra was still on the bed starring at the felines with wide eyes. Adora's safety was temporarily placed to the side. Cyra never let her eyes leave Catra's face as if everything would fall apart if she looked away.

"What?"

That was the only word spoken from Catra after the long silence. Cyra just sighed as she smiled at Catra.

"We don't expect you to just accept us and act as nothing changed. We are both aware that you are not in a good place right now so wanted to wait." Catra just started completely lost on what to say. She had a family? She had parents? They were kind and loving. Catra spoke a bit hushed trying to keep her voice even.

"Do you still want me?"

Now it was time for Cyra and Azar to stare in shock. Though it didn't last long as Cyra pounced forward holding Catra close and placing her face in her hair.

"Not a day has gone by that we even considered the thought of not wanting you." Catra couldn't even cry she just clutched Cyra's back refusing to let go while tears went down Cyra's face.

"Am I dreaming?"

Cyra just let out a watery chuckle as she clutched Catra closer.

"I hope not." Catra was startled at how easily Cyra said it.

'They want me'

Azar then got overwhelmed by pure joy then scooped up her family as much as she could and just nuzzled her kit and wife. Just then Catra had a realization and looked up to her- Cyra and Azar.

"So were the dreams real?" Azar looked down at her confused.

"What dreams?" Catra described all of the dreams she's been having lately which made both women smile as they reminisced.

"I think I had them out of order though and I can't remember many details." Cyra was just smiling while Azar had this serious expression on her face.

"Well shit, I guess you still have your memories in your subconscious."

"Azar!" Catra laughed as Cyra started going in on Azar. A sense of calm and safety washed over her.

Safe. And like that Catra was reminded why she was stuck to the bed. She started wiggling in Cyra's arms as she tried to escape but that just caused Cyra to get a better grip on her.

"This doesn't change anything Adora is still in trouble!"

Cyra sighed as she grabbed Catra's face and looked her in the eyes.

"I know you want to help your friend but you have to understand going in alone is not the way to do it." Catra knew that. She's not dumb but she was just desperate.

"But-"

"When we go back to Halfmoon I'll contact some spies I have in the Fright zone to try and find your friend and make sure she's okay," Azar spoke before Catra could protest. Catra looked to Azar.

"I promise."

Catra's protest was silenced by those words as she just nodded. Azar smiled and started scratching Catra's ears which made her purr instantly. Azar chuckled as she scratched the spot she remembered Elizabeth loved. The reaction was instant as she started leaning more into Azar and out of Cyra's lap.

Then Cyra started rubbing my back gently.

"Did you know you have a real name?"

Catra's ears perked up which stopped Azar's scratching as she looked over to Cyra.

"No, I didn't remember so Adora just named me."

"That explains the stupid name."

"Azar!"

Catra wanted to defend herself but she wanted to know more about herself before everything.

"What was it?"

Cyra stopped her verbal assault and looked at me.

"Elizabeth D'riluth III." Catra stuck her tounge out.

"That's a mouthful." Azar then started laughing. Hard. Cyra just glared at her with a huff.

"I told you!" Azar said through her laugh causing Cyra to smack her shoulder.

Catra's POV

I felt warmth all through my chest I had a family.

I had a family!

And they want me. Not only that they're kind and supportive. They are even going to try and help Adora! I felt like I would just wake up and everything would be a dream but it's not.

It's real.

Cyra and Azar started telling me all about my childhood. Which was a weird thought. They told me everything from when I climbed the walls to embarrassing stories I was glad I forgot.

"Then bam! You dodged and Leo went face-first into the wall!" Azar was laughing and Cyra just shook her head with a fond smile on her face.

I don't think I've ever smiled this much my cheeks even started to hurt. Suddenly drowsiness was starting to take a toll on me. I started yawning and tried to rub the sleep out of my eyes. Cyra of course noticed.

"Alright as fun as this is I think it's time for you to head to bed."

"No it's alright I can stay up a little longer I wanna know more."

Cyra then started rubbing my head causing me to purr. I seem to be doing that a lot.

"I know you can but I don't want you overexerting yourself. Especially after today. You need to heal up."

"I need to what now?"

Azar chuckled and Cyra just rolled her eyes at her. Cyra then offered her arms out for me. I didn't even hesitate and neither did Cyra. She pulled me into her arms wrapping Adora's blanket around my shoulders and started carrying me out of the infirmary with Azar opening the door for us. As we walked down the halls of Brightmoom Azar finally explained what they meant when they

said "heal up" as Cyra rubbed my head making it harder and harder to stay awake.

"Magicats can heal at an insane rate but all the energy in their body is needed so it usually makes you want to fall asleep. So your body could keep you sleeping for days just to save you."

It felt like I just blinked and I was back in the room I've been staying in. My confusion must've been noticeable because Cyra chuckled at me.

"We can talk more in the morning." She laid me down in the nest of blankets and tucked me in as she kept rubbing my head.

Wow, she's good at this whole putting people to sleep thing.

Just before I felt myself drift off I heard Cyra.

"Would it be okay if I called you Elizabeth?"

That woke me up a bit I opened my eyes after blinking and saw Cyra's face.

She looked content. Like my answer wouldn't even matter to her.

"I don't mind. I guess I should start getting used to it since it is my name." Cyra kept her smile.

"Alright then." She started rubbing my head and I closed my eyes again.

"Sleep tight Elizabeth."

Chapter End Notes

I'm so excited to get into the Magicat culture/biology
I imagine it's a type of Arabian style with hints of Egyptian. I know that makes no sense but I'm sure itll work out. Thanks for reading!

Safe

Chapter Notes

> If this feels rushed I'm sorry I'm just really excited to get to a certain part so sorry if the pacing is terrible.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Glimmer you heard what Angella said, we need to let her sleep."

"She's been sleeping all day and besides I have to see if you'll be able to find her when we play hide and seek. It's impossible."

I first smelled glitter and pine. Then heard the voices of a hushed conversation. They're not very good at this staying quiet thing. Then I felt someone poke my nose.

"Glimmer!"

Uhhgg. I was starting to open my eyes then the second I opened them I was blinded by bright light when someone opened the curtains.

"Hiss!"

"Glimmer!"

"She's awake!" Thankfully Arrows closed the curtains and I was able to adjust my eyesight. As I was trying to rub away my grogginess Sparkles kept talking.

"Okay, so Bow, as been living in the whispering woods for a long time he practically knows it like the back of his hand! So I was thinking we could play hide and seek in the woods! I bet that you would win but Bow begs to differ."
I won't lie hearing Glimmer thinks so highly of me made me stutter a bit.

"You don't have to pay if you don't want to. Besides I don't think Angella wants us playing in the woods." Glimmer then crossed her arms with a grin.

"Already backing out?"

Bow seemed to look conflicted. To be honest I kinda wanted to talk more with Cyra and Azar but I'm curious myself if I can still win against someone more... experienced?

"I don't mind playing with you guys."
Sparkles started grinning even more.

"Great! Now come on!"

Sparkles then grabbed my hand and started to drag me out of the room. I looked back to the bed where Adora's blanket was. It's fine I can go a few hours without it. We all went through the halls with Sparkles talking.

The. Whole. Time.
I was beginning to highly regret this decision.

We got to the gardens and there was a small decorative fence that Arrows climbed over and helped Sparkles.

"Here I can help you." He offered me his hand and I just rolled my eyes and hopped over the fence.

"See?" Sparkles looked so smug you would think she was the one who jumped the fence.

"Okay! Bow count to twenty and me and Catra will hide first." Bow nodded and turned his face into the tree with his arms covering his eyes

"One...two..."
The second I heard counting I ran. First I went in a straight line for a few seconds then took a sharp left and went three trees

down and was starting to climb. I went just high enough that I would be covered by the leaves.

"Wow, you're fast."

I got startled by the voice and quickly regained my balance.

"What the heck?!" I tried keeping my voice low knowing my twenty seconds were up.

"What? I just want to win and you always win so I'm sticking with you."

Uhhgg

"Fine but if you get me caught I'm pushing you and running." Sparkles just laughed.

I wasn't joking but okay.
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after a while, I heard a rumbling sound. It was close by too. I looked to where the sound was coming from and noticed smoke. As I was beginning to move Sparkles grabbed my arm.

"Where are you going?"

"Stay here I wanna see something."

"No way!" I didn't have time to argue with her.

"Fine if you can keep up." I leaped from the tree and started making my way towards there as fast as possible. On the way, I started to notice that this is the same way I took to Brightmoon.

Oh no.

My legs started carrying me faster.

Come on come on.

I finally made it to the ending tree line and see a skiff coming to the edge of the woods.

"Jeez, you could've at least-"

"Shut up!" I clasped my hand over Sparkle's mouth and as she started to struggle I tilted my head to the oncoming skiff. I felt her gasp under my palm and put my finger up to my lips and she nodded. I removed my hand and started to try and get closer as the skiff began slowing down.

"What are you doing?!" I just ignored her as I tried to listen in on the conversation. Between a tall woman with white hair and purple skin and some faceless Horde soldier.

"Jeez I don't even know why we bothered coming here there's no way she survived this long. I mean look at the skiff it was a hard crash and judging by the scratch marks she fell into a ditch. Now can we go-" suddenly the purple lady had him up by his throat as he clawed at her hand gasping for air.

"Listen you think I wanna be out here? I don't but I'm not allowed to go back till this kid is one hundred percent confirmed dead and if we go back now and she somehow survived who do you think will get all the shit for it?" The soldier continued struggling.

"That was a question!"

"Y-you Huntara" She then let him down to the ground. "Good now start looking around. She won't be hard to spot she has cat ears and a tail.
Then Sparkles gasped.

Loud.

The women's eyes went straight to our hiding place and I grabbed Sparkles and ran. I had to leap down from the trees. But I was being slowed down.

"Come on! How'd you keep up before?"

"I'm out of teleports!"

Crap.

Angella was sitting small table just enjoying her afternoon tea outside because of how nice and clear the skies were. Then she saw Cyra approach her.

"Hello, Cyra."

"Hey, you mind if I join you?"

"Not at all." Cyra smiled as she took a seat across Angella.

"Where is Azar?" Cyra rolled her eyes.

"Sparring with Leo. Said she didn't want to slack off." Just then Angella smirked,

"Strange usually you always have a front-row seat. If I remember correctly you used to say you love the way Azar's muscles look while she's fighting." Cyra's face lit up bright red then she coughed into her hand.

"Well I wanted to catch up with you but you're right might as well get back to my front-row seat."

"I'm kidding! Come on I would love to catch up."
Cyra took a seat as Angella poured her a cup of tea.

"Thanks." Angella just nodded in acknowledgment.

"So how are things with Catra?"

"They're great! We... we told her everything."
Angella smiled.

"That's great do you know if she'll want her memories back?" Cyra shook her head.

"No, but I don't think it's a good idea. I mean if she wants to then I'll be okay with it, it's just... I feel like it would be selfish for us to take them away. Not to mention Adora."

"Who's Adora?"

"She's the one who helped her escape. She wanted to go back last night saying she'll get hurt for helping her. Azar said once we get back to Halfmoon we could contact some spies we have in the Horde to try and help her."

"You have spies in the Horde?" Cyra sighed and looked at Angella.

"No."

"Oh..."
There was an awkward silence then Angella spoke again.

"So when do you intend to go back to Halfmoon?"

"I want to leave tomorrow but Azar wants to give Elizabeth more time to adjust." Angella nodded in understanding.

"Where is she anyway?"

"I assume she's still sleeping she went through a lot last night."
As Cyra thought about it she realized it was a little late into the afternoon.

"You know I think I will go check on her. I'll be right back."
Angella waved her off.

"Come back soon."

Cyra walked back to the room reminiscing as she walked. She remembered coming here with Azar all the time when they were younger. It hurts her to see how everything has changed. Once at the door Cyra knocked on the door.

"Elizabeth? Are you awake?" Cyra waited for a moment fort then knocked again. "Elizabeth?"

Nothing.

Part of Cyra wanted to just leave her alone but her paranoia wouldn't let her.

"I'm coming in."

She quietly and slowly opened the door and saw the room empty. Cyra wasn't startled by that but the fact that she left Adora's blanket made her worry. She picked it up and stared at it as she rubbed her fingers along it. It was rough and didn't feel comfortable in the slightest. Which just proved how important this girl was to her.
Cyra remembered how last night Glimmer said she wanted to play with Catra so Cyra went back down to the garden to ask Angella.

"Wow, you're back sooner than I thought. Is she still asleep?" Cyra shook her head.

"No she's gone I think she's with Glimmer. Do you know where she is?"

"Probably playing hide and seek with Bow."

Cyra still looked uneasy but it was replaced with shock as she felt someone wrap their arm around her waist then turn her around placing the person behind her.

"Azar, what are you doing?" Cyra said as she turned her head to see Cyra hiding behind her.

"Protect me!" Suddenly Cyra saw Leo who was soaking wet and upset.

"Nope, not getting involved in that." Cyra then stepped to the side as Leo came running at Azar.
Azar sidestepped and began avoiding them as she ran.

"I'm surrounded by traitors! Shit!"

Just then Leo had Azar over their shoulder about to throw her into a nearby fountain until they hear Bow.

"Miss Angella!"
Everyone stopped laughing as they saw Bow running. Angella was first to walk up to Bow.

"Now what's wrong?"
Bow was trying to catch his breath as he explained.

"Glimmer, Catra, and I were playing in the woods and I couldn't find them so I climbed a tree and I saw smoke from a vehicle the Horde uses!"

"What have I told you about going In the woods!"
Azar was back on her feet and went to Bow.

"Where did you last see them?" Bow swallowed thickly obviously scared by the intense look in Azar's eyes.

"Right at the entrance but I heard what direction they went in."

"Take us there!"

"What are you doing standing around for? After them!" I heard the purple lady scream and Sparkles was starting to panic.

Not good.

Suddenly we came up to a blocked path. Luckily there were vines I could quickly climb. I gasped for air as I turned around to help Glimmer.

"Catra!"

Crap she's too loud. I went to help her but backed up to hide when I saw the Huntara lady covering Glimmers only exit. Not good.

"Hey there Glitter we were just looking for someone named Catra. Mind telling us where she is?" Glimmer had tears running down her face as she backed up more to the wall.

"Fuck, this is why I don't do kids." Suddenly she pulled out a retractable staff that was sharpened at the edges.

"Well, I'm sure Shadow bitch won't mind us bringing back a princess. So just comply- fuck!"

I wanted to throw a rock to call her attention away but I hit her square in the eyes.

"What are you doing? Run!" Glimmer ran past Huntara whose attention was on me.

Crap.

She ran up and stabbed her staffer into the cliffside propelling herself up the wall.

She's fast.

I dodged as she stabbed the place where I was just sitting. I scrambled as I ran on all fours. I needed to lead her away then I

can circle back around to Brightmoon. I tried to climb up a tree just to lose here but was yanked back by my tail.

"Ow!"

I scratched her hand bit and flailed but she just grabbed me by my hair.

"Wow, I kinda feel bad now." I just hissed at her and she just laughed.

"Calm down I'm not a monster I'll make it quick." Just then she whipped out a knife.
Oh no.

I panicked and just screamed as loud as I could and when Huntara flinched I scratched her face and ran. I came across a large cliff edge. Without any vines or even stepping stones. It's completely smooth.

Crap! Why now? I turn around and see Huntara clutching her cheek.

"Oh, you're in for in now."

She started walking towards me with staff in hand. I'm gonna die. And I'm guessing Huntara won't make it painless any more. I backed up as much as I could and just closed my eyes tightly. I'm just going to sleep is all.

Then I heard loud growling. And felt something standing over me I looked up and saw a giant black cat thing standing over me and flashing its fangs at Huntara.

Whoah.

I found myself scooting back into the wall to try and get out from under them but they seemed intent on keeping me in one place. Huntara backed up as she griped her knife closer to her chest.

She looked at me then back to the cat thing above me. She then scoffed and ran away.

Alright, one problem solved. Now I have to outrun this thing. They didn't take their eyes off the woods till Huntara was gone then they flicked their gaze to me. When they looked at me I saw the green eyes and as I looked at their fur and tail they looked familiar.

"Leo?"

They nodded their head then put their snout to my stomach and tilted their head to their back.

"I don't know what you're trying to say."

Leo rolled their eyes then put their head through my legs and stood up putting me on their back.

"Oh."

They meowed at me which I assumed meant to hold on because once I got a grip we were running through the woods.

Very fast.

I dug my face into Leo's fur to keep my eyes from getting dirt into them. Leo then let out a loud meow as we began to slow down. I looked up and saw the Brightmoon gardens. Leo came to a stop. I hopped off and was tackled by Bow and Glimmer.

"Are you okay? I was so scared! Did she hurt you?"

"Glimmer told me you saw a crazy lady why was she after you?"
I shrink back feeling overwhelmed by all the questions.

"Elizabeth!" Bow and Glimmer parted as Cyra came up and wrapped her arms around me.

Oh, that's new.

"I was so worried." Cyra then looked behind me.

"Thanks, Leo. I don't know what I would've done without you."

I turned my head and saw Leo was back to normal.

"It's what I'm here for." She bowed to Cyra and looked at me.

"Are you alright?" I nodded.

"Thanks." Leo smiled at me.

"No problem."

"Glimmer you should know better!" I looked over and saw Angella yelling at Glimmer. Well not yelling it looked less intimidating but the look on Glimmers looks as if Angella just broke her down. Then Angella took a breath and wiped her face.

"I was so scared you got hurt."
Then I caught Azar's scent. Then I see her running up to meet me.

"What happened."

Oh, this feels way more intimidating. I knew from experience that this is an interrogation and I need to get as much information out before I get stopped.

"Glimmer and I were hiding and we saw smoke. We went to see what happened and found Horde soldiers. Then they spotted us, we, ran but Glimmer couldn't keep up and one of the soldiers cornered her. I threw a rock to distract her and I ran but she caught me so I screamed scratched her and that's when Leo showed up." Azar seemed shocked at how fast I got everything out but before she could start

Glimmer interrupted.

"They were looking for Catra."
Well, that caught everyone's attention. Cyra then looked down at me.

"Is that true?" I looked to the side. I hated seeing her face all sad and stuff.

Luckily Glimmer had no problem finishing everything off.

"Yeah the big lady soldier was named Huntara and she had this soldier with her who was complaining about having to come out to the woods and said that she would be dead from the crash. Then Huntara told him to keep looking because she could get into trouble if Catra was found alive. Then she said 'she shouldn't be hard to miss she has cat ears and a tail." Everyone went quiet trying to process all that information until Angella spoke.

"Alright, this was a crazy day I think we all need a while to... process everything. We can meet back up at dinner. Bow if you don't mind I would like to keep you here so I can send a guard to escort you home." Bow nodded and Glimmer was quickly trying to pull him away to her room.

"You're not off the hook Glimmer." Glimmer just groaned then she ran back to me.

"Thanks by the way I owe you one!" Then she ran back with Bow.

I waved them goodbye and looked up to Cyra and Azar. They were doing that thing when they have a whole conversation with their eyes. Before Cyra sighed and picked me up.
I'm starting to get used to that.

"Elizabeth, me and Azar need to talk with you. Do you want to wait till after dinner or right now?"
it's fine. They already told me they wanted me. There's no way they want to get rid of me because I made one mistake. Right?

"I'm okay to talk."

Cyra nodded then she and Azar began to walk towards their old room. This was the first time I paid attention to my surroundings while walking down this way. I saw all types of paintings on the walls that were in decorative frames. As we turned down another hallway I noticed Azar tensed up a bit and kept her head down. I looked around and the only noticeable thing was a big mural with a guy standing in the center with a staff and a glowing hand.

"Who's that?"

Cyra stopped but Azar just kept walking and gave a short reply.

"An old friend." That was all that was said as Cyra sighed and clutched me closer. Azar opened the door as we both went into the room and shut it behind her. Cyra then sat me down on the edge of the bed and crouched down in front of me while Azar just leaned against a wall looking zoned out.

I swallowed hard.
This feels way scarier than any other time I got yelled at. Cyra must've seen the absolute fear on my face because she gripped my shoulder gently.

"You're not in trouble."

I found that hard to believe. Azar started pacing the room and that just made me more anxious. Cyra noticed and glared at Azar making her stop in her tracks and give a nervous smile. Cyra rolled her eyes fondly and looked back at me.

"So I and Azar have been talking and we need to go back to Halfmoon. We were trying to wait a little longer till you adjusted to everything but... we want to take you home. It's much safer there."

"Especially since you have a hunter on your tail."

"Azar stop."

"Cy she knows what's going on you have to admit that she understands adult concepts."

"That's not a good thing!"

"Well obviously! But you have to know she isn't just a naive child she knows what's happening."
Cyra just put her attention back on me.

"We just want you safe and we think the best to do is for you to lie low for a while and Halfmoon is hidden and most importantly, safe."

Cyra accentuated the last part at Azar. My brain is still reeling over the fact this conversation wasn't about me getting in trouble but instead about keeping me safe. I guess that's just a princess thing.

Wait, princess.

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~
"You probably have never heard of them they're very secretive but I was able to contact the Queens and they are coming to see you."
~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

Their queens. And I'm their kid so that must mean...

"Am I a princess?!" Cyra was shocked at my sudden outburst. She blinked at me a few times before collecting herself.

"Yes... is that a problem?"

Yes! Yes! Are you kidding me? Of course! Can I never get a break? I bet this is all just some cruel joke-

"No..." Cyra smiled but Azar pushed herself off the wall she was leaning on as she walked towards me and crouches down next to Cyra.

"Hey, it's alright to think it's overwhelming. I assume the Horde didn't speak kindly of princesses."

That's putting it lightly. I just nodded.
I then felt Cyra wrap Adora's blanket around me.

"I saw you left it and it just made me worry more."
I don't know if it's the care in her voice or Adora's scent but I feel my body relax.

"When would we leave?"

"Tomorrow morning."

"What!" I didn't expect it to be so soon. Cyra then started rubbing my head again.

"Elizabeth there are people after you we want you somewhere we can not only keep an eye on you but around people...I trust."

Oh.

The silence in the room stretched and I just wanted something to talk about so I decided to ask about Leo.

"What was that cat thing Leo turned into?"
Azar then burst out laughing. Cyra then gently shoved her shoulder making her fall to the ground. Which was covered in pillows and blankets.

"Leo turned into a panther. It's a gift usually reserved for the royal family but Leo is a special case."

"How do you know they're not just a distant relative or something?"

"The royal family always has the physical trait of blue eyes. Or in your case eye. Leo technically has royal blood in their body because I donated some of my blood to save their life. They've been my best guard ever since... well until I had you and they

volunteered to be your guard."
Wow, a whole guard for one person? To be honest sounds like a waste but I didn't voice my opinion. Once that conversation finished I decided I couldn't avoid the elephant in the room.

"I- I think I would like to go to... Halfmoon." Cyra then got this big smile on her face as she jumped up and hugged me.

"Oh, I'm so glad! There's so much I have to teach you! You'll love it, oh and I'm sure Bowen will be so happy to know you're okay! We can have a big festival and-"

"Cy, enough you're overwhelming her." Cyra looked and saw my tensed face and chuckled sheepishly.

"Sorry, we can talk more after dinner." I nodded.

"So can you turn into one Cyra?" She had this weird look on her face when I said her name but before she could respond there was a timid knock on the door. Azar got up to answer it and when she opened the door I heard Glimmer.

"Is Catra here?"

I tried to get up but Cyra just put her hand on my shoulders to keep me down. So I just listened to the conversation.

"She is, what do you need?"

"Bow and I are forced to stay in my room and I wanted to invite Catra to come to play with us." Azar looked back at us and Cyra was shaking her head no. Then Azar looked at me with a silent question. Honestly, I'd rather be able to think about everything away from Cyra and Azar.

So I nodded my head yes.

So Azar turned back to Glimmer.

"Alright just give us a second." With that, she closed the door and came back to me and Cyra.

"Just try and think about it alright?"

"I will." Azar smiled then put a pointed look on Cyra and she let me go. As I got up and went to the door Azar called after me.

"Stay outta trouble." I nodded and left the room. The second I was out the door I felt Glimmer about to hug me and step out of the way so she went face-first into the wall.

"Okay, no hugs got it." She said as she rubbed her nose. I just snicker and she starts running down the hallway.

"Race you there!"

After Catra left Cyra and Azar were both left in silence.

"Cy, I know you want her home as soon as possible but you can't just expect her to be okay with everything."

"I know that!" Cyra then shook her head and took a deep breath. "Sorry it's just... she is being hunted down like- like some kind of animal. The safest place for her is Halfmoon... we are leaving tomorrow all of us...

No matter what."

Huntara was now in the black garnet chamber on one knee with her head down as Shadow weaver looked over a cadet's file.

"So you're telling me you are so incompetent that you couldn't catch on a measly animal?"

"I told you she's long dead there was a giant-" suddenly a black coil wrapped around her neck.

"You only speak with permission!" Huntara nodded as she was dropped to the floor gasping for breath. Shadow weaver took a deep breath.

"You seem to have forgotten your place and respect. So to gain it back you will be sent to the crimson waste." Hunter's eyes went wide.

"No, but-" with a wave of Shadow weaver's hand soldiers cornered her and began dragging her away.

"She's a fucking child! You're nothing but an evil coward!" Huntara shouted more obscenities as she was dragged away. Shadow weaver just smoothed her hair back and took a deep breath. She then called a guard.

"Go tell Adora and her instructors that she is excused from training for the next two days." The soldier gave a short yes ma'am and left.

Shadow weaver looked over to her desk and saw a box there that she packed to be thrown away. She looked in the box and saw her belongings from Mystacor but what caught her attention was a daisy that was still fresh and alive due to the spell the giver cast on it. She caressed the petals as she heard their voice.

"Oh come on someone as dreary as you have to admit they're cheerful!"

Shadow weaver then clenched her fist and shook her head. "Honestly should've been thrown away by now."

She placed it into a nearby vase.

Glimmer Catra and Bow hung out until dinner which was mostly just Glimmer and Bow talking about how "cool" Catra was while Catra just sat down and played with some of Bow's cool arrows completely ignoring his long explanation for each one. Eventually, Glimmer asked Catra something that caught her off guard.

"So are Ms. Azar and Cyra your moms?" Catra just nodded not wanting to talk about it. The concept of parents was still foreign to Catra and even the thought of calling Cyra or Azar's mom caused her body to flinch due to an old accident involving Shadow weaver. Glimmer then just continued to talk.

"So tell us about Halfmoon!" Bow then got super excited.

"Yeah, it's such a mystery!" Catra suddenly felt table.

"Oh I don't remeber and I haven't been there in a while. "

"How can you not remember?"

"Glimmer she's probably not allowed to talk about it."

"Oh! My bad." Catra just took the out and nodded. Then a guard said it was time for dinner and escorted us to the dining room. Luckily dinner wasn't as bad as it could've been Azar just kept quiet while Angella and Cyra talked. Glimmer was talking more so at Catra than to her but she didn't mind she liked the distraction. She knew she had to decide soon. She would like to see Halfmoon the place she was supposed to be raised but it scared her. The unknown always did. Catra then felt someone grab her hand she looked up then saw Azar squeezing her hand.

She knew her answer by then.

Catra was starting to get a bit more tired as Cyra's and Angella's conversation kept going. Glimmer then let out a yawn so loud it

had to be intentional. Angella then laughed. "Alright, I think it's time for bed. Juliet, could you escort Bow home?"

"Of course your majesty."

Bow hugged Glimmer goodbye and just waved bye to Catra. Azar grabbed Catra's hand and walked out with her as Cyra hugged Angella goodbye. By the time they made it back to the room and Azar got Catra tucked in Cyra was back. She then sat next to Catra and started rubbing her head like always. It was starting to become a routine Catra was already getting used to it. It was obvious Cyra was just trying to act like she wasn't waiting for Catra's answer but after a few more head scratches Catra sighed.

"I wanna stay with you both... and if that means going to Halfmoon then that's okay..." Cyra then stopped and scooped Catra up in a big hug which Azar joined.

"Oh thank the stars I was so scared you wouldn't want to." Cyra then started purring and so did Catra and she started to fall asleep in her arms. Before she could fall asleep though she had one more question.

"Can we finish that story you were telling?" Cyra smiled and kissed her head.

"We have so many copies at our library. I'll read it to you the second we get home."

Home.

That was a concept Catra only related to Adora.

But she decided she's okay to share it with something new.

The morning came and Glimmer was crying.

"But she just got here!" Angella was actively holding her back from tackling Catra, who was sound asleep in Cyra's arms. Not from the fact of being up early since she was used to it but when they told her she could sleep on the way there she was out like a light with Adora's blanket around her shoulders. Luckily Angella offered them a carriage to take them to the edge of Halfmoon so they didn't have to walk.

"It was great to see you again... both of you." Azar just rolled her eyes and got into the carriage. Cyra gave a shy smile and waved goodbye. Before she could make it in however Glimmer grabbed onto a piece of her outfit.

"Can Catra come to play again?"

"It isn't safe for her right now but I'm sure we can find a way for you two to meet up again." Glimmer smiled and whispered a bye to Catra as she ran back to her mom.

Leo then steered the carriage through the woods and to the hidden kingdom of Halfmoon. The way there Cyra and Azar just talked about how lucky they are and gushing over Catra's little twitches and purrs she made while sleeping. They then came to a stop by the late evening and Leo helped Cyra out as they joked with Azar.

They then come to a massive arch of two trees over a cliffside. Then all the felines just walked right through and were greeted by the guards who bowed.

"Welcome back my queens" they spoke in unison Cyra just smiled as Azar waved them off. Magicats have adapted to being nocturnal so as of now all the early risers were beginning to wake. Everyone welcomed the queens which they returned.

Cyra had Adora's blanket covering Catra not wanting people to know about her just yet as they walked to the palace. Halfmoon was still fairly large being one of the biggest known kingdoms

next to Brightmoon and the kingdom of snows but obviously, they had to downsize since the invasion. The palace was made of a warm sandstone with an orange-ish color and came to sharp points at the top. Cyra then started to feel Catra start to wiggle and begin to wake up. Cyra then got into the palace and closed the doors and dismissed the guards.

"Welcome back." Catra just groaned as she rubbed her face against Cyra's neck.

Catra then blinked a few times and then noticed her surroundings. "Where are we?"

"Welcome to Halfmoon."

Chapter End Notes

By the way Azar has one braid in her hair but it's less noticeable because of how short her hair is. She never got a braid for Catra only her first child because she believed Catra wasn't dead.

Throughout the years

Chapter Notes

> We finally made it to the end of the long, long, LONG, prologue. I cant thank you enough for the support. So strap in because I'm coming in with angst and heartbreak

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra age:9
Cyra showed me around the whole castle since Azar had some stuff to do. I think Cyra did too but she still wanted to show me around pointing out things like small claw marks from when I was little to giant murals and paintings of my ancestors.

Which had to be explained to me. The end of the tour had us at the library and Cyra placed me down on a window nook like the one in Brightmoon but the window had deep red curtains keeping the light out.
Wait for light?

I look through the crack in the curtains and there seemed to be a source of light coming from the top of the Castel but I couldn't see it. Then Cyra came back with a familiar book in her hand.

"Now where were we again?"

"They were dancing!" Cyra smiled and she sat down and placed me into the old position with me in her lap. She opened the book and began reading. She then got to the part where the beast let her go.

"What the heck!" Cyra just laughed at my outburst

"What?"

"I thought he liked her? Why did he just send her away?"

"Because he knew that she would be happier away."

"But what about him?"

"When you love someone you do what's best for them. Even if it hurts them."

Oh. For some reason, I thought of when Adora sent me off and how sad her face looked. I just shoved the thought out of my head as my face flushed. Before Cyra could say anything I interrupted.

"Keep reading."

Cyra laughed and continued the story.

As the story went on and Belle started talking about her father it made me think about Cyra and Azar. Would it be weird to call them mom? Are there different terms? I feel so dumb. Cyra then poked my side.

"What's wrong?" I don't know-how about Etheria she can read me so well. Maybe because she knew me when I was younger. I wanted to just have Cyra keep reading but I guess I should voice this now before it becomes even more awkward.

"What... what do I call you?" Cyra clutched me closer.

"You can call me whatever you're comfortable with."

Well, that doesn't help.

"What did I used to call you?" Cyra then took in a short breath.

"Mom."

"What about Azar?"

"Momma."

"Is- can I call you that?"

"Nothing would make me happier."

Adora age:9
When I was told I was going to be excused from training I expected to be upset but my body just wanted to curl up and cry.

So that's what I did.

From when my squad left to when they came back I just hid under my covers and cried. I hated it. I tried to keep it quiet but I still had Kyle ask me if I was okay. I wasn't, everything hurt. I felt sick. As if someone stuffed me full of food then put a hard wack to my stomach.

"Hey Adora, are you-"

Those words made it all come back up with violent images of Catra's dead body. I ran over to the small trash can in our barracks and vomited up half my stomach. I felt someone rub my back and hold back my hair. After a while, I just kept my head over the trash to cry.

I then felt someone pull my arm over their shoulders.

It was Lonnie. She brought me back to my bed and laid me down. As I opened my mouth to apologize Lonnie held up her hand.

"Don't worry about it. Just stay in bed." I nodded knowing Lonnie wouldn't listen anyway.
"I Kyle and Rogelio will leave you be." Without another word, they left and a whole new wave of hurt hit as I cried again.

Catra please come back.

Catra age:12
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"Come on Leo don't be a downer." Leo let out a sigh that was a tad dramatic in my opinion.

"Liz your moms would kill me."
~~~~~~

"No, they wouldn't. Momma was gonna teach me anyway but she got called in."

"Why can't you just entertain yourself with like... I don't know other hobbies?"

"Sparring is a hobby!" Leo just rolled their eyes.
I was about to just give up when a sudden idea came to mind.

"Alright. I guess this is for the best. I mean I much rather learn from my momma considering she is the best fighter around."

"It's not going to work!" I just kept walking away giving Leo a small wave. I knew I had a smirk on my face. That was soon wiped away as I was scooped up and thrown over Leo's shoulder.

"Stars you're such a brat."

I just laughed as she carried me to the training grounds. "Thanks, Leo."

Once we arrived Leo wasted no time. We've sparred before when I first came here but since I only knew Horde training meant for strength, not agility I got my butt whooped. I was embarrassed for a while but Leo assured me that it was just because I was trained wrong.

Ever since then Leo has helped me learn a few things here and there. Today though I finally got to play around with weapons. I was practically jumping in place till Leo grabbed me by the scruff of my neck. I hate when they do that.

"Listen, I'm doing this to help you but you have to listen to me okay? These could seriously hurt you. So no messing around alright?" I nodded my head eagerly. Leo then let me down and I ran to the weapon rack. I scanned through everything until I saw what I wanted and showed it to Leo.

"This one!"

"Stars why do you have to get the hardest and most dangerous one?"

"Whip!"

Adora age:12
~~~~~~
I quickly disarmed Kyle and hit the armor on his chest within the first fifteen seconds after the exam started. Rogelio was distracted fighting Lonnie and I knew he would be the hardest to take out because of his strength so I helped Lonnie get him off balance to just leave me and Lonnie. After he was eliminated Lonnie came straight at me going right for my chest.

I managed to dodge and make a sweep at her feet. She stumbled but got right back up but still keeping some distance between us. We both circled one another as we waited for the other to strike first.

This was running up my time.

I went forward and as she went to block my attack from the front I crouched down and kicked her shin as she clutched her teeth I continued my momentum and hit her chest plate from behind which glowed red.

"And there's our winner."

I smiled as my team came up and congratulated me. I then looked around wondering where Cat-
Stop it. Stop acting like she's here you look crazy.
I shook my head and smiled again.

"Damn Adora I'll admit you won fair and square." Lonnie then offered a fist bump which I awkwardly bumped.

"Yeah, thanks!"

"Lonnie." Everyone tensed up as Shadow weaver came into the room. Lonnie turned around and saluted.
~~~~~~

"Yes Shadow weaver?"

"I expected better." Without another word she left. Ever since... the accident. Lonnie has been subjected to Shadow weaver saying things she knows would hurt the girl but I just tried to ignore it. The last time I didn't.

I lost Catra.

Catra age: 15
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"Come on C, you have it all going on." I just rolled my eyes.

"Sparkles I know everyone in this place and I'm not interested." Glimmer groaned as she flopped onto my bed. Which I rarely ever used thanks to nightmares and my body's need to be close to my parents. The bow was sitting on a bean bag chair in the corner tampering with some arrows. Glimmer then sat up.

"I have an idea why don't we look around in Brightmoon? I'm sure you'll find some nice gal." I laughed at that.

"You know I'm not allowed outside don't you?"

"It's just Brightmoon! Besides you can't just stay locked up here forever." I sighed. I knew that I've had multiple conversations with my moms about it but Cyra wouldn't budge.

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"You have to stay hidden just a little longer. Just to make sure you're safe."
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And that's all she's said for that past six years. Glimmer and Bow even being allowed here took a lot of convincing. For the longest time, we just wrote letters back and forth.
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"What about that girl Vivianne we always saw hanging around you?"

"Oh yeah, she's cute!"

"Bow you think everything is cute," I said cringing at the last word. Glimmer then got up and sat next to me on the floor which was covered in blankets and pillows.

"Come on Catra you e of the most romance-filled books of all time! I and Bow see how longingly you look at couples." I felt my face flush as I pushed my copy of 'Beauty and the beast' under some blankets.

"It's- it's not like that..." That seemed to catch Glimmer and Bow's attention because they were now looking at me expectantly. I started fiddling with my claws as I looked at the ground.

"There was this girl in the Horde-"

"EEEEEEE!"

Suddenly Glimmer and Bow were both at my sides asking questions.

"What was she like?"

"Is she pretty?"

"How long have you liked her for?"

"Is she pretty?"

Then they both asked in unison

"What's her name?!" After taking a few seconds to process...that. I responded shortly.

"Cool, I guess, yes, I don't know, yes and none ya."

My face was probably bright red and my ears were down as I tried my damndest not to look at Bow or Glimmer. Then Glimmer was shaking my shoulders.

"You can just say that and not elaborate!" Luckily Bow pulled her off before I scratched her. Glimmer gave an awkward laugh.

"Sorry. Seriously though tell us about her!"
I felt my face heat up even more.

"Well, she was the first person I found after the invasion. I was placed under her care and so she took care of me. We grew up together. We would play pranks on our squad. Then after everyone was asleep we would climb to the highest part of the Fright Zone just to try and see the moons. Then our commander found out I could perform magic and... She overheard a conversation that I was going to be sent away. So like an idiot she stole a skiff, supplies, and maps. I was woken up in the middle of the night and she sent me away. I'll never forget how that was the first time I ever saw her cry."

"Sniff"

I looked up and I saw Glimmer and Bow with watery eyes.

"That's so sad!" Bow said between his sniffles.

"Where is she now!"

I shrugged. "I told my mama about it and she said she contacted her spies to try and find her." Glimmer then looked at Bow then back at me.

"C, there hasn't been a spy in the Horde since before the invasion. They recruit children and have IDs of everyone and whoever wasn't accounted for had a truth spell performed on them. So we all just stopped sending spies."

What? there's no way. Without a word I, quickly got up and ran out of my room.

"Catra!"

I ran to the meeting room where Cyra and Azar were looking over reports.

"Oh, Elizabeth-"

"Do we have spies in the Horde?"

I saw Cyra and Azar look at each other and I knew. I felt my heart drop to my stomach "You lied to me!" Azar then stood up.

"You have to understand you were trying to run into the Horde we knew you would-"

"Would what? Try and save my friend! I only agreed to your fucked up rules because you said you were trying to help Adora! You promised!" I felt my eyes starting to sting.

No, I'm not doing this. Not here. I then just left the room.

"Elizabeth!"

I slammed the door. banged my head against it and bit my lip as tears went down my face.

I left Adora for dead. I tried to keep it down but it all just overwhelmed me.

"I'm so sorry."

Adora age:15
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Today was by far the worst type of torture I've ever had to endure.

Sex education.

All the uncomfortable glances and flushed faces. Part of me wanted to accept Shadow weavers offer to let me be excused. Of
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course, I didn't understand what it was so being stubborn I didn't want to miss a single lesson. So here I am in the locker room trying my best to keep my eyes down as I changed. Trying to ignore the awkward conversations around me.

I took off my shirt cringing a bit when I smelled my sweaty odor.

Shower. A shower would be good.
Then I felt someone's hand go up to my back which made me shiver as I whipped my head around. Lonnie was smirking.

"Sorry couldn't help myself. You've grown a lot, Adora." She then bumped my shoulder.

"Heh yeah I mean I'm supposed to grow but I did get taller a lot faster than I thought. I swear my clothes are changing sizes every day. Though I guess it's worth it since I can now build more muscle mass and-"

"Shit! Adora stops just....uhhgg never mind." I tilted my head at her.
Did I do something wrong? I shrugged it off and grabbed a towel as I made my way to the showers.

Once I got in I tried to wash as fast as I could to avoid being in the ice-cold water for any longer than needed but as I turned the water off and stepped out of the shower I heard giggling and backed into the shower to avoid being seen.
Shouldn't everyone be gone by now?

"Are you sure this is a good idea?"

"Nope!" I then heard more laughter and then someone was pinned to a wall. I looked out to see if they were okay but when I looked my face flushed.
She was anything but hurt.
The other girl was- kissing?- her against the wall and sounds were coming out of her mouth sounded pained but her body said otherwise.

This was nothing like it was taught. The way they described it I thought it would be some boring military regiment but those two women were not bored. Then one of the women started to put a hand under her shirt. I suddenly felt like a huge creep and started backing away.

The tile floor was much slicker than I remembered because suddenly I was falling I flailed my arms and grabbed onto a shelf in the shower to stop myself but it knocked off a bottle of soap and I clutched my eyes shut as the loud bang of the bottle hit the floor. I then put my hand over my mouth and held my breath.

"Shit! Come on!"

I then heard their retreating footsteps.
Well, that was...weird... I shook my head and quickly got dressed and left. Ignoring the weird longing in my chest.

I miss Catra.

Catra age:17
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I woke up and I felt extremely sweaty and gross. I threw my legs over the bed as I tried to stretch and stand up to take a shower but a big wave of nausea went over me and I had to sit down. What the hell? My stomach then felt even worse. I curled back onto my bed just clutching my stomach. Why does everything feel so hot? I desperately wanted to shower just to get cool again but every time I even thought about getting up my stomach screamed at me making me curl up more.

That was the endless cycle till I heard a soft knock at the door. "Elizabeth? Are you alright?" I wanted to just say I'm fine so she would leave. Ever since I found out they lied about my friend's safety for literal years! Nothing has been the same. I no longer slept with them, instead of in my bed. Despite the nightmares, and while we talked it was always short. I didn't even train with Azar anymore just with Leo. It hasn't been this awkward since I first was reunited with them. I wanted to stay resilient but I
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honestly felt like I was dying. So in response, I just let out a groan of pain.
That got Cyra's attention as she opened the door and came next to me. She saw the state I was in and felt my head.

"Oh, sweetie."

"Everything...hurts... so hot... I think I'm dying..."

"I know I know."

I raise my brow at her as I curled in on myself when I felt another pulse of pain go through my stomach. Cyra then rubbed my head.

"You're going through heat. Usually, it happens around puberty but since your body didn't feel safe it pushed it off."

"What does that mean?"

"It means you're not dying." Cyra got up and I suddenly felt a pull.

I don't want her to leave. I reached for her hand and mewled before I could stop myself. Cyra seemed to be expecting it and smiled.

"Don't worry I'll be right back. I'm just going to ask Leo to get you some medication." Luckily she didn't have to go far considering Leo was stationed right outside my fucking door. Ever since I tried sneaking out...twice, Leo has been personally assigned to keep me out of trouble.

Sadly I can't test out that new plan I had because I'm dying.

Cyra came back and sat back down next to me. All my senses felt like they were in overdrive but Cyra's scent made me feel better so I tried curling more into her but it hurt to move. Cyra then scooted closer to me and I was able to place my head in her lap. She then started rubbing small circles into my back and that made me feel a bit better.

Leo came in a few minutes later with some medication and water.

"Thank you, Leo." Leo just nodded and rubbed my shoulder.

"Hey, you're gonna be okay. You'll feel better after you take some meds." I just groaned in response. Easy for them to say they're not feeling like hot death. Leo left and Cyra readjusted us so I was laying between her legs with my head on her chest. She was scratching the base of my ears causing me to purr. She then grabbed the medication and gave it to me.

"You're going to have to drink a lot of water." She then handed me a glass and I gulped it all down.
Wow, I guess I was more thirsty than I thought. She placed the empty glass down then started rubbing my ears again.

"I miss you." My ears twitched at the confession. I wanted to be mad. How dare she say she misses me when she lied to my face? Now she's trying to make me feel bad? Bullshit!

But of course, my body isn't listening to me so I just nuzzled into her. Which she accepted and pulled me closer and hugged me tighter.

"Elizabeth I-"

"Can we please just... not talk about it right now?" Of course, the one time she's ready to talk I feel like shit. Cyra nodded and I nuzzled into her neck. She then started humming a light tune. I felt my eyelids go heavy as the ache in my stomach started to fuck off.

Then Cyra stopped and clutched me closer.

"You know I love you right?"

I sighed as I push myself closer to her.

"I know

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I love you too."

Adora age:18
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"Adora." I just finished putting on my belt when I turn around and see Shadow weaver. I saluted and stood so straight I'm pretty sure I popped something.

"Shadow weaver." She nodded her head to me letting me relax.

"Come with me." She then turned around and I followed her out of the locker room.

"Lord Hordak has been watching you. He thinks you are a fine candidate for Force Captain."
That made me perk up.

"Really? Force Captain? Lord Hordak said that about me?" I'm sure my eyes were sparkling.

"Oh yes. He sees great promise in you. He has elected you the honor of leading a squadron in the invasion of the rebel Fortress of Thaymor."

"Thaymor? You mean we're finally seeing active duty? " finally! I can get out of the Fright Zone. Maybe I could stop by the edge of the whispering woods! There might be a chance-

"You are seeing active duty." Shadow weaver made sure to accentuate the first word.

"But-"

"Adora." I stopped talking immediately. Shadow weaver then came up to me caressing my face.
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"You should know better than anyone that sending out a cadet that's not ready is a death sentence. Would you like to lose the rest of your team?" I was only able to shake my head. Every time... she was mentioned I had a hard time keeping the lump in my throat down.

Shadow weaver then stood up straight and stretched out her hand to me which produced a dark cloud that then formed the force captain badge.

I took it without hesitation.

Chapter End Notes

> Kinda sad Azar wasn't very prominent in this chapter but her trauma will come soon enough.

To get out

Chapter Notes

> Welcome back! Sorry for taking so long to upload I got done with this chapter early and started working on the next and for got to upload this one. Oops.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"Stop right there!" A Halfmoon guard yelled as others began the pursuit of a hooded figure.
'
Shit shit shit!'
The feline went directly through the town square weaving through the crowds. They then hopped one of the nearby buildings scaling up the sides. One of the guards groaned in frustration.

"Cut them off!"

'Not good.'

The figure then ran on all fours heading straight for the gate responsible for keeping the kingdom hidden.
The guards were there waiting just outside the chamber holding the gate. The person didn't stop however running through them like nothing. One tried to grab them but was knocked back as they used the guard as a stepping stool to get higher ground.

"Uhgg! I don't get paid enough for this!" The last guard said as they took a stance in front of the door. The figure then ran at them claws exposed and as the guard went for a block the figure used the armor on their shoulder to dig their claws into and propel into the chamber quickly closing the door behind them.

"Shit." The hooded feline leaned against the door and took deep breaths trying to get their breathing back. They then heard slow

clapping.

"Record time. You're getting faster." That just made the person snarl as they saw Leo with a smirk on their face. Standing right in front of the gate.

'Great.'

"Uhhggg!" The feline then ran at Leo trying their best to land one hit on them but Leo dodged each hit effortlessly.

"Come on! You're better than this."
This seemed to piss off the feline more. They then went for a quick direct hit. Leo grabbed them by the arm and threw them over their shoulder. The figure then rolled across the floor.
Leo let out a whistle.

"I've taught you better than to try and get a direct hit on me."

"I wasn't aiming for you." Leo looked confused until they saw they propelled the figure straight to the gate. Without a second thought, they got up and ran to the gate.

'This is it! I'm coming-'

"Ah!" Suddenly a net was dropped on the culprit.

"Cheater!"

Leo laughed. "I know but it was just a precaution. I never thought you would make it past me. Good job." The once hooded figure huffed as the net removed the hood revealing none other than princess Elizabeth D'riluth III.
She crossed her arms.

"This is so unfair." Leo laughed as she untangled Catra from the net. The second she was free however Leo placed cuffs on her hands.

"Oh come on! Isn't this a bit excessive?"

"Last time I let you walk back freely we had two guards in the infirmary and my tail was sore for weeks." Catra rolled her eyes

"I've already apologized like a million times."

"And I expect another million."

They walked out of the chamber and all of the guards were starting to get up. As they walked past Leo nudged Catra's shoulder and nudged their head to the guards causing Catra to let out a huff.

"Sorry guys." All of them groaned in response except one who ran up to Catra.

"You have to teach me how you did that claw thing with the armor!"

"No way, then you'd catch me." The guard pouted.

"Ineer! Come on!" He smiled sheepishly and waved bye to Catra. As they walked back to the palace people talked to Catra.

"Princess! How was today's attempt?"

"You know better and better. Leo had to cheat this time!" Leo just pulled Catra along grumbling as she laughed. Then Catra's chipper mood died down as an orange and white Magicat approached her. 'Oh, brother.'

"Oh, my starts, Elizabeth!"

Leo jabbed Catra's shoulder and gave her a look. Catra then put on a strained smile.

"Hey, Vivianne."
It sounded sincere enough because Vivianne smiled.

"Are you doing anything later?"

"Yeah, actually I was just getting arrested soon...
Yeah..." Catra then kept walking pushing Leo forward. Vivianne then yelled from afar.

"Maybe later then!"

'Definitely not.'

"Maybe!"

"Jeez, Liz maybe try to be nice."

"I was." Vivianne was the general's daughter and one of the only other girls around Catra's age. The fact her dad was always around the castle didn't help either. So she got attached to Catra and if Catra hasn't been around her in a while she would complain to her dad, who would complain to Azar, which in turn made Catra spare a day for her.

Catra always thought that just encouraged her behavior but whatever.

Finally, the pair made it to the palace with the guards at the door bowing.

"Welcome back princess."

"Uh-huh."
Catra was well aware of where Leo was taking her the same place she was taken to every time she attempted to get out of the kingdom-

"Seriously? Can you not go one day?"
Azar's study.

"Come on your guards are getting free training. And no one was injured!" Azar raised a brow to Leo who just shrugged. Azar sighed.

"Thank you, Leo. I'll take it from here." Leo went to take off the cuffs but Catra was already out and offered them the cuffs.

"If you could've gotten out why didn't you?"

"To show how sorry I was about the tail incident." Leo huffed and snatched it from her hand.

"Have fun with that!" Leo then closed the door to Azar's study. Azar ran a hand through her hair.

"Just sit down I need to finish up a report." Catra laid down on the couch in the room as Azar sat back down and continued working while Catra just picked at her claws.

Eventually, Azar finished and put away the report to be delivered tomorrow. Then Azar called over Catra to sit at the chair in front of her desk.
"So
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How far did you get?" All of the serious energy was then sucked out of the room.

"I made it to the gate. I would've made it out if Leo didn't cheat." Azar laughed at Catra's pout.

"How did they cheat?"

"They had a net trap set up!" Azar sighed.

"No that was your mother. She got paranoid when you made it to the chamber the last time."

"Uhhgg, what is her problem!" Catra said as she leaned her head back over the back of the chair.
"You know she's-"

"Just trying to keep me safe! I know I've heard it a thousand times by now."

"I'm sure. Maybe you should try getting other hobbies-"

"I graduated our art program at fourteen, read all of our books in the library, completed all of the training requirements, and completed all of my schoolings. What else could there possibly be?"

"Maybe-"

Suddenly the door swung open revealing queen Cyra. "Elizabeth."

"Oh, here we go." Catra stood up and looked at Cyra. She didn't look amused.

"We need to have a long talk." Catra scoffed.

"Funny I was about to say the same thing."
Cyra then stepped out of the doorway and I left the room with her behind me. We didn't even make it to Cyra's room before she started up.

"Please tell me what I have to say to you for you to understand this is for your protection?"

"That hunter is probably long dead since she returned empty-handed."

"And that is the place you so desperately want to run back to!?"

"Well, I wouldn't even be trying to leave if you didn't lie to my face."

"So your suggesting I risk my people's lives to get a spy into the Horde?"

"Of course not! That's why I just want to get in and get out!"

"Now you're saying I send you out into the unknown? You realize you are just as important to me as all of my people, even more so. How could I sleep at night knowing I sent my daughter to death trap for just one person you don't even know is still alive!"

"She saved my life isn't that worth something? Besides, you said yourself after the first time if I could make it to the gate that would prove I'm strong enough to survive on my own!"

"Well, obviously I never thought you would make it!" Cyra's eyes widened as she clutched her mouth with her hand. Catra was staring at her in pure disbelief.

"Wait Elizabeth I didn't-"

Catra was already gone. She didn't want to hear anything else. Cyra wanted to go after her but was stopped by a hand on her shoulder. She turned around and saw her wife.

"How much did you hear?"

"Enough to know you need to leave her alone for a little while."

Adora's POV

After my talk with Shadow weaver, I decided to got tell my team about what happened.
Bad idea.

"So only you get to go?" Lonnie had her arms crossed and Kyle was rubbing his arm while Rogelio shook his head. Lonnie then scoffed.

"Of course just ignore the fact we helped you get the best time."

"Lonnie I'm sure they're just-"

"Seriously Adora?! You're just going to leave us hanging? What about all the times we helped you?"

"Lonnie I'm doing this so you guys can get more training! Come on Kyle?"

I looked over to Kyle expecting some kind of support but he just looked down not even acknowledging me. Neither did Rogelio.

"Guys come on. I want you there too. I mean you're my team."

Lonnie scoffed.

"Yeah YOUR team. Come on." And they then left without another word.

"Kyle?" He looked back at me then shook his head as he followed Lonnie and Rogelio out of the room.

This is for the win.

At least that's what I tell myself. Part of me knows it's unfair but I wouldn't be able to live with myself if Shadow weaver was right and they got hurt.

I still find it hard to live with myself as of now.

I need some air.

I walked outside of the barracks after sitting alone quietly long enough so I don't run into my squad again. I didn't realize where my feet were taking me until I was there. I looked up and saw the rusted ladder leading to our perch.
Why was I even here?

I'm a force captain now I have better things to be doing.

They could wait. I then started climbing up and felt a wave of nostalgia wash over me.
~~~~~~
"Hurry up Adora!"

"Wow, the mighty Adora was beaten by a mere mortal."
~~~~~~

"Careful dummy!"
~~~~~~

I found myself smiling at the memories. Which was bittersweet. I was glad I could finally remember her without crying, but it makes me feel like I'm starting to forget her.

As I made my way up and over the ledge I had to stop for a moment to catch my breath. How long has it been since I last climbed up here? It took a little longer than usual to catch my breath thanks to the high altitude but when I did I looked out to the Fright Zone. I always thought the Fright zone was kinda scary.

It was cold, dingy, and dark.

Catra disagreed.

She would always find some spot to show me the beautiful colors of the Fright Zone. She always said that 'Even someone like you could be beautiful if you look in the right places.' The memory hurts as much as it warms my heart. I lean on the railing thinking about the time we snuck out and I fell asleep. I remember feeling so warm and safe while sleeping in Catra's lap.

Then Shadow weaver caught us.

Everything went downhill from there. I'd give anything to just go back and fix things.
But I can't.

I reach into my pocket and pull out the force captain badge. Clutching it in my hand.
~~~~~~
"You look out for me and I look out for you. Nothing really bad can happen as long as we have each other."

"You promise?"
~~~~~~
~~~~~~

"I promise."
I'll make sure this never happens to anyone else. As I was turning to walk away I suddenly felt a rumble beneath my feet. I turn towards the woods and see a bright blue light.

"What the hell?"

I looked down over the edge to see the soldiers patrolling but they acted as if nothing happened.

Weird.

I looked back up again and looked to where the light came from. I felt this weird pull towards it.
I looked down at my badge again.
I have access to the skiffs.

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~
"As soon as I get to see active duty I'll wait at the edge of the whispering woods and the Fright zone we'll meet then okay?"
~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

I know it's stupid.
But just to clear my conscience. Besides that weird light needs to be investigated. I then started making my way towards the skiff bay.

Catra's POV

This is so stupid I'm acting like a fucking toddler. As of now, I was in my room under a bunch of blankets curled up just wanting to disappear. It shouldn't bother me. I know my mom didn't mean it.

Then why did she say it?

I shook my head at that voice. It's fine she was just frustrated and just spoke without thinking.

Spoke what she thought.

I always had problems with my self-worth. My childhood, that I remember, didn't help. I was used to it. From Shadow weaver, random cadets, even my squad. I didn't even realize how much it affected me till my moms put me into therapy, but hearing it from her just

Hurt so much worse.

I felt stinging at my eyes again as I shoved my face down into the mattress to silence them.
Stop it! Get your shit together!

If I'm so tired of being treated like a child stop
acting like one!

My voice was yelling at me and I started clawing at my head.

Shut up shut up shut up shut up shut up shut up

Honestly, she gives you everything and you treat her like this?

shut up shut up shut up shut up shut up shut up

no wonder why you were always treated like dirt get treated with kindness and you get disrespectful.

shut up shut up shut up shut up shut up shut

Honesty, y maybe you should've just let Shadow weaver take you away.

shut up shut up shut up shut up shut up shut

They don't want you.

Shut up shut up shut up

Adora didn't want you.

"SHUT UP!"

I threw the pillow that was covering my ears at a wall. My fur was sticking up as my chest was heaving out of control.
I need to calm down.

I tried some breathing exercises going over them again and again till I didn't feel like I was having my face held underwater.

I looked up and noticed when I threw my pillow I of course hit the one breakable thing in my room, being a pot of some flowers.

"Of fucking course." I wiped my face and got up off my bed. I crouched down picking up the now wet pillow and carefully grabbing the pieces of glass.

Everything went well till there was a sudden knock on my door. Causing me to jump and a piece of glass to cut my hand.
"Fuck! Who is it?"

"It's me."

I stare at the door for a moment at least it isn't mom, but I feel like I'm still going to get into trouble. Before I could respond I heard her again.
"Don't make me use my other hand."

"Stars you're so weird! Come in." Azar walked in with that stupid smug look on her face. Then it morphed to concern when she saw me crouching over a broken pot and clutching my hand.

"What the- come on Liz!" Azar came up to me and took my hand. I winced when I saw the cut.
Shit that cut deeper than I thought.

"You realize you have literal maids that are meant to do this stuff don't you?" Azar then started taking me to my bathroom and sat me down as she looked in the cabinets for some bandages.

"I don't like people going into my room. Besides it was just some dumb plant I would've been fine had you not given me a heart attack." Azar just rolled her eyes as she crouched down to wrap my hand. To which I just snatched the gauze to try and do it myself.

"So how'd the plant break?"

"I don't know."

"Elizabeth."

"Fine! I got frustrated and threw a pillow and it knocked it over, happy?" I only found my frustration get higher at I tried to tie the gauze around my hand and failed horribly. Eventually, Azar got tired of it and grabbed it from my hand. I reluctantly held out my hand and she started
wrapping it properly.

"I thought you said you are getting better about lashing out?"

"I am!"

Azar raised a brow at me and I let out a defeated sigh. "I mean. I am. I just got... overwhelmed and my head wasn't working with me." Silence fell over the room as Azar wrapped my hand.

"You know Cy didn't mean it that way."
Of course, I know that. That was what I wanted to say but I just nodded.

Azar didn't buy it. "She always thought that after staying for so long that you would stop trying to leave. She just worded it wrong."

"How do you know that?"

"Because," Azar then finished wrapping my hand and pulled it taunt with her teeth. "She was rambling to me the second you left

to explain herself." That caused me to smile a bit as I visualized Cyra being a blubbering mess. Azar then kissed the bandage.

"All done!"

"Still annoys the hell out me you can wrap better than me with one arm."

"It's a talent." She said as she pushed her hair back dramatically. We walked back to my room and I sat down on my bed as Azar asked someone to get her something to sweep up the mess.

"So I've been thinking about what you said. You know about the whole having learned everything here." I looked at Azar confused and she continued.

"And you're right you've learned almost everything there is to offer in Halfmoon."

"What do you mean almost?"
Azar smirked and sat next to me.

"If you want I could teach you some magic." I just rolled my eyes.

"Nah I'm good."

"Not illusionary magic or stuff like that. I meant combat magic." My ears perked up as I looked up at her.

"Seriously?!"

"If you're up for it-oof"

I tackled Azar in a hug before she could finish.

"Are you serious? Thank you thank you thank you!" Azar was laughing as she rubbed my back. "I know, I'm great. But you can't use it during your escape attempts or on the guards alright?"

I nodded quickly as I pulled away from her with my tail waving in excitement.

"So when can we start?"

"Let's start tomorrow." I pouted.

"Come one why waste time let's start today!"

"I would but you might have your hands full." I tilted my head at her till I heard the telltale sound of

Sparkles.

"Catra!" Both me and Azar parted as Glimmer jumped to hug me making her fall to the floor.

"Glimmer, Cyra said we should knock." Bow was just standing awkwardly in the spot Glimmer teleported them to. Azar then stood up and stretched.

"Well I'll leave you guys be." She then came up to me and started rubbing her cheek with mine while making a dumb kiss face.

"I love you!"

"Momma stop!" I pushed her away and she laughed as she left the room.

"She is so much nicer than I thought." I heard Glimmer say from the floor. I leaned my head over my bed looking at her.

"Are you gonna get up or what?"

"Nah, it's quite comfortable due to all the blankets."

I just rolled my eyes. It's fair though my bed never really "ends" I never had somewhere to call mine. Somewhere I could hideaway. I didn't have many interests when I first came to Halfmoon so my whole room kinda just became a big nest with my bed in the center and pillows and blankets surrounding it.

It makes me feel like people are sleeping next to me. Of course, as the years went on I added more things. I got a desk for drawing, some drawers to hold some of my things, and some chairs for Bow and Glimmer. I also had some other stuff hanging on the walls but most of them were when I was younger.
So I don't remember the events in the pictures.

"So what brings you guys here?" Bow took off his shoes as he came to sit next to Glimmer taking off her shoes as well.

"Your mom sent us a message from your tracker pad and asked if we could come to toe hang with you." Of course, she did.

"Did something happen?" Glimmer then sat up. From the floor looking at me expectantly.

"I made it to the gate today."
Bow and Glimmer were now staring at me with excitement.

"Wait really? Does that mean you can come to Brightmoon! Oh, this is perfect! I was just talking to my mom about bringing back the princess alliance and with you about to bond to your runestone, it's perfect!"

"Calm down Sparkles. I still can't leave." Bow then stepped in

"But I thought-"

"Yeah. What do you think the fight was about."
There were a couple of seconds of silence before Glimmer puffed up.

"That's not fair! You can beat up the whole guard and they go out for supplies all the time!"

We repeat this conversation almost as much as Cyra and I do. And I'm not in the mood not to mention I'm so tired of repeating myself. Not to mention I've already had my tantrum for the day.

"Sparkles can we please not do this right now?"
Glimmer looked at me then took a breath.

"Okay."

Before the silence could stretch for too long I started another conversation.

"Aren't you supposed to be guarding that one village right now?"

Glimmer groaned as she faces planted on the bed. Bow chuckled, "Glimmer this is your first mission as a commander. It won't be somewhere right by Horde territory." Glimmer then sat up.

"Bow she sent me to Elboron. A.k.a the furthest possible village from the Horde! She might as well have kept me inside." Glimmer then winced as she looked at me.

"No offense." I just hit her with my tail.

"Wait. Are you supposed to be guarding that village right now!"

"Relax. Nothing happened for weeks and if something did Bow gave them an emergency device that sends us a signal." Bow then jumped in.

"Yeah and I made it so when it goes off it's really loud so it'll be impossible to miss-"

Suddenly a very very. Very. The loud ring went off and I had to clutch my ears.

"Turn it off!"

The bow was fumbling with the pad until he finally answered.

"Bow Glimmer it's the Horde!" The lady on the screen then flinched when an explosion went off.
"We are starting the evacuation plan but some people couldn't-"

The screen then cut out. Glimmer got up and ran to Bow grabbing his arm.
"Finally! Come on Bow let's kick some Horde butt!"

"Sparkles wait-" I tried reaching out for them but they were already gone in a cloud of glitter.
Of course.

I always envied the fact Glimmer could just reappear and disappear whenever she wanted. She even offered to teleport me out of here for my birthday, but with Brightmoon and Halfmoon's already strained relationship having Glimmer commit treason didn't seem like a good idea.

I heard a timid knock on my door followed by a quiet,

"Elizabeth?"

I already knew it was Cyra.

"Come in." She opened the door and had a tray of food in her hands.

"I got snacks for you guys..." Her voice trailed off as she saw just me in the room.

"Glimmer was called in for an emergency. Horde attack or something."

"Oh." A maid followed behind her with a dustpan and a broom and cleaned up the mess and made a hasty exit sensing the awkward tension. Cyra placed down the tray on my desk and then stood awkwardly picking at her claws. The second the door closed Cyra started.

"Elizabeth I'm sorry-"

"If you're apologizing for what you said forget it. I'm not upset about that."

"I know. I'm apologizing for lying to you...again."
At least she acknowledged it this time. I just sighed.

"Are you though? I mean you said that last time and now you're doing the same thing again. Apologizing when I catch you and for all, I know you have something else you're hiding from me."

Cyra huffed.

"I only said that because you were being impulsive. It was wrong of me to lie to you but what would you have done in my situation?"

I rolled my eyes.

"I don't know maybe just say 'you can't leave you have no trouble saying it any other time. But instead, you give me false hope by lying to me."

"I'm trying my best to give you what you want but I couldn't live with myself if I allowed you to get hurt again."

"Mom I'm going to get hurt. It's a part of life. Keeping me locked up won't help anything. I haven't even seen the moons in years."

"Well I'm sorry you want to leave me so badly but I'm not letting you go hand yourself over to the Horde."

"Mom why can't you understand I don't want to leave!"

Suddenly I was standing up and Cyra had this shocked look on her face.

"You think I want to go back to the place that treated me like dirt? Like at any moment II could die and no one would care? Well, I don't. But my best friend is still there. I know it. And I refuse to leave her there." I realized I was crying and quickly rubbed my eyes.

"I planned on coming back here with her. So you could meet her and- damn it!" I rubbed my eyes hard and I couldn't even talk without choking on my tears. I then felt Cyra's hands on my face pulling my hands away from my face and pushing my bangs out of my face. Then pulled me into a hug. She cradled my head into her neck and I just clutched her shirt as tears fell. I nuzzled into her neck as she rubbed my head.

"Elizabeth I know you have no reason to believe me but, I'll talk with Azar about...sending some scouts to the Fright Zone. But I can only do that if I don't have to have fifteen guards guarding the gate because of some kit I know." I just laughed but it came out wet and broken. Cyra then pulled away rubbing the tears out of my face.

"So I'll try my best to find a way to make sure your Adora is okay. But you have to work with me." I won't admit how my face flushed when she said 'your Adora'. I nodded.

"Okay. I'll work with you. But you have to keep me updated. Even if you find out there isn't anything you can do."

"Alright. So no more escape attempts?"

"I promise."

Adora's POV
This is such a dumb idea.
That was the only thought going through my head as I drove the skiff away from the Fright Zone. The skiff I stole. Oh if Shadow weaver finds out I'll be done for. Not to mention I can kiss my force captain status goodbye.

Maybe I should go back.

I shook the thought out of my head. No way I'm already here. I saw the whispering woods come into view as I slowed the skiff down. This is it.
The edge of the Fright Zone. I stare into the woods and drive

through. As I go I shout Catra's name. Hoping I'll see the familiar wild hair and bright eyes.

"Catra! Its Adora! Hello!" In hindsight shouting out names in rebel, the territory is not the smartest idea but Catra is somewhere.
She had to be.

I then saw the familiar skiff out of the corner of my eye. I quickly stop the skiff and run towards where I saw it.

"Catra! I knew you'd-" I lost all my words when I saw the skiff. Part of me was hoping Catra hid. Or Shadow weaver was lying and just showed me an illusion but sure enough.

It crashed.

The roots consumed the skiff only the back end visible. Despite my hesitation, I went towards it. I looked around hoping to find any trace that somehow Catra made it out.

"Come on. I know you're okay. There's no way some crash takes you out." I found myself getting more and more desperate as my face became wet.

"Come on please!"

Please. I've done everything right. Cant I have this? Why do I give up everything for everyone else and still get fucked over!
I started punching the ground as I cried.

"It's not fair! It's not-"

"Adora."

I leaped to my feet and grabbed my staff and aimed it towards the voice.

"Whose there?"

I got distracted. Not good.

"Adora."

I turned around as I heard the voice come from somewhere else. "Hello?"

"Adora."

The voice sounded farther away. "Are you okay?" I started walking towards it as it kept repeating my name over and over.

It then stopped.

"I won't hurt you! I'm with the-" as I pushed away a vine I saw a bright blue glow. As I got closer I saw it was a sword. It was a blue blade and had a gold hilt containing a gem. It was stuck in the ground and I felt a sudden pull towards it.

"Adora,

Etheria seeks a hero."

Chapter End Notes

> So I've been thinking about starting a tumblr just for my stories (when I post more) for you guys to ask me questions and so I could post some of the concept art I have of Cyra, Azar, Leo ect. So leave a comment if that's something you guys would be interested in.

Destiny and meant to be

Chapter Notes

Enjoy Adora being heartbroken and Catra being frustrated.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Azar was in her office, once again filling out more paperwork when she heard a familiar knock on the door.

"Come in." Azar smiled as she saw her wife.

"Hey Cy, what's wrong?" Azar noticed Cyra had this conflicted look on her face.

"I just would like to talk to you about something if you're not busy." Azar nodded and got up from her desk and took Cyra to the couch to sit down.

"What's up?" Cyra took a deep breath then spoke.

"I talked with Elizabeth and she promised no more escape attempts for the time being." Azar then looked at her shocked.

"How on Etheria did you convince her to do that?" Azar knew Catra didn't take promises lightly. s very prideful of the fact she didn't break promises.

"I told her I would talk with you about... about sending a scout to the Fright Zone."

"What?! Are you-"

"Azar please just listen!" Azar looked to her wife and took a breath as she calmed down.

"She-she said she didn't want to leave. She said that she didn't want to go back to a place that treated her... badly. But she didn't

want her friend stuck there because of her. So I told her I would talk to you about finding a way to help her. And in return, she sai,d she won't make any more attempts as long as we try and a."

Azar groaned and pushed her hair back. "Cy you know I can't. Liz said she was the only Magicat there it will look suspicious if a new one suddenly shows up."

"I know. That's why I contacted Angella."

"You did what!" Azar's fur puffed up as she stood.
"Why on Etheria would you do that?"

"Look I know you don't think highly of her but she's been trying to get spies in the Horde for years and she's close. So it's either suck it up and work with her or we try and send one of our own in knowing they won't make won't" Cyra and Azar stared at each other for a moment until Azar sighed and sat back down rubbing her face.

"Fine. But this doesn't mean we're joining that dumb princess alliance!" Cyra laughed as she leaned over and gave a peck to Azar.

"Deal."

As Cyra pulled away Azar smirked as she wrapped an arm around her waist and pulled her into her lap and kissed her again. Which caused both felines to smile into the kiss. They pulled apart and Azar cradled Cyra's cheek, which she leaned into and purred. After a short, while they ended up slouched against the couch with Cyra curled up on her lap nuzzled into Azar's neck as Azar rubbed small circles into her back.

"Stars I'm so tired," Azar said as she leaned her head back against the cushion.

Cyra laughed,

"Maybe we should take a vacation. I heard Mystacor is having a celebration in a few months for the restoration ceremony."

"That sounds nice. I wanted to see how Casta was doing anyway. But could you imagine the fit Liz would throw?"

"That's a valid concern. But considering she's half the reason we're stuck filling out so many reports I'm sure she'll be fine." Cyra's eyes were now closed with a content smile on her face.

"Maybe we could take her with us? I was going to start teaching her more about magic anyway. We can bring Leo to keep an eye on her as well." Cyra was now much more awake.

"You're already teaching her magic? Isn't it a bit soon?" Azar looked at her confused.

"She's about to bond with the runestone. If anything it's a bit late don't you think?" Cyra bit her lip as she was looked to the side with her ears down by her head.

"About that. I don't think Elizabeth should bond with the amber."

"Huh?"

"I mean it necessary"

"Cyra it is a literal ceremony and one of the biggest deals!"

Cyra just shrank in on herself. "I know but... she won't be leaving so there isn't a point just like teaching her magic."

"Cyra you can't ou can keep her locked up forever?"

"Of course not! I just- want her here until it's safer."

"And when is it deemed safer?" Cyra clutched to Azar before sighing.

"When the Horde is gone."
Azar just held her wife tighter not wanting to argue about Catra

anymore. Cyra noticed Azar was a bit tenser she always knew Azar loved teaching magic back at Mystacor. Cyra spoke up.

"Maybe it would be good to take her to Mystacor. And her knowing some magic might help." Azar smiled and just relaxed in the presence of her wife and the light clicking of footsteps outside her door.

She couldn't help the small purr that left her throat.

Adora's POV
Uhhgg.
My head feels like I just got hit by a skiff. I tried to open my eyes but flinched at the bright light. Where am I?

Sudden flashes of a woman and a sword went through my head. The sword!
I sat up quickly, regretting that decision immediately as I clutched my head.

Bad idea.

Once my head stopped spinning I looked around only to see I was back at the crashed skiff with no sword insight.

"What the?" Am I going crazy?
I noticed the moons were starting to set. How long was I out? I got up and quickly dusted myself off making way to my skiff. As I got onto it I looked back to where the old skiff lay. Sand with a deep breath I turned the engine on and quickly. Headed back to the Fright Zone

By the time I got back, dinner was just called and I was able to sneak the keys back and nobody was none the wiser. I went to sit at my usual table but noticed no one was there. I looked over and saw Lonnie and them sitting with another squad. Part of me wanted to go over there but something told me they weren't over the whole Thaymore situation.

So I sat down and ate alone. Occasionally rubbing my head when I would get flashes of the sword I found. Maybe I finally got brain damage. I looked down at my rations and didn't feel very hungry.

I went back to my bunk.
Alone. And got into my bed, which felt even colder than usual, and brought up the thin blanket to my shoulders. I faced to my left and saw me and Catra's drawing which just made me feel ten times worse. I eventually forced my eyes shut.
Sleep didn't find me as flashes of women and a sword kept repeating in my mind.

"Liz I swear if you use this on Leo they have full permission to kill you." Catra wasn't ng because she was trying to hold back her laughter. Catra was practicing a spell that used static electricity and Azar snuck up on her and the result was Azar looks as if she got struck by lightning.

"My bad- but- pfft!" Catra was clutching her stomach from how hard she was laughing.

"Haha very funny," Azar said as she walked over to Catra.

"Only one way to fix this." Catra looked at her confused, then Azar poked Catra's arm sending a sharp shock.

"Ow! Not fair!"

Azar just laughed at her as she waved her hand making her fur go back to normal.
Azar and Catra have been doing magic all day and had just started doing actual spells because Azar insisted that Catra knows all the formations beforehand, which helped a lot to Catra's reluctance.

"So I wanna try something if you don't mind." Catra chuckled at Azar.

"That makes it sound like I'm your lab rat."

"Oh please, a lab rat would be much nicer."
Catra huffed at her mother.

"Thanks. So what is it?" Azar went up to Catra and repositioned her hands so both of them were palmed out.

"I want you to try and cast a light spell with your right hand and that static spell with your left."

"Is that even possible?" Azar just nodded. "Is that why you made me learn only using one hand?"

"Yep! Of course, if you want more power behind it you should use both. But being able to do two spells at once is a huge advantage." Catra gave a nod.

"So what do I do?"
Azar smiled at the determined look in Catra's eyes.

"Okay, so the best thing to do is to do one spell at a time. Since the light spell is the most familiar do that one first." Like second nature Catra summoned the ball of light into his left hand.

"Alright here's the hard part. The best way to keep the light going and the other spell is to separate the magic in you. Half to your left half to your right." Catra took a deep breath and tried to do what Azar said.

Catra felt something starting in her right hand but it was faint so she tried adding more energy into it causing it to come to life but the light in her left hand faded significantly. And that went on for a good minute while Catra tried to balance it out but it always ended with one being stronger than the other. Catra then felt herself starting to tire and dropped her hands.

"Damn it!"

But before Catra could sit in her self-loathing for too long Azar tackled her in a hug.

"Holy shit you did it!" Catra looked at her confused.

"What do you mean I couldn't even balance it."

"Liz being able to even summon a little bit of two different spells is something worth celebrating! You were even able to change the ratios!" Azar's tail was going crazy and she was bouncing slightly.

"Oh, I can't wait to teach you more!" Catra flushed a bit at all the praise.

'I don't think I'll ever get used to this.' Then they both turned their ears to the sound of a small cough.

"Hey, Lizzy! Are you busy right now?" Vivianne was standing a few feet away from the pair and before Catra could say anything Azar pulled her Catra back by her scruff.

"Not at all she's free as a bird!" Catra glared at her

"wait no im-" Azar suddenly pulled Catra around so they were both having our back facing Vivianne.

"What the hell?!"

"Liz I have been subjected to so much moaning and groaning from her dad because of a disagreement we had. Please just hang out with her for today she'll tell her dad and I'll get a break."

"You can't just deal me out like a service!"

"If you do it I'll make Cyra make your favorite for dinner tonight." Catra narrowed her eyes at her mother.

"I would but Sparkles and I have plans."

"Nice try shes grounded."

"Still no."

"Fine, I'll clear my schedule a whole two weeks off to train you and the dinner deal?"

"Uhhgggg. Fine." Azar smiled then turned around.

"Sorry about that had to tell her to stay out of trouble." Catra just rolled her eyes but Vivianne was smiling wide.

"Oh don't worry about a thing your majesty." Vivianne then reached for Catra's hand which she instinctively pulled back. Azar nudged her arm when she saw Vivianne's face fall. Catra sighed and offered her hand to her making her smile again as she dragged Catra off.

"Have fun!" Catra flicked Azar off.

Adora's POV
I sat up from my bed again gasping for air. I clutch my head as I keep hearing that dumb voice over and over.

"Adora."

Uhhgg. I place the pillow over my ears and try to block out the voice but it just got louder. Every time I tried to close my eyes the sword would invade my vision making me wake up again.

After tossing and turning for another five minutes I sat up.
Okay, this is not working. Maybe I should just go see it and my brain will be satisfied enough to let me sleep. I silently got out of my bed and grabbed my boots and jacket as I left the room. Once out in the hallway input on my shoes and jacket and made my way down the hall.

"What the hell are you doing!" I heard a whisper and jumped.

"Lonnie?"

Lonnie pulled me back out of the view of the oncoming surveillance bots.

"Don't 'Lonnie' me. Where do you think you're going?"

I don't have time for this.

It's nothing I just have to go find something I'll be back by morning drill." I tried pushing past her but she grabbed my shoulder.

"Adora. I know you're acting weird because I was a bitch to you but come on what's happening?"

"If I tell you you'll think I'm crazy."

"Try me."

"I went to the whispering woods and found a bright sword sticking out of the ground and then I touched it because it was calling my name and ever since I've been having visions of a lady and I keep hearing the voice calling my name and I can't sleep!"

Lonnie stared at me shocked for a moment blinked and then sighed.

"You're right I don't believe you. Come on you need help." She then grabbed my arm.

"Lonnie wait!"

"Nope Shadow weaver will fix you like she always does whenever you get like this."

What?

No, I can't worry about it right now.

"Lonnie please." She turned to look at me and I tried pleading as much as I could with my eyes. She finally caved and let go of my arm.

"I'm not covering for you. If they ask I'll say I saw you leaving... but I won't say anything. Right now. You better be back in time." I smiled and hugged her on instinct.

"Whoah, there don't get all mushy."

"Thank you, Lonnie. I appreciate it."

I waved goodbye and ran back towards the skiffs.

I'll just go in realizing I just hit my head too hard and leave. I started the skiff and headed back to the woods.

Catra's POV

"Wow look at this Lizzy!"

"Yeah, it's something." As of right now Vivianne dragged me down to the tailor's and was trying to get me to try on some clothes. I refused.
So she made it her mission to find something I would willingly wear. I had many doubts considering-

"Oh look at this dress!"

That. Look I don't have a deep-rooted hatred of dresses but they just always gave me an uneasy feeling. And that's just from looking at them! Not to mention if I had to fight it would only slow me down. I expressed this to her but, of course, she insisted.

"Look, Vivianne-"

"Call me Vivvy."

"Yeah, whatever. Not to be a downer but let's say I found something I liked where on Etheria would I wear it?" I hoped that would sedate her but she just smirked.

"You would wear it on dates and stuff like that." She then held up another dress to me to which I just backed away from.

"Okay but I don't go on dates."

"Don't worry I'll change that." She said that in a hushed voice. I heard it but it's better if I pretend I didn't. I knew Vivianne had a crush on me. She's not very subtle. I've just been playing dumb but something tells me she has something planned.

"Lizzy come on!" When I snapped back to my body I saw that Vivianne had a bag on her arm and was heading towards the door.
Hopefully, she just bought something for herself.

We walked through the town some more waving at the people as we walked. I usually enjoyed talking to them but all they were doing was 'oo'ing and aw'ing' at us which made me sick. It's nothing against Vivianne. Well kinda. She just always has this eerie presence about her. Like at any moment she'll flip.

I noticed the runestone was starting to dim meaning it was getting late. That acted as our clock and would get darker at night and brighter during the day. People always said we're nocturnal because we can hide better at night but I just think Azar accidentally cast the spell wrong and made it so it was night here and day outside. Luckily though we were coming up to the palace entrance meaning I could just eat the good dinner and fall asleep. But as I was about to give my farewell bullshit Vivianne grabbed my arm.

"I had fun. I miss hanging around you."

"Yeah well you know... things have been getting really busy as of now."

"I guess. But once I officially become a guard we'll be able to hang out all the time. Just us." She then started rubbing her hand up and down my arm. Okay, this is getting weird.

"Yeah well, l I should-"

"You know I like you right?" Well shit. Maybe I can just play it off as just friends and run inside

"Like as in more than a friend."

Fuck!

She started stepping closer to me and leaning down. Stars I hated being the only Magicat that isn't stupid tall. Vivianne then leaned lower and I backed up. "Whoah there. I'm not-"

"Elizabeth be realistic." Vivianne suddenly got this very serious look on her face. Like she was looking right through me.

"We both know you're gonna be stuck here forever and I'm the only girl even close to your age and our families already love each other. It's practically meant to be."

"I'm not going to be stuck here forever! Besides I'm not interested in dating or anything."

That's true.

"Okay but you realize ruling a kingdom is hard. Doing it alone would probably be impossible-"

"Well, that's why I have my moms."

"They won't be around forever."

"Alright and neither will I what's your point!" She was starting to piss me off. Vivianne finally got the hint and backed up.

"Fine, I'm not trying to start a fight. Just something to think about." She then offered the bag to me which I took. Vivianne then started to walk away.

"What is this for?" She turned around and smirked at me.

"Our date." And continued walking down the Castel steps.

Who the fuck does she think she is? I have half a mind to go after her and beat the hell out of her!

But I won't because I am getting better at not lashing out!

I groaned as I opened the gates and got greeted by the guards.

"Welcome back princess."

"Uh-huh." I closed the door and threw the bag in some random corner as I went to the kitchen following the smell of spices and fish.
At least I gained something out of this. I walked into the kitchen and see Azar cuddling Cyra while she's cooking.

"Ew."

Azar just stuck her tounge out at me as Cyra laughed. "Hey sweetie where were you?" Cyra said as she was wiping her hands on a towel.

"Why don't you ask your wife." Cyra looked to Azar confused.

"Come on Liz it couldn't have been that bad." I then walked out of the room and picked up the abandoned bag went back to Azar and pulled the dress out.

"Okay yeah, that's bad." Cyra then took the dress from me.

"Oh come on it's not terrible. I'm sure we can have Luna have a look at it and make it more... for you." I just rolled my eyes. Cyra placed the dress back and went back to watching over the food.

"So I'm guessing you and Vivianne hung out?" I just groaned in response.

Cyra just laughed at my misery. "She isn't that bad Elizabeth. She just likes having someone around her age she can talk to."

"Yeah yeah. I've heard that a thousand times already. She just I don't know. It's like she expects everything to go her way."

"Did something happen?" Cyra then looked at me with a sad look.

"N-no nothing. I mean besides the usual." I told myself I didn't tell them because they would overreact but part of me was scared they would just tell me that Vivianne was right. Cyra smiled and Azar spoke,

"Well, now you can learn magic for the next two weeks and can probably not have to see her again for a good month."

I laughed.

"Momma, why don't you just tell her dad to fuck off?"

"Elizabeth." I cringed at Cyra's tone.

"Sorry."

Cyra rolled her eyes as she started putting the food on plates. I will always like Brightmoons sweets but the meat with all the spices we have here is the best by far. My mouth was already watering at the thought.

"Okay, enough talking of our bad day let just eat some nice food and then sleep like the dead."

"Yeah!"

Adora's POV
Why do I always find myself in the stupidest situations? Oh, that's right because my brain physically wont allow me to go to sleep at night just because of some dumb most likely hallucination. I decided to leave the skiff at the edge of the woods figuring it's significantly easier to walk through the woods on foot. I was wandering around for a good fifteen minutes before I just groaned in frustration.

"Are you kidding me! Jeez, I must look like a total idiot!" Then again if I'm completely alone out here I doubt anyone saw me waste my time. I was about to head towards the skiff when I saw Catra's old skiff. I looked to the sky.
I still have some time to spare.

I started going around the woods picking flowers and other nice-looking florals. I also grabbed some stones and two small logs that looked as if they were placed just for what I had in mind. I stuck one of the logs into the ground in front of the skiff wreck and used some vines to tie the other log across the first one forming a tilted cross for a marker. I then placed the stones in a small circle around the front of it. Finally, I arranged the flowers inside the small circle. I then sat right in front of the pitiful memorial.

"Sorry, y it's not the best. I know you always said that you didn't need an actual burial but... I'm being selfish aren't I?" I clutched at my pants to keep myself from crying.

"I still miss you. Every day I wake up wishing you were there."

"Adora." I turned around towards the voice. Of course, now it shows up! I wipe my eyes and stand up making my way towards the voice. As I walk further I see it.

The sword! I was about to make a run for it when I suddenly heard voices.

"Bow, just let me lead the way, okay?"

Oh no.

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading! Love all the comments and can't wait to show you guys more of this story!

Questions instead of answers

Chapter Notes

> Welcome back! I swear it feels like months between each update for me. I wanted to try and get through 'The sword part 1 and 2' but I feel as if I already rushed though it enough so you're gonna have to bare with me.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"The trackpad says otherwise."

"It's this way--"

I didn't even have time to consider running when I saw a boy wearing a crop top and a girl with glitter in her hair. We all stared at each other for a moment until the sparkly one screamed.

"Horde soldier!"

"I see her!" Then they both started yelling towards me. I snapped out of my shock and got into fighting formation. I then remembered the sword.

Sword first. Fight later.

I ran to the sword but the girl was suddenly by the sword.
A princess!
I grabbed the sword but the girl threw it to the boy.

"Bow catch!"

Uhhg.

"Give me the sword." Of course, I would run into trouble just trying to get a sword.
As I ran the girl jumped on my back and started pulling my hair.

"Get off!" Then I felt an extra weight on me as the boy flopped onto me.
I fought against them as I tried to grab the sword. Almost got it. I touched it and suddenly there was another flash of light.

Suddenly I was in a blue room and the woman that's been haunting me was standing in front of me.

"Hello, Adora."

"Who are you? What is going on?"

"My name is Light Hope. I have been waiting a long time for you, but I could not reach you until you forged your connection with the sword." I gasped.

"You sent the sword?" Finally, I'm starting to get answers!

"The sword is meant for you. Etheria needs of you, Adora. Will you answer its call? Will you fight for the honor of Grayskull?" Now I'm once again confused.

"What are you talking about? What-- What is-- What's Grayskull? You're not making any sense! I don't understand"

Light hope then gave a very vague.

"You will." Then everything was once again beginning to fade.

"Wait!" When I tried reaching for her with my hand but it only went through her and my world went dark again.

"Oh, Gods is she dead?!" Bow and Glimmer were now off of the Horde soldier who was passed out and tied up.

"No, I don think so." Glimmer then started poking her with the hilt of the sword.

"Glimmer!"

"What?" Bow snatched the sword from Glimmer.

"We don't go around poking unconscious people!" Glimmer rolled her eyes.

"Oh please, it's the least a Horde soldier deserves." Glimmer then glared at the still unconscious girl.

"Glimmer you don't know that. I mean Catra technically was a Horde soldier."
Glimmer scoffed.

"That's different! C didn't have a choice!"

"Maybe she didn't either." The conversation was cut short when the girl started groaning. Glimmer took the sword and they both got on either side of her as she started opening her eyes.

"She's awake!"

Adora opened her eyes, which widened when she saw her wrist bound. "What happened?"

"Quiet, Horde spy, I ask the questions. How did you make it this far into the Whispering Woods?"
Adora looked at her confused.

"I just walked in. And I'm not a spy!" Glimmer rolled her eyes.

"Sure, sure. You just so happened to find yourself in the Whispering Woods, like you just so happened to try and steal our sword."
Adora then rolled her eyes.

"It's not yours! I found it first."

"The Whispering Woods is under the Rebellion's protection. You were lucky to make it as far as you did. Come on, Bow. Let's get this spy back to Bright Moon where she can be interrogated properly." Glimmer then pulled Bow so their backs were to the Horde soldier.

"This is perfect. Not only do we First One's tech for the rebellion, but we've also captured a Horde spy. My mom's gonna be so impressed." Bow looked as if he was going to say something but Glimmer put her attention back onto Adora.

"Now come on, on your feet."

Adora's POV
Well isn't this just great. Not only am I now captured, by a princess no less. Judging by the placement of the moons it is too late for me to even think about making it back before breakfast.

"It's fine, okay? Just let me figure this out."
And now my captors were fighting over directions. Suddenly the archer was talking to me.

"Sorry about her. Usually, she's nice." I find that hard to believe. I just turned my head away from him finding the ground much more interesting.

"Not much for talking, huh?" I just scoffed,

"I prefer not to swap pleasantries with my captors." The boy just shrugged. The princess then teleported away.

"Why are you with her? You do realize what people like her do?"

He only raised a brow at me.

"What do you mean by people like her?"

"Princesses!" He kept that stupid confused look on his face. Seriously people cant be this trusting!

"They're violent instigators who don't even know how to control their powers."

"Is that what Hordak told you?" As I went to correct him we heard a pained sound come from the princess and the boy dragged me along. We came to a stop at a destroyed village.

"What happened to this place?" The princess turned towards me and got into my face pointing a finger in my face.

"Don't play dumb with me. I bet you were part of the raiding party that did this!" I pushed her hand away.

"What are you talking about? The Horde didn't do this." She then grabbed my bound wrist and dragged me to a bot practically showing off the Horde symbol.

"Oh yeah? You're a heartless destroyer, just like all the rest of your people."

"I'm not a destroyer! If anything you people are why this war is still happening!" I saw her hands start to glow as she turned towards me.

"We were perfectly content before the Horde showed up!"

"You're just upset the Horde doesn't allow you to go around hurting innocent people just because you have magic!"

"We have never used our magic against innocent people! Can you say the same?"

"Liar! I know for a fact you have killed at least one person who didn't deserve it!"

"Oh please. No one in the Horde is innocent! They probably deserved it."

It was like that incident with Lonnie all over again. Except for this time I didn't regret it afterward. I hit her with as much force as I could with both fists that were bound together. The girl clutched her nose and then I went to hit her again but was held back by the boy.

"She was a fucking child! What on Etheria could a six-year-old do that makes her deserve to be killed!?" Before anyone could

respond we all felt the ground shake beneath us.

"Oh no." The boy then dragged both me and the girl back as a giant bug came out of the trees.
We all screamed. The girl then started throwing glitter at the monster and the boy was helping her.

Leaving the sword unattended.
I ran towards it and picked it up it felt heavy in my hands. I was about to make a run for it when I saw the bug throw the girl putting her in a bad spot. The boy didn't look any better.

I had the sword I could run now and maybe Shadow weaver will take the sword and have mercy. I notice the beast closing in on the pair.

'Oh please. No one in the Horde is innocent! They probably deserved it.'

If I just leave I have nothing on my conscience. They kidnapped me and said my friend deserved to die. I have the moral high ground.
I look into the sword and back at the two who are about to be eaten.

I'm gonna regret this.

"Hey, bug brain!" The bug whipped its head around and started coming at me.

"Come on, Magic Sword. Oh, where's a blinding flash of light when you need one?"
Oh wow, it is fast.
It suddenly threw its claw towards my head and I put up the sword blocking it.

"Adora..." oh great the voice is back.

"Will you fight for the honor of Grayskull?"
The words echoed in my head and like instinct, the word fell out

of my mouth.

"For the honor of Grayskull!"

"Lonnie." The mentioned girl flinched as she heard Shadow weaver's voice.

"Yes ma'am?"

"Come with me." Lonnie audibly gulped as she followed Shadow weaver to her Oh so lovely black garnet chamber.

"Force captain Adora is missing. Do you have any information on her whereabouts?"

"No ma'am. Adora and I aren't talking as of now." Shadow weaver turned to face the girl.

"Last I remember I told you it was your responsibility to keep an eye on her."

"Yes but-"

"Quiet cadet!"

Lonnie snapped her mouth shut.

"Honestly I expected you to be better than Catra yet here you are unable to even know Adora's whereabouts."

Lonnie but her tounge to remain quiet. Shadow weaver then walked over to her garnet as she took a deep breath.

"No matter. I know where she is."

"So am I free to go?"

"Oh no. You are going to get Adora back. And then hope by Hordak's grace you are allowed to continue staying with the

Horde." Lonnie just stared in disbelief.

"But-"

"Go!" Lonnie nodded and ran out the door and ran to Rogelio and Kyle.

'There's no way in hell I'm doing this without my friends.'

Adora's POV
Tall.

That was the first thought in my head when the light faded. I looked up and the bug looked as if it just. Stopped.

Huh. Well then. I then looked down and no wonder I felt taller. And I was wearing some white and gold outfit and I felt behind me and I had way longer hair.

"Ah!"

I tripped over my own feet as I fell to the ground. I looked back down and I was back to normal. Suddenly I was tackled by the girl.

"Stay where you are!" She then began wrestling with me for the sword.

"What did you do to me?"

"What do you mean what did 'I' do to you?"

" I didn't know being a princess was contagious!" The boy was then with us trying to calm us down.

"Okay, okay, everyone, calm down!" He then looked at me

"Wanna tell us how you did that?" I just rolled my eyes. Like I know?

" I didn't do anything. All I did was pick up the sword, and then, whoosh, I'm in a tiara!" While I was talking to him she took the sword from me with a tug.

" I don't care how she did it. We just have to make sure she never does it again!"

The beast then lit back up and came running at us. The boy then snatched the sword and ran to me.

"Do it again! Do it again!"

"Bow!"

"Do what you did before!"

"I don't know what I did before!"
The girl then grabbed both of us and ran with us into the woods.

"No time. We have to go."

We run and run and come to a cliffside and we fall into a heap at the bottom. I'm gonna be so sore after this! I tucked my head down as we tumbled down the cliff.

Well, at least we lost the bug.
The rumbling behind us continued.

Damn it!

We all quickly got up noticing the structure up ahead that was bright blue. It looked weirdly familiar.

"What is this place?" The boy pushed me further forward.

"No idea, but in there's gotta be better than out here."

Can't argue with that. That thing was getting closer and we don't have time to argue.
I looked over to the pair and they were going on about teleporting or something. Seriously we are being hunted down.

I look up at the door.

"What's written on this door? It looks like some kind of password."

"You can read that?"

"You cant?"

The bug then leaped into the clearing scanning the area till it landed on us.

"What's it say?"

"Uh, "Eternia."

The lines on the door then began to glow as the door opened.

"Oh come on!" I wasn't paying attention to the girl I had just run into. I do not want to be eaten thank you very much.

The door closed behind us as we all sat in the darkroom gasping for air, the adrenaline finally calming down.

"So, Horde soldier, have you always been able to read First Ones' writing?"
First ones? The heck with the first one? I also didn't like the accusatory tone coming from him.

"Wanna tell us what exactly is going on here?"
Uhhgg.

"I told you I don't know I just read the word on the door!" The girl looked as if she was going to say something but the boy just firmly shook his head at her and she just huffed.

She then conjured a ball of light in her hands. It almost looked identical to the one Catra had made so long ago. The biggest difference is the color and the Sparkles floating off of it. For some reason that just made her dislike towards the girl stronger.

Catra would still be here if it wasn't for that stupid spell.

She began walking as the boy helped me up.

"Hey, so, thanks for saving us from that bug thing back there when you could've escaped In instead." I decided not to respond.

"I'm Bow, by the way."

"Adora."

Bow started laughing. I suddenly felt embarrassed.

"What's so funny?"

"Nothing it's just the Horde seems to have a running theme."
I wasn't gonna bother asking where that came from. As we kept walking I noticed the girl kept glancing back at me and Bow kept looking at me as well.

"Okay do I have something on my face or?" I whispered to Bow.
He looked ahead to the girl then whispered back.

"I just wanted to say sorry...about your friend. Glimmer didn't mean it. She just... lost someone to the Horde and we have a friend that stayed there and... it wasn't a good experience."
I decided to just keep walking without acknowledging him.

Suddenly everything was a lot brighter Bow then ran over to the Glimmer.

"Uh, Glimmer? Maybe you should take it easy. We're a long way from Bright Moon. It'll be a while until you can recharge."

"Pfft-You have to recharge your powers?"

"Can we not talk about this in front of the Horde soldier?" Bow rolled his eyes and then looked to a wall.

"Oh hey! That's you!"
I looked to where he pointed and saw a mural of a lady with long gold hair and armor.

"What? That doesn't look anything like me."

"No, I mean, the other you. The scary one in the cape."

"That was me?" She looks so different. Taller. Stronger.

Better.

Bow then snapped me out of my head.

"You can read that inscription, right? What's it say?"

I looked at the inscription and read it aloud.

"It says, She-ra?"

Suddenly the room lights up and a hologram appears making us all jump.
"Greetings, administrator."

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"Catra!"

The catgirl was curled in on herself high up in the rafters of the Fright Zone clutching her tail as she tried to hold back her tears.

The blonde who called for her was standing on the ground looking around until she looked up.

"Catra please come down." The girl just shook her head. The blonde huffed and walked away.

The feline then felt even worse as she realized her friend left her alone. Until she heard something being dragged against the hard metal floors. She peeked over her shoulder and saw the girl grab a grate and was trying to climb her way up to the cat girl.

She made it to the ledge Catra was on after a few tries and Catra just stared at her dumbfounded. She pulled her way up and after catching her breath she looked to Catra and smiled.
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"I made it!"

Catra stared at the blonde mesmerized. Adora then looked at Catra's hands that are holding her tail.

"Is it broken?" Catra snapped out of her head.

"I don't know. It just hurts." Catra then curled into herself more. Adora noticed her fighting back tears.

"can I see it? I promise I'll be careful." Catra hesitated for a second before she unfurled herself and gently offered her tail to Adora flinching from the pain that came from just moving it a little bit. Adora noticed and frowned as she scanned the tail now in her lap.

Adora then looked to Catra.

"Is it okay if I touch it? Just to see if it's broken or anything." Catra wiped her eyes as she nodded. The girl then gently stroked her tail and when she got to the middle and Catra flinched. She instantly brought her hands back.

"Sorry I didn't-"

"You're fine I just didn't expect it."

Adora nodded. "Well, it doesn't feel broken. But I think something is wrong. You should go to the infirmary."

"No!" Catra then curled back into herself.

"Catra I know you don't like them but this is serious. Something might be wrong." Catra just shook her head. Catra had a very bad experience in that forsaken infirmary. The first time she went there for a physical they were...intrigued by her. They had never seen a person like her.

They didn't treat her like a person. They ran tests on her and it lasted for days. They would force her claws to see how deep they

could cut, how much her balance depended on her tail, how sensitive her hearing was, and how much endurance she had.

The only thing that saved her was Adora got antsy without Catra and Shadow weaver said Catra was to be released.

Catra never felt relief when she saw Shadow weaver but when she took her out of that room she never felt so grateful. Catra never told Adora. She didn't want her to know.

"Catra, please? I don't... if Shadow weaver sees..."
That made Catra just want to curl up and disappear. Catra just shoved her face into her knees. Adora placed a hand on her shoulder. Catra looked to Adora.

"Please Catra. I'll stay with you the whole time. I promise." Catra saw that dumb determined look in her eyes.

Catra nodded her head. And Adora helps Catra up. "We look out for each other.

Always."

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"Adora!"

My breath heaved as I felt tears going down my face. "Damn it!" I wiped my eyes and brought my legs to my chest. I feel over to my left subconsciously bringing the blue blanket around myself.

I feel so useless. I miss you, Adora. So so much. I fiercely wiped my eyes as I looked out my bedroom window.

It was still dark. I wonder how late it is. Early? Doesn't matter. I got up from my bed and popped my back as I stretched. I just need to clear my head that's all.

I quietly went to my door and looked both ways as I snuck out. Be careful not to wake anyone. As I get into the hallway I turn to
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my left and see Leo leaning on their spear passed out in a chair. I chuckled a bit and quickly grabbed a blanket from my room and placed it over Leo.

I swear they are gonna get such a bad back if they keep sleeping like that. I quietly walk to the kitchen trying to avoid all the guards. Best if I don't have them thinking I'm trying to escape and them waking up everyone in the palace just because I'm having a mental breakdown.

I finally make it to the kitchen and grab a glass to get some water.

"What are you doing up this late?" I dropped the glass and turned around.
The glass levitated in the air as I saw Azar.

"Shit. You scared me." I grabbed the glass from the air and placed it back on the counter. Azar just laughed at me. She then went quiet and had a worried expression on her face.

"What's wrong?" I felt my fur fluff up in defense.

"Nothing! Why?"

Azar just rolled her eyes at me.

"Seriously Liz?" She then gestured to my shoulders. I looked and saw Adora's blanket wrapped tightly around my shoulders.
I hadn't even noticed I kept it with me. Azar then pulled out the seat next to her and patted the seat.

"Come talk to ol' Azar about your troubles."
I just rolled my eyes and took the seat.

"You are so dramatic."

"Maybe." Azar then downed whatever she was drinking. "So what's troubling you?" I just sighed.

"Just... never mind it's stupid." Azar laughed.

"I doubt it." I just stared down at the table.

"You know one time I tried to impress a girl by showing off a spell I learned. It wasn't quite ready and I ended up turning into a squirrel." I busted out laughing and tried coughing it away but it didn't stop.

"I'm sorry I'm sorry- but-pfft." Azar didn't look amused.

"Jeez, that's the last time I try to make you feel better."

Azar had a fond smile on her face. "So now you have to share your stupid thought." I just sighed.

"It's just. I had a nightmare and now... I just wanted to see you and mom." Azar then got a solemn look on her face. She then placed her hand on my shoulder.

"Liz that's not stupid." It felt stupid. I just looked to the side and I then felt Azar wrap her tail around me and lift my chin to her.

"You know me and your mom have nightmares. I wake up in a cold sweat and reach out for Cy. The first few months you were here she would constantly check on you to make sure you were still with us." She then started rubbing my ears making me purr and lean into her hand.

"Leo rarely slept before you came back. They felt so much guilt about you being taken." That made my ears perk up as I looked to Azar.

"Why?" She retracted her hand as she took a breath.

"Leo has always been your guard. During the invasion. It was so sudden. Cy needed to put the evacuation plan into action and I needed to lead the army. So Leo was assigned to protect you.

And they did.

They got you to the cave entrance but. When you couldn't find me or Cy you insisted... you snuck off to go find us. Leo tried to get to you but. By the time they noticed, you were long gone. And then..." Azar then placed her arm on her other shoulder.

"What happened?" Azar shook her head at me.

"It's not something we should get into right now."

"Momma come on. You've been dodging it forever. I can handle it."

"Maybe when you're older."

"I'm turning eighteen in a couple of months. How much older do I have to be?" Azar just sighed.

"Look-"

"Azar?" We both looked to the doorway and saw Cyra there rubbing her eyes. Azar was up in an instant.

"What? Is it walk around in the middle of the night week or what?" Cyra chuckled then look over at me.

"Elizabeth. Is something wrong?" A beat didn't pass as I ran and hugged her. Cyra stumbled a bit as she laughed. I buried my head into her neck trying my best to not mumble.

"Can I sleep with you guys tonight?"

I couldn't see her face but I felt her pull me closer to her and she started purring.

"Of course." The moment was ruined by Azar.

"Damn and here I thought I might've gotten some action tonight." Cyra and I just sent a glare in her direction.

"I'm kidding! Stars I swear it feels as if there are two Cy's." Cyra laughed and looked back at me and pushed my bangs out of my face.

"Let's head to bed then." Cyra placed a hand on my back as we walked to her room with Azar close behind.

We got into the room and it wasn't long before I was trapped between my mom's with Azar behind me and Cyra rubbing my ears. Azar had her arm over me rubbing Cyra's arm with small circles. I felt my eyelids get heavy.

"Sleep tight Elizabeth."

Catra was fast asleep her breathing even as the two mothers had a hushed conversation over her head.

"It's almost time. Are you sure you don't want her bonding with the runestone?" Cyra shook her head.

"I don't know. She hasn't even learned to shift, not to mention her lessons with you. I just feel like her getting all this power at one time will attract..."

"Cyra. The spell I cast on her ensures that the incident with Micha won't happen again." Cyra looked down at Catra.

"I know but... I'm just worried." Azar gently grabbed the back of her neck and leaned forward to kiss her head.

"I know." Azar then looked back to Cyra's eyes.

"I swear to you that which is probably long dead."

Chapter End Notes

I will say I decided to cut out some things because 1 I dont want to put you guys through something you've already seen

and 2 I feel like Adora isnt as as nice because she truly believes what the Hirde stands for.

Under attack

Chapter Notes

> Hey I'm not dead! Sorry about lack of chapters I had a lot going on with work and my sisters wedding is coming up so I've been pulled around in a different directions. Updates will now be every Tuesday!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

We all stared at the hologram in obvious shock.
"What is this thing?"

"What is your query?" The hologram said in an eerily calm voice.
Then Bow waved his hand through the hologram.

"I think it's some kind of ancient hologram." The hologram then repeated itself.

"What is your query?"

"Uh... Hi. What is this place? How do we get out of here?" Bow's question was only answered with the same repeated phrase.

"What is your query?"

"Welp. She's broken."

Glimmer then started waving her hand through the hologram.

"She's old. I'm surprised any of this stuff still works at all." The hologram then finally spoke something other than 'what is your query?'

"Administrator not detected. Lockdown initiated."
Oh no. Suddenly the whole room went red and the walls started crumbling as the doors tried to shut us in.

"I didn't do it!"
Bow then started panicking.

"No. No. No lockdown! No lockdown!"
The ceiling then started to cave in.

"Adora, you gotta get it to stop!"
I turned to Bow frustrated.

"What makes you think I can?"

"Query not recognized." Does she ever shut up!?

"There's gotta be a password or something!" I then started shouting at the hologram with random words we encountered.

"Uh, stop it! Uh, Eternia! Eternia!" This isn't working! I looked at the mural and saw the lady in the Cape.

"Give me the sword!"
Glimmer then clutched the sword close to her

"What? No!"

"We need the scary lady in the cape. I don't know how, but she's the key to this place, so maybe she can get us out."

"You're a Horde soldier. I'm not giving you the sword." I don't have time to argue with her! I then started shouting the words again.

"Eternia! Uh, cape! Uh... She-Ra!" The building didn't respond and all the doorways were blocked. Then the princess grabbed me and Bow.

"Hold on!"

"Glimmer, no!"

Suddenly there was a flash. I wanted to breathe a sigh of relief until my stomach dropped as we fell to the ground. I look and see

the girl had passed out and I and Bow were screaming. Then I saw him pull out an arrow and shoot it causing a net to spring free.

I guess today is just a falling day. Bow spoke first.

"Are you okay?"

"Yeah just...just give me a minute." I feel as if I'm going to throw up. So I just stay laying down staring at the sky as Bow talks with Glimmer. Something about him being right or whatever.

"Why are you still here?" I sat up and looked at Glimmer.

"What?"

"Bow and I are hardly a crack security team. You could've escaped at any time. Why didn't you?" I went to respond but the words caught in my throat. Why was I still here? I looked at the sword on her shoulder and I thought back to what had happened to me.

"If I'm being honest I was trying to get the sword...but then...whatever happened and now I'm just. Lost? I was told my whole life I had one purpose. Now I have this...thing happening to me and I cant... if I go back now I won't ever know what happened to me." Another reason I didn't mention was the fact that if I go back with nothing Shadow weaver will no doubt have my head. Glimmer glared at me harshly but stopped when Bow placed a hand on her shoulder.

"Glimmer's mom knows more about First Ones' tech than anyone. She'll know what's going on with you and the sword for sure. So, if you want your questions answered, stick with us?"

He then extended his hand to me.

I took it and he pulled me up.

"Let's go. There should be a village a few miles from here. We can catch a ride to Brightmoon there."

I nodded my head then she got in my face.
"Do. not. Betray us!"

"Same to you."

Bow seemed to miss the tension as he clasped his hands together.
"Road trip!"

Catra's POV

As I wake up I stretch to pop my back and yawn. I sit up as I rub my eyes looking around the room. Where am I? The events of last night suddenly came back to me as I recognized my mom's room.

With that question answered I now wonder where the heck are they? It's unusual for me to not feel them get up. Even more so I look around and don't see a note or anything that would tell me where they went. I got up from the bed and went to the door. I open it and am met with Leo standing guard with their arms crossed and a serious expression on their face.

"Leo? What's going on?" Startled by my appearance they look back at me.

"Oh, Liz. It's Nothing you need to worry about." Oh, now I'm worried.

"Where're my moms?" Leo just sighed.

"Dealing with the thing you shouldn't worry about." I just rolled my eyes as I tried to step past Leo only to place their spear in front of me.

"Sorry but you are not to leave until the situation is dealt with."

"Oh come on! Now you have to tell me what's going on!"

"Liz Seriously this isn't a game. I have strict orders for you to remain in this room until everything is resolved. Please don't make this any harder for me." Leo had an expression that made it

obvious they weren't playing around. I wanted to get mad but I just thought of Azar's words from last night.
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"And send for Leo." The guard bowed and made their way down the hall. Azar closed the door and ran to the closet to get dressed. All the rustling and rushed movements caused Cyra to sit up. Careful of Catra.

"What's wrong?"

"An outsider got in somehow. I'm going to interrogate them now." Cyra was suddenly up and moving.

"What? How? Do you know who they are?"

"No, I just got word." Azar was trying to rush through everything but Cyra grabbed her shoulders.

"Azar!" She finally looked to her wife. Worry is evident on both women's faces.

"Cy everything is fine. I'll perform a truth spell, find out how she got in, and fix it." Cyra didn't look convinced. She then glanced to the bed where Catra was lying down.

"I sent for Leo. She will be here until this is all resolved. I need you to be calm alright?" Cyra took a deep breath and nodded.

"I'm coming with you." Azar wanted to argue but Cyra's face already told her she made up her mind.

"Alright."

The pair walked down a never-ending tunnel the stairs leading down into the darkest part of the caves. Once they got there the guards in front of the door bowed to which the queens nodded as the guards opened the door.

Imagine their surprise when they just saw a purple-haired girl rolling around in the dungeon trying to catch the guard's tail as it moves with irritation.

"Fascinating." Azar then made an ahem sound while Cyra just laughed. Azar seemed shocked because usually, Cyra was always super uptight when it came to intruders. Sometimes even ruthless.

"Entrapta?" The girl then finally looked up at the queens.

"Oh, hi Cyra!" Azar seemed even more shocked. Noticing Cyra explained. "This is princess Entrapta of Dryl."

"Hi!" The guards then hastily let her out scared to face a princess's wrath. But Entrapta didn't even spare them a glance.

"I used to visit her a lot because she's been on her own from a young age." Cyra then directed her attention to the girl. "Sorry I couldn't keep in contact with you."

"It's alright. I heard about the invasion I sent some bots to help but you were gone by the time I got there." Entrapta said it like it was no big deal as she explored the room and talked into her recorder.

"Thank you Entrapta that means a lot that you tried to help." Entrapta then looked to Cyra.

"Of course. We are friends right?" Cyra nodded.

"Best friends. Now come on let's get out of here I can show you around a bit. Azar, can you go get Elizabeth? I don't want her to get antsy." Azar just nodded. Azar remembers a bit of Entrapta but she was never very close with her like Cyra.

"Yeah, I'll meet you in the dining room." Azar then took her to leave.

"Wait isn't Elizabeth the one that got captured?" Cyra smiled at Entrapta.

"Yes but we recently got her back. I want you to meet her." After the grief, Cyra went through after her first pregnancy she had found out that Entrapta was on her own for practically her whole life so she would visit her often throughout her younger years. Even after she had Catra she would still visit.

"Don't be silly Cyra I've already met Elizabeth."

"Well, the Horde did something to her memories so she doesn't remember anything from before she was taken."

"Oh." Entrapta noticed Cyra looking sad and then pulled out her recorder. "Edit to log. Elizabeth seemed to have suffered memory loss. Meaning attempt for a new first impression is allowed." Entrapta then gave Cyra a smile which she returned.

Adora's POV
After having to rid me of my jacket and the badge I worked years for in exchange for a sparkly cape and a dumb flower I was anything but calm and rational. Not to mention all the loud noises coming from the surrounding people.

I tried asking what the heck was going on but Bow just told me it was a 'party and I have no idea what that is so he then went to Glimmer.

"She has never been to a party before, Glimmer! This is serious."

Before I or Glimmer could disagree Bow grabbed me by the arm and dragged me to some stalls.

"Here try this Adora!" He then handed me something on a stick. I raised my brow skeptically at it but when the smell hit my nose I found it hard to resist.

I took a small bite of it. I felt my own eyes go wide.

"What is this?" I didn't part my eyes from the glorious thing in front of me.

"It's just some meat with some sauce on it. What do you think?"

"Is there more?" I said over a full mouth having eaten the whole thing in one go. Bow just laughed and dragged me over to a table where a lady was dancing on it. He sat me down and people started serving all kinds of food and delicacies. I looked over to Bow and he smiled.

"Go ahead eat all you like."

I never thought I would hear that sentence but I didn't waste time by processing it as I began to stuff my face with all the amazing food and flavors.

I finished all of mine- and Bow's- food. I was then eyeing up Glimmers as well. She then offered the food to me which I graciously ate. Ignoring her rolling eyes.

Bow then dragged me off to play games with the other kids. It was fun it was nothing like the games we would play in the Fright zone if you could even call them games. After being run dry of all my energy the kids ran to their parents and I felt exhausted.

They have way too much energy. I joined Bow who offered me what looked like a cloud on a stick while he ate some small pill-shaped candy.

"So, seriously? No parties ever? What do you guys do on your birthday?"

"Huh?" I understood the concept but all the cadets just got a random day assigned to them based on their identification number so they could test us exactly a year later to see how far we had come. Catra always bragged that she was older than me.

But only by like two days!

"No birthdays?! How is your life this sad?" I glanced up when I saw something move in my peripheral. I suddenly interrupt whatever Bow was saying.

"What
Is
That?"

I see a weird four-legged creature.

"It's a horse."

"It's majestic." Suddenly Bow was pushing me forward.

"Wanna say hi to him?" I then started pushing back.

"What! No!" I clutched my eyes shut as Bow extended my hand for me.

"Come on he's friendly." When my hand made contact I opened my eyes as he nuzzled into my hand.

"This is the best day of my life."

I didn't notice when Bow left my side, as I was much too interested in the amazing creature under my hand.

I did notice when the ground began to rumble beneath my feet. Suddenly I looked over and smoke was rising into the air.

"It's the Horde!"

Chapter End Notes

Just some context Entrapta is about 13 years older than Catra (considering shes 30 in the beginning of the series I'm pretty sure.) So when they met it was just a lot of one sided conversation but Catra loved all the cool gadgets Entrapta would let her play with.

Back on track

Chapter Notes

> Whoo this was long awaited I've been busy with 0lanning and stuff. I'm hoping to have a tumblr set up just for my story (soon stories.) I'll post artwork and answer any questions!
>
> TW: mild sexual content/ implied sexual relations! If you dont feel comfortable with that you can just skip over it!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's POV
I know I said I would give Leo two hours but thirty minutes have passed and I'm already antsy. I was considering jumping out the window to escape when I heard talking on the other side of the door.

Before I could try eavesdropping the door opened and Azar walked in. I quickly stood up.

"What happened?" Azar then laughed in my face.
Rude.

"Aren't you nosy?"

"Well considering I got locked up in your boring ass room I think I have a right to complain." Azar just rolled her eyes.

"Always so dramatic." Azar was joking around so that's a good sign but also weird considering how bad Leo reacted.

Azar must've noticed the gears turning in my head because she sighed and placed a hand on my shoulder.

"There was an intruder but turns out it's an old friend of your mother. So we are heading to go meet up with them."

"An intruder!"

"Shhh!" Azar then clamped her hand over my mouth. "Do you want a widespread panic?!" I shook my head and she let go of my face.

"How'd they even get in?"

"That's what I plan on asking. You used to know her before the whole... you know." Azar and Cyra always tried to avoid the whole memory wipe thing. Part of me thinks it's more for Cyra's sake than mine.

I look up and notice Azar begin walking out of the room. She then turned to face me. "You coming?"

"Obviously!"

Adora's POV

As smoke filled the air Bow and Glimmer grabbed me and pulled us away to hide behind one of the few buildings still intact. I look around and see all of the destruction, people running for their lives, and there are so many children.

They look so scared.

"Why are they here? The people of Thaymor aren't a threat." Bow's voice snapped me out of my thoughts.

"Wait. Did you say Thaymor? This can't be Thaymor." Glimmer then pointed an accusing finger at me.

"Did you know something about this?"

"No! I mean, yes. But there's been a mistake. Thaymor's supposed to be a heavily fortified rebel fortress, not a civilian town!" Glimmer then grabbed my arm dragging me to the inner part of the town where the damage was the most significant.

"Do you think that matters to them?"

I look around noticing the bots and soldiers moving forward without a care in the world.

This isn't right.

"I can get them to stop. This is all a big mistake. I just need to talk to them. Get as many people out as you can and don't let them see you."
I quickly disposed of the Cape and the flower in my hair throwing them to the ground.

I look back to Bow and Glimmer.

Then I run forward trying to find someone who will listen to me.

I wandered around trying my best to not only search for someone I can reason with but also avoid all of the explosions and damage. Come on, come on, come on!

The longer I searched the more time I was wasting meaning more people were being hurt! I tried to keep focused but my mind kept drifting. Why would the Horde do this? This isn't the rebellion fortress they thought it was so why bother? It's not like it has any gain anyway. What if Glimmer was right?

No, I can think like that! The Horde raised me! They hurt Catra. But they meant the best! Shadow weaver tried to send Catra away. Maybe I just got confused. These soldiers said they were sent to look for a girl with cat ears and a tail. The princesses killed Catra!

What if they lied?

"Adora!" Before my mind could spiral any further I heard a familiar voice call my name.

"Lonnie?" The soldier running up to me then removed her helmet and sure enough, I saw the brown locks be released.

"Are you okay?!" I nodded.

"Yeah. Yeah, I'm okay." Lonnie let out a breath of relief then popped me on the back of the head. "Ow!"

"Where the hell have you been! Do you know how pissed Shadow Weaver is? Come on we have to go. You'll be lucky if your favoritism gets you out of this one." I pulled my wrist away.

"Lonnie you have to tell everyone to leave right now!" Lonnie laughed at me.

"You think I have any say in this raid? I'm a mere soldier Adora. Now come on." Before she could reach for me I backed away.

"Lonnie this is a civilian town! We are hurting innocent people!" Lonnie just rolled her eyes.

"Adora they kidnapped you!"

"No, they didn't Look around the Horde is tearing apart families! All these children who doot know are now running for their lives!" Lonnies calm demeanor snapped in an instant.

"News flash Adora that's what the Horde does! Dividing up families makes them weaker, orphaned children can become soldiers, and the Horde had been hurting people to instill fear so that no one questions them!"

"How can you be okay with that?"

"Don't you dare try and make me the villain Adora? You were perfectly fine with me, Rogelio, and Kyle getting abused! So what? These... strangers caused you to suddenly care?"

"I was never okay with how they treated you guys I just didn't understand how wrong it was until- ahhing!" I felt my body go

numb as a wave of electricity went through my body. Without missing a beat Lonnie continued.

"Bullshit! You were perfectly fine with how we were treated as long as it wasn't directed at you!" Lonnie then sent another wave of shocks through me as I tried to stand.

"Tell me, Adora." Lonnie then crouched down and lifted my head to look out into the village that was now on fire. "What did the Horde do to these strangers that caused you to question them? Why is it that the Horde attacks their village and suddenly you want to change sides, but you stood by as Catra, your best friend, was beaten and abused then ultimately killed?"

That made my body tense up more than the shocks she put through me. She's right.

"Aaahh!"

I turn my head as I hear Lonnie scream and see her wrapped up in a net. I look forward and seeing Bow and Glimmer on the (horse?) Thing I was petting earlier. Glimmer then grabbed me and teleported me away leaving Bow to fight. I regained my footing and Glimmer slumped to the ground. She didn't look good.

"Are you okay?" I went to her and she pulled the sword off her back.

"I should've given this to you back at the ruins." I was cautious at first why would she?

"I heard what you said, about how innocent people were being hurt. You had this look in your eye. I can't describe it but... I like to think you were sent here to help us. I'm sorry, for being a jerk, for what I said, for everything!"

"I'm sorry too." Glimmer looked up at me in surprise then smiled. I slowly took the sword from her as bots came out way. I raised it to the sky.

"For the Honor of Greyskull!"

Everything after that moment became a blur. I felt, out of control. I remember seeing Lonnie about to finish off Bow but was stopped when I arrived. I managed to destroy the tanks the bots and the soldiers. Soon they were running with their tails between their legs. As if the sword knew the danger was gone I shrunk back down to my normal size. I looked up and saw Lonnie carrying Rogelio with Kyle helping as well.

She turned her head to glare at me over her shoulder before disappearing into the smoke. Before I had time to reach out for her I heard Glimmer and Bows voices.

"We won! Take that Horde scum!"

I look over to the pair jumping and celebrating and I feel as if I'm intruding. They look so happy. It makes me miss Catra. I think back not only to what Lonnie said but about what I've seen of the princess so far.

"Hey, Glimmer?" She looked at me surprised. Before she could speak I spit out what has been going on in my head for hours.

"The Horde told me they found my friend's body a lifeless husk. Is there a princess that has a power like that?"

Glimmer looks at me in shock while Bow looked at me with sympathy. As if Glimmers silence wasn't an answer she shook her head.

"That isn't... princess powers don't work like that."

"So then that means." I clasped a hand over my mouth as I fought back tears. They killed her. I fell to my knees trying to keep my cries under control. Lonnie was right! I'm nothing but a

hypocrite! I was so dumb! How could I have let them hurt her and my friends for so long?

I suddenly feel arms wrap around me. Part of me thought it would be Bow but to my surprise it was Glimmer.

"I'm so sorry Adora."

Catra made her way to the dining room with her mother as she bounces in place.

"So she's an inventor? Does she blow stuff up?"

"Never on purpose." Azar laughed. Before Catra could ask what her mother meant they were both outside the dining room. Catra, excited as ever was about to run in till Azar put a hand on her shoulder.

"Hold on."

Catra turned around with a raised brow.

"I need to let you know that princess Entrapta tends to get... excited very easily. But I assure you she knows how to listen so if she does something you don't like just, let her know. She has a hard time picking up on some social cues. So you have to communicate." Azar made sure to accentuate the last word annoyingly.

Catra just huffed and nodded her head in understanding. Azar then smiled and opened the door.

"After you." Catra walked into the room to see her mom and Entrapta chatting away. They barely noticed her walk-in so Catra coughed to gain their attention. Cyra smiled as she saw her daughter.

"Elizabeth! This is-" as Cyra went to gesture to Entrapta she was already out of her seat and way too close to Catra.

"You're alive! How is that? What was the Horde like? How is the tech? How is-"
Catra swallowed hard and tried her damn best to communicate as her mother said. Say the words she has repeated in her head for what to say if someone gets too close for comfort.

"Do you mind backing up a bit? I don't like my personal space being invaded." Entrapta stopped her onslaught of questions and looked down at her feet. As If she finally noticed how close she was her eyes widened.

"Oh! My bad I should know better from all the scars you gave me. I got a little excited!" Entrapta then backed up a good amount. She then continued her questions from a further distance. As if nothing happened

'Wel, that was way easier than I thought it would be.' Catra zoned out for a moment but was brought back by Entrapta's questioning. Before Catra could lose her courage she interrupted her again.

"Look, I don't mean to be a bitch." She got a pointed look from her mother.

"But, I don't really... like to talk about my time in the Horde. And I didn't pay much attention to the tech and stuff. Also, I know you knew me, before the whole situation but to m, e you're still a stranger."

Catra felt bad seeing the gears turning in Entrapta's head. She sat there waiting for her to get upset or angry but instead she just nodded.

"That makes sense. So what are we allowed to talk about?"

"Well, what did we used to tall about?" Catra then noticed a sudden gleam in Entrapta's eyes.

"Well, you were a little you so we didn't have much conversation but I liked talking to you about my inventions."

"Oh yeah?"

"Yep! I'm even in the Ethiopian makers' society!"

"What type of stuff do you make?" As Entrapta began to explain all of the things she would make Catra began to become more and more interested trying her best to keep up.

Azar looked to Cyra and tilted her head towards the door and Cyra nodded. They were trying to be subtle about their leave but the two girls were so into their conversation that they didn't even notice. Even sat down at the table as Entrapta began to show her something off of her tracker pad.

Once the door closed Cyra let out a sigh of relief. Azar laughed.

"What was that for?"

"I don't know I was just worried Elizabeth and Entrapta wouldn't get along is all." Azar sighed as she pushed some of Cyra's hair back and cradled her face.

"Cy, we talked about this. Just because she doesn't remember a small part of her life doesn't mean she is a completely different person."

"I know I know. It's just... I don't know. I thought I'd be over it by now after all these years but, sometimes I'll have these moments where I'll reference a time before and Elizabeth will give me a blank look and I remember all over again."

Cyra's ears fell in her distress and Azar felt hers do the same at the sight of seeing her wife distraught. "It's alright to miss something that was actively stolen from you. It's okay to want her to remember that time in her life, as long as you remember she is still our kit, and don't allow it to make you distance yourself from her." Cyra smiled up at Azar and gave her a quick kiss on the cheek as she wrapped her arms around Azar's neck and rubbed her face along her neck.

"Thank you. I can always count on you to make me feel better." Azar then put her hand to Cyra's chin and gently lifted her head.

"Damn right." She then gave her a sweet kiss on the lips. Cyra just thrilled at the contact and brought her hands to Azar's face to pull her in more.

The hand that was once on Cyra's chin then drifted to her waist as she rubbed small circles along her back. They pulled apart but kept their heads connected as Cyra just stared lovingly into Azar's eyes. She always used to think that there was probably no chance that their child would have her gold eyes due to blue being a guaranteed eye color when it came to the royal family and that thought always was so unfair in her mind. So when Catra opened her eyes for the first time and she saw not only the blue eyes she grew up with but as well as the striking gold of the love of her life she fell even harder for her kit.

"What's the reason for that dumb look on your face?" Azar said with a blatant smile on their face. Cyra just laughed.

"I just love you so much." Azar tried to be smug but the purr rising from her chest betrayed them.

"I love you too."

Cyra then went in for another kiss which Azar happily accepted. She even gave back tenfold. Her hand drifted to the base of where Cyra's tail met her spine and rubbed the fur there up and down. Their lips parted as Cyra gasped from the feeling and dug her face into Azar's neck.

"Stars Azar- ah!" Azar just smirked,

"what was that sweetie?" Cyra then used all her willpower to grab Azar's wrist. Cyra then stood there for a minute trying to even out her breathing, her face beet red. Azar had a look on her face showing just how proud of herself she was.

"You're insufferable you know that?" Azar practically purred out her response.

"It's a part of my charm don't you think?" Cyra just shook her head as she laughed.

"Of course." Cyra then placed her hands to Azar's ears and rubbed the sensitive flesh there as Azar began purring.

"Careful there I'm a married woman. I even have a cute kit at home." Cyra just laughed as Azar leaned more into Cyra's touch.

"Aw, what a shame. And here I thought I might have a chance with the best sorceress around." Cyra said in faux disappointment.

"So is there no way for me to convince you? Oh, great sorceress." Azar sighed into Cyra's hand.

"Keep scratching and maybe." Cyra laughed as they kissed again. Azar tried to initiate... more but Cyra once again stopped them causing her wife to whine.

"We are not doing such things in a hallway. Not to mention with our kit right next door." Cyra said as she booped her wife's nose.

"Oh Cy, do you remember that one incident in the library?" Azar purred into Cyra's ear as she ran a claw up and down her arm. Cyra physically shivered as her face went red.

"Azar we are not fucking in the hallway." Cyra's words caused Azar to laugh at her sudden use of vocabulary.

"Alright, I can tell when I'm not wanted." Azar went to back away but Cyra just pulled them in and whispered playfully in her ear.

"I said not in the hallway." Azar's ears perked up as she looked to her wife. When she saw that glint in her eyes she became giddy. Cyra laughed at the dumb look she had on her face before pulling her down the hall while they shared hushed laughter. Feeling a sense of Deja vou.

Chapter End Notes

I just love Azar and Cyra sue me.

Horses and games

It was around midday when Azar left her room after having a nap with her wife. She was going to stay with her but decided to check on Catra. After all, she and Cyra did leave her alone with Entrapta and that can be a dangerous combination.

Azar first went to the dining room where she had last seen the pair, after putting on one of her robes of course, to her shock they weren't there. So she went to Catra's room. She knocked on the door and heard a quiet 'come in' before she entered.

She saw Catra laying on her stomach on her bed doodling on her sketch pad, her tracker pad from Bow beside her, barely paying any mind to Azar.

"Where's Entrapta?" Azar took glances around the room but saw no sign of her.

"Oh, she left a while ago. Said something about her bots finding something in her mines. I think it was called one's tech or something. She seemed excited."

"First one's tech."

"Yeah that. You know what it is?"

"Not I try to stay away from stuff associated with first ones." Catra finally looked up at her.

"What's that supposed to mean?" Azar shot Catra a confused look.

"You don't know about the first ones? I thought you said you read every book in the library? The history of the first ones is in almost every textbook!" Catra grimaced a bit.

"Okay, when I said I read 'every book' I didnt mean any of the historical ones." Azar let out a defeated sigh and sat next to Catra.

"Well... okay do you know how Entrapta got here?" Catra shook her head.

"No. I thought she told you."

"She did. I just needed to know if you knew. Anyway, she got here through tunnels that expand across all Etheria." Catra's ears perked up.

"Don't even think about it. Anyway, I never had them built over because it's a literal maze. Only the royal family has an actual map of it. Which Cyra told me it's hard to decipher anyway. The fact Entrapta even made it here is a miracle."

"Okay, so what does that have to do with the first ones?" Cyra chuckled as she lightly flicked Catra on her ear.

"I'm getting to that. Despite their names, they were not the first ones to come to Etheria. All types of people lived here. Including Magicats. We were worried at first when we saw them arrive. They had much higher tech than us but they e peaceful. They wanted to know how magic worked. We even had our mages teach them to know we trusted them. So much so the queen offered them a feast in their honor. We brought them into Halfmoon. Welcomed them. Everything went off without a hitch. Until a week later. Turns out they had a plan to steal the magic of Etheria and we were in their way."

Azar got a grim look on her face "They used our feast as a way to determine our numbers and where Halfmoon was. The Magicats fought hard but they had a weapon some claim it was a giant, while others said it was a sword. They couldn't beat whatever it was so they retreated. As they were running legend says the magic of Etheria led the queen to a secret cave to hide. And over the years she had tunnels that built throughout Etheria to be able

to see what was happening. One day a scout said all of the first ones left without a trace. We went back to the surface and we've been very secretive about our ways of magic, culture, and everything else since then."

Beats of silence passed as if Catra was trying to process all of the information then she just let out a simple response.

"Holy shit. Was like. It's that for real?" Azar shrugs.

"I mean I know there is some truth to it the records of the attack prove it but some of it sounds a little unbelievable to me. The whole weapon especially. It was probably just some high-tech robot or something. They called it 'the destroyer.'" Azar said as she wiggled her fingers in a creepy gesture.

"It sounds cool though. I mean not like cool but interesting." Azar laughed.

"Like I said there are a ton of books about it in the library if you're interested." Suddenly a notification came from Catra's trackpad and she all but pounced on it looking intently at the screen only to groan and flop on her back.

"What's up?" Catra just sighed as she sat up with her tracker pad in her lap.

"I've been trying to contact Bow and Glimmer but all I've gotten is radio silence."

"Well, Glimmer is still grounded, isn't she? Maybe she cant answer?" Catra sighed,

"Well, that doesn't explain why Bow isn't answering." Catra then got a sad look on her face as her ears lowered.

"Hey, why don't you just write her a letter? I know queen prissy always checks her mail. I'm sure she'll make Glimmer respond." Catra just rolled her eyes. She has an idea of why Azar hates Angella so much but never got the details. She used to hate

Glimmer just by association, but once she saw she acted so much like Micha Azar became a lot nicer.

"I guess you're right." Azar then grinned and ruffled Catra's mane.

"Of course I am." Catra rolled her eyes as she pushed her mother's hand away.

"Yeah, yeah whatever." Azar chuckled then stood back up popping her back as she stretched.

"Anyway just write a letter and I'll get it delivered. In the meantime, I believe I promised two weeks' worth of training?" Catra perked up and stood up as well.

"Hell yeah, you did! I didnt go through all that shit for nothing!"

Adora's POV
Eventually, Glimmer pulled away enough for me to curl in on myself I kept my head down refusing to meet the gaze of the pair. I'm so pathetic.

Glimmer then got up and was having a hushed conversation with Bow. Probably trying to make a plan to get rid of me. I stood up on shaking legs, I look down at the sword debating on taking it with me. No. Anything that powerful will be sought after best to lay low.

Maybe I can find a map and make my way to a peaceful village.

"Where are you going?" Glimmer didnt sound mad.

"Don't worry I'm not going back to the Horde. You can keep the sword. I'm just gonna find somewhere to lay low for a while." I wrapped my arms around myself and went to walk away.

Suddenly a puff of Sparkles was In front of me. "Hey!" I stopped walking and just stared at her. Despite her tone, she looked more concerned than angry. She then let out a huff. "Look, me and Bow

were talking and... if you have nowhere to go. You could come with us."

My eyes widened but before I could answer Bow stepped in.

"What I said still stands, Glimmer's mom knows the most about the first one tech." I thought about their offer. It sounds like the only right choice but, this could be a trap. A way to make me let my guard down. I looked at both of their faces and saw nothing malicious. Almost as if the thought never crossed their minds.

"Alright."

"Yes!" They both then started jumping in celebration once again. Then I felt something nuzzle my back. What? I turn around and it was that horse thing again. "Hello." He just huffed at me as I pet him. Bow and Glimmer then start walking towards what I assume is Brightmoon as I followed.

Hey, whose horse is this?"

~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~
Catra age: 9

"Elizabeth I'd like you to meet Vivianne." Catra was standing in front of her mom who had her hands on her shoulders. Which was the only thing stopping the kit from running very far and very fast. The other Magicat didn't seem to mind though because she offered her hand ecstatically.

"Hi, it's nice to know someone my age! You can call me Vivy if that's easier for you."

Catra didnt respond. Her hands were behind her back and she was gripping her mother's clothes tightly trying to subtly tell her she didnt want to play with some random kid. Cyra seemed to get the hint.

"Would you excuse us for a moment?" Vivianne's dad gave a smile.
~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

"Of course." Cyra returned the smile and pulled Catra out of the room.

Once the door closed she let out a breath. "Please don't be mad." Cy ra turned around and crouched down to Catra's level and held her face to make her look at her.

"I'm not mad Elizabeth." Catra just looked away.

"Vivianne is a nice girl. I'm sure you'll like her if you just give her a chance."

"Why can't I just stay with you?" Cyra sighed.

"I have to go to a meeting and it isn't a place for children." Catra gripped Cyra's hands.

"I'll be quiet! You won't even know I'm there." Cyra laughed as she nuzzled her head to Catra's.

"I know but it's the rule."

"Why can't Leo watch me then?" Cyra laughed at her daughter's stubbornness. 'Wonder where she got that from' she thought.

"Because Leo has the stuff to do today."

"Then why not just let me watch myself? I'll just stay in my room." Cyra was starting to be worried by how hard Catra was fighting this.

"Elizabeth, what's going on? I know you're nervous but it might be good for you to make friends with people your age." Catra just shook her head. "Elizabeth-"

"People my age don't like me." Cyra stared in disbelief.

"Elizabeth you don't know that."

"Yes, I do! Everyone my age didnt like me or would act like they did to mess with me. Everyone except..."

Catra bit her lip as she stared at her feet. Cyra's heart broke at the sight. She gently lifted Catra's face to look at her and pushed a stray hair out of her face. "Well, they sound like big idiots. Mean-spirited idiots. That didnt deserve you." Cyra then started giving Catra kisses which she tried to fight.

"Mom stop!" They both then started laughing as Cyra pulled Catra into her arms.

After a bit, Cyra pulled back to look at Catra. "Can you just go an hour? I promise I'll come to d you the second it's over okay?" Catra looked up to her and nodded her head in defeat. Cyra smiled as she gave her a tight hug.

"Cy, are you ready? The meetings about to start!" Azar came into the hall and saw Catra and Cyra. She chuckled a bit at the sight. "Trouble in paradise?" Cyra rolled her eyes. Catra gave Azar a quick hug. Azar chuckled as she ruffled her hair.

"Alright go on we're gonna be late."

Catra just sighed and opened the door. She looked back to her mothers. Cyra gave her a wave as Azar gave her a thumbs up with a big smile. Catra took a breath as she took a step through the door.

Once the door was shut. Cyra started fidgeting with her claws. Azar sighed and grabbed her shoulders. "Come on. She'll be fine."

"I know I know. It's just. Maybe we can make an exception I'm sure she'll be super quiet." Azar grabbed Cyra before she could walk back to the room.

"Sweetheart this will be good for her. I know Grell and he won't let anything happen to her under his watch. Vivianne is a rule follower so she'll keep her out of trouble."

"I hope so."

Catra was annoyed. Vivianne and her dad brought her to their house and Vivianne was very adamant about wanting to play with her. Catra just wanted to sit and watch the time go by until her moms pick her up.

"Come on Lizzy, let's play something! You've been sitting watching the clock for almost half an hour." Catra felt as if it's been years.

"Viviane-"

"Vivvy."

"-yeah whatever. I don't feel like playing I'm tired."
Vivianne pouted.

"Come on!" She then grabbed Catra's hand and began pulling her. She was significantly stronger than her.

"No!" Catra tried pulling her hand back but then Vivianne's dad came down from upstairs.

"what's going on?"

"Lizzy isn't playing nice!" Her dad then looked at Catra accusingly.

"All I said was I didnt feel like playing because I'm tired." He then sighed and put a hand down his face. He then looked to the clock and crouched down to Catra.

"Look. You have about twenty minutes so just play a game of hiding and seek and by the time it's done your moms will be here." He smiled at Catra.

"But I don't want to!" His face then got sour.

"I know you're used to things going your way but sometimes we have to do things we don't want to do."

"Okay, then Vivianne has to just sit and watch the clock because we can't always do what she wants to do."

He then huffed. "Well, you've been sitting for 30 minutes so stop being selfish and go play." He then pushed Catra towards Vivianne. Catra went to fight but Vivianne grabbed her wrist and dragged her to her room. Before I could get a word in she started talking.

"I'm gonna be a royal guard like my dad but he says I need to be well trained so he gave me a bunch of games I can play to train. My favorite is night training!" She was digging around in her closet trying to get something. Then she whipped around and grabbed me again to lead me somewhere.

"Can you stop-"

"Here we are. She opened the door and it was a long narrow hallway with a painting on the other end. Vivianne then threw all the things she got from her closet onto the floor. "Alright, you wanna go first?"

"You haven't even told me how to play! Or the rules." She laughed.

"It's simple just avoid the toys touch the painting and run back to the door. And you have to ram the door open! I'm gonna try to keep you in and vice versa."

"That sounds dumb." Vivianne just shrugged.

"So you wanna go first?" Catra looked at the clock and noticed that her parents will be back any minute.

"Nah you can go first," Vivianne smirked and shoved me into the hallway.

'Great.'

Catra was going to just do it when the lights were turned off and she was surrounded by darkness. Her vision narrowed, her heart started beating rapidly, her breath became shallow. She turned around and began banging on the door.

"Vivianne let me out you win!"

"Come on just try."

"Vivianne!"

Catra felt her fur stand up and started seeing the shadows shape and shift. She tried shutting her eyes. But she just felt more trapped.

"This isn't funny let me out!" She heard her voice crack from unshed tears and the loss of breath. Her foot touched something and even though she knew it was some stupid toy her mind told her something different.

She was panicking. Maybe if she was calmer she would've known she could've used the light spell but all she was thinking was

Get out. Get out. Get out.

GET OUT!

Cats own mind began to play tricks on her as she struggled to tell the difference between reality and imagination.

"Elizabeth!"

Catra opened her eyes as she saw light from the doorway. Her mom was standing there. She ran into her arms without hesitation.

"I didn't know!" Vivianne was trying to speak on her behalf but the mothers weren't listening Cyra picked up Catra and looked to Azar and shook her head. Cyra nuzzled her kit rubbing her head.

"It's okay. I'm so sorry."
~~~~~~

Adora's POV
Wow.

We finally made our way to Brightmoon and the name is very fitting. Everything is white or pastel and there are gold accents that just make the sun reflect making it even more... bright. Glimmer didn't seem to mind she was already looking like she was ready to go to sleep.

"Okay, I'll go talk to my mom Bow take Adora through the back way." Bow nodded.

"Wait what's the back way?"

"This is the back way!" I was currently I don't even know how many feet up off the ground and Bow acted as if it was another Tuesday!

"It's fine I come in this way all the time." He then offered his hand and pulled me through what I assumed to be Glimmers' room. Which was also very bright. Suddenly clothes were being thrown at me while Bow was saying something about putting them on. I didn't bother to listen to his excuses I knew what was going on.

"You're trying to hide me." Bow then got a strained smile on his face.

"Nooooo, kinda." I just sigh.

"No, I get it. Probably won't be a good idea having a Horde soldier running around." Bow then took a seat next to me.

"Hey, they're just scared. Everyone has lost someone to the Horde." I nodded.

"I know."
~~~~~~

Suddenly there was a knock at the door I went to jump out the window but Bow grabbed me to stop that. Luckily it was just Glimmer.

"Whoah! Relax Adora. I just talked with my mom. Now you just have to turn on She ra and we'll be fine."

"Umm, yeah I dont- dont know how to do that." Glimmer's excited smile suddenly looked less prominent.

"Well um, we can figure it out!" This sounded like a bad idea but I had nothing better so I guess this will have to work.

Alright. "For the Honor of Greyskull!"

Nothing.

"Uhh. For the Honor of Greyskull!"

Nothing.

"For the Honor of Greyskull!" I felt myself get even more frustrated.

"Come on! I'm doing it just like last time! Uhggg" I threw the sword and it knocked a pot onto the floor which I flinched from.

"Crap, sorry."

Glimmer went to say something but Bow stopped her.

"Hey, why dont you go to the back garden? As long as you cover your clothes you should be fine. A little more space might help. I and Glimmer can keep her mom busy."

That's a better idea. So I nodded and grabbed the robe thing Bow gave me and adjust it to cover the symbols.

The pair smiled and Bow took me there then left so I can be alone. "Alright sword.... uh let's do this?"

After that everything went wrong.

Stupid horse.

Getting along

Chapter Notes

> Didnt have many notes last chapter because I wasnt at my best. So sorry about that. Hope you enjoy this chapter and leave comments I promise I love reading them!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's POV
I woke up with the memory fresh in my mind.

"Fuck."

Of course, my mind replays memories I don't want to remember but stars forbid it shows me memories I lost! I woke up and stretched trying my best not to think about the memory. But of course the more you don't want to think about something the more it knocks into your skull.

I'm not mad at Vivianne, about that incident anyway. It wasn't until I got back home my mom explained to me that Vivianne didnt know I couldn't see in the dark. I'm the only Magicat who can't see in the dark. Because of course, I am! Not to mention I'm shorter than almost everyone in Halfmoon. I'm below the average height of 5'9 for girls my age.

I was born way earlier than planned so my eyesight didn't develop and so on. Not to mention the whole not being fed during a "developmental state In my life." I try not to think about the fact even when I'm surrounded by my people I'm still the odd one out. I quickly shook my head. Nope. Not thinking about that. I quickly left my room and went down to the dining room to see my moms.

"Look who has risen." Momma joked as she sipped her what I assume to be coffee.

"Haha." I rubbed my eyes trying to get them to adjust. Then mom came in looking even more tired. It amazed me when I found out Azar was the natural early bird out of the pair.

Mom yawned, wrapped me in her arms, and nuzzled me. "Mom? You good?" She just hummed and held me closer.

"I'm perfect. Just missed you." I looked over to Momma and she just smiled and shrugged. The only time mom gets this mushy is right after...

Azar saw the realization on my face and started laughing uncontrollably. "You should see your face!" Cyra was none the wiser just content and purring while holding me.

"You guys are so gross!" They both laughed at me. I wiggled out of Cyra's grip and sat down. She looked sad but her attention was drawn away by Leo coming into the room.

"I have news, your majesty." Of course, they bowed even though we have all told them they don't have to. Azar stood up.

"What's wrong?" Leo stood back up.

"Thaymore has been attacked." Azar sighed and sat back down.

"They are way out of our area. It doesn't concern us."

"That's not what we're worried about." This made mom perk up. "We received a statement from one of the town's people and they claim that they were saved by a warrior." Azar raised a brow urging Leo to continue. "The description is the same as the weapon from the first ones."

Adora's POV
"And this is the dining room! I and Bow sneak down here at night to get cake!"

I wasn't paying much attention to Glimmers tour. I tried I did but my head was still reeling from the past events. I may or may not

have turned a horse into a magical horse and it went on a rampage and in an attempt to stop it been revealed as a Horde soldier and got hunted down, ran into a crazy old lady almost got captured found out horsey was a stupid name, met the queen and have been accepted only for Glimmer to excitedly show me around what will be my new home.

Glimmer was being very, very thorough with her tour not skipping a single room. Until we passed one door in the long hallway. "Uh, Glimmer you missed one." I went to reach for the handle but she gasped as she teleported and grabbed my hand.

"You can't go in there!" I retracted my hand instantly worried.

"What why?"GGlimmer sighed as she looked at the door with an unreadable expression on her face.

"That's a guest room made specifically for a friend of mine. She has a really sensitive nose so we try not to let people in there because she might not like their scent. I didnt mean to startle you sorry."

I looked back to the door worriedly. Its sticks out against the bright sleek interior of the Castel, the door is a natural oak color and there are small indents along with the door which makes it look even less like the rest of the Castel. Wow, I spend less than a day here and already noticing pointless things I don't even know what I'm talking about anymore.

"Hey, don't take it personally! She hates the way I smell. Says I smell like too much magic or something."

"Yeah. Weird." Glimmer then grabbed my hand and pulled me down the hallway to another door that looked more like it belonged.

"Okay. You've seen the dining hall, the throne room, the portrait hall. So, the last stop on our grand tour is... your new room! Ta-da!"
I found myself overwhelmed by pure pink.

"It's pretty standard. You've got your vanity, the bathroom, crystals, bell pull, tea nook, more crystals, bed, desk, and of course, the waterfall."

"And uh is the waterfall for showering?"
Glimmer then laughed at me.

"Ha! Waterfall for showering! That's a good one Adora. I'm right down the hall if you need anything. Night!"

Before I could get a word out she was gone.

I just sigh and look over to the bed. If you could even call it that. It looked like an over-glorified pillow.

"Okay. This is different than the Fright Zone, but I'm sure I'll get the hang of this in no time." I took a seat trying to relax only to be eaten by the comforter.

"Help!"

Azar looked to Leo in shock and saw Catra's ears perk up trying to listen in as she rose out of her seat.

"Wait for me outside I'll be there in a moment." Leo nodded and left. Cyra then got next to Catra clutching her shoulders.

"Sorry, Liz we're gonna have to push back those lessons...again." Catra once again got out of Cyra's grip.

"That's fine then I can just help you and Leo come up with a plan!" Azar sighed.

"Liz this isn't something I want you involved with."

"But-"

Suddenly Cyra cut in.

"Hey, why don't you and I have a mother-daughter day! Just us while Azar takes care of everything."

Catra looked upset but when she saw how happy her mom looked she had to fight the urge to blindly say yes to her. "Come on Liz Cy has been busy. I promise I'll tell you everything once the meeting is over." Catra looked to her momma and just let out a groan.

"Fine."

Cyra clasped her hands excitedly and took Catra's hand and led her out of the room. "Oh, I'm so excited this is the first day off I've had since who knows when! What would you like to do Elizabeth?" Catra looked to her mother and didnt have much of an answer she and her mom haven't hung out by themselves since she was a kit. Even then they just napped or Cyra read her stories. 'It would be weird to ask her to do that right? I mean I'm almost an adult.' Catra thought.

Oh yeah.

"Why don't we talk about party plans? It coming pretty soon right?" Catra saw her instantly light up.

"Of course! We have so much to do, if you want we can invite Glimmer and Bow to stay the week leading up to your birthday." Catra nodded.

"Yeah, that would be fun."

"Come on we can go to the library and look at all the traditions we want to do for yours!" Catra smiled as her mom dragged her down the hall with a bright smile on her face.

Once the pair arrived Cyra didn't waste a second pulling book after book off the shelves. She had even dismissed all the staff leaving just Catra and her mother. Catra just followed Cyra around holding the books she has chosen until Catra lost her sight and

had to tell Cyra she thinks this is enough to get started. She turned around and laughed. "Sorry got a little carried away."

"You think?" Catra said behind a large stack of books. Cyra chuckled and grabbed about half the stack and they both sat at the small table.

They both took turns reading through the books suggesting things. Some were definite, like having a big feast, others were maybes and some were just a flat-out no. Eventually, they were laughing as Cyra turned the page and saw an illustration of the Amber runestone.

"What's that about?" Catra craned her neck to see.

"It's the bonding ritual for the runestone." Catra stared at the page and Cyra interrupted before she could speak. "Elizabeth would you like to learn to use the runestone?"

"No, not really." Cyra's speech was cut off.

"Wait really?" Catra shrugged.

"Yeah, I have a lot going on with Momma and not to mention my training with Leo. If I can put off adding a whole new aspect to my life count me in." Cyra just blinked in pure shock.

Catra noticed the silence and looked back to her mom confused. "What?" She just smiled and hugged her tightly.

"I just love you so much."

Adora's POV
"Glimmer! I think I killed the bed! Oof-" I rubbed my head as I felt myself run into someone I look up and of course the person I ran into was none other than Angella.

"Ma'am- I mean your majesty-I mean sir." I tried to bow and salute at the same time and she looked me up and down. Oh yeah, feathers. I quickly swatted them out of my hair and face.

"So what are you doing up?"

She glanced over at me and I quickly regained my posture. "When I feel the cares of the day weighing upon me, I come here." She like Glimmer had a glowing orb in her hand as she shined it on a mural of a man.

"Who is that?"

"King Micah. My husband. He built the Rebellion with me. And he was one of the first casualties of The Horde." I looked over to the left of the mural to see Horde soldiers with weapons aimed at the king.

"Sorry. I didnt know." I put my head down instantly feeling even more out of place. The Horde symbol on my back felt like it was burning into my skin.

"Adora, how much do you know when it comes to relationships?" I looked up at the queen in shock. That was the last thing I expected her to ask me.

"I don't know what you mean." The queen sighed. "Like friendships, family, romantic. How much do you know about such topics."

I tried to think hard about it. "Well I had friends and some I even considered family but, I don't think I understand the last one." Angella just laughed.

"Of course. Well, Adora is there someone who you think doesn't into either category? Yet you still feel intense positive emotions towards?"

I didn't have to think hard. Her name instantly came to mind. "I guess... but she's not around anymore." I clutched my arm with my nails digging into the skin. I'm not crying. Especially not now.

"My apologies. I didn't mean to bring up something recent."

"No don't apologize it was years ago. I'm probably just dwelling on it too much." Shadow weaver always insisted I was too hung up on her death. I looked at Angella and just saw the horrified look on her face.

"Did- did I say something wrong?" She shook her head.

"No. It's just... how old was she?"

"Too young." There was a long pause of silence filling the room.

"I'll never forgive what the Horde has done. They've torn apart families and destroyed everything. Then force children to fight in their war."

"Then why did you agree to let me stay here?" She looked at me with such kind eyes and a soft smile.

"Believe it or not you aren't the only ex-Horde soldier I've taken in." I gave her a look of pure shock. She just laughed.

"Are they still here?" Maybe I can talk with them. Being the only ex-Horde soldier for a while they might welcome a new one.

Angella got a sad look on her face. "Unfortunately no. We managed to find the family she was taken from and she went home. I do miss having her around. Though I'm glad she found her rightful home."

I could tell by her face it was a difficult topic. "I know the Horde isn't kind. I also know that the way you were raised wasn't fair. Not only that Glimmer vouched for you. So I'm willing to give you a chance. Understood?"

I nodded my head firmly.

Chapter End Notes

For reference Catra is 5'2 Adora 5'9 Vivianne 5'10 Azar 5'7 Cyra 5'9 Glimmer 4'11 Bow 5'10.
(Idk if these are canon but they are to me

No party like a Halfmoom party

Chapter Notes

> I have been writing like no tomorrow! I'm so excited to see how you guys like the next couple chapters!
> Also I accidentally swapped Cyra and Azars height in the last chapter Azar is the taller one. Oops.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

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Catra age 9:
"Come on, please? I can't stand seeing you walk around all dirty."

Catra looked up and saw Cyra staring at her with pleading eyes.

"I already bathed." She wasn't lying the water dripping onto the floor proved that. The kit was currently a shivering mess wrapped in a towel. Cyra sighed, she let Catra clean herself because she didn't want to overstep and scare her off less than a week of her being in Halfmoon but it was obvious Catra wasn't used to fur and hair treatment.

"I washed everything! What else is there?" Cyra felt hurt when she heard how much Catra didnt know. She then sat down in front of Catra and leaned her head forward as she undid her hair from its usual braid.

"Here this is what your hair is supposed to feel like." Catra stared at her for a moment before reaching her hand forward and she gasped as she felt her fingers guide through it gently.

Cyra smiled as she brought her head back up. "Unfortunately for you, you happened to get my thick hair so it requires some upkeep. The fact that you haven't been using more than one product it's not a surprise your hair is all matted." Catra felt herself shrink as she held her hair close to her.
~~~~~~

"Are you gonna cut it off?"

"No of course not!" Cyra then realized she had raised her voice a bit and gained her composer.

"I mean, if you want to I can but I'm not gonna force you to cut it if you don't want to." Catra quickly shook her head.

"No. I want it long." Cyra smiled.

"You know they say that's a type of instinct amongst Magicats." Catra raised a brow as her ear perked forward.

"Hair is something that is engrained into our culture. It's very important to us. Some say it's just a learned behavior I think otherwise. I got the wrong idea when I first saw Azar. I thought she was crazy." Catra laughed.

"She is crazy." Cyra nodded.

Catra then started fidgeting with her hair. "I don't think I can get mine like yours though." Cyra then smirked.

"Is that a challenge? If you cooperate I can get it super soft." Catra looked up at her and smirked right back.

"I doubt it." Cyra smiled. She always loved how much Catra resembled Azar.

"Alright but you have to get back in the bath." Catra let out a long groan before reluctantly agreeing. Cyra scooped up her kit and walked her to the bathroom attached to her room. Catra has found herself wanting to sleep with her moms instead of her room. They didnt mind.

Cyra placed Catra into the bath which Cyra tried to warm up a bit beforehand but was still a bit cold judging by the way Catra shivered.

"Stay here for a second." Cyra quickly got some more bottles and a brush from a cabinet and got back on her knees behind Catra.

"Okay close your eyes. You don't want to get this stuff in them I swear." Catra nodded and shut her eyes tightly.

As Cyra ran her fingers through Catra's scalp which caused Catra to purr. After rinsing it out Cyra picked up the brush.

"Alright, this is the long part. Tell me if I hurt you at all okay?" Catra nodded and rubbed her eyes which were starting to feel heavy. Cyra just smiled and worked her way up from the bottom of Catra's hair. It was tangled and at some points, Cyra had to go back and apply more product because it didnt gets through all of her hair.

Eventually, after almost two hours she got through all of her hair and went through it with some more product. "Of course you would get Azar's wavy hair." She said with a hint of envy Cyra expected a reaction but when she leaned over she noticed Catra was fast asleep. Sadly Cyra had to wake her so she can dry off and get dressed. Though she enjoyed it for as long as she could.

She gently picked her up and wrapped her in a towel as she began to start waking up again. Catra nuzzled more into her mom trying to not be woken up. "I know but I just need to get you dressed and pull your hair up then you can go right to bed." Catra groaned again and she rubbed her eyes trying to wake up.

Cyra set her down as she went to grab some clothes for Catra. 'We have to go to the tailors to get her some fitting clothes soon.' Cyra came back with an old nightshirt and shorts from when Catra was six. It hurt that she was still able to fit them due to the lack of food she received. Watching her eat was sad to watch. She always asked if she was allowed more even when it was obvious she was starving.

Cyra was brought out of her thoughts when she heard Catra yawning. "Alright now just let me put it up and we can go to

sleep." Catra nodded as Cyra picked her up and walked her out of the bathroom.

Azar was sitting on the edge of her bed in thought and her ears perked up to the door opening. "Hey what's- wow how'd you manage to tame that mane?" Cyra just rolled her eyes.

"Talk all you want but Elizabeth didnt take the easy way out by chopping it all off."

"Fair enough. You alive?" Azar directed the question at Catra as she laid heavily onto Cyra almost passed out.

"Mhmm." Azar was inwardly aw'ing at the kit. She always missed her child the second she was taken, but moments like this make her wonder how she survived so long without her. Cyra sat down on the bed with Catra in her lap she reached for the brush and gently pulled it back into a loose bun just to keep it from getting tangled while she slept.

Catra was lost to the land of the living in a matter of seconds. Cyra just brushed her hands through her hair scratching her scalp. Azar smiled as she sat next to her wife who was cradling Catra. "She has both the best and worst hair genetics."

Azar laughed as she wrapped her arm around her wife and placed he head into the dip of her shoulder. "When are you gonna give me the special hair treatment? Looks like it works wonders in getting kit's to sleep." Azar said as she gestured to Catra.

"Maybe when I get one from you."
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Adora's POV
"I can't believe we scored another princess! All we need is Frosta and we have a real fighting chance!" Bow was still riding the high of his sonic arrow working and he and Entrapta geeked out for what felt like forever after the whole killer bots thing.
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We were laughing and talking as we made our way into Bright moon but all chatter stopped when we heard Angella. "Glimmer!" Oh, that can't be good.

Glimmer groaned as she grabbed me and Bow and teleported us to her room.

"What is this?!" Angella gestured to Glimmers room which looked... interesting. Clothes were thrown everywhere, her bed a mess, and her bathroom disorganized.
Glimmer cringed.

"Oh come on! What were you doing in my room anyway?" Angella rolled her eyes.

"Trying to drop off this." Angella then held up a scroll with a wax seal of a half-moon and a red ribbon wrapped around it. I thought nothing of it until Glimmer gasped and tried to reach for it. Angella pulled it away.

"Clean your room first and you can have it. I'll come to check on you in a few hours."

Before Glimmer could respond Angella left the room. "Uhhhg! I can't believe her!" She then teleported to her bed and landed face-first into the mattress. Bow had already started picking up and folding Glimmer's clothes.

"Hey if we all do a section it'll be done in no time."

"Yeah Bow can do all the dirty clothes clean up, I can organize everything and you can do your bathroom." I and Bow both knew the bathroom was the best place for her because she'd get distracted trying on clothes or by random things on her desk. With a new pep in her step Glimmer teleported to her bathroom.

"Let's do this!"

Glimmer was already complaining fifteen minutes later. I just rolled my eyes as I closed one of Glimmer's desk drawers. "Come on Glimmer we're done-" I opened the third drawer and was attacked by a bunch of pieces of paper.

"Oh, I knew I put those somewhere!" Glimmer was next to me going through the papers. Well, there goes the keep Glimmer from being distracted plan. I look at the papers thrown about and realize they're all letters from one person.

"What are these?" Glimmer then smiled at me like she was waiting for me to ask.

"They're from that friend I told you about! She's not really...allowed out of her kingdom so she sends me letters! We usually use Bows tracker pad But- Oh shit! Bow did we ever give C' our new frequency?!"

Bow's eyes went wide. "Uhh." Glimmer then groaned. "No wonder she sent a letter! Not to mention the way we just up and left! She's gonna kill us!" I was becoming more and more confused. While they were talking about being murdered or something along those lines I read a letter I picked up.

'She's driving me crazy! I swear I don't know how you ever saw her as a potential partner.' I then glanced over to the next one skimming over it. 'I made it to the gate chamber today! Found out Leo is the one to guard it so it's back to the drawing board. I'm so close, once I can leave you to need to take me to that place you got that weird fruit thing.' It was nice to read something that made sense. Every time we got letters from kingdoms it was so formal and sounded forced, but these just sounded so much more, human?

'I wish I could teleport like you. Could you imagine the trouble I could cause? Not to mention mom could never keep me here.'

'I just want to see the moons again.'

'I hate seeing the same people every day.'

'I'm so sick of this place!'

The longer I go over the letters the nice feeling goes away and is replaced with sadness.

"She thinks her moms love her too much." I'm startled out of my thoughts when Glimmer speaks. "Please don't think of them as bad people. When I started receiving letters of her saying she wished she could leave I wanted to go straight to her mom's demanding answers. My mom stopped me and finally explained why."

I was waiting for her to explain but Bow chimed in. "Glimmer, Adora doesn't know her and we shouldn't be telling her about it. It's her story to tell."

"But Adora also-" Bow gave her a harsh stare and Glimmer sighed as she picked up the pieces of paper. "Come on let's get this done. C' is probably worried and her letter might be important."

Earlier that day
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Usually, when Catra would wake up there was never a rush to get ready. Not a lot of stuff seems to go on. Today was the exact opposite. Catra was woken up by one of her maids, Gen. She then told her that her mother requires her presence. At first, she thought it was an emergency but once she made her way to the throne room only to see a bunch of people running around like chickens while Cyra was staring at a piece of paper before nodding and handing it off to a person standing next to her.

"Uhh...mom?" Cyra turned around and smiled.

"Oh, Elizabeth! You're here just in time!" She grabbed Catra's hand and dragged her to a nearby table that had a wide range of different meat on it.

"We were just deciding what to serve on your birthday feast!" Considering Catra just woke up and hadn't had breakfast yet to
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say she was hungry was an understatement. Not to mention the fact the smells were amazing.

"Twist my arm why don't you?" Cyra laughed as she sat Catra down at the table. She was about to dig in when Azar rushed into the room.

"Liz quick I need your help before Cy gets-" She looked over and saw Catra and Cyra next to each other.

Cyra then put on a strained smile. "What was that darling?" Azar then coughed into her hand.

"Just saying how much I love you." Azar wrapped her arm around Cyra nuzzling her.

"Mhm, m I'm sure." Catra in the meantime was stuffing her face with the samples telling the maid what she knew then was a must-have.

"Which is your favorite mom?" The pair looked to Catra.

"Don't worry about us it's your birthday!" Catra looked to Azar and she subtlety pointed to the third option.

Catra relayed the information to Gen which she wrote down to show to the chef. Gen was the one to watch over Catra after the Vivianne incident. Catra likes her, though she is significantly older than her she never treats her as a child and at the same time doesn't treat her like Catra will have her head chopped off any minute. Which Catra learned is hard to come by.

"So when are Bow and Glimmer expected to arrive?" Suddenly Catra dropped her fork as she had wide eyes. Cyra just laughed.

"I assumed you forgot luckily I sent out a messenger earlier." Catra sighed out a breath of relief.

"Don't scare me like that." The queens laughed.

"Azar!" We all turned as we heard Leo shout.
Azar quickly got up and kissed Cyra and Catra on the cheek.

"Well, that's my cue. Love you!" Azar then sprinted out of the room.

A few seconds later Leo came in with the white of their fur a bright orange. "Where?" The remaining Magicats pointed in the direction of where Azar ran off to.

"Thank you."

Adora's POV
Five hours.
It took five hours to clean Glimmers' room. Could it have been done in one? Absolutely but Glimmer kept going on and on about how her mom would check every inch and if it wasn't perfect she'd just get upset and send maids to do it.

That isn't good because Angella thinks it's important to teach kids to clean. I didnt have a problem with the deep cleaning. I was just shocked by how much stuff Glimmer had. When we approached Angella she just nodded and handed Glimmer the letter.

"Wait aren't you going to check?"

"Nope."

Glimmer was fuming by the time she was back in her room. "She always checks... She always checks!" Bow quickly grabbed her shoulders.

"Hey let's look at the bright side! Cleanroom and now we have the letter!" Glimmer took a deep breath.

"Yeah, yeah you're right." Glimmer opened the letter and we both watched as she read. Suddenly a big smile appeared on her face and she jumped up and down excited. "We're going to a party!"

Glimmer disregards the letter and Bow joins her in chanting about a party.

I crouch down and read the letter which luckily wasn't hard to read.

'Dear princess Glimmer of Brightmoon, and master archer Bow, We would like to invite you to join us in Halfmoon for the celebration of Elizabeth's eighteenth birthday. We hope to see you there.

Regards, Queen Cyra.'

Well, then no wonder they're excited. "Come on Adora this will be your first party! Arent, you excited?" I pointed to the first line of the letter.

"I wasn't invited." Glimmer rolled her eyes.

"Adora we're not just gonna leave you alone, C' doesn't get to meet a lot of new people I'm sure she'll love you!"

Bow then butted in. "Uhhh, Glimmer are you sure about that?" I raised my brow at Bow. "Nothing against you Adora, but C' can be a bit, intense?"

"She's a bitch."

"Glimmer!"

"What? It's not to be mean!" Bow sighed and looked back at me.

"What Glimmer meant to say was, she's sarcastic, gets into trouble, and doesn't enjoy kiss-ups or...people pleasers." I dropped my head.

"So what your saying is she'll hate me the second I open my mouth." Bow gave me a strained smile.

"Well, we don't know that! Like I said she's super curious just talk about the outside world and she'll at least tolerate you."

"I don't know-" Glimmer grabbed my hands.

"Come on Adora! There is no party like a Halfmoon party! I promise if you don't like it I'll teleport you back." I sighed as Glimmer started her puppy dog eyes.

"Fine." She then jumped up again excitedly.

"We're going to Halfmoon!"

Chapter End Notes

I promise it is sooo close. Also Azar 1000 percent uses Catra as a defense against Leo. (Leo could never be mad at Catra.)

I see your face

Chapter Notes

> Love reading all the analytical comments! I put a lot of foreshadowing and hints in almost every chapter. Its come to my attention that the fact no one has mentioned Catra to Adora despite their similar backgrounds. I bring it down to Magicats are meant to be a secret and everyone who has been to or knows of Halmoon are sworn to secrecy. Hence why Glimmer never described her friend. And Glimmer herself didnt find out Catras background till she was older and most of Halfmoon also doenst know shes from the Horde. Hope that clears that up.
>
> Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's POV
"Mom please! Glimmer and Bow are coming today, can't we just push it to tomorrow?"
Mom just rolled her eyes at me.

"I told you to go last week because I knew you would be complaining about it this week, but you didnt listen, and if you don't do it now it won't be ready in time."

"But mom it'll take forever. Cant I just go after I see Glimmer and Bow?" Cyra laughed at me.

"If I do that then you'll complain that I made you leave." I just rolled my eyes. I went to speak when Cyra spoke up again. "Look your leaving today so you can go now and be back to see Glimmer and Bow or you go later and not only face Diane's wrath but also not be back till late. Which do you prefer?" Azar then walked in.

Bingo.

Cyra must've read my mind.

"Nope get out!" Cyra then started to shove Azar out of the room.

"Hey! I haven't even done anything yet." Cyra just shook her head at her.

"Nuh-uh. Elizabeth is going somewhere today and you are not letting her off the hook." Azar looked offended.

I slide up next to Azar. "Wow, Momma looks like mom thinks you're weak-willed. I would never." Cyra glared at me. It was a well-known fact Azar could never say no to me.

"Azar, Elizabeth has to get fitted for her birthday attire today." Azar raised a brow.

"I thought Bow and Glimmer were coming today."

I just smirked at Cyra. "That's what I said but-"

"She has to get fitted today! No buts." I slid next to Azar, got under her arm, and nuzzled into her.

"See what I'm dealing with?" Azar laughed as she started scratching my head.

"Come on sweetie, she hasn't seen Bow and Glimmer for a while. I'm sure she can just go tomorrow." Cyra groaned. Then her eyes got a glint to them that I didnt like.

"Azar, can we talk? Privately."

I saw Azar gulp and nod as she followed Cyra out of the room. I was about to sneak away but Cyra's face made me stay in place.

Five minutes later Cyra comes out. Alone. With a smile she just says.

"You have five minutes to get to Diane's." I went to argue but she just pointed to the door.

"Five seconds before I get Leo."

"Oh, I cant wait to see her again! I also can't wait to make fun of her for missing us so much." Glimmer said as she and the best friend squad made their way through the whispering woods. Bow laughed and looked to Adora who was studying the invitation like no one's business.

"You okay Adora?" Adora's attention didnt leave the paper as she answered.

"Yeah, it's just you guys say this is one of the biggest kingdoms and I've never even heard of it." Adora thought the Horde would be all over a large kingdom like Halfmoon.

"Well, they're super secretive. The Horde invaded years ago but they escaped and moved underground. Ever since then they are very wary of outsiders." Adora visibly tensed up at this.

"And you're sure it's alright for me to just, show up?" Bow looked worried but Glimmer just laughed.

"Don't worry with this we're practically invincible!" She then pulled out a coin with a Halfmoon Crest on it with fancy swirls surrounding it. Adora raised a brow.

"Am- am I supposed to know what that is?" Glimmer groaned.

"This is a royal Crest given to me and Bow so it lets everyone know that we are guests of the royal family. They can't fight with us. Not to mention they know us by name at this point."

Adora's nerves weren't completely erased but she felt a little more at ease than before. Then she read over the invitation again and asked something that bothered her for some reason.

"So if her name is Elizabeth why does Glimmer call her C'?" Bow looked to Adora.

"Oh, that's because when we first met her she went by a different name."

"What was-"

"We're here!" Adora looked up expecting a castle but instead, she was at a flat cliff side.

"Uhh." Glimmer smiled and winked at Bow.

"I love this part!" She and Bow then ran right into the cliff. But instead of hitting a wall,l they went straight through it. Adora screamed as Glimmer's hand came out and dragged her in. Adora clenched her eyes shut but opened them when she felt her feet land on the ground. "What the?" She looks up and sees a dark chamber with torches lighting it up.

"Whoah." Adora didnt have long to awe as Bow and Glimmer began to walk down the pathway.

"Hey wait up!"

"Stars will you please stand up straight?" Catra groaned as she tried straightening up for Diane. She was a tall frail-looking grey cat with green eyes and has a gray Dutch braid that goes down her back.

"I don't get why you can't just use my measurements from last year. It's not like I've grown or anything." Diane rolled her eyes as she started to measure the circumference of Catra's head.

"I'll have you know there is a lot more that goes into your eighteenth birthday. Years of traditions are combined into one day. Your outfit is one of them. It requires things that you have never worn before meaning things need to be measured and re-measured. So suck it up!"

Catra just rolled her eyes. Suddenly the shop door opened and Catra looked over. "Sorry, we're closed come back later to make an appointment."

"Oh come on Diane I'm hurt." Catra just sighed as she considered running. Diane looked up and saw Vivianne.

"Oh welcome!" Vivianne laughed as she walked up to the pedestal Catra was standing on.

"Hey, Lizzy. Having fun?" Catra groaned.

"Yep." Diane then smirked and Catra knew where this was going.

"So Vivianne, what color do you think would look best on her?" Catra went to speak up.

"Shouldn't I be the one to-" Too late Vivianne and Diane were long gone talking about fabric colors? Diane has been a long supporter of what people call 'Livyanne' since Cate met her.

Catra then sat down waiting for them to be done talking about her outfit. Catra didnt bother getting involved. Despite how annoyed Catra gets with Diane she knows that she would never make her wear something she hates. So she'll deal with them being annoying for a while. "Vivvy!?"

'Wow so everyone just bursts in nowadays' Catra thought as she saw Vivianne's dad enter the shop.

"What's wrong?" Vivianne was up on her feet once again.

"I need you to be a surveillance guard." Vivianne's eyes lit up.

"Really?!" Her tail started going to and fro excitedly. Her dad smirked.

"Yep looks like our...guests brought an extra and I want you to keep an eye on them." Catra then stood up.

"Hey hold on. I'm sure if they're with Bow and Glimmer they're probably not up to anything."

Vivianne's father gave me a strained smile. "I know it's easy for you to trust everyone who walks into our home but let's leave this to the professionals." Catra's eyes twitch as she started to throw all of her anger management out the window. Diane quickly stepped in.

"Well don't let us keep you. Hurry now I have to finish up with Elizabeth."

Vivianne's dad began to leave and she looked back at me. "Save me a dance alright!" Before Catra could deny the offer Vivianne was long gone.

'Why the heck would Glimmer bring a random person here?'

When Glimmer went further down the chamber Bow decided to lag to make sure Adora was okay. "Yeah, it tripped us out too when we first got here. And we were only twelve." Adora laughed.

"So how long have you known Elizabeth?"

"Since she was nine." Adora then began to ask more questions.

"Yet you never visited her till you were twelve." Bow got a sad smile on his face.

"Sadly no. We wrote letters but the only reason we were allowed in was that she tried to come and see us too many times."

"The more you tell me about her life the more I'm concerned." Bow sighed.

"Sadly I can't tell you why without her permission. I assure you though her moms are only doing what they think is best for her." Adora was curious what he meant until they arrived at a large gate with two guards with large staff covering the entrance.

Adora's eyes went wide as she saw them. Not because she was shocked to see actual guards, something Brightmoon should invest in, but they had cat features. The only person Adora has ever seen look like that was-

Glimmer's voice stopped Adora's thoughts. "Hey what's up?" She went to walk straight through but was stopped.

"Sorry princess Glimmer but a chaperone must accompany you." Glimmer puffed up but Bow pulled her back.

"Understandably. Right Glimmer?" Glimmer huffed and nodded.

Adora wanted to feel bad but she was still staring at the guard with a look of disbelief. 'There's no way.'

"Psst, Adora don't just stare!" Bow whispers to her trying to be subtle. Adora shakes her head.

"Sorry." She tells herself it's just a coincidence. Catra had to have come from somewhere. That she needs to make a good impression so just stop worrying about Catra.

Suddenly the gate opened and an orange, black and white Cat person came through half her head was shaved and parted to the side into a low ponytail. She glared harshly at Adora. Glimmer didnt notice as she walked up to her. "Hey, Vivianne! Sorry, you had to come all the way here. I promise she's nice." Glimmer then grabbed Adora and pushed her close to the girl. "Adora this is Vivianne, Vivianne this is Adora." Adora smiled and tried to extend her hand in greeting but Vivianne stopped it.

"No need I'm just here to keep an eye on you till the queens see you as not a threat." That made Adora slump a bit. Vivianne then let Adora walk forward. "Come along."

Adora was shocked when they left the chamber and she saw a whole kingdom full of cat people. "Wow." Glimmer excitedly grabbed her arm.

"I know right? Come on the faster we get to the Castel the faster we can eat their amazing food!" Before Glimmer could run Vivianne stopped her.

"Sorry but no running."

Glimmer pouted. Bow just gave a grateful smile. They walked through the town and Adora noticed there wasn't a lot of people out and about. Not to mention everything was darker and street lights were being lit.

"Where is everyone?" Bow looked to Adora.

"Oh yeah, this must be new to you. These people are called Magicats. They're nocturnal so it's about dinner time for everyone. It's cool! You see that." Bow then pointed up to a giant orange stone in the middle of the city.

"That's their runestone. Somehow they made it go on a cycle so when its 'day' it's brighter and when it's 'night' it dulls."

Bow was geeking out but Adora got more questions. "Wait so this kingdom has a runestone? Why haven't you guys gotten their princess to join the rebellion?"

Glimmer went to answer but Vivianne intervened. "Trust me Lizzy isn't a fighter. Besides she doesn't want to leave so don't even bother." Glimmer glared. Adora wanted to know more but Glimmer whispered to Adora.

"I'll tell you later." Adora realized then she was going to have to appeal to a whole new princess. She inwardly groaned.

"Come along the queens don't like to be kept waiting."

"Shit shit shit! Could you please hurry this up? I'm running late." Diane just flicked Catra's ear.

"Well maybe if you came in last week as I told you this wouldn't be a problem! Now hold still."

'Kill me now.'
Catra looked outside and noticed it getting darker and darker. Diane sighed.

"Be back here by five AM tomorrow. I'm letting you go and squeezing you in. Don't be late." Catra looked at her and gave her a big smile.

"Thank you Diane I promise back by five tomorrow!" She laughed as Catra ran out the door.

"Teenagers."

Adora felt like she was repeating the words Whoah over and over again. Yet she found herself amazed the further she went onto the city and the Castel just. "Whoah." Once they entered they were escorted to the throne room when Viviane finally left their side. The doors shut behind them and Adora looked to see another Magicat with blonde hair and light fur. She stood next to her throne looking regal.

"Cyra!"

Glimmer and Bow ran to her with no hesitation. "Lovely to see you all again!" The queen went from stern to kind as she hugged the pair. She then looked up at me. "Who is the special guest?" Her eyes were a bright blue. Adora inwardly flinched as she was hit with a wave of sadness. She sounded skeptical of Adora and so she panicked and just gave a forced laugh. Glimmer's facepalmed and whispered to Cyra.

"She's a little...socially challenged." Cyra smiled as she nodded. Glimmer then grabbed Adora and walked her up to the queen. "Cyra I'd like you to meet Adora. We ran into her during a Horde invasion and have been friends ever since!"

Cyra's eyes went wide as she stared at Adora as if she was looking for something. Glimmer noticed and coughed into her hand. "Adora this is queen Cyra. Elizabeth's mom." Adora went to bow but by then the queen was snapped out of her daze and waved her hand.

"Oh, no need for that." She then nodded to the guards and they left the room. "Glimmer, Bow make your way to your rooms while I have a chat with Adora. Elizabeth will be home late." Glimmer nodded and Adora's face said help me.

Cyra noticed and put a hand on her shoulder. "No worries you're not in trouble. This is just time to make sure you're not a threat to me or my people." Adora gulped as she nodded. Glimmer and Bow then left the room. Cyra then whispered to one of the guards and they nodded before leaving. Adora tried to start a conversation.

"Your kingdom is lovely."

Cyra walked out of the throne room with Adora behind her they walked down the hall lined with portraits. "I'll skip to the point are you from the Horde?" Cyra was now facing Adora head-on.

"Oh I'm not- I mean, kinda? No! Not kinda I'm definitely not a Horde soldier! I- I was though. Used to be I mean!" Cyra laughed.

"I didnt mean for it to sound accusatory I was just trying to confirm something. So thank you." Adora was confused as Cyra opened another door and gestured for her to go in.

"If you don't mind there is someone I'd like you to see. So just wait here for a moment. Feel free to take a seat as well." Adora just nodded along as Cyra shut the door and afterward ran to find Azar.

"Did I miss them!" Catra came into the throne room panting. The guard chuckled as they pointed.

"Queen Cyra wanted me to tell you to head to the dining room." Catra nodded and started running.

"Thanks!" Catra ran down the hall and almost missed the door with how fast she was running. Without thinking she opened the door.

"Sorry I got stuck with Diane and I couldn't make it-" Adora turned around at the sound of her voice and they both just stared until the blonde spoke up.

"Catra?"

Chapter End Notes

Finally! Now time for upcoming fluff! Dont worry though. Angst is soon on its way.

Clearing things up

Chapter Notes

> Ahhh! I loved writing this chapter. Just Catra and Adora being cute and being *oblivious* thanks for all the comments I promise the plot will start up again I'm just trying to have as much fluff as I can before then!
>
> Also I know its different in the series but as of now Adora already knows how to make her sword into a bracelet. Because I highly doubt Halfmoon would let a stranger with a sword into the castel let alone a first ones sword. Enjoy!!!
>
> Fixed the spacing I dont know how that happened. Oops

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Cyra rushed down the halls first heading to the library only to see a lack of Azar.

"Stars where are you?" Cyra ran through all the places her wife could be until she ended up at their room. She opened the door to see Azar passed out on their bed.

Without hesitation Cyra grabbed a pillow and wacked Azar on the head.

"Ow what the hell?" Cyra then started trying to pull Azar up.

"Come on ,come on ,come on!" While Cyra was trying to pull Azar up she just sighed and pulled her wife into her lap.

"Calm down Sweetheart." Azar then started to nuzzle Cyra's neck. Cyra purred for a momment before snapping out of it and grabbing Azar's face.

"No time! Adora is in the dining room and Elizabeth is on her way!" Azar suddenly was more awake.

"Wait like Adora, Adora? But-" Cyra groaned.

"No time to explain come on!" She then grabbed her and pulled her out of the room. Azar was trying to process but was too busy trying to keep up with Cyra. 'What the hell is going on?'

Adora's POV

I was extremely uncomfortable. Why would the queen just leave me alone in a room? Everything is just weird. I decided not to sit down. Part of me still thinks sitting down is a sign of disrespect. I try to just calm down. Glimmer and Bow have known these people since they were kids. There's nothing to worry about. Besides the queen seems nice enough. A little intimidating if anything.

Suddenly the door opened and I heard a voice.

"Sorry I got stuck with Diane and I couldn't make it-" I turned around quickly at the new voice and all of my worries left as I saw her. I've seen people that looked like Catra as I walked through the city yet there was always an obvious difference, but this is uncanny. Her brown hair with the light tuffs below her ears, her stripes that go down her arms, the freckles on her cheeks that I remeber tracing while she slept in my arms, but those eyes. I could never forget those eyes.

I spoke before think whether it be from hope or excitement I couldn't tell.

"Catra?" I couldn't even get another word out as I was tackled in a blink of an eye. I stepped back a bit to regain my balance and put my hands on her waist. She was hugging me so tightly and I couldnt help but squeeze her tighter. I had tears running down my face but was too happy to care. I could've sworn I felt the vibrations of a purr I used to hold so close to me. She pulled her head back to look at me and she was crying too.

I put my hands on her face trying to make sure this isn't a dream. She just laughs at me. I missed this. "You're real. Like really real." Catra smiled.

"You're such an idiot." I didn't even let the words register as I picked her up and spun her around for no reason.

"I'm so glad you're okay!" Catra had her hands on my shoulders as I held her up.

Catra's POV
I honestly thought this whole situation was was a dream. She then picked me up and spun me around.

Wow she's strong. I stared at her and she smiled up at me. I didn't acknowledge the beating of my heart. She then placed me down and wiped her eyes quickly. "I- I thought you were dead."

"Come on Adora give me a bit more credit." I tried making it more light hearted but Adora just shook her head.

"No i- I know but... Shadow weaver told me they found you dead and then I saw the skiff and I just-" I tried to suppress the flinch from the mere mention of her name. I wasn't surprised she lied to Adora. She probably used my death as an example if anything.

"Well the skiff crashed because someone forgot to give me the override code for the autopilot." Adora looked confused then sheepishly smiled.

"Oh, sorry."

I couldnt even be snarky as I laughed. Shes still the same stupid Adora. "How'd you end up here?" I smirked back at her.

"I could ask you the same question." We both stared at each other and then started laughing.

"Its a long story but I came her with Bow and Glimmer." I stared at her in shock.

"Ohh! So you're that extra guest everyone is talking about."

"Oh please dont tell me that's what people are calling me." I laughed at her.

"We dont get many visitors besides Glimmer and Bow. They're just intrigued is all. I'm just curious how you got out of the Horde, or why you left in the first place."

"Are you kidding? Why would I want to stay in a place like that?" I just shrugged my shoulders.

"I dont know. I just thought you'd be better off. I mean you were on your way to force captain!" Adora frowned.

"I kinda left by accident. I went to see if I could find you after I was promoted and got taken by Bow and Glimmer. Once I saw what the Horde was doing I couldnt stay. I only stayed because... Shadow weaver said a princess killed you."

I would've liked to act surprised but all of that is perfectly in character for the witch. I saw Adora look down in shame. "Hey dont beat yourself up. Manipulation is Shadow weavers whole thing. Shes been messing with our heads since we were kids." I wiped the forming tears from her eyes.

Once she composed herself she started asking me questions. "So what are you doing here?" Where do I even start.

"Its kinda a long story."

"What do you mean-"

Just then I heard something in the hallway. Oh no. "Hold that thought for a sec." I quickly ran out into the hall slamming the door shut and to my not my surprise saw my moms standing there. Azar looked dazed but Cyra was up at attention. "Elizabeth. Hi..." I crossed my arms and raised a brow.

"Looking for something?"

Azar just rubbed her head. "Can someone please tell me what's going on?" Cyra smiled.

"I told you Adora is here! That's who Glimmer and Bow brought with them!" Azars brain started to kick into gear.

"So... that's good right?" Cyra face palmed. "What? I dont know what to say!" I just rolled my eyes and began pushing them back down the hallway.

"Dont say anything you guys have to go!"

"But I want to meet her."

"You already did! Besides I want to talk to her before she treats me like everyone else here." Cyra then turned around.

"What do you mean by 'like everyone else here?" I hated when she got that concerned look on her face.

"Nothing! I mean it's not bad just... frustrating. I just don't want her treating me differently because of who my family just so happens to be." Cyra's ears dropped.

"Oh..." shit wrong thing to say.

"Mom please don't take that wrong. I'm not saying I want to keep you a secret its just... I haven't seen Adora in nine years I want to take things slow. I'll tell her later today once shes adjusted. Promise." Cyra sighed and nodded.

"Alright." I smiled and hugged her.

"I love you." Cyra clutched me tighter.

"I love you too." Suddenly we got a third person in on the hug.

"I love you three!" We laughed as Azar squeezed us tightly. Cyra then stepped back.

"Alright come on Azar we have to actually hide you."

Azar scoffed. "What? Why?" Cyra huffed,

"because if Adora sees you she'll know you're her mom right away." Azar just stuck her tounge out. Cyra blooped her nose.

"Don't be like that! Be grateful no one doubts you're her mother." As she began walking away. Cyra went to follow her but quickly turned around to me. She then grabbed my hands and placed a key inside my hand. "Behind the third painting on the left there's a door. This will unlock it and it will take you straight to the gardens. I'll make sure no one goes there."

I smile at her. "Thanks mom." She then winked at me.

"Have fun." I chuckled as I opened the door to see Adora.

Adora's POV

Catra quickly left the room which luckily gave my mind time to process. Catra's alive, shes happy, and it seems like we still get along. She's still the same after so long. I still don't know how she got here but they must've treated her much better here then in the Horde.

She was probably really happy when she saw people like her. Catra would never admit it but I knew how much she hated how different people treated her. She eventually just thought they were right. That she didn't deserve to be treated like she was normal because to her, she wasn't.

Judging by the fact Catra is allowed In the castle she probably worked her way up. I never understood how Shadow weaver never saw the potential in Catra. She had to learn to survive in the worst situations and I can only imagine how much she grew. But now I don't have to.

I feel a smile form on my face. Shes back. My head is still finding it hard to process. Maybe for once the universe is giving me a break. The door then opened and I saw Catra had a smile on her face. I suddenly got a weird feeling in my chest.

"Is everything alright?" Catra perked up.

"Yeah I actually got something to show you." She then walked to a painting on the wall. She went to push it to the side but the frame didnt budge. "A little help?" I snapped out of my daze.

"Are you sure this is allowed." Catra just rolled her eyes fondly at me.

"Yeah I'm sure. Got permission too. Now come on." I went over and grabbed the other side and pulled.

"Wow this is a lot heavier than it looks." Catra laughs as we pushed it to the side. Low and behold a door was behind the painting. Catra then inserted a key and unlocked the door. Part of my brain said I should probably check on Bow and Glimmer.

"You coming?" Catra offered me her hand. And I took it without hesitation.

Meanwhile Cyra and Azar were talking while going down the halls heading to their room before dinner was ready only to be stopped by a cloud of sparkles.

"Did you kill Adora?!" Azar jokingly went to say yes but Cyra stopped her.

"No, she and Elizabeth are just hanging out." Glimers mouth hung wide open.

"What!" Cyra looked confused.

"I thought that's why you brought Adora here?" Glimmer looked even more baffled. Azar then stares.

"You don't know do you?"

"Know what?" Bow then came in running and stopped to catch his breath.

"Is.. Adora... dead?"

Adora's POV
We went down the passageway and continued talking as if we hadn't been out of each others lives for nine years. I missed how easy it was to just talk with Catra. She never let go of my hand even as we walked. I finally got a momment to actually look at Catra. Like really look. She was wearing loose baggy pants with a fancy sash wrapped around her waist. Her top was simple with a transparent sash that goes from her neck to the bottom of her top which exposes her stomach.

Her hair was pulled back into a ponytail and looked alot curlier then I last remembered. Her fur also looked softer. I also noticed how much she grew. Her arms are much more muscle, I also noticed the fact she was walking with much more confidence, and the way she walked really showed how much she... filled out.

I quickly shake my head and look at my surroundings. "So where are we going?" Catra smirked back at me.

"You'll see. Dont worry you'll love it." I dont think I'll never get over how pretty shes gotten. How pretty shes always been.

I finally see a light and we walk out. I squint a bit once my eyes adjusted and saw a beautiful indoor garden. Orbs of light are surrounding the area in the air. "Wow." Catra smiled.

"I know right!" Catra then yanked me by my hand down a row of yellow flowers. I was going to admire them but Catra kept pulling me along until we came to a hedged circle away from everything else. There is a silk door thing draped over the hedge and Catra pulls it aside.

"Welcone to my new hiding place. Once I'm dragged there I'm given a momment to look. It's a simple hammock tied between two large trees with flowers all around. A simple stone path leads to the hammock. Surrounding the hammock is pillows and spare

blankets and I notice a bookshelf to the right with a good amount of books.

"Wow. This is amazing."

Catra smiled smugly. "Cool right?" I nodded as I walked up to the hammock and noticed a book sitting in it.

"What's this?" Suddenly Catra was up and snatched it from me and put it behind her back.

"Nothing!" I tilted my head at her as she put the book somewhere.

"Anyway. Now that we have actual privacy. What have you been up to?" She then sat down on the hammock and offered me a place next to her.

I sat down and it was surprisingly comfortable. "You gotta lean back idiot." Catra laughed as she pulled me down by my arm. I laughed as I leaned back with my legs dangling off the edge. I found myself surprisingly comfortable. I look over and see Catra resting her head on her arms with her eyes closed.

"Adora?" I look back at her and notice her staring at me. "You alright?" I nod.

"Yep! Sorry I spaced out. What were you saying?"

"I was asking how have you been? I mean after all the Horde stuff."

Where do I even start? I feel like going straight to She ra is a bit too far. Gotta ease her into this whole thing.

"Oh umm, I've been living in Brightmoon for a while now. It took some readjusting but Glimmer has been really helpful. She even switch out my bed for a cot."

Catra laughed. "Really? I loved those things! Figures you would want back problems in your future." I rolled my eyes at her as I turned to face her my head resting on my hand.

"I swear it tried to kill me."

"You probably killed the bed." I felt my face still when she said that. She then looked at my face. "You did didn't you? Oh that's funny!" I flushed a bit. I decided to quickly change the subject.

"So this is where you came from right? How's it been?" Her ears perked up as she turned to face me.

"Oh its been nice. Amazing even. I've made some friends and I..."

I stared at her expectantly. "Adora I'm gonna tell you something but you have to promise not to freak out." I stare at her confused.

"Uh okay?"

"Promise?" I nod my head.

"Promise." She then let out a breath as she effortlessly got out of the hammock. I sat up but not nearly as gracefully as Catra. Luckily she didnt notice as she began to pace around in a circle. Fidgeting with her tail as she bit her lip. "Is everything okay?"

Catra nodded her head. "Yeah it's just. Weird?" I turned my head slightly.

"What do you mean." Catra stared at me and sighed.

"I just... Adora I missed you. A lot. I mean this has to be one of the best days of my life and I... I don't want to ruin it."

I managed to fight my way out of the hammock and walk over to Catra who was fidgeting with her hands while facing the ground. I

place my hands on her shoulder and tilt my head to get her to look at me.

"Hey." She then looked up at me. "Catra less than an hour ago I thought you were killed and I would never see you again. Now I get to talk with you again and I know you have been treated like you deserved. I don't think theres anything you could say that would ruin this day for me."

Catra gave me a soft smile and I felt my heart skip a beat. She then took a breath.

"You know queen Cyra?" I looked at her surprised. That's not what I expected.

"Uh, yeah. Shes a little intimidating if you ask me. Kinda scary too." Catra looked at me shocked and started laughing.

A lot.

I suddenly felt left out of a joke or something. "Uh." Catra then looked up with me with tears forming in her eyes from laughter.

"Cyra is my mom. My real name is Elizabeth."

Chapter End Notes

Dunn dunn dunn!!!
Get ready for more flashbacks and an awkward dinner in the

next chapters! Have a good day!

Painful memories

Chapter Notes

> Currently feeling like shit but good news is I can write more!
> Hope you enjoy and as always leave comments!
> Also lowkey cried in this chapter so people with mommy issues be warned.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra age:9
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Catra was currently in her mom's room writing and reading for something called school. Of course, the Horde had something similar but the lessons Cyra gave her are much more difficult in a different way. She had to learn how to do that stupid fancy writing called cursive.

Azar and Cyra were at another meeting. Catra honestly didnt understand why they bother. When they have the power to just force people to do what they want. A sudden knock at the door caused Catra to go on edge. Cyra or Azar would just open it.

A small voice then came from the other side of the door.

"Lizzy? Are you in there?" Catra's ears perked up. It hasn't even been a full week since the last incident. Catra considered acting like she wasn't there but Vivianne spoke again. "I just wanna talk. Then I'll leave. I just need a minute of your time."

Catra sighed and got up. 'I'll just let her speak and then she'll leave.' The girl then went to the door and cracked it open just to see Vivianne standing with her ears down.

"What?" She perked up as she saw Catra.

"I just wanted to say I'm sorry. I know you couldn't see in the dark. That doesn't justify it, I should've let you out when I heard
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you were scared. Well, I should've just let you be instead of forcing you into that anyway."

Catra saw that Vivianne was now crying. She instantly felt weird. 'What the heck am I supposed to do with someone crying?!' Catra didnt know what to do. So she just did what her mom does when she cried. Catra then awkwardly pats the crying kit's head. "Please stop crying. It's not that big of a deal."

Vivianne looked up and sniffed as she rubbed her face. Catra stared at her as she tried to compose herself and tried to think of something to cheer the kit up. "Hey umm, do you know how to write in cursive? I need some..help with it."

Vivianne smiled. "Totally!"
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Adora's POV

"Adora?"

I probably looked crazy staring at a horse I've never seen re. Catra- Elizabeth? Grabbed my shoulders and started shaking me.

"Come on Adora you promised you wouldn't freak out!" I grabbed her wrist to get her to stop shaking me.

"I'm not freaking out! I just was expecting something... I don't know!"

"Stop freaking out! It's making me out!"

"I'm not freaking out!"

"Then why'd you make that face?!"

"I'm processing!"

She stopped yelling and I took a deep breath trying to collect my thoughts. "So Cyra is your mom. You're Elizabeth and you met
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Glimmer when you ran away from the Horde I assume?" She nodded her head.

"So that would make you..."

"Yep, I'm-"

"Younger than me!" Catra looked at me shocked.

"What?" I smirked at her.

"How old are you?" Catra shook her head.

"Adora what are you-" I grabbed her shoulders.

"Just say it!" Catra rolled her eyes.

"I'm seventeen. I don't know what that has to do with-"

"Ha! I'm older! By a significant amount!"

"Stars is that really what you're concerned about? You had me stressing out for no reason!" I tilt my head at her.

"Why would you stress out?" Catra raised a brow at me and gave me a look that said, 'figure it out.' I thought back to the information she gave me I mainly focused on the fact that her being this Elizabeth person means we're here for her birthday making her younger than me. (By a significant amount.) Also, her mom is queen Cyra, and-

"Holy shit, Cyra is your mom?!" Catra then laughed at my face.

"You're still such an idiot." I then panicked.

"Hey when I said Cyra was intimidating I meant in a good way!" Catra laughed harder.

"Glad to see you haven't changed."

"What's that supposed to mean?"

"It means your still a dumb people pleaser." I thought back to what Glimmer said before.

"Oh, yeah, sorry." Catra looked at me confused.

"Adora I was kidding I know you're not an idiot." I shook my head.

"No, I mean I'm not. But Glimmer said you don't like...people pleasers."

"Well yeah, but I've made an exception for you. Feel honored." I smiled back at her.

"Sooo. You're a princess? What are the chances?" Catra sighed as she flopped down onto the soft grass.

"I know right. Wow, I am glad you're taking this so well. I thought you would've freaked out more." I shrugged my shoulders as I sat next to her.

"I think I'm just too happy to process everything. I'll give you my freakout later." Catra laughed and we sit in silence for a bit as I watched Catra's breathing even out. I should tell her.

My brain kept telling me to just tell her. She already shared her secret and she can't have a worse reaction than mine.

"Hey, Catra?" Her ear perked up and she opened one eye.

"Hmm?" I felt myself sit up straighter.

"I kinda have something important to tell you too." Catra then sat up to give me her full attention.

"I'm listening."

"So I found a swor-"

"Catra!" Catra's ears noticeably twitched. "Well shit."

Earlier~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~~

"You didnt think to tell us?!" Glimmer and Bow were almost speechless as Cyra explained.

"I assumed you knew. I mean how many nice Horde soldiers are there that have blonde hair, blue eyes, and around Elizabeth's age?"

"And named Adora," Azar stated. Glimmer huffed.

"Well, she never told us her name how were we supposed to know?!" Azar raised a brow.

"You never once mentioned Elizabeth to Adora? Wouldnt it has helped her to know you knew another Horde soldier? Never thought they might know each other?" Glimmer stuttered a bit.

"Well sorry, I don't assume all Horde soldiers know each other!"

Bow placed a hand on Glimmers shoulders.

"Anyway! So you said Catra and Adora are with each other?" The couple nodded. Glimmer sighed.

"Can you tell us where?" Cyra went to answer but Azar stopped her.

"Why don't you guys just wait a while? They probably have a lot to talk about." Glimmer groaned.

"Fine. Fifteen minutes! Then I'm hunting them down!" Azar laughed and nodded.

"Fair enough."

Glimmer watched the time slowly move as she prepared to chase Catra down the second fifteen minutes struck. Bow looked concerned.

"Glimmer why don't we just wait till dinner? Like Azar said they have a lot to talk about." Glimmer looked to Bow.

"Do you think she'll tell her?" Bow raised a brow.

"Who will tell who, what?" Glimmer groaned.

"Both? I mean ra have a...history. I mean Catra loved Adora before she even knew what love was!" Bow shrugged his shoulders.

"I don't know Glimmer. I think they are just happy to know the other is okay. Maybe we should just let them pace themselves." Glimmer nodded and looked back to the clock.

Bow then stretched and walked to the door.

"Well, I'm gonna check out their library. Remember to go easy on them."

"No promises!"

The second the clock rang past fifteen minutes Glimmer teleported to the garden and shouted.

"Catra!"

Catra's POV

Glimmer's voice always had the shrill frequency like her mother and it always made its way directly into my ears.

"Stop yelling!" I heard Glimmer huff.

"Five minutes before I come in there!" I rolled my eyes and looked over to Adora who looked concerned.

"Hey let's just entertain Sparkles for a while and then I'll show you around." She smiled at me and stood up dusting her pants off. I went to get up when she offered her hand to me. She wasn't even

paying attention. Her head turned towards Glimmer's voice. She just offered her hand like an instinct.

The same instinct that made me grab it without hesitation. Adora then led me out of the secluded part of the garden and saw Glimmer looking around for us in some bushes. "Hey, Sparkles." She jumped at my voice and whipped her head around. "There you are!" She then ran up to me and lightly flicked me on the ear. "Ow! What the hell?" Glimmers cheeks puffed out. "Why didnt you tell me the girl was Adora?! Do you know how easy this could've been? Adora has been with us for months!"

"Well maybe if you would pick up your damn tracker pad I would've known. Or responded to any of my letters. Shit, why didnt you just send me an update after you teleported out of my room?!" Glimmer suddenly looked a lot less confident.

"Well maybe if you just told us her name we could've figured it out!" Adora then spoke up for the first time in this interaction. "Uh, what do you mean? Did Catra talk about me?" I felt my face go red and Glimmer noticed. She then got a sly look on her face.

Shit.

"O, e talked about you Alright. All the time even. She told us about how you were her first lo-"

"Okay! It's been nice talking to you but I was just about to show Adora around." I then hastily start pushing Glimmer towards the exit. Glimmer then teleported away to Adora. "Aw come on I'm sure Adora would love to hear about how much you missed her!"

"Shut it!" I lunged at her and she teleported and stuck her tounge out at me. "Be back by dinner!" Without another word, he left in a cloud of Sparkles. "Fucking bitch." I looked back to Adora and she had her arms crossed and a shit-eating grin on her face. "No, uh-uh. Zip it!" Adora then tackled me in a hug. "I can't believe you missed me! That's so embarrassing for you!"

"I did not!" I wiggled out of her arms and tripped her as she tried to grab me again. We laughed and I grabbed her ponytail. "Come on idiot I wanna show you the town before dinner." Adora caught her breath as I let go of her hair and she jogged to catch up to me. She then subconsciously grabbed my hand.

I refused to acknowledge it in fear she would retract it.

Catra age:10
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"I'll only be gone a week. The Horde is getting too close for comfort. I want as many allies I can get."

"Azar this sounds like a horrible idea."

"It'll be a quick trip. I'll be back in one week." Cyra sighed. "Why can't this wait till after Elizabeth's birthday? This will be her first year back." Azar put a hand down her face. "I know but this is the first time my dad will be in Mystacore you know how hard it is to keep him in one place. I'll be back in time if everything goes as it's supposed to." Cyra chuckled a bit.

"As if anything goes according to plan when you're involved," Cyra smirked as she put her jacket on. "It keeps you on your toes." She then leaned over and kissed her wife on her cheek. "Mhm." Cyra started purring causing the small bundle in her lap to start moving. Azar noticed and started scratching Catra's head to make her fall back to sleep. Leo was then at the door. "Are you ready to leave?" Azar looked to her kit and sighed. "Yeah." She kissed Catra on the head and then kissed her wife. "Be back soon." Cyra laughed "you better." Azar then left the room and closed the door.

As if Catra knew what happened she started moving around in her sleep. Cyra reassures her. "Shh. It's alright." Cyra then scooted herself down the bed to curl around the kitten. "I know. I miss her too."

The next morning Cyra had a morning meeting she had to attend so she carefully slid out of bed trying her best not to wake the kit.
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Once she got dressed she then went to the meeting room and saw Vivianne and her father. Vivianne noticed Cyra and waved her over. "Hi, Cyra!" She smiled as she walked over to the pair. "Hey, Vivianne. Elizabeth is asleep right now but I can go wake her up if you'd like." Viviane's father then stepped in. "We're here because I was wondering if I could get a pass allowing Vivianne to accompany me on the surface. Just to teach her some hunting skills." Cyra's eyes widened.

"Oh, yes of course. Let me just grab one right now before I forget." Cyra rushed to her office and grabbed a medallion which told the guards they were allowed passage outside the gate. She stared at it as she began to worry. 'Is it fair if I allow another parent to take their child to the dangerous world but not my own?' She shook her head as she walked out of her office and went back to the pair.

Meanwhile, Catra woke up to an empty bed with her hair in different directions. "Mom?" Catra rubbed her eyes as she looked around for her moms. Cyra was usually long gone by early morning much to her displeasure. But Azar was usually hanging around at her desk. 'Maybe she's in the library.' Catra got up and walked to the door. She looked both ways as she peeked out the door and she then made her way to the training grounds. 'If Azar isn't there Leo is there.'

However to Catra's shock neither was there. "Where are you?" Catra walked to the library but saw the same result. After wandering almost the whole castle she walked back to her mom's room defeated and saw the door to their room open. When Catra looked she saw a guard under the bed. "Shit! The queen is going to have my head!" Catra tilts her head. She didnt recognize this guard.

"Are you stuck?" The guard let out a startled scream as he hit his head from trying to get up. "Oww.." he carefully gets out of the bed and his eyes widen as he sees Catra. "Princess! Where were you?" Catra shrugged. "I was looking for my momma." He straightened up. "Oh, she's away with Leo on a mission." Catra

frowned. "Oh." The guard attempts to cheer her up. "Well, I would be happy to entertain you!" Catra just climbed back onto the bed and lay down. "No thanks." She curled into herself and buried herself under the blankets. The guard waited for a moment before leaving the room.

Catra was then woken up by the sound of rustling. She sat up in a panic worried about what was happening and relaxed when she saw it was just her mom rummaging through the drawers. "Mom?" Cyra turned around and smiled. "Hey, sweetie I didnt mean to wake you I just have to find a certain document but Azar was the one who put it away." Catra got up and walked over to the dresser by the bed and pulled out a piece of paper. "This one?"

Cyra turned around and grabbed the piece of paper. "Oh perfect! Why would she put it there?"

"She said she wanted to put it somewhere she wouldn't confuse it with the others." Cyra just blinked at Catra and laughed. "Of course. Well, I have to head out but I'll try to be back by dinner." She went to turn around but Catra grabbed her sash around her waist. "I thought the meeting was already over?" Cyra sighed.

"Well...something happened and it's taking longer than I thought it would've and I was not able to meet with the hunters yesterday so I have to fit them in today." Catra frowned. Cyra crouched down and held Catra's face gently. "Hey I'll be back by dinner and we can have a mommy-daughter day sometime this week how does that sound?" Catra just nodded.

Cyra smiled and kissed her forehead. "See you tonight." She then rushed out the door. Catra went to lay down not knowing what to do when all of the people she usually talks to are not around.

Despite what Cyra said she wasn't there for dinner. Catra sat at the long table along with the new guard to her right. Catra found out that her mom knew she wouldn't be able to make it because her favorite was made. She didnt feel like eating but did anyway.

It tasted bitter.

Catra just went back to bed. She didnt even sleep just lay down and thought. She eventually found rest but was woken up by the door opening. She went to look but couldn't see much. "Sweetie, what are you still doing up? It's late." Catra sat up as she heard her voice. "Was waiting for you." Catra then yawned. Cyra sat on the bed after changing and pulled Catra into her arms. "Sorry I missed dinner. It seems everyone wants to argue today." Catra just curled in closer to her mom. "It's okay." Cyra smiled and held her closer. Catra just said tomorrow would be better.

The pattern repeated over for three days. Catra always knew her mother was always busy being queen and all but Catra hadn't realized how much Azar, Leo, and even Vivianne had distracted her from it. She felt. Lonely. Every dinner she had was alone and the only time she mother was when she came into bed but even then it was just an exchange of a few words both too tired to try anything more.

On the third day, Catra didnt even eat dinner. She swore it didnt taste the same. So she sat curled up in her mom's bed again. She tried reading but quickly got bored of it. Before she could even realize she had tears going down her face. When Catra felt them she wiped them harshly and berated herself. "Stop being stupid! She has better stuff to do than entertain some kid!" She tried rationalizing everything but she was sobbing uncontrollably.

All she could think of as she wrapped her blankets around herself was. 'I want my mom.'

Cyra was now in her third meeting of the day that seemed to drag on forever. The chefs were arguing about the quality of the fish the hunters were bringing in and nothing she said seemed to calm them. 'I just want this to be over.' Cyra also couldn't help but worry for her kit. Lewis, her new guard for the time being. Said she didn't eat dinner and Cyra has been more focused on that than anything.

Suddenly the arguing was stopped by a timid knock on the door. Someone then pointed their head through. "Lewis, is there something you need?" Lewis nodded. "If you don't mind I would like to talk with you about something important." Cyra excused herself and closed the door behind her. "What's wrong?"

"I heard princess Elizabeth crying and-" Cyra didn't bother to listen to the rest as she ran down the hall. All she needed to know was her baby was crying. She almost went too far past the door as she halted to a stop. She went to open the door but first tried to listen in.

It was barely audible but it was a choked sob. Cyra slowly and quietly opened the door. She only saw a curled-up mass shaking under the blankets only a small tail visible. Cyra crouched down and pulled up the covers a bit. "Elizabeth?"

Catra acknowledged her for the first time as she looked into her eyes and Cyra's heart broke. ", Oh sweetie. Come here." Catra clung to her mom as she held her tightly trying to stop her tears.

Catra was shaking as she tried to take deep breaths and silence her crying by biting her lip but Cyra just purred and held her tightly. "Can you tell me what's wrong?" Catra just shook her head into her shoulder refusing to face her. Cyra just curled her tail around her and tried to get Catra to relax.

"Don't you have a meeting?" Catra's voice came out more hurt than she wanted it to. "Don't worry about it. I do plan on leaving till I know you're okay." Catra then pulled herself away. "I'm okay." She then started harshly rubbing her face. Cyra grabbed her wrist. "Elizabeth what's wrong?"

Catra was trying to talk over the lump in her throat. "It's stupid and-and you'll get mad...then you won't want me anymore!" Cyra stared wide-eyed and grabbed Catra's face to make her look at her. "Elizabeth you could be the most ruthless leader of the Horde and I would want you every second." Catra looked up at her in shock. "Really?" Cyra just hugged her close. "Of course. I truly

wish you knew how much I and Azar love you." Catra just closed her eyes and nuzzled her mom.

"I missed you., Catra said it so quiet Cyra barely heard it. "What was that?" Catra then pulled herself back to look at her mom. "I said I missed you! I know you're busy but I didnt realize because momma or Leo is around, but-but they're not, and I *sniff* just miss my mom."

Cyra stared at her kit as she tried forcing her tears to stop. "Sweetie I-" then a harsh knock, more like banging, came from the door. Cyra looked to the door and back at her kit. "One second alright?" She then kissed Catra on the head and rushed over to the door. Once she closed it her caring mother was taken away as she looked to the hunter and chef. They both looked upset. Lewis spoke up "I tried to stop them but-" The chef spoke up first. "Your majesty this all could've been handled two days ago if he decided to show up!"

"Well unlike you we have a job to do that can't be pushed off!"

"Oh ye, s your job. Which is to bring safe and clean food back, yet from what I've seen you are shit at your job!"

"Look we have to meet a quota by the end of the month we don't have time to check every little thing!"

"Disease could break out and wipe us out you, idiot"

"Who the fuck are you talking to you-"

Cyra's voice turned cold. "Let me tell you how this will work. You two are going to agree on one going to be taken to ensure the quality of food is up to your standards yet also not so harsh that it adds more than two hours to the hunter's harvest."

"But your majesty-"

"If you both are too incompetent to do that then I will simply find people who aren't. Am I understood?" They both gulped and

nodded their heads. Cyra didnt relax till they were out of sight. She then turned to Lewis with a smile. "Cancel my meetings for today will you?" Lewis quickly nodded and started hurrying away.

Cyra took a deep breath and walked back into the room and saw Catra curled up alone. Cyra walked over and picked Catra up. "Are you leaving again?" Cyra shook her head. "No, I have all day." Catra looked up to her mom in shock. "But I thought-"

"Let me worry about dumb adult stuff. Now come on let's go see if momma's letters arrived."
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Adora's POV
"This is the best spot to prank people!" Catra was excitedly walking me through the town. I was happy to see her so excited but I felt awkward at all the people staring. Whether it be because I'm not a Magicat or because Catra is the princess I have no idea. We then kept walking and I looked up and saw the runestone.

I then audibly gasped. "Can you use the runestone?!" Catra looked back at me. "I mean I should in theory but I'm pretty sure." I looked at her confused. "Really? I thought you'd already be bonded with it by now." From what Glimmer said she bonded with the runestone right after she was born.

Catra must've noticed my confusion. "Things in Halfmoon are a bit different than all the other kingdoms. Technically we've been around the longest so we have a lot of traditions. One of them is the bonding ceremony that happens when the princess is eighteen. Though there are some special cases where that can change."

I nodded. "So are you bonding with the runestone?" Catra sighed. "No. I mean I will eventually but... I kinda have a lot going on at the moment and adding uncontrollable powers in the mix is not a good idea." That makes sense. "So Catra about that thing I wanted to tell you-"
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"Lizzy!"

"Oh come on!"

Chapter End Notes

If it makes you guys feel better I'm also annoyed at myself for my cliffhangers

Communication is key

Chapter Notes

> Welcome back! I was supposed to get farther in this chapter but I've been busy so sorry in advance for the abrupt ending!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora looked over and saw Vivianne as Catra rolled her eyes. "Vivianne, what do you need?" Catra faced her with her arms crossed. Adora looked shocked. This is the first time she's seen Catra upset since she reunited with her.

Vivianne didnt notice or if she did she didnt care. "I heard you were with the... new guest and wanted to check on you." Catra grabbed Adora. "Her name is Adora. And I'm fine. So if you'll excuse us." Vivianne then stepped in front of Catra. "Lizzy I'm not comfortable with you walking around alone with some stranger. Just allow me to keep an eye on you. " Adora visibly flinched.

"Well, I'm not comfortable with you following me around! And Adora is an old friend as well as a guest of princesses Glimmer of Brightmoon. So I suggest you treat her as such considering its part of your job." Catra then grabbed Adora and hastily walked away.

"Stars she needs to take a hint." Adora just stared in awe. She decided to ignore the feeling of pride in her chest as well as a...weird feeling she couldn't describe.

"What was that about?" Catra was about to answer but stopped when she looked around and noticed a bit too many guards for it to be a coincidence. Uggg. Mom." Adora looked confused. "Huh?" Catra then looked back and smirked at Adora. "Get ready to run."

"Wait what?!" Catra grabbed Adora's hand and ran down a nearby ally way and cut through an abandoned building. "Where are we going!" Catra just laughed. "You'll see." Catra then jumped over a building. "Catra?" She then turned around and offered her hand. "Shh! Come on." She pulled Adora up and when Adora got her feet down Catra dragged her down. "Ow. What the-"

"Shh!" Catra then made Adora look towards the center square where they both saw two guards not so subtlety looking for certain Magicat. Catra chuckled with Adora. Catra then got up and slid down the side of the building. Adora followed though not so gracefully. Catra was laughing without a care in the world. Adora stared at her. 'She looks so happy.' Catra then grabbed her hand again. "Come on there's somewhere I want to show you."

Catra then went to a nearby crate that she opened and pulled out two cloaks. She then threw one to Adora. She caught it clumsily then laughed. "What's all this?" Catra smirked as she put the cloak over her ears. "Let's just say this isn't my first time." Adora put on her cloak and followed Catra. They kept close to the shadows and made their way to a tunnel on the outskirts of the town. Catra then pulled Adora through.

"This is where I come to hide. I wanted to find a place my moms couldn't find me. I found a book in the library saying there's a bunch of hidden passage ways down here. And I found this one." Adora stared in awe as she saw it. A wide circular room with a pathway from the doorway to the center of the room above the water surrounding it. Light orbs floating above and glowing mushrooms.

"This is amazing!" Catra stared longingly at Adora as she looked around. Catra then walked towards the center of the room and looked back to Adora. "Hey how about we spar? For old times sake?" Adora smiled and ran towards the center.
"You're on!"

Adora took off her jacket and started stretching.
Catra kept her eyes on her the whole time. 'Wow.' Adora's voice

made her snap out of her daze. "Now just because it's been a while doesnt mean I will go easy on you so dont be embarrassed when-"

Catra sweep her feet down and caused Adora to fall flat on her ass. Adora groaned as she rubbed her tail bone. Catra was up with her arms crossed and a smirk on her face. "You were saying?" Adora laughed. "Cheap shot!" Catra giggled as she got into her stance.

The pair circled each other both waiting to see who strikes first. Of course Adora lost her patience as she went in first. Catra smirked as she dodged. Adora was a pure soilder. All of her moves are calculated and left almost no openings. But Catra wasn't sticking to the Horde lessons Adora knew.

Catra always used her agility to her advantage but this was different. Instead of just avoiding attacks she used her enemy's brawn against them. Adora had a hard time keeping up.

Then Catra gave her an opening when she went to dodge Adora did a fake out and got a grip on her waist. Catra noticed and tried to squirm her way out by gripping her shoulders but Adora grabbed her wrist and pinned her down with he legs on either side of Catra.

Usually Catra would be hissing and kicking trying to get out but she was just laughing without a care in the world. Adora stopped and stared at the woman underneath her. Catra calmed her laughter and looked up to Adora. Once they both made eye contact everything stopped.

Catra's heart beat fast as Adora stared. They both panted as they tried to catch their breath. Adora didnt realize but she used this time to look at Catra. She noticed things that changed, like how her cheeks were sharper instead of round like in her childhood and her fur looked shinier then she remembered. Though her eyes still had the mischievous glint to them and her nose still looked boop-able.

Meanwhile Catra was panicking. She didnt even try to notice all the new things about Adora because all that went through her mind was, 'pretty girl on top of me.' Though Catra did notice things about Adora mainly how her biceps were flexing from holding Catra's wrist and how her thighs felt around her waist, not to mention that intense look on her face.

Eventually, neither could say how long Catra's ears hears a toll of the clock tower. Suddenly Catra snapped out of her trance. "Shit we're late!" Catra sat up too quickly and bumped heads with Adora. "Ow!" Catra winced as she gripped her head. Adora went to apologize but Catra just raised her hand. "Nope that was my bad! Fuck that hurt."

Adora went to check on it but Catra just stood up and grabbed her. "Come on! Sparkles will have my head!" Despite what Catra said she had a smile on her face and Adora did as well as Catra pulled them through the town as the lights begun to dim and the people retired to their houses.

Catra walked up to the palace with her arm linked through Adora's and waved to the guards. "Hi Rin! Hi Lex!" The guards eyes widened as the princess referred to them by name but they smiled. "Welcome back Princess." They said as they bowed. Catra walked through the doors and pulled Adora quickly down the hall. Adora suddenly stopped. Catra looked back to her.

"Hey everything okay?" Adora bit her lip. "Yeah its just... I think the whole you being a princess is catching up to me and... you have parents! Like good parents!" Catra smiled and walked closer to Adora. "Yeah. Yeah I do. They're the best." Adora looked and saw Catra with that soft smile on her face and felt her knees go weak.

"Adora I know you have this weird obligation in you're mind that everyone has to love you but trust me my moms already think very highly of you. So there's not much you can do to make them dislike you." Adora looked at her wide eyed. "Really?" Catra nodded. "Duh, you saved my life and because of you they were

able to find their lost child! Kinda hard to not like you." Adora flushed at her words then smiled. "Thanks Catra. I needed that."

Catra smiled. "Yeah yeah dont get all sappy." She then grabbed Adora's hand. "Now come on! We're late enough as it is." Adora and Catra laughed as the doors to the dining room opened.

All eyes were on them as they entered the room. Glimmer was the first to speak up. "Wow only thirty minutes late I'll be honest I expected worse." Bow sighed. "Glimmer." Catra shrugged. "We lost track of time is all. I'm sure you can ask the guards that were tracking us." Catra pointed that statement to Cyra who grinned sheepishly.

"Anyways! You're lucky Azar isnt here yet or else you would have no one to shift the focus on." Catra just grinned. Adora just stared dumbfounded at the queen. On a quick glance you could easily say Catra and her dont look alike but after knowing and really looking at the queen shes surprised she didnt see it before. Besides the obvious eye color her and Catra's faces are practically identical. Not to mention the similar hair tuffs.

Adora didnt get long to stare like an idiot because Catra brought her to sit down. Luckily Adora was surrounded by people she knew with Catra on her right Glimmer on her left with Bow next to her. Catra sat to the left of her mom and the chair to her right remained empty.

"So Adora what do you think of Halfmoon?" Adora turned to the queen and tried her best not to make a fool of herself. "Oh its great! Catra showed me around a bit and its beautiful." Cyra then looked to Catra.

Catra then rolled her eyes. "Yes she knows." Cyra smiled. "Wonderful! Anyway, Adora I did want to talk about-" suddenly everyone heard a crash and harsh whispers. Cyra sighed as she stood up. "If you'll excuse me a momment." Cyra then dissapeared behind the closed door.

"Uh what was that about?" Catra just slouched in her chair. "Don't worry about it." Bow then stepped in. "So what are the chances you guys found each other? There has to be some divine intervention." Glimmer laughs as she takes a sip of her water. "More like dumb luck."

"I dont know Glimmer I mean what are the chances they both are-" Cyra then came into the room dragging Azar by the ear. "Honestly can you not go one day without torturing poor Leo?" Azar just gave a half hearted laugh.

Adora saw Azar and saw the resemblance right away. If it wasnt for the short hair, lack of ear tuffs, eye color and the fact the queen was missing the bottom half of her right arm they would look practically identical. Azar then made eye contact with Adora. "Wow she wasnt exaggerating about the forehead." Glimmer spat out her water.

"Azar!"

"I'm kidding!"

Adora looked over to Catra who was actively not looking at her and was taking deep breaths to keep her not so hidden laugh in. "Why do I feel like you payed her to say that?" Adora then rubbed at her head. Which is probably more swollen from Catra's headbutt earlier. 'Well now theres no doubt. That's Catra's mom.' Adora then saw Azar ruffle Catra's hair as she went to her seat. Azar then started talking to Cyra in a hushed voice.

"I'm giving it five months." Cyra then raised a brow as she answered back. "I don't know seems a bit too oblivious. I say a good year." Before Adora could try to decipher what they were saying Catra spoke. "You'll love the food! Halfmoon has the best meat ever, though I reccomend Brightmoon for desserts." Just like that Adora forgot about the awkward conversations and fell into conversation with Catra about all the different foods they've tried since leaving the Horde.

Cyra looked fondly at the pair and Azar nudged her slightly. "You're staring." Cyra huffed. "Well sorry I want to see my daughter happy." Azar flicked her with her tail. "Brat." Cyra laughed.

"Yeah me, Bow and Glimmer are actually trying to rebuild the princess alliance!" The room went quiet but Catra didn't sense the tension as she excitedly talked with Adora. "Really? How on Etheria did you manage that?" Adora felt awkward as she noticed eyes on her and Glimmer was definitely giving her the 'shut up' look. But when she looked to Catra she couldnt resist that face.

"Oh well, you know...negotiations and stuff... though if I'm honest every princess we got to join we had to fight something, so saving them was a big factor." Catra had her eyes on Adora the whole time. "Tell me everything!" Adora told of how she and the best friend squad got all the princess.

While Catra was listening intently about how Adora fought the Horde and against killer bots Cyra just sat anxiously in her chair. Azar noticed and whispered to her. "Hey you alright?"

When Glimmer started explaining how funny Adora was when she first saw a horse Cyra stepped in. "Well, it certainly sounds like you have had quite the journey. A very dangerous journey." Cyra pointed that last part to Catra. She just huffed and sat back in her seat. Adora leaned over to Glimmer. "What was that about?"

"I'll tell you later." Adora stopped mid sentence when she smelled something delicious. Catra laughed as she saw Adora perk up at the smell. Adora flushed a bit at how obvious she was. As food was placed down Cyra tried to change the subject away from violence. "So Adora how did you meet Glimmer?" Adora was busy eyeing the food in front of her so Glimmer spoke for her. "We met in Thaymore, during the Horde attack." Azar suddenly looked more interested.

"You didn't see anything strange there did you?" Glimmer tilted her head. "Uh, not really. Except the Horde." Azar didn't voice her

suspicions as she saw Catra offering all the best food to Adora.

"Anyway was Entrapta okay?"

"Oh yeah shes fine though I worry she might break something someday if shes not careful."

"From what I've heard she already has."

Catra and Adora continued their conversation as if everyone else wasnt there. Cyra watched carefully with a smile on her face. Was she obviously staring yes but Azar didn't want to break her out of the trance. Glimmer then stood up from her chair.

"Speaking of the alliance. We've been thinking what if... you know, Halfmoon joined?" Glimmer was cringing as she waited for an answer while Adora just leaped at the opportunity. "Yeah! Catra could come with us to Brightmoon!"

"Wait-" Cyra's objection was interrupted by Catra. "Really?"

"Elizabeth I dont think-" Adora spoke up again as if oblivious to the queen. "Well yeah I already know you're a great fighter and if you bond with your runestone we'll have a whole new elemental princess! Not to mention Halfmoon is one of the biggest kingdoms around."

"Well-"

Catra was now perked up. "No way! I wanna see Angella again. And I can go to that sweets place." Adora just nodded. "You have to meet Mermista you'll love her."

"Now just hang on-"

"Oh we can go on adventures with Bow and Glimmer! Like when we fought that sea monster!"

"You fought a sea monster?!"

"Enough!" The room went silent as Cyra slammed her hands on the table. Once she saw she got everyone's attention she stood up straight. "I'm sorry but we are rejecting Brightmoons alliance as well as your invitation for the princess alliance. Halfmoon has made the mistake of being too trusting and getting involved in situations we have no part of. The Horde is a serious threat that we have no reason to engage. End of discussion." Catra went to speak but Cyra beat her to it. "I said end of discussion." Catra just slouched down in her seat with her arms crossed and Glimmer sat back down.

Cyra then took a breath and sat down. "Now, Adora how are you adjusting to Brightmoon?" Adora sensed the awkward tension but when she looked to Catra she just waved her hand. "Oh, it's great. Very... bright."

Discussion continued through dinner but the tension never fully left and it was obvious Catra was still upset. She gotten so carried away with what Adora was telling her she completely forgot about her current situation. Adora tried to check on Catra anytime the conversation didnt involve her but Catra didnt seem in the mood to talk.

Dinner luckily ended on a good note when Azar told a story about Glimmers dad when he was younger and Glimmer loved hearing about him. As maids came out to begin picking up the plates Azar walked over to Catra and gripped her shoulder. "Hey Liz could I borrow you for a while?" Catra then looked over to Adora who just waved her off. "Dont worry about me I'll see you later."

"I'll meet up with you when I'm done."

Adora nodded. Catra smiled as she followed Azar out. Adora hadn't realized it but she ended up being the last person in the dining room. She went out the door to find Glimmer but queen Cyra was there instead. "Adora, I was just about to ask if you'd join me for a walk. I'd love to talk with you."

Adora felt her hands start fidgeting out of nervousness. "Oh of course." Cyra smiled as she led the way with Adora keeping pace. 'Its just a walk no big deal. This is just the mom of your best friend who can control if I ever see Catra again. No big deal!' Cyra seemed to notice Adora's heightened nerves.

"I would just like to say thank you." Adora snapped out of her head and looked to the queen. "What for?" Cyra chuckled. "For taking care of Elizabeth when I was unable to." Adora flushed at the compliment. "Oh well it's not a big deal. I'm sure anybody would have if I didnt."

"You're too humble." Adora just chuckled as she continued following Cyra down the hallway. "You know she missed you a lot. Even tried to go back." Adora looked surprised. "Really? Why?"

"She felt as if she abandoned you. She didnt want you to be in danger." Adora just smiled. "Sounds like her." Cyra sighed. "Yeah it would've been cute had she not been nine years old."

"Nine?!"

"The second she realised she was safe she wanted to go back for you." Adora frowned. "Sorry if it caused any trouble." Cyra placed a hand on her shoulder. "Adora I would be more worried if Elizabeth was okay with leaving you behind. From what she told me there was a very good chance that if she stayed she might've been... not around anymore. Me and Azar owe you everything."

Adora felt awkward from hearing that. "Please dont worry about it. Like I said anyone would have done it in my place."

"Yet you were the only one who did." Adora's eyes widened. She never thought of it like that before. Cyra sensing her being uncomfortable decided to change the subject to something more light hearted. "So if you want I have some cute photos of Elizabeth if you'd like to see them." Adora's mood instantly shifted. "I would love to!"

"I got some to start you off but I cant promise the reliability of each account." Azar had just dropped a pile of records onto Catra's table she used in the library from the battle against the first ones.

Catra has been curious. Insert dumb cat joke. About the whole 'weapon' thing but since nothing has been proven about it all the history books dont speak of it. So Azar went and found the records of old statements from people who claimed to be at the battle.

"Thanks." As much as Catra didnt want to leave Adora she has been trying to find if there was any truth to what Azar said about the weapon. Catra decided to just cycle through everything and once she has a good starting place head back to Adora. Hopefully shes with Glimmer and not her mom.

"So what's got you so interested in this first ones crap?" Azar said as she sat on the table. Catra just shrugged. "It sounded cool. Not to mention Entrapta kinda got me interested." Azar sighed. "Wow good job of not getting involved with first ones." Catra just rolled her eyes at her moma.

Azar then took a seat next to Catra. That same momment Catra sighed and stood up. "I think that's all I'm doing for today." Azars ear were now by her head. "Oh well, I actually wanted to teach you a new spell if you're not busy." Catra didnt acknowledge her as she began to put the books she wasnt using up. "I would but I told Adora I would meet up with her." Azar frowned and looked to Catra struggling to reach the shelf to put the book back.

Azar took the books from Catra placing the one back on the shelf. "Dont worry about putting them back. I was the one who got them. Besides you gotta see Adora right?" Catra smiled. "Thanks moma." She went to leave but Azar grabbed her and gave her sloppy kiss to her head. "Ew!" Catra tried squirming out Of her grip. "Dont deny my love!"

"Moma Seriously I have to go!" Azar had a sad smile on her face as she let Catra out of her grip. "Yeah I know. Have fun." Catra nodded as she rushed out of the room leaving Azar behind. "Love you!" Azar then spoke to the empty room with her ears down turned and a sad smile. "Love you too"

Adora's POV
"Oh my gosh look at her ears!" I was currently sitting next to Cyra on a couch looking at old photos of Catra. Cyra chuckled. "Cute isnt she?" I nodded my head as I looked at the photo of Catra, around twelve years old curled up in a pile of blankets.

I couldn't tell how long I've been looking at pictures of Catra. I thought it would make me upset seeing peices of her life I wasnt a part of but it did the opposite. It was obvious Catra grew up in a loving family and was given the life she deserves.

"Its crazy she wouldnt remeber any of this." I said referring to the pictures of Catra around three years old. Cyra's face dropped. Oh no did I say something wrong? Damn it Adora! Cyra must've saw my panic because she smiled again. "Oh I'm sorry I thought you knew." I tilted my head at her. Cyra sighed. "When we found her she didnt remember us at all. I thought maybe she would remeber eventually but Azar found out she had a memory wipe spell on her."

Adora frowned. "Is there anything you could do?"
Cyra shook her head. "The spell has a type of fail safe. We could give her memories back but in exchange she wouldn't remeber anything from after the invasion. We never told her because we felt it was unfair to make her decide. Besides I doubt she would want to forget you." I flushed a bit at the way Cyra looked to me. I then coughed to regain my composer.

"That actually makes sense." Cyra then looked at me confused. "What do you mean?"
"Well when I first met Catra she was in a box and when I asked for her name she said she didnt know... then she said the lady?

Did something." Cyra had a sad look on her face then went tense. "Do you know who 'lady' is?"

"You're majesty?" I look up and see a guard at the door. "Yes? What's wrong?" Cyra always seemed on edge. Then again who am I to judge. "Grell is here to discuss..." the guard made eye contact with me and went quiet. I assume the discussion was about me.

Cyra relaxed a bit and put the photo album on the table. "Right I'm on my way." The guard bowed and left. "Well duty calls! Elizabeth will most likely be in the library around this time." I nodded my head in appreciation. Though I have no idea where that is.

"Down the hall take a right the big door at the end of the hall."

"Thanks."

Cyra smiled and left with the guard not too far behind. I took a deep breath. Despite how kind she was the way Cyra flipped during dinner made me go back to being intimidated by her. But the way she talks about Catra shows me how nice she is. I sighed as I left the room and began down the hall till a voice called out to me.

"Where are you going?" I turned around and saw Vivianne. "Oh I'm just meeting Catra in the library." I didn't like how judgmental her question was. "She doesn't like people bothering her while shes in the library." She talked as if I was a child. "She told me to go meet her." I dont know why she was suddenly acting so hostile to me. She then rolled her eyes. "Well she probably won't keep you around for long."

"What's that supposed to mean?"

"It means you're a constant reminder of the Horde. A place that treated her like shit. And you have the audacity to act as if she wants to be friends with you again."

"Catra said-"

"Dont call her that! You dont even respect her title! Did you ever ask her if she wanted to be friends with you? Maybe you should get your head out of your ass."

I wanted to yell at her. Of course I respect Catra- Elizabeth. And I assumed she wanted to be friends. She said she missed me. Maybe she only said that because I said it first.

Do I really just remind her of the Horde?

Vivianne seemed to understand I wasnt listening anymore and bumped my shoulder as she left. I didnt even react. "You should just leave." Should I even go to meet Catra? Does she want to see me? Shit I even called her the wrong name! Am I even allowed to call her by Catra anymore? Is that fair?

"Adora!"

I look up and see just who I was thinking about.
"What's wrong?" I don't even know what to say to her. "Nothing I was just about to go see you." She laughed. "Could you imagine if we both missed each other on the way?" I didnt even listen to anything after that as used all my courage. "Are we friends?"

Catra stared dumbly at me. "Of course we are... do you not want to be?" I quickly scrambled for an answer. "Of course not! I mean yes... no I mean- uhg!" I took a deep breath to collect my thoughts. "Of course I want to be your friend. I just didnt know if maybe after all this time... having me around would be... weird?"

"Why would it be weird?" Vivianne's words were on repeat through my mind. 'You're a constant reminder of the Horde.'

"You know what let's forget about it!"

Chapter End Notes

Azar is starting to feel left out... as always leave comments they really brighten up my day!!

Things arent always what they seem

Chapter Notes

> Welcome back! Just celebrated my birthday so I got a new wave of motivation! Enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

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"Fuck shit fuck!" Azar ran through the Halfmoon halls on all fours. Trying to make it to her room as fast as possible. 'Cy is gonna kill me!' Once she turned the corner she saw a maid and a guard talking. 'Shit.'

Azar then hurriedly walked up to them completely disregarding their previous conversation. "Is she alright!? Did I miss it?" The maid frowned a bit. "She's in the room now. Congratulations." Azar wanted to feel excited but all she thought was how angry Cyra was going to be with her. Not to mention the fact she missed the birth of her kid.

She nodded and gently opened the door and closed it behind her she saw Cyra's ears twitch at the sound of the door and looked over. "Look who finally showed up." It was meant to sound sarcastic but Cyra was so worn out it came out soft.

Azar sat quietly next to the bed. "Sorry I came as soon as I heard."

"If only there was someone who warned you about leaving so close to the due date." Azar rolled her eyes. "Yeah yeah I know. I'm sorry I thought I had a good two weeks. I blame the kit for coming too early." Cyra laughed. "You can't blame her."
Azar's ears perked up. "It's a girl?" Cyra nodded. Azar looked down and saw the bundle curled into her wife's chest. Cyra noticed and gently readjusted so Azar could see her. Azar audibly
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inhaled as she saw the kit. 'She's so tiny.' Her eyes were still closed and Azar felt her heart clench as the kit's nose twitched.

Azar saw the kit reaching out and she placed her finger in the tiny palm and the kit clenched it brought it to her mouth and started gnawing on it. Azar laughed. "Gross." Cyra looked up to her wife. "Oh, my stars are you crying?"

"Shut up!" Cyra laughed as she laid her head down. "Wanna hold her?" Azar visibly tensed. "U, h no thanks. I'm good." Cyra rolled her eyes. "Funny how you think it was a question. Come on my arms hurt." Azar pulled her hand back and backed away as Cyra tried to hand the kit over. uh-uh. I love you but I don't trust myself."

Cyra then put the kit by the edge of the bed. "Azar quick I'm losing my grip! Imagine what your father would say if she found out you allowed your only fall to her doom." Azar knew Cyra would never actually drop her but her arms were shaking from holding the kit up. Azar flushed. "Fine but you have to help me I don't know what I'm doing." Cyra smiled as Azar took a seat next to her on the bed. "Alright just make sure to support her head and cradle her body with your arm."

Azar did as instructed and took the kit in her arms. Cyra relaxed against the mattress and turned over to see her child being held. Azar was crying. "She's so tiny."

"Didn't feel tiny when coming out of me." The couple laughed and Azar nuzzled her face into the kit. "Already causing trouble?" Cyra barely let out a laugh as her eyes began to grow heavy. "Her name is Elizabeth." Azar smiled. "How did I know you would pick that name." Cyra smiled. "Because it's the least I owe her. I promised I'd name my kit after her. She was so bashful. Saying she was just a maid and I should name them after my 'real' family."

Azar rolled her eyes. "No offense but your parents were assholes." Cyra just nodded. "You can rest. I'll watch her." Azar leaned in and

kissed her wife on the head. "Okay... you're still in trouble." Azar laughed as Cyra yawned. "Yeah, I know."

Cyra was then out like a light. Her exhaustion is obvious. Azar looked at the kit in her arms and smiled. "Hi, Elizabeth. Sorry I missed your birth I got caught up. I'll be better now though. Promise." Azar finally got a good look at Elizabeth and smiled as she realized she had the same hair and fur color as Azar. "I hope for me and Cy's sake you get her patience."

The kit then started trilling and wiggling in Azar's arms. "Careful there!" The kit laughed at her mother's obvious distress. "Brat." She kissed the kit on the head causing her to giggle. Azar then looked over to her wife as if to confirm she was sleeping back to the kit. "Let's see what you're hiding." She then closed her eyes and placed her pointer finger on the kit's head.

Every teacher in Mystacore is required to know how to perform this spell to decide which students have more magic potential than others. Some sorcerers who didn't even have to use the spell would just know by looking. Azar was not one of those sorcerers.

Azar smiled as she removed her finger and opened her eyes. "You're gonna be so badass." 'And that magic doesn't include the magic she'll gain from the Amber.' Azar then looked at the kit and saw them begin to open their eyes. Azar wanted to wake Cyra up for her to see but she doubt she'd wake. Besides Azar assumed the royal blue eyes would be there.

Imagine her surprise when heterochromatic eyes stared back at her. Before even considering leaving her be Azar started to shake Cyra awake. "Cy! Wake up!" Cyra groaned. "Azar I have no objections to killing you as of right now."

"She opened her eyes!" Cyra was now more awake as she looked over she blinked a few times to adjust her vision. Then saw the kit smile as she stares back at her. "My stars. She has your eyes!"

Azar chuckled. "Halfway yeah." Cyra then reached out for the kit and Azar handed her over. The kit reached up and started pulling at the braids by Cyra's ears. "You're lucky you're cute." She said as she gently moved her hands away from her ears. There was a peaceful silence with the noises of Elizabeth just making random sounds as she kneaded into her mother. Cyra was already crying again. "Oh, my Stars are you crying?" Cyra nudged Azar. "Shut up I'm emotional."

Azar tried to remain silent but her excitement got the best of her."She has amazing magic potential." Cyra sighed. "Azar you said you wouldn't check."

"Technically I said I wouldn't check throughout her life." Azar meant for it to be light-hearted but Cyra was upset. Azar frowned. "Sorry I didn't know it would be a big deal." Cyra shook her head. "It's not it's just... what if you checked and she didnt has any." Azar scoffed. "She's the product of the best sorceress and a queen. I had no doubt."

"But what if she didnt? Then what?" Azar looked confused. "I don't know what you mean."

"Would you have been disappointed?"

"Of course not! I swear." Cyra looked to Azar and sighed. "You're on thin ice I hope you know that." Azar laughed.

"Is there any chance what happened with Micha will happen with Elizabeth?" Azar's breath catches. "I- I don't know." Cyra just clutched the kit tighter. Meanwhile, the kit was playing with the hem of Cyra's shirt. "Is there anything we can do?" Azar looked to her wife. "I have one idea but it's not foolproof." Cyra raised a brow at her wife. Azar then drew a rune in her hand and put it to the kit's head. Elizabeth didn't even flinch just tried reaching for the light and started giggling.

As Azar released a breath the light faded into the kit. "What was that?" Azar took the kit back into her arms as she reached for

Azar. "It cloaks her magic potential. But if someone knows about the spell it can be removed. It's the best option I have."

"You could take it away altogether." Azar's eyes left Elizabeth. "You can't be serious!"

"You already said you wouldn't mind if she had no magic."

"Being born without magic and your magic being taken away are two very different things!"

Cyra sighed. "It was just a suggestion." Cyra then turned her body away from Azar. Her ears went down. She hated when Cyra ignored her. Azar looked down and saw Elizabeth playing with her hand as if trying to get the light to come back. Azar smirked.

Cyra felt a tap on her shoulder and turned to see Azar holding up Elizabeth by her armpits hiding behind her. "I love you. And you shouldn't be mad at momma." The kit laughed as Azar talked in a baby voice. Cyra chuckled and took the kit after sitting up.

"That's not fair." Azar pecked Cyra's lips. "Haven't you heard? All's fair in love and war."
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Catra's POV
Something is up with Adora. She is being...hesitant and unlike before she asks if every little thing Is okay. 'Are you sure?' 'I can go ask Glimmer to show me around if you don't want to.' 'I do have to see your room if you're not okay with it.'

Which led us to where we are now. Me sitting on my bed while Adora awkwardly stands. I finally just sigh and look at her unable to ignore this tension. "Oka at is wrong?" Adora jerked up. "What do you mean?" I just rolled my eyes as a saw her begin to fidget with her fingers. She'se'sying.

"Adora." I stared at her and she refused to look me in the eye. She seems upset over something. "Adora just talk to me-"
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"Oh, you know what? I haven't told you how I got out of the Horde! It's a cool story!"

Way to change the subject. "Wait-"

"So I was back at our spot above the Fright zone, and I saw this big bright light and I was like 'I should go check that out.' I also remembered I promised once I got promoted I would try going to meet up with you."

"Okay cool but that doesn't explain why you've been-"

"So when I went there I found a sword and then it disappeared. But when I went back to the Fright zone I kept hearing voices so I went back and then I met Glimmer and Bow."

"I'll be honest you sound crazy-"

"Anyway then we got attacked by a bug and then I used the sword and- st show you that'll be easier." She then took the bracelet wrist and it turned into a sword. How the hell? I instantly recognized that writing and that bright blue from Entrapta's rambling. "Adora wait!"

"For the honor of Greyskull!"

A bright flash of light came and I backed away and fell off my bed. "Fuck!" I closed my eyes until the bright light disappeared. "Adora what the hell!" I blinked a few times to adjust only to see...not Adora.

"Are you okay? Sorry, I forgot about the whole blinding light thing." Okay so that's Adora just really... different. Before I could even say a word there was a knock on my door. "Lizzy?" Shit! I jumped up and pushed...Adora? "Hold on!" I then pushed Adora onto my balcony. Closing the doors and made curtains shut as Vivianne walks into my room. "Hey! What's up?" I stood in front of my window.

Vivianne looked suspiciously around the room. "I heard something fall and I wanted to make sure you were okay." I nodded quickly. "Yep! Just...peachy." oh that sounded wrong coming out of my mouth. Vivianne, also noticed me standing in front of the window like I would die if I parted from it.

"Peachy?" I nodded again. "Yep!" I then saw Vivianne glance up. Shit! Before she could say anything I rushed forward. I'm so gonna regret this. "Hey about that dance." That caught her attention. Her eyes were back on me and she seemed to notice our proximity and her face went red. "Oh- I... what?" Stars this is sad. Is this all it takes nowadays?

"Well, I recall you telling me to save you a dance and I was just curious that was a promise?" I twisted a strand of her hair around my finger. "Um... ye- yes! Of course. I would-" suddenly there was a bang from the balcony. Shit, Adora! Vivianne was back to being alert. "What was that?"

"A bird probably!"

Vivianne then started to put her hand by her sword. I just inwardly groaned. If Adora makes out of this alive I'm killing her. I grabbed Vivianne's shoulders and turned her around so her back was to the balcony. "He, y I'm an absolute shit dancer. Why don't we meet sometime tomorrow and you can teach me?" Vivianne wasn't paying much attention to me looking back to the window.

Damn it! I grabbed her face with my hands and brought her head down to be eye level with me. "Just us. No distractions. Just... two hours of us hanging out." I bit my lip waiting for her response as she looked dazed. I then saw her physically gulp. "Uh, yeah that sounds..." she then seemed to snap out of her shocked state and put her hands on my hips. Touchy much? "That sounds great."

I quickly pulled her as far away from the window as I could. "Great! So I was just about to change for bed so if you don't

mind." I then opened the door for her and she visibly flushed. "Oh, shit! I'm so sorry I didnt mean-"

"Don't worry about it I'll see you tomorrow, okay? Kay great bye!" I then slammed the door shut behind me. I just fucked myself over. I push my hair back and stomp over to the balcony and pulled open the door. Imagine my surprise when I saw Adora back to normal. "You could've changed back!" Adora scratched the back of her head. "I tried to explain but I have already shoved out a window." I felt my eye twitch. "You- Ugg!"
Okay, so Adora can change into a giant sword-swinging lady. I can believe this

I'm so gonna kill her.

Adora's POV
I thought worst-case scenario Catra would be upset about She-ra but never did I imagine she'd throw me out. I felt She-ra flicker but I just let out a breath as I let her go returning to normal Adora. I then heard talking. I crouched down and looked through what I could but couldn't see anything I then stood up and tried looking seeing the top of Catra's head and... Vivianne. I couldn't hear what they were talking about. Suddenly I saw Catra walk up to Vivianne and I crouched down when I noticed Vivianne glancing at the window.

I carefully got back up and noticed how close they were... and Catra was playing with Vivianne's hair. I was so focused that I lost my balance from standing on my tiptoes and my head hit the window. What is with today and hitting my head?! I sat down for a second clutching my head. I'll have a whole black and blue forehead by the end of this!

I crept back up and I had to clasp a hand over my mouth to avoid making a sound. I saw Catra... kissing Vivianne?! I flushed and turned my back to the window. I expected myself to feel embarrassed but all my mind was thinking about was Catra was with Vivianne.

It made sense why Vivianne seemed so protective of her. She probably didn't like how close I was with her... girlfriend. My stomach turned at the thought.

'I could so beat her up.'

'Does she even know Catra's favorite number?'

'Favorite color?'

'That little spot at the base of her ears?'

'Can she turn into an 8ft tall warrior?'

I snap out of my thoughts as I hear Catra unlock the balcony door.

Catra's POV
I took a deep breath and pulled Adora back into the room. "Okay. Please explain what the hell that was. Not show!"

"Uh, sword turns me into a warrior named She-ra." Well, that was informative! Of course. I rubbed my eyes feeling them grow heavy. It's too late at night for this. "Alright I'll be honest with you my brain isn't processing anything right now. And if I continue this conversation I can't promise I won't kill you. We'll talk about this in the morning. AND why you've been acting weird. For now, though do NOT transform around anyone!" I looked at the sword clutched in her hand. "And put that away! Weapons are strictly forbidden unless documented. And I doubt you have that." Adora nodded and turned the sword back into her bracelet.

I finally calmed down and sat on the floor with my back leaning on my bed. Adora stood awkwardly and I patted the spot next to me. She sat down and was stiff. I decided a change in topics might help us both. "I know you're probably not tired...the whole nocturnal shit." Adora laughed but it was obvious she had something on her mind. "Did my mom say something weird?" She looked shocked. "No, nothing. I was just... thinking."

"You sure? After dinner, you completely changed how you act. I thought we were... reconnecting but now you seem like you want nothing to do with me."

"I've already told you, I'm glad we're still able to be friends. I'm glad you're okay it's just... I kind of just showed up and made assumptions about you and meme just don't want to say something wrong." I sighed and scooted closer to Adora and spoke in a hushed voice. "Ask me anything you want to know."

Adora looked down as if to gauge if I was kidding or not. Before she could say something stupid I interrupted. "We'll take turns. I'll go first. What do you think of Angella?" Adora blinked a few times and finally answered. "She's nice. Though I ran into her one night and swore she was gonna kill me." I laughed. "Sounds accurate. Okay, you turn." Adora didnt even hesitate.

"How long have you known Vivianne." She spoke Vivianne's name like venom. "Around eleven years? I don't pay much attention." Adora looked as if she would ask more but I decided to change the subject. "What do you think of Entrapta?"

"What's with you and knowing how I think of people?" I shrugged, "Just curious." Adora then told me more about the killer bots and that she forgot about half the battle. We both kind of forgot about the game for a while as we just talked then she brought up the alliance.

"Why do you're moms keep you here?" I ing she wouldn't ask that. "It's mainly my mom. She lost her first kid a few weeks after birth due to sickness. Then she had me and I got taken by the Horde. When I was at Brightmoon I found out Shadow weaver sent out someone to hunt me down. My mom got paranoid and so I'm not allowed to leave till she seems it 'safe'" I did air quotes. "When will that be?"

"When the Horde is gone."

I saw Adora frown. "Oh." I nodded and leaned my head on her shoulder. Wow now I know I'm losing it. "How's Kyle." Adora seemed content to change the subject as she joked about kyle.

Eventually, the room was filled with just Adora's quiet voice and Catra's breathing. "But I hope I see Seahawk again he's fun to be around." Catra just gave a hum in approval. Adora hadn't realized she was playing with Catra's hands as she used to Put slight pressure on her fingertips making her claws unsheathed.

Eventually, the silence allowed Adora to get lost in her head and she begins thinking back on what she saw. Vivianne holding Catra and Catra caressing her face.

"What's your relationship with Vivianne?" Adora rushed the question out and clenched her eyes shut waiting for a response.

It never came.

Adora opened her eyes and looked to see Catra passed out slightly snoring. Adora let out a breath. 'It's none of my business anyway.' Adora looked back to Catra and felt a wave of nostalgia of when they would both sneak away and just lay with one another. Catra then shook a bit and curled into Adora, her tail now laying on Adora's lap and her legs folded into herself.

Adora decides that the floor isn't the best place to sleep and carefully slides her shoulder away while simultaneously putting her hand there to cushion Catra's head. She then weaves her arm beneath her legs and picks her up bridal style. Once Adora's back on her feet she goes to the side of the bed and puts Catra's weight to one side to pull back the covers with her other hand. She then places her down and pulls up the blankets.

As Adora goes to leave she hears a weird, mewling? Sound coming from Catra and she somehow got a hold of her hand. Adora smiled. 'So cute.' She pried her hand out of Catra's grip. And silently crept out of the room closing the door behind her.

Adora let out a breath and looked both ways.
'Where was my room again?'

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8 years ago:
"Azar!"

"Grell..." Azar sadly got dragged into a forced social even with Grell. 'Of course, we're at a bar'
Azar thought with disdain as she took a seat next to the tall-built cat with spots of orange, white, and black with white hair in a braid down his back. He then put his arm around Azar's shoulders. "Two rounds of shots for me and the queen! The strongest shit you got!"

Azar rolled her eyes. One of her biggest reasons for her...disliking of Grell was the way he flaunts her title. Not to mention the passive-aggressive comments about how lucky Azar was to be the one to win Cyra's heart. Though Cyra said to play nice since she and Grell have been long time friends. The second the shots arrive he downs his. Azar just stared at hers. She used to love going out and drinking but she hasn't had the time nor reason as of recently.

"So how's life with the misses?" She now has a reason she thought as she downed the shot. She isn't a lightweight by any means but by the way the alcohol burned her throat she could tell she's gonna have quite the hangover. "Fine. How's Vivianne?" Grell just rolled his eyes. "She's been getting on my damn nerves! Honestly, all she does is whine and complain."

"Yeah, that's what kids do."

Grell then smirked at me. "I guess I can't complain too much. I can only imagine how bratty a royal kid is." Azar downed another shot. "Liz doesn't like asking for much. The only material thing she's asked for since returning is something she can draw on."
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"Wow, perfect wife and kid. Good for you." The venom from that statement was practically filling the air. Azar kinda felt bad. "Well I love my family they're great but not it's not always perfect. I and Cyra still fight and Liz is still dealing with her issues." Grell downed another shot.

"Oh yeah, I'm sure a fucking nine-year-old has a lot of issues." Azar knew by now that this is the point he gets... loose-lipped. Considering Azar was drinking as well this wasn't bound to end well. "Yeah being raised in the fucking Horde during a developmental state gave her a lot of issues. Thanks for your understanding."

Grell laughed as he downed another shot. "Oh, I'm sure. But hey at least she isn't a whiny brat. Maybe I should've let Vivianne get captured she'll hang there for a while, might straighten her-"

All Azar felt was blood down her knuckles she saw Grell covering his bloody nose but he was smiling. Her vision was narrowed and no doubt she was growling at him. He seemed to like this is exactly what he wanted. "You wanna fight? Fine, let's fight!"

Whole the surrounding patrons were just cheering for a fight while someone left to get a guard to stop it. Azar didnt care as she just charged at Grell without care. He moved and grabbed Azar's hair and threw her into a table.

She spits out blood as she got back up. "Wow going for the hair? What a pussy!" Grell just got pissed and now charged her and once he got close enough Azar jumped up swinging off the light fixture making him go straight into the wall. "Fucking bitch!"

He then just started throwing punches which were sloppy due to the alcohol but Azar was also slightly intoxicated so dodging took a lot more focus than it should've. Azar found an opening and slid around him and ducked as he went to punch and swept his feet from right under him. She then got on top of him and put her claws to his neck. His arms were pinned behind his back by her legs.

"One move and I'll split your fucking throat!" He then started laughing like a maniac. "You don't have the guts!" Azar flexed her claws. "Try me," Grell smirked. "Wow, good job Azar you won a dumb bar fight. Imagine if you won that one fight against that witch maybe you're kid would be less fucked up." Azar saw red as she grabbed his hair and slammed his face into the ground. There were audible gasps.

"Wanna say that again?" She pushed him down again. "Oh come on? Can't talk shit with blood in your mouth?!" Again. "Tell me again about how much you wish you were with Cy?" And again. "Tell me about how jealous you are that I get to go home every day and see my wife still alive!" She went to push him down again but she was pulled back. "Azar enough!"

"Fuck off!" Azar wasn't going down without a fight. The person who pulled her back was of course Leo. They dragged her out of the bar while the medics checked on Grell. He had passed out. Once outside Leo threw Azar back.

"What the fuck was that?" Azar rolled her eyes.

"Mind your damn business." Leo noticed her steps sway.

"Stars are you drunk?!"

Azar didn't respond just kept walking to who knows where. Leo grabbed Azar's arm. "Come on let's get you back to the castle." Azar gave a weak tug but ultimately followed.

"Azar, what happened?" The second Azar arrived Cyra was inspecting her. "Stars you're hurt!" Azar just smiled.

"Just a little." Leo then stepped in.

"Go clean yourself up. Cyra I need to speak with you." Cyra nodded and gave Azar a quick kiss on the cheek before following Leo.

'Shit I'm in trouble.' Azar just limped to her room. Apparently when she was thrown across the room something popped. 'Stars am I getting old?'
Azar opens the door to her room without thinking and makes light only to hear a quiet groan. 'Shit' Catra crawled out of her blanket and squinted at Azar.

"Momma?" Azar walked and for some reason, everything in her mind just told her she wanted her kit and just pulled her into her lap and clutched her tightly.

"Sorry. Didn't mean to wake you." Catra could smell the blood on her.

"Are you hurt?" Azar just laughed.

"No, I'm alright... I missed you." Catra curled into her mom.

"I missed you too." She then yawned and just fell back asleep.

Azar felt tears go down her face as her grip tightened on Catra. "I love you so much... I'm so sorry I couldn't protect you..."

Chapter End Notes

> Can you tell misunderstanding is my favorite trope? Lowkey feel bad for Adora's forehead... also this was supposed to end after Adora left the room but I wanted more Azar and some hints into Vivianne's life.

Reconnecting

Chapter Notes

> Welcome back! I sadly wont be uploading this upcoming tuesday, a lot of stuff is going on in my personal life and I just want a break for a while. But I have started a tumblr for this story. I already have the character sheets for Azar and Cyra that I'll post. If you're interested the link will be below.
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See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV
I'm lucky some guards noticed me struggling and led me to Glimmers room. I was going the exact opposite way. I thanked the guard and they just smiled and walked back to their post. I knocked on the door and whispered. "Glimmer? It's Adora-Ah!"

Glimmer pulled me into the room and closed the door behind herself. The second I got my bearings Glimmer was In my face. "So where have you been? So late at night. Catra nowhere to be seen?" I just rolled my eyes. "We were talking in her room. I told you that you could've joined us." It was Glimmer's turn to roll her eyes. "Stars Adora you are so stupid. I wanted to give you guys some, alone time."

"Aw, thanks Glimmer!" Glimmer rolled her eyes. "Anyway. How was it?" I smiled. "It was fun. I'm glad we can still talk like we used to without being awkward." Glimmer was looking at me weirdly. "Nothing else? No...confessions?" I was confused by what she meant. "Oh! Yeah, I told her about She-ra." Glimmer then facepalmed. I tilted my head at her. What did she want me to confess?

"Just- never mind. Your room is to the right when you leave. Try to get some sleep. Trust me tomorrow will suck if you try staying up. Luckily you don't have much to do besides show up but I'm

helping Cyra with the desserts and Bow is going to be gone with the local kits helping out. So you'll be free to just sit and relax. Though ask Catra at some point when you can meet with the tailors." I raised my brow at her.

"Why do I need to go to a tailor?" Glimmer groaned. "Because Halfmoon has a lot of traditions. One of them being the chosen guest of royals, that's you, Must wear certain things." I nodded. "Okay. So what am I supposed to do tomorrow?" Glimmer smiled. "That's the best part. Nothing! You get a few days to relax. You deserve it."

"But-" before I could protest Glimmer kicked me out of her room. "Relax! That's an order. Goodnight!" She then slammed the door on my face. "Great." I went to my room dreading what type of monstrosity of a bed I'll encounter only to see a simple cot with folded blankets and a note on top.

I picked it up and was relieved it was in writing I could read.

'Hey Adora, even though our bed's arent nearly as bad as Brightmoons thought a cot might be more your style. -Catra.'

'P.s don't come crying to me when your back cramps up!'

I smiled at the letter. Of course, Catra would do this. I placed the note on the bedside table and took off my clothes to leave me in my tank top and shorts. I then quickly made the bed and played down.

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Only to realize I'm not tired at all.

Azar walked lazily back to her room. She regretted offering to put all those books away for Catra.

She entered the room and saw Cyra brushing out her hair while humming to herself. Azar just walked over to her and placed her head in her hair. Cyra looked to the mirror in front of her to try

and see Azar but her face was hidden. "Well hello to you too." Azar didn't respond just buried herself into her hair. Cyra figured out at that moment something was wrong.

Cyra placed down her brush and turned to face Azar. Once she saw her ears downturned she frowned. She grabbed Azar's face. "What's wrong?" Azar then smiled. "Nothing! Just tired." Azar tried walking away but Cyra refused. "Azar."

Azar looked into Cyra's eyes and caved. She sighed. "It's just- do you think... Liz likes me?" Cyra's eyes widened. "Of course she does. She loves you." Azar just looked away. Cyra almost wanted to laugh at the absurdity of Catra not liking Azar but she could tell Azar seemed bothered by it. "Why do you think she doesn't like you?"

Azar shrugged. "I don't know it just seems like we haven't...hung out lately. I couldn't tell you when we last had a day it was just us. No magic lessons, no dumb meeting, just us." Cyra frowned. "Have you asked Elizabeth if she would like to have a day with just you?" Azar groaned and sat down on their bed. "But if I do that she'll say yes just because I asked!" Cyra had to hold back a laugh at Azar's antics.

"Azar, Elizabeth thinks just like you. She might think if she asked you to hang out with her you'd just say yes out of pity. If you both refuse to talk then you'll just be at a standstill." Azar groaned as she leaned back on the bed. "I hate when you're right." Cyra laughed as she kissed Azar's forehead. "I know." Azar then decided to change the subject. "So what do you think of Adora?"

Cyra noticed the topic change but she already said all she could. "She's nice. Though a bit jumpy." Azar laughed. "The fact she found you intimidating says something." Cyra gave an offended gasp. "She is not intimidated by me."

"She is!"

Cyra just rolled her eyes. "Whatever you say. Now move over!" Azar smiled and moved so Cyra could get comfortable. Azar was content until Cyra started rubbing her ears. She started purring the second she made contact but Azar knew something was up. "What did you do this time?"

"What I can't just love on my wife?"

Azar stared into Cyra's eyes and she had that look of guilt all over her face. "Alright, I may or may not have scheduled an early meeting with Grell."

"What why!?" Azar was now sitting up and Cyra sat up as well. "Because he's not convinced about Adora being here."

"Well tell him to fuck off! It's not his decision anyway."

"I know but he's been going around and making people doubt our decision. If we just talk with him maybe we can cut this off before Elizabeth's birthday." Azar groaned and dragged a hand down her face. "Fine." Cyra smiled and kissed Azar's cheek. "Thank you." Azra just rolled her eyes and pulled Cyra down to the bed. "Yeah yeah now keep scratching before I change my mind." Cyra smiled and continued.

Morning came way too soon for Catra. She sat up and rubbed her eyes. 'How did I end up in bed?' Catra thought back to last night. Realizing she must've fallen asleep at one point. She smiled knowing Adora must've played her down on her bed. As she got dressed she was immediately regretting her decision of pushing off Dianne for so long. She looked in the mirror and saw the mass of hair on her head going in different directions. "Uh." Catra then layed back down on her bed. 'Being a little late won't hurt.' The knock on the door crushed that possibility. "Elizabeth." Catra just groaned in response.

Cyra opened the door, still in her pajamas, and saw her kit laying face first in bed. "If only someone warned you about pushing it off

for so long." Catra just groaned again. Cyra laughed as she sat next to Catra. "Come on sweetie. I woke up early just to make sure you got up."

"Mhhh which hmmm mhhm!" Cyra rolled her eyes as Catra spoke into the bed. "I can't understand a word you're saying." Catra sat up and yawned dramatically. "I'm up and ready so I'm just killing time." She went to flop back onto the bed only for Cyra to stop her. "Yeah right. Come on I'll help you with that rat's nest." Catra just stuck her tounge out at her mom. Cyra just rolled her eyes as she pulled Catra up to stand on her own two feet. "Come on."

Cyra pulled her to the bathroom and quickly brushed as much as she could and pulled up her hair. "It's not perfect but presentable." She then kissed Catra on the cheek. "Are you coming back right after?" Catra sighed. "No, I'm meeting up with Vivianne." Cyra's eyes widened. "Really?" Catra nodded.

"Two hours." Cyra laughed. "How do you get yourself into these messes?" Catra just shrugged. Catra looked out the window and she realized she probably gonna have to run to make it to Diane's on time.

She didn't feel like running. Cyra seemed to understand and patted her back. "Well good luck! Love you." Catra quickly got up and grabbed her bag. "Yeah. Love you too."

Hours later Adora got dressed. She was up practically all night but told herself she couldn't walk around at the equivalent of 3 AM. As of now, she feels fine but she knows that the longer the day goes on the more tired she'll get. She heard Glimmers door close so she assumed now was an acceptable time to wake up.

Knowing she didn't have much to do today, correction anything to do, her feet carried her straight to Catra's room. She should probably explain the whole She-ra thing. Adora went to knock on her door but hesitated. 'Maybe she isn't awake yet. She might be busy. Vivianne might be in there.'

"You won't find her in there. She's at the tailor's getting fitted." Adora was startled as she looked and saw Azar. "Oh, uh... thanks." Adora wanted to run away from the awkward situation but Azar stepped in. "Hey I heard that you were at the top of your class in the Horde, that still true?" That caught Adora's attention. "Oh yeah. Well, technically not anymore because you know-"

"I'm just curious if you wanna spar. I have nothing better to do and I think you'd give me a run for my money." Adora decided there would be no harm in it. After all, she had nothing better to do. "Uh yeah, sure." Azar smiled and began walking with Adora behind her.

Adora wanted to make conversation but the silence didn't feel awkward and she didn't want to say something wrong. Luckily it was a short walk to the training room. Adora has been in awe throughout her whole visit but her new favorite thing is the training room. It looked used, unlike Brightmoon, and had all sorts of things rock climbing, spar mats, weights, punching bags everything. "Wow," Azar smirked.

"Bet it beats Brightmoon!" Adora just nodded wordlessly. "Definitely." Azar put a hand to her mouth and shouted. "Aye Leo get your ass over here and come meet Adora!" Adora was confused until she saw a tall black and white Magicat with scars on their face and piercing green eyes.

Adora felt herself shrink. 'Why does everyone here look like they could rip my head off?' Luckily Leo wasn't glaring at Adora more so Azar for throwing them off their session. "Azar remember that conversation we had about, not interrupting me?"

"Yep! So this is Adora Liz's friend from the Horde and I wanted to spar with her and we need a mediator."

"Hell no."

"Glad to hear you're on board come on Adora!"

Adora felt uncomfortable, scared this Leo person would start a fight but to her surprise, they just groaned and followed the pair. They went to a mat and Azar was excited. Leo just looked uninterested. Then she looked to Adora. "Do you allow combat magic?"

"Uhh...yes?"

Leo went to say something but Azar interrupted. "Great!" Leo sighed. "You want a weapon?" Adora smiled. "Whatcha got?" Leo gestured for Adora to follow them and opened a cabinet revealing a shit ton of weapons. Though Adora already knew which one she wanted.

She grabbed the bo staff without hesitation. Adora tested out the weight and was surprisingly satisfied. She walked back to the mat expecting Azar to be warming up for their fight but was surprised to see her just standing with her eyes closed and taking a series of deep breaths. Adora didn't know what to do so she asked Leo. "Is She- like... ready to fight?"

Leo sighed. SShe'ss just trying to clear her head. Shesthis morning." Adora looked to Leo. "What does that mean?" Suddenly Azar opened her eyes and seemed to find a new source of energy as she shifted her weight from foot to foot. Leo got a sly grin on their face as they looked at Adora. "It means you're fucked."

"If I knew you'd be this cooperative this early in the morning I would've made you be here early yesterday." Catra just rolled her eyes too tired to argue. "Are we done yet?" Diane sighed. "Yes, you're free to go just sign this." Catra looked at the paper and signed it agreeing that she approved the design, colors, cut, etc.

Catra got out earlier than expected and thought she might have time to go home and nap before-

"Lizzy? You here?"

'Nevermind.' Catra thought she might as well get it over with. "Yeah back here." Vivianne came from the front of the store and

her face lit up when she saw Catra. "Hey!" Catra just waved as she yawned. Diane then looked between the pair and smiled. She then gasped as if remembering something. "Oh Vivianne comes here I have something to give you!"

Catra heard them whispering about something and then they giggled and Vivianne looked over to Catra as Diane placed something in Vivianne's hand. "Well, I won't keep you two, run along!" Vivianne smiled. "Thanks! Come on Lizzy I rented out a place for us." Catra looked a bit surprised. "Really?" Vivianne nodded. "Of course."

Catra tried to be positive. 'We were close friends at one point. Just have to do whatever we used to.' They walked through town with Vivianne leading the way while Catra trailed behind.

"Do you hate me?" Catra was caught off guard. Not just from the question but the way Vivianne just said it so casually. "No... no, I don't." Vivianne smiled and let out a breath she didn't know she was holding. "Oh thank the stars." Catra found herself laughing. "You think I'd invite you out if I hated you?" Vivianne shrugged. "I don't know maybe?"

Catra felt a pang of guilt go through her. She never meant to make Vivianne feel that way. 'Maybe I've been meaner than I thought.' Catra sped up a bit and grabbed Vivianne's arm to get her attention. "Hey, I'm sorry. Really." Vivianne looked confused.

"Sorry for what?" Catra groaned she didn't want to explain this. She started rubbing the back of her neck. "For being a bitch. I'll be honest I just got...frustrated with everything. And what you said about the whole 'not getting out of here' thing pissed me off. So can we just agree to start over? Just hang out like we used to." Vivianne stared at her for a moment and clutched the item in her hand.

"Yeah...I'd like that."

Catra smiled. "Alright enough of this emotional shit. Let's go I have some research to do after this."

Cyra was currently sitting in her office filling disputes. She felt bad about leaving Glimmer to decorate on her own but of course, duty called. 'Honestly, how have we survived so long when half the people here are at each other's throats?' A knock was heard. "Come in." Cyradidn'tt bothers looking up and just said what she has memorized by now. "Hey what can I help you with?"

"Wow is that how you greet your friend?" Cyra looked up and smiled. "Grell, how are you?" He just smiled as he sat down. "I'm good. You?" Cyra just groaned. "I'm surviving." Grell laughed. "Well, at least you get a nice desk." Cyra shrugged. "Seriously though is there something wrong?"

"No nope nothing wrong I have good news." Cyra perked up. "Really?" He nodded. "Yep and I just wanted to give you a heads up." Now Cyra was confused and put her full attention on Grell. "What's up?"

"Well let's just say Elizabeth is gonna have a father-in-law!"

Adora's POV
The second Leo said, "begin!" Azar went straight for me catching me off guard I had to quickly move my staff to avoid a blow to my stomach. Holy shit.

Every blow was lethal and I had no time to regain my footing. She had all of Catra's speed but it was obvious she's been fighting for a long time. I expected to try to get to her right side since it was an obvious blind spot but she never gave a moment. Hit after hit after hit.

I was hoping she'd wear herself out but nothing was giving. I felt like I was getting tired out and I have yet to throw a single punch. Damn it.

Azar then went to punch and I got ready to block but noticed her right foot. She was faking me out. I ducked under her arm and

place the staff between us and pushed it to push her off balance. Though I knew from experience that wouldn't be enough to knock her down.

Of course, she just propelled herself backward and was back on her feet. Stupid tails. Giving them stupid agility. But I was more prepared now. I went in and started swinging. It was like a reverse of before.

Me being the hitter this time around. Yet she wasn't dodging as well as Catra. Might be because she used all that stamina. I couldn't talk much because I was already sweating and my breath was labored. I need to end this fast.

It was risky. But it's all I got. I pushed forward and got behind her then placed the staff at an angle across her body planning to push her down and pin her to the ground. But as I started to push my foot around her leg to get her off her footing but something happened.

Suddenly the staff felt hot in my hand then became scolding. "Fuck!" I dropped the staff on instinct and in a blink of an eye, I was pinned. I tried twisting out of it but I landed on my arms and Azar was on top of me and had her forearm pressed against my neck. I sighed.

"I give."

I felt the pressure be relieved as Azar got up. I turned over and saw Azar offer a hand to me. I took it as she talked. "Good fight. I tried to avoid using magic but you're tougher than you look." I chuckled. "Uh, thanks?" Leo rolled their eyes. "If Azar didn't cheat I think you could've won." Azar dramatically gasped. "How do I cheat?"

"You know Adora doesn't know what combat magic is. Not to mention you used the runestone not combat magic." Azar stuck her tounge out. "She yielded still counts." I was so confused. "Wait you can use the runestone? I thought Cyra was the actual

queen." Oh, that sounded bad. "I mean I know you are an actual queen I just meant you aren't related to the royal bloodline. Which I mean nothing wrong with that I just-"

Azar started laughing at me. "Jeez, kid you need to chill." That's an understatement. Azar then began talking again. "So the amber is different from the other runestones. Technically the power can be passed to anyone. Though it was by tradition it stayed within the royal family. It's even a law now. I was able to scrape by the law because I'm technically a royal by marriage. Though passing on the power has to be willing so we never have to worry about stuff like people trying to take it for themselves."

"So you and Cyra share it?" Azar shook her head.

"Nope. Unlike the moonstone, the Amber can't be...shared. so I'm the only one who possesses It. To split it between me and Cyra the power would just burn us from the inside out. The power is not only offensive but half of the process of gaining the power is your body learning to defend itself from overheating."

Interesting. From what I've heard this isn't like all the runestones I've encountered before. Then again She-ra's runestone got passed to me. "So why didnt Cyra just use the runestone? I mean it seems like a big deal." Azar sighed. "Well, the thing is if the runestone isn't actively in use it'll die out. Cyra doesn't like magic so she wouldn't have used it anyway. So she offered it to me so it would continue."

"Wow, I didnt know a runestone could just stop."

"Yeah it's an anomaly in itself but I spent too much time trying to figure it out and I've come to accept it's just one of those things. Though I think Liz might end up down that rabbit hole soon."

For a moment I almost had to ask who Liz was until I remembered Catra isn't her real name. "Really? What makes you say that?" Azar shrugged. "With how obsessed she's become with

'first ones' it's only a matter of time till she moves to runestones." I felt tense up. "First ones?"

I heard Leo scoff. "Don't know what's so interesting about a bunch of lame-ass colonizers." For some reason, I spoke without thinking. "How do you know that?" I felt myself subconsciously place my arm with my bracelet behind my back. Azar looked at me suspiciously. "Considering we have records of their invasion of our home I'd say we have a good proof."

Sour subject. This is the first time I've even heard of actual records of the first ones. "Is there any way I could see these records?" Azar eyed me. "Why are you interested?"

"Oh- um you know..." Leo stepped in "come on Azar leave her be." She stuck her tounge out at them. Maybe I should do my research while I'm here.

Catra's POV
Despite me being the one claiming to need help Vivianne was struggling the most. Honestly, she had two left feet and the grace of a newborn deer. "Shit sorry!" Vivianne said after stepping on my toe for the hundredth time.

"Alright let's start over and go over the moves. My feet can't handle being stomped over and over." Vivianne's ears went down. "But I thought you wanted help?" Shit.

"That was just an excuse to... hang out." Vivianne's ears were perked up and her tail was swaying. "Really?" Before she could get too hung up on that. I grabbed her hands. "Alright first of all you have to stand up straight." She snapped up. Stars I forget how tall she is sometimes. "Okay now grab my hand and put your other one on my side." She followed every order like clockwork. "Alright now follow my steps with the opposite foot."

She followed along slowly and her steps were hesitant. After a while of practicing, I noticed her get more confident and faster. I started to explain the next sequence of moves. "Okay now put

your right hand down and we keep our hands connected as we pull apart." Vivianne followed as I explained. "Now we both turn to meet back to back. And now we switch our linked hands and we pull away from from the opposite way." Vivianne did as told. Luckily she didnt has to do much for the last part. I just spin myself back to her and we are back at the start. "See? Easy." Vivianne nodded. I think this is the quietest she's ever been.

"Wanna run that all together? Or just do the last part a few more times?" Vivianne nodded. "I need an answer."

"You're gorgeous- Shit I mean yes! T-to the second. Choice. Yes, let's run that ending part a few more times!" She's funny when she's all flustered. "Alright then."

We ran through the last part a few more times and then started trying to get through the whole thing. It started tense and slow but she didnt step on my foot so that's something. Once we were able to get through it a solid three times It was time to fix Vivianne. When we went to start I grabbed her chin and lifted it a bit. "You can't stare at the floor." I felt Vivianne stumble a bit but she just agreed. Though she didn't look me in the eye.

"What were you up to before we met up?" Vivianne snapped out of her thoughts to answer me. "Oh, I was just talking with my dad about...stuff." The dance became more relaxed as Vivianne focused on speaking to me and just let her muscle memory go through the moves. "Really? Am I allowed to ask what about?"

"I don't think you'd be interested in hearing about me and my dad." She looked upset. "Well, I'm all ears." She finally looked me in the eye and it ended when we pulled away and were now back to back. However, when we came back together she let it all out. "I and him have been arguing lately about...decisions. He wants me to do something for the sole purpose of benefiting him and then try and play it off like he's doing me a favor. Which I want to do the thing he wants me to do but..."

She looked back at me. "I think it would be harmful to the other person involved." I hadn't noticed but we stopped dancing. It was silent until Vivianne sighed. "Sorry, that probably made no sense." Honestlysshe'ss right I had a hard time trying to decipher all that. "Kinda but it's obvious it was bothering you." She smiled. "Thanks for all this. I know the invitation probably wasn't sincere but... I appreciate it." I just shoved her. "Don't get all sappy." Vivianne laughed. "I would never!"

We stopped as both of our ears twitched at a sound and we looked to the door. It was Adora! Holding up a candlestick stand that looked like it almost fell to the floor. She smiled sheepishly. "Hey..."

I laughed as I walked over and helped her look presentable. "Seriously you have to be the least graceful person I know." Adora laughed and then froze as she saw Vivianne. I glanced over and noticed she had a sour look on her face. "Sorry I didn't mean to interrupt-"

"Well, you did." Vivianne now had her arms crossed. "Well, Azar told me to come to check on you." Vivianne rolled her eyes. "Oh, I'm sure."
Adora snapped.

"Seriously what is your problem with me?"

"I've already had this conversation with you." That ticked off something in my brain. "Wait what?" I was now looking at Vivianne. She seemed to lose her confidence. "I-"

"What conversation did you have?" Vivianne tensed up a bit. "I just told her that she has to respect you and your title."

"When was this conversation?"

"Lizzy, I-"

"When."

Vivianne sighed as she pushed some of her hair back. "Last night. After the dinner." So that's why Adora's been acting so weird. There was something more she said but I won't get it from her. "Come on Adora." Adora hesitated and I grabbed her wrist and walked away hastily.

I tried not to look back to Vivianne.

Chapter End Notes

Thanks for reading! Interested in the art for this fic? Check out my tumblr for this story!
http://lyssa-stone.tumblr.com

Feel free to ask any questions or post theories here and any art or concepts you may have!

Planning begins

Chapter Notes

> I'm back! Im currently on bed rest due to strep throat so I have more time to write!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV
Catra looks pissed. She hasn't said a word since we left Vivianne and she's still dragging me by my hand. "Umm-" I thought we might be going back to the palace but instead I noticed Catra taking back ways and recognized we were going back to her hideout on the edge of the kingdom.

She dropped my hand as she stomped out onto the raised area and started mumbling to herself and kicked a rock over the ledge and it dropped to the water below. "Fucking bitch!" Suddenly she waved her hand and it shattered a boulder in a second. Shit.

She then turned her head to me and I felt myself flinch. Then like a switch was flipped she smiled. "What did she say exactly?" I had to snap myself back into the conversation. "What?"

"Vivianne. What did she say to you?" Should I tell her? I can't lie and lie to Catra is a death wish. But I can't help but feel like I would be sabotaging Catra's relationship. "It wasn't anything bad she was just making sure I was being nice to you." Catra was now fully turned around. "Adora."

I expected to see Catra mad but when I faced her she looked upset. "Seriously you've been acting weird since her talk. Vivianne has a bad habit of... speaking on my behalf despite her not knowing shit about me." I looked to the side.

Suddenly I felt a hand on my face and it forced me to look at Catra. "I promise I won't be upset with you, Adora. I just want to know so I can confirm if Vivianne stepped out of line." She's so

gentle. Was she always this gentle? I leaned into her hand before I could stop myself. This is wrong I know that.

Not only is Catra In a relationship she's... Catra? I looked back into her eyes and everything just spilled out. "She just said I should know my place and respect your title as princess. That me being around is just... a reminder of a time In your life you want to forget." I saw the gears turning in Catra's mind until she seemed to register everything I said and she just stared past me. "Catra?"

She didn't respond. I noticed her eyes were pinpricks, her ears were at attention, and her fur was puffed up. I grabbed the hand that was on my face and she seemed to snap out of it. "Catra?" She took a step back and laughed. "Sorry zoned out for a minute."

She took a moment to recollect herself then finally acknowledged me. "Adora I swear that you don't remind me of the Horde. The only thing I get reminded of when I see you is how happy I am that you're alright. I remember all the fun things we used to do in the Fright zone and I think of all the new memories we'll make."

I felt my face turn red and just nodded in response. "Yeah- I... I would like to make new memories." Catra smiled. Catra.

"Should... should I be calling you Elizabeth?" That name felt weird. "Please don't. The people who call me that are just royal politicians and people who were a part of my... old life."

"Like Vivianne." I didn't intend for that to come out so...violent but it just did. Catra laughed. "Not even. Vivianne is a...special case."

"Yeah, I assume." Catra looked at me. "What's that supposed to mean?" I felt myself stutter out a response. "Well I mean you two are like... you know." I tried making a vague band gesture but by the way, Catra just tilted her head at me she didn't get it. "Adora please just use your words."

"Because you guys are like...together." Catra seemed to catch on and then she had a mean look on her face. "Did Vivianne tell you that! I swear she just keeps getting worse and worse!" What? I grabbed Catra's arm as she began to walk away. "Wait! She didn't tell me that. I just assumed because I saw you guys." I made another hand gesture. This one Catra seemed to understand. "When was that?"

"That night you threw me out your window." Wow, that sounds way worse than it was. Catra looked more confused then her face got red. Cute. She groaned and put her hands on her face. "Adora you idiot. I grabbed her face because she was going to see you." Oh.

"Oh! That makes sense. Kinda." I wanted to ask why Vivianne was so protective of her but decided against it. "Whatever. Now since that's all cleared up it's time we talk about something more important."

"What?" Catra's eye widened at me. "Oh, I don't know let's start with how the hell you turned into a giant!"

Cyra stared at Grell with her jaw agape. "Of course there are traditions we have to account for but due to my status as general-
"

"Wait hold on." Grell finally stopped his speech about how the wedding should go. Cyra composed herself and began. "Look Vivianne is a lovely girl and I know her and Elizabeth are friends-"

"Close friends." Grell interrupted. Cyra put on a strained smile.

"Of course. But they aren't even dating. Not to mention has Vivianne even talked to Elizabeth about this?" Grell then crossed his arms.

"Are you indicating that Vivianne is not suitable?"

"No! I'm just saying that Elizabeth should have a say in this." Grell smiled

"of course. Vivianne plans on asking during their dance at her celebration! She'll give her answer then." Cyra stared at Grell seeing no traces of her old friend.

"How on Etheria is that fair!? I'm saying marriage is a big deal that should be talked out before the actual proposal. And asking in front of a crowd? That's putting her in an uncomfortable social situation where she feels as if she can't say no! Not to mention on her birthday, a day that should be about her."

Grell just rolled his eyes. "Cyra be realistic We both know she's gonna be stuck here forever and Vivianne is one of the only girls even close to her age and our families already have a history with each other. It's practically meant to be."

"My answer is no." Grell looked shocked as he looked at Cyra.

"What?" Cyra stood her ground.

"I said no. You do not have my blessing nor Vivianne. If you wish to receive it Elizabeth must tell me that she willingly wishes to marry Vivianne."

"Cyra-"

"If that is your only reason for coming you have no business here. Good day." Grell went to speak. "Good. Day." Grell huffed and turned to leave.

"My offer stands. Think about it. Nothing can keep Elizabeth here more than a marriage can. And with how much Adora is involved with the rebellion I wonder how much longer Elizabeth will remain idle." Grell closed the door behind him leaving Cyra in her thoughts.

She hated how hard she doubted her answer.
"Cyra?" She looked up and saw Glimmer.

"Apologies I got caught up." Glimmer just smiled.

"No you're fine I was just coming to say I finished up."

"Oh, thank you." Cyra seemed dazed. Glimmer noticed.

"Are you okay?" Cyra sighed and smiled.

"I'm okay just overwhelmed." Glimmer laughed.

"Yeah well, it'll be better once all of this is over. Party planning is stressful enough and the fact C is 'okay with whatever doesn't help." Cyra laughed.

"Yeah."

A nice silence filled the room as Cyra's thoughts went rabid.

"Is there any chance Adora will stay here?" Glimmer looked to the queen.

"What do you mean?" Cyra sighed.

"Let's forget it. I need your help getting desserts delivered." Glimmer saw she was upset but decided to leave it be for now.

"Of course!"

Catra's POV
"Holy shit what is the rebellion feeding you?" It was a joke but as I circled Adora I just noticed how much bigger Adora is as "She-ra" who is her alter ego. Adora laughed awkwardly as she tried to follow my movements. Which was difficult for her considering I was sliding through her arms. I finally faced her head on which was inconvenient because she was three feet taller! "How did this happen?" Adora tilted her head at me.

"I told you already I found the sword and-"

"Adora you rushed an explanation then transformed so excuse me if I didn't pay attention." Adora had the nerve to huff at me.

"Okay so I was in the Fright Zone and I saw a light come from the woods. I decided since I was promoted I could check it out and... see if you were waiting for me."

I felt my breath catch. "You went looking for me?" Adora looked at me and this was the first time I noticed her electrifying blue eyes.

"Of course I did. I promised didn't I?" It was so strange how Adora always knew exactly what to say at every moment. I tried to force down a smile at her words.

"Yeah, you did."

I quickly shook my head. "Anyway continue." Adora coughed.

"Right uh so I found this sword and I thought it was a dream at first because I passed out afterward. I went back to the Fright zone but couldn't stop thinking about it so I went back. I found it but Glimmer and Bow were there and you can imagine how that went. Anyway soon a giant bug came after us and I got the sword. Then a voice said fight for the honor of Greyskull and then poof I'm in a tiara."

I laughed. "I'm sure that was a fun experience." Adora's face told otherwise. She then sighed.

"I kinda wish I met you first. Seeing all the other princesses be all..." She made a gesture again. She should stop doing that.

"Sparkle?" I finished.

"Yeah. It was a trip."

"I swear I almost went blind when I first went to Brightmoon." Adora laughed. It was weird seeing this warrior laugh just like Adora. Then Adora's eyes widened as if she remembered something.

"Do you have access to the first one's reports?" I raised my brow at her. Before I could ask why she started explaining. "Finding physical records of first ones is almost impossible and She-ra is connected to them and I'm still trying to figure everything out. I just want to know if they have the information I can use to get stronger."

Of course, even as a glowing 8ft tall hunk of muscle she still feels the need to become even stronger. "I can ask but I can't say all of them are reliable sources." Adora looked at me as if I had just taken a bullet for her and didn't just agree to get her some years old files that might be useless. "Really? Thank you!" She picked me up like I was nothing. I instinctively grabbed onto her. "Stars Adora give a girl a warning!" She just laughed at me. I got situated and Adora had me on her arm. Which was in a flexing position and her other arm relaxed at her side.

"Comfortable?" I just laughed. "Very." I tried to not acknowledge the that fact Adora was holding me up by one arm. "Oh yeah. You might want to keep this whole thing away from people. Might make a whole mess." Adora nodded. "Wow, this is the first time She-ra isn't wanted around. " I frowned. I didn't like how she said that. "What do you mean?" Adora deflected. "I was just shocked usually something bad happens and She-ra saves the day."

"Well, now you get a break. Would love to see you trying to relax." Adora huffed. "Yeah yeah, whatever. Seems you have no problem." Adora said as she placed her other hand on her hip and looked to me who was practically swinging my legs like a child on a playground. "It's a talent."

There was a short silence until Adora desperately filled it. "I sparred with your mom today." My ears perked up. "Really? She kicked your ass didn't she?" Adora scoffed. "Well, I wouldn't say that-"

"She did!" I started cackling at Adora's face. "I'll drop you," I smirked at her threat. Then blinked up at her with a pout. "You would never!" That made Adora laugh. I noticed her hair sway

with it. I felt my pupils dilate as I have this weird pull towards the golden hair.

Shiny...

"Uh, Catra?" When I snapped out of it my claws we kneading into her hair. Adora seemed amused. "She-ra always wins when it comes to hair." I laughed and crawled over her head as I went to her other arm. "Isn't She-ra you? Why the separation?" Adora went to answer but stopped herself. "I- I don't know. I just never thought of us as the same person." I laughed. "Dummy."

Adora got a pout on her face. "Anyway, what are your thoughts on her?" I said while I played with Adora's hair.

"Azar?" I nodded. "She's cool. She is a good fighter. She reminds me a lot of you." I rolled my eyes. "Everyone says that." That's no exaggeration. Every time I go anywhere people will say I look so much like Azar. So much so Cyra cried once because she thought I didn't look like her kit. Which is stupid considering we have a lot of similarities. Just under the surface level.

Adora then spits out something so quickly I practically got whiplash from turning my head.
"Would you be interested in joining the alliance?"

"Azar?"

"In here!" Cyra walked into her room and went to the bathroom where she heard Azar's voice. Cyra was shocked to find Azar sitting on the sink with a pair of scissors. "What are you doing?" Azar's eyes widened. "Uhhh." Cyra sighed. "Seriously?"

"What it was getting in my eyes I was just trimming it." Cyra rolled her eyes. "Then at least ask for help. The last time you cut it by yourself it was a hot mess." Azar huffed. "That was one time out of hundreds." Cyra took the scissors from her. "Come sit down and I'll trim it for you. But this is the last time." Azar smiled.

"Of course." Cyra pulled a chair from their desk, placed it in the bathroom, and patted the chair. "Well hurry up." Azar laughed as she sat down. Cyra noticed the knots. "You were going to cut your hair with it tangled?"

"I was gonna cut them out."

"That's not how that works!" Azar just laughed at Cyra's frustration. She just huffed and grabbed the brush from their vanity. "Honestly how your hair even comes out halfway decent is beyond me." She said as she began to brush Azar's hair. 'How come the people who get the best hair barely take care of it!' Azar just hummed in response and leaned more into her wife.

The silence went on till Cyra was through with brushing her hair. Cyra bit her lip as she remembered why she came to see Azar. "So Elizabeth and Vivianne." Azar raised a brow.

"What about them?" Cyra shrugged.

"I don't know I was just wondering what you think of their... relationship?" Azar sighed.

"Vivianne is a nice girl and Liz gets along with her when she isn't being obsessive over her. But other than that I don't have many thoughts."

"Would you care if they ever got together?" Azar now looked to Cyra through the mirror.

"If that's what Liz wants then sure. I mean it would be annoying being connected to Grell for the rest of my life but I'll deal with it." Azar noticed Cyra's face shift.

"Where did this come from? Did something happen?" Cyra just shook her head.

"No, I've just been thinking that maybe Elizabeth would like to start thinking about that stuff you know? I mean she never shows interest in dating but it's obvious she still thinks about it a lot."

Azar smirked. Don't worry with Adora around she might start to think about it." Cyra frowned.

"That's what I'm worried about."

"I thought you liked Adora?"

"I do it is just, she is a major part of the rebellion and she won't want to stay here and Elizabeth will not stay here knowing Adora's still out there." Azar looked to the side.

"Is that so bad?" Cyra froze for a moment.

"Azar-"

"I received a letter from Mystacore." Cyra tensed up. Conversations starting like that never end well.

"What was it about?"

"It was an invitation to the eclipse ceremony." Cyrarelaxe a bit but was still cautious as she lined up Azar's hair to cut.

"Wel,l that was nice of them to invite us despite the fact we never attend." Azar let out a nervous laugh.

"Yeah... I was thinking... what if we went? I'm sure Liz would love to."

"Azar we've talked about this."

Snip.

"N,o we haven't. You just say it's not safe and turn it down."

Snip. Snip.

"That should be reason enough."

Snip. Snip. Snip.

"You're acting as if Liz is going to get hurt the second she leaves."

Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip.

"Well considering the last time she left the caves she was kidnapped by the Horde that very well might be the case."

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"Mystacor is hidden not to mention Liz was a kit when that happened she can defend herself fine."

Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip.

"That doesn't include the journey there! Not to mention Magicats are worth a lot on the black market any rando could target her!'

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"Stars Cyra I don't even know why I bother trying to talk to you when all you do is make up crazy scenarios. You never listen to me!"

Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip. Snip.

"Well the last time I listened to you Elizabeth was taken!"

Snip.

"Fuck!" Azar leaned forward as she clutched her neck. Cyra cut too close and a, luckily, shallow cut was below where her hair ended. "Stars! Aza,r I'm so sorry! Stay right there!" Cyra rushed and grabbed the medkit. Azar was clutching the spot. And Cyra quickly shoos her hand away. It already stopped bleeding but Cyra was trying to hold back tears and her hands shook as she went to bandage it. "Cy it's fine."

"N-no its-it's not!" Azar turned around and grabbed Cyra's face to get her to look at her.

"It's already healed. I know it was an accident. Probably shouldn't have had this conversation while you had a sharp object in your hands." Azar jokes to lighten the mood but Cyra was just shaking her head.

"It could've been so much worse!" Azar wiped her eyes.

"But it wasn't." Cyra tried taking deep breaths. Azar wrapped her arm and tail around Cyra and held her. Cyra tried pulling away but Azar didn't let her. Cyra would do one thing wrong and refuse help or comfort believing she didn't deserve it. Luckily Azar is one of the most stubborn people around.

The cut didn't hurt. Mostly just surprised her. Yet Cyra thought she destroyed everything at that moment. "So would now be a good time to ask what you can do to make it up to me? Because I have some ideas." Azar joked and this time Cyra laughed.

"I'm impressed finally stopped being a doormat. Maybe cut Grell next time." Azar then nuzzled Cyra's face as she laughed.

"Stop! That's not funny!" Azar smirked.

"Then why are you laughing?" Cyra grabbed Azar's face.

"Because of your stupid face!" Azar faked offense then tackled Cyra.

"Take that back!"

"Azar!"

Adora's POV

I saw Catra's face fall. "I mean I would like to but... it's not happening." I hated seeing her ears drop. "Maybe I could talk to them. I've been known to be convincing." Catra rolled her eyes at me. "I'm sure." She then jumped down from my arm and I placed my hands around her in case she fell. Though the chances of that happening were slim to none.

"Trust me I've been trying for years." Despite the calm voice,e I noticed her arms crossed. I realized I was still She-ra and decided that maybe she wasn't the best for this conversation. I let the magic flow away as I walked to Catra. "Wel,l It's obvious they care about you. Maybe if-"

"Adora I promise you I have tried everything and they haven't budged." The frustration was obvious in the way her tail moved and her eyes narrowed. I wanted to say something to make her feel better but I could tell she didn't feel like talking. I then heard her take a deep breath and smooth out her hair, which looked a lot nicer than I remembered. She then turned to me and smiled as if nothing happened. "You know we used to have a whole kingdom on the surface. It was similar to this place but like ten times bigger. You should go to the ruins on your way back to Brightmoon." Her voice dropped on the last sentence.

"What's it like?"

"Had massive corridors and the palace its self didn't end. It just flowed into the town as a symbol of unity amongst the people or something." Catra got lost in the explanation. She just like that place. "When was the last time you went there?" Catra looked back at me and her smile faded. Oh no.

"O,h I've never really been there. Well,l technically I have. I was raised there but I don't... I don't remember anything. Most of my knowledge is from books and stories." Looking at Catra upset made my stomach turn.

"How far is it from here?" Catra's ears perked up at me. "Umm just about a fifteen-minute walk. Why?" This was a really bad idea. Not only would I be going against the queens but the whole kingdom could come after me. "Why don't we go see it in person?"

I like to tell myself Catra's face would make it worth it.

Chapter End Notes

As always hope you enjoyed and leave as many comments as you can! Also concept art for Cyra has been posted to my tumblr if you're interested in how I envision her. Just to warn you I'm not a great artist...

http://lyssa-stone.tumblr.com

Tonight is the night

Chapter Notes

> Hey sorry for the late update! This was supposed to be way shorter but I got greedy and thought I could add more before it was too late so enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV
Catra looks pissed. She hasn't said a word since we left Vivianne and she's still dragging me by my hand. "Umm-" I thought we might be going back to the palace but instead I noticed Catra taking back ways and recognized we were going back to her hideout on the edge of the kingdom.

She dropped my hand as she stomped out onto the raised area and started mumbling to herself and kicked a rock over the ledge and it dropped to the water below. "Fucking bitch!" Suddenly she waved her hand and it shattered a boulder in a second. Shit.

She then turned her head to me and I felt myself flinch. Then like a switch was flipped she smiled. "What did she say exactly?" I had to snap myself back into the conversation. "What?"

"Vivianne. What did she say to you?" Should I tell her? I can't lie and lie to Catra is a death wish. But I can't help but feel like I would be sabotaging Catra's relationship. "It wasn't anything bad she was just making sure I was being nice to you." Catra was now fully turned around. "Adora."

I expected to see Catra mad but when I faced her she looked upset. "Seriously you've been acting weird since her talk. Vivianne has a bad habit of... speaking on my behalf despite her not knowing shit about me." I looked to the side.

Suddenly I felt a hand on my face and it forced me to look at Catra. "I promise I won't be upset with you, Adora. I just want to

know so I can confirm if Vivianne stepped out of line." She's so gentle. Was she always this gentle? I leaned into her hand before I could stop myself. This is wrong I know that.

Not only is Catra In a relationship she's... Catra? I looked back into her eyes and everything just spilled out. "She just said I should know my place and respect your title as princess. That me being around is just... a reminder of a time In your life you want to forget." I saw the gears turning in Catra's mind until she seemed to register everything I said and she just stared past me. "Catra?"

She didn't respond. I noticed her eyes were pinpricks, her ears were at attention, and her fur was puffed up. I grabbed the hand that was on my face and she seemed to snap out of it. "Catra?" She took a step back and laughed. "Sorry zoned out for a minute."

She took a moment to recollect herself then finally acknowledged me. "Adora I swear that you don't remind me of the Horde. The only thing I get reminded of when I see you is how happy I am that you're alright. I remember all the fun things we used to do in the Fright zone and I think of all the new memories we'll make."

I felt my face turn red and just nodded in response. "Yeah- I... I would like to make new memories." Catra smiled. Catra.

"Should... should I be calling you Elizabeth?" That name felt weird. "Please don't. The people who call me that are just royal politicians and people who were a part of my... old life."

"Like Vivianne." I didn't intend for that to come out so...violent but it just did. Catra laughed. "Not even. Vivianne is a...special case."

"Yeah, I assume." Catra looked at me. "What's that supposed to mean?" I felt myself stutter out a response. "Well I mean you two are like... you know." I tried making a vague band gesture but by

the way, Catra just tilted her head at me she didn't get it. "Adora please just use your words."

"Because you guys are like...together." Catra seemed to catch on and then she had a mean look on her face. "Did Vivianne tell you that! I swear she just keeps getting worse and worse!" What? I grabbed Catra's arm as she began to walk away. "Wait! She didn't tell me that. I just assumed because I saw you guys." I made another hand gesture. This one Catra seemed to understand. "When was that?"

"That night you threw me out your window." Wow, that sounds way worse than it was. Catra looked more confused then her face got red. Cute. She groaned and put her hands on her face. "Adora you idiot. I grabbed her face because she was going to see you." Oh.

"Oh! That makes sense. Kinda." I wanted to ask why Vivianne was so protective of her but decided against it. "Whatever. Now since that's all cleared up it's time we talk about something more important."

"What?" Catra's eye widened at me. "Oh, I don't know let's start with how the hell you turned into a giant!"

Cyra stared at Grell with her jaw agape. "Of course there are traditions we have to account for but due to my status as general-
"

"Wait hold on." Grell finally stopped his speech about how the wedding should go. Cyra composed herself and began. "Look Vivianne is a lovely girl and I know her and Elizabeth are friends-"

"Close friends." Grell interrupted. Cyra put on a strained smile.

"Of course. But they aren't even dating. Not to mention has Vivianne even talked to Elizabeth about this?" Grell then crossed his arms.

"Are you indicating that Vivianne is not suitable?"

"No! I'm just saying that Elizabeth should have a say in this." Grell smiled

"of course. Vivianne plans on asking during their dance at her celebration! She'll give her answer then." Cyra stared at Grell seeing no traces of her old friend.

"How on Etheria is that fair!? I'm saying marriage is a big deal that should be talked out before the actual proposal. And asking in front of a crowd? That's putting her in an uncomfortable social situation where she feels as if she can't say no! Not to mention on her birthday, a day that should be about her."

Grell just rolled his eyes. "Cyra be realistic We both know she's gonna be stuck here forever and Vivianne is one of the only girls even close to her age and our families already have a history with each other. It's practically meant to be."

"My answer is no." Grell looked shocked as he looked at Cyra.

"What?" Cyra stood her ground.

"I said no. You do not have my blessing nor Vivianne. If you wish to receive it Elizabeth must tell me that she willingly wishes to marry Vivianne."

"Cyra-"

"If that is your only reason for coming you have no business here. Good day." Grell went to speak. "Good. Day." Grell huffed and turned to leave.

"My offer stands. Think about it. Nothing can keep Elizabeth here more than a marriage can. And with how much Adora is involved with the rebellion I wonder how much longer Elizabeth will remain idle." Grell closed the door behind him leaving Cyra in her thoughts.

She hated how hard she doubted her answer.
"Cyra?" She looked up and saw Glimmer.

"Apologies I got caught up." Glimmer just smiled.

"No you're fine I was just coming to say I finished up."

"Oh, thank you." Cyra seemed dazed. Glimmer noticed.

"Are you okay?" Cyra sighed and smiled.

"I'm okay just overwhelmed." Glimmer laughed.

"Yeah well, it'll be better once all of this is over. Party planning is stressful enough and the fact C is 'okay with whatever doesn't help." Cyra laughed.

"Yeah."

A nice silence filled the room as Cyra's thoughts went rabid.

"Is there any chance Adora will stay here?" Glimmer looked to the queen.

"What do you mean?" Cyra sighed.

"Let's forget it. I need your help getting desserts delivered." Glimmer saw she was upset but decided to leave it be for now.

"Of course!"

Catra's POV
"Holy shit what is the rebellion feeding you?" It was a joke but as I circled Adora I just noticed how much bigger Adora is as "She-ra" who is her alter ego. Adora laughed awkwardly as she tried to follow my movements. Which was difficult for her considering I was sliding through her arms. I finally faced her head on which was inconvenient because she was three feet taller! "How did this happen?" Adora tilted her head at me.

"I told you already I found the sword and-"

"Adora you rushed an explanation then transformed so excuse me if I didn't pay attention." Adora had the nerve to huff at me.

"Okay so I was in the Fright Zone and I saw a light come from the woods. I decided since I was promoted I could check it out and... see if you were waiting for me."

I felt my breath catch. "You went looking for me?" Adora looked at me and this was the first time I noticed her electrifying blue eyes.

"Of course I did. I promised didn't I?" It was so strange how Adora always knew exactly what to say at every moment. I tried to force down a smile at her words.

"Yeah, you did."

I quickly shook my head. "Anyway continue." Adora coughed.

"Right uh so I found this sword and I thought it was a dream at first because I passed out afterward. I went back to the Fright zone but couldn't stop thinking about it so I went back. I found it but Glimmer and Bow were there and you can imagine how that went. Anyway soon a giant bug came after us and I got the sword. Then a voice said fight for the honor of Greyskull and then poof I'm in a tiara."

I laughed. "I'm sure that was a fun experience." Adora's face told otherwise. She then sighed.

"I kinda wish I met you first. Seeing all the other princesses be all..." She made a gesture again. She should stop doing that.

"Sparkle?" I finished.

"Yeah. It was a trip."

"I swear I almost went blind when I first went to Brightmoon." Adora laughed. It was weird seeing this warrior laugh just like

Adora. Then Adora's eyes widened as if she remembered something.

"Do you have access to the first one's reports?" I raised my brow at her. Before I could ask why she started explaining. "Finding physical records of first ones is almost impossible and She-ra is connected to them and I'm still trying to figure everything out. I just want to know if they have the information I can use to get stronger."

Of course, even as a glowing 8ft tall hunk of muscle she still feels the need to become even stronger. "I can ask but I can't say all of them are reliable sources." Adora looked at me as if I had just taken a bullet for her and didn't just agree to get her some years old files that might be useless. "Really? Thank you!" She picked me up like I was nothing. I instinctively grabbed onto her. "Stars Adora give a girl a warning!" She just laughed at me. I got situated and Adora had me on her arm. Which was in a flexing position and her other arm relaxed at her side.

"Comfortable?" I just laughed. "Very." I tried to not acknowledge the that fact Adora was holding me up by one arm. "Oh yeah. You might want to keep this whole thing away from people. Might make a whole mess." Adora nodded. "Wow, this is the first time She-ra isn't wanted around. " I frowned. I didn't like how she said that. "What do you mean?" Adora deflected. "I was just shocked usually something bad happens and She-ra saves the day."

"Well, now you get a break. Would love to see you trying to relax." Adora huffed. "Yeah yeah, whatever. Seems you have no problem." Adora said as she placed her other hand on her hip and looked to me who was practically swinging my legs like a child on a playground. "It's a talent."

There was a short silence until Adora desperately filled it. "I sparred with your mom today." My ears perked up. "Really? She kicked your ass didn't she?" Adora scoffed. "Well, I wouldn't say that-"

"She did!" I started cackling at Adora's face. "I'll drop you," I smirked at her threat. Then blinked up at her with a pout. "You would never!" That made Adora laugh. I noticed her hair sway with it. I felt my pupils dilate as I have this weird pull towards the golden hair.

Shiny...

"Uh, Catra?" When I snapped out of it my claws we kneading into her hair. Adora seemed amused. "She-ra always wins when it comes to hair." I laughed and crawled over her head as I went to her other arm. "Isn't She-ra you? Why the separation?" Adora went to answer but stopped herself. "I- I don't know. I just never thought of us as the same person." I laughed. "Dummy."

Adora got a pout on her face. "Anyway, what are your thoughts on her?" I said while I played with Adora's hair.

"Azar?" I nodded. "She's cool. She is a good fighter. She reminds me a lot of you." I rolled my eyes. "Everyone says that." That's no exaggeration. Every time I go anywhere people will say I look so much like Azar. So much so Cyra cried once because she thought I didn't look like her kit. Which is stupid considering we have a lot of similarities. Just under the surface level.

Adora then spits out something so quickly I practically got whiplash from turning my head.
"Would you be interested in joining the alliance?"

"Azar?"

"In here!" Cyra walked into her room and went to the bathroom where she heard Azar's voice. Cyra was shocked to find Azar sitting on the sink with a pair of scissors. "What are you doing?" Azar's eyes widened. "Uhhh." Cyra sighed. "Seriously?"

"What it was getting in my eyes I was just trimming it." Cyra rolled her eyes. "Then at least ask for help. The last time you cut it by yourself it was a hot mess." Azar huffed. "That was one time

out of hundreds." Cyra took the scissors from her. "Come sit down and I'll trim it for you. But this is the last time." Azar smiled.

"Of course." Cyra pulled a chair from their desk, placed it in the bathroom, and patted the chair. "Well hurry up." Azar laughed as she sat down. Cyra noticed the knots. "You were going to cut your hair with it tangled?"

"I was gonna cut them out."

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"Where did this come from? Did something happen?" Cyra just shook her head.

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"Well considering the last time she left the caves she was kidnapped by the Horde that very well might be the case."

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Adora's POV

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me. "I'm sure." She then jumped down from my arm and I placed my hands around her in case she fell. Though the chances of that happening were slim to none.

"Trust me I've been trying for years." Despite the calm voice,e I noticed her arms crossed. I realized I was still She-ra and decided that maybe she wasn't the best for this conversation. I let the magic flow away as I walked to Catra. "Wel,l It's obvious they care about you. Maybe if-"

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"Oh, I've never really been there. Well,l technically I have. I was raised there but I don't... I don't remember anything. Most of my knowledge is from books and stories." Looking at Catra upset made my stomach turn.

"How far is it from here?" Catra's ears perked up at me. "Umm just about a fifteen-minute walk. Why?" This was a really bad idea. Not only would I be going against the queens but the whole kingdom could come after me. "Why don't we go see it in person?"

I like to tell myself Catra's face would make it worth it.

Chapter End Notes

I love Azar and Cyra and I wanted to give them something nice. Also look forward for next chapter where Catra and Adora set out on their journey to old Halfmoon!

Into the unknown

Chapter Notes

> Just barely made it on time! Thanks for all the support not only on this story but as well as my Tumblr. As I've mentioned this week my hours are intense so next chapter night be a little shorter hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra couldn't believe what she just heard. "What?" Adora noticed her hesitation and began to backtrack. "I was just wondering if you'd like to go see it? But you know what never mind it was stupid." Catra started laughing which gave Adora pause. "Wow, I didn't know you had it in you. Thinking about going against a direct rule and from a queen no less. I am a bad influence on you."

Adora flushed a bit as she thought about what she suggested. She is crazy. "Yeah like I said forget it!" Catra smiled and placed her hands on Adora's shoulders. "I appreciate the thought but..." Catra seemed to hesitate for a moment then started thinking.

'The guards wouldn't be nearly as heavy because of me promising not to try to escape. If we did it late tonight the woods wouldn't be too dark because the sun would be about to rise. No stop what am I thinking?!' Catra looked up and it's like Adora knew she was thinking of all the ways they could sneak out. She had a smirk on her face. "Stop it!"

"I'm not saying anything." Catra rolled her eyes. "Yeah yeah." Adora laughed then looked to Catra. "I mean hypothetically if I were to say I'd help you sneak out. Would you want to?" Catra's eyes widened in response. "Really! Uh... I mean... hypothetically, how would it work?"

"How well do you know the layout of this place?"

"Seriously let me make sure it's clean." Cyra was currently wrestling with her wife trying to see the cut. "I told you it's fine to let me go!" Azar tried escaping but Cyra wrapped her legs around her middle and her arms around Azar's neck. "Hold still! Stars you're such a brat!"

Azar smirked as she licked down Cyra's arm. "Ew!" Azar laughed as Cyra shook the saliva off her arm. "Honestly how do I put up with you?" Azar shrugged. "Maybe because you know I'm worth it?" She fluttered her lashes while Cyra looked unamused. "I'm sure."

Azar relaxed while Cyra rubbed her ears. "I'm sorry I shouldn't have snapped like that." Azar just sighed. "I told you it's fine. I've already forgiven you. I like to think you don't want to hurt me on purpose." Cyra smiled. "Never."

As Azar purred Cyra felt her eyes get heavy. 'How long has it been since I had a day off?' Azar noticed the slowing of Cyra's hand and then saw her looking dazed almost as if she fell asleep with her eyes open. Azar then got up and Cyra was back to reality. "What's wrong?" Azar just grabbed Cyra and pulled her to her feet. "You are going to bed." Cyra looked puzzled.

"But-"

"No buts! You're overworking yourself." Cyra smirked. "Funny coming from you." Azar just rolled her eyes then started to push Cyra to the bed. "Yeah, yeah but you always get annoyed when you're tired." Cyra got an offended look on her face. "I am not! Besides I have to finish up so I can meet with Elizabeth tomorrow about the ceremony." Cyra tried to slip out of Azar's grip but she didn't relent. "Nope. Glimmer already told me she finished up. Besides I can take the reins for a while. You don't want to be half-dead by the time Liz's birthday arrives do you?"

Cyra sighed. "No, I guess not." Azar let go of her and Cyra dashed the door. Unfortunately for her, Azar was always five steps ahead.

Azar bent down and grabbed Cyra by her waist and hoisted her over her shoulder. "Azar come on!" Azar didn't respond as she practically throws Cyra on the bed. "Nope. Rest. Now." Cyra groaned.

She refused to admit how she instantly relaxed when her body made contact with the mattress. 'So soft.' Azar noticed Cyra on the edge of consciousness and sat next to her rubbing her arms. Cyra leaned into the touch as her eyes closed. "Mm, no fair." Azar laughed and kissed her head. 'So not fair.' Cyra thought.

"I know you think I'm too obsessed with Mystacore but I honestly think all of us need a break." Cyra knew that. It was hard to get a day off when all your subjects can see you at their local market. "A break sounds good. I'm just worried."

"Cy, I promise Liz will be fine I'll have Leo stalk her if you want." Cyra laughed which led to a yawn. "Maybe..." Azar noticed and chuckled. "Just think about it. We'll talk later." Cyra just made a sound of acknowledgment as she finally succumbs to sleep.

"Shh!" Catra urged Adora to quiet down despite Catra giggling just as much. "Sorry, sorry!" Adora said in a hushed voice. "I just don't know how this will help us with the plan?" Catra smirked. "Watch and learn young one." Adora was so ready to tease her about the fact that Catra was the younger of the pair but stopped when she saw Catra point below the railing they were hiding on.

It was Leo, who looked exhausted, their head hung down and their shoulders were tense. Adora then saw Catra draw a rune and carefully hovered it over where Leo was about to walk. "Almost..."

The second Leo passed the threshold the spell was released and then there was a puff of smoke. Catra then leaped from the railing. "Catra!?" Adora saw her land the winked with her fingers to her lips then began to pretend to cough from the smoke.

"Leo?" The smoke cleared and Leo had grown in height from their hair sticking out in all directions. Catra had to use everything she

had not to laugh. "Oh, stars what happened." Leo looked to Catra.

"Where is Azar?" Catra shrugged.

"I think I saw her upstairs." Leo was then on a warpath.

Adora took the stairs down and looked at Catra in confusion. "What just happened?" Catra laughed. "What just happened is Azar and Leo are going to be... distracted. Cyra is too busy doing party stuff with Glimmer so we can use this time to scope out the area."

"Oh.. smart."

"Of course." Catra then quickly grabbed Adora and began to whisper in her ear. "We'll leave tonight."

Unaware of a feline listening in.

Catra: age 12
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Azar was already up and dressed while Cyra was struggling to even open her eyes. Azar smiled at her wife as she just clutched Catra closer and nuzzled her nose into her hair. Azar sat next to her and started shaking her a bit. "Come on, you know if you don't get up now you'll be late." Cyra just groaned and swatted Azar's hand away.

"No, I quit. Go find a new queen." Azar rolled her eyes.

"Come on Cy." Azar wasn't lying when she said she'll be late if she doesn't get up soon. Yet Cyra has a knack for making it right on time while Azar will wake up hours early and somehow still be late.

She was a bit envious of Cyra's talent. While Azar was thinking she began to hear Cyra begin to snore. "Cy wake up!" Usually, Azar would just drag her out of bed but Cyra has learned if she's
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holding Catra, Azar wouldn't dare. Luckily Azar has her ways. Azar walked around to the other side of the bed and snuck her arm around Catra and slowly pulled her back. Cyra noticed the missing warmth but before she could react Azar leaped over Catra and physically dragged Cyra out of bed. Leaving Catra none the wiser as she remained asleep.

"Azar!" She just smiled.

"Good morning!" Cyra finally stood up as she rubbed her eyes and dusted her sleepwear.

"I swear." Azar laughed as she noticed Cyra's hair in disarray.

"Looking good. I'm sure those privileged assholes will love it."

"Ha. Ha." Cyra took a deep breath as she pushed her hair back out of her face. She then groggily got up and went to the restroom to at least try and look decent. Azar just watched her leave into the bathroom and then jumped slightly when she heard rustling on the bed.

Azar saw Catra reaching out towards the spot where Cyra was and then began to open her eyes when she felt nothing there. "Mrrp?" Azar felt legit pain from the way her heart clenched. She hastily walked over to her kit as she began to rub her eyes. Azar then began to run her fingers through her hair.

"Sorry did we wake you?" Catra sat up with a yawn.

"Wheres, mom?" Azar noticed Catra's voice was a bit rougher than usual.

"Throwing a fit." Catra just nodded. "Are you leaving?" Azar smiled.

"Nope, I'm free all day!" Catra's ears perked up.

"Can...can we hang out?"

"Of course!" Catra smiled which turned into a yawn causing Azar to chuckle. "But first you can sleep a while. Luckily you don't have to deal with stupid early meetings." Catra just nodded and laid on Azar, who simply picked her up a bit so she could be laying down on the bed with her. Catra was back to sleep, this time on Azar's right shoulder. Azar had a soft smile on her face as she combed Catra's hair back with her hand.

She found herself asking how she got here. She doesn't fool herself by saying things like she was a good person and deserves this. Though she will be forever grateful for what she has.

Shortly after the bathroom door opens to reveal a more put-together Cyra. Though her face made it obvious she much rather be passed out in bed. Speaking of. "How is this fair that you get to stay in bed?" Cyra said enviously. Azar just smiled.

"Last I checked I wasn't allowed to attend meetings with Grell. I have no idea why though..."

"Still not fair." Azar laughed as Cyra went to their dresser.

"Try starting a fight during a meeting that's how I got let off." Cyra rolled her eyes as she began to take off her sleep shirt to get ready for the day. Azar whistled only for it to be cut short as Cyra threw a shirt at her face.

"Shush you." Azar just laughed. Cyra was putting on her necklace when she looked to the window and noticed how late it was. "Oh, stars I'm gonna be late!"

She rushed around then gave Catra a quick kiss on the head and another to Azar. "Love you stay out of trouble!" And Cyra retreated out the door. Azar rolls her eyes fondly as she continues to caress Catra's head.

"I swear she'll run herself to an early grave with all this stress." Of course, she got no response from the bundle of warmth on her. Azar wasn't tired but she knew if she started getting up and

about, Catra would say she was not tired just to be able to follow Azar around.

Though she would never deny an offer to just lay down with her kit while the light brightened outside the window.

Azar didn't know how long she remained in this peaceful state till she felt Catra begin to toss and turn. Azar also noticed her breathing was labored. Azar's first thought was she's having a nightmare but when she felt her head it was obvious she had a fever.

"Shit." Cyra was usually the responsible one. Azar has no idea where to even start when it comes to taking care of someone when they're sick. Catra starts to make distressed sounds in her sleep and kicks off the blanket over her. Azar panics.

"Liz? Wake up." Azar shook her a bit and she opened her eyes slightly but they were glazed over and she went back to sleep with her ears to her head. Azar tried again but got the same reaction. She thought back to what she did whenever she was sick but she usually just slept and let her Magicat healing do the rest. Though there was one time she was sick.
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"Sleeping it off does nothing but weaken your immune system more so stop being a nuisance and take the medicine!"
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Despite remembering the annoyance Azar's...friend had with her at the time it still didn't stop the smile from coming to her face. Catra then began coughing bringing Azar back to the present. 'Right medicine and uhh get a doctor!' Azar hastily left the room and went to the medical wing.

Catra woke up when she felt as if she couldn't breathe. She had a coughing fit and couldn't breathe out her nose because it was all clogged. She opened her eyes and everything was spinning. 'Why does everything hurt?' That was her only thought. She reached up and felt her head and almost gasped at her body temperature.

She recognized these symptoms. Kyle once was like this and he couldn't hide it well enough. These people came in the night and took him somewhere. Three days later he wasn't sick and was brought back. He never told anyone where he went. He never got sick again. Catra looked around and noticed her moms were nowhere to be found. She knew her mom had a meeting but her momma said she was free all day. Not to mention she was just laying with Catra.

Part of her was sad she left but a much bigger part of her was relieved. 'She didn't see me be weak' Catra knows this is just what she was raised to believe. The chances of her parents sharing the same mindset are slim to nothing but her body reacts first and she's up and trying to find a place to hide.

'Just don't let them see.'
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"Liz?!"

"How did you lose your fucking kid?!"

"I asked for help, not judgment!" Leo rolled their eyes as they looked through the closet. "Seriously she couldn't have gotten far so just relax," Azar growled. "She's sick! She shouldn't be up and moving!" Leo stood up and looked to Azar who was tearing her bed apart looking for the kit. "Calm down, let's just get Cyra and she'll get the guards to do a sweep of the castle-" Azar was up in Leo's face as they tried to turn to the door. "We can't! This meeting has been postponed for months! It's super important to Cy."

"More important than you kid?"

"Of course not but... let's- give me twenty minutes! If I can't fund her by then I'll get Cy." Leo stared skeptically at her. "Please, Leo. Let me try." Leo groaned and walked out the door. "Twenty

minutes! She better be back in this room!" Azar let out a sigh of relief. 'Thank the stars.' Azar knew Catra most likely wasn't in the room but had no idea where else she could be, she didn't even know why she ran in the first place?!

Azar took a deep breath and thought hard about any reason as to why Catra left. When Azar didn't see her upon walking in she had just assumed she was in the bathroom but that theory quickly fell apart. Azar decided standing around doing nothing is pointless so she begins to try and hunt her kit down. She got Catra's scent easily and followed it down the hall.

"Damn it!" It ended at a dead end. She rubbed her nose harshly. "Stupid nose. Getting my hopes up for nothing." Maybe sniffing all those 'potions' when she was younger was a bad idea...

She started going down a mental checklist of where Catra could be, the library, training grounds, even her room, but she couldn't find her. Azar looked to a clock in the hallway and mentally cursed. 'How the hell do I only have five minutes?!' Now Azar was sprinting throughout the castle. 'Shit shit shit where could she be?!'

She decided to retrace her steps and try to find her scent again but it just led her to the same dead end. 'She has to be here!' Then Azar's ears twitched when she heard a sneeze as she turned to leave. She stopped everything and began to look around. She then notice pillars lining the walls and noticed scratch marks leading up. Her eyes followed the trail and saw Catra laying on an archway on the ceiling.

Azar leaped up the pillar, but lost her grip and had to dig her claws in. 'Cy is gonna kill me.' Though that thought was pushed to the side as she saw Catra laying down on a beam that was barely wide enough for her not to fall off. Azar also noticed she looked worse than this morning.
'Why the hell is she up here?' She was curled up with her blue blanket and Azar could see the sheen of sweat from the distance.

She carefully walked across the beam and crouched down and grabbed the kit.

She just let out a groan as Azar placed a palm to her head. 'She's burning up.' Azar wanted to just carry her down but the only way Azar could climb down while holding her is if she was clinging onto her back, or throwing her over her shoulder. "Liz, wake up." She gently shook Catra. She saw her eyes open slightly and once they saw Azar she just clenched her eyes shut and buried her head under the blanket. "Liz come on. Seriously you're going to only feel worse if we don't get you some medicine." Catra just ignored her keeping her face hidden in the blanket he thoughts of being just, 'don't look at me! I don't want you to think I'm weak.'

Azar refused to leave her like this. "Liz, just grab onto my back and I'll carry you back."

"No!"

Azar recoils a bit. This was the first time since returning Catra has not only yelled but said no to her. Azar had to blink a few times to even register it. "This isn't the first time I've been sick, I do just fine on my own so just leave!" Azar just frowned. 'She shouldn't have had to deal with it on her own...' Azar sat next to her while her legs dangle off the edge.

It was silent for a while until Catra realized Azar hadn't left. Her mane of hair peaked out as she look at Azar over her blanket. "Why are you still here?" Azar cringed a bit at how her voice sounded like sandpaper. "I'm not leaving without you." Catra huffed.

"Well, you're gonna be here a while." Azar laughed.

"You know damn well your mother will be on her way the second she can't find you." Catra didn't respond and just laid down her breathing growing heavy as she began coughing.

Azar wanted to try and wait Catra out but she couldn't stand it. "Okay this is serious please just come with me. We can go to the

doctor and they can help you." Catra felt her body go tense at the mention of a doctor. 'No, they hurt. I don't want to go!' Azar looked and noticed Catra's eyes filling with tears as she shook. Azar went to grab her. "Liz-"

"No! I told you I can handle it myself! I-I don't want to- I don't want to go to a doctor again!" Azar backed away slightly. 'What does she mean? We've only ever taken her to the doctor when she was way younger why would- oh.'

Azar didn't have to know exactly what happened but judging by what she knows about the Hordes treatment of her daughter she could fit the pieces together. "Alright. No doctors, promise." Catra turned to her mom and Azar's heart broke upon seeing her tear-stained face. Azar scooted over to Catra and offered her arm. Catra has an internal battle with herself but ultimately gives in to the offer of kindness.

Azar pulls her close as she runs her hands through her hair. "Will you please just come with me? No doctors, I just want to get you some medicine so you'll feel better." Catra just shook her head.

"We were... supposed to hang out today..." Azar sighed.

"Do you really wanna hang out when you're not feeling well?" Catra didn't acknowledge the question.

"Are you mad?" Azar laughed,

"of course not." Catra smiled only to be interrupted by a coughing fit. Azar just patted her back until it stopped. "You know if you come with me I'll get you some medicine, you'll feel better, and maybe you'll feel better tomorrow and we can hang out then, how does that sound?" Catra looked at her.

"Okay." Azar smiled and turned her back to her.

"Alright hop on and hold on tight." Catra followed the instructions and when Azar knew she was secure made her way down.

Catra felt her eyes grow heavy as Azar walked down the hall her arm holding Catra's legs as best she can. Her tail wrapped around her to keep her secured to Azar's waist as she felt Catra drifting to sleep.

"What do you mean she's lost?!" Leo realized that being the one to tell Cyra Catra is missing was probably a bad idea. "Well, Azar said she woke up sick and went to get medicine-"

"She's sick?!"

Leo's only thought was 'I don't get paid enough.' Luckily Cyra just rushed past Leo and was heading back to her room. 'I'm gonna kill her!' She slammed open the door and started yelling. "How on Etheria did you lose-"

"Shh!"

"Do not 'shh' me!" Azar pulled back the blanket and Cyra stopped in her tracks as she saw her kit resting soundly. Cyra rushed over to the bed and felt her head. There were signs of a slight fever but it wasn't nearly as bad as before. Cyra looked to her wife who just smiled sheepishly back. Cyra gestured to the door.

Azar knew what that meant. 'Shit' she followed Cyra out the door and the second it was closed Cyra's arms were crossed. "Why didn't you tell me she was sick?"

"Kits get sick all the time. I didn't think it was something worth interrupting your meeting."

"And losing her?"

"Okay, I left for like two seconds!"

"Why didn't you come to get me?"

"I'm her mother too okay? I can handle some things on my own." Cyra took a deep breath as she pinched the bridge of her nose.

"I-I know, but I could've helped." Azar pouted.

"I handled it didn't I? Please Cy can you just have faith in me for once?" Cyra gawked for a moment.

"Azar I always have faith in you-"

"You don't act like it."

"Azar." Cyra pulled her chin to look her in the eyes. Azar kicked herself for how easily she leaned into her. Cyra then placed her head to Azar's. "I know for a fact you do everything you can to take care of Elizabeth. Even though you sometimes don't even know where to start. I sometimes forget I have you as support and I go back to thinking I have to do everything myself. That's not fair to you and I never intended to make you feel as if I don't have faith in you. Honestly, I don't think I could've made it this far without you."

Cyra's hand drifts from Azar's face to her hand and their fingers interlocked as Azar leaned down to kiss her wife. Cyra smiled into the kiss and her other hand went to the back of Azar's neck as she pulled her in. Call it cliche but Azar always feels as if she rules the world when Cyra kisses her, the only thought going through her mind being. 'Ha! Look how hot my wife is! I get to kiss her whenever I want and I have a cute ass kid!' All of which is true in Azar's opinion. Speaking of, Azar relaxed more into Cyra's soft lips as she began to deepen the kiss which to her surprise Cyra allowed. Azar released Cyra's hand to grab her cheek and pull her in.

Azar then began to nib at Cyra's bottom lip hoping Cyra will allow just a little bit more. Intimacy between the couple has been nothing more than pecks as of recently, then Cyra pulled back and whispered with amusement in her voice. "Gonna have to try harder than that." Azar practically buzzed with the challenge. She was back on Cyra's lips and the sound Cyra made at the contact was pure bliss.

Azar tried sucking on Cyra's lip but she didn't budge and even had the nerve to smirk about it. Azar decided to play dirty while Cyra was occupied with Azar's mouth she sneaked her hand behind Cyra's back. She then went to the base of her tail and with two fingers pressed on the two points where her tail meets her back and Cyra let out a small moan giving Azar her chance to ravage Cyra's mouth. She didn't complain as Cyra gripped Azar's hair and pulled slightly to get Azar to release a few groans of her own.

"I love you- mmh! So much." Cyra said between kisses to which Azar smiled as she began to kiss down her jaw, her hand now gripping at Cyra's thigh. "I have that effect." Cyra felt her body tense at her voice that turned rough. Cyra placed her hands on Azar's face who was looking up at her from where her headrest at Cyra's chest, which was heaving from her loss of breath. "You're supposed to say, I love you too."

Azar stood back up and ghosted over Cyra's lips. "I love you too." Cyra's eyes were watching Azar's lips intently, hanging off every syllable. Not noticing the hand on her thigh had pushed her leg up and Azar was now between her legs with her hand tensing.

Cyra got impatient and pulled Azar the remaining distance just to get her back to what she was previously doing. Cyra's tail also wrapped around Azar's waist to make sure she remained as close as possible. Though she still wrapped her arms around her neck to make sure. Azar's thoughts became clouded with lust as she temporarily forgot where she was and her hand that was on Cyra's thigh began to rub up and down her leg and then placed her hand into the cutouts of Cyra's pants.

'Stars I love these pants.' Cyra seemed to agree as she pushed herself more into Azar's touch. "Azar, please-mmmh..." Azar just covered Cyra's sounds with her mouth though she felt the vibrations of the moans going into her mouth and she craved it. Cyra then began to dig her claws into Azar's neck. "Fuck, I love you"

"Hey Azar is Liz oka-" everything froze as Leo walked into the hall bright red and dumbfounded. "We're kinda busy if you don't mind-" Cyra pushed Azar off her and straightened herself out ignoring Azar's complaints. "Leo, yes she's fine! I was just going to go check on her!" Cyra then rushed into the room closing the door behind her.

Leo then smacked Azar on the back of the head. "Seriously? In the hallway!"
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Chapter End Notes

So excited for old Halfmoon! As always leave comments and I'll try to respond to them as soon as possible!
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Race you

Chapter Notes

> Legit finished this chapter up on my break! Love all of the support I've been shown and it really makes my day seeing all the nice comments. I know I sound like a broken record but thank you and I hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora nodded. For some reason, her voice wouldn't come out. Catra just laughed as she opened her balcony door. She seemed to check the surroundings before gesturing for Adora to follow. Catra then jumped onto the balcony railing and before Adora could ask what she was doing she jumped down into a bush.

"Catra!" Adora yelled though it was hushed. Catra just smiled.

"It's fine it's like landing on a pillow." Adora did not like this idea but decided to just go for it. Once she jumped Catra teased.

"Don't miss!"

Adora then flailed wildly suddenly scared. Though once she landed face first in the Bush she felt foolish. Catra laughing at her didn't help either.

"Come on you look stupid down there." Adora pouted at Catra who started plucking the sticks out of her hair. She then offered a hand which Adora took. Catra then got serious as her ears perked up tracking every little sound. Luckily Catra's room was right above the gardens. Catra recalled the time her mother took her through the passage when she found out Catra had followed her trying to sneak with her to Mystacore.

Catra smiled at the memory. She quickly head to the back of the gardens where what looked like a bush was pushed aside. Catra then did a dramatic bow to Adora.

"After you princess." Adora just rolled her eyes.

"Oh please." She then walked through. Catra then turned her head facing the direction they came from. She didn't know why but...

Something felt wrong.

Cyra was currently getting ready to go to sleep, she took off her necklace and placed it in the case next to Azar's. Cyra smiled. There wasn't a purpose in getting them. Their marriage was already legitimate when they exchanged items, but despite Azar's protest that she isn't a romantic, she got them anyway.

Speaking of, Azar was currently on their shared bed reading. Cyra smiled as she sat down on the bed. Like instinct, Azar put her book down and pulled Cyra to lay with her.

"About time. I was starting to think sleep was foreign to you."

Cyra rolled her eyes. "You say that but last I checked you were the one who let me sleep in till dinner."

"You're welcome." Cyra just shoved Azar lightly.

"Idiot." Azar then wrapped her arm around her.

"You idiot!" Azar then started rubbing her head along Cyra's cheek.

"Azar!" Cyra laughed at her antics.

They eventually calmed down as the lights went out and a calm silence encased the couple. Cyra wasn't very tired since she had a literal cat nap not even hours before, but she was still tempted with sleep when Azar rubbed her arm and purred softly.

"I've thought about it."

Azar must've been on the edge of sleep because she only responded with a half-hearted, 'hmm?' Cyra curled into Azar.

"About going to Mystacore, with Elizabeth." Azar failed at hiding her excitement but tried to keep it out of her voice.

"What did you decide?" Cyra sighed.

"Maybe... this can be a better way to give her some freedom without letting her join the rebellion. Besides, your dad is bound to be there right? I'm sure Elizabeth would like to meet him." Cyra looked up to Azar trying to gauge her reaction but was cut off by Azar kissing her.

Cyra barely had time to process before Azar pulled back.

"Really? Like, really, really really?!"

Cyra laughed. "Yes but I'd still like for there to be precautions." Azar tackled Cyra in a hug.

"Yep, anything! Oh, I can't wait, oh I have to go write them back saying we'll be there." Cyra pulled Azar back to bed.

"In the morning." Azar blinked and remembered it was the middle of the night.

"Oh right, yeah." Cyra just laughed at her wife. If she'd known she would've gotten this reaction she would've said yes sooner. Sadly all happy moments must come to an end.

A firm knock came from the door. It seemed all of Cyra's happy moments were stopped with a knock at the door.

Cyra looked to Azar silently asking if she was expecting someone but Azar just shrugged as she stood up and walked to the door. She regretted opening it when she saw who it was.

"Grell, to what do we owe the pleasure?" Grell didn't acknowledge her and instead looked to Cyra.

"I have some news about princess Elizabeth."

"Catra?"

She snapped out of her daze and looked back to Adora who was a few steps ahead of her.

"Yeah, sorry I'm coming."

Catra let the vines fall behind her. After a few steps, the tunnel begins to grow dark. Catra went to just use her light spell. However, Adora already pulled out her sword which let off a blue glow. Adora smirked at Catra's face.

"Show off." Adora laughed as she followed Catra down the tunnel. The heavy footsteps of Adora are the only sound.

"Crazy to think these tunnels go throughout Etheria," Adora said nervously.

Catra nodded. "Yeah but it's not very helpful since nobody can navigate it. The only reason I know this path is because I marked it. The way my momma found it was thanks to some old text in Mystacore."

"Mystacore?" Catra turned to Adora.

"It's basically where all the sorcerers hang out. My momma visits frequently. She used to teach there too."

"That's cool. I bet she was a good teacher." Catra chuckled.

"She got the position on accident. But she is a great teacher. Never say that to her though." Catra looked on the walls when they came to a split and followed the claw marks. Adora follows wordlessly.

"She told me about how your runestone works. It sounds crazy." Catra shrugged.

"I don't have much to compare it to besides Glimmer's." Adora then looked at her sword. 'I guess I can't judge too much, considering how weird this runestone works.' Catra then puts out her arm to stop Adora from walking.

"This is it."

In front of them is a ladder leading up.

"This goes to the center of the town square, so the second we're both out we have to quickly get out of sight. Got it?"

Adora nodded firmly and put on her hood seeing Catra do the same. Catra climbed up the ladder and came to a stop at the top when she tried pushing up the cover.

"Shit this is heavier than it looks." Adora came up behind her and put her hands to the lid as well. Then spoke to Catra.

"On three alright?" Catra got a bit distracted by how close Adora was but nodded dumbstruck. That seemed to be enough for Adora.

"Alright, one. Two. Three!" They both pushed and the lid went to the side. Catra quickly climbed up and offered a hand to Adora. Once she was out they both grabbed the lid and placed it back as quietly as they could.

Catra then grabbed Adora's hand rushing her to an alleyway. Adora went to speak but Catra quickly shook her head. Adora understood.

They kept to the shadows the whole time and whenever they had to cross brighter areas they were fast. Making it to the gate was almost easy.

Until Catra got too eager.

She saw it insight and just went straight for it. She didn't notice the guards coming her way. Luckily Adora did.

She snatched her arm and pulled her into an ally and covered her whole body with hers cornering her into a wall. Adora Kept her head down. Catra wondered what was happening till she heard the quiet footsteps.

Both of their breathing went shallow as they waited for them to walk away. Adora's eyes never left the guard's path concentrated. Catra couldn't be bothered. For some reason seeing Adora all protective of her made something flutter in her chest.

Not to mention Adora's hand subconsciously flexed on Catra's waist. Catra has never in her life been one for being flustered but Adora just did something for her and made her feel... warm.

Whilst Catra was panicking Adora finally let out a sigh of relief as the guards walked past. She then leaned her head down to whisper into Catra's ear. "Can you still hear them?"

Catra knows Adora was just being conscious of her voice but for some reason, her whispering in Catra's ear like that made something flare up in her. "Catra?"

Catra decided to just nod not trusting her voice. When Adora stepped back Catra expected herself to calm back down but instead, a wave of coldness went over her.

"Catra you okay?" Catra was confused on why she asked until she noticed her tail, which had a grip on Adora's leg.

"Come on." Catra dragged Adora to the gate chamber. Adora went to open the door but Catra quickly stopped her shaking her head. Then her eyes looked up. Adora looked up and didn't see anything so just shrugged at Catra.

Catra facepalmed and gestured for Adora to just follow her. They climbed up a ladder on a side building that was next to the

chamber and once on the roof Catra pointed to the chamber roof which was a good distance.

Catra leaped right onto it and turned around waiting for Adora.

Adora was never scared of heights but for some reason, she had a really bad feeling about this whole situation.

"Adora," Catra called, she looked up and Catra stood with a confidence Adora had only ever seen once before. Catra then smiled. "I'll catch you if you fall."

That's when she saw it. Adora remembered a similar situation when they first found their spot. Catra was so confident climbing up. She would always be the happiest when she was climbing or doing anything she had a talent for. Though she would always help me.

Always makes sure I never fall.

Adora nodded her head firmly and leaped over the gap.

Despite Azar being the one to open the door, Cyra was rushing forward.

"Grell what do you mean? What's wrong?" Azar tried to step in but Grell already knew he had Cyra's undivided attention.

"I hate to tell you this, but I have reason to believe princess Elizabeth is attempting to escape." Azar's face contorted to a sneer.

"Yeah, I'm sure." Azar didn't buy it for a second. Cyra was hanging on to every word.

"What? No, there's no way." Azar went to comfort her but Grell stopped any chance right then.

"I heard it myself." Cyra went to leave the room to check on her daughter but Azar stopped her then and there.

"Cy, can I talk with you? Alone." Azar glared at Grell harshly. Grell put his hands up in mock surrender.

"As you wish. I mean the longer we're here the farther Elizabeth will be but, sure take your time." Azar felt herself grow angry. Grell always knew exactly what to say to get to Cyra. Before Cyra could object Azar spoke.

"Great thanks, now excuse us." Azar slammed the door shut in his face and looked to Cyra, who had her eyes trained on the door. "Cy." Her eyes didn't move her tail waving warily while she was picking at her claws.

"Maybe we shouldn't waste time. Checking can only do more good than harm." Azar stopped her then and there.

"Cy, seriously." Azar grabbed her shoulder and made her look into her eyes. "Liz promised. Have you ever known her to break a promise?" Cyra shook her head. "Right, so instead of just running in blindly throwing accusations let's just ask why Grell thinks that and we can go from there." Cyra nodded again.

She took a deep breath and finally started to relax. "Thank you." Azar smiled and kissed her on the head.

"Anytime."

Cyra then opened the door and stated firmly. "Why do you think she's trying to escape?" Grell smiled towards Azar.

"I heard her and... Adora. Talking about it in the library and the hallway." Cyra lost all of her confidence and Azar saw her physically restraining herself from running to Elizabeth to make sure she was still here.

"Liz promised she wouldn't attempt to escape anymore. We honor that more than some random accusation that has no evidence."

Grell chuckled a bit.

"Oh, I know Elizabeth would never break a promise. It's practically a guarantee, though..." Grell then looked right to Cyra. "...A bad influence can go a long way."

"Enough, we'll talk with Liz in the morning. Goodnight Grell." Azar then slammed the door in his face, flicking off Grell from behind the door. "The nerve of that guy! Could you believe..." Azar cut herself off when she saw Cyra's face.

Which was covered in doubt. "What if he's right? Maybe she hasn't made it out yet. Let's just go check." Azar stopped her.

"Cy, we'll talk with her in the morning."

"But-"

"If what Grell says is bullshit and you go storming into Liz's room and actively show her you don't trust her what do you think she'll feel like?"

Cyra's ears went down. "...But what if he's telling the truth?" Azar sighed.

"Then she'll be back by morning and we can ask her then."

"But what if she gets hurt?!"

Azar placed her hand on Cyra's cheek. "Cy, please. Let's just go to sleep and we'll see in the morning." Cyra sighed and tried to relax.

"Alright."

Azar smiled and went to lay down, Cyra followed as well and played with Azar who was already half asleep when her head hit the pillow. Cyra was amazed at how easily she could sleep. Cyra always had a hard time but now it was even harder as all the scenarios of 'what it?' Went through her head.

She doesn't know how long it took but she didn't want to know, she'd be embarrassed by how quickly she left the room.

She was just gonna check on Elizabeth. Just to calm her nerves.

"See? Worried over nothing." Catra said as she helped Adora up. She made the jump easily and fell over.

Then Catra's face got serious. "Alright, first things first take off your shoes."

"What why?"

"Because your footsteps are already loud as hell and those boots don't help." Adora pouted but complied anyway, unzipping her shoes and pulling them off. "Alright, you also need to stop stomping around. Light on your feet. You have to walk on your toes not just stomp. Once I open this hatch every noise we make can't be louder than a cough. Got it?"

Adora had a worried look on her face. Catra realized maybe this might be a bit harder for Adora than she thought. Catra thought for a moment. Her original plan wouldn't work well. 'It's fine. Plan B it is.'

"Okay, so we're going to plan B."

"We had a plan B?"

Catra groaned. "We do now. So I'm gonna go down. Alone. I'll distract them and when I signal you, jump down. You have to be quick. And most of all quiet!" Before Adora could ask questions Catra opened the hatch.

Catra then looked to Adora and nodded firmly. Then jumped down landing quietly. Adora was amazed at how soundless it was. Catra kept a level head.

She saw the gate right there. The Magicats were blindfolded and didn't seem to notice Catra. She looked around. The room was open. Which made plan B a lot harder. She hoped there would be a place to call them away.

'Shit.'

Catra crouched down and grabbed a pebble on the ground. 'Just test the waters.' She thought as she did a gentle throw to the corner. The second the stone hit the ground it was cut in half by a spear.

Catra didn't even have time to blink. 'They're fast. Way too fast.' Catra had to fight to keep her breath even. Catra knew she has a good chance but Adora...

Catra looked up to see Adora patiently waiting. 'We've already made it this far.' Catra through as she walked to the wall with her foot firmly placed against it. She inhales a deep breath.

"Now!"

Cyra stood at Catra's door. Her hand was raised to knock but she stopped herself. "She's probably asleep. Azar's right I'm worrying over nothing." Her body wouldn't let her walk away, however. She then groaned.

"Stars I'm such an idiot! Grell would probably say anything to get Adora into trouble." Cyra began to walk away. "I should just leave her be." Then that nagging voice came into her head.

'What if she's gone? What if she's alone in the whispering woods? What if the Horde found her again? Remember the last time you blindly trusted someone else?'

Cyra ran back to the door and knocked firmly before she could stop herself. "Elizabeth, are you in there?" She got no response. Cyra knocked again.

"Elizabeth please open the door." She then placed her hand on the handle. "Please." She opened the door went in and became choked by the silence. "Elizabeth?!" She looked in her bed and found nothing. "Sweetie if this is a prank you got me. Now come out." Cyra started to ransack the room.

"Elizabeth D'riluth this isn't funny!" Cyra's anger quickly went to worry. She's gone.

She's gone.

Cyra ran out of the room. 'I'll have Leo find her. I'll get the whole guard if I have to. Please don't be too late.' Her thoughts were cut off as she ran into someone. "Sorry."

"Cyra?" She saw Glimmer rubbing her eyes. She looked like she had just woken up. Her sleepiness quickly faded when she saw Cyra in an obvious state of panic. "Hey, what's wrong?"

"Elizabeth is missing! Grell warned us that he heard Adora and her making a plan to leave and I didn't listen! Now she who knows where! I'm getting the guard to look for her. If you could help that would be great! Oh, I knew I shouldn't have let the guard detail be lifted-"

"She's with me!" Cyra looked at Glimmer.

"What?"

Glimmer panicked. "Well Bow and I haven't had much time to see her so we decided to have a best friend squad sleepover! So she's in my room. Asleep. In my room. With Adora. In my room." Cyra blinked a few times then covered her face in her hands. "Sorry I didn't tell you."

"Oh, stars look at me. I have been worrying over nothing. After all that talk, I gave about how I trust her." Glimmer saw her out.

"Well if you need to see her I can go wake her up for you." Cyra gasped as she grabbed Glimmer.

"No! No thats- thank you but it's alright. I'm sorry. I've just...been on edge I guess." Glimmer felt bad for lying but she had faith that Adora could keep Catra safe. Besides she knew Catra would owe her one. "I'm sorry. I just need sleep, that's all." Glimmer nodded.

"Goodnight. I'll tell Catra to see you in the morning." Cyra smiled gratefully and left her room, beating herself up over this whole ordeal.

Meanwhile, Glimmer teleported to Bow.

"Bow wake up!" Bow sat up quickly.

"Huh?"

"Catra and Adora are gone!"

"Now!"

Adora jumped without hesitation. Once she landed on the floor she looked around and couldn't see Catra anywhere. She almost called out to her until she saw a blindfolded magicat standing over her.

'Shit.'

They didn't seem like they heard her. Adora carefully stepped back on the tips of her feet just trying to put space between her and the guard. 'Catra where are you?'

Adora hoped she didn't get caught. She looked around and noticed there was a group of them standing by a wall as if looking for something. I looked up and saw Catra clinging onto the roof, Adora could see her shaking from where she remained crouched.

Once Catra saw Adora she nodded her head towards the gate. A silent 'go.' Adora got to the doorway which was luckily had no door and led to a staircase.

Adora watched as Catra tried to jump down but due to the angle, it wouldn't be as easy. Adora noticed Catra's eyes begin to look around frantically.

Adora placed her boots that were in her hand on the floor. Then walked like Catra instructed her. It felt unsteady. Weird. Though it certainly was quiet. Catra saw and her only thought was, 'what the hell are you doing?'

Adora then got under her with her arms out. 'Jump!' Was the look Adora gave to Catra. Adora then saw the guards begin to go back to their stations, and one was walking right towards Adora. If they went back to their post the door would be a lot harder to get through.

Adora looked back up to Catra. 'Jump!' Catra hated this. She hated relying on people. What if Adora made too much noise? What if they get caught? What will her mom say?

Catra looked to Adora and despite the situation had that smile on her face. The same one she'd always give Catra whenever she was scared. The one that always said. 'We look out for each other.'

Catra clenched her eyes shut. 'I'm gonna regret this.' She then let go of the ceiling and as Adora caught her, she crouched down to avoid making too much noise from catching her and bracing herself. Adora then placed Catra down, who was still trying to process what just happened but Adora didn't let her as she dragged her out the door grabbing her boots on the way out.

Adora kept walking up the steps with Catra behind her slightly, both refusing to talk until they were certain they were out of the hearing range of the Magicats.

Catra then saw a red step. The second she and Adora were across it she collapsed to the floor breathing heavily. Catra saw Adora reach for her sword. "It's alright... that step marks the farthest they can hear. We're safe." Adora let out her sigh of relief and came to Catra's side.

"You alright?" Catra nodded.

"Yeah just... that was way too close for comfort." They laughed.

"Oh definitely." Adora sat down leaning against the wall. "I thought we were dead for sure." Catra just laughed, but it was cut short by a quick intake of breath. Adora noticed. "You okay?" Catra was cradling her leg. Adora saw a tear in her pants.

"Yeah, I'm fine." Adora disregarded Catra's words and went to look for herself. "Adora!"

"Shit Catra you're bleeding!" Catra rolled her eyes. It was a shallow cut and was barely bleeding.

"I'm fine Adora." Catra tried easing her nerves but Adora didn't look convinced. Catra flicked her head.

"Ow!"

"Stop worrying dummy! I just underestimated how fast they were. I should've started climbing the second I screamed and not after." Adora huffed but when she looked at the cut she calmed down. It wasn't as bad as Adora thought it was when she saw Catra get hurt.

Catra seemed to feel better because she was back on her feet. "Alright now, all we have to do is just... walkout." Catra could see the end of the tunnel from where she stood. Adora nodded and started walking up, Catra not far behind her.

However, once they came to the last step Catra hesitated. Adora noticed. "Hey, you alright?" Catra let out a small laugh.

"Yeah, it's just... I never thought I'd make it this far if I'm being honest." Adora playfully bumped her shoulder.

"Come on give yourself more credit." Catra sighed as she looked to the wall separating her and the world she's been trying to go to for years. She looked to Adora who was smiling brightly.

Catra then made a sprint for the wall. "Race you there!"

"Cheater!"

Chapter End Notes

Coming next chapter: Old Halfmoon!

Broken thrones

Chapter Notes

> I wanted so badly to have Catra's birthday line up with the birth day chapter but alas it was not meant to be. So Happy early birthday Catra and I hope to see you guys next week enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

"What do you mean they're gone?" Glimmer groaned.

"What do you think I mean? Poof. Gone. Vanished. Not. Here!"

Bow finally began to wake up properly. "Do you have any idea where they went?" Glimmer shook her head.

"No. I just saw Cyra and she said C' was missing and then Grell said he heard Adora and her talking about trying to escape."

"Cyra knows? The whole guard is probably all over the place!" Glimmer looked away guiltily. "Glimmer?"

"I lied and said we had a best friend squad sleepover and so she thinks she and Adora are in here." Bows eyes popped out of his head.

"What! Glimmer do you realize how bad that is? Not only did you lie to the queen but, you are now an accomplice to treason! And now you told me... I'm an accomplice to an accomplice!" Bow was now up and pacing the room.

"I can't go to jail Glimmer! Halfmoon has legit cells!" Glimmer stood up.

"Bow calm down!"

"You can't tell me to calm down when you aren't calm!" Glimmer groaned and then took a deep breath.

"You're right. I'm calm." Bow took a deep breath of his own and after a while of silence, Glimmer spoke. "Alright, let's stick to the story. If I know C she'll try and be back before she has to meet with her mom. So... let's just wait until then. And try to hunt her down before Cyra can get to her."

Bow nodded and sat back down on his bed. "You're gonna give me gray hairs by twenty." Glimmer laughed.

"Aww cheer up at least you're never bored!"

Despite Catra running out first, Adora caught up fairly quickly. "So unfair!" Adora joked but got no response. She saw Catra just staring up at the rising sun peeking over the horizon. Adora smiled. "Cool right?" Catra nodded wordlessly and Adora allowed her a moment to just look around. Catra then began walking through the woods, Adora not far behind her.

"It's pretty," Catra said causing Adora to laugh.

"You think everything is pretty." Catra shoved her shoulder.

"Shut up!"

"So, where to?" Just like that Catra suddenly remembered why she and Adora were out here and pulled a map out of the satchel on her hip. Catra took a moment to look at it then pointed in a direction.

"That way!" Catra was practically skipping with her walk. Adora just was happy seeing her happy. They walked while exchanging stories and Adora had a fun time explaining who Razz was and how much she has helped her.

Then all of a sudden Catra stopped talking and turned her head when she saw a ditch. "What's wrong?" Catra then turned to the right and started walking. "Wait Catra you said it was this way!" Adora followed her and nearly tripped on an uproot.

Catra finally acknowledged Adora's questions. "I remember this!" Adora just tilted her head at that. Then all made sense when she saw a crashed skiff with the faded numbers one and four. Adora was surprised it was still visible. "What's this?"

Adora looked to where she was looking. It was Adora's sad excuse for a memorial. Adora quickly walked up to it next to Catra. "Oh um... I found the skiff when I first left and, I thought you were dead so I... did that. I know it's not much but I didn't want to-" Catra wrapped Adora in a tight hug, one Adora returned instantly.

"What's this for? You know you're not dead right?" Adora joked but Catra just hugged her tighter.

"I know. It's just... that was nice of you. Thank you." Adora didn't know how to respond so she just gripped Catra tighter leaning her head into her.

Catra then backed away and gave a fake cough. "Any way to old Halfmoon!" Adora's hands were still up as if Catra was still in her arms and the warmth Catra brought her still lingered. "Adora? come on!" Adora snapped out of her stupor.

"Right sorry!" Then ran to catch up to the feline.

Catra age:2
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"Alright make sure to feed her right at two she gets fussy if she isn't. Also, make sure to give her plenty of water in the morning because her throat gets dry. Don't forget-"

"Cy, will you relax? We're only gonna be gone for a weekend Leo's got this right?" Leo thought they had this but Cyra was making them double guess.
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Azar gave a not-so-subtle 'say yes!' "Uh, yeah I got this." Before Cyra could say more Azar grabbed her.

"See now come on Cy, Angella is waiting!" Cyra frowned as she was dragged along.

"Wait!" Cyra slipped out of Azar's grip and went to Catra who was in Leo's arms. She gave Catra a quick kiss to the head, which caused Catra to laugh and reach for her mom.

"Cy." She dropped her head and began to walk back to her wife. Then turned around to say something but Azar just dragged her by her hand. "Come on Cy."

"Love you sweetie we'll be back as soon as we can!" Catra gave wave-making nonsensical noises towards her mom's. Leo sighed as they looked down at the kit in their arms.

"Alright, it's just you and me." Catra just looked up at them and blinked then started laughing. Leo then dropped their head. "This is gonna be a long weekend." Leo then walked back into the palace with the kit trying to pull at Leo's hair. "Will you please stop that?"

Catra just stared up at them causing Leo to groan. "Honestly why do I bother? You can't comprehend a single thing I'm saying, dumb baby." Catra poked Leo's eye. "Ow!"

Catra then started laughing- a little too hard in Leo's opinion. "Uhgg." Leo then went into Catra's room and placed her down on her play mat. "Just stay here and play I've got shit to do." Leo left the room planning on sending a maid to keep an eye on her till Leo almost tripped over Catra.

"What- how did you?" Catra then started to climb up Leo. "Hey!" Leo then grabbed her and opened the door again. "Stay here!" Leo placed Catra down and closed the door. "What a-ahh!" Leo looked down and saw Catra clinging to their leg. "Stop it."

Catra just stared up at them. "Uhggg, fine!" Leo then picked her up. "But I have a lot of stuff to do so just sit and be quiet." Catra pulled on their hair. "None of that," Leo said as they pulled Catra's hands away from their hair.

Leo walked to the gym wanting to meet up with Bowen to spar. When he saw Leo he smiled. "Hey, Leo you-" he stopped himself when he saw the kit in their arms. "Oh. My. Stars!" Bowen leaped over. "Is this Azar's kit? She's so cute!"

Leo rolled their eyes. "The cutest. Now you ready to get your ass kicked?" Bowen gasped.

"Leo not in front of the baby!"

Bowen was now waving his tail right out of Catra's reach as she attempted to grab it. Bowen was smitten with her. 'Stars above.' Leo then pulled Catra away and set her down on a bench. "Stay." Catra frowned at Leo then they went back to Bowen. Leo was relieved when Catra stayed put.

"Hey, we can reschedule if you need to watch her I don't mind."

"No! I mean... no we've been planning this for weeks and I need to work off some steam anyway. So stop being a wuss and fight me!" Leo didn't even give Bowen a chance to get into a fighting stance before they went in for a tackle.

"Hey, no fair!" Bowen said as he barely was able to dodge. Leo didn't seem to care because they were back on him in a second.

Bowen could tell something was bothering Leo the way they were fighting was much more aggressive than their usual fight style and Bowen didn't think this spar was all in good fun.

They traded punches, kicks, and anything in between. Bowen went in for a punch but Leo grabbed his arm and threw him to the ground Bowen went to fight back but got distracted by a sound of... cheering? which gave Leo the chance to pin him down and restrain his hands behind his back.

"I win." Leo then heard clapping and weird noises. They looked over and saw Catra frantically clapping and her version of cheering.

"Aw, you got a cheerleader!" Bowen said with half his face on the mat. Leo rolled their eyes as they got up and walked towards the kit, who met Leo halfway trying to crawl up them again. Leo gave some sympathy and picked her up.

They'll never admit the small smile that made its way onto their face. "Aww look at you being all lovey!" Leo's ears went down, their face going beat red.

"Shut up, I just kicked your ass so show some respect."

"Leo! Baby!"

Leo rolled their eyes. "Oh please, she can't understand a word I'm saying she can't even talk-"

"Ass!"

Leo's eyes went wide as they looked down at the kit in their arms giggling like crazy. "Ass!" Catra began repeating that word over and over laughing all the while. Bowen and Leo just stared at one another.

"Oh, Leo you are so dead."
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Adora's POV

I had to take the map from Catra. Not because she couldn't read it or she was going the wrong direction but she just kept getting distracted every second. Whether it be a bug, plant, or sometimes just the sky. I didn't mind though I loved seeing her look so happy.

The sun was finally starting to light everything up making the woods significantly less creepy. Though Catra disagreed. "Ahh!
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Too bright!" I laughed as I saw Catra covering her eyes and turning away from the sun.

"Come on Catra your being...dramatic." as I was talking Catra moved her hands and I found talking difficult as I saw the sun completely encase Catra in a soft glow and her eyes were practically sparkling.

"That thing is a headache!" I snapped back to my senses at Catra's words and found myself giggling at her. Only she could compare something like a sun to nothing more than a headache. Then she went up to climb the trees. I just rolled my eyes as I continued on the path to old Halfmoon. Catra staying close from up above.

I squinted at the faded map. Suddenly Catra was right above me hanging from the tree upside down. "Hey Adora, how's it hanging?" I laughed.

"Seriously letting me do all the hard work? That is low even for you." Catra smirked as she leaped down and was face to face with me.

"Aww, you know nothing's too low for me." I felt my heart skip a beat. Then she just laughed as she continued forward. Well, that was...something. "Adora I think I see it!" I shake my head and follow through the bush.

I don't know what I expected old Halfmoon to look like but, this wasn't it. The entrance was nothing more than crumbled pillars and vines overgrown over them all the buildings were missing walls and or roofs. The only place that seemed still recognizable was the castle up the path.

Catra was no longer the cheerful ray of sunshine as she walked solemnly through the derbies. I stayed close behind her. "I- wow. It, destroyed." I just nodded.

Catra then walked to one of the still-standing buildings deciding to explore the inside. I went to follow but quickly turned around

when I heard something move. I stayed like that for a good moment before relaxing. "I'm going crazy."

"Hey, Adora come look!" I followed into the building and saw Catra on the floor going through a box. I sat next to her trying to see.

"What is it?"

"It's my mom." I looked at the picture and sure enough, there was Cyra with who I assumed was Grell. They couldn't have been more than ten. I looked over and saw Catra smiling.

She then jumped up. "This must've been Grell's house! Let's see if we can find any dirt on him!" Before I could object Catra had begun to rummage through the home. I rolled my eyes and decided to continue looking in the box for more photos.

I figured Grell had some relation to Cyra but they had been friends for a long time. I went through the photos and the most recent one was of Cyra and Azar along with Grell and another woman I've never seen before.

"Hey, Catra?"

"Yeah?" Catra came from another room and came up to me.

"What's up?" I showed her the picture.

"Who's that? Standing next to Grell?" Catra tilted her head at the paper.

"I think it's Vivianne's mom."

"You think?" Catra nodded.

"She died right after giving birth to Vivianne so I never met her. Though judging by the spots I think it's safe to say that's Vivianne's mom." I found myself feeling bad for Vivianne. Catra must've seen that because in the next moment I was pulled to my

feet. "Let's go look at the Castel, I don't trust these roofs." I just followed Catra without a word.

I walked behind her and then suddenly heard a Crack below my foot. I stopped and lifted it just to see a now shattered picture frame. Catra turned around and looked at the picture.

I stepped back as Catra grabbed the frame to get a better look at it. "Do you know them?" Catra tilted her head at it.

"Kinda. I'm pretty sure this was my old caretaker. Think his name was Lewis."

I waited to let her continue. "I mean this is him no doubt but I don't know who the other people are." I looked back at the picture. It was pretty obvious to me he was holding a small kit and with what I assumed was his husband's arm wrapped around him.

"That must be his family." Catra shook her head.

"That's the thing, he said he had no living family that he knew of." I shrugged.

"Well, why don't you ask him when we go back?"

"I would but he went missing years ago. He just up and vanished. Without a trace." That sounds weird but Catra just sighed.

"Come on." I nodded as I carefully avoided the glass and marched on being more aware of my surroundings from thereon.

The Castel was different from the one I've become accustomed to but there were obvious similarities. The tall pillars, wide pathways, and gorgeous architecture. However, instead of being made of the tan stone is was gray, aged by years of no maintenance. We both came to the door which was imposing, to say the least, not only I'm its size but as well as in the dark oak.

Catra goes to open it but struggled. "A little help?" I nodded and got a grip on the door. I braced myself guessing the door had inflated due to rain and was now stuck in the door frame. So I was put a lot of strength behind my pull.

Only for the door to open easily and for me to fall to the ground. Catra was laughing so hard. "Ha! I can't believe you fell for that... literally!" Her joke just made her laugh even harder.

I just ignored her as I stood up and dusted myself off. "Come on Catra I can't believe you're still pulling such childish and immature- is that a mouse!"

"What where?!"

I found myself having a hard time breathing I was laughing so hard. I looked and saw Catra's fur puffed up and her eyes pinpricks. Which made me laugh harder than I knew possible.

"I can't believe that still works!" Catra smoothed out her fur as she pouted.

"Will you ever let it go? It was one time!" I found myself laughing all over again. Catra just rolled her eyes as she walked into the Castel. I followed behind her wiping tears from my eyes, still chuckling.

We both entered and it was obvious this was the throne room. Catra wasted little time as she practically ran up to it. She sat down on it a got a smug grin on her face.

"Bow before your queen!" She said in a dramatic stuck-up voice I just laughed as I gave a dramatic bow.

"Why of course your royal fluffiness," I said in my dramatic tone I saw Catra roll her eyes and stick her tongue out at me as I stood back up looking at the surroundings. The Halfmoon insignia was on banners lining the tall walls, though torn and aged.

I then noticed deep-rooted scratch marks on the wall. Before I could think about them Catra was behind me. "Whatcha looking at?"

"Nothing."

Catra shrugged and began to go through a large set of double doors. "Hey look!" Catra then pointed to the door which looked like it had been rammed in one spot.

"That's weird." Catra then started laughing. I tilted my head at her.

"My moms told me about this. I was running and when Leo tried to grab me I dodged and they went face-first into the wall." Catra then felt the wood. "I wonder what other memories I could find."

"Let's go find out." Catra looked up to me as I offered my hand to her without thinking. I saw her stare at it for a moment and felt myself lose confidence. Before I could pull my hand away Catra grasped it tightly.

"Lead the way."

Adora and Catra walled through the halls laughing at portraits and overall enjoying all of the cool things Catra pointed out to Adora. Then as they were laughing Catra suddenly came to a stop as she saw a connecting room.

It was trashed. There were obvious signs of a struggle as well. The curtains hanging over the windows were torn, the carpet out of place, and furniture thrown about. Though the thing Catra noticed most

Was the dried blood on the floor. "Catra?" She didn't listen to Adora, as if transfixed on the blood.

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Flashes of...something came to Catra's mind. 'Was it a memory? That doesn't make any sense my moms told me I got captured shortly after I left Leo. There's no way I could've made it back here.' Catra felt a cold chill go over her body. She didn't know why but her fur started standing up and she felt uneasy.

"Catra?"

She turned her head around and hissed on instinct causing Adora to pull back. "Whoa. Hey, you alright?" Catra finally started to relax as she tried to even out her breathing. 'How'd I get so out of breath?'

"Yeah-yeah I'm fine it's just...I thought I saw something nothing to worry about. Come on let's go somewhere else." Adora could tell she was shaken up but decided against fighting her on it.

Catra went to the closest room which so happened to be the master room. "Hey let's see if we can find some blackmail!" Adora laughed as Catra went rummaging around. Relieved Catra was starting to act like her usual self.

Adora didn't want to snoop, feeling it was weird. She excused Catra because she was family. Then Adora saw a big piece of paper on a desk and couldn't help herself. It was rolled up nicely but still had a good amount of dust collecting on it.

Adora seemed to realize what she was doing and decided she should just leave it but Catra thought otherwise. "What are you waiting for? Open it!" Catra then began to hop in place slightly as she smiled. Adora rolled her eyes.

"Catra I'm not snooping into your mom's things." Catra frowned.

"Fine. I understand." Before Adora could smile back at her Catra took the piece of paper. "So I'll do it for you!"

"Cat-" too late Catra had already opened it and
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It was a map. A map of Etheria. Though something was off about it. Adora noticed most of the kingdoms and other areas were labeled but some weren't to mention the ones not labeled seemed to be peeling.

Catra then saw the title.

'This travel map belongs to: Cyra D'riluth.'

"It's a scratch-off map." Adora stared confused.

"What's that?" Catra didn't look up from the page.

"You scratch off all the places you've been to." Adora looked shocked. From Brightmoon to Mystacore, even the crimson waste was all scratched off. The only areas that weren't were remote islands. Catra was mesmerized by the map.

"Do you know what this means?" Adora shook her head. Catra started laughing, but it was soft and light. She then looked to Adora with the nicest smile on her face.

"My mom was a traveler!"

Chapter End Notes

Idk why but Catra's first word being ass was so funny to me I laughed for a solid two minutes when I wrote it.

How didn't I notice?

Chapter Notes

> Sorry in advance for the content of this chapter...
> Anyway hope everyone had an awesome Halloween and I'm hoping that by chapter 35 we'll start getting into the more plot heavy stuff. Thank you allfor your patience and for dealing with all the cliff hangers hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's POV

I stared at the map scanning over all the destinations my mom had traveled to. It was a wide variety and all the places were so far from Halfmoon. As of now Cyra barely leaves Halfmoon if at all and even when she does it's never far. "Hey, Catra. Might want to look at this."

I look to Adora who has an old journal that she pulled out of a drawer. Cyra's name was etched into the cover. I put the map down and took the journal from Adora and chose a random spot and briefly read through it.

'I swear after everything she did to me she dare have the nerve to ask me out? I want to do nothing more than bashing her head in!'

I laughed at the obvious frustration. I then noticed there were chapters? Each section had a name of a kingdom and then pages of information based on the location and tales of my mom's adventures. It was like a whole different side of her.

Crash!

My ears perked up as I heard something fall to the ground. Before either of us could say something Adora had her sword and ran

towards the noise. "Adora!" It was no use she was long gone. "Uhg." I shoved the journal into my bag and ran after her.

Catra age:12
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"Liz?" Azar was standing outside Catra's room wishing she would listen to what she was saying to her.

"Just leave me alone." Azar dropped her head. She wanted nothing more than to cheer her up but when Catra was like this there was no fighting it. So Azar decided to wait her out. She took a seat in the hallway on the floor with her back to the door.

Catra knew she was there. Not only could she see her shadow from under the door but Catra was also leaning against the door on her side and could hear Azar's breathing.

Catra knew Azar wouldn't leave. She's too stubborn for that. Though so was Catra. She planned on not opening that door and if Azar stayed there all day then so be it.

Then Azar started humming.

Catra's ears perked up. It wasn't anything more than a simple tune but Catra felt like she wanted nothing more than Azar rubbing her ears while she slept in her lap. Catra huffed. "Why are you still here? "

'Got her' Azar thought. "I'm not leaving till you talk to me."

"I am talking to you." Azar let out a fake laugh.

"Come on. You know what I mean." Catra remained silent for a while and Azar was slowly losing hope in her plan. Until she heard the noise of the door opening. Azar stared but the door shuts as quickly as it opened as Catra sat next to her and laid her head in her lap.
~~~~~~

Azar started rubbing her head without missing a beat. "Do you plan on talking about it?" Catra just dug her head deeper into Azar's lap. To which Azar sighed. Cyra and Catra got into a disagreement though Azar doesn't know what about. She tried asking Cyra but she quickly ran saying she needed to hunt down Leo, so Azar decided to ask Catra instead.

"All I did was ask if I could go see Sparkles and Arrow boy and she got upset." Azar frowned.

"I figured it would involve something like that." Catra just curled more into her mom and Azar held her closer. "You know she's just trying to protect you the best way she knows how." Catra didn't respond.

Before Azar could get another word out she heard walking coming from the hallway. It was fast too. Catra sat up as she heard it as well, only to see Cyra running towards them.

She stopped a few feet short to try and catch her breath. "Careful Cy you might-"

"Can I take Elizabeth for a moment?" Catra stared at Azar as she bumped her shoulder. Azar gave her a silent question, 'do you want to go?' Catra got up and followed Cyra before she could hesitate. Cyra seemed to relax and gave a wave as her Catra walked down the hall.

Catra walked beside Cyra tense and hesitant. Suddenly Cyra stopped walking and looked at Catra. "I'm sorry I got upset, today has been a lot and I took it out on you when I shouldn't have." Catra nodded.

"It's okay." Cyra gently grasped her head

"No, it wasn't. It's unfair of me to let out my frustrations onto you." Catra's eyes started to fill with tears. Catra then hugged Cyra hiding her face in her shoulder. Cyra just hugged her back. Catra hated letting anyone see her cry.

Cyra just held her till she eventually pulled away with puffy eyes. Cyra smiled as she picked her up. "I have a surprise for you." Catra tilted her head in a silent question. To which Cyra laughed as she continued walking. "I think I should've done this years ago but I was stubborn. So..." Cyra placed Catra down and opened a door that leads the dining room.

Catra didn't have time to react as the scent of sparkles and pine-filled her nose.

"Catra!"
~~~~~~

Adora's POV

"Adora!" I kept running towards the sound disregarding Catra's obvious worry. Something is wrong. It's staring me in the face but I can't figure it out at all! Which just frustrated me. I didn't even know where I was running.

I stopped by a room I had assumed the crash had come from. The door was slightly ajar. I gripped my sword and placed my hand on the door. I would transform if I didn't have to say a phrase out loud and I didn't want to risk making my presence known.

I braced myself and prepared to attack once the door opened. Something or someone is here. And the fact they haven't revealed themselves puts me on edge. With a deep breath, I make a mental countdown.

Three

Two

One!

I pushed the door open and ran in my eyes darting across the room looking for anyone but suddenly I realized what was wrong.
~~~~~~

It was so obvious how did I not notice? Whatever had made the crashing sound was long out of my mind as I stood in shock looking in the room.
Sitting at tables some laid on the floor others propped up against the wall looking as if they were having a conversation

We're corpses.

Skeletons would probably be a better word. I felt my stomach turn as I not only realized they were the fallen from the Halfmoon battle but the thought of someone coming in and arranging them like set pieces in some fucked up game.

"Adora?" I quickly looked at the door.

"Catra wait!"

Catra walked in. "You idiot you can't go and run away like-" I quickly grasped my hands over her eyes. "Adora!" She tried prying them off but I held firm.

"Catra trust me you don't want to see this." I was hoping she'd just let me lead her out of the room but her nose twitched. I knew the smell of decay would make her connect the dots.

Catra went completely still. It was obvious she stopped breathing for a second. "Adora let go of me."

"Catra I don't think its a good idea-"

"Adora I'm going to fucking vomit!" I got my hands off her eyes and she instantly turned and went back into the hallway.

I heard her gagging.

I went next to her and held her hair back. She was holding her stomach and I thought I heard her crying.

Eventually, Catra calmed down though her body was still tense. I rubbed her back. "Catra-"

"I'm okay just- just give me a second."

"Take your time." I looked back towards the room. "Catra stays here I wanna see something." I went to get up but Catra got a sudden death grip on my hand. She still had her head down.

"Adora-" I gently removed my hand.

"I'll be right back. Promise." Catra quickly shoved her face to her knees as a sound came out of her stomach. I went to leave when Catra's voice stopped me.

"Adora come here for a second." I sat back next to her and she suddenly was hugging me tightly. She had her nose in my neck and she was inhaling it like it was fresh air after years of not having any.

Then just as quick as it happened she pulled away.

"Hurry up, that smell makes me sick!" I firmly nodded and quickly went back into the room. I was able to see Catra in the hallway. Part of me wanted to close the door so the smell didn't leak through but I wanted Catra to still be in my line of sight in case anything happened.

I took a deep breath, which was not a good idea, and began to look through the room. Everything was eerily clean. Not many cobwebs nor any signs of aging.

Someone's been here. Recently.

I should've noticed there were no bodies, I should have noticed besides things affected by the weather everything was relatively clean, why didn't I notice? Now Catra's awesome day got ruined and she can't even get up. Suddenly something caught my eye.

A book on a shelf with first ones writing on the spine.

Catra's POV

I was trying my damn best to focus on Adora's scent and not the one surrounding it. I also tried to listen for Adora's movements, which were still the same as when she was a kid, calculated.

I then heard something fall over. "Shit. I'm okay!" I laughed a bit. How can she be such an idiot? I decided being next to my vomit wasn't where I wanted to be so I slowly got up and keeping my back to the room made my way down the hallway. Not enough to not be able to hear Adora but enough that I wasn't facing the result of my weak stomach.

I don't know how much time went by but I was beginning to become impatient and worried. "Adora? You okay?"

"Yeah, I'm alright! Just give me two more minutes!" I rolled my eyes. She's been in there for twenty at least. I leaned my head against the wall behind me. Stars I'm pathetic. Adora's investigating alone and I couldn't even get through the damn entryway.

I suddenly start to feel cold. Am I going into shock? No there's no way. I try focusing back on Adora's scent but it's difficult. I wanted to call out to her but then I caught something.

Momma? There's no way she's here. But I know her scent. I stood up before I could think logically. I followed it down the hallway. "Momma? Are you here?" In hindsight, if she is here I'm in so much trouble and I probably shouldn't be calling out to her.

I arrived at the hall we were at before with the torn curtains and thrown furniture. What the hell? I sniffed the air again. Her scent was here but where could she be hiding?

I followed it and It only came to a piece of the torn curtain laying crumpled on the floor. Are my senses broken? I sighed. Still, why would some random curtain reek of my momma? I picked up the piece of curtain not thinking much of it.

Until I saw half a right arm laying on the floor.

Adora's POV

I was reading through the book as much as I could skimming over parts that looked interesting. It was a history book. Well, a history book of the first one's time on Etheria. Though my history lesson was cut short when I heard Catra scream.

"For the honor of Greyskull!" I ran out the door and noticed she wasn't there. Shit, how didn't I notice? I ran down the hallway as fast as I could which my new height almost made me trip myself up.

I found myself in a place we'd been to before.
I see Catra in the center of the room staring at something on the floor. I ran up to her and she didn't even look me in the eye. "Catra are you okay? What happened?" Catra just silently pointed to the floor.

I looked and instantly wish I hadn't. It was half a right arm. But the weird thing about it was it wasn't a skeleton. It looked as if it was just cut off.

"How-"

"Magic. It's-" Catra looked like she wanted to vomit all over again. And she started breathing heavily.

"Catra you need to stop looking." Catra nodded but she didn't make an effort to look away. I tried to put my hand on her face but she flinched.

What? Why?

I look down at my hand. Oh right. I shift back to my normal size. At least that made Catra look less tense. "Hey, Catra can you look at me please?" Catra wasn't responding. I decided to do something and hope it works or that she'll slap me. Either way, she will snap out of her shock. I grab the back of her neck and put it where she put her head earlier.

She was still with her face in my neck. I clenched my eyes shut hoping she didn't slap me. Luckily she seemed to snap out of it and curled into me, clutching my jacket so hard I could feel the pricks of her claws.

"I wanna go home." Catra's voice cracked It was quiet. I rubbed her ears gently.

"Alright. Can you walk?" Catra nodded her head but it was hesitant. "How about I just carry you till we get out of the Castel?" Catra didn't move for a moment then nodded. "Alright keep your eyes closed." Catra still didn't say anything and nodded. I rearranged us until I could get a good grip on her and stood with Catra in my arms. The second we started walking she put her head in my neck refusing to look up.

"Wow, Catra if you wanted me to carry you like a princess you could've just asked." That at least got a laugh out of her. I think I even heard a purr.

"I'll keep that in mind." I smiled at her.

"First thing you need to do is drink water and brush your teeth. You smell like throw-up." Catra hit me with her tail.

"Oh fuck you." We just laughed as I continued walking back to Halfmoon. Catra let me carry her all the back.

Chapter End Notes

I plant on going back and editing all my older chapters fixing grammar mistakes, spelling, plot holes ect. As always leave comments I've been trying to get back to them all so sorry if I haven't gotten to yours yet. Have a good rest of your day!
💜💜

Memories

Chapter Notes

> This came out way longer than I intended but I'm trying really hard to get Catras birthday ready to go by chapter 35 hope you enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Sneaking into Halfmoon was significantly easier than sneaking out the only bump in the road was when they entered the chamber and Adora had to help Catra get through the panel in the roof and Catra had to pull her up.

Despite how the journey ended Catra was still happy she got to leave Halfmoon for a good few hours and be with Adora. Sneaking into the Castel was also relatively easy.

Catra led Adora to her room and the second the door closed behind them they were laughing. "I can't believe that worked!" Catra whispered. Adora laughed.

Suddenly a light turned on revealing Glimmer in a nightgown sitting on Catra's bed. "Hey C." Adora panicked while Catra naturally smiled.

"Hey, Sparkles! What brings you here? I and Adora were just raiding the kitchen-" Glimmer's face showed she didn't buy it. "Do you have any idea how crazy your mom went when she saw you were gone?!" Catra's fur stood up.

"How'd she find out? Where is she now? Fuck she's gonna kill me!" Glimmer spoke up.

"Calm down." Catra turned to Glimmer about to yell until Glimmer continued. "She found me first and I told her you and Adora were sleeping over in my room." Catra let out a sigh of relief.

"Thank the stars."

"Fuck the stars start thanking me! Do you know how much trouble I could get into?"

"I know thank you, I'm sorry-"

"And you didn't invite me!?" Catra's eyes widened as she looked at Glimmer who started pacing. "I mean seriously! I wanted to see your reaction! Hey, maybe we can sneak out to Brightmoon? Tell me everything that happened!" Adora stepped in when she saw Catra tense up.

"Glimmer we're really tired so maybe we should talk about this in the morning." Catra gave a silent thank you. Glimmer groaned.

"Fine. But you owe me C, Cyra was about to send the whole guard on a search."

"I know. Thanks, sparkles." She smiled as she left the room. Adora went to leave as well until she saw Catra hugging herself. She placed her hand on her shoulder.

"You okay?" Catra took a deep breath.

"Yeah, it's just...a lot." Adora nodded.

"You know if... if you need anything I'm right down the hall." Catra smiled.

"Thank you, yous Adora." Adora blames the adrenaline for her brain not comprehending what she did. She grabbed the sides of her face and kissed Catra on the head.

"Goodnightcatrahaveanicenight!" Adora then briskly walked out of the room before she said something stupid. Her brain repeating 'why did I do that? Why did I do that?' While she left the room.

Meanwhile, Catra was in a daze her hand drifting to where Adora had kissed her head. Catra felt her face go red as her brain finally

caught up. "Idiot." It came out way softer than Catra intended. She was giddy as she changed into her nightclothes. She took off her satchel and placed it on her desk. Unfortunately, it wasn't sealed and the contents spilled out.

Catra just picked them up and put them back, making sure to seal it this time. She hesitated when she saw her mom's journal. She hid it on her desk. Her mind then went back to Adora.

Her heart was beating so fast she could hear it in her ears. Her head was going crazy with 'what if's?' Part of her wanted to go to Adora's room just to ask her to do it again. Catra felt like a child with the way she dug her face into her pillows giggling wildly with her tail waving in the air.

Despite what the day had done to her she was content and went to sleep with a smile on her face.
If only her dreams were of Adora and not memories she didn't know she wanted to forget.

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She just kept running. She didn't know why or from what but all she knew was she had to keep running. There was smoke around her home. People in dark gray and green armor with a symbol of crimson red wings.

"Liz!" She ignored that voice coming from behind her. She has to find her mom's. They promised they'd be there. The kit was running on all fours with her breath labored. Weird machines were walking around on three legs destroying everything with a red beam from their eyes.
She saw the castle in view but stopped as she was picked up by one of the people in the dark armor. "Aww look they're cute up close."

"Put it down!" The other one then aimed a thing at the kit. She didn't know what it was but decided she didn't want to find out. She bit down hard on the person's hand.
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"Fuck!" The girl then ran barely missing something that came from the thing that the second person was holding.

Once she saw the castle she ran inside.

It was the quietest she's ever heard it. There was always a sound of talking or guards marching in unison. Now there was nothing but her labored breathing. "Mom? Momma?" The kit began walking through the halls. "Is anyone here?" Catra's ears twitched as she heard sounds come from down a hall. "Hello?"

She slowly went towards the sound, of course, everything was dark. The only light coming from the moons in the sky coming through the windows. As she arrived closer she realized the sounds were from a struggle.

"Honestly. Where did all of that potential go?" The voice sounded corrupted. Strained. It made a cold chill go up the kit's spine.

"The same place your compassion went!" The kit recognized that voice it was the same one who'd sing her lullabies and keep the monsters away.
The kit looked in and saw her Momma but she didn't look the same. She had a scary look on her face and blood was spilling out of her mouth and running down her face. She had never seen a look like that on her mother's face. Then the other person waved her hand and her Momma screamed in pain her body convulsing.

The other person began to shake her head. "Azar come now. This has gone on long enough, luckily for you, I'm willing to negotiate."

"Fuck you." Another scream came from her.

"Azar enough playing hero. I can give you what you want. We both know sitting around and hiding isn't how you like to do things. I would know."

Azar's arms were shaking as she tried to push herself up. "I'm giving you one more chance. Azar, you are one of the best

sorceresses of your time. Are you going to waste it playing housewife?"

The stranger sat down in front of the kit's mother and held her head up with her hand. Then when they leaned in Azar spat blood in their face. The person pulled back and wiped it off. "You-"

Azar fell back to the floor. "Get out of my house." That seemed to piss them off. They then started forming a dark spell.

"A shame."

The kit ran to her before anyone knew what was going on.

"Elizabeth!"
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Catra sat up with her hair clinging to her forehead. Her chest was heaving. 'What the hell was that?' Catra tried to rationalize everything. 'I probably scared myself because of what I saw at old Halfmoon.' Though Catra knew what dreams like those were.

Catra's memories came in bursts always random rarely having them in the correct order and when she wakes up she would only remember a few details. This was different. She remembered everything from the dream. Even her thoughts, the smells, and sounds were so real.

Catra had so many questions and zero answers. Though Catra wasn't sure if she wanted answers. All she knew was she wanted to see her Momma.

What if that's when she lost her arm?

Catra didn't want to think about it she wanted to see her mom's. It was risky, considering she had just got back from sneaking out, and avoiding them would be the best option but, that dream freaked her out.
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So before she could second guess herself she went out into the hallway, her legs automatically taking her to the room she practically lived in. As she walked past Adora's room she felt her feet stop.

Catra remembered what Adora said. 'Would she be okay with me coming to her?' Catra shook her head and kept walking. She wanted to see her mom's and that's what she was going to do!

Catra refuses to admit how long she stood silently outside of Adora's room.

Catra expected an easy walk but she had forgotten about the guard's parol and ran right into one. "Shit my bad," Catra said as she rubbed her head then suddenly the person grabbed her arm.

"Princess just what are you doing up this late?" Catra didn't like the man's tone. It sounded accusatory.

"I was going to see my moms." He then rolled his eyes at her.

"Likely story. I'm not dumb I've heard of your attempts and I'm not someone you can outsmart." Catra was tempted to say she already had but decided against it.

"Look if you don't believe me you can follow me. Now can you let go!" Catra tried pulling her arm away but his grip got tighter. Catra flinched, there was going to be a bruise.

"Fine, then I'll escort you myself." He then dragged her down the hallway not loosening his grip once.

"I told you asshole I'm heading there anyway so just let me go and I'll walk with you!" He practically ignored her request and talked back to her.

"So why are you 'seeing the queens' at this time of night?" He practically put air quotes with his voice.

Catra bared her teeth. "That's none of your fucking business!" Thinking he won he had a smug look on his face as they walked down the hall. "Asshole."

Once they arrived at the room, the guard still holding her arm in a death grip, knocked loudly on the door. Catra recognized her mom's hushed bickering of who would answer the door.

Catra hoped it was Azar.

They then heard footsteps coming to the door. It opened to reveal Cyra.

Catra's face must've said 'oh shit' because the guard got confident. Before a word could get out however Cyra was smiling at Catra. "Elizabeth what's wrong?" Catra couldn't even get a word in.

"I caught the princess trying to escape-"

"That's bullshit!"

"So I grabbed her for you and thought you would-"

"Mom I swear I was just trying to come to see you!"

"Like to handle her accordingly."

He then gripped her arms tighter and that caused Catra to let out a whimper. Cyra noticed immediately. "Get your hands off her! Can't you see you're hurting her?!" The guard instantly let go. Sure enough, there was a bruise on her arm.

Cyra pulled Catra towards her. "Thank you for your report I'll take care of it. Though next time I suggest you are mindful of how you treat my daughter because I have no problem of trialing you for treason am I clear?" That confident exterior quickly shattered.

"Um yes, I'm sorry your majesty won't happen again." Catra thought that was the end of it till Cyra spoke again.

"I believe the apology isn't for me." He then gulped as he bowed to Catra.

"I'm sorry princess Elizabeth I should've been more mindful I hope you can forgive me." Catra just rolled her eyes and crossed her arms.

"Yeah, whatever." Cyra waved her hand dismissing the guard and once he was out of earshot Catra began speaking twenty miles per hour. "Mom I swear I wasn't trying to sneak out! I just wanted to see you both because I got scared please believe me!"

"I know Elizabeth."

"And I know you don't trust me but- wait what?" Cyra laughed.

"Elizabeth don't short credit yourself I know if you were trying you would never have gotten caught by someone like that. His footsteps are practically screaming 'here I am!'" That caused Catra to smile a bit. Cyra then gently grabbed Catra's arm.

"Does it hurt?"

"Only a little. It's just a bruise, no big deal."
Cyra frowned.

"I'll make sure to have a word with his superior." Catra laughed.

"Calm down mom. Like I said no big deal."

"Okay but what if he's done that to someone else? Or continues abusing his power? I learned the best way to deal with people like that is to take away their authority immediately."

"I guess." Catra didn't have much to say after that.

"Why did you want to come to see us?" By the soft tone in her voice it was obvious she had guessed it was a nightmare. She of course was right.

"I-I had a dream and I think it was a memory." This caused Cyra's ears to perk up. Though she tried to keep calm.

"What happened? Stars I hope it wasn't of the time Azar made my hair stand up. I swear you laughed way too hard for my liking." That caused Catra's mood to pick up a bit.

"No. You weren't even there." That caused Cyra to tilt her head.

"What-what was it about?" Catra bit her lip and looked at the ground.

"I think I want to talk with Momma about it first. If you don't mind." Cyra wanted to argue but figured if the memory didn't involve her she should let Azar handle it. She'll most likely tell Cyra about it later anyway.

"Okay, do you want to talk with her alone?" Catra nodded. "Okay, she's right inside. While you do that I'm gonna go hunt that guard down." Catra chuckled and Cyra kissed her head. "You're welcomed to stay with us for the night."

"Thanks, mom." She smiled and walked in the direction of where the guard had left. Catra opened the door and shut it behind her, but not before summoning a ball of light. She walked in and Azar was passed out face first in the pillows snoring like an engine. Catra shook her shoulder.

"Momma?"

Luckily despite the snoring Azar was a light sleeper. She yawned as she sat up and squinted. "Liz? What are you doing up?" Catra didn't know what to say.

"I had a dream but I'm pretty sure it was a memory." Azar started to look a little more awake.

"Why do you make that sound like a bad thing? I mean you've recovered a good amount of core memories over the years."

"It was during the invasion." Azar's eyes went wide and she suddenly looked hesitant.

"Well you usually talk with your mom about this I don't think I'll be much help-"

"You were the only person I knew in the dream. Cyra wasn't there." Azar looked tense.

"Maybe we shouldn't talk about this right now."

"You know exactly what I'm talking about don't you?" Azar's face said it all. "Who was that crazy guy? How did they know you? What aren't you-"

"Liz stop!" Catra went silent as Azar dragged a hand down her face. "Listen I'm tired and I don't want to talk about this right now."

"Oh, so you only want me to remember things that you want to talk about? How is that fair? How long are you going to keep secrets from me and pretend you'll explain it to me 'when I'm older.' I'm finally beginning to remember important information and you refuse to help me!"

"Liz I'm not refusing, I'm just tired and don't want to talk about this right now."

"Fine then give me a time." Azar lifted a brow at Catra.

"What?"

"Give me an exact time and date we will talk about this."

"Liz seriously-"

"If you aren't telling me because you're tired then let's make a time to talk." Catra stared right into Azar's eyes with every ounce of conviction.

"January 12th. Midnight." Catra went to argue but Azar started. "You said to give you a time and a date."

Catra just huffed, Azar laughed and the tense energy went down. "I expect you to keep your word." Azar smiled.

"Of course." Suddenly Catra hugged Azar tightly. She almost fell back but laughed as she regained her balance. "Hey, what's all this for?"

"Just let me have this." Azar frowned and pulled Catra closer. She had a good idea of what memory Catra had and this confirmed it for her. She just needs to know how much she saw, how much she remembers.

Catra felt her head go foggy as Azar waved her hand over her head. "Just rest for a while. It'll be gone by morning."

Adora's POV

I rushed out of Catra's room before she could slap me or yell at me. When the door closed I didn't have a moment of relief when Glimmer grabbed me. "Adora!"

By the time I screamed, I was in Glimmer's room. She then had her arms crossed. "Where-" she stopped herself as she heard Bow snoring next to her. She then flicked his head.

"Ow!"

"Where the hell have you been?"

"Oh welcome back Adora." Bow said as he yawned. Glimmer rolled her eyes and looked back at me expectantly. I didn't know how much to tell. Catra would know. She's way better at this type of stuff. I felt a smile forced its way on my face.

"Hello? Etheria to Adora?" I snapped out of my thoughts as I saw Glimmer waving her hand in front of my face.

"Oh um. We went to Old Halfmoon." Glimmer didn't have a chance to say anything as Bow was suddenly super energized.

"You have to tell me everything! How did you even find it? My da-datapad has been trying to find the ruins for years." I shrugged my shoulders.

"Catra had a map and we followed it." Bow seemed slightly disappointed at my answer but Glimmer cut in.

"Seriously Adora? Why the hell would you want to go there? Also not to mention the fact, you took Catra!" I flinched at her voice.

"Catra said she wanted to go see it and I offered to help." Glimmer facepalmed. Bow however had a soft look on his face.

"Look Adora I know you were trying to be nice but do you realize how much trouble this could cause?" Of course, I did but thinking rationally around Catra has proven to be fruitless.

"We didn't get caught and we made it back no problem. I don't see the big deal." I felt that was the wrong thing to say when I saw Glimmer's eye twitch and Bow behind her shaking his head.

"The big deal is that Catra is not allowed to leave Halfmoon, and not in the way my mom grounds me, it is a literal law! So not only did you commit treason by aiding her but have you ever thought about how this might affect the rebellion? Hell Brightmoon as a whole? If this gets out the rebellion will be seen as people who think they can break whatever law we want. And not to mention Brightmoon and Halfmoon are already at odds and like it or not you represent Brightmoon. Imagine the backlash we would receive!"

The more and more Glimmer listed the more I realized this was probably a really big mistake. "I know it was stupid. But it's already been done and no one was none the wiser."

"Oh, you think? How do you think Cyra almost found out? Grell heard you two talking about it!" Glimmer must've seen my face go pale because her next sentence was said softer. "Luckily I covered for you both. Not to mention Grell has a reputation of not liking outsiders so it was seen as him making it up to get you out of the picture."

"Thank you Glimmer and I'm sorry I wasn't thinking about the repercussions. I just wanted to cheer Catra up." Glimmer sighed and Bow finally spoke up.

"I know you want Catra to be happy but maybe next time try talking to the queens first. As much as they prioritize Catra's safety they still want her to be happy." That's when an idea went off in my head.

"You're right! I'll talk with them tomorrow!" Glimmer then grabbed my shoulders.

"Nope hold on. First of all C's birthday is the day after tomorrow so she and Cyra are going to be working all day tomorrow. Second, I and Bow have been trying to convince Cyra for years just to let C come to Brightmoon. What could you possibly say that we haven't said already?"

"Come on Glimmer I'm convincing."
I didn't appreciate the way Bow and Glimmer looked at each other.

"Whatever. Now go get to bed we have a long day ourselves. I and Bow still have to finish up wrapping our gifts for C."

"Gifts?"

"Oh yeah, it's traditional to give gifts to the birthday girl. Though I'm sure C will understand if you didn't know."

I started to panic. "I can't be the only one not to give her a gift!" Glimmer and Bow must've seen me spiraling because Bow grabbed my arm.

"Hey, it's okay. If you want to get her a gift we'll visit the market tomorrow and you can pick something out for her." I hugged Bow.

"Really?" He smiled at me.

"Of course! It'll be a best friend squad mission!" Glimmer laughed and started pushing us out of her room.

"Okay okay go get some rest for our mission. That's an order." I and Bow chuckled as we were pushed into the hallway and then Glimmer pulled me back slightly.

"Also if you ever go on an adventure with C without me again I'll banish you from Brightmoon.
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Sweet dreams!" She then shut the door.

"Glimmer really wanted to go."

"Yeah, I can see that."

Cyra was walking down the hall, after giving a certain guard a stern talking to, heading back to her room. She didn't know how long she should give Catra and Azar to talk but decided to knock just in case.

"Come in." Cyra came in and Catra was sleeping halfway on Azar's lap and half her body still kneeled on the floor. Cyra smiled as she closed the door and walked towards them.

"I assume the talk went well?" Azar didn't even hesitate to fall right back into her old patterns.

"Yeah, turns out it was just a memory of when I first took her hunting." Cyra smiled.

"Oh, I was scared it was something bad she was shaken up when I saw her." Azar continued rubbing her head.

"Well there was an incident of her almost falling but I caught her. Maybe she just freaked herself out. I mean she was terrified when it first happened." Cyra looked worried.

"Why wouldn't she talk to me about it."

"She probably didn't want to get me in trouble." Azar hated how easily she lied. As if the years of her trying to atone have been shredded to nothing.

Cyra was none the wiser. "I guess." Cyra rubbed Catra's back. "I'm worried she's going to start to resent me." Azar was shocked at her sudden words.

"Cy, Liz loves you more than anything-"

"Do you think she'd be happier in the rebellion?" You could've heard a pin drop in the room. Before Azar could ask where the change of heart came from Cyra continued. "I was just thinking about how happy she looks with Adora and I know she'll go back to the rebellion Elizabeth will be heartbroken and... I don't want to be the reason."

Azar didn't know what to say. But she tried. "It's your decision. Will Liz be upset most likely but I doubt she'll be upset with you. And I'm sure Adora will visit whenever she can. I think you're just thinking too hard about it."

"I guess." Cyra sighed and stood up. "Alright now the worst part." Azar laughed as she pulled her hand away from Catra's head. Cyra shook Catra's shoulder. "Elizabeth? Wake up, sweetie." She only got a groan in response. "I swear if I have to pick you up I'm throwing you in the bath." Catra groaned again but started to wake up a bit more. She yawned and Cyra was overwhelmed at

how cute she was. "I know, I know, I'm the worst but I don't want you sleeping halfway on the floor."

Catra then leaned on Cyra about to fall right back to sleep. "Come on just lay on the bed and you can sleep as much as you like." Cyra was nice enough to hold half of Catra up and help her to the bed. She passed out once again when her body hit the mattress. "I swear she can sleep through everything." Azar laughed. To which Cyra smirked at her. "Oh, you can't laugh you're just as bad."

"Whatever you say." Cyra rolled her eyes as she lay on the other side of Catra.

"Sleep tight Elizabeth."

Adora's POV

"Glimmer wake up!"

"Ahh!" Glimmer fell out of her bed but luckily for her this one wasn't so high off the ground. "Adora?!" When Glimmer looked she noticed me also having a firm grip on Bow's arm who probably looked as frazzled as Glimmer.

"Come on we have to go get Catra a present before it's too late!" Glimmer cringed as she looked at the time.

"Adora it's like... five in the morning." Bow yawned. I ignored him as I pulled Glimmer up.

"Come on come on!"

Glimmer honestly looked like she wanted to kill me but I didn't have time. I grabbed some of her clothes from her closet and threw them at her. "Adora!"

"She did the same to me."

I rolled my eyes at Bow as I dragged him out of the room. "Come on Bow let her get changed and we're about to do what I like to call you were late to breakfast and you need to eat quick!"

"Huh?" Then I continued dragging Bow down the hall.

Unfortunately, our schedule was thrown off by the fact that Bow eats like a mouse.

"Uhhgg, we're so far behind." Glimmer laughed at me.

"Adora I guarantee you everything will be fine. Most people will be decorating for tomorrow so the market won't be very busy." Then I saw Azar walk into the room.

"Holy shit I didn't know anyone else is up at this hour." Glimmer groaned.

"Yeah well Adora wants to get a-"
I slapped my hand over her mouth.

"Good constant sleeping schedule!" Azar looked at me weirdly and then I felt Glimmer lick me. "Ew Glimmer!" She just laughed. Azar just grabbed a sandwich from the breakfast table.

"Well Cyra and Liz aren't going to even think about getting up for another few hours so enjoy yourselves. I'll be in my study if you set anything a flame." She then waved as she left.

Once I was sure she couldn't hear I spoke. "She looks way meaner than she is." Bow stepped in.

"You should see how she interacts with Angella that's when she's scary." I got confused. Angella is one of the nicest people I've ever met. Before I could verbally express this Glimmer spoke.

"My mom made a bad judgment call and sadly Halfmoon had to pay the price." I wanted her to elaborate but decided against it. Glimmer seemed visibly upset.

Bow sensing the now still air took a swig of his orange juice then let out an exaggerated satisfied sound and exclaimed, "Hey let's head to the market and get Catra an awesome gift!" Glimmer instantly cheered up.

"Yeah what he said, to the market!"

Catra's POV

Beep beep.

Beep Beep.

What is that? I blinked my eyes open and the beeping was coming from the table next to the bed. What the? I reached over and grabbed it and saw the time and below it was writing saying 'waky waky you and Liz have stuff to do!' I knew it was left by momma. We did have stuff to do today but the bed was really warm. Besides a few more minutes won't hurt anybody.

Then the beep became significantly louder.

That's when I heard my mom start to wake up. "What is that noise?" I just put a pillow over my ears. Cyra reached over me and suddenly gasped.

"Oh, crap we were supposed to meet with Diane an hour ago!" I've never seen Cyra get ready as fast as she did. She dragged me out of bed and forcefully kicked me out telling me to go change and to meet her at the palace entrance ready to run.

I just yawned as I walked to a nearby guard. "Hey, can you tell me the time?"

"It is 9:10 princess."

"Okay, thanks." I knew it. Momma had the time say 10:10 so I can spare a nice walk to my room.

Maybe I can see Adora.

I felt my face heat up at the memory. Stop it Catra you're better than this!

I felt my pace quicken but subconsciously slowed when I found myself in front of her door.

It was always like this in the Horde. Whenever I was upset or missed her it was like my body would automatically try and hunt her down.

"She and Glimmer left early this morning."

I turned and saw a familiar magicat. "Vivianne?" She didn't look as cheerful as she usually did.

"I saw them leave. Said something about going to the market."

"Oh, okay... thanks." The tension could be cut with a knife. I felt bad for yelling at her but she could've messed up my and Adora's...relationship.

"I'm sorry about what I said to Adora." I look at her and she was looking down at the ground. "I'll be honest with you I thought it was unfair she comes back in your life after years of being out of it and yet receives all of your attention I've been trying to get for years. It wasn't fair of me to take that out on her."

I noticed her ears were down.

"I meant everything I said beforehand. I want us to be like we were before. Start over and everything."

I can tell she's being sincere it's painfully obvious. She never could hide her emotions. I guess I never really gave her a chance to explain herself. "Alright."

Suddenly she was back to smiling. "Really?!"

"On one condition!"

"Anything." I was caught off guard by how fast that response came.

"Promise you'll treat Adora better. She's still my friend. Also, you have to apologize to her too." Vivianne didn't look thrilled about it but nodded.

"I promise."

"Alright, I got to go get ready to go see Diane." Vivianne nodded.

"Yes of course sorry." I laughed at her all flustered. I won't deny that she's pretty. I like to think maybe if... things were different maybe we could've lived the life Vivianne wanted.

"I still expect a dance!" I said as I walked to my room.

"I wouldn't miss it!"

I arrived at the gate and Cyra was running in place. "Oh Elizabeth perfect now come on we have to run." Before she could drag me off I started.

"Mom it's 9:30. Momma changed the clock." Mom had a range of emotions and then groaned.

"I could've slept in some more!" I laughed as I pulled her towards Diane's. "I feel betrayed you didn't tell me."

"Mom if you slept in more we would've been late. Be thankful. Besides nothing stopped you from asking for the time."She huffed then smirked at me.

"Well since you're being such a brat I guess I won't tell you the good news." She always knew what to say. I then wrapped my

arms around her waist.

"Mom come on don't be like that!" She just laughed at me and hugged me back.

"I guess I can give some mercy." She then let go and continued walking with me. Stopping every once in a while to say hi to people. "So your mother and I have been talking about taking a break. But it's so hard to do that here."

There's no way.

"Sooo, we're going to Mystacore."

"No way!" She nodded at me. "Seriously? And I get to go?!" She smiled again though bigger this time.

"Yep. I want Leo there but... I feel like I've been too harsh on you and who knows maybe after this we can see about Brightmoon." I practically tackled her in a hug.

"Thank you, mom." She hugged me back.

"Of course." I then pulled back.

"When are we leaving?"

"February 11th though we'll be there by the 12th."

Adora's POV

"Wow." The market was like a whole ecosystem. I've seen the market twice but the first time I was being held under guards' watch and the second was when no one was around. Now it was completely overwhelming with sounds and excited chatter.

I didn't get long to oo' and aw' because I was suddenly being dragged down the stalls by Glimmer. "Welcome to the market! They sell all types of stuff here so I'm sure finding a present will be super easy!"

We were at a stall that was selling blankets and sashes that sparkled. "See something you like?" I saw a short round magicat with ginger hair, almost covered by gray and earings covering all of her ears. While I was starring Glimmer spoke.

"Hi, we were just looking for now." She nodded.

"Of course take your time. Just so you know for a little extra I can get the blanket to smell like any scent you'd like!" Glimmer smiled.

"See Adora this could be perfect!" I raised my brow at her.

"Catra already has a bunch of blankets."

"Yeah, but if you get one with your scent she'll love it! You know she still has a blue blanket she says smells like you and she used to carry that thing everywhere. She still has it in her room too."

"Wait Catra still has that?" Glimmer nodded.

"It's perfect for a princess." I was on board until the shop lady spoke.

"Oh, dear is this a gift for princess Elizabeth by chance?" I didn't like how she said that. Bow nodded when I nor Glimmer didn't respond. "Oh I'm sorry but I can't sell it to you."

"What? Why not?" I'm glad I can count on Glimmer to always ask what I'm thinking.

"There's this rule amongst vendors that we can't sell more than three items to different people for the same event. This is to avoid the princess getting a bunch of duplicate gifts. Unfortunately, I've sold my three. I'm sorry." Bow ever-optimistic said

"Well that's okay I'm sure we can find something else." Then the woman grabbed my hand and stamped it with something.

"Sorry, another rule. This will show who you're shopping for so just show a vendor this and they'll check to see if they have anything they can give you."

"Thank you." I looked at the stamp and it was kind of hard to see on my pale hand but it was a gold initial of an E. Glimmer looped her arm around me.

"It's okay I'm sure we'll find something I mean what are the chances that everything is sold out?"

"Everything was sold out!" Glimmer was going red with frustration. She was pacing as I and Bow just sat in defeat. "I mean seriously who came up with this system anyway?"

"Probably Cyra."

"Looking for support Bow!"

I sighed as I stood up. "It's fine I'll just get her something afterward." Glimmer must've seen my face because she was shaking her head.

"There has to be something."

"What if we get her something from somewhere else?" I look over to Bow.

"Yeah, we can get her something from Brightmoon!" Glimmer suddenly had a lot more energy. "What do you think Adora?"

It sounded like our best option but, I don't even know what I would get her. At least with the market, it narrowed everything down by a lot but now with the option of getting anything! I started doubting everything what if she doesn't still like the things she used to? What if she hates what I get her?

Then I remembered something I know for a fact Catra still wants but getting it would be a whole separate challenge. "I think I know exactly what to get her... but it's not in Brightmoon."

"That's fine we have all day. Where is it?"

"The Fright Zone."

Chapter End Notes

I would like to apologize in advance for Azar fans...

Old faces new problems

Chapter Notes

> Sorry it's a bit late I had a long work day. Enjoy the chapter I'm trying to keep up the longer chapters and sorry if you are getting bored of Halfmoon I promise plot is coming up!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV

"The Fright Zone?!"

Bow laughed loudly as she ushered me and Glimmer away then whispered, "Let's not talk about the Fright zone in public!" Bow then gave a forced smile to any bystanders.

"I'm serious Glimmer I would only be like ten minutes tops. I know exactly where it is and she'd love it!" Glimmer looked as if I was spouting nonsense.

"So let me get this straight, you want to go to the Fright Zone to get a gift for C? What could be there that we can't get from Brightmoon?!"

"When we were little she found a sort of headpiece and she loved it! It was one of the few head amour pieces she could wear without hurting her ears. Unfortunately, it didn't fit her. But she kept it hidden under her mattress where her pillows are. So I can get it quick!"

"Do you not hear yourself?" Bows' voice cracked as Glimmer faced palmed.

I was beginning to think they weren't on board with the plan.

"So that's a no?"

"Adora. It's a no." So I guess I'll be going to the Fright zone by myself. I'll have to revise my whole plan. I was relying on Glimmers teleportation. "Adora you are not sneaking away to the Fright Zone."

Am I that predictable?

"What? Pshh, of course not!" I tried taking small steps backward but when I saw Glimmer's eyes narrow I decided it'd be better to make a run for it.

"Adora!" I maybe got two steps before I was grabbed and teleported to Glimmers room. She then disappeared and reappeared with Bow. "You can't just run into the Fright Zone, take something and walk out!"

"Why not?"

Glimmer's jaw practically hit the floor but before she could yell what I assume would be a colorful vocabulary Bow stepped in. "Adora is there anything we can say to convince you to not go?" I shook my head. I knew it'd be worth the look on Catra's face.

Bow then looked over to Glimmer, shrugged, and then Glimmer let out a loud groan. "Fine! But we need an actual plan. And my mom can't know about this!" I felt myself get giddy and ran up to Glimmer hugging her.

"Thanks, Glimmer you won't regret it!"

"Too late."

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"Here cover your ears with this." Adora wrapped her blanket around the small kit, now known as Catra.

"Why?" Catra didn't understand why she had to hide her ears, if anything Adora should be the one hiding her ears. Catra thought.
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"Because I need to show you to Shadow weaver. She'll get you some clean clothes, some more food, maybe we can even share a bunk!" Catra only understood a few words of what Adora was saying but nodded along anyway.

"But why do I have to cover my ears?"

"Well we need to get you an identification number first and Shadow weaver can get you that. Until then though we can't attract attention...and your the first cat person I've ever seen." Catra's ears went down to her head. Adora suddenly felt guilty.

"Hey, don't worry once you get your ID you can show off you're cute ears!" Catra's face went red and she just clutched the blanket closer to her head.

"Hurry up then." Adora smiled and grabbed her hand and had to force herself not to skip as she walked. Once they left the storage area Catra began to analyze her surroundings. Everything was a muted gray and green. It smelled disgusting.

Catra subconsciously got closer to Adora to try and focus on her scent and not the smell of polluted air and sweat. Adora seemed none the wiser as she had a smile on her face and her ponytail swayed as she walked. She was so bright and her surroundings only made her shine brighter. Catra became slightly distracted as her eyes followed the hair's movement.

The hallways were long and everything about this place put Catra on edge but Adora's hand linked with hers kept her grounded and whenever she felt uneasy she would see Adora's confidence and just trust she knew what she was talking about.

Meanwhile, Adora was excited. Not only had she made a new friend but she also recruited a potential soldier! Shadow Weaver was bound to be impressed. The worst part would be knocking on her door. That was always the worst part in Adora's opinion.

"Adora." Suddenly Catra was pulling Adora back.

"What's the wrong Catra?"

Catra looked scared her fur was fluffed up and even from under the blanket I could see her tail moving frantically. "I don't like this. Can we just go back? This place gives me a bad feeling." Adora looked and two doors down were the black garnet chamber.

"We're so close now Catra. I promise it's not scary. Well actually scratch that. Shadow weaver looks scary but she's nice. Just stick with me and everything will be fine." Adora tightened her grip on Catra's hand and Catra decided she had nowhere else to go so she nodded and followed Adora again.

She felt the uneasy energy coming from the room a few doors down. She hoped with every bone in her body they would stop one door before it. Or walk past it entirely.

They stopped right at the door. As Adora raised her hand to knock Catra pulled harder on her hand. "Adora please I don't like this!" Adora turned to face her and she saw her eyes watering.

"Catra I told you she isn't scary." Catra just shook her head.

"No! I don't like this!" Adora finally seemed to recognize the panic in Catra's eyes. Adora backed away from the door and used her free hand to wipe her tears. "Hey, it's okay...if you don't want to see Shadow weaver then we won't. So please stop crying." Catra was now biting her lip trying to silence her tears. She then nodded and Adora released her hand just to wrap Catra in her arms. "See you're okay."

Catra just placed her head into Adora's neck where her scent was the strongest. She hated this place. It smelled gross, everything had her on edge, and she hated not knowing how anything worked.

"How about you stay in the storage room and we'll try again tomorrow?" Catra shook her head. She didn't want to try again! "Catra you have to do it eventually. Shadow weaver will just register you and then we can hang out all day. Doesn't that sound

fun?" It did sound fun, Catra thought. She didn't want to meet this woman. Just her name made her sound scary.

She also didn't like the humming energy coming from the room where the woman resided. It made her skin itch. Then Adora grabbed her face and made her look her in the eyes. "Catra I promise she won't hurt a hair on your head. I'll be right next to you the whole time. We have to show off your cute ears remember?" Adora tried to cheer her up and Catra had stopped crying for the moment.

Catra then looked back to the door the energy coming from it only making her more nervous. Then she looked back to Adora. She had such a nice smile on her face. As if Catra's answer wouldn't affect her mood. Finally, Catra nodded. "You'll stay with me the whole time right?"

"Of course."

Catra gripped Adora's hand. "Well Hurry up then before I change my mind." Adora smiled showing off her tooth gap and finally knocked on the door. It was a firm two knocks. Catra jumped a bit when the door slid open with a hiss. Adora noticed and gave her a reassuring smile.

"Yeah, it scared me too the first time." She said in a small voice. They both then walked into the room. Catra's fur stood up as she walked in feeling as if the room was choking her. The room reeked of coal and static. Catra then got closer to Adora gripping her whole arm. Adora was stunned for a sec then just pulled the blanket over her ears. "Just let me do the talking yeah?"

Catra let out a quiet "mhmm."

"Miss Shadow weaver?" Catra almost questioned Adora seeing as no one was here until they walked past the giant crystal in the center of the room to reveal a woman sitting at a desk. Every instinct in Catra's body was telling her to run. Run very fast in the

opposite direction. Catra felt her claws flex into Adora's arm causing her to rub her hand to reassure her.

"Adora what do you need. You know I'm quite busy." If Catra thought her looks were intimidating her voice was another level. She then looked up to Adora and the lack of her visible face made Catra even more uneasy.

"Sorry Shadow weaver but I wanted to introduce you to someone."

"Adora I do not have time to waste on meeting every little animal you find." Adora wanted to argue that was one time but decided against it.

"I understand that but-" Adora then pulled down the blanket revealing Catra to the woman. "-this time it's not a roach!" Adora didn't know what to expect for Shadow weavers reaction but what she got wasn't it. She was suddenly standing up and trying to pull Adora away from the girl.

"Adora where on Etheria did you find this? Let go!" Adora pulled away from Shadow weaver and hugged Catra.

"Wait she's my friend!" Catra made eye contact with the woman and Shadow weaver looked even angrier with her hair defying gravity making it look as if hands were reaching out towards her.

"Adora. Let go of her and leave I'll handle this accordingly." Catra gripped Adora tightly almost pricing her skin. Adora panicked. She couldn't disobey a direct order from Shadow weaver. She looked and saw Catra's scared face.

"No." Shadow weavers eyes widened.

"Excuse me?"

"Her name is Catra and she's my friend. I found her in the storage room and-"

"Adora I strongly advise you to"

"-She was alone and scared, so I came here to get her an identification number and she can stay in my room."

"Adora."

"I promise I'll look after she and I'll do extra chores and help her catch up with her studies."

"Adora!" The crystal in the room began to glow as shadows began to surround the pair. "You dare come into my office making outrageous demands and giving information to an outsider?" She then grabbed Adora's chin making her face her. "Now you dare to deny your superior officer!?" Before Adora could speak Catra bit the woman's hand.

"Ahh!" On instinct Shadow, weaver used her shadows to push Catra away causing her to hit the ground.

"Catra!" Before Adora could reach for her Shadow weaver gripped her shoulders.

"Adora stays away she's rabid." Adora shook off her hands and ran over to Catra pulling her body into her lap. "Adora." Shadow weaver then reached for her and Adora covered her body with her own.

"She didn't mean it she was just trying to keep me safe! She just got really scared she's sorry!" Catra curled into Adora. "Are you okay?" Catra didn't respond.

Meanwhile, Shadow weaver stared at the two girls. Never had her authority been questioned least of all by Adora. This pest proved to be a source of multiple problems in the span of a few minutes...but this could be turned into a swift win-win situation. Shadow weaver then crouched down next to Adora.

"Please don't hurt her! She didn't mean it!" Shadow weaver sighed. Stood up and walked over to her desk. Adora stared

confused. Then Shadow weaver came over with a piece of paper. Adora looked at it and saw a line of numbers and Catra's name then a bunch of blanks.

It was an ID sheet the blanks being for the information from her physical she would have to have. Before Adora could reach for it Shadow weaver pulled it back. "Understand she is your responsibility. And if she in any way affects your work ethic or studies know I have no problem removing her am I understood?" Adora just nodded. Which caused Shadow weaver to narrow her eyes.

"Of course Shadow weaver." She then gave Adora the piece of paper and cradled her head. She then stared at Catra.

"I think... Catra being here is a wonderful addition. Though I'll have you know that if her animalistic behavior continues I'll have no choice but to treat her as such. Do I make myself clear?" Adora didn't know what she meant but she understood enough, she can't give Shadow weaver any reason to get rid of Catra.

Catra meanwhile was beginning to regret following Adora. Her back hurt from hitting the wall. "Take her to get her physical and I'll see to it that the barracks will be fixed upon her return." Adora smiled as she stood up with Catra latched onto her. It hurt Catra to stand.

"Of course, thank you Shadow weaver."

"Dismissed."

Catra learned two lessons that day. The first one is never to go into the black garnet chamber expecting to come out unharmed.

And Adora can't always keep a promise.

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The bell to the tailors ringed getting an instant response from the owner. "Read the sign I have an appointment you're welcomed to
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come in sometime after eleven."

"It's us, Diane." She came from the back and was shocked to see the queen and her daughter.

"Oh my on time for an appointment." She then checked the clock. "With fifteen minutes to spare? Color me impressed." Cyra rolled her eyes.

"Very funny. I'll have you know I had no problem this morning-"

"Momma, changed the clocks so she thought it was ten instead of nine." Diane laughed causing Cyra's face to go red. She then turned away from her daughter.

"Well then guess that trip won't be happening." Catra's eyes went comically wide as she started pulling on her arm.

"Oh come on mom I was kidding!"

Diane laughed again and then quickly composed herself. "Alright as fun as this is I need Elizabeth to put on her birthday attire to make sure everything fits right." Cyra stopped teasing Catra and nodded.

Catra followed Diane to the dressing rooms and laid out nicely was the outfit. Catra smiled and shut the curtain behind her as Diane went back with Cyra.

"I'm amazed how fast you finished. I know Elizabeth is known for being last minute." Diane sighed.

"Yep, she's your daughter alright." Cyra huffed. She felt like everyone was against her today. Though she won't admit the pride she feels whenever someone compares them both. That pleasure is usually saved for Azar.

"I'll try to not take offense to that." Diane smiled.

"Believe it or not but tailoring for Elizabeth is my favorite thing. Besides a few hard nos like dresses, glitter, and pink she lets me have a lot of freedom. It's fun. Also, the look on her face when she sees what I made for her is worth it. Don't ever tell her I said that." Cyra smiled as she zipped her mouth shut with her hand.

When Cyra first took Catra to Diane she didn't understand what was happening until they came back to get everything. A whole wardrobe just for her. She asked if Diane would want them back after a while but she just smiled and said "they were made just for you no one else would fit in them." Catra kept every single piece of clothing Diane made for her even after she grew out of them. They all sit in her closet folded nicely in a drawer.

When Diane found out she cried.

"Diane?" Cyra's thoughts were cut off as she heard Catra call from the back.

"Yes?"

"Help." Diane laughed as she walked to the back.

"Be right there!" Cyra laughed remembering the time Catra tried to figure of how to put on more complicated clothes. Especially since Diane loves using wraps of silk in her designs. Cyra still laughed at the memory of Catra struggling to figure out where her head was supposed to go and when she called for Cyra she was all tangled up.

Then Diane came out rushing. "Cyra close your eyes! Hold on Elizabeth I have to set the mood!" Cyra laughed as she covered them with her hands.

"What does that even mean?" Was heard from. Catra

"Let me have this!" Then Diane closed the curtains over the windows leaving the lights around the platform -used for measuring and fitting- made everything glow in a warm orange. "Okay now!"

Catra rolled her eyes as she walked out Diane dragging her to stand on the stage-like platform. "Don't look yet!" Cyra laughed.

"Not looking." Diane then stood back looking Catra over making sure everything was laying properly. She also fixed a few stray hairs to make Catra look a bit more presentable.

"Okay, now you can look," Diane said as she got off the platform. Cyra removed her hands and saw Catra and she was speechless. Catra paid no mind to her as she looked down at herself and moved her legs to see if she had all her mobility. When Catra finally looked to her mom she had her hands over her mouth and tears were running down her face.

"You okay mom?" She nodded firmly and started wiping her eyes. She then stood up and in front of Catra rubbing her arms.

"I think it's just hitting me how fast you're growing up." Catra averted her gaze. Cyra smiled. "Well, what do you think?" Catra turned around to look at the mirrors in front of her and kinda surprised herself. She didn't even recognize the person in the mirror.

The outfit was more regal than anything Catra has ever worn but it still kept elements of her everyday outfit. She still had the see-through wrap around her neck but now it spread out making loose hanging strap-like sleeves showing off her shoulders and forearms. The silk also has some that went down in the front stoping right past the gold belt around her waist.

She had a jumpsuit on that fit loosely the top being a low V and the pants having cutouts on the sides connected by gold chains down her legs.

Catra liked it. She also had long silk trailing down the back of her arms seeming to come from the thin sleeves over her arms. She could only imagine how it'll look when she isn't rocking the bed head look. Then Diane came from the back holding a long piece of fabric.

"Don't worry it'll just be for the ceremony and you can take it off afterward." She went up and before she could place it on Catra's head she asked for Cyra. "Cyra could you take her hair down?" Cyra was in a daze staring at her daughter but nodded.

She gently pulled out the thick hair tie and fixed it up a bit to make it look a little less wild. Diane smiled in thanks and placed the fabric on Catra's head. Holes were right where Catra's ears were making the fabric lay flat. Diane then got behind Catra and pulled the fabric out revealing one long train. Catra looked to her mom and her crying before wasn't even the worse of it now she was sniffling.

Diane silently left to the backroom to give them some privacy. Catra grabbed her mom's hand. "Stop crying its not that big of a deal." She shook her head.

"I'm sorry I just-" she wiped her eyes harshly. "I didn't know if I'd ever get to see this." Catra felt bad. She didn't like seeing her mom cry whether it is happy tears or not. "You look beautiful." Cyra then rubbed Catra's cheek. The moment was sweet until Catra saw Cyra smirk.

"I'm sure Adora will pass out."

"Mom!" She just laughed.

"Alright enough crying. Does everything fit right?" Catra nodded. She will always be amazed by Diane's skills. Speaking of, Diane seemed to sense it was alright to come out and she was holding three tall bags.

"These are for the princesses' guests. I left one in the changing room for when you change." Catra nodded and Cyra removed the veil from Catra's head and traded off with Diane. She folded the fabric and placed it on the edge of the platform. "Alright, Elizabeth you're good to go change if you don't have any complaints." Catra nodded and left to leave but not before Diane teasingly called

after her. "Holler if you need any help!" Catra groaned in response.

Catra didn't need any help after Diane showed her how to figure the crazy thing out. So getting out of it wasn't a problem. Catra hung it in the bag carefully knowing Diane's wrath when it comes to messing up her special orders.

When Catra walks out with the bag containing the outfit hanging off her shoulder she just sees Cyra and Diane talking most of it being Cyra praising her work and Diane being flustered.

"You ready mom?" Cyra acknowledges her and nods.

"Yep just let Diane put the veil in the bag." Catra hands over the bag letting Diane work. Then Cyra checks in on Catra.

"Are you feeling better after last night? You practically slept like a rock." Catra didn't know what she was talking about and Cyra saw it on her face. "After the nightmare?" Now Catra was even more confused.

"What are you talking about?" Cyra's face made Catra uneasy.

"What do you remember about last night?"

Catra of course remembered the impromptu adventure to old Halfmoon but it gets blurry when Adora left her room. All she remembers is falling asleep in her room and then waking up with her mom. She just assumed she walked there in the middle of the night and forgot about it.

"I went back to my room and fell asleep then I woke up with you. I probably just didn't remember getting up. Like you said I was tired." Catra didn't like the look that crossed her face. Cyra remembers coming back to the room and seeing Catra passed out in Azar's lap.

She should've known. Catra wouldn't have fallen asleep naturally in the position. Then all she was asking herself was why? Why

was Azar lying to her? She also questioned how much she lied about.

"Queen Cyra!" Catra turned her head as she saw a guard enter the shop. Cyra then looked serious.

"What's wrong?"

"Nothing, I think. There's someone here to see you."

"Well tell them I'm busy." Cyra cleared her whole day just for Catra and if she let one person complain to her then everyone else will want to.

"My queen its-"

"Oh, my stars!" Catra saw an all-white magicat push past the guard and walk into the shop. If Catra thought Cyra looked like royalty this woman is a whole other level. She had curly hair pulled back into a low ponytail and jewels around her neck with a gold belt decked out with pearls and blue gems. She also had striking green eyes and the black off-the-shoulder dress she wore only made her fur look brighter and Catra also noticed she had light gray fur sprouting from her nose and her tail looked so fluffy.

She then wrapped Catra in a tight hug which Catra felt her fur fluff up at. 'Who is this lady?' In all of Catra's years, she has never seen someone like her before. She then grasped Catra's face staring her dead in the eyes. "Oh my, how rare! What are the chances of her having heterochromia? Oh and that hair tell me Cyra who on Etheria did you mate with to get such a gem?"

Cyra didn't even get embarrassed she was standing slack-jawed. The woman then looked over to her. "I'm asking a question." The woman's tone shifted when she said that. That seemed to shock Cyra enough for her to react.

She grabbed Catra's arm and pulled her away from the woman. "What the fuck is going on!" Catra was in shock. That was the first time she's ever heard her mom curse.

"Cyra please I was coming to see my only granddaughter. I was a bit hurt by the lack of an invitation." Cyra was seething. Meanwhile, Catra was confused. 'Granddaughter? Her Momma only has a dad and both mom's parents died in a battle.'

"You're supposed to be dead!" Catra's ears perked up at that. The woman flinched.
"I never said I was dead. You came to that assumption all on your own."

"Then where have you been for the past 31 years?!" The woman then looked to Catra. Completely ignoring Cyra.

"Hello my name is Esme, but you can call me auntie! I hate that this is how we had to meet but I'm glad I could see you turn eighteen! Say you have any potential mates in mind?" Catra has never been so confused.

She was promoting Catra to speak but she remained silent Esme seemed unsatisfied but Cyra quickly put herself between them.

"You won't talk to her until you explain yourself! I receive a letter saying my father perished and after weeks of not seeing you I come to the right assumption you passed as well. Where have you been this whole time? Do you realize what I went through? I was queen at fucking sixteen! Is dad alive as well?"

The hope in her voice made Catra's heart hurt.

The back of Cyra's mind told her she shouldn't be saying this in front of her kit but damn it she's pissed. How dare she show up and act as if nothing happened? How dare she approach HER daughter? How dare she walk into HER kingdom and make demands?

"Mom?" Cyra turned and saw Catra looking at her worriedly. Right. Catra is still here. Cyra seemed to have forgotten. Cyra took a deep breath and looked back at her mother. If she could even call her that. Birthgiver would be more accurate.

Cyra went to speak but Esme spoke first.
"I know and I'm sorry." Cyra's eyes went wide in pure disbelief.

"What?"

Adora's POV

"In and out Adora!" I groaned as I said 'I know for the fourth time now. I appreciate Glimmers' worry but it's getting annoying. I had to show Glimmer my whole plan and then redo it fifty times for her to be satisfied. She was insistent.

Bow even gave me a 'panic button' that would let them know if I got into trouble. My plan was perfect. Nothing to worry about but Glimmer and Bow disagreed.

They were only walking me to the edge of the whispering woods by the Fright zone and then Glimmer will teleport me as far as she can then teleport back to wait with Bow. Then I'll make my way to the edge of the woods with a skiff after I take the mask.

Easy peasy.

Glimmer teleports me in without a hitch and with one last "in and out Adora." She's gone. I quickly try to find out where I am it's a closet. Though where the closet seems to be a mystery. I listen closely before I open the door looking around. It was a hallway but being out in the open wasn't a good idea. I decided I'll wait until hopefully, a guard passes by and just take their armor, and that way no one would question me. Though after a good thirty minutes of not hearing anyone I began to believe this was a dead hallway. Which means I'll have to sneak on my own.

Great.

I exit what I found out was a broom closet quickly trying to leave before I'm spotted until I realize absolutely no one is here.

No one in the halls no guards standing by doors. Just the humming of machinery. Weird. I walked through the halls that I know have no cameras but the whole time I was waiting for the other shoe to drop.

Then I heard a voice. It came from down the hall. The opposite way of the barracks. That's good I can grab the headpiece and get out with everyone none the wiser.

But the talking was coming from the commons room. No wonder nobody was around. Hordak himself must've called a meeting.

With everyone in attendance.

This must mean it's super important. Maybe if I listen in I could find out important information for the rebellion. No, stop it Adora in and out remember?

Honestly, I don't know why I was trying to convince myself when my feet started walking towards the door. Luckily It was cracked and sure enough everyone was cramped into the small room. Hordak standing on the stage talking.

"As you all know we have a defector working for the rebellion." His voice sent a shiver down my spine. I'd never talked directly to Hordak but his voice matched him. Deep and threatening. Then the screen behind him came to life with a picture of me.

It wasn't anything flattering by any means just my latest ID picture from when I was first promoted. "She used to be our most promising asset but the princesses have corrupted her turning her into this." Then a picture of what I assume they think is She ra appeared.

Though it was drawn up to strike fear. The Golden hair is dark and instead of luscious curls is now shown jagged and her eyes are angry.

I almost wanted to laugh at the inaccuracy of it. Then again thinking back on the training simulations and propaganda posters

I think they do that to everyone they don't like. Angella indeed doesn't look as scary as they led us to believe. Unless she's yelling.

Then she's scarier...

"This means we'll have to rework our systems since she no doubt knows how we run things here. Shadow weaver will be in charge of reworking the Fright zone from the inside out. Since it was due to her negligence we have this problem. So I ask of you for cooperation." All the soldiers slammed their heels together and all shouted aloud,

"Yes, Hordak!" Then with a nod, she began to walk away. Shit, the meeting is ending. I quickly ran back towards the barracks. Part of me almost wanted to laugh hearing Hordak call out Shadow weaver but I decided not to test my luck.

Luckily I made it to the room without running into anyone. I was l Catra taught me all the back ways. I quickly go to Catra's bunk which remained untouched ever since she left I made sure of it personally.

I can reach the top bunk easily thanks to all my growth spurts but as I went to lift the mattress I heard fast footsteps approaching. "Shit!" I didn't have time to hide so I instead get ready to transform my sword until I see a small girl running in crying. Like an idiot, I let my guard down despite knowing that when I was that age I already knew how to subdue someone with my bare hands.

She notices me and gasps then starts to back away. "Oh, I'm sorry I must've gone the wrong way." I relaxed as I realized she was probably too young to have gone to the meeting resulting in her not knowing who I am.

"It's alright are you lost?" She seemed shocked that I wasn't yelling at her. I can relate to that. When I was her age asking for

directions could result in running laps till Shadow weaver was bored.

"I'm okay!" She spoke quickly then recoiled as she realized she raised her voice at who she believed was superior. I decided to crouch down to try and look less intimidating but that just caused her to back up.

"What squad are you in?"

"I'm with Octavia." Makes sense. I try to remember exactly where her squad is stationed. Everything is ordered by rank so the Shadow weavers squad was the closest to the main areas like the commons, dining, training gyms, and so on. So if I'd rank Octavia she'd probably be about to sections down.

"You'll find it about to sections down just take a right out the door." She stared slack-jawed at me then nodded.

"Oh, thanks." She then gasped. "I mean thank you sir- ma'am!" I laughed a bit but I couldn't talk much considering I would've done the same. Heck, I did the same when I first met Angella.

If Catra were here she'd tease me to no end.

Oh, shit Catra! The mask!

I stood up quickly and lifted the mattress and thanked the first ones the helmet was still there. "What's that?" I jumped a bit having forgotten about the girl for a moment.

"Oh, it's my friend's she...left it here on accident." Luckily that was enough for the girl. She looked new. By that age usually, you would know what not to ask or know exactly where your barracks reside. "Are you new?"

She frowned. "Is it that obvious?" I wanted to try and be nice but it was super obvious. "It's okay I know. I was in a raid and... my dad didn't make it." She had a new wave of tears going down her face.

I looped the mask on my belt then went back to her. "Hey, don't cry umm." Oh yeah! I went over to my bunk and leaned down place my arm under it and pulled up a loose piece of metal finding my hidden ration stash from when Catra wasn't allowed to eat. I grabbed one and walked back to the girl.

"Here food makes me feel better." She looked at it and took it hesitantly. "I know it's not very good but food Is food. Though I prefer Halfmoons food over anything here."

"You aren't from here?" I heard voices and footsteps coming down the hall My time is running out fast so I stood up.

"No, I am. Just not anymore." I then winked at her and ran like the wind throwing stealth out the window as I raced to the skiff bay leaving the girl stunned and all the cadets I passed doing double-takes.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed as always leave comments and keep and eye on my Tumblr because I'll be posting Esme tomorrow! 💜 💜

http://lyssa-stone.tumblr.com

The past and the present

Chapter Notes

> Procrastination Nation where you at? But seriously sorry for the late chapter as always any questions or theories go to my Tumblr and comments literally make my day so don't be shy!
> 💜 💜
>
> Also sorry for any spelling errors I didn't have time to re read it tonight but I'll edit it tomorrow... maybe

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV

I managed to make it to the Skiff bay without running into anyone and it was a relief. I even got into the skiff and started up. I was sure I was home free until the lights leading up to me started going out.

I only know one person capable of doing that. "I knew you'd be back but I'd never thought it'd be to steal. Life in the rebellion isn't going well?" Shadow weaver emerged from the growing darkness and I formed my swords keeping my other hand on the controls.

"What do you want?" If Shadow weaver wanted to kill me she would've done it by now. Same if she wanted to try and drag me back kicking and screaming.

"I'm here to offer you a deal." I felt my grip on my sword lessen. Of course, Shadow weaver noticed and I quickly recovered but it was too late Shadow weaver now stepped closer realizing I wasn't going to fight her.

"Stay with the rebellion and be a spy for me. I can go to Hordak and once you give me some inside information he'll welcome you

back with open arms and you'll be back on top." I felt my eyes narrow at her. But my curiosity prompted the conversation to continue.

"What would I get out of this deal? I don't know if you've noticed but being She ra of the rebellion already has me on top so if that was your selling point try again."

This seemed to make Shadow weavers eyes light up with joy as if waiting for me to ask. "I could bring Catra back." I felt the air leave my lungs.

"What?"

"I'm sure you've learned how the princesses Magic works that Catra wasn't killed by a princess. I never found her body but if she is alive I know a spell that could bring her straight to the Fright Zone and you and her can unite." If I hadn't known Catra's exact location part of me believes I would've taken the deal. Though now a whole new fear is running through me.

At any point, Shadow weaver could drag Catra back here.

"How?" I was trying to get information if I knew how she planned on bringing her here I might be able to stop it.

"You don't need to worry about that just know I can."

"How do I know you're not lying?" Shadow weaver seemed to look offended at the accusation.

"Adora I gain nothing from lying. And if I was and you ratted out the rebellion only to find out I lied I'd be making enemies with She ra." She's right. Shadow weaver is anything if not logical. I wasn't going to accept the deal. I already know where Catra is, she's safe with her loving family in Halfmoon. Though I don't know how I could reject this deal without looking suspicious. Shadow weaver knows the extent I would go for Catra's safety.

"I can see you need time to think. When you make your decision meet me in the whispering woods in three days." Without another word, she began walking, or more so gliding, away.

"You're letting me leave?"

"Considering all you stole was nothing more than a worthless piece of scrap metal I'll let it slide." The hand that was on the controls went to the mask on my belt as if making sure it's still there. "I'd advise you to run along Adora."

She then left without another word. I hated how she was able to get under my skin like that. I decided to advise her warning and began to head back to the whispering woods. My stomach filled with anxiety. What if Shadow weaver assumed I got the mask for Catra and uses her spell to bring her to the Fright zone?

How would I explain that to her parents? How could I get Catra back? What would stop Shadow weaver from going after her again? I was hoping the wind in my hair would relax me but I instead focused on the sting in my eyes. I was probably worrying over nothing but I can't get rid of the bad feeling.

As I saw the edge of the woods I slowed the skiff to a stop decided to just leave it by the edge instead of trying to maneuver it through the woods. Luckily the second I walked past the divide of the Fright Zone and the woods I was tackled by Glimmer.

"Oh thank goodness. Did you get it?" I pull the gift off my belt and show it off with a smile.

"Yep!"
Bow came out from the woods and seemed to smile as well. "I'm sure she'll love it." Glimmer frowned.

"This is what you risked your life for?"

"Glimmer!" Bow gently shoved Glimmers shoulder.

"Kidding! I'm sure she'll like it. Now come on let's head back. I hate being in the woods at night." I nodded and placed the mask back on my belt and followed the pair hoping they knew where they were going.

I honestly keep forgetting about the whole nocturnal thing. My first plan was to use the breakfast shift to sneak in and then Glimmer reminded me that outside of Halfmoon it's night.

"Did you have any trouble?" Bow asked as Glimmer treaded carefully ahead of us with light coming from her hand.

"No, I got lucky. Turns out Hordak called a meeting so nobody was around. I was able to listen in but I couldn't get much information. All I know is they're completely reworking the Fright zone since they know I understand how it works."

Glimmer huffed. "Of course. I hate when the Horde is smart. Did you see Hordak?" I nodded.

"Yeah, he looks creepy. Though he is very collected. Seems sane at the very least. He's also smart I kinda assumed someone else was running everything behind the scenes. I keep forgetting he built the Horde from the ground up." I looked up and saw Bow and Glimmer staring at me puzzled.

"What? I know he's bad but you got to admit to doing all he's done so quickly is kinda impressive." Bow gave a strained smile and Glimmer rolled her eyes as we came up to the entrance to Halfmoon. They walk through without issue and Bow and Glimmer talk a few steps ahead of me.

When we step past the red step I remember all of what happened the night previous all over again. I try to focus on all the fun we had and not on the horrific discoveries. Then my brain remembered the last time I was with Catra.

When I kissed her head.

I felt my face flush up. It was perfectly innocent! I did that when we were kids. Though my heart still stutters when I remember it. I hope Catra doesn't say anything about it because I might break down from embarrassment.

We arrive at the actual gate and despite having our medallions at the ready the guards just let us in probably since he's seen how often we're around.

The jolt from the quiet night in the woods to the chatting people excitedly decorating for tomorrow is weird to adjust to but seeing everyone putting up lights and banners makes me giddy myself.

Glimmer must've noticed because she's grabbing my arm. "Come on let's head to the Castel and wrap your gift." I nodded and we started towards it people barely sparing a glance at us as they try to get everything ready.

I found it sweet how all the people love Catra. Knowing she would be fine with a small get-together if anything, yet regardless everyone still pitches in. It's what Catra deserves. I always would do little things for Catra on what was her birthday but I could never celebrate it the way I believe she deserved.

Yet she always had such a bright smile on her face whenever I gave her anything I could find for a gift. I smile at knowing this year I can give her something she wants.

At least I hope she wants.

Before I could spiral into that though I felt Glimmer grab me and I was teleported to her room. Before I could register that she was digging around in her closet and pulled out some boxes and wrapping paper.

"Let's do this!" Bow clapped at her excitement and I felt a smile tug at my lips as I removed the helmet from my belt. I rubbed my fingers across it and leaves a dirty residue behind I placed it on the floor wiping my hands on my pants.

"Are there any cleaning supplies I wanna get rid of all the grime before wrapping it?" Glimmer nodded.

"Down the hall to the right the 6th door on the left is a supply closet, there should be some sanitizer wipes in there." I nodded in thanks and left the room. I followed her instructions and was relieved to see the supply closet.

Nothing against Glimmer but since she teleports everywhere her sense of direction is lacking, to say the least. I started rummaging around trying to find something that would work.

"You need some help?" I jumped at the voice hitting my head on the shelf above me. "Shit, my bad didn't mean to scare you." I turned and saw Azar staring at me as I rubbed the now sore spot on my head. Though despite her apology she was hiding her smile.

"You're fine I was just trying to find some cleaning wipes. Glimmers instructions weren't very clear after directions though. Azar stepped forward and pulled them off the top shelf. She then handed them to me wordlessly. "Need anything else?"

I don't know why I was surprised she knew where it was. This is her house after all. Though calling this place a house seems inaccurate. "No, thank you." She just nodded and began walking away again.

My brain is telling me to say something to her. Though she seems perfectly content to leave and continue doing whatever she was doing beforehand. "You used to teach magic right?" That made her stop.

She then turned to face me with a smirk that was all Catra. "Why, you wanna learn?" I forced out a laugh.

"N-no I just... think it's cool?" That couldn't have come out more wrong. Azar seemed amused anyway.

"That's one way to put it. Though after studying it for almost 40 years puts a damper on it."

"40 years?! How old are you?" Azar couldn't look anything beyond 28 at most. Same for Cyra.

"Old enough to know you never ask for a woman's age." She said as she patted my head. I could probably do the math to figure it out if I ask Catra how old they were when they has her but my mind can't process the queens being so old and still looking relatively young.

Azar must've seen the gears turning in my brain. "Magicats have a long life expectancy most people aren't considered 'old' till they hit around 80 because that's when signs of aging begin again." I guess that makes sense. Then again I know Angella is immortal and Glimmer has implied she's thousands of years old.

"Sorry I didn't mean to be rude." Azar laughed and patted me on the back.

"Relax kid I'm just poking fun. But what's got you interested in magic?" I wanted to say 'because I'm She ra' but I knew that wasn't the reason I asked.

"I was just wondering if... there was a way to like, teleport someone to you? With mage magic." The way I worded that probably sounded suspicious

"Depends if the person is willing or not." Oh, how am I supposed to say without sounding like a creep?

"Uhh..."

"Adora just tells me why you're asking so I don't have to guess." I felt tense up. I guess Azar is the straightforward type. Though I probably shouldn't tell her. "You can tell me now or I'll just spy on you till something slips." Azar had a smile on her face but something tells me she wasn't joking.

"Maybe not here." Azar nodded and gestured me to follow her. I saw her begin to walk and went to follow her but realized I was still holding the wipes. "Uhh." I saw a plant sitting on a podium and placed them on the edge and hastily caught up to Azar.

"What?" Cyra stood stunned by the shop in silence.

"I said I'm sorry stars how many times do I have to say it." Esme seemed frustrated as she turned her head away. Diane standing in the corner trying to decide when to sneak away.

Cyra's tail started lashing then she took a deep breath and turned to Catra. She grabbed her shoulders and looked into her eyes with a soft smile on her face. "Sweetie why don't you go home while I deal with this. It shouldn't take long and I'll meet back up with you around lunch alright?"

Catra wanted to say no but she noticed her mom's hands trembling on her shoulders. "Okay." Cyra smiled and kissed her head. Catra took the bags containing the clothes and walked out giving a small wave to her mom.

"Diane, do you mind if I borrow the shop for a while? We have some things to discuss." Diane jumped hearing herself being acknowledged.

"Yes of course. I had to go out and get some groceries anyway so take your time." Diane then rushed out leaving Cyra and Esme alone.

Cyra tried to ignore the fact Diane left her wallet. "How sweet seems your people like you." Esme tried to ease the tension but once the words left her mouth Cyra was shaking with anger.

"Where have you been?" Cyra tried keeping her voice level but the anger was leaking into it. Esme sighed and sat down on one of the nearby couches.

"Wow, not even a Hello? And here I thought I taught you respect."

"You earn respect here and like it or not I'm queen meaning I'm your superior." Esme just rolled her eyes.

"I have no doubt you're about to complain to me about your reign yet you seem to love using the benefits."

"Shut up and listen."

"I've been listening." Esme's smile just made Cyra more irritated. Esme noticed. "Careful there. Might bust a blood vessel." Cyra walked over to her placing a hand on the back of the couch making her face level with Esme's.

"Listen very closely because I will not repeat myself. You will answer any questions I have, without the attitude, or I will have you publicly trialed for abandoning your kingdom. Am I understood?" Esme stared back looking as if she's finally taking this seriously as she silently nodded.

"Where have you been?"

"Mystacore." Cyra was always decent at detecting lies but Esme was a difficult case. Whether she was telling the truth or gas been planning this out since before she arrived is a mystery in itself.

Cyra decided she would have to just take the information at face value no matter how much she doesn't want to. "Why?"

"That's a loaded question." Cyra just glares. "Calm down. I- when I heard of your father's...demise I was scared. I knew nothing about ruling a kingdom, I didn't even want to! I still had things I wanted to do. I knew you were way more prepared than I was so I decided faking my death would be the best solution. Mystacore treats me nice since I'm royalty and I've kept in touch with a traveling magicat about how things were going in Halfmoon and whenever you came to Mystacore I went to Thaymore for a while."

"So you're telling me you left me, just because you didn't want to be a queen?! Did you ever think about what I wanted? Not to mention if you had a scout why didn't you come back afterword of the invasion?"

"Oh please you were raised without a single want, stars forbid you to struggle. Though I guess you'd prefer if I were the one forced to rule before I was ready." Cyra shook her head as she started pacing the room.

"Will you stop that! Stop trying to blame everything on me, if you came back we could've helped each other but instead, you ran away and left your only child to deal with the problems that you and dad caused." Esme scoffed standing up and walking towards Cyra.

"Cyra why are you acting like this? I've apologized and you know how sparingly I give those out. I'm here to celebrate my granddaughter's birthday. Do you ruin it over some petty argument that has already been resolved?"

"Resolved for you! You left me! Do you have any idea what happened to me after you left? Do you even care? I went into a depression- I ht people, people I care about, years after you left all I wanted was help and I got nothing! Now you have the nerve to act as if it's water under the bridge? Bullshit!" Cyra wasn't even trying to contain her yelling. She thought she had gotten over this but years of anger and sadness all came back with a vengeance and she wanted nothing more than to tear Esme apart.

"Cyra will you just-"

"Quiet!" Cyra took a deep breath as she turned away from her refusing to look into her eyes. "As much as I'd like to scream at you I've already wasted too much time. I have a lot of preparations I need to finish for Elizabeth's birthday and-"

"Elizabeth!?" Cyra mentally slapped herself. Now Esme started reacting. "You named your only child after her?" Cyra felt her

claws dig into her now crossed arms.

"Why do you care?" Esme scoffed.

"Do you realize what that insinuates?"

"What that she was more of a mother to me than you were? Because if so it's pretty damn accurate." Esme scowled at her.

"You wouldn't even name her after me in memory?"

"Oh trust me your memory lived on in my head for decades. Besides I told Elizabeth I'd name my child after her and unlike you, I keep my word. Now please make yourself scarce I have things to do today." Cyra went to leave but Esme harshly grabbed her.

"Listen here you little-" Esme took in a gasp of breath as she felt sharp needles on her neck. Cyra was using her grip on her wrist to pull her forward and dug her claws into her neck slightly letting Cyra feel her pulse quicken.

"I'm giving you two options. Leave now and forever be the bitch that walled out on her kid because she felt like it. Or prove to me how much your bullshit apology is worth by being there for your grandchild." Esme gulped.

"T-the second one. I'll stay and be there!" Cyra stared at her for a moment and removed her hand causing Esme to breathe.

"Perfect." Cyra put on a smile and left the shop with Esme standing in shock. Esme then growled.

"I swear if it isn't here I'm gonna kill him." Esme let out a deep breath and smoothed out her hair. "Cyra wait up!" Esme ran to Cyra and quickly caught up to her.

Cyra refused to acknowledge her as they walked side by side, which only accentuated how different they are with Esme and Cyra came from two separate worlds and that's just from looking.

Esme tried to make conversation as she walked and saw the townspeople preparing for tomorrow's event.

"Well... Elizabeth is such a beautiful young lady. Is there a potential mate on her list?" Cyra wanted to ignore her but she remembered Esme's apology. 'If she meant it I should at least give her a chance.' Cyra thought.

"Not officially but there is someone she has her sights on." Esme clapped her hands.

"Really? That's wonderful! You know they say the happiest marriages start young." Cyra firmly shook her head. Esme always had an obsession with the marriage she got married the second she turned eighteen. It also helped that the king proposed to her.

"Well, it's her decision." Esme rolled her eyes but decided against arguing against her.

"So who was the one who won your heart?" Cyra felt her face flush as she pushed her bangs out her face suddenly feeling flush.

"She is one of the top sorceresses of Mystacore we met when I first went there and everything fell into place after that." Esme smiled.

"Well, how lovely though I'm disappointed to not see you with Grell. Such a nice boy." Cyra sighed.

"We're still close and he's head of the guard, even has a lovely girl, Vivianne. She and Elizabeth are good friends." Esme smirked.

"Oh, I'm sure." Esme then winked at Cyra. She was confused then quickly went to explain.

"Oh no, it's not like-"

"Esme is that you?" Speaking of, Grell ran down the kingdom steps. Esme finally had a genuine smile.

"Grell!" He picked her up effortlessly in a hug.

"Oh, I thought you had perished. Happy day!" She simply laughed as he placed her down.

"Oh my, you sure have grown. Cyra how could you give this up?" Cyra gave a pointed look and Esme frowned. "Touchy." Grell seemed confused but Esme quickly linked arms with him. "Grell, why don't you give me a tour? If that's alright with you Cyra?"

Cyra stared and remembered all the things she still had to do for Catra. She didn't want to allow her to wander freely in her castle but Grell always has Cyra's best interest at heart. If anyone wouldn't allow Esme to be shady it's him.

"Alright you're going to be in the same room you were before. It hasn't been touched by anyone other than maids for cleaning you can reside there. Your old clothes should be there as well." Esme smiled.

"Perfect! Come on Grell!" Then she practically dragged him. Cyra waited for them to walk away before she snapped her fingers and Leo practically appeared out of thin air.

"How can I help you?"

"Follow them. I don't trust her and she's tricky. If she manages to catch him off guard Grell is screwed. Be their shadow."

"Of course."

Catra's POV

I dropped each dress in their rooms. Saving mine for last I laid it out on my bed and sat down at my desk, my head going frantic. Was that my grandmother? If so why isn't she dead? Why did she just show up? And most of all why was mom so angry?

It was so out of character for her and I don't think I've ever heard her voice sound so...mean. Even when she gets frustrated she more so has that 'I'm so disappointed voice unlike Azar's 'I'm gonna kill you' voice.

All these questions but getting answers are practically impossible to get from anyone other than my mom and she's gone. I sighed as I laid my head down on my desk, causing my drawers to rattle.

The bottom drawer rattles and makes me remember. I pull it open quickly seeing my mom's journal. I pick it up and run my hands along with the engraving. This is wrong. It's private but...

I look up to my bedroom door as if someone would enter. Then I looked back down at it. Maybe just a little peek. Just the first page and then I'll put it back and never read it again. I open the book to the first page.

'I guess I'm supposed to write my thoughts and feelings here. Right now I feel obligated to write in this stupid thing because Elizabeth got this for my birthday and she always gets a dumb sad look on her face when she thinks I don't like her gifts. So I'll try to keep up with this.

-Cyra.

'I just turned sixteen not even three days ago and I'm already leaving Halfmoon on my own for the first time. My dad says he can't come because of work. I'll be going to a nearby village so it's nothing big but still, it feels surreal that I've been sixteen for less than a week and I already get to leave on my own about time.

-Cyra'

The next entry was written in an angry scratch.

'SHE DIDN'T EVEN CARE! I WAS GONE FOR AN EXTRA WEEK AND ALL SHE SAID WAS 'WELCOME BACK.' LIKE SHE DIDN'T EVEN NOTICE! EVEN MY DAD ACTED AS IF IT WASN'T A BIG DEAL WHAT IF I WAS KIDNAPPED OR SOMETHING? THE ONLY PERSON

WHO GAVE A DAMN WAS ELIZABETH AND SHE ISN'T EVEN MY MOTHER!

-CY--A'

"Holy shit." I read each word with interest. The last entry was almost impossible to read and an ink spatter covers part of the page. Technically this is where I should end. I read the first page and I know Mom's problem is that Esme lied to her and never acknowledged her. Mystery solved.

I tried. I even shut the journal and shoved it back in my drawer. I sat at my vanity and after maybe twenty seconds of fiddling my thumbs, I practically tore the drawer off its hinges as I got the journal.

"Just one more page." I opened the second page and judging by the date in the top corner it was almost five months since her last entry.

'I forgot to update this thing but I'm pretty sure Elizabeth is done watching me ever since she caught me writing in it the last time. She looked so happy. Elizabeth is everything I want in a mom.

Maybe because she's everything Esme isn't.

-Cyra

I'm starting to think Esme wants me to be with Grell. She would always say suggestive stuff ever since we were kids and hung out but now it's painfully obvious. She said that Grell shouldn't bother trying for a head guard because soon he'll be king, WHILE I WAS IN THE ROOM! It was so embarrassing. Why the heck does she think if she corners me into these social situations I'll just agree to save face? Well, jokes on you I don't give a damn about my social image!

-Cyra'

The last line made me laugh. I felt like I was getting a peek into what my mom was like as a kid. Which I kinda am but... it's nice knowing even she had her rebellious stage. I decided to skim a few pages and saw the Mystacore chapter. Her age as well.

This was the time she met Momma. They told me about how they met but it was very vague. This might be my best chance to get the details.

'I'm going to Mystacore! I finally calmed the kingdom down enough that I can afford a whole week to myself. It was at Leo's insistence saying I was overworking myself. Though it's nice to see some new scenery I've started hating looking at Halfmoon. I'll be leaving within a few days and I'm also going to see all the top sorceresses and sorcerers. I was so excited I don't know if I can sleep tonight. Maybe that's why I'm writing instead.

-Cyra.

I have never met someone as arrogant and selfish as that-'

I was shocked out of my reading by a knock on the door.

"Elizabeth?" Shit! I quickly pull out the drawer and shove the journal in.

"Hold on, I'm changing!" That was a bad excuse because when I opened the door mom stared me up and down confused. "Changed into your same clothes?" I looked down. Shit.

"Uhh..." She just laughed and rubbed my shoulder.

"Relax Elizabeth. You don't have to lie for me not to burst in just say you need a second." I nodded silently and rubbed my neck.

"Right sorry I was just... I don't know."

"It's alright. Today was weird but if you'd like... I've taken care of things and we can continue our plans?" I saw her soft face and smiled back.

"Of course!" I guess I got too excited because I shut the door hasher than intending unknowingly causing the drawer holding the journal to open a bit.

Chapter End Notes

Esme is embodiment of gaslight gatekeep girlboss... also I'm so excited to get more into Cyra's childhood!

Whatever it takes

Chapter Notes

> I'm back! I am so excited for the next chapter because it'll be the start of the finale for the 'Halfmoon arc' meaning things are about to get serious. As always enjoy!

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Grell walked with Esme down the halls giving her an intensive tour. Talking about nothing in particular. "And then I said, you call that a diamond? And showed her my wedding ring." Grell laughed then pointedly looked to her left hand. She subconsciously covered it.

"I stopped wearing it after his loss." She sounded hollow when she uttered the sentence. Grell made a mental note then stopped by a large door.

"And this will be where you are staying." Grell did a dramatic bow as he opened the guest room door for Esme.

"How lovely." The room wasn't just a guest room it used to be her room anyway, she was shocked to find everything preserved. The bed with a large privacy curtain, her vanity nicely preserved, and everything cleaned spotless. However, she noticed the new addition of family portraits covering the walls. She looked over to the few pictures she remembers being their family picture, she remembered it well because Cyra had bitten her, the scar still on her wrist under her fur. A curtain covered Esme's face.

She just removed the curtain staring at her late husband with an unreadable expression. Grell came up by her side starring at the portrait as well. "Cyra looks a lot like her father." Esme scoffed. Grell's eyes then narrowed towards her.
"You know I'm so glad you're back. I missed having you around. I remember hearing you call me and Cyra from miles away."

Esme laughed, "still a charmer I see."

"I try." Esme then noticed new pictures on a nearby shelf. She saw a Magicat with short brown hair, holding who she now knew was Elizabeth.

"Who is this?" Grell rolled his eyes.

"That's Azar. She's Cyra's wife." Esme frowned. She looked rugged, was Esme's first thoughts.

"Does she have any real title of her own?" Esme didn't fully believe Cyra, thinking she merely exaggerated this woman's skill to impress her. Grell huffed.

"She does. She was one of the top sorceresses of Mystacore. Even made her own magic division. Though she hasn't told anyone in what, so I think it's bullshit. Though that's not my place." Esme just hummed in thought. She then looked at the kit in the woman's arms. 'She looks so much like her.' She felt her ears go down.

"Is everything alright?" Esme quickly shook her head and perked back up.

"I'm alright it's just a shame you aren't together, I had so much money bet on you getting with her. I was so excited to have you added to our family tree." They laughed and then Grell got a smile.

"That might be a possibility." Esme stared confused. "You know I have a daughter now?" Esme nodded wordlessly. "Well, she and Elizabeth have been together for years. Vivianne is planning on proposing tomorrow."

"Oh, that's wonderful! You have to allow me to help out with the planning, seems we'll be connected through law." Grell then turned to her.

"Of course, unless..." Esme's ears perked up

"Unless what?" Grell turned his back to her a grin on his face.

"Oh, it's nothing just... A silly little rumor." Esme's tail went still as her body stiffened.

"What rumor?"

"Nothing more than playground gossip. Some people seem to believe you aren't Cyra's biological mother." Esme bared her teeth.

"Who the hell is saying that?!" Grell put his hands up in mock defense.

"As I said, dumb rumors. If anything it had more to do with kings Edgar's lack of loyalty in his younger years." Grell then crossed the room to pictures of Cyra. "Though, many saw it as suspicious no one saw you during your pregnancy. Not to mention Cyra shares a lot of traits with-"

"Quiet! I forbid you to compare Cyra to that... Woman! Retired or not I am a part of this monarchy meaning you must show me respect!" Grell was now starring in her face.

"Are you sure? Because some think your relation to the crown died in the war." Esme inhaled a sharp breath as the tense air in the room surrounded her. After a few beats of silence, Grell chuckled.

"But hey as I said nothing but rumors. I mean even if it were true we have no evidence." Then Grell gave her a pointed look. "Except in the archives two doors down the hall. Though that room is always heavily guarded. Except for large social events." The implication was clear.

Grell then strolled to the door giving Esme a reassuring grip on her shoulder. "See you tomorrow night?" He didn't wait for a response as he silently left the room leaving Esme alone with her thoughts.

Grell firmly shut the door behind him. "Dad? What were you doing?" Grell ushered Vivianne away from the room.

"Just giving Esme a tour."

"You know that wasn't what I was talking about." Grell sighed as he escorted his daughter down the hallway.

"I'm just making sure everything will be perfect for your proposal." Vivianne stopped in her tracks.

"Wait we're still doing that? I thought Cyra said-" Grell just puts a hand up to silence her.

"Don't worry I'm taking care of it." Vivianne bit her lip.

"Well, there was something I wanted to talk with you about..." Grell turned around giving her his full attention. "Maybe I should try just doing it the easy way and just ask Lizzy out?" Grell didn't even give that thought a chance.

"It'll take too long. Recent events have shown Cyra might be getting laxer with Elizabeth. It'll be pointless if she isn't around. Besides, I have assurance she'll say yes."

Vivianne stared confused. "What did you do?"

"I did nothing." Grell made a gesture and a blindfolded Magicat appeared from the dark.

Vivianne gasped as her tail fluffed up. "Dad-" Grell held his hand up to silence her and then held his hand out letting the Magicat place a piece of fabric in his hand.

"Elizabeth however did do something." Vivianne felt her fur fluff up in the presence of the Magicat. "This is all the evidence I need, not to mention they heard her voice in the chamber. I doubt she'll want her mothers to find out about her...escapade." Vivianne gulped.

"You- you can't do that." Grell ignored Viviane, his attention to the other magicat.

"Dismissed." The magicat bowed and disappeared into the shadows. Grell then looked back to Vivianne. "Everything is going to be fine. So just say your lines and keep track of the ring." Grell said the last sentence with a firm tone.

"Dad maybe-"

"Viviane enough. Now be a good girl and just-"

"No!" Grell paused.

"What did you say to me?" Viviannethen went from rebellious to curling in on herself. Her tail wrapped around her ankle anxiously

"I was talking with Lizzy and, she said we could start over. She's giving me a chance and... I wanna take it. I want Lizzy to want me. Blackmailing her is only going to make both of us miserable, This isn't what I wanted." Grell glared sharply at her then walked forward causing Vivianne to flinch as he grabbed her face.

"Are you seriously backing out now? After everything, I've done for you?" Vivianne growled as she shoved him away.

"Stop acting like you're doing this for me! I know you're only doing this to satiate your weird obsession with being 'in' with the royal family!" Her voice came out shaky with tears threatening to spill.

Grell scoffed then turned his head down. "I am doing this for you. It just so happens to align with my interest." He then looked up and walked towards her. Vivianne just stepped back till her back was to the wall. Grell leaned down to whisper in her ear.

"I'm giving you a chance to live the life of luxury with the woman you love. However, if that isn't enough to convince you. Remember this, I lost my wife because of you. Therefore you owe

me. Are we clear?" There it was. The tears went down her face as she tried to gasp for air.

"I- it wasn't... I didn't mean to." Grell just shushed her.

He stepped back, then reached for her face, her body telling her to pull back, but he just wiped her tears and smiled. "Now go get cleaned up. We can't have you using all your tears up before the proposal!" He pats her cheek as he walks back down the hall the piece of fabric gripped tightly in his hand.

Vivianne stutters out a breath as she harshly rubs her eyes. It wasn't until Grell was out of earshot another person appeared.

"Hey what's wrong?" Vivianne gasped as Leo appeared from the rafters. She then turned her back to them.

"Oh nothing, I just got stressed is all." Leo didn't buy it for a second.

"Why do you let him treat you like that?" Vivianne just shook her head. Leo couldn't hear most if not any parts of the conversation but they could tell Grell said something that made her upset.

"You wouldn't get it." She wrapped her arms around herself. Leo then gripped her shoulder. Vivianne looked up to them. Their eyes burning.

"Then help me, get it." Vivianne stared shocked at Leo. Then bared her fangs.

"Leave me alone!" Before Leo could reach for her Vivianne just ran away.

She needed to punch something.

Catra's POV

I walked along with my mom blindly not knowing what else we had planned today but she was content just walking with me close

behind.

Even though her journal helped restrain some questions I still craved more answers. I tried being subtle about it but mom always could read me like an open book.

She sighed as she pulled me aside as if someone could be listening. "I'm sorry you had to see me like that. I was caught off guard and... I had a lot of words to say to her." I shook my head.

"No, it's fine, from what I heard she isn't innocent." Mom laughed and rubbed my shoulder.

"Still, however mad I was at her I should've escorted her somewhere private. She apologized, whether I believe it or not is... questionable, but if she is sorry I don't want your relationship with her to be strained just because of how she treated me in the past. I want to believe she wants to be better."

Part of me thinks our relationship was doomed to be strained the second she got all up in my personal space without asking. Though she seemed hopeful.

"Sure, though seeing you go off on her was badass!" Mom rolled her eyes.

"Alright, I'll let that one slide. Though do not tell your mother about that conversation." I motioned zipping my mouth shut which made Cyra laugh. Then she pulled me back to where we were walking. "Well, now that's cleared up. I have something to show you." I nodded enthusiastically.

"Wherever you say, boss." Mom pulled me forward to walk side by side. I was expecting us to leave the castle but instead, she pulled me to the throne room. Then mom turned to give me a serious look. "Now, this is a secret only the royal family can know about so you have to swear you'll keep it secret." I felt my heart beat faster.

"Promise." She smiled back at me then dismissed the guards in the room. Once every door was shut tight. She pulled me towards the throne. She then stood on the chair and rotated the amber shard that sat in the top center. This causes the floor to shake and open up to a staircase behind the thrones.

My mom gets a smug look from my reaction. "Come along!" I eagerly follow behind her. The wall closed behind us leaving only the glow of the candles lighting the way.

Mom began confidently walking up the staircase, me following behind her. I looked at the walls and notice all the carvings. "What are all these?" Mom smiled as if waiting for me to ask.

"These are how we kept a record of important events. We still use it but it's more so for tradition than keeping records." Mom caressed the wall then stopped. "This one is from when you were born." I walk further up to see and my mom simply steps aside for me.

I recognized my moms holding a bundle in their arms that I assumed was me, but I looked at the picture right before it, and it was my moms standing over a grave. Mom noticed and took a stuttering breath.

"That was when your sister passed." I was shocked she even acknowledged it. Anytime my would have been sister, comes up mom isn't around or she tries to deflect the topic. "I wanted so badly to have multiple kits. Being an only child myself I knew how lonely I
It gets. Not to mention having siblings mean you will have someone to support you when your parents won't. I wanted to get in between you both to make you stop fighting. Making me and Azar grow gray hairs just trying to keep you guys from going at one another. See you both play around and drive each other crazy." Mom had a sad smile on her face.

"That sounds nice... Do you think you'll try again?" Mom sadly shook her head.

"I would but... Pregnancies for me always have complications. I still don't know why. I've been looked at by healers, doctors, even sorcerors all said they didn't know why. I have no family history of pregnancy troubles. At one point they told me there was no point in trying." Mom then looked at me with watery eyes. "Then you came along. My perfect anomaly, You should've seen the doctor's face when he saw you breathing. Despite all odds, you made it." Then she smiled. "I knew then you were a survivor. Then you only proved yourself, even more, when despite how you were treated you kept your compassion and kind heart."

Cyra wiped the tear I hadn't even noticed from my face. I quickly wiped the rest away myself. Then I just nodded not knowing what to say, luckily she didn't ask for an answer.

"Well let's keep going. I think I've had my fill of bad memories." I give a hum in acknowledgment, as I follow behind her staring at the wall. The only thoughts were about if I had a sister.

The step in front of me was slightly higher than the rest and I missed it completely. "Shit!" Mom grabbed me quickly me grasping her arm. She laughed gently as she helped me to my feet.

"Careful sweetie. You alright?" I nodded as she gave me a look over. Then her eyes zeroed in on my pants. "Oh, how'd you tear your pants?" I looked down confused. It didn't feel like they ripped. Then I remembered when I got that cut.

"Oh, I was climbing earlier and it got snagged on something." Mom narrowed her eyes. Then looked at my leg and saw the scratch mark. "I got cut by a rock. No big deal." She frowned. She didn't look like she believed me.

"Okay, well stay close to me we're almost at the top." I nodded and she kept me at an arm's length.

"Where are we going anyway?"

"You'll see." I huffed, which just caused mom to laugh. We made it to the top and I saw a long pathway leading to the runestone.

"Whoah." I looked over the edge and saw all the people running around in the town beneath me. I looked back up and saw mom continuing to the runestone and I quickly followed. It's a lot bigger up close.

It gave off a nice heat like an open fire. Mom then sat on the edge and gestured for me to join her. I sat next to her keeping my eyes on the stone. "I remember being so scared when I first came here." I turned to face her and I noticed she looked distantly at the runestone.

"Why?"

"I don't think the runestone ever wanted me. It was barely a week after my father's death and I had to bond with the runestone before it died out. It was a struggle. I couldn't control it and I had no one to teach me. I would legit have steam come out of my ears when I was upset." She laughed but all I craved was to see how 'angry Cyra with steam coming out of her ears' looked.

"Ever since Azar took on the power though, I love coming here. It's relaxing and the one place I can hide from people."

"Do you ever miss having that power?"

Mom firmly shook her head. "No, even if I did I doubt the runestone would come back to me after Azar. Besides I'm not a fan of magic anyway. I've seen too many people hurt because of it."

"So you married a sorceress?" Mom laughed.

"You know what they say if you can't beat them." We both laughed together then she went silent. "Elizabeth," I looked to her in acknowledgment.

Mom then gave me a serious look as she held my hands in hers. "Elizabeth, I never want you to be forced into that situation. So whenever you are ready let me know and I and Azar will help you all we can."

"I know." She then rubbed my cheek and I leaned into the contact gladly. She smiled then pulled me next to her hugging me gently on the side.

"We'll have to get Azar up here. She can do all sorts of cool tricks being so close to the amber." I nodded.

"That'd be fun to see." Mom leaned her head on mine and we just sat together staring at the swirling colors in the runestone.

Then mom laughed, "let's hope she doesn't set her tail on fire." I sat up a bit to look at her, my tail swaying.

"She set her tail on fire? You have to tell me everything!" She smiled as she thought back.

"Well, it was around the time Azar first arrived here and bonded with the amber."

Adora's POV

"Come on in." Azar escorted me to a room that looked as if it was a weapon bunker. The walls were covered in all types of weapons and maps. The dark oak desk by the back wall with two sofas in the middle of the room had blankets ganging off the edge.

It was the perfect mix of threatening and comforting.

Definitely Catra's mom.

Azar sat down on her desk, forgoing the chair behind it. She then crossed her legs. "So what's going on?" I gulped as I tried to think

of a way to explain everything. Before I could get a word out Azar stopped me.

"Know, I'm trying to help. I can't help if you lie to me. So decide now whether or not you want to tell me the full truth."

Azar stared straight into my eyes, her gaze never wavering. As anxious as I was I knew telling her about my trip to the Fright Zone can't really get me into trouble, since there are no rules against it. Not to mention, if Shadow Weaver knows how to teleport her back Azar might be one of the few who knows how to stop it.

"You don't have to tell me-"

"No, I do." I took a deep breath and cautiously took a seat. "So I went to the Fright Zone this morning to get... Something I forgot. Then as I was leaving-"

"Wait you went to the Fright Zone?!" I blinked at her outburst.

"Oh yeah, but that's not the issue-" Azar's jaw was on the floor.

"N-not the issue? You're telling me you snuck into the Fright zone, took something, and got out? In the span of... A few hours?!"

"Yeah, but like I said that isn't-" Azar was suddenly on the couch opposite of me.

"Do you know how long we have been trying to infiltrate the Fright Zone? And you just walked in and out without getting caught?" I felt a frown appear on my face.

"Not exactly." That's when Azar's curiosity went to concern. She was now looking at me intensely.

"Shit, were you followed?" I shook my head.

"No, the person who caught me was my old mentor. She... She offered me a deal." I had Azar's undivided attention as I took a

deep breath. "She also was me and Catra's commanding officer." I don't know how much Azar knows about Catra's relationship with Shadow weaver but her face told me she knew enough.

"She thinks I think Catra is dead. So when she found me she didn't fight me or sound any alarms. She said she wanted to make a deal. Promising that if I gave her information about the rebellion she'd be able to...bring Catra's body back to the Fright Zone." I finally looked up to Azar at the last second.

I was hoping to see her smiling and saying it was impossible but her face looked worried. She then made an audible gulp. "How much magic does she have access to?"

"She has a runestone." Azar's eyes widened.

"Shit." She stood up and started pacing as she ran a hand down her face. I stood up as I began to feel myself get anxious.

"Please tell me she was lying." Azar looked at me and her worried expression gave me my answer. "Is there anything we can do?" Azar took a deep breath. Then went to her desk, sitting in her chair this time.

"Thank you for telling me. I can handle it from here." I felt my eyes bulge out of my head.

"But I can help. No one knows the Fright Zone better than me. She told me to meet her in three days by the woods. I can talk to her or-" Azar sighed as she looked up to me.

"Adora, I appreciate you wanting to help but I can handle it. Just don't meet up with her. I should have more than enough time to find a repellant spell for Liz. Just keep this between us." She winked at me then went back to scrambling for something in her desk drawers.

"Are you sure?" I'm sure I could help with something if she would let me. Azar stood up, walked towards me, and put a reassuring hand on my shoulder.

"Adora you have already helped me by telling me about the spell. I also know I have to do a thorough spell-check on her. I knew she was around a sorceress but knowing she has a runestone adds a whole new problem, that I can now solve thanks to you. I promise I will come to you if I need help." I saw nothing but kindness in her eyes as she escorted me out.

I couldn't even argue. "Now go on with your day and I'll update you if anything happens." I nodded wordlessly as I go to exit the room. "Oh, Adora." I quickly turn around hoping she'll ask something of me.

"Yes?"

"Why on Etheria were you at the Fright Zone?" I felt myself flush.

"Oh uhh... Catra had something there she liked as a kid so I thought it would be a nice gift." I expected her to laugh at me, or the very least make me hand it over but instead, she just smiled.

"You're telling me you snuck into a highly fortified military fortress just to get Liz a birthday gift?" I nodded my head in shame. When she says it like that I sound stupid. She laughed fondly.

"Don't beat yourself up. That sounds like something I would do." I snap out of my shame to see her smirking at me with a knowing look. "Well, I won't keep you, run along." I nodded firmly and rushed out of her office. Relieved that went so well.

"Adora!"

Oh no. I look down the hall and see Glimmer running full speed in my direction. Once in front of me, she began talking so fast I could hardly keep up.

"Where were you? You left an hour ago, do you have any idea how worried we were? You still have to clean wrap C's gift!"

"Oh, crap Glimmer you're right. Sorry, I was talking with Azar about something but I'm all yours now!" Glimmer huffed then

pouted.

"Well, I already cleaned and wrapped it for you so forget it." I shrunk a bit feeling bad.

"Sorry Glimmer." She turned to me and then finally stopped her act.

"I'm just messing with you." Then she put her arm around my neck ruffling my hair making me have to crouch down.

"Glimmer!" She just laughed at my suffering. Then I heard a pointed cough. We both froze as we saw who it came from.

Vivianne.

"Princess Glimmer would you allow me to speak with Adora? It's important." Glimmer looked to me as if asking if I was okay with it. I looked to Vivianne and noticed she didn't look nearly as harsh as before in fact she looked pained if anything.

"Sure." I got out of Glimmers grip and gave her a general 'I'll be fine' gesture and she stared skeptically then puffed away in a cloud of glitter. I turn to Vivianne to ask what she wants but the second I do she's on one knee with her head down.

"I wanted to formally apologize for how I treated you."

Chapter End Notes

Feel free to leave comments and if you have any questions go to the link for my Tumblr where I answer any questions! 💜

http://lyssa-stone.tumblr.com

Things aren't lining up

Chapter Notes

> Gosh, this took a while to get out. Sorry for the late update like I said I ad family for the holidays and got swept up. Anyway hope you enjoy it and as always leave a comment! 💜 💜

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra couldn't say how long she and Cyra were sitting by the runestone. Their conversation faded off into a content silence. Catra laid her head on Cyra's shoulder and watched the runestone, feeling her eyes begin to get heavy.

Cyra noticed and rubbed her head, combing through her hair. "Alright come on. We have to prepare for dinner. Not to mention I have to tell Azar about the whole Esme situation." Catra groaned as she just leaned in putting her full weight on her mom.

"That sounds exhausting." Cyra laughed.

"Tell me about it." Cyra went to stand but Catra just gripped her tightly to keep her down.

"Five more minutes!" Cyra yelped as she was pushed down.

"Elizabeth!" Carra ignored her, laying on top of her mother. Cyra sighed and gave up. She put her hands back up to her head. "Okay just a little longer." Catra smiled as a purr rumbled through her chest. In the passing silence, Catra reflected on Cyra's journal.

She didn't question it at the time, far too overwhelmed by the surrounding information about Cyra's mother. Catra never knew where her real name came from. She always assumed it was after Elizabeth the first, whoever she was. But Cyra's journal made her think differently.

"Hey, mom?" Cyra just hummed in acknowledgment. "Who was I named after?" Cyra's breathing startled for a minute but kept rubbing Catra's head.

"That's kind of a difficult question. On paper, you're named after your great, great, great, you get the idea, grandmother, but I named you after my caretaker." Catra got her head out from her mother's neck and propped herself up to stare at her.

"What was she like?" Cyra smiled and Catra could see her zone out to reminisce.

"She was the best. I feel bad for how much I put her through. She was with me every second she was allowed. She would always play with me despite how tired she was, always there to cheer me up with baked goods after arguments with my father, and whenever I cried she would be right there to make everything feel better."

Catra laughed a bit her only thought being, 'so that's where she got it from.' Cyra stared at the runestone noticing it begin to dim. Before Cyra could speak up, no doubt about to say they needed to head back Catra spoke,

"Is she still around?"

Cyra's claws flexed but her response came out quick as if rehearsed. "No, she vanished after I got the news of my father." Catra frowned and Cyra knew, she could always just be able to tell when her daughter was upset. Cyra, wanting to change the subject excitedly remembering the funny memories.

"You know I hate orange juice." Catra's ears flicked as she stared confused. Cyra always had orange juice for breakfast. "I only drink it because of some dumb nickname I gave Elizabeth. She had ginger hair and round cheeks. So I always called her orange juice. One day someone, I don't know who told her that I didn't like it. She assumed I gave her that name to show my distaste for her.

She was so upset you'd think I yelled at her. I felt bad so I said I loved it." Cyra sighed.

"Of course her being her she got me a massive supply of them, and she would restock every time she saw it getting empty. It's a lie even Azar doesn't know about." Catra didn't know whether to laugh or be impressed.

"You seriously faked liking orange juice for the sake of someone's feelings? Wow, you're soft."
Cyra laughed as she quickly stood up with Catra attached to her, as Cyra held her up. Cyra had her in her arms like an oversized toddler.

"Alright enough," Cyra said as she laughed at Catra trying to get out of her mother's grasp but Cyra didn't relent.

"Uhgg I hate when you do this!" Cyra laughed as she placed her down.

"Now come on dinner will be ready and I know we didn't have time for lunch so I expect you to eat lots." Catra rolled her eyes as they both walked back down the staircase.

"Oh please, I could starve for months and be full just eating the entrees we have for tomorrow. Seriously I've never seen so much food being prepared in the kitchen." Cyra scoffed.

"Well considering Adora seems to have a black hole where her stomach should be it might not be enough." Catra laughed.

"Yeah eating nothing but ration bars has that effect on people." Cyra cringed.

"I can imagine." They arrived at the entrance swiftly.

"So, how long is Esme going to stay here?" Cyra sighed.

"That's something I need to talk with Azar about. I know she's staying for tomorrow but that's all I got from her." Catra nodded.

They both arrived back at the throne room in silence, the pathway closing behind us.

"Cy?!" Cyra's ears perked up as she turned to see her wife frantically looking for her. Once noticed she ran straight to Cyra. "Oh, my stars you're not going to believe this! I just saw your mom! Like alive!"

"I know Azar, I was just about to come to talk to you about it." Azar looked dumbstruck.

"Why didn't you come to tell me?" Cyra sighed and walked to Azar.

"Come on let's talk somewhere more private. Catra we'll meet you for dinner alright?" Catra nodded wordlessly as Cyra dragged Azar off.

"Seriously what is going on?" Cyra was walking them to their room but just gave up on waiting till they were at their quarters.

"I'm still figuring it out myself. She just showed up. She didnt feel ready to rule so she faked her death and left me to take care of the kingdom." Cyra's hand that was hanging off Azar's arm flexed a bit. "So now she's here to apologize and try and be a part of Elizabeth's life. I said I was willing to give her a chance." Azar flinched.

"Judging by your claws sinking into me it wasn't an easy decision." Cyra released Azar with an apologetic smile. Azar chuckled and wrapped her arm around Cyra's shoulders.

"Well, I'll always do my best to support you, even though this sounds like a bad idea." Cyra playfully elbowed Azar.

"Well, Leo is keeping an eye on her. I'm going to talk with her more but I just want to make it through tomorrow with no issues."

"Yeah, I assumed." Arriving at their room Azar held the door open for her and Cyra walled in with thanks. They had some time to kill before dinner. Azar planning to get in a quick shower.

"Azar I wanted to speak with you about something." Azar turned to face her.

"Cy if it's about your mom you don't need to feel bad. This is quite literally more your kingdom than mine. You don't have to ask me if she can stay." Cyra laughed but shook her head.

"No, it's not about that. I was talking with Elizabeth...about last night." Azar paused what she was doing and quickly began removing her necklace with her back to Cyra.

"I'm surprised she remembered she was really out of it when she came to me." Azar went to the opposite side of the room putting the necklace in its case, purposely avoiding Cyra's gaze.

Cyra crossed her arms. "Azar you know what this is about. Why on Etheria would you mess with Elizabeth's memories!"

"I didn't-"

"Don't lie to me! Stars how dumb do you think I am? Why would you do that? What if something went wrong and that failsafe activated?"

"I was careful!"

"So you admit it!" Azar just turned towards the bathroom. She didnt want to argue about this. Cyra grabbed her before she could leave. "Azar." When she looked at Cyra she was visibly upset. "Why?"

Azar just shoved her hand away. Cyra refused to let herself be ignored. She quickly got in front of Azar blocking her path. "Why!" It sounded more like a demand than a question.

"It was from the invasion and she wanted to forget about it. Happy?" Azar hoped that was the end of it, trying to sidestep Cyra but she remained in front of her.

"No! You can't just erase memories she doesn't like, and I highly doubt she asked you to erase anything considering she's been trying to gain as many memories as possible! Why are you lying to me?" Azar didnt respond. turning her head to not face her.

Cyra hated when Azar did this. Completely shutting her out with no explanation. "Fine, just ignore me." Cyra stepped out of Azar's way. "I expect Elizabeth to have her memories returned immediately." Cyra was seething.

The last thing Azar wanted was to have Cyra upset with her, especially so close to Elizabeth's birthday. "Cy-" the door slammed as Cyra left the room. Azar could hear her muttering as she walked down the hall. Azar ran a hand down her face.

"Fuck."

Adora's POV

"Uhh..." I didnt know what to say to Vivianne just crouched down on her knee. Vivianne's shoulders tense and refusing to look me in the eye. More silence passed as I stared at her.

I decided to fill the silence myself. "You're fine please just stand up." Like my words commanded her she stood up quickly. Still refusing to look me in the eye. I tried to lighten the mood but Vivianne suddenly got a new wave of confidence.

"Look, I'm only apologizing because Lizzy asked me to, she's special to me and for some reason, you're special to her. So we play nice with each other and she'll be happy" I gave a forced laugh.

"Well I'm not much of an actress, so maybe we could actually... Try and get along?" Vivianne's tail started to lash.

"No." I frowned. What was her problem with me?

"Why do you dislike me so much? We seemed fine when I first arrived, so what changed?" Vivianne scoffed as she crossed her arms.

"You don't know?"

"Obviously not." I saw Vivianne's eye twitch. She then stared at me as if trying to see if I was playing dumb.

I wasn't.

"Because..." Her ears dropped and her gaze dropped to the floor. "Because she obviously favors you over me."

"What? Who?"

Vivianne growled. "Elizabeth! You come back after years of her not seeing you and she already has everything I've been trying to get for years! She wants to hang out with you, she wants to talk with you, she wants...you." Vivianne looked defeated.

I was in disbelief. "Wait so you're jealous of me?" Vivianne scoffed. I realized how conceited that sounded. "Well more so jealous of my relationship with Catra- er Elizabeth."

"Like I said you get everything I've ever wanted. She to this day has never hugged me! Never willing anyway." I felt bad. Maybe I shouldn't take Catra's affections so lightly.

As long as I've known her Catra has always been a touchy person. So much so she would hang off of me. Until Shadow weaver...

"I'm kinda jealous of you." Vivianne rolled her eyes.

"I don't need your comfort."

"No, I'm serious. I mean you grew up with her, I could never compete with that. The most I got was seeing her as a kid and

seeing her now. She changed a lot. I wish I could've been there to see the change myself."

Vivianne then got a distant look in her eyes, as if reminiscing. "For the longest time, I didn't understand why she was the way she was. I wasn't told she was from the Horde till later in my life. So I just thought she was a sheltered kit. She rarely left her mother's side when she first arrived. I was one of the only girls around her age so I thought it would guarantee our friendship but... I took it for granted."

I frowned. Vivianne didn't seem so bad. I was wondering if this was the Vivianne Catra talked about. The one Catra enjoyed being around.

"Well for what it's worth. I think you're great, and I'm glad you are there for Catra. Dont tell her I told you this but, she talked to me about how much she enjoys spending time with you." Vivianne gave me a genuine smile. Then frowned.

"You should stay close to Lizzy tomorrow." I tilted my head at the subject change.

"What?" Vivianne's ear twitched. She then grabbed me by my shoulders.

"Stay by her side during the celebration after the ceremony. Dont leave her alone. With anybody...especially my dad."

"W-wait..." Vivianne then rushed down the hall without another word. I stared at where she left.

What did she mean?

"Sneak attack!"

Huh?

I went to turn around but felt a weight on my back. Then I heard a squeaky laugh. "Catra!" Like instinct, I put my hands under

Catra's legs to support her.

I fought a laugh myself as Catra clutched my shoulders. "Piece of advice, yelling sneak attack before sneak attacking someone isn't the best idea. Catra ignored me.

"What were you and Vivianne talking about?" I tensed up a bit hoping she didnt hear much.

"She was apologizing."

Catra got a soft smile on her face.

"That's nice of her." I rolled my eyes.

"Oh, I know it's like someone asked her to apologize." Catra scoffed.

"Maybe," I smirked as I jostled Catra a bit.

"So are you gonna get down or do I have to carry you?" Catra laughed then pointed her finger forward.

"To the dining room my stead!" I complied and began walking to where Catra pointed. Not able to think back to where the dining room is.

"Anything you need, princess." I know could hear my smugness. I practically felt Catra roll her eyes. She then lowered to my ear.

"Aren't you a princess? When you're all tall?" I felt flush at Catra's voice directly in my ear.

"Yep, princess of power."

Catra laughed way too hard she almost fell off my back. "Isn't that pretentious? And I thought princess of sparkles was dumb. So do you shoot beams of power out of your hands?" Catra laughed again.

"Ha. Ha. Brat."

Catra gave a weak 'hmmp' as she laid her head down on my shoulder. I felt a slight rumble from her chest. "Tired?" Catra nodded.

"It's been a day."

I was about to respond until Catra's ears twitched and suddenly her head went up and she dropped from my back. Before I could ask why a white-haired magicat came around the corner.

"Oh, Elizabeth and company..." I didnt like the way she looked at me. As if I was an afterthought.

"Adora this is Esme-"

She extended her hand to me. "Also known as the former queen of Halfmoon. Who are you?"

"Adora." I went to shake her hand but she pulled her hand back.

"Title?"

"Uhh..." Catra stepped up.

"She's the main strategist for the rebellion and founder of the new princess alliance." Esme then grabbed my hand and shook my hand.

"Nice to meet you. I don't think I've ever seen an Etherian in Halfmoon. Usually, we don't allow them here. Especially in the castle." She gave a pointed look to Catra. "Are you heading to the dining room? I was just heading there myself. Why don't we go there together?"

Before I could respond Catra grabbed my arm. "We were heading to Adora's room. She wanted to show me some gadgets she got from the rebellion. We'll meet you down there in a minute."

Esme gave a skeptical look but ultimately nodded. "Don't be too long." Catra nodded and then dragged me in the opposite

direction to where we were heading.

"Who was that?"

"My grandmother technically, but she just showed up today. Just wanted to warn you, my mom does not have a good relationship with her and we all thought she was dead until today." I smirked.

"Runs in the family I see." Catra took a second to process then smacked my shoulder.

"Oh, shut up now come on let's get dinner before Bow steals all the good stuff." I laughed as she led me along.

Catra's POV

Somethings wrong.

I and Adora came into the room and everything was normal, we were greeted by sparkles and arrows and my mom's. Everyone was in their usual seats. I thought maybe I was being paranoid until I heard my mom.

"Elizabeth could you pass me a napkin."

She and momma are fighting. I nodded and handed it to her. I saw momma's ears twitch. Whenever mom needed something momma was always the first person to do it, so much so she only asked her for anything she needed.

Not only did mom ask me but momma is now glaring at her while mom isn't batting an eye. It's kind of fun to watch. I tap Adora's thigh with my tail.

She looks at me with her mouth stuffed I then gesture to my parents.

Adora gulped down her food. "Are they okay?" She whispered. I laughed. My moms did not notice as they kept actively avoiding each other.

"They're fighting."

Adora let out an 'oh' sound then took another bite of her food. "Is it bad?" I shrugged my shoulders. As far as I knew they were fine this morning.

"So Elizabeth are you excited for tomorrow?" I was startled slightly as I saw Esme sitting across from me resting her face on both of her hands with a shallow smile.

I looked over to my moms to see if I should respond but they were in their world of being petty. "Yeah." I was hoping Esme would get the hint I didn't want to talk with her but she continued.

"Oh, you should be ecstatic! This is a big deal, eighteen is when all the fun stuff happens." I just shrugged as I took a big bite of my food hoping if she saw I couldn't talk she would just talk with herself. "You know it's around this time you get to have all the fun in the sheets."

I choked on my food and mom had a similar reaction while drinking water. "Esme!" She put her hands up.

"I was kidding." Adora patted my back as I tried to get air back into my lungs. I didn't even know how to respond.

"Uhh-"

"Elizabeth you don't need to respond to that." I sighed as mom gave me an out.

"Stars Cyra I was joking lighten up a little. You know you were around her age when you started-" mom flushed,

"Stop now or you can finish your meal alone." Esme rolled her eyes then began picking at her food. That was so uncomfortable. Adora must've felt me tense because she started petting my tail that I left in her lap.

When I looked at her she gave me the 'are you okay?' Look. I nodded back.

I just want this meal to be over.

"So Azar was it?" I relaxed at Esme's new target. Though momma was already upset and she didn't have a filter like mom.

"Yep, though I'm surprised you haven't heard of me," she then stared straight into Esme's eyes. "My wife told me you were staying in Mystacore while hiding from responsibility, considering I was one of the top sorceresses not to mention one of the two magicats that resided there I never saw you. Even with my abrupt visits there from time to time."

I looked at Esme and her face looked pale despite her already white fur. She laughed it off. "Two ships passing in the night." Luckily that was the last she spoke for dinner.

Momma must've freaked her out.

I continued eating until Adora tapped on my tail. I turned to her and she had a smile on her face as she gestured to my moms.

Looks like momma was trying to win mom back. Despite their subtlety. I could see momma's tail tickling Mom's side as she tried to fight laughter.

Then mom stood up abruptly. "Well it's been a long day today and we have a longer one tomorrow. Esme if you don't mind I would like to talk with you outside. She huffed as she followed mom.

Momma gave me a quick kiss on the head. "Goodnight."

"Night." Then she followed mom out of the room.

"Aww." The dubbed 'best friend squad' all said at the same time.

"Shut up!" I felt my tail lash as I left with Adora snickering behind me. Before I closed the door I looked back as I saw Bow and Glimmer talking with Adora staring back at me. She smiled as she gave a wave.

I waved back and headed back to my room. I'm so tired.

I was halfway there to bedrest until Grell saw me.

Ah shit.

"Elizabeth, just who I was looking for." Of course.

"Can this wait till the morning? Please?" Grell smiled.

"Afraid not, you see I heard-"

"Dad!" I craned my neck and saw Vivianne running at us full speed. Grell growled.

"Vivianne, I am."

"There's an emergency! Uh, some kit went missing, and her mom is going crazy and causing the paranoia!" Grell sighed. Then smiled at me.

"I guess it can wait till morning." I noticed his glare at Vivianne. Once he's out of earshot I thank Vivianne.

"Thanks did not want to deal with that." Vivianne laughed.

"Yeah... Well, I'll let you sleep. Bug day tomorrow." I nodded. Vivianne went to walk away but my words stopped her in her tracks.

"Thanks by the way." Vivianne turned to look at me confused. "For apologizing. I know you didnt want to but... Thanks." Vivianne smiled.

"As I said wanted a new start. Besides something tells me if I'm on Adora's bad side ill be on yours as well." I laughed.

"Yeah." I noticed a hint of a frown go on her face.

"It's the same for you too. Tell me who on your bad side and I'll fight em'." That got Vivianne to laugh.

"Will do." Content with that I went into my room my body finally relaxing as the door closes.

If today wore me out tomorrow is gonna be a nightmare. I laughed at the thought.

Yeah right. Despite how worn out I am after my birthday I'm never bored with it. Mom makes sure of that. Even for my first birthday here she didn't throw a big party just me, her, and momma.

I knew mom wanted something big but didnt want to overwhelm me. I smiled at the memory as I changed into some sleepwear.

I flopped down onto the bed ready to bud the world goodbye until I heard a voice.

"C, wake up!"

Chapter End Notes

Hope you had a great holiday if you celebrate and have a happy new year! 💜 💜

Preparations and more preparations

Chapter Notes

> This was supposed to already get through Catra's birthday ceremony...oops

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Adora's POV

"Adora wake up!"

Before I could even respond I was hit by a pillow causing me to jump out of bed with my fists up. "Huh? What!"

"Glimmer relax. You-" Bow was cut off by a yawn, "are freaking her out." I had to rub my eyes adjusting to the dark.

I see Glimmer with her hands on her hips while Bow looks about as tired as I feel I also see him holding some wrapped boxes and a bag. "What's going on?" Glimmer looks as if she is about to explain until she checks the time

"Oh, we're running behind!" She then grabbed my hand dragging me out of bed and grabbing Bow on her way to who knows where.

"What is going on!" Bow sighs as Glimmer who is ever so determined to continue ahead.

Bow laughs. "Catra gets a lot of gifts on her birthday for obvious reasons. So for time's sake, she can't open all of them. So I and Glimmer started a tradition of giving her gifts right at midnight to make sure she sees them. Also, Glimmer wants to be first." I hear Glimmer grumble.

I laugh at the thought of Glimmer staying up till midnight just to be first.

Glimmer refused to stop her stride as she led us to Catra's room. Luckily my tiredness turned to excitement the closer we got. Suddenly Glimmer stopped.

"Azar?" Bow and I looked over Glimmer's shoulders and sure enough, Azar was sitting against a door dozing off. Hearing Glimmer's voice she jumped.

"Oh hey. Is it midnight already?" Glimmer gave a forced laugh.

"Almost, so what are you doing... Out here?" Azar smiled sheepishly.

"Cy is upset with me so I can't sleep with her tonight." Glimmer still looked confused.

"Dont you have like... A million guest rooms?" Azar laughed though her eyebags didnt fool us.

"Yeah but if I stay out here Cy will eventually find me and she'll feel bad enough to let me back in." She gave a wink.

"I heard that!"

Cyra's voice came from behind the door. Azar flinched a bit. Then she waved her hand, "well you guys better run along! Almost midnight."

Sure enough, Glimmer looked to the clock and panicked. "Crap! Come on!" Without another word, Glimmer grabbed us and teleported.

I expected to be in Catra's room but we were a few doors down. As if hearing my confusion Glimmer spoke in a hushed voice. "She can hear my teleports so it's easier to just sneak in normally."

"Okay..." I decided not to question her methods considering she had been doing this for who knows how long. "Alright, this is the hard part."

We walked towards the door and like a practices art Glimmer slowly and quietly turns the handle. She gives a pointed look to Bow who just zips his lips.

Glimmer then cracked the door ushering us inside. Her hands waving in a 'quickly quickly' motion. Once in the room Glimmer shuts the door just as quietly as she opened it.

I was honestly impressed, I dont think I've ever seen her be this quiet and planned. She then shooed Bow somewhere and he nodded.

Was there a debriefing I missed?

Glimmer then pointed to Catra. She then made an 'X' with her arms then a sleeping motion. I stared at her utterly confused. She strangled the air then pulled me down to whisper so quietly I almost missed ut entirely.

"Make sure she doesn't wake up." Glimmer then backed away and she gave me a thumbs up then went to join Bow.

At least I got an easy job.

I walked over to a chair that was conveniently right by the head of her bed and decided to just sit there.

Turns out this was the hardest job.

Not even a foot away from me was Catra laying curled up on a literal cloud of blankets curled into a cute ball with twitching ears and hair framing her face.

Definitely the hardest job.

How am I supposed to just watch her and not squeal with cuteness? I was so... Entranced that I didn't notice Bow slide up next to me.

"Glimmer took me off Catra duty when I kept squealing." He spoke quietly causing Catra's ear to twitch slightly. We both held our breaths for a moment we both sighed with relief when she didn't stir.

We both smiled at each other.

My gaze was pulled violently back to Catra as if my brain couldn't have me focus on anything else. Bow seemed to share the sentiment.

As I stared I noticed Catra kneading in her sleep, which wasn't uncommon. She did it all the time when she was a kit. Though my arms and legs were the victims. I didnt mind.

Though seeing her new victim made my heart clench. I never thought Glimmer was lying but seeing her cling to the blue blanket I gave to her, what felt like centuries ago I could tell Bow noticed my revelation.

I was seconds from having to cover up my mouth until Glimmer joined us. "It's time!"

She then tapped Catra on the nose.

"C, wake up!"

Catra's nose twitched, then her ears turned to the sound, finally, she began to blink her eyes open. Once she recognized the smiling person leaning over her she groaned and hit Glimmer with her pillow.

"Ow!"

"Go back to sleep." Glimmer huffed and shook Catra.

"Happy birthday!"

Despite Catra's fake annoyance as she fought with Glimmer she still had a hint of a smile on her face.

It made me smile.

Bow laughed as he grabbed both of the girl's shoulders. "Alright alright, enough fighting we have gifts!" Catra rolled her eyes.

"I guess I can tolerate you guys for free stuff." Glimmer shoved her as they stood up.

"Brat." Catra stuck the tip of her tongue out at her. Then Catra seemed to notice me and smiled.

"Hey, Adora."

"Hey, Catra."

"Uhgg, come on no time!" Glimmer then dragged us to a small circle set up with the gifts in the middle.

I sat next to Catra and Glimmer pounced on her, shoving a box in her arms. "Mine first, mine first!" Catra laughed.

"I dont know I think I want to open this one." Catra jokingly reached for another box but Glimmer tackled her.

"No way!" Catra laughed.

"Okay okay!" Catra sat crisscrossed on the floor. Placed the pastel blue box with a purple bow on her lap.

Catra gently undid the bow and as she went to lift the lid she looked to Glimmer skeptically. "This isn't another glitter bomb is it?" I fought to hold a laugh with that mental image.

"No, this one is glitter bomb-free!" Catra rolled her eyes.

Catra then lifted the lid and looked in and saw something wrapped in pastel pink paper. Catra raised an eyebrow at Glimmer. "Pastels?" Glimmer rolled her eyes.

"Just hurry up!"

Catra pulled the item out of the box and gently pulled the paper away. Revealing a gorgeous book-lined with golden vines and red roses. I didn't know what it was but Catra was infatuated.

"I know you're obsessed with that story so I got you the limited edition. It includes concept art, writers' notes, and..." Glimmer opened the book to one of the first pages, "signed."

I didn't understand the significance but Catra looked absolutely flabbergasted.

"Sparkles I don't... How? I dont even know what to say!" Glimmer laughed.

"How about thank you?" Catra laughed.

"Thank you. Seriously. This is awesome." Glimmer then got a soft smile on her face.

"Don't mention it." The way Catra's hands lined the title, lined with vines. Catra looked absolutely enamored.

I suddenly felt like my gift couldn't follow up. Glimmer seemed to revel in the way Catra was obviously in love with her gift.

"Oh! This is from my mom. Said she would ground me for life if I didn't give it to you." Catra smiled.

"Jeez, what's with Brightmoon and bright colors." She said as she examined the purple box.

Without another word, she opened it and once again was rendered speechless. I had no idea what exactly it was. All I saw was a bunch of tubes with stripes of colors.

"What are these?" Catra smiled.

"They're paints. We don't have them down here so I would always have to get mine from travel merchants. Though being Angella she of course got some of the fanciest ones I've been dreaming

about." Catra then saw a card left in the box and eagerly opened it.

I not so subtly tried to lean over to see what it said to which Catra just moved closer to me so I could see.

It was a simple and sweet message.

'Happy birthday Catra I hope you enjoy your gift and have a perfect birthday.' It wasn't in her usual formal writing making it seem more personal.

Catra seemed to appreciate it. Suddenly Bow clapped. "Soooo..." Catra laughed.

"Alright arrows. Bring it here." He smiled as he handed her a bag. Catra opened it and got a smirk on her face. "Oh, you shouldn't have." Bow laughed.

"I know I know but..." Bow tapped the screen of the new trackpad. "Not only is it more advanced. It also has photo capabilities, so I and Glimmer took pictures of our adventures."

The pictures were rolling a lot of them being Bow taking a selfie while Glimmer and I were fighting. Catra laughed then got a distant look on her face. "Thanks this is awesome. I wish I could've been there."

Silence spread through the room as Bow and Glimmer looked at each other.

Before it stretched for too long Glimmer spoke up excitingly. "Adora next!" Catra's ears perked up.

"Really? How am I not surprised." I flushed.

"It's not that great it was last minute, impossible to find anything still in stock, you know what forget it." I went to snatch it but Catra's reflexes were too quick.

"Oh, now I have to see it!"

"Catra!" I tackled her down with her laughing trying to get the gift out of her hand. "You brat!" Despite my words, I know I had a smile on my face.

Despite me pinning her down I was pulled back by two sets of hands. "Oh no, she is opening that!"

"Especially with all the stress you put us under to get it!"

Catra laughed and quickly opened it before I could get out of the weak attempt at a hold.

Once Catra opened it I cringed in fear.

She's gonna hate it. Then she's gonna do that thing where she just pretends to like it for my sake.

"Adora where did you get this?" I looked up when I heard her voice and she was smiling.

Like really smiling.

"Uh..."

"Seriously I've been trying to get something like this for years. Blacksmiths always made it wrong and I couldn't find any that were lightweight but sturdy. This is the same color as my old one too!" I smiled sheepishly.

"Yeah because it's the same one." Catra stared wide-eyed at me.

"But I thought..." Glimmer jumped in.

"Yeah, she went to the Fright zone just to get it!"

"Adora!" I shrugged.

"I didnt have enough time and everything was sold out at the market." Catra laughed.

"So you just infiltrated the Fright zone?"

"Well, when you say it like that." We all laughed. Except for Catra who was stunned.

"You went to the Fright zone for a gift?" I stared confused at her.

"Of course I did. You said that was important to you." Catra stared at me intensely her ear twitching slightly.

I was snapped out of my staring by Glimmer's exaggerated yawn. "Well C has a long day tomorrow." Glimmer then grabbed my shoulders. "So let's get out of her matted hair." Catra flicked her off as Bow rolled his eyes.

I frowned. I was hoping to talk with Catra a little longer. Especially since she will no doubt be surrounded by people tomorrow.

Glimmer noticed.

"Oh, crap Bow I forgot our uh... Yeah!"

"Wait!" Then Bow was whisked away in sparkles. I and Catra looked at each other and started laughing.

"Real subtle," Catra smirked.

"Oh please, they don't have a single 'subtle' bone in their bodies." Catra looked down at the headpiece in her hands.

"You know you can tell me if you don't like it. I'm a big girl." I flexed jokingly and got a good laugh out of Catra. She then placed it in her lap as she raised her arms to undo her hair from its now usual ponytail.

She shook her head slightly to even it out then maneuvered the mask into place. She turned to me. "How's it look?" I wanted to laugh and tease her but my heart stuttered.

It fit. Almost too perfectly.

"G-good. Looks good!" I then gave an awkward thumbs up. Catra laughed in my face.

"Perfect." I laughed forcefully.

"I-I should go huh?" Catra shrugged.

"Up to you." It isn't fair how she said that.

"Well- uhh... Night!" Catra grabbed my wrist and before I knew it I was in a tight embrace. I fell forward a bit grabbing her waist with one hand and my other bracing myself on the floor.

As quickly as it started Catra pulled back. "Thanks, really. It's gonna be hard to top this next year." I raised a brow at her.

"Next year?"

"Oh yeah, you're stuck with me now." I laughed as she pulled back and offered me a hand to stand up. I accepted it and once on my feet, she let go of my hand.

I should go. But saying goodbye felt wrong.

"Well, see you tomorrow?" Catra smiled and nodded.

"Of course dummy." Catra playfully smacked my back. "Now go I need my beauty sleep."

"I think you have plenty."

Luckily Catra just laughed that off. "What a charmer." I put my weight on Catra.

"Indeed." She groaned as she pushed me out her door.

"Go to bed. Also, dont think you're off the hook about the Fright zone." I laughed.

"I would never princess." That got an eye roll, though she smiled.

"Seriously though. See you tomorrow?"

"Definitely!"

Tomorrow was far too close.

Before Catra knew it she had put away her gifts, her new headpiece on her bedside table, crawled into bed, and was jarred awake."

"Liz."

Catra just covered her face with a pillow. "Too early." Catra recognized Azar's chuckle.

"Funny your mom said the same thing." She suddenly pulled back the blankets, causing Catra to curl into herself from the cold. "Momma five more minutes!" Azar just rolled her eyes.

"Oh alright, I mean Cy made your favorite for breakfast. But you can wait I'm sure your friends will leave some leftovers." Catra glared at her mother over her pillow.

"Cheater."

Azar laughed as Catra sat up to get dressed. "I'll meet you in the dining room." Right before her exit Azar turned back around. "Happy birthday!" Catra rolled her eyes as Azar left.

She decided to just wear loose pants and a tank top considering pretty soon she'll be in her formal attire all day.

She rushed down to breakfast hoping to get the first batch. Catra almost ran into Leo who was patiently waiting for her down the hall.

"Whoah slow down. Your mother made plenty for you all." Catra let out a 'pshh' sound.

"I wasn't rushing for that I was uhh.." The raise in Leo's brow showed they didnt fall for it. Defeated Catra sighed.

"Okay, you caught me." Leo shook her head fondly.

"Right this way princess." Catra cringed.

"I hate when you do that." Leo just laughed in her face.

Once in the dining room, Cyra instantly ran to Catra as she sat down. "Good morning!" Cyra then squished her face and pulled Catra's face to hers kissing her cheek. "Happy birthday sweetie!"

"Ew, mom!" They laughed as Cyra went and grabbed a nearby tray and placed it in front of Catra and opened the top. It held the most perfect stack of pancakes.

"Dig in, your drooling." Catra didnt have to be told twice.

Despite Azar's threat Glimmer and Bow didnt roll out of bed till five minutes later. Adora looked wide awake next to them but she was bouncing on her heels looking at the food.

"Hey, Adora you can sit next to me." Before Adora could accept Azar grabbed her shoulder.

"Sorry, Liz I need to speak with her about something really quick!" Adora only got to frown at her lost meal as Azar dragged her out of the room.

"What's up with her?" The question was directed at Cyra but she only crossed her arms.

"Stars if I know." Catra just assumed they were still arguing. Though she was curious about what Adora and her momma had to talk about.

"So Elizabeth I know you dont like to waste time so on all the traditional stuff so luckily you are free till twelve. That's when I

need you back in your room to begin getting ready." Catra tilted her head.

"Doesn't it start at six?" Cyra laughed as she pats Catra's head.

"Trust me I need a lot of time with this." She then ruffled Catra's hair. Glimmer didnt even laugh as she swayed in her seat.

"Tired sparkles?" Catra was loving this. Glimmer just glared yet the bags under her eyes told a different story.

Even Bow looked out of it but ever the optimist still tried smiling through it. Cyra then began to give Catra a run-down of the day. No matter how old she is Catra always appreciates knowing everything beforehand.

Though her ears twitched to hear Azar and Adora's conversation.

Adora tried to hide her disappointment at the missed breakfast but Azar caught on quick. "Don't worry I'll let you go I just needed to speak with you about the spell." Adora became more attentive.

"Well?" Azar sighed then pulled a purple vile out from her pocket.

"This should make the spell ineffective... But only for a few hours. I could try and just give it to her like medicine but the herbs required are native to Plumeria, somewhere we don't have trade access to. I was able to make five." Adora perked up at the mention of Plumeria.

"We were there recently! Princess Perfuma joined the rebellion. I'm sure we could negotiate an arrangement." Azara thought on it.

"Would that work? I mean she doesn't know us. Not to mention we're not in the rebellion." Adora tried to let it come out seamlessly. This was her chance.

"Well, the rebellion is open if Halfmoon would like to join." Azar shook her head.

"That-"

"Just think about how happy it would make Catra." Adora tried to use the information from Glimmer. "She can fight too and Glimmer, me Bow, and the whole rebellion will keep an eye on her and-" Azar stuck her hand up.

"I know. Trust me, but that isn't my decision. If you want to plead your case you should do it to Cy." Adora frowned. She found it easier to plead to Azar. She laughed as she grasped Adora's shoulder. "Trust me kid Cyra is significantly easier to talk to. Just stubborn." That made Adora chuckle.

"Whatever you say."

Catra stopped all conversation when she heard the door open and Adora walked through. "Hey, Adora sorry but you missed it there's no more breakfast left." Catra laughed at Adora's sad face until Cura flicked her ear gently.

"Be nice. Adora, we have more than enough for you she's just being a brat." Catra stuck her tounge out at her mother.

Adora just took her seat next to Catra as breakfast went on with everyone speaking with each other... Except for Cyra and Azar.

After a good thirty minutes of preparing for the day a guard came into the room simply nodding before Azar stood up and excused herself. Cyra sighed. "Guess it's that time. Remember your room by 12 Elizabeth. Your formal attire for you all should be laid out by then. If you need anything let a nearby guard or maid know."

The best friend squad gave their thanks as Cyra left the room. Glimmer then bumped shoulders with Cyra. "Excited for today?" Catra shrugged.

"I don't know there is a whole ceremony beforehand, which isn't new. Though my mom says this one is a bigger deal. I just want to get to the fun part."

"This will be Adora's first official party." Catra turned to Adora.

"Really?" She nodded. Catra smiled, "ill make sure to show you how it's done." She winked at Adora to which Adora laughed her off. All while Bow and Glimmer looked to each other knowingly.

"Cyra?" Interrupted by an all too familiar voice Cyra sighed as she turned around.

"Yes, Esme." She cringed slightly at the way Cyra spat her name. Esme stood still staring at her. Sighing Cyra dismissed the guard she was speaking to. "Listen I have a lot to do today so I don't have the time to argue. Nor the time to listen to you so if you could just-"

"I want to help." Cyra stopped her speech. "I want to prove I am trying to change. So let me help. I know it's a lot for these things I could help." Cyra raised a skeptical brow. She was hesitant. Esme smiled, "what happened to let me have a second chance to prove myself?"

Cyra sighed. "Fine but if you do anything to"

"Perfect!" Esme just as quickly dragged Cyra off. "Where to first?" Cyra was regretting this immensely.

Chapter End Notes

Hope you enjoyed it as always leave a comment 💜 💜

Work off some nerves

Chapter Notes

> Sorry for the late update life got in the way and I'm in the process of switching depression meds so I went through some weird stuff... Anyway enjoy the chapter low key almost cried at the end of this chapter so do with that what you will.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Catra's POV

"Adora stop!" I was trying my best to keep Adora at arm's length as she tried to put food on my face.

"Come on Catra I thought you liked pancakes?" She tried sneaking her other hand to my face but I grabbed it.

"Now when your hands are all gross!" I tried to push her hands back but alas her dumb muscles.
"Sparkles help!" Glimmer just laughed as I tried pushing Adora away with my foot. Adora then got an evil look on her face as she pulled her arms back towards her taking me with her. Before I could pull back she grasped my face rubbing the crumbs into my fur.

Her hands caressed my face with both her hands laughing at the food now stuck in my fur. I chuffed at her.

"You're such a brat."

"Says the brat."

Adora hadn't let go of my face and she didnt seem to notice, I refused to be the one to remind her. I felt her calluses that covered her hands I also felt her thumbs moving, rubbing my cheek subconsciously. It was at that moment I realized I was more in her seat than my own practically hanging off her.

She seemed to notice too as she stared right back at me. Were her eyes always that blue? They almost looked like they were glowing.

"Ahem?"

Glimmer snapped us out of our staring contest but I pulled up suddenly basically headbutting Adora's chin. "Shit sorry!" I clutched the back of my head as I sit back in my seat.

Adora just rubs her jaw. "We have to stop doing that, I'm gonna end up bruised all over." I laughed and Glimmer groaned.

"Anyway, Catra what do you wanna do today?" I shrugged. Being honest this week has already been perfect.

"I'm okay with whatever we've been doing what I want all week." Adora laughed.

"Uh, duh. It's your birthday." Bow elbowed Glimmer.

"Ow!" Bow gave her a pointed look.

"Glimmer." She groaned.

"It's true." Glimmer said while dramatically rubbing her arm. Adora then rested her head on her hand as she looked at me.

"So Catra anything else you wanna do?" I went to make a joke but my face flushed up at the thought.

Stop it Catra!

"Let's spar again. I never got to kick your ass." Adora scoffed suddenly sitting up.

"Last I checked I beat you," I smirked as I crossed my arms. Adora instantly zeroed in, knowing I was about to dispute her.

"I was going easy on you because I didnt want to scare you off so soon. How embarrassing would it be if the mighty Adora was

beaten by a mere mortal like myself?" Adora stood up passionately.

"I accept your challenge!" I laughed as I raised my hand to her.

"Shake on it?" She eagerly shook my hand and I pulled her down as I ran out the door. "Race you there!" Adora's jaw dropped on the floor as she rushed behind me.

"Hey, no fair!" I swear I could hear a chair fall as she ran after me at full force. "Catra!" I felt a sense of Deja-vu remembering all the times in the Fright zone we would play like this. Memories that seemed so distant all came back at once.

The late-night talks under Adora's blanket.

The pranks on Kyle.

Our roof time escapades.

It all made me question how I was able to go so many years without waking up to her. "Catra?" Adora was next to me. I had stopped running at one point. I looked at Adora who had obvious worry on her face. "You okay?"

I forced myself out of my thoughts. "Yeah just giving you a chance to catch up." Adora raised her brow.

"Sure... You sure you didnt just miss me?"

"Oh get over yourself!" Adora smiled at me. Then pulled Catra back as she ran forward.

"See you at the finish line!" I huffed as I chased after her.

"Hey, no fair!"

"So who decorated?" Cyra squeezed her eyes tight as she took a deep breath.

"I did. Why is something wrong?" Cyra turned to Esme with her arms crossed. Esme gave a forced laugh.

"Nope. It's perfect..."

"But?" Esme ran her hand down the red decor.

"Isn't very...personalized." Cyra shrugged.

"Elizabeth doesn't care for parties much she just enjoys having her friends. She said what it looks like doesn't change anything. As long as there are no pink sparkles." Esme seemed to finally laugh.

"I guess that's fair." Cyra had to catch herself when she started to smile. Esme was observant.

"Was that a smile?" Cyra turned away crossing her arms.

"No." Esme poked her side slightly.

"Oh, I did!" Cyra began walking away.

"I'm not acknowledging that!" Esme laughed as she followed Cyra out of the main ballroom.

"Fine, fine. I'm done. Where to next?" Cyra kept walking.

"I have to make sure all the food prep is done, receive the Brightmoon desserts, and then get Elizabeth ready." Esme sighed.

"Wow, that's a lot. All for one day?" Cyra clenched her fist.

"Well, it's a lot of traditions that go into it. Though you never were involved...it was always Elizabeth."

Esme sighed as she stopped walking prompting Cyra to turn towards her. "Cyra I know I was a shit mother. I know there isn't a single thing I can do to give you back your younger years. So tell me what can I do to at least be tolerated by you?"

Cyra's breath caught. She didnt- she didnt knows what to say. What did she want of Esme? "I-" she didnt know. Cyra didnt know if she could ever forgive Esme.

She had an idea of where to start.

"Stay." It was Esme's turn to stare shocked.

"What?" Cyra grabbed Esme's hands.

"Stay. Here, with us. You could be in Elizabeth's life...and mine." Esme opened and closed her mouth. Words are almost impossible. Cyra smiled.

"Think about it?" Esme nodded. Not knowing how else to respond. Cyra smiled. Then quickly removed her hands.

"Sorry. Let's get going. We're on a tight schedule." Cyra turned and refused to let tears fall but she couldn't hide her smile. She was finally making progress.

Maybe she would never have Esme as a mom again. But maybe she can have her as a friend.

"Cyra?" She turned as she heard her name. Esme looked hesitant. Though she smiled softly.

"Tell me about Elizabeth." Cyra smiled brightly.

"Oh, where to start. She's by far the most intelligent kit I've ever met. She was already assisting in trade routes and strategies at twelve. I admire her in a lot of ways." Cyra's eyes seemed to sparkle at the mention of her daughter.

"You sound like you've been living the dream." Cyra nodded.

"I'm blessed with a loving family and a home. There were times however I... Didnt know what to do. Pregnancy was a struggle for me. With both conception and then, the Horde." Esme stared expectantly but Cyra shook her head.

"A story for a later time. How have you been? I haven't gotten many details from you?" Esme seemed hesitant to answer.

"Oh well like I said I was in Mystacore but for a while, I traveled. Nothing too big." Cyra wanted to know more but decided against it when she noticed Esme uncomfortable.

Maybe there was more to her time away than Cyra thought. It's okay though. Cyra has a lot of time with Esme.

She can patiently wait.

Catra ran after Adora on all fours swiftly dodging and weaving her way through crowds while Adora was slowed down by her bumping into people and saying 'sorry' and 'excuse me.' Though Adora still had a significant lead.

Assuming they were going to spar at the same place Adora ran full force to the hidden tunnel.

She was so close to the finish line. This might be the first time Adora has won a race fair and square. Well as fair as their races are. Suddenly Adora felt a weight on her back as Catra jumped her causing them both to fall onto the ground.

"Aww, guess it's a tie," Catra said slyly as her tail waved mischievously behind her. Adora blew a strand of hair that fell into her face.

"Brat!" Catra laughed as she pulled Adora up. Then a puff of sparkles appeared.

"Can you guys ever just walk?" Adora and Catra stared at each other then laughed at the same time. It was almost unsettling.

"Learn to keep up Sparkles." Glimmer groaned. However, before she could say anything she heard footsteps approach.

"I'm here... Too..." The bow was huffing as he collapsed on the floor. "I'm just gonna, take a quick rest." Glimmer facepalmed.

"Sorry Bow!" She rushed over to help him up to which she smiled gratefully.

"So rematch?" Catra smugly said. Adora punched her other hand.

"Bring it!"

"Wait!" They both looked to Glimmer who seemed just fed up. "I wanna watch!" Bow groaned as Glimmer teleported him to the 'sideline.' Glimmer teleported to grab a fallen stone and used it to draw a circle in the ground then gestured for the competitors to come to the center 'ring.' Glimmer clapped excitedly as she did a dramatic voice.

"Welcome one and all to the fight you've all been waiting for!"

Silence.

Glimmer then turned to Bow. "Oh, whoo!!" Bow clapped. Glimmer smiled as she gestured to Catra. "In this corner, we have the furball with an attitude."

"Hey!"

Glimmer ignored her protest as Adora laughed but stopped suddenly when Glimmer gestured to her. "And in this corner a strong idiot who couldn't know what flirting was even if there was a sign in neon lights pointing it out!" Catra choked on her spit.

"I feel targeted."

"It was intentional!" Adora rolled her eyes. Glimmer then raised both her hands." alright ladies I want a clean fight. the First one out of the ring is the loser best two outta three. So no She-ra," glimmer gave a pointed look to her Adora then she looked at Catra. "And no biting, clawing, maiming, hair pulling,-"

"Hey, no fair! Why does Adora only get one handicap?"

"Because Adora doesn't bite people!" Before Catra could protest Glimmer dropped both her hands. "Begin!" She then teleported to sit next to Bow. "Whoo tear each other apart!"

"But not literally!" Adora laughed at Bow's addition allowing Catra to attack her head-on.

"Whoah!" Adora was instantly pinned down and her head outside the circle. Catra leaned down smirking, her tail waving in amusement.

"One for Catra." Glimmer exclaimed.

"One for me." Catra laughed as she stood back up. With a huff, Adora lept to her feet."

"Lucky shot." Catra laughed then used her finger to beckon Adora.

"Bring it."

Adora got a smug grin on her face as she undid her belt and took off her jacket placing it to the side.

Catra's mind went crazy.

Glimmer teleported quickly back to the center of the ring. "Round two!" Then just as quickly got out of the way with Bow cheering every once in a while.

Adora didn't let her guard down for one moment. They both went into their pattern of circling each other waiting for someone to act, or for a weakness to find and ultimately exploit.

Adora decided she wouldn't act first. Though harder said than done. Adora had boundless energy and desperation for instant results. Waiting wasn't her strong suit and Catra knew it.

"You gonna use those muscles or are they for decoration."

Adora's patience snapped.

She dashed forward and Catra swiftly dodged to which Adora swung back around to grab her. The best Catra can do is wear her out. If Adora grabs her it's over. Catra can be as sly and trucky as she wants but Adora has a grip that is impossible to get out of.

Adora getting a grip on you equals game over.

Catra wanted a clean slate but Adora wasn't as naive as she used to be. She knew Catra's tricks. So instead of wearing herself out, she took a step back. Putting distance between them.

Catra smiled. 'She's learning.' She thought. Then Catra rushed forward. Expecting to catch her off guard but Adora knew this sequence.

It was the same one Azar used on her.

Adora dodged her fist then grabbed Catra's leg causing her to lose her footing. Adora saw her going down and knew the ground would hurt Catra she pulled her down cradling her head to avoid it impacting the hard stone.

Adora sat up. They seemed to be in this situation a lot lately. Pinning each other down while panting. That way of phrasing made Adora flush. She needed to get herself together. "Are you-"

"Round two goes to Adora!"

They were both startled but Adora looked up and noticed half of Catra's hand was outside of the ring.

Adora quickly stood up and offered a hand to Catra. "Sorry, didnt mean to pull so harshly. Are you okay?" Catra laughed.

"I'm fine. Seriously only you would apologize during a fight." Adora scratched her neck.

"Seems to do well. I mean I beat you didnt I?" Catra went to retort but Glimmer was back in the center.

"Threetwoonego!" Then she was gone, before Adora could process that jumbled mess of words Catra leaped on Adora causing her to lose her footing.

"Crap!" Adora turned quickly making her fall within the ring. Catra huffed then tried to hold her down but Adora and her superior strength managed to throw Catra off, she quickly recovered and Adora rushed to her feet as Catra tried to knock her down again.

Adora went on the defensive as Catra came at her with hit after hit. Before she knew it she was already at the edge once again. Adora hoped Catra's fast pace would wear her out but she was too smart for that appearing as if she could go on for hours.

Catra went in again but Adora managed to grab her wrists. Though without hesitation Catra headbutt Adora harshly. "Ow, will you stop doing that!" Catra clutched her head after getting some distance away.

"Shit, you are literally hard-headed."

"Hey! I'll have you know I-" Catra smirked as she tasted victory while Adora was distracted ran forward and got a grip on her shoulders making Adora fumble.

She was so close her heels would be over the line if she laid them down. So overpowering Catra on her tiptoes was a challenge in itself. Though Catra found Adora struggling hilarious.

"Gee Adora you're not looking too good." Catra then pressed down more of her body weight.

This was it. This was the end.

Adora looked Catra in the eyes. "Sorry, it has to be like this." Catra raised a brow,

"What are you-" Adora suddenly gasped.

"Is that a mouse?!"

"What where!?" Adora quickly turned Catra around throwing her out of the ring. Pining Catra down. Adora sat up, still on top of her, and raised her arms. "Victory!"

Catra blew a strand of hair out of her face. "Cheater."

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"Azar hurry up! Were gonna be late!" Azar laughed as Cyra dragged her along excitedly.

"Careful Cy, remember they told you to take it easy?" Cyra rolled her eyes.

"I know I know but they never said I couldn't speed walk!" Azar smiled at her wife who was still content dragging her to the doctor.

6 months. She was 6 months along in her pregnancy. This was the farthest pregnancy she got to since their first attempt two years ago. To say Cyra was ecstatic was an understatement.

This might have been the first time Cyra woke up before Azar and even then Azar had a suspicion she just stayed up all night.

"Azar?"

She snapped out of her thoughts not noticing she had walked right past the door to the doctor. "Oh shit sorry." Cyra slapped her arm slightly.

"What did I say about language?" Azar pouted.

"They can't hear me." Azar opened the door for Cyra.

"Well, you should get out of the habit before they can." Instead of arguing Azar gave a sarcastic.

"Yes, dear." To which Cyra tried glaring but her obvious happiness was still peeking through.
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Upon entering the doctor bowed. "My queens, how is everything going? Cyra clapped her hands.

"Just perfect!" The doctor nodded.

"And how are you doing?" Azar laughed.

"Easy for her to say she doesn't have to get woken up every night to deal with her wife's weird cravings." Azar jokingly poked at Cyra's ribs. Cyra giggled.

"Stop! It hurts to laugh!" Azar stopped as Cyra's laugh died down. The doctor smiled fondly.

"Well, I won't keep you long. I just need to check on the kit and you'll be on your way!" Cyra frowned causing Azar to laugh.

"I hate this part." Azar kissed her temple.

"I know but it'll be quick." The doctor nodded in agreement. Azar helped Cyra on the examination table as the doctor lifted her shirt and drew a rune. Cyra shivered.

Azar just rubbed her hand. "I know, I know. You're doing great honey." Cyra laughed through the discomfort. The doctor's hand then glowed causing the discomfort to increase in Cyra's stomach.

Azar just continued rubbing her hand praising her through it.

The doctor's movements stopped suddenly.

Cyra didnt notice, but Azar did. She noticed their face fall slightly. It made Azar's stomach drop.

"Alright all done." Cyra let out a sigh as the rune on her stomach disappeared the doctor cleaned their hands. Cyra then smiled.

"So how is it going?" The doctor's shoulders tensed. Azar got a bad feeling. They slowly turned around leaning against the desk behind them.

"I-... I'm sorry your highness." Cyra's smile faltered.

"What- what's..." Cyra looked to Azar as if expecting an answer. The doctor took a deep breath

"I was hoping they would've caught up by now but... Please know you both have done everything you could. Nome of this is your fault-"

"What's wrong?" Cyra wrapped her stomach protectively.

"They aren't developing. I'm sorry to say but, the most likely scenario is if they make it to the due date...they won't last an hour."

Cyra's face broke. "But- but everything was fine last checkup?!" The doctor shook their head. They grabbed two pictures.

"This is what a 6 month along should look like." They then pointed to a picture labeled '3 months' "this is what they look like." I was hoping they would be developing. But... I'm sorry." Cyra just dropped her head clutching the picture.

"Why?" It sounded so hurt. Azar tried to comfort her but she refused. "Why! It makes no sense everything was fine!" The doctor didnt respond to her outburst.

"We dont know. You have no medical history relating to this nither your family. We have tried spells, potions, and many medical experiments. There's always a chance but Maybe... it's time you start looking into different options."

Cyra shook her head. "I want to go home." Azar just nodded. Walking Cyra out.

"Thank you." The doctor nodded.

The previous excitement from the walk there disappeared. Cyra remained silent. "Cy?" She just shook her head.

"It's not fair." Cyra's tears began to fall. "It's not fair! It makes no sense. We've tried everything. I really thought..." Cyra clutched her stomach again. "I thought this would be it." Azar hugged her tightly.

"I'm sorry Cy." Cyra sobbed. It wasn't fair. Why her? All she ever wanted was taken from her over and over and the one time she thought she had a chance it was taken again.

"Cyra?" She looked up from Azar's shoulder. Leo stood there waiting.

"Whats-" Leo remembered what today was. "Are they-" Azar gave Leo a stern look. Cyra just walked away her tears falling faster.

"Cy, wait!" Azar looked to Leo.

"Cancel my lessons." Leo nodded firmly.

"Yes, of course."

Azar already knew where Cyra would be. The one place she kept visiting through every pregnancy. The place she was once so excited about.

Before knocking Azar already heard the crying. Azar wanted to rip off her ears just to rid that sound from her memory. She knocked softly on the door. "Cy?" She heard a soft

'Come in.'

Cyra was leaning over the crib. It was a dark oak with a stack of blankets in it all gifts from friends. Cyra turned to Azar looking distraught.

All she wanted was to go back in time. Back to when they first decorated the nursery. Both of them asked how their kit would act, how they would look. Now Cyra only associated this place with pain.

Cyra wiped her eyes harshly. "I suppose I should go back. Make an appointment to... Fuck." Cyra's words were cut off by more tears. She began clawing at her scalp. Azar quickly approached her removing her hands.

"Cy, enough of that." She just shook her head. Azar clutched her face. "Cy, please." Cyra looked into Azar's eyes then kissed her quickly. She pulled back as tears ran.

"I- I just wanted them... So bad!" Azar nodded.

"I know."

"And it's been taken from me...all over again!" Azar shook her head.

"Hey, hey you dont know that. You heard the doctor. There is a chance they could make it." Cyra stuttered,

"Azar I-I can't go through that again. I'm not strong enough." Azar pulled Cyra into a hug cradling her.

"...you know I support your decisions. But there's a chance. Whether they're small or not you have a kit growing inside you. Isn't that a miracle itself? " Cyra hesitated then nodded.

Azar smiled. "Besides dont, you want to soak up all the attention? I swear to you I would not deal with the three AM wake-up calls under any other situations." That got Cyra to give out a weak laugh. Azar then rubbed Cyra's stomach.

"I have a good feeling about this one. Were both too stubborn. No way they won't pull through." Cyra pulled Azar's eyes up.

"You promise? Please, just lie to me." Azar pulled one of Cyra's hands to her lips.

"With the stars as my witness, you will be the best mother." Cyra tried laughing through the oncoming tears. Azar continued. "You'll catch them sneaking out and go all red with anger. You'll love

them so much they'll get annoyed. Yet they will love you with all their heart. Knowing no matter what, you will be there for them.
.
.
.
Because you're that good of a mom."

Chapter End Notes

I need myself an Azar... As always leave a comment in love with all the support on this story! 💜 💜

Almost perfect

Chapter Notes

> Finally after way too long I got this out I really tried to make this a great finale but sorry if some parts are rushed as always criticisms are welcomed! I condensed it down into two chapters so please enjoy.

See the end of the chapter for more notes

Azar thought she would get out of the hustle and bustle of party planning by hiding out in her office, but it always found her every year. Though it usually was in the form of people running up to her and asking her to do a million things at once, this time it came in the form of laughter outside her office.

Azar got up and opened the door to see Cyra laughing... With Esme.

To say she was stunned was an understatement noticing Azar, Cyra tried to compose herself.

"Azar, sorry I was just-" she looks at Esme and they both burst into laughter.

Azar was speechless. Not only was it weird to see the pair get along but even more so Cyra seems to be fine with speaking to Azar again.

"Sorry, sorry. Grell wanted to know if you had the security layout for tonight."

Azar face palmed.

"Shit I was supposed to give that to him yesterday. Hold on I have it right here." Azar hastily walked into her office and began to rummage through her drawers.

Cyra and Esme then glanced at one another, Esme smiling while Cyra was trying to hold her laughter in. Of course, Azar could hear her failed attempts but did not want to question her wife's new giddiness.

Once finding the scroll she pulled it out and handed it to Cyra. "Here you-" Cyra grabs the scroll then gives a quick kiss to Azar.

Azar blames her stunned reaction on the fact Cyra has not even touched her since the argument.

Her right-hand caressed Azar's cheek.

"Thanks love!" Cyra then quickly dragged Esme down the hall. Both snickering and whispering like schoolchildren. Azar just shrugged.

Unaware of the bright blue dye Cyra had subtly put on her cheek.

Cyra did not stop her light jog till she was well out of hearing distance from Azar. She began laughing with Esme.

"That was so fun!"

Esme smirked back.

"Oh, please that was child's play. Wait until I get my hands on some adhesive!" Cyra laughed harder. Cyra was glowing with joy.

She never got to interact with her mother this way. Cyra slightly recoiled at the thought. She never really thought of Esme as her mother. It was a shock, but it was nice.

Esme sighed as she began to walk "I'm sorry." Cyra's words made Esme's steps falter.

"Sorry? Why?" Cyra began fidgeting with her tuffs.

"You came here to reconcile things and I just yelled at you and doubted your sincerity. That wasn't-"

Esme just laughed. "Oh, hush now. No more apologies from you." She then gave a teasing 'Boop' to Cyra's nose. Causing it to twitch. "This is supposed to be my feeling bad moment not yours." Esme then smirked as she glanced at Cyra. "Soo.... Don't take it from me!" She tackled Cyra jokingly tickling her sides.

"Stop, stop!" Cyra tried to forcefully remove Esme's hands but could not stop laughing.

However, Esme stopped shortly when she noticed a movement behind Cyra. Snatching the scroll from Cyra.

"Well, I'll go run this to Grell you two have fun!" Cyra tilted her head in confusion. until she heard movement behind her.

"Cy..."

Cyra gulped as she turned around to see a terribly upset Azar with paint all over her face, no doubt from dragging her hand down her face.

"Uh..." Cyra turned quickly to run but Azar put her into a head lock. "Esme!"

"You're on your own!" She said from down the hall. Cyra groaned.

She then looked up sweetly at Azar. "Hey sweetie... you look great!" Azar's annoyed expression soon turned into an evil smirk.

"Aww, you think so. Fresh look I am trying. Give it a shot!" Azar then began rubbing her paint covered face against Cyra's.

"Azar no!" She tried pushing her away, but the damage was done. Cyra then got out of her hold just to rub at the paint, beginning to cling to her fur. Azar had no shame as she laughed up a storm

Cyra tried to rub it off with her hand but that just made it worse. "Bleh!" Azar laughed then pulled Cyra in by her waist.

"So, am I forgiven?" She gave a sly smile.

"Hmm...maybe..." Cyra brought a hand to the back of Azar's neck pulling her in.

Meanwhile her other hand grabbed pink powder out of her pocket and when Azar went in for a kiss, she blew it right in her face. Azar coughed and Cyra snickered as she tried running away. “Oh, no you don’t!”

Azar tackled Cyra down straddling her to stop her thrashing. Cyra had momentarily forgotten about her grudge against Azar. She smiled in a daze while staring up at her wife. Azar smirked in victory Cyra then turned her head to the side remembering her resolve. “This doesn’t change anything I’m still upset with you.” Azar’s ears went down as she pouted.

“Come on! What can I do?” Cyra feigned thinking with a ‘hmm.’

“Oh, I don’t know how about you, give Elizabeth back her memories!’ Azar groaned.

“Correction memory. I only took one.” Cyra huffed then shoved Azar off her and quickly stood up dusting her skirt off.

“I can’t believe you’re acting like this.” Azar stood up as well.

“I did it for her. Trust me she would not want to see the rest of it.” Cyra pulled on her hair tuffs in frustration, getting pink and blue powder in her hair.

“Stars Azar, that isn’t for us to decide!” nearby guards that went to patrol the hall quickly turned back as they heard the arguing.

“Easy for you to say the memory doesn’t make you out to be the bad guy.” Cyra refused to give in to Azar’s darkened face. Though her voice became gentle against her will.

“Azar, Elizabeth isn’t going to judge you for what you did while you were fighting for your life.” Azar shook her head.

“That’s not the part I’m worried about.” Cyra looked confused wondering what the reason for was trying to keep a memory away from Elizabeth. Luckily, Azar noticed her confusion. With a sigh Azar continued, “The memory raises a lot of questions...questions I don’t have the answers to- questions I don’t want to answer.” Cyra frowned.

“Well, someone told me that sometimes you just have to bite the barrel and take it.” Azar gave a huff, Cyra gripping Azar’s arm for comfort, “They also told me that I should trust my daughter.” Azar rolled her eyes then looked at Cyra. She wanted to be comforted but she just began to laugh,

“It’s hard to take you seriously with pink and blue all over your hair.” Azar began to laugh then Cyra rubbed her hands both on Azar’s clothes and face.

“You brat.” They laughed quietly together. Cyra then cradled her face, both seeming to momentarily forget about the paint.

“Does this mean I'm allowed to sleep in the bed again?”

“I guess, only because you produce enough heat at night.” Azar smiled and ignored the comment instead shoved her face in the crook of Cyra's neck hugging her waist tightly from behind. Cyra ruffled her hair. "I still expect you to talk with Elizabeth." Azar just groaned into her neck. Cyra rolled her eyes fondly. There was silence for a moment.

"Will you be with me?"
Cyra laughed.

"The whole time." Azar sighed and rubbed along Cyra's neck, scenting her. Cyra giggled. Rubbing her ears made Azar purr into her neck. Cyra then stared at her head and noticed the dye had mixed in Azar's hair making it go purple. Cyra smirked as she turned to face the brown-haired woman.

She pulled harshly on her hair making an embarrassing groan to come from the brunette. She was now looking at Cyra's narrowed eyes as she leaned in.

"Have I ever told you how pretty you look in purple?" Azar raised her brow in confusion until Cyra pulled her in for a kiss. Azar let out a gasp in surprise as Cyra gripped her chin with one hand and held her hip with the other. Cyra began swirling her tongue in Azar's mouth, and Azar blamed her reaction on the fact she hasn't been touched by Cyra in a while.

No other reason...

Azar sunk against the wall as her eyes rolled closed. Cyra smirked into the kiss and put her leg between Azar's legs causing her to jump slightly at the new pressure and grip Cyra's shoulder.

Cyra pulled back for air, saliva connecting them as Azar was huffing for breath and shaking.

"You alright love?" Cyra said teasingly. Azar flushed at her voice.

"Shit Cy you can't-" She moaned as Cyra pushed her leg higher. "J-just go and... fuck." Azar's claws begun to flex slightly into Cyra. She leaned her head into Cyra's neck to hide her shame as she began to grind down on Cyra's leg.

Cyra laughed as she forced Azar's hips to still with a firm grip, pink and blue powder leaving two bright handprints there causing her to let out a pitiful mewl. "Cy-" She whined.

Cyra smiled. "What's wrong love?" Azar clutched her shirt as she dug her fangs into Cyra's neck. Cyra gasped then chuckled as Azar kept her face hidden in her neck.

"Adora wins!"

"No way that was foul play! Catra argued as Adora gave a hand to help Catra off the ground. Glimmer seemed to ignore Catra's complaint while Bow shrugged.

"I mean I see how it can be a dirty way to win but nothing in the rules said Adora couldn't distract you." Catra gaped.

"If I tried that I would be called a Cheater! Besides Adora barely had any rules." Adora smirked.

"No one likes a sore loser Catra." Catra's ear twitched as she tackled Adora's back.

"You're so annoying!" Adora laughed as if she did not have a Magicat tackling her and pulling at her hair.

"Ow, Catra tail, tail!" Adora referred to her ponytail as Catra pulled on it. Glimmer laughed, while Bow was cautiously trying to get them to stop fighting. Though it was obvious they were just playing around.

"Maybe it's because she grew up with you, but Adora seems to have some Magicat tendencies." Suddenly the pair stopped as they stared at Glimmer. Adora flushed as Catra hopped off her shoulders.

"You don't say?"

Adora pulled Catra back. "Glimmer don't!" She ignored Adora.

"Seriously, she hums when she's happy to simulate a purr, she will just knock stuff off counters just because, and not to mention when she sleeps, she curls up her legs!" Adora was now covering her flushed face as Catra stared wide eyed at Glimmer.

Catra then gives a smug smile. "Wow Adora didn't know I had such an impact on you."

"Please stop talking." Catra laughed, directing her attention to Glimmer.

"I think most of that stuff was, so I didn't feel so left out. And we used to share a bed and I lay at the foot of it. So that explains the curling up." Bow's eyes shined.

"Aww!"

Adora then grabbed Catra's shoulders. "Catra please I can't handle the embarrassment." Catra laughed.

Bow's tracker pad then went off. Catra jumped onto Adora, her tail fluffed up. "Oh, it's time to start heading back. I set up a timer, so we didn't forget." Glimmer snickered at Catra who hissed as Adora placed her down, used to being the one to catch Catra.

"Shut it." Glimmer smiled

"I didn't say anything!" Catra chuffed. Adora was just content in smiling and listening. She was simply happy, existing next to Catra. This whole week was something she did not know she needed. Relaxing was never something that came easy to her. Yet here she is relaxing. She thinks it has a lot to do with Catra.

She does not know how she will go back to Brightmoon without her. She only made it this long without her because she did not know she was still alive. Now that she knows, and has gotten used to having her around, being without her sounds impossible.

"Adora?"

"Sorry what?" Adora looked up to notice Catra, Glimmer, and Bow had already started to leave. Catra simply hung back waiting for Adora to follow. She briskly walked towards her and kept pace with Catra.

Bow and Glimmer talking to one another while Adora and Catra walked in a nice silence, though Catra turned worriedly to Adora.

"You, okay? You looked a little out of it."

Adora nodded. "Yeah, I'm okay. I was just thinking about... nothing never mind."
Catra got close.

"Okay now you have to tell me!" Catra's tail began lashing as if she already knew what it was. Adora frowned as she stared down at her feet subconsciously counting her steps.

"It's nothing nice, actually its upsetting." Catra's ears dropped. Adora hated seeing her look like that, all dejected and worried. "Maybe we should wait until after today I don't want to upset you so close to your celebration." Catra grabbed Adora's hand and Adora hates the way she squeezes it back.

"Well, I'm already worrying about you so just tell me and we can get over it. Besides, you tend to worry over nothing most of the time." That got a shy chuckle from her.

"I was just thinking about how great this whole week has been. I got to just... be me, with you. No Horde, no war, just...this." Adora gestured to their interlocked hands causing Catra to blush, she had not even realized she reached for her hand. "I don't know how I'm going to live back in Brightmoon knowing you won't be there."

Glimmer and Bow had stopped talking for a while now but decided to keep walking when the pair stopped, sensing this was a private conversation. Of course, Catra noticed but refused to acknowledge it. Right now, all she could focus on was Adora, her blue eyes staring directly at her and Catra began to be hyper-aware of everything, it was too much. She felt as if her heart would explode. Adora has always been an intense person and the way she is looking at her right now makes her want things she cannot have. She does not want to see Adora like this, she hates it and most of all she hates how she cannot do anything about it.

"Well of course you'll miss me I'm amazing after all." Catra wanted it to come off as teasing, but her voice gave way to how helpless

she felt. It got a weak smile from Adora at the least, her thumbs rubbing along Catra's hand.

"Yeah, you're amazing." That is the last thing Catra wanted to hear. Adora sounded so dejected and unhappy. Suddenly Adora pulled away, "I'm sorry I know this is your home and I really shouldn't make you get involved with the rebellion just because of me. I just... sorry this is stupid can we just forget about this whole thing?" Adora began a fast-paced stride trying to literally run away from her problems. However, to Adora's dismay, Catra did not allow it.

She grabbed her hand again and pulled her back. Adora stood still patiently waiting for Catra to say something, anything. Catra wanted to say she would stick by her side but that was not in the cards for her.

"Well with my new tracker pad Bow gave me we can still talk to each other. And know that you are always welcome in Halfmoon if you ever want a break from all the war stuff. I'll be your personal guide." That made Adora feel a little better.

"I'll definitely take you up on that."

"Perfect."

"Catra we're going to be late!" Glimmer shouted, Adora and Catra noticing just how far ahead they were.

"Coming!" Catra said in their general direction then turned back to Adora. "Hey, let's talk about this later, no point in worrying about things that haven't happened yet." Adora nodded though her thoughts betrayed her,

'I'm more worrying about what I know has to happen.'

Adora and Catra rushed to their friends and began a conversation as if nothing happened, though Catra would subtly look at Adora making sure she was all right.

Catra’s POV

I honestly lucked out with Bow setting an alarm, I managed to make it to my room and no more than ten seconds later mom was coming in. “Oh, wow look at you, here on time.” I rolled my eyes

“You can’t talk about punctuality.” I teased

Cyra huffed as she went into my closet to grab my clothes,

“Where’s the best friend squad?”

“Please don’t call us that.”

Cyra laughed, “I think it’s cute.”

“they’re getting ready in their rooms.” I lay down on my bed trying to get in a few minutes of shut eye. I realized too little too late that running around and fighting with Adora before a six-hour celebration was a bad idea, and that does not include the however long ceremony beforehand. I did not do the ceremony the first few years I came here. I was too nervous. Back then my ‘celebration’ was just me, my moms, Leo, and Vivianne later. I do not remember when I decided to try it out but ever since the ceremony got progressively bigger and grander as the years went by what used to be a small get-together became a whole holiday.

“Put this on and then we can start to try and tame that rat's nest on your head.” I stuck my tongue out at her, she only gets to talk because her hair is thin enough that even with bed head it lays flat. I was able to change into the outfit much quicker now that I know what the outfit is supposed to look like. While I got changed mom was setting up on my vanity with brushes and products.
By the time I was done mom was as well and gestured for me to sit down.

“Stars just what were you doing? I swear I see actual dirt in here.” I shrugged; I could see mom smirk in the mirror.

“What?"

she laughed, “Nothing.” I hate it when she does that. I crossed my arms,
“Maybe I should just get Gen to do my hair if it’s such a hassle for you.”

Mom laughed,
“Like you would let anyone else get close enough to.” I wish I could say she was lying but it is the truth. My hair has never been easy to manage even with all the fancy shampoos and conditioners it was still a process to get through it with a brush. Though the Horde’s shit products did not help me any. They had tried to get it to lay flat, but they either could not catch me, or the brush would break two strokes in. I always hated it.

It got so bad that even Shadow Weaver tried to get a handle on it, giving up after one too many scratch marks. They threatened to cut it all off but when Adora saw how upset I was she offered to try. She was not any better. Though she did not try holding me down and was so gentle, apologizing for every little snag. They finally left me alone and Shadow weaver just said that it better not become a problem, or she would cut it all off. Ever since then I have been very mindful of it.
One point Lonnie caught wind of it and tried to pull it during a sparring session, but when I noticed I punched her square in the jaw and fled. With Adora chasing after me.

“Elizabeth?”

“What?’

“I asked if you are excited about today.”

“Oh, yeah as excited as I usually am.” mom then got a smug look on her face.

“Even though Adora is here?” I felt my face flushed with embarrassment and mom laughed.

“Shut up!”

“I didn’t say anything.”

“You were thinking it.” Mom rolled her eyes. She continued brushing.

“So, you aren’t happy Adora is here?” I sighed; I knew she was not going to stop.

“Of course, I am. I am happier about the fact she is all right.” Mom did not look convinced.

“Just as a friend?” There it is.

“Of course, what else would it be?” Mom stared at me in the mirror.

“Elizabeth.” I turned my head away from her gaze. I knew if I said to leave it alone that she would. As much as she jokes mom tries her best not to push.

“She doesn’t see me that way.” I refused to look back at her. Mom continued brushing my hair.

“How do you know?” I wanted to laugh at that. Has she seen Adora? She is quite literally the embodiment of perfection. She is kind, pretty, and as well as a literal goddess. Also, She-ra, whoever that is.

“Because I have eyes. Honestly, she has all Etheria filled with people who would throw themselves at her, I would be her last pick, if at all.” I tried laughing it off, but mom could always see through my bullshit.

“Maybe but give yourself more credit.” She put a hand under my chin and made me look in the mirror. I noticed one side of my hair looked significantly tamer than the other. Other than that, everything else looked normal, for me anyway. “I wish you saw what others see when they look at you. I hate the fact that you believe you are not the most beautiful girl in the world.” I rolled my eyes.

“I’m quite sure you’re required to say that being my mom and all.”

“Maybe but then what about Vivianne? She wrote so many poems about your eyes alone.” I scoffed.

“She just said that because-”

“What about Bow? Glimmer?”

“They’re my friends they have to be nice.” Mom sighed,

“Fine if that’s what you think.” Thankfully, she went back to brushing my hair. “Though for what it’s worth I think you’re gorgeous.” Easy for her to say. I decided to change the subject quickly, not wanting to continue the Adora and feelings topic.

“How are things with you and Esme?” I saw a faint smile appear on mom’s face,

“Good actually. I asked if she would like to stay, and I think having her around will do her and me good.” I smile, I never knew much about their relationship. The most I know comes from the journal I read. Though I’m glad she’s happy if anyone deserves happiness it’s her.

“So, about Adora-” I groaned, “Nothing embarrassing! I was just curious about... her plan for after today.” I frowned, seems like Adora isn’t the only one worrying over this.

“She will go with Bow and Glimmer back to Brightmoon. We’ll still be in touch, and I said if she ever wants a break from the war, she’s welcome here. Though I doubt she’ll be able to get away.” I don’t know much about She-ra but apparently, she is actively turning the tide of the war, I doubt the rebellion will be okay with her throwing away responsibilities just to come visit me. I doubt Adora would even think about doing that.

“Well... Maybe, you could go with her.” I felt my eyes widen. I turned fully around to look at her positively, my wishful thinking

has me hearing things.

“What?”

Mom bit her lip, as if she had not meant to say that. “I was just- We plan on leaving for Mystacore anyway... You could just stay in Brightmoon for a while and meet us there- We must ask Angella first of course and Glimmer, also you would have to be able to contact us to make sure you’re all right and-”

“Please tell me this isn’t some cruel joke.” This was unbelievable, who was this and where was my mom?

“Obviously, I need to talk with Azar about this, but I know you don’t like being stuck in one place and you still played by my rules despite how many times I lied to you. You deserve to have freedom and if there is anywhere, I know you would be safe, it is with your friends in Brightmoon.”
I didn’t even know what to say. So, I just tackled her in a hug. She laughed, “Careful I just got through your hair.” I pulled back and my face hurt from smiling so much.

“I promise I will send you an update every minute if I must. Thank you, thank you, thank you, thank you!” Mom gently pushed me back in the chair, my legs giddy from excitement.

“Don’t thank me I should’ve done this years ago. I let my fears make you miserable, you don’t deserve that. See this as my way of saying I trust you.” I didn’t pay much attention to what she was saying, I was too excited. Depending on when I leave, I could get a whole month in Brightmoon, and that’s not including Mystacore! I heard mom chuckle at me.

“If I knew this would get you so excited, I would not have gotten you a gift and said this, is it.” I smiled as I turned to her again.

“I swear you don’t have to get me a gift for the rest of my life, this is perfect!”

"Noted. Now try and contain your excitement while I finish up your hair." I sat down and tried to remain still, but my tail was still moving in excitement. I honestly thought this was a dream. Everything was falling into place.

As excited as I am for today tomorrow is now on the forefront of my mind. I was already making a list in my head of all the things I want to do in Brightmoon. I couldn't wait to tell Bow and Glimmer, they had been just as desperate as me to get me in Brightmoon. Then Adora.

I could only imagine her face. I finally have something to say to her to make her worry disappear. And it's true.

“Adora you alright in there?” Adora is currently in her room finishing up her hair. Glimmer impatiently waiting outside,

“Yeah, one second!” Adora looked back at her reflection, the clothes were beautiful. A deep crimson with gold accents, apparently these were the colors for the royal family or any one associated. It was elegant as it was comfortable, a simple red halter top cut off just below the ribs and a plain red ankle length skirt with a sash of a dark maroon laid on top tied at the side with gold embroidery. That’s not even mentioning the gold cuff around Adora’s bicep and as well as a decorative hair clip that covers Adora’s hair tie.

“Adora!” She finally snapped out of her daze and made her way out of the room.

“Alright, alright I’m done.” Checking once more in the mirror, Adora left the room and slightly startled seeing Bow and Glimmer waiting right outside. Getting a good look at them, they were in the same type of outfit as Adora. Glimmer stood out the most with her being in a deep muted purple and wearing her family crest to hold her top together. While Bow had a red crop top with golden embroidery of a heart on his chest, and long maroon pants with gold cuffs at the end.

Adora smiled. “Wow Glimmer you look great.” She gave a twirl showing off the silk cape that sparkled behind her.

“I know right! I was a little embarrassed that I wouldn’t be wearing red, but the purple still looks cohesive with you, guys.” Bow gave a thumbs up.

“I love Halfmoon ceremonies. Not only are they gorgeous but the parties are great and even their formal wear is super comfortable, no offence to Brightmoon.” Glimmer gave a wave of a hand.

“None taken if I could wear stuff like this instead of all those corsets and petticoats, I would hate political dinners significantly less.” They all laughed together. Glimmer then grabbed Adora and Bow’s arms. “Come on let’s see if we can get in a quick hi to Catra before she has to leave.” With that Glimmer teleported them all right outside her door.

Glimmer then gave a small knock. “Room service!” Adora could hear Catra’s scoff. The door opened to reveal Cyra.

“Oh, you all look amazing.” Glimmer smiled at the compliment.

“I doubt we’ll look so amazing when we stand next to C, she always knows how to get all eyes on her.” Cyra smirked and leaned back to let Catra hear her.
“Hear that?”
“lalalalala, I’m not listening!” Cyra fondly rolled her eyes and stepped aside to allow the group in. Glimmer just sat right on the bed while Bow sat on the bean bag chair next to it. Adora didn’t feel nearly as comfortable as they did, so she remained standing. Cyra noticed and gave a Adora a look over.

“Well, I have to give Elizabeth some credit.” Adora tilted her head at that.

“I’m sorry?” Cyra smiled

“Unfortunately, we didn’t have time to get an outfit tailored for you, Glimmer and Bow’s was already in the making for a while, so

we had to throw something together last minute and Elizabeth said this would work for you.” Adora felt her face heat up. She did not need to know that, and her heart might combust with that information.

“Oh, I-I had no idea.” Cyra gave a sly smile. She didn’t understand how her daughter didn’t notice Adora’s obvious liking towards her. A part of her blames the treatment of her back in the Horde. Cyra then put her hands behind her back, her ear then twitched towards the bathroom door.

“Excuse me I just need to finish up Elizabeth and then you guys can harass her before she needs to be in the throne room.”

“Will do!” Glimmer said as Cyra entered the bathroom and shut the door behind her. Glimmer then gave a pointed look to Adora.

“What?” Glimmer patted the spot next to her.

“Trust me you want to be sitting down for this part.” Adora didn’t understand what she meant by that but shrugged and took a seat next to her. Just then Cyra appeared from the adjacent bathroom.

“Ready when you are.” Cyra stood anxiously as she waited for Catra who came out leisurely

Picking at the veil that was hanging off her head.

“I can’t wait for this thing to go.”

Despite the lack of a dramatic entrance the group stood in awe. Adora was suddenly very grateful she was sitting down. Cyra noticed Catra’s picking and quickly grabbed her hands.

“Don’t pick at it. It’s only for an hour, if that. You can survive until then.” Catra stuck her tongue out at her mom who just laughed and did the same back to her. Meanwhile, Adora stared star struck and her jaw practically on the floor.

Glimmer nudged her shoulder, “Isn’t she gorgeous? If she didn’t talk, I could mistake her for a princess.”

“I’m right here!”

Glimmer laughed as Cyra lightly held Catra back saying “Don’t get into a fight until after!” Adora didn’t understand what Glimmer said afterwards. Adora wasn’t blind, she knew even when she was younger that Catra was pretty. Catra never believed her. Kids were cruel and especially to Catra, there were times when people would pick on her for her obvious differences, her tail was the biggest victim of that, but that didn’t stop people from flirting with her. Catra just thought it was a dare and never listened to it.

She’s even more beautiful than before, not only from puberty but eating well and not having a twelve in one shampoo helped her hair tremendously, her hair actually shining and curling instead of just puffing up at the back of her head.

Her new wardrobe didn’t hurt either, Catra never liked wearing Horde issued uniforms, always cutting them up with her claws or adding things she finds laying around. She never had much so whatever she got she made it her own. It seems Halfmoon only encouraged it. Every outfit Adora had seen her in was as classy as it was functional, loose so she could move but also tight as to not to get caught on anything.

However, this outfit she wore now wasn’t made for functionality, she looked like the definition of regal.

And she has been trying to get Adora’s attention for a while now

“You finally got brain damage?” Adora finally picked up her jaw and Glimmer laughed at her fully, Bow gently elbowed her. Saying something about ‘being rude.’

"What?"

Catra rolled her eyes. "I asked what do you think?" Catra was standing right in front of Adora giving her a look over.

‘Sleeveless was definitely the right call.’ Catra thought as she shamelessly stared. Adora was no better but with Catra being so close she found herself gripping the sheets below her to stop her hands from reaching out.

She didn’t know why but her body was hot and something in her stomach was twisting and Adora didn’t know what was happening, she just knew she needed to calm down.

“You look-" Amazing, gorgeous, glowing? No pretty? "...fine?" Glimmer face-palmed while Bow cringed slightly, Catra just smiled.

“Thanks. Same to you.” Adora thought that was a good reaction and decided that Bow and Glimmer were being dramatic. Cyra then grabbed Catra by her shoulders.

“Alright, we have to get Catra in position and you guys need to start heading down to the throne room.” The best friend squad all nodded, and waved goodbye as Cyra dragged Catra along. The second the door shut Glimmer grabbed Adora’s shoulders and began shaking her.

“What is wrong with you!”

Adora answered in spurts, “What- are- you-talking-about?” Before Bow could stop her Glimmer halted and narrowed her eyes.

“You look fine? Fine?!” Bow pulled Glimmer back.

“Glimmer I’m sure she meant it as a compliment.” Adora stared confused. From what she saw, Catra seemed content with the comment, ‘pretty’ didn’t feel right, no words felt right.

“Adora out of all the things you could’ve said, why- ‘fine?’” Adora didn’t have an answer. She also didn’t know why they seemed so hung up on it.

“I-I don’t know, there wasn’t anything else I could think of.” Glimmer went to speak but Bow stopped her.

“Adora what do you think of Catra’s appearance.”

“Why-” Bow stopped Adora.

“I just want to know.” Adora sighed.

“I... I don’t know how to describe it.” Glimmer went to speak but Adora continued, “Seriously! I mean how do you describe her with so few words? Not to mention she is so much more than her appearance. She’s kind and she tries to play it off with sarcasm and blunt comments but she has the kindest heart I’ve ever known. Sure, she has hips for days, hair that could make She-ra envious, and eyes you could drown in, but she could talk about anything for years on end and I would never get bored, and she is just…fine? See I don’t know how to describe that in one word without feeling like an idiot.” Adora finally came to herself not noticing how she had gotten up and began to pace. She turned to Glimmer and Bow, and she felt sheepish knowing her face was red.

Glimmer then stood up and grabbed Adora by her wrist dragging her out of the room. “Glimmer what-”
Glimmer didn’t even turn to look back at Adora as she huffed.

“You are going to tell Catra everything you just said!” Adora felt herself go red and she pulled back.

“No! I mean why?” Bow was speed walking to catch up.

“Because-” Bow gave a stern look towards Glimmer shaking his head, Glimmer groaned then grabbed Adora again,
“Because I said so!” Before Adora could even argue Glimmer pulled open a door and shoved Adora inside.

“Glim-” then slammed the door shut.

Catra’s POV
Mom walked me down to the main hall that led to the Throne room, which was temporarily changed into a viewing hall for the

ceremony. I was already fidgeting with one of the silks that went down my front. Mom noticed and grabbed my hands.

“Hey, you have nothing to worry about. Just one hour then we can start the fun part.” I laughed,

“Is there any chance we can go back to our small dinner next year?” Honestly, the idea of a small dinner sounds amazing. Just me, my moms, and my friends. No fake pleasantries and most importantly no big ceremony with everyone’s eyes on me for an uncomfortable amount of time. Mom brushed back a strand of hair that fell out of place,

“We could, but then we wouldn’t get to keep all the leftover food.” Mom joked and I sighed

“The sacrifices I must make.”

“Oh, how tragic.” Just then there was a familiar knock from the door. I rolled my eyes as mom said ‘come in.’

“How’s it going?” Leo stopped short when they looked at me, they gave a low whistle “Look at you, I might mistake you for a respectable young lady.” I felt my ear twitch,

“Sparkles already made that joke.” They laughed at me then bowed to mom.

“Well, it’s time to get started I just came to fetch you.” Mom smiled,

“Alright, just give me one second and I’ll be right behind you.” Leo seemed to give a knowing smile, then nodded as they made their exit.

Mom turned back to me, “You’re sure you don’t want me to walk with you?” Honestly, I want to go back and change that decision but considering I’ve done this for years now I should be able to walk down an aisle without my mom holding my hand.

“I’ll be fine. It’s just a few seconds before I meet up with you and Momma.” Mom nodded then got a sad smile on her face.

“You really are growing up.”

Oh no, here it comes,

“Mom please don’t start crying.” She shook her head,

“I’m not!” She took a deep breath then tried to strengthen her resolve, “Okay, I’m okay. See you in a minute, I love you.” She gave me a quick kiss on the forehead and hastily walked out the door. I finally let out the breath I was holding.

I always hated this part, the anxious waiting. Usually, mom would be here to distract me but of course I wanted to prove a point. I tried to strain my ears to listen through the door, momma always gave an introduction speech, I was so concerned listening for the piano to start I jumped at the door behind me slamming shut.

“Glimmer!”

I knew that voice. “Adora?” Sure enough, Adora hastily turned around and gave a sheepish smile.

“Catra...Hi?” I couldn’t hold back my laughter,

“Are you lost?” Adora got a flushed look as she turned to me looking up and down. Her face suddenly got even redder.

“N-no I just wanted to...” She’s so stupid. I can’t keep a smile from fighting it’s way on my face. I walked up to her and grabbed her arm.

“Come on I’ll try and get a guard to escort you to where you’re supposed to be,” I expected Adora to silently follow but she pulled me back slightly. I turned back and gave her a questioning look. Before I could ask what was wrong Adora took a deep breath and started rambling.

“I think you look way better than just ‘fine’ I just couldn’t think of a better word to say because everything just felt wrong in comparison to how absolutely gorgeous you look, and I panicked so I said the first thing that came into my mind. Honestly, you look amazing, well better than amazing, but like I said that was the whole problem with me unable to find the words to describe how great you look. Glimmer said I should tell you that, which I’m not saying, she’s forcing me to say this. Also, you look great even without being all done up heck even in your casual outfit I find it hard to focus, that sounded weird, just forget it… Catra please say something before I walk myself into a breakdown.”

“I-” How was I supposed to respond to that. Even when Adora said I looked fine I was still a flustered mess and now she just spills out this as if it won’t make my brain short-circuit. Even when I tried to speak, I could hear how breathy it sounded. “Thank you Adora, but I knew what you meant. Honestly, I only asked what you thought because I didn’t want to compliment you too strongly and freak you out, trust me I get it because I also have trouble thinking of words to describe how... fine you look.” That got a flustered smile in return. The Adora scratched the back of her neck.

“We’re really bad at this huh?” I laughed again,

“Yeah, I blame Shadow Weaver.” It felt good for us to laugh at the mention of her name. I’m not the same kit who was jealous of how Shadow Weaver treated Adora, therapy and having two good moms showed me that Adora was just as much affected as me. Adora then heard talking from the main door.

“I should probably head out there.”

I nodded, “Probably.” Adora turned to leave but my grip on her arm tightened. Adora gave me a confused look.

“I have some good news to tell you after the ceremony. It's important.” Adora smiled,

“I’ll be the first to hunt you down.” I let her go and she gave me a wave as she walked backwards, giving a nervous laugh as she almost knocked something over, she gave one more awkward wave as she left the room. I stared at where she once stood and when I heard my cue to leave, I realized I needed that.

I never felt as calm as I did when the doors opened to the main throne room with rows of people on either side.

Adora was able to sneak in the side door and quickly make her way to sit next to Glimmer in the front row, Azar was still speaking so luckily nobody noticed,

“How’d it go?” Glimmer whispered in a hushed voice, Adora’s face began to go red as she recalled the conversation, Glimmer smirked “good I assume?” Adora just nodded not making eye contact, Glimmer then got a smug look towards Bow who just rolled his eyes.

He felt like Glimmer was cheating at their game by interfering with Adora.

“Without further a due let’s begin.” Everyone stood up as everyone turned towards the large double doors opening to reveal Catra who Cyra was surprised to see looked calm and collected remembering the awkward and shy girl who would have to cling to her mom while looking down to even make the fifth teen steps to the thrones. Cyra already felt her eyes start to water, though she felt better when Azar seemed to be barely holding it together herself.

Catra tried not to seem too eager by slowing her steps, but she wanted this to be over with. She thinks she did good enough because by the time she got to her mom's they were both smiling. “You did great.” Cyra said in a hushed tone to which Catra just gave a sheepish smile. Azar’s voice then echoed throughout the halls.

“We can’t thank you all enough for joining us today in honor of Elizabeth’s ceremonial celebration, though I assume most are most excited for the after party.” Everyone laughed, Catra was envious of how her momma could command a room and keep everyone engaged, even Cyra had trouble. “We’ll try not to keep you too long, with all that said, Leo?”

Leo approached with a box in hand bowing slightly before presenting it to Cyra, who gave a quiet thank you. Cyra then stood tall in front of Catra,

“I never thought I would get to see the day I could formally recognize your coming of age. It is no secret that you are here today is seen as a miracle in itself, with complications during your early days and the Horde invasion taking you and others.” The room filled with silence and Adora suddenly felt uncomfortable in her own skin. Cyra takes a deep breath, “but against all odds here you stand before us, showing just how... persistent you are.” Cyra cracked a smile, and Catra heard

Glimmer snickered as she whispered,

“That’s the royal way of saying stubborn." Azar seems to hear it too because she lets out a laugh herself.

“We couldn’t have asked for a better daughter.” She opens the box to reveal a golden hair clip with what looked like pieces of amber shards accenting the sides. Catra stood in awe and genuinely didn’t know what to say, Cyra leaned down slightly to whisper. “Happy birthday sweetie.” Catra refused to acknowledge the tears coming to her eyes as she took the box in her hand.

“Thank you.” Cyra smiled and gave her a quick but tight hug. She then moved aside, people clapping as Azar approached Catra.

“Gonna be hard to follow that up.” Catra laughed.

“You could save us both by just saying ‘yeah what she said’ then we can start the fun part.” Azar chuckled,

“Yeah, but now, I have to show Cy up.” Catra jokingly rolled her eyes. “Liz, I think from the moment I saw you I became stupidly attached. You would give me heart attacks almost every day whenever you would decide to climb the walls and stars forbid you ever stood still. When you were...gone, I tried so hard to stay strong not only for your mother, but for myself as well. When we finally got you back it was as if everything had fallen back into place. I’ve been given the chance to watch you grow up and make up for lost time I had thought I would never get back. I see you here today and feel nothing less than pride. I honestly don’t know what I did to deserve you. I hope that this is one of the many milestones I get to see you through,”

She presented her own box to Catra that she opened and felt her tears begin all over again. It was a golden arm band that was almost identical to Azar's. Catra stared in awe as Azar positioned it onto Catra's right arm. Seeing the tears going down her face, Azar then leaned down and hugged her as tightly as she could.

The cheers covering her last words for Catra, “and I hope one day you are able to see just how we see you, who is the kindest and most beautiful person in the world.”

Azar went to pull back, but Catra clutched her closer. Azar smiled and just kept her closer. Catra always hated people seeing her cry, this way she could just hide it until she could collect herself.

The rest of the ceremony went off without a hitch one of the elder Magicats read off the oath Catra had read every year since her 13th birthday and was officially recognized as an adult, of course she has always been the princess of Halfmoon but now she has taken an oath of allegiance and responsibility, meaning that she now has the power to take over as acting queen should anything happen to her mothers.

Azar noticed Catra’s sudden hesitance when she was told that. “Don’t worry they always say that, besides we might just leave you in charge so we can get a break.” That made Catra scoff, but it made her feel better.

As the ceremony was ending Catra was hyper aware of how the veil on her head irritated her ears, not to mention her knees hurting from when she had to kneel before the elder, Cyra had to fight back a smile subtly squeezing Catra's hand. 'Almost done' was the message it conveyed. Catra was slowly starting to doze off but then the elder said,

"You may now rise and greet your people." Catra tried to hide her sigh of relief, but it wasn't effective; Azar gave her hand to help her stand.

This was the scary part. Having to turn around and face everyone, it always made her hands shake and her chest tighten. It frustrates her to no end, she knows everyone here. Still her mind just fills with fears and insecurity. She knows that she gets the same response every year, people cheering for a while then her mother's pulling her aside to reassure her and make sure she doesn't get overcrowded. So, the frustration only grows, this fear is completely illogical, still she has to take a deep breath before she can turn around.

Just as she said people began to cheer, congratulations ringing through the hall as well as some happy birthday's. Glimmer and Bow are screaming like mad men in the front row, While Adora claps happily while simultaneously trying to decide if she should act like she doesn't know the people next to her.

Catra and Adora find each other's eyes and Catra hates how her breathing instantly calms down. Adora always had that effect on her, it drove her crazy in all the wrong ways.

Once Cyra noticed the cheering begin to die down she grabbed Catra's shoulder and escorted her to the back door, all the while Azar tells people to make their way to the town square where the real fun will start.

Glimmer grabs Adora, "Come on, this is going to be the best party ever!" Bow hollered in agreement Adora pulled back,

"I'll catch up with you, I told Catra I would wait for her." They both smiled, Bow then grabbed Glimmer

"Okay see you there!" and they both followed the crowd out the door, Adora just sat back down hoping Catra wouldn't be too long.

"Adora? What are you doing?" Adora startled, feeling slightly as if she got caught. She relaxes a bit when she sees it's just Azar.

"Oh, I was just waiting on Catra. She said she has something important to tell me." Azar's eyes widened a bit.

She might actually lose this bet to Glimmer. She thought.

Then she smiled. "Alright, she's just speaking with Cy she shouldn't be long. See you two at the party." Adora gave a small wave goodbye and tapped her hands on her lap as she patiently waited.

"Get this thing off me." Cyra laughed at her daughter.

"Alright, hold on." Cyra then began to remove the meticulously placed pins that kept Catra's veil in place. The second in was removed Catra shook her head, her ears flapping. "You're so dramatic."

"Easy for you to say, that thing itches." Cyra laughed and Catra turned her back towards her. "Can you put my hair up? I don't want it to get in my face." Cyra smiled as she began to undo the half up- half down style.

"Anything for you birthday girl." Catra jokingly rolled her eyes as her mother began to put up her hair, Catra suddenly jumped and opened the box she had in her hand.

"Put this in?" Catra handed the new hairclip to her mother, she smiled and sealed the bun in place with the clip.

"Alright you're all good." She then gave Catra a kiss on her cheek, to which Catra gave a dramatic 'mom!' causing Cyra to laugh in

turn.

Catra then began walking back towards the throne room then stopped when she saw Cyra not follow.

“Are you coming?” Cyra shook her head.

“I’ll be there later I’m just going to put this up in your room to avoid it getting messed up.” She gestured to the veil in her hand.

“I can go put it up.” Cyra raised her hand in refusal.

“It’s fine, go have fun. I’ll be down in a second.” Catra nodded, turned to the door then just as quickly turned back and hugged her mom.

“I love you.” Cyra’s lips turned up as she hugged her back.

“Love you more.” Catra then smiled as she went into the throne room leaving Cyra to herself.

It couldn’t have been more than two minutes when Catra reappeared and Adora quickly stood up. Catra smiled, she honestly should’ve expected this. “Hey, Adora.” Catra walked up to her and smiled. “Have you been to the party yet?” Adora shook her head

“No, I wanted to wait for you.” Adora can’t keep saying stuff like that, her heart can’t handle it.

Catra then offered out her arm with a smirk,

“I’ll be your escort then.” Adora laughed as her face heated up.

“Shouldn’t I be the one to escort you? Miss birthday girl?” Despite her words Adora still took her outstretched arm. Catra laughed,

“Humor me, will you?” If Catra with her hair down is a sight to behold her with her hair up is other worldly. She had loose strands

framing her face, but the low bun revealed all the detailing on her outfit that just seemed to make her eyes shine. Adora gulped.

“Anything for you.” Catra’s breath catches, and her brain was working into overdrive to try and excuse Adora’s words. Even though she knew it was meant as a joke Catra’s heart still craved to know the extent of those words. What is Adora’s definition of anything?

Catra pointedly just began walking. “Come on, I don’t want sparkles teleporting like an idiot trying to find us.” Adora laughed at the thought and followed Catra out the door and Catra’s ears recoiled a bit at the suddenly loud surroundings.

Everyone was dancing to the music that only seemed too crescendo louder and louder, kits running around with sparklers that were no doubt lit by Azar, and the center was temporarily a giant bon fire where most people were dancing, tables scattered and decorated with food. Despite the ringing in Catra’s ears she was still smiling. Seeing Adora in the orange lighting and her blue eyes captivated by all the hustle and bustle was a sight to behold. She was practically bouncing with sudden energy then she turned to Catra as if waiting for permission to go play. Catra laughed and dragged her down.

“Come on dummy before you break something from eagerness.”

“Esme. Nice to see you.” Grell walked easily up to her, Esme gave him the cold shoulder. Grell pouted, “Oh please tell me you’re not still upset about the other day?” Esme sighed.

“Of course not. That would be childish. How are you Grell?” If Esme knew anything it was how to save face. Grell smiled excitedly

“I’m doing great, though Vivianne is nervous.” Esme gasped.

“Is she proposing already?” Grell nodded,

“Yes, all eyes will be on them. I’ll make sure of it. Have you seen Cyra anywhere?” Esme looked around,

“Huh, that’s strange I thought she would be here.”

Grell then gave a faux face palm

“Oh, now I remember. I forgot she went to the archives, said she had to update Elizabeth’s status.” Esme’s eyes widened.

“What?”

Grell shook his head, “I completely forgot but I think she had to drop off something so she shouldn’t be there now.” Grell gave a pointed look to Esme, who finished off the rest of her drink. She tried ignoring him, but he just lowered his voice, “I’d hurry if I were you.” Esme slams her cup onto the table.

“If you’ll excuse me.” she then walked away briskly. Grell smiled as he took a swig of his own drink. Vivianne then narrowly misses Esme as she strides through the crowd.

“What’s with her?” The question wasn’t really directed at her father, but he answered less.

“Nothing to you need to worry about, do you have the ring?” She did, it’s presence was practically burning a hole into her pocket every time she remembered it existed.

“Maybe we should wait. Azar, Leo, or Cyra will stop it the second they even think something is

happening and-” Grell rolled his eyes,

“Let me worry about that, just be ready.” Vivianne bit her lip.

“I don’t think Catra will leave Adora’s side. I might not have a chance, so can we just push this off? Please?” Grell let out a frustrated sigh.

“Vivianne, I don’t have time to argue with you again. So just do as you’re told. You’ll thank me later.” Grell then left as suddenly as he appeared. Vivianne had a terrible feeling about today.

Azar was having fun doing shows for the little ones, making illusions and doing some fire tricks she taught herself. “Azar!”

Azar internally groaned as she shooed the kids away. “Grell to what do I owe the pleasure?” Azar’s smile was the definition of strain, though she got serious when she saw the stern look on Grell’s face. Despite how they butt heads Grell was head guard for a reason.

“I’m sorry to say but I have reason to believe Esme is planning on stealing something.”

“What?!” Azar flushed as she noticed eyes on her and quickly laughed as if she just had a little too much to drink before dragging Grell off to the side. “What are you talking about?” Azar said in a hushed voice though it was unnecessary considering the hollering surrounding them.

“She was lurking around the castle and when I mentioned Cyra wasn’t around she hastily left toward the castle I have reason to believe she wants something from the archive.”

“Shit.” Azar hastily looked around then back to Grell, “Hold down the fort here. No reason to cause a panic. I’ll take care of it.’

“Are you taking Leo?” Azar shook her head,

“I’ll be fine on my own.” Then she hastily walked away grumbling about how nothing can ever just go her way.

Grell kept up the façade until Azar was long gone, ‘two down, one to go.’ They briskly walked to Leo, having feigned panic in his voice. “Leo, something is wrong Esme is missing and so are the queens.” Leo startled slightly and kicked themselves for not noticing earlier, Leo however just took a deep breath.

‘’If I’m being honest, they’re probably just trying to get a quickie in while Liz has her friends around.” They said nonchalantly, Grell felt his eye twitch.

“Could you go check on them? Just to ease my worries.” Leo’s ear twitched as they got a grim look on their face.

“I’d rather not.”

Grell sighed,

“Fine I’ll just go ask Elizabeth to go find them for me.” Leo’s eyes widened.

“You-”

“So, you’ll go check on them?” Leo huffed as they stood up from the wall they were leaning against and began to walk away. “Thank you, Leo!” They just flicked him off as they began to mumble to themselves about having to deal with this bullshit.

Grell waited till they were well out of sight until they went to the band and made a song request slipping in some silver to bump it up the list. Everything has to be perfect. now for the hard part.

Getting Catra alone.

“Azar, I swear if I end up seeing you naked, I’ll kill you!” Leo shouted throughout the castle making their presence abundantly clear, they did not want another run in.

“Leo what are you going on about?” Leo jumped slightly when they saw Cyra, by herself?

“Grell told me he was worried he hadn’t seen you or Azar I thought you two had snuck off.” Cyra flushes a bit.

“No, I just went to put this away for Elizabeth." Cyra gestured to the veil in her hands. She had gotten caught up in a conversation

with Dianne. "Is Azar not out there?" Leo shook their heads. Suddenly a nearby guard spoke up.

"Sorry to interrupt your majesty but I believe I saw queen Azar come in rushing towards the archives, she said something about miss Esme." That made Cyra's breath catch, what could they need in the archives? Cyra gave a stern look to the guard.

"I'm going to go check on them."

Leo nodded.

"I'll accompany you." Cyra didn't wish to argue so she just walked with Leo close behind. This gave Cyra a bad feeling, she had so many questions. Why was Esme going to the archives? By herself? Then Azar following her? It all left a bitter taste in her mouth.

Cyra hadn't realized her steps became an angry march as she approached the archives, then she heard yelling.

"What the fuck is wrong with you? Let go!" Azar's voice made Cyra storm in.

"What is going on!" Cyra stared in shock at the scene before her, Esme crouching down holding a piece of paper close to her chest and Azar trying to pull it away from her. Leo quickly pulled them apart.

Esme still held the paper tight, when she was standing it was then Cyra noticed the shredded pieces of paper scattered on the floor. "What did you do?!" Cyra yelled as she looked at them. Esme refused to look at anyone still gripping the paper with an iron grip.

Leo grabbed Esme by her arm, "Let go of me!" Leo ignored her protests as they looked at Cyra.

"What do you want me to do, with her?" Cyra stared in disbelief, 'this was all wrong.' Her eyes then snapped to the piece of paper in her hand. Esme noticed and her hands began to flail to tear it

apart Leo simply grabbed her other hand though she tried to kick back. Cyra snatched the paper out of her hand.

“Don’t!” Cyra saw it was a record of her birth, something that would be evidence of Esme’s royal heritage no doubt. Cyra began to connect the dots for herself. She wanted evidence, she wanted something to prove herself as someone important.

“You never planned on staying.” Cyra glared at Esme. "You were lying this whole time! You planned on sneaking away and using this to make people treat you like royalty.” Cyra gestured to the parchment. “I can’t believe I actually thought you meant anything you said.”

“I did plan on staying-”

“Liar!” Leo’s eyes widened as she noticed Cyra’s eyes dilatating, her claws coming out to an uncomfortable point, and her fur fluffing up. Azar looked concerned as she tried to reach out for her.

“Cy, let’s-”

“Don’t touch me!” Cyra dropped the piece of paper as she began to grip her hair. The room filled with whimpers as Cyra clutched her head. Leo shoved Esme into Azar as then approached Cyra.

“Get out I’ll handle this.”

Azar scoffed,

“I’m not leaving I can help!”

Leo growled,

“You can help by getting her out of here. I know better than anyone else so let me do my job!” Azar went to protest but then heard Cyra cry out as a painful crack filled the air. “Azar out now!” Her feet moved on their own as she dragged Esme out and

slammed the door shut behind them, actively trying to ignore the cries of her wife on the other side.

Azar looked at Esme to see she grabbed that paper again, Azar slapped her, making her fall to the ground. “What the fuck is wrong with you? Do you even realize what you’ve done!” As Esme pushed herself up, she still reached for the parchment. Azar pulled it away from her. “Are you serious? Do you even care about your daughter!?” Esme’s hair covered her face making her laughter shake Azar’s bones.

“You remind me so much of Edgar.” She then looked right at Azar, making precise eye contact. “He also hit like a bitch.” Azar snarled and began to walk towards her. “I’d read that if I were you.” Azar paused and looked back to the piece of paper that seemed to ruin everything. “Might put things in perspective.” Azar glared at her and opened the folded piece of paper.

Her eyes widened, causing Esme to smirk.

“There it is.”

“Cyra, I need you to listen alright?” Cyra has already lost the ability to speak, most of her answers being snarls and whimpers. Cyra was never able to transform seamlessly, always getting stuck in the painful in-between where her bones were more panther, but her body is still fighting to remain Magicat. The result is wanting to rip your skin away from your body.

Most close calls were from stress, too many meetings in one day that just cause Cyra’s emotions to go into overdrive and starts the shift, though they were easily solved with Leo making Cyra call off all her meetings and forcing her to relax. This is the first time it’s been started by pure anger. Leo was more concerned with getting others out of the room than Cyra for a small moment, Leo knows better than anyone how violent Cyra can get, the scar on their cheek is the smallest reminder.

“Cyra, I think you need to fully shift, then we can have you change back.” Cyra didn’t seem to like that idea as she let out a painful scream. Cyra only ever fully shifted twice, once when she received word of her parents' demise and the second of when Catra was taken, each time someone was hurt.

“Do you think you can calm down enough to change back? Or should I get Azar to put you to sleep?” Cyra snarled.

Cyra had a strict ‘keep Azar away’ rule. Leo sighed. This was always the hard part, though they’re lucky that they now have such a good topic that can calm Cyra down almost instantly.

“You know Liz was trying to teach Adora how to dance." Leo began as they pushed back Cyra's hair. "I honestly didn’t think Liz had a patient bone in her body, but she seemed like she was distracted with trying to not stare like a lovesick idiot.” A sound similar to a laugh came from her. Leo was grateful when Catra returned for obvious reasons, but the way Cyra seemed to completely relax at just the mention of her name was an added bonus. “Adora doesn’t seem to be any better, I think she tripped over herself multiple times just trying to stare at her. Glimmer and Bow aren’t very subtle either. Ironic how they get frustrated with Adora and Liz’s obliviousness when they both are just as bad, if not worse.” Cyra’s labored breathing became even as she just listened.

Leo noticed her claws were no longer reaching out, so they slowly shifted to sit next to her. “You’re doing great, can you try talking?” Cyra opened her mouth but began coughing when she tried to speak, Leo sighed. Coughing meant she was gaining the ability. “I’ll get you some water, you want some painkillers?” Cyra took a deep breath.

“Yes.” It came out hoarse as her vocal cords began to shift back to speaking and not just screaming. Leo nodded as they gave her a once over. Everything looked fine, luckily nothing got dislocated. Leo grabbed Cyra and gently helped her sit up properly. Once she

was leaning against the wall, she breathed out a sigh of relief. Leo stood up.

"I'll be right back; do you want Azar?" Cyra seemed to think on it for a moment.

"Yes please. Thank you, Leo." Leo just smiled,

"It's no problem." Cyra smiled back before putting her head back against the wall trying to take deep breaths.

Leo left and closed the door tightly behind them, they couldn't even take a deep breath because they saw Esme on the ground and Azar standing above her. "Azar what the hell?" Leo was being mindful of their voice, knowing Cyra is in a very delicate position right now and the tiniest thing could set her off. Azar didn't respond.

Leo noticed her reading something. "Azar what's-"

"Take Esme down to the dungeon. Tell Cyra she just ran off." Leo went to protest but Azar was already grabbing Esme who began to fight. Leo grabbed Azar.

"Azar sorry to say but according to the law since she is a part of the royal family her imprisonment has to be a unanimous decision". Azar shoved the parchment in their hand.

"Then there shouldn't be a problem." Leo glanced between the two women, before reading,

'In case of any medical emergency regarding Princess Cyra D'riluth II please look first to Elizabeth Rose, as the legitimate mother, her kidney in case of incidents will be a match. This is to remain between us

-King Edgar D'riluth I'

"Adora, I swear you're going to make yourself sick. I will not be rolling you back to Brightmoon." Glimmer and Bow laughed at

Catra's words, but Adora swallowed down her steak harshly.

"Oh please, it would realistically be Glimmer rolling me back." Adora's words came out sadder than she liked, Catra got a smug smile on her face.

"You're right no way am I going to waste my first trip hauling your ass around." That caused Glimmer to look to Bow confused. Then Glimmer looked back at Catra's smirk, and her eyes widened.

"You're kidding." Adora looked to Bow as if it would explain anything, and he shrugged all the while Catra nodded with a smile and Glimmer started having sparks come off from her. "If you're lying, I'll kill you!" Glimmer was smiling so hard her cheeks ached.

"Mom said I would have some conditions and I need to ask Angella first." Glimmer then started jumping and squealing. Adora raised her hand dumbly.

"Am I missing something?" Bow then got a look of recognition.

"No way!" Bow and Glimmer then began jumping in excitement together. Adora felt even more confused. Catra laughed at her obliviousness. She grabbed Adora's hands.

"My mom said I could go to Brightmoon with you!" It was over simplified but that was all Catra needed to say. Adora smiled so brightly and hugged Catra tightly spinning her around.

"That's amazing!" Catra laughed, her stomach flips. Adora realizes her and Catra's position and placed her down. "When? How long? Why?" Adora began a rapid fire of questions and Catra's smile began to hurt her face.

"I don't know the details, but we planned a trip to Mystacore and my mom said I could stay in Brightmoon and then meet them there." Adora sighed.

"That's awesome." Catra nodded.

“I told you there was no point in worrying about future crap.” Adora laughed and nodded.

“So sorry I ever doubted you, your highness.” Adora said in a teasing tone, Catra shoved her jokingly

Glimmer was still going frantic then put her arms around Catra and Adora, “I’m so excited! Catra, we are going to have so much fun! Don’t worry about my mom she’ll love to have you!” Bow was also giddy.

“I can show you around the whispering woods, oh and you have to come to Plumeria princess Perfuma is the best.”

Glimmer rolled her eyes and crossed her arms.

“I wouldn’t say that.” Catra noticed but Adora quickly called her attention away.

“You would love the gardens, and there are so many high hiding places.” Glimmer and Bow didn’t understand how impressive that was, but Catra smiled brightly.

“Elizabeth.” Catra’s smile saddened slightly, she always hated when he talked. Adora noticed in an instant. Catra gave Adora's hand a squeeze then turned to Grell.

"Hey, enjoying the party?"

Grell laughed, "Of course. You sure do know how to throw a party." Adora stared confused at Catra's shift in attitude. It was obvious she was playing nicely, at least to Adora. Her ears were perked up and her tail twitched every so often. "I was actually wondering if I could speak with you, privately." The last word was pointed at the group. Catra sighed, about to agree just to get things over and done with but Adora recalled Vivianne's words.

"Stay by her side during the celebration after the ceremony. Don't leave her alone. With anybody...especially my dad." Adora gripped Catra's hand.

"Catra I actually wanted to talk with you about...uh-" Adora didn't think this through, she dragged out her 'Uh.' Glimmer looked confused when Adora looked at her trying to subtly ask for help. By the time Glimmer understood Bow had stepped in. "We really wanted to show Adora the Magicat games, with the kits!"

Grell raised an eyebrow.

"What would be the point? She is not a Magicat." Bow was now looking at Glimmer just as desperately.

"Well-"

"Lizzy!" Suddenly Vivianne appeared as she grabbed Catra's arm. "Hey let's go dance! I didn't forget about that promise." Vivianne then looked at Grell. "Oh, hey dad. I was just going to steal Lizzy away for our dance. That's okay, right?" They both had a stare down for a moment before Grell smiled.

"Of course, have fun!" Vivianne smiled and dragged Catra to the dance floor. Adora then saw Grell about to leave but she had a bad feeling about all of this. Why did he want to talk with Catra, then just walk away when Vivianne shows up?

"Adora?" Glimmer called.

"I'll be right back I want to check on something." Adora didn't wait for a response as she ran toward Grell disappearing in the sea of people.

"Hey!" That caught his attention as he turned around. Adora squeezed through the crowd and was now face to face with him.

"Can I help you?" He said with obvious disdain.

"I already talked with Vivianne, and we're cool now. So, can we be cool now? I don't even know why you don't like me." Grell started to laugh.

“Forgive my daughter she was always a bit competitive. Though I apologize. I as well thought you would be a problem, but it turns out you were nothing more than an inconvenience.” Adora stared confused. She hated how he spoke to her, as if she was a child who didn’t know what insults are. Grell then crouched down to eye level. “Know now that you are nothing more than a phase, a shiny new toy Elizabeth was intrigued by and soon will get bored of. When you leave, she’ll realize that.” He then laughed in Adora’s face as he began to walk away.

Adora gaped then blurted out, “If that’s true, why is she coming with us to Brightmoon?” Grell snapped his head around and Adora clutched her mouth.

“What?”

Adora started to go back away. Grell tried to approach her, but Adora ran into the crowd trying to avoid him. Grell stopped pursuing her when he noticed. He cursed under his breath, this was bad. He dug his fingers into his palms. He then looked at Vivianne and Catra.

He needed this to go perfectly. He reached for the fabric in his pocket, the sole piece of evidence he had then gasped as he didn’t find it. He franticly looked for the missing fabric.

“Explain, now!” Esme kept her head down. Azar growled as she grabbed her shirt again. “Speak now or we’ll just starve you in the dungeon.” Leo flinched at Azar’s voice trying to be aware of Cyra in the room. Esme still ignored her.

“Azar, go sit with Cyra I’ll take care of this.” Azar turned to protest but Leo stopped her. “Unless you want Cyra shifting again we need to keep her calm until her adrenaline goes down. I will get the information out of her just go. Try to get her back to the party, people are already starting to notice she’s gone.” Leo grabbed Esme and pointed to the room not allowing any back talk. Azar huffed. Before she went in Leo spoke once more. “Don’t tell her. Not until we know more alright?” Azar just

nodded and entered the room shutting the door behind her.

Leo then glared down to Esme who flinched slightly. Leo didn't say a word as they dragged her somewhere more secluded.

"Please don't I'll just leave and never come back!"

"Too late for that." Leo shoved her against the wall and cornered her in. "Explain yourself." Esme tried to ignore them, looking down at the floor. "I assure you Azar is a lot kinder than me. I am not above using force to get information out of you." Esme shut her eyes tightly. Leo waited for her.

Realizing they weren't budging, Esme sighed.

"There was a contract in place to save face." Esme said. Leo didn't interrupt allowing her to continue to speak, "Edgar was a snake nothing more. I said I wanted to wait to have kits, I was only eighteen and I still wanted to do things and have fun. Edgar got impatient. Laid some house cleaner that he fancied and got her knocked up. Obviously, that was Elizabeth." Esme took a deep breath. "Edgar thought it was perfect, he got a kit, and I didn't have to be bedridden for months. I was upset for sure, but it was a win-win. Things got complicated when Elizabeth wanted to be a part of her life." Esme scoffed. "Of course, out of all the girls in the world he had to choose the one with attachment issues. We tried offering her money, but she didn't want it, so we made a deal. She would be her head caretaker she would be with Cyra every part of the day. The only condition is she had to keep it a secret. I came here to destroy all record of it." Leo stared in shock this didn't compute in their brain.

"Where- what happened to Elizabeth." Esme shrugged.

"I don't know. All I know is it was part of the contract that if me and Edgar were to die, she was to be exiled from Halfmoon. This was an assurance she wouldn't try to reveal everything and try to take the throne for herself. Though that was an unnecessary

precaution, that woman had not an evil bone in her body.” Leo interrupted.

“Elizabeth is alive!?”

“Maybe, as I said I don’t know. I’m honestly surprised she listened, she worshiped Cyra.” Leo couldn’t believe their ears.

“Why come for the records now? Better yet why not just take the throne and never have to worry about anything.”

“Being queen isn’t fun. Everything is micromanaged to no end, everyone's problems are your problems, and I wasn’t even the head! Can you imagine? I never got to have a life of my own, ever since I was born, I was wed to the king. All because I was born with a nice face. I wanted a chance to live my own life, to be me! I only came back for the records because I was staying at a nearby village, and someone knew... so I wanted to get rid of all the evidence. So, I could keep my luxuries.” Leo scoffed.

“You realize Cyra was ready to give you everything if you just stayed. If you just explained everything this all could’ve been resolved by now.” Esme’s eyes flashed with...something before she shook her head.

“She was going to the archives to change Elizabeth’s status in the records. She would’ve seen it.” Leo stared confused.

“What? No, we rarely use that room. Most recent records are stored in Cyra’s office.” Esme’s eyes widened.

“But, Grell said she was going there.” That raised a red flag in Leo’s head. Though they didn’t understand why Grell would send her back here. Something wasn’t right. “Please just...let me go. I’ll never bother you again. I can’t just stay locked up forever.”

“Even if it meant reconnecting with Cyra?” Esme laughed.

“You know now I’m not her mother. She has said she never thought of me as a mother. She only tried to reconnect with me

because she thought I was, maybe she wanted some approval or something.” Leo was honestly disgusted.

“So that’s it? You’re just going to leave? Was there no part of you that cared about Cyra?”

“What would I gain from loving a bastard?” Esme said coldly.

"Get out."

Esme looked up shocked. "What?"

"Get out and never return. Now! Before I change my mind!" Esme flinched at the raised voice but tripped over herself as she ran away.

“Cyra?” Azar saw her leaning against a wall with her chest moving up and down with calm breaths. She turned her head at Azar’s voice. She smiled.

“Come here often?” Cyra said tiredly.

Azar chuckled as the door shut behind her, walking eagerly to sit next to her.

“Is everything alright?” Cyra nodded.

“Nothing some painkillers won’t fix.” Once Azar was sitting properly Cyra leaned in closer resting her head on her shoulder, she hissed a bit at the headache starting. Azar wrapped her arm around her.

“Try to be careful, Leo should be back soon.” Cyra gave a hum of acknowledgement.

“It was stupid of me to think she changed... I’m such an idiot.” Azar tensed under her a bit. The scent of salty tears invading her nose. Azar clutched her tighter.

“There’s nothing idiotic about giving people a second chance. You did nothing wrong. She took advantage of you, nothing more.” Azar began stroking her hair, trying to keep her calm and collected. Cyra noticed.

“I’m fine. I don’t know why Leo acts as if adrenaline takes hours to wear off.” Cyra tried forcing a laugh but gripped her side in pain. Azar held her.

“Careful!” Cyra smiled at the concern as she got situated again in Azar’s neck. “You’re gonna give this old woman a heart attack.” That made Cyra laugh again.

“Stop it hurts to laugh!” Azar smirked.

“Sorry it’s hard to keep down my natual charisma.” Cyra rolled her eyes as she took deeper breaths.

“Where’s Esme?” Azar shook her head firmly.

“Worry about that tomorrow.” Cyra frowned.

“Why were you here anyway?” Azar hummed as Cyra interlocked their hands.

“Grell noticed Esme leave wanted me to go check on her. Though I don’t know why Leo is here.” Cyra curled into Azar more.

“I’m surprised he didn’t come get her himself, he’s usually first in line to steal the glory.” Azar nodded. It was strange how open he was to letting Azar handle it. Especially since he is a fight now ask questions later kind of guy.

“Yeah, that is weird.”

“Is Elizabeth having fun?” Azar rubbed the back of Cyra’s hand with her thumb.

“Yeah, lots. One point Glimmer and Bow were jumping around like maniacs while Adora and her just talked. It was funny.”

“I actually wanted to talk with you about letting Elizabeth go to Brightmoon with them, then just meet us at Mystacore.” Azar stared confusedly at her, thinking she must still be out of it. “I already spoke to Elizabeth about it. She was so happy.” Azar stared at her wife’s face which was totally at peace and smiled.

“I think that’s a great idea.” Silence passed for a while and Azar just began to speak about anything and everything while they waited. “...I swear Vivianne was silently fuming while they danced-” Cyra suddenly sat up. “Whoa careful Cy!” Cyra clutched her head for a moment before trying to stand up. “Cy wait-”

“I need to see Elizabeth now.” Azar helped Cyra as she began to fall a bit.

“Cy calm down, just wait till Leo comes back and we’ll go see her.” Cyra shook her head frantically.

“No that’ll take too long!” Azar gripped her shoulder.

“Cy what’s wrong.”

"Grell sent you here so nobody could stop Vivianne’s proposal! She’s going to do it in front of everyone, practically forcing her to say yes! So please let’s go!” Cyra began to drag Azar behind her. She didn’t know what to do other than follow.

Azar just had to keep her calm.

“Vivianne, are you okay?” Catra tried asking as Vivianne quite literally dragged her, then just as suddenly pulled her into a dance as Vivianne looked over her shoulder.

“Just look at me and dance.” Catra was starting to get concerned as Vivianne took her through the motions. All the while she was staring at her father just waiting for him to screw off. He gave her a nod then left to who knows where. Vivianne then looked back to Catra. “Sorry, I was just... you look great.” Vivianne’s face went from serious to flushed. Catra almost got whiplash from the change.

“Thanks, you look good yourself. Is there a reason you were in such a rush? You know I wouldn’t forget.” Vivianne chuckled.

“Yeah, just got...antsy.” She sighed as she pulled Catra closer.

"Being a little forward-"

“Will you marry me?” It was in a quiet voice and Catra almost thought she made it up.

“What?” Vivianne laughed as she pulled back looking in her eyes. She was serious. “Um, Vivianne, listen you’re great and all but-”

“I figured. Do you think you would consider it if we dated?” Catra did not want to have this conversation. Vivianne said. “You can answer honestly. I promise I won’t get mad.”

Catra looked down slightly, “Sorry Vivianne but, I just don’t see you that way.”

Vivianne gave a sad smile. “It’s Adora isn’t it?” Catra’s face went red. “I knew from the second I saw the way you looked at her. I didn’t get it. She seemed like everything you hated. Then I spoke with her. She really is just a kind person. I don’t think she could physically be bad. It’s funny actually. I imagined my competition to be so intimidating, who else could get your attention? Just for it to be her.” Catra felt embarrassed. Vivianne didn’t stop. “I never had a chance. Did I? Not when she seems to be the holder of your heart since childhood.”

The answer was so obvious to Catra, but she couldn’t say it. “I’m sorry Vivianne. Maybe...maybe if things were different but-” Vivianne shook her head.

“I don’t need sympathy. You don’t need to apologize for your emotions. I mainly wanted to warn you.” Catra tilted her head and Vivianne leaned down to her ear. “My dad knows about your adventure outside, and he has evidence. He was planning on black mailing you to say yes to my proposal.” Catra gasped as

Vivianne pulled away, returning to the dance without missing a beat.

“Why didn’t you just go along with it?” Catra asked genuinely.

“I’ll be honest it was tempting but...I love you. And I couldn’t live with myself if I made you miserable.” Catra stopped in place causing Vivianne to stare in confusion. Catra wrapped her arms around her neck hugging her tightly. Vivianne was caught off guard, eyes wide and tearing up.

“You’re such a great friend, and I know it’s not in the way you want but... I do love you.” Vivianne hugged her tightly. Seeing Adora just ahead of her. She clutched her eyes shut and felt her tears start to pour.

“There really isn’t anything I can do? I swear I will never let you want again, I will do anything to make you happy.” Catra frowned, she really wishes it wasn’t so hard. She just hugged Vivianne tighter and that seemed to get the message across. Vivianne laughed through her tears.

"Was I that obvious?" Catra said quietly.

"The way you look at her is the same way I look at you." Vivianne then placed something into Catra’s hand, and upon further inspection she saw it was a torn piece from her pants.

“Grell!” He turned around and saw Cyra, who was trying her best to stand on her own, Azar ready at a moment's notice to catch her.

“My queens how are you? You’re just in time!” Cyra looked out and sure enough Catra and Vivianne were already dancing. Cyra growled.

“You realize you are actively going against a direct order?” Grell sighed.

“I tried to stop her, but she was insistent she wanted to propose. Who am I to get in the way of true love?” Azar pulled Cyra back slightly, frustrated that everything seemed to be against keeping Cyra calm.

“You entitled-”

Then the music stopped. Catra hugged Vivianne then

Nothing.

The group stared in confusion as Catra just walked back to her friends and Vivianne walked off rubbing her eyes. Grell looked floored while Azar smirked. “Looks like Vivianne got cold feet.”

Cyra glared at him.

“We will have a discussion about this behavior.” Cyra then briskly walked towards Catra, and Azar gave a smug smile before she walked after her to make sure she wouldn’t push herself too hard.

Adora was speaking with Catra when Cyra approached her. “Elizabeth.” Cyra said with relief.

“Hey where have you been?” Catra said shoving the fabric into Adora’s pocket, she unfortunately didn’t have her own.

Cyra laughed.

“I got held up.” Catra noticed her sway a bit and Azar appeared behind her and held her up. Catra frowned.

“What’s wrong?”

Azar spoke up first.

“Worked herself a bit too hard Leo is getting her some painkillers, she is supposed to be relaxing.” Azar said pointedly. Catra laughed.

“Something tells me a loud party is the last place she should be.”

Azar sighed,

“That’s what I said.”

Glimmer came on her other side.

“I can teleport her to her room if she wants.” Cyra raised her hand.

“I’m fine. Leo is getting me some medicine and then I’ll be fine.” Catra nudged Adora.

“She’s almost as bad as you.” Glimmer and Bow laughed while Adora began to pout.

Cyra tried to laugh but her head decided to act up again. “Queen Azar!” Azar turned and saw Dianne.

“Oh, is now a bad time?” Catra grabbed Cyra.

“I’ll walk her to her room. Be right back.” Before anyone could object Catra began to drag her mom off.

“Elizabeth I’m fine.” Catra linked arms with her.

“I know but don’t you want to spend time with me?” Cyra smiled.

“Of course. How’s the party?” Cyra leaned her head down to rest on Catra’s head.

“It’s great you and Glimmer did awesome.” Cyra gave a sound in acknowledgment.

“Glad you like it.”

“Cyra?” Leo approached with a glass in hand, painkillers, as well as Catra’s veil across their arm. Cyra frowned.

“Dianne is gonna kill me for leaving that on the floor.” Leo went to grab Cyra, but Catra just took the items from Leo.

“I got it. You go have fun!” Leo stared skeptically.

“Liz it’s my job to do this stuff, besides its your party.” Catra shook her head.

“I owe mom and you a favor anyway. I got it.” Leo sighed and gave up giving a glance to Cyra who just shrugged.

Leo left and Catra began to walk her mom towards her room, but Cyra stopped at Catra’s. “Let’s put that away first.” Gesturing to the veil. Catra nodded and opened the door letting her mom sit on her vanity chair.

Catra helped her sit down and placed the water next to her. “Elizabeth I’m fine, stars you’re as bad as Azar.” Catra rolled her eyes fondly.

“Yeah, just two seconds while I hang this thing up.” Cyra nodded and Catra disappeared into her closet leaving Cyra alone with her thoughts.

She never got a chance to process everything. That’s probably a good thing considering she needs to keep calm. That’s when Cyra noticed a book peeking out of a drawer.

She didn’t think much of it until she saw a name carved into the cover.

Her name.

Cyra pulled it out slowly and stared at the book she had long forgotten. It was withered and dirty but there was no doubt, it was hers.

“Alright mom I’m-“ Catra stopped short when she saw her mothering looking at the book. Cyra’s eyebrows furrowed when she looked up to Catra.

“Where did you get this?” Catra couldn’t even think up a lie as she felt her stomach drop and her heart go into her throat. Cyra stood

up and her voice became stern. “Elizabeth, where did you get this.”

Catra bit her lip and looked down to the floor. Cyra scoffed.

“I’m such an idiot. I should’ve known Grell wouldn’t risk lying about you leaving.”

“Mom-“

“I can’t do this right now.” Cyra turned her back on her trying to keep herself calm.

"Wait let me explain-"

“Go say goodbye to your friends because you aren’t going to Brightmoon anymore.” Catra gasped.

“Wait but-”

“Nor are we going to Mystacore. I’ll speak with Azar about having guards to accompany you once again.” Catra clenched her fist.

“Mom that’s not fair!” Cyra turned back and Catra flinched slightly at the anger present in her eyes.

“Not fair? What’s not fair is how you go behind my back and break the one rule I gave you! What if you had gotten hurt? We would’ve never known, and you would just disappear again.”

“Adora was with me.” Catra spoke without thinking, she hoped it would make Cyra calm down, but it had the opposite effect.

“That doesn’t change anything! Never mind we’ll talk about this later.” Cyra was trying to just ignore the itching on the back of her neck begging her to just scream.

“I’m sorry I went behind your back, but if I had known you were suddenly going to let me leave-”

“Don’t try to flip this on me-”

“I’m not! I’m just saying I assumed that this would be my one chance to get out of here.”

“Why didn’t you just try asking?” Catra scoffed.

“Yes, let me ask the woman who has been treating me like a prisoner for years if I can leave, doesn’t that sound smart?” Cyra had to take a deep breath.

“I’m not arguing with you, especially when you are talking to me like this. Just go.” Catra clenched her fist.

This wasn’t fair, she did everything right. Cyra had lied to her multiple times, and nothing came of it, but Catra lied once and suddenly Cyra is a saint. Catra wouldn’t just take this lying down.

“So, I lie to one time and suddenly I can’t be trusted.” Cyra didn’t even look Catra in the eye.

“Elizabeth, stop.”

“Could you imagine if I stopped trusting you when you lied to my face?”

“Elizabeth-”

“Or maybe the second time, what if I had just completely shut you out after that time?” Cyra didn’t even get a word out. “Imagine if after the third time I refused to even look you in the eye even though you were trying to have a conversation with me!” Cyra began to clutch the side of her head. She tried staying calm, she really tried. Unfortunately, Catra inherited Azar’s way of knowing just how to push her buttons. Catra gave a faux laugh, “Honestly what did I expect, you obviously don’t care about what I have to say.”

Cyra took a deep breath as her claws scrapped the dresser. “You’re right I don’t.” Catra’s false confidence disappeared. “The only thing I care about is keeping you safe. Anyone who threatens that is insignificant to me.” Cyra glared over her shoulder, her

pupils were dilated and Catra had never seen her look so angry. “What category do you fall in?” Catra gasped.

Catra looked at her mom and didn’t see her anymore, she just saw black hair and magenta robes.

“Insignificant.” That word played over in her head clawing in her head begging her to spiral into thoughts she knows she shouldn’t be indulging. She was hurting, and she did what hurt people always do,

“I never should’ve left the Fright zone.” That seemed to snap Cyra out of her stupor and she turned around suddenly, and she saw angry tears going down Catra’s face. Cyra flinched at the way Catra suddenly hardened and stormed out of the room. Cyra wanted to go after her, but she was already stressed, and she realized then that what she said was the worst thing she could’ve said.

“Have you seen Catra at all?” Adora knew she wanted to help her mother, but she’d been gone for over an hour. Glimmer shrugged.

“She might’ve gone to bed, she said earlier she was tired.” Adora frowned, she had hoped she would’ve at least said goodnight. Glimmer laughed at her crestfallen face. “Relax Adora she’s gonna be stuck in Brightmoon for a while then you can ogle as much as you want.” Adora flushed.

“I-” Bow grabbed Glimmer,

“Glimmer be nice.” She rolled her eyes and took another sip of her drink, pouting slightly. Adora decided to go look for Catra herself.

“I’m gonna go check on her, just to be safe.” Bow smiled.

“Okay tell her we said hi!” Adora nodded and left to go find her but was stopped short when she heard Cyra talking with the guards.

“What? And you’re sure you looked everywhere?” The guards gave a hesitant nod back. Cyra began to pull at her hair. “Just-check again!” She turned back and jumped slightly when she saw me. “Oh, Adora.” Her voice didn’t seem to hold her gentleness, she looked as stressed as she was angry.

“Is everything alright?” Cyra sighed then put her hands on her hips.

“Elizabeth is nowhere to be found.” She then gave Adora a skeptical look. “Would she be back at Old Halfmoon?” Adora’s breath caught in her throat.

“Uh-”

“Never mind, I don’t have time for this.” Adora doesn’t know how she figured it out, but she was thankful she seemed distracted at the moment.

“Is she alright? I might be able to help.” Cyra wanted to be angry at Adora, and it wouldn’t be very hard. Though Adora’s face looked so worried she couldn’t find the heart to do it. Cyra sighed.

“We got into an argument, and she stormed off. I’ve checked everywhere and I can’t find her.” Adora shrunk in on herself, it was obvious what the argument was about. Cyra sighed, “She doesn’t want to be found, least of all by me. Do you know where she would be?” Adora had a good idea.

“I think so. I can go check.” Cyra nodded.

“Just...if she doesn’t want to come back at least let me know she’s safe.” Adora gave a firm nod and began heading to the cave entrance Catra had showed her. Guilt eating away at her the whole walk there. She never should have told her to leave now she’s fighting with her mom and it’s all her fault.

What if she can’t go to Brightmoon? Catra will never forgive her.

“Catra?” Adora began shouting as she walked down the tunnels. “It’s Adora! Are you here?” Adora arrived in the wide space and Catra was nowhere in sight, though that doesn’t mean she isn’t here. “Catra?”

Silence.

Adora was used to this game. Catra would get reprimanded and hide away for hours and Adora would be sent to go find her. She could always find her but sometimes, she doesn’t want to be found, not even by Adora.

Unfortunately for Catra, Adora was stubborn. Adora sighed as she just took a seat in the center of the room.

There’s a chance she isn’t here and Adora will sit here forever like an idiot, but there is also a chance she is. Adora will wait for her. Like she always does.

It had to be ten minutes of silence before Adora began to question if Catra was really there.

“How long are you going to sit there?” Adora smiled as she looked up, seeing Catra on a protruding rock high above staring down.

“Until you come down obviously!” Adora expected a smile, but she just turned away.

“Then you should just leave." Adora frowned when she saw Catra’s tail curl over herself. Adora sighed and internally thanked herself for wearing shorts under this skirt but also berated herself for listening to Glimmer when she told her to leave her sword behind.

Adora grabbed the overlaying sash and used it to tie her skirt up to stop it from hindering her. Adora then cracked her knuckles and got a running start and jumped up gripping onto the stone wall. Catra jumped and turned to see Adora with her tongue stuck out trying to climb up.

“Adora what are you doing?” Adora jumped up again, almost slipping as she gripped the wall.

“If you aren’t coming down-” Adora yelped as she slipped causing Catra to sit up. “I’m coming up!” she said as she readjusted her grip. Adora was still closer to the ground than she was the perch Catra was on, but not by much.

“Adora you’re going to hurt yourself!” Adora gave Catra a hopeful look,

“You’ll come down?” Catra rolled her eyes.

“Fine break your legs see if I care.” Adora laughed as she continued to climb Catra trying to feign disinterest.

Catra was startled when Adora shouted in victory as she faceplanted on the perch. “Made it!” It was muffled and it made Catra crack a smile. Catra then shook her head and turned her back towards her.

“Congrats.”

Adora bumped shoulders with Catra, who was trying to ignore her. Though Adora was never one to be ignored. “You know I’m missing cake right now to talk with you so feel special.” Adora said it jokingly, but Catra hissed,

“No one is forcing you to be here!” Adora pulled back at the outburst and Catra hugged her knees, burying her head. “So just go away!”

“Sorry I was just joking.”

“I know!” Adora frowned and pointedly stayed silent. Catra took a deep breath and uncurled slightly. “So, who sent you?”

“No one sent me. I was worried.” Adora smiled, “so is your mom.” That turns out to be the wrong thing to say.

“Well considering the last thing she told me was I was insignificant she can get over it!” Adora stared wide-eyed.

“Catra I’m sure she didn’t mean-” Catra suddenly stood up.

“She said ‘anyone who threatens your safety is insignificant, what category do you fall in?’ Bitch!” Catra shot out small spell that made a rock shatter. The debris hurdling to the ground. “Who does she think she is! So, she can lie to me for years on end and the one time I do it suddenly I’m the bad guy?” Catra’s voice then went soft. “Now I can’t go to Brightmoon.” Adora felt her heart clench when she saw Catra’s eyes water.

“Maybe you should just apologize, and she’ll reconsider?” Catra scoffed.

“I already did.” Adora gave her a skeptical look,

“Did you actually apologize, or did you just say the words ‘sorry?” Catra glared,

“Are you seriously taking her side?” Catra crossed her arms and Adora stood up.

“No, I’m just saying I’m sure Cyra has good intentions. She was worried about you-”

“So, it’s fair that I have to be locked up here with guards breathing down my neck?” Adora dragged her hand down her face.

“Of course, not but you should try and see where Cyra is coming from.”

“Why should I? She never did that for me!”

“Catra she was willing to let you leave, I think that shows how hard she’s trying.”

“After years of lying to me!” Adora went to speak again but heard Catra sniffle.

She was crying.

“Why can you never take my side? Why am I always the one in the wrong?” Catra then looked into Adora’s eyes. “Can you just be my friend right now? I know I’m being stupid and selfish, but I just want you to lie to me and say 'everything will be fine' and side with me, for once.” Catra wiped her eyes harshly. “Fuck!”

Adora just hugged her, she didn’t know if Catra would claw at her or not, but it felt right, especially when Catra hugged her back just as tightly. Adora swayed slightly, making Catra feel drowsy.

She was so tired. Tired of arguing. Tired of just everything.

“I wasn’t trying to justify what Cyra said. I just don’t want you arguing with her because you look so happy when you guys are together, and I want you to be happy.” Adora pulled back and wiped Catra’s tears that had started again. “I hate seeing you cry.” Catra laughed and leaned into Adora’s hand. “Are you mad at me?”

Catra shook her head. “No.” Adora sighed with relief.

“Great because I don’t think I can get down from here by myself.”

“Cyra-” Cyra turned and pointed at Azar’s face.

“If you tell me to calm down, I will burn this place to the ground!” Azar just nodded as Cyra continued to search the castle for Catra.

Leo stayed right by her side the whole time, ready to act if anything was to go wrong. Today was not a good day for Cyra, too many things happened at once, with Esme, Grell, and now Catra is missing. The only thing keeping Cyra sane is the fact that she knows for certain Catra is still in Halfmoon.

Azar wasn’t surprised to find out Catra had escaped. She was sneaky and resourceful it was only a matter of time. Cyra didn't share the same thought process.

“Your majesty she’s back.” Cyra turned sharply towards the guard.

“Where?” He gulped as she pointed to the entrance.

“She should be back any second. She was spotted walking back.” Cyra sighed and went to the castle entrance.

Catra was there with Adora, Glimmer, and Bow. Cyra interrupted.

“Where have you been?” Catra crossed her arms refusing to look at Cyra.

“I went on a walk to clear my head, is that allowed?” Adora nudged Catra.

“Catra.” She just rolled her eyes.

Cyra let out a frustrated breath.

“Fine just- are you okay?”

“I’m tired.” She pulled Adora’s skirt gesturing her to follow, along with Glimmer and Bow.

She just wanted one more night with them.

“Elizabeth, we need to talk. Privately.”

“Can it wait till tomorrow?” Catra strained to keep her tone polite, Adora seemed to appreciate the effort.

Before Cyra could dig herself, a bigger grave Azar interrupted. “Yes, it can.” Catra didn’t wait any longer to drag her friends up stairs to her room.

“Azar why would- “

“Cyra you are creating a rift between you and Liz. You’re not thinking clearly. This is the last time she gets to see her friends for the unforeseeable future. This can wait until morning. They will be gone so no interferences. I know you don’t want to hear it, but you need to relax. Liz is here, Esme is gone, and Grell is nowhere to be seen.”

Cyra nodded. “Okay. You’re right.”

Azar smirked. “Always.”

“Okay what is going on?!” Glimmer barley waited till the door shut to start screaming. Catra kept her voice even as she picked up dirty clothes in her room.

“My mom found out about me leaving and we had an argument.” Glimmer frowned as did Bow.

“Is-”

“I’m not allowed to go to Brightmoon, and I have a new security detail. I assume starting tomorrow after you leave.” Glimmer’s mouth hung open comically. Before Glimmer could express her outrage Catra interrupted. “Can we just forget about it?” Catra gave a forced smile. “Let’s just have a fun sleepover and pretend everything is fine.”

Adora hated that look on her face, her drooping ears and hurt eyes all trying to be hidden by a false smile.

Glimmer sighed and Bow seemed to steal his features. “Best friend squad sleepover?” Bow’s tone forced excitement and came out more like a question than a statement.

“We are not calling ourselves that.”

“Do you prefer Glimmer group?” Glimmer said with a cheeky smile. Catra groaned.

“Never in a million years. Dealing with you is hard enough.” Glimmer laughed and tried pouncing on Catra, but she sidestepped her making Glimmer try for her again.

“Just admit you love me!”

“Never in a billion years.” Catra began dodging her jokingly as Glimmer teased her.

Bow smiled and it seemed they just mutually agreed to ignore the bad news, but Adora struggled to. The forefront of her mind just being

Catra wasn’t coming to Brightmoon.

“Careful Glimmer we don’t want to tear anything.” Bow said shyly and both girls stopped to look down, as if just remembering they were still wearing their royal ceremony clothes. Glimmer smiled bashfully.

“Oops.” Bow rolled his eyes fondly. Glimmer then teleported away then reappeared less than a minute later holding a pile of clothes. Adora and Bow recognized their sleepwear in her arms, along with some extra clothes Glimmer accidentally grabbed in her rush.

She threw Adora and Bow’s clothes at them respectively and grabbed Catra’s arm. “we’ll change in the bathroom.” Catra pulled her arms away and went to her dresser pulling out her own clothes and followed her into the bathroom as she chatted, leaving Bow and Adora to themselves.

Bow wasted no time quickly changing clothes, but Adora hesitated.

“Are we really just going to leave Catra here?” Bow paused.

“There’s nothing we can do. Besides we now know Cyra is willing to let Catra leave so we just need to be patient.” Adora didn’t want to be patient.

“I guess.” Adora changed into her usual tank top and shorts.

“Hey, we can still call her and message her. Glimmer calls the first week of us returning the ‘Catra withdraw.’ With the surface vertigo, readjusting to the time change, and getting used to Catra not being there it sucks. So, me and Glimmer try to call her lots! It’s always fun because by the time we call her she’s in bed and most of the time she falls asleep on call, and we get to see how cute-”

“Finish that sentence and you die.” Catra appeared from the bathroom looking annoyed as Glimmer pouted behind her with a brush in her hand.

“Come on Catra let me brush it!” Catra gave a halfhearted hiss in response to her. Catra was wearing an oversized shirt with loose shorts and her hair was down. Adora refused to look up from the floor until her face was no longer red.

Glimmer was in a pastel purple nightgown while Bow was in a crop top and shorts. Bow laughed at Glimmer’s pout when Catra still refused to let her brush her hair, taking the brush from her and placing it back on her dresser. “I told you I don’t need to brush it.” Catra then dropped herself on her bed with her hands on her stomach as she just stared at the ceiling.

“Today was exhausting.” Glimmer sat next to her as well as Bow.

“Yeah.” Without even having to look, Catra spoke.

“Adora stop standing off like a weirdo and come here.” Adora scoffed as she crossed her arms.

“Well excuse me for not tackling you every second.”

“You’re excused.” Catra smirked and Adora sat on the bed as she gave a faux offended gasp.

“Well, I’ll be you are the rudest princess I have ever had the displeasure of meeting.” The group laughed and began talking the

night away

They didn't stay up long, sadly. Catra tried, not wanting tonight to end, but the yawns became more frequent, and it was going to be a long journey back for them, so Catra relented.

Catra helped set up pillows and blankets all along the floor for them, trying not to show her obvious disappointment with the night ending too quickly for her liking.

She was going to keep it together. She kept up the images for this long, everything is fine. That was her mantra that repeated in her head every time she saw Glimmer, Bow, and Adora get ready for bed.

"Catra?"

"Yeah?"

"I asked if you were alright." Adora gave a concerned look to Catra who just shrugged it off.

"Yeah, I just spaced out for a second." Catra dimmed the lights leaving a soft orange glow that made everyone in the room audibly sigh as sleep beckoned them. Catra also shut the curtains to her balcony not wanting to wake up to the artificial light of the runestone.

"Goodnight fur ball!"

"Goodnight, Sparkles." The room filled with 'goodnights' as Catra crawled into bed and laid down. Less than a minute later Bow's snores filled the room causing a fit of laughter from the girls.

Catra just stared at her ceiling feeling tired, but anxiety filled her chest as she began to think about what would happen tomorrow. After they leave, she'll be watched every second of the day, no doubt communication with Brightmoon will be limited, and not to mention the conversation she has to have with her mom. Catra internally groaned as she grasped her hair.

Tomorrow was gonna suck.

Catra's ears then perked up as she heard rustling. She sat up and looked over her bed to see Adora punching in her sleep, as well as kicking. Catra snickered a bit. She had a good collection of bruises from lying with Adora and accidentally kicking Catra. Adora would always profusely apologize the next day, feeling terrible to which Catra would just laugh her off.

Then Adora let out a pained whimper and it was then Catra noticed the forming sweat on her forehead and her furrowed brows. Catra frowned, she hated the fact that nightmares were still commonplace for Adora. Swinging her legs over she crouched down and gently shook Adora's shoulder.

"Adora. Wake up." She shook her a bit harder and suddenly Adora sat up almost hitting Catra as she leaned back.

"Catra?" Her chest was heaving and now that her eyes were open, she could see her eyes watering.

"I heard you thrashing." Adora nodded as she clutched her head trying to level her breathing.

"Sorry." Catra scoffed.

"Oh, please if we are punishing people for nightmares I wouldn't be here." That got a smile from Adora. Catra offered her hand and Adora took it with a confused look as Catra pulled her up. Catra pulled her to the bed and pulled back the covers before offering her hand back to Adora. She stared confused and Catra just smiled. "This is what my mom does whenever I have a nightmare. I don't know if it'll work for you but worth a shot." Adora nodded and took her hand and Catra gestured for her to lay down.

Adora felt her back hit the bed and it was like a cloud. Catra laughed quietly at her expression. "I told you sleeping on the equivalent to a rock is gonna ruin your back." Adora wanted to rebuttal but stopped when Catra lay down in front of her, making them face one another. The dim lighting made Catra's eyes glow,

and her hair was spread out on the pillow making her look angelic.

“So, do you want to talk about it?” Adora snapped back into reality.

“About what?”

“Your nightmare dummy.” Catra jokingly poked her forehead, and it was then she noticed her hair still in the tight ponytail. “Stars Adora, you even sleep with your hair up? No wonder your forehead is growing by the day.” Adora’s mouth hung open in shock,

“Well, I-”

Catra wasn't listening as she pulled the hair band making the blonde stands fall down her shoulders, then rubbed where the hair was held up and it made Adora sigh with relief. Her whole body felt as if it untensed. Catra laughed, “What were you saying?” Adora just hummed in response as she let her eyes close for a moment.

“Did your moms teach you this?” Catra rolled her eyes.

“No, it’s common sense you shouldn’t sleep with your hair up 24/7.” Adora grumbled causing Catra to giggle slightly. “Anyway, do you want to talk about it?” Adora opened her eyes slightly, but pointedly kept them down cast.

“Um, yeah I can-”

“Adora, I asked if you wanted to, if you don’t want to it doesn’t change anything. There are tons of nightmares I didn’t even consider telling my mom's.” Adora still felt guilty. Catra went to scratching her head. “You know apparently nightmares aren’t supposed to be of like bad memories?”

“Hmm?”

“Crazy I know. Found out from Vivianne that most nightmares don’t make sense. She had a nightmare about being chased by a giant spider with sunglasses and he was holding a block of cheese.” Adora laughed weakly. “I was so mad when I found out that. I really thought I drew the short stick, but I was told it was a ‘trauma response’ replaying bad memories in my brain because... I don’t even really know.” Catra chuckled dryly.

She looked back to Adora, and she was breathing evenly with her eyes closed. Catra smiled. She didn’t really know what she was doing. Not to mention the bed probably helped more than the actual talking in getting Adora to sleep. Catra noticed they were closer than when they first got into the bed. Trying to put some distance between them Catra recoiled at the grip on her hand.

When did Adora even grab her?

Catra tries to be better, tries to be stronger but she’s selfish at heart. She moved closer, carefully to not wake her and shared a pillow with Adora. She closed her eyes tightly not wanting to acknowledge how close they were.

At some point in the night Adora’s arm found its way across Catra’s waist.

Adora’s POV

“Aww it’s so cute!”

“Bow shh!”

I came to with a groan as I opened her eyes to bright light and two shadows over me. “Huh?”

“Wakey wakey sleepy head. Have fun last night?” I stared confused at them and Glimmer gestured with her head to the side. I turned to the side and saw Catra lying on my arm, vibrating with a purr, it was warm. I closed my eyes again while my brain tried to catch up with the living world.

“Mhmm.”I just remained lying down feeling exhausted, I can’t remember the last time I was able to sleep this well.

“Just give her a second.”

I had no idea what Bow was talking about. I got distracted again by the purring next to me. I missed this. There were very few times Catra would lay next to me most of the time still being at the-

“Holy shit!” My eyes widened as I sat up.

“There it is.” Bow said with a laugh. Catra sat up groggily rubbing her eyes.

“How are you guys so loud so early in the morning?” Her hair was puffed out from bed head, and I couldn’t help but see the young kit I would run around with as a child, half of her height was her mane of hair.

Catra let out a big yawn as she stretches showing off her sharp canines. She then looked over to me and smirked. “Sleep well Adora?”

My face went red as Glimmer began cackling like a mad woman. “Shut up!” I threw a pillow at her face, but she didn’t stop. Catra began laughing as well and I gave her the same treatment with a pillow to the face. “You guys are so annoying.” Catra smiled as she wrapped her arms around me dramatically

“You don’t mean that.” I crossed my arms.

“I do.”

“Not what you said last night.” I flushed as Glimmer and Bow gave me a wide eyed look. I grabbed a pillow and smothered Catra with it as she laughed below me.

“She’s joking!”

“Right...” Glimmer gave me a wink.

“No! No winking!” Bow laughed and grasped her shoulder.

“Leave her alone Glimmer she might combust. Though I’m hurt that we weren’t invited for cuddles.” Bow gave a faux hurt expression.

“You and Glimmer seemed to have that covered.” Catra said from under the pillow, and it was their turn to go red. I released Catra and she smacked me with a pillow.

“Real mature.” I said as I spat out a stray feather.

“I know, learned it from you.” Catra smirked.

I put Catra in a head lock and ruffled her hair.

“You’re such a brat!” Catra laughed as she tried slithering out of my hold.

“Let me go!” I feigned thinking.

“I wonder...” I then started scratching at her sides and she laughed hard. “Hah, still works!” Catra kicked as she tried to fight through her fit of laughter.

“Stop, Stop! I give!”

“I don’t think I’m feeling very merciful today.” I teased as she swiped at me.

Then came a firm knock on the door.

Everything stopped as we all stared at the door.

“Liz?” Catra sighed.

“Come in.” Leo came in and stared back with a somber expression.

“Cyra has everything packed and ready to go for them.” I noticed Catra frown.

“Yeah, just give us a second.” Leo nodded,

“I’ll be just outside.”

“Whatever.” Leo shut the door behind them and when Glimmer went to speak Catra held up her hand, her ears then directed themselves to the door as if trying to hear for movement. She then scoffed.

“Didn’t take her too long.” I stared back at Catra.

“What do you mean?” I said hesitantly Catra stood up as she crossed her arms.

“Leo is waiting outside the door. I guess they’re part of the new security detail.” Glimmer had an angry look on her face.

“I swear, let me talk to Cyra I can convince her.” Glimmer cracked her knuckles and bow sighed.

“Glimmer what did Angella say before we left?” Glimmer groaned.

“Don’t start a war.” Bow nodded, then stood.

“We’ll leave you to get dressed we have to go and get ready ourselves.” Catra frowned.

“Yeah, I’ll meet you down there.” Bow then forcefully began to push me and Glimmer out of the room.

“Bow!” Me and Glimmer said in sync. He ignored us as he rushed us out of the room, once the door was shut, he looked at us.

“Come on Catra’s already upset let’s just get this over with.” Glimmer sighed, then walked grumpily down the hall. I turned and saw Leo leaning against the wall right next to Catra’s door.

“Adora?”

“I’ll catch up.” I then walked up to Leo, who just raised a brow.

“Can I help you?”

“Why is Cyra set on making Catra unhappy?” Glimmer gasped as Bow face palmed.

“Excuse me?”

“I want to know why Cyra wants to see Catra unhappy. It’s obvious she really wanted to go to Brightmoon and she took that from her based off a dumb adventure to a place not even a mile away. Now she has a security detail that’s going to be breathing down her neck, something that makes Catra unhappy.”

“Adora don’t!” Glimmer said in a hushed voice and Bow began making wild hand gestures to get me to stop talking.

“So, am I to assume it was you who helped her leave?”

“Yes, in fact it was my idea. So, if you’re going to punish anybody it should be-”

Glimmer grasped her hand over my mouth. “So sorry Leo. She’s drunk!” I snatched her hand away.

“You’re making her miserable, how can you be okay with that? I thought you were her friend!” Bow now grabbed my other arm as they both tried dragging me away.

“Adora this isn’t going to do what you think it will!”

Leo spoke, “Adora, I understand you’re frustrated but I am a guard before I am a friend. Whether you believe me or not Cyra does everything for her daughter. Do I agree with her methods? Debatable but it’s my job to listen to orders and to act them out according to the queens will. Arguing with me does nothing for you but gives you momentary satisfaction. If you want something changed you need to speak with Cyra or Azar.” That answer just made me even more angry.

“You-”

“Adora leave it alone.” Catra was dressed now and looked tired. I frowned, why was she just giving up? Bow and Glimmer gave a slight bow to Leo before dragging me off, giving me hushed reprimands about how much trouble I could’ve gotten in. I just looked over my shoulder to see Catra with her arms crossed as Leo talked to her.

There wasn’t much to do in terms of packing, Cyra really did have everything packed and my white shirt and grey leggings were left out. I assumed they packed my jacket. Not feeling like digging around for it.

Once I got my boots on, I put the pack back on my shoulders and attached my sword that I had hidden in my closet, to my wrist after turning it back into a bracelet. I’m really glad I learned how to do that, walking around with a sword attached to my back was not the greatest way to show I’m not a threat.

The door opened and I saw Glimmer with a smug look on.

“What did you do?” I asked suspiciously.

“Let’s just say I have a plan to ensure we see Catra again!” Bow shook his head.

“Glim-”

“No listen! Okay so I may have accidentally left one pair of my boots here.” Glimmer winked at me.

“So, we’ll give Cyra a week or so to calm down. Then I’ll come back to get them and boom! Get to see Catra!”

It’s not a bad idea.

Though something tells me it won’t work out the way she wants to.

“No harm in trying I guess?” Bow shrugged as Glimmer proudly put her hands on her hips.

We headed to the throne room, apparently there would always be a type of sendoff with Catra before we left.

Cyra and Azar were standing just behind Catra, who smiled upon seeing us. She walked over to us.

“You ready?” Bow’s eyes began to water, and Glimmer looked on the verge of a breakdown.

“No!” They both exclaimed as they pulled Catra into a hug and she just let it happen.

“Stars you guys are such crybabies.” I noticed her fond smile as she returned the hug. Glimmer pulled away with tears down her face.

“You’ll call us, right?” Catra side glanced at Cyra who was talking quietly with Azar.

“Yeah...yeah, I’ll try” Bow was a mess with snot running down his nose as he tried wiping away his tears. Catra just laughed.

“You good?” Bow nodded.

“I’m already going through withdraws!”

“I’m right here.” Bow hugged her again and Catra gave him some pats on the back. “There, there big guy.” That just made him sob harder. I honestly was beginning to feel the effects of this ‘Catra withdraw.’ Glimmer forcefully removed Bow.

“You’re smothering her Bow!”

“Sorry!”

Catra laughed, “It’s fine. I’ll just have to wash the snot out.” She then looked over to me and smiled, as she opened her arms.

“Come here.” I now understood why Bow was crying so hard. It took me two strides to get to her and I just hugged her tightly. Catra smiled. “Eager much?”

“Shut up.”

I felt Catra’s claws flex into my shirt. “Damn this is hard.” Her voice was hoarse as she trembled slightly. “No chance I can convince you to just stay is there?”

She definitely could.

“You can try, though Glimmer might throw a fit at losing two Horde soldiers to Halfmoon.” Catra flicked me in the ear. “Wow, never mind you’re too cruel.” I teased as I felt Catra roll her eyes.

“Here.” She handed me a bag.

“What-” Catra pulled me back when I started to pull away from the hug.

“As far as my moms are concerned, a gift. It’s those files you asked for. Though let’s keep it our little secret.” I laughed.

“Liz.” I felt Catra tense up a bit at Azar’s voice.

Not yet, please not yet.

Catra let go and nodded. “I’ve kept you guys long enough.”

Not long enough if you ask me.

Glimmer teleported to get one more hug in and Bow dragged me into a big group hug.

“You guys are such saps!”

“Says you!” Glimmer retorted as she saw Catra’s eyes start to water.

“Shut up!” Leo coughed to get their attention.

“We should be leaving now.” Glimmer sighed.

“I hate this part!” Bow exclaimed.

Catra laughed. “Tell Angella I said hi.”

Glimmer gave a faux salute. “Will do!”

Azar then gave me a quick side hug, I thought it was out of character until she whispered in my ear.

"Stay safe and remember, don't engage." she said firmly. I didn't have to guess who she was talking about. I hated that Shadow weaver always found a way to ruin even my goodbye to Catra.

“Glimmer.” I jumped at hearing Cyra’s voice. Glimmer gave her a confused look and then her eyes got wide as she noticed what Cyra was holding.

“Luckily Leo checked the rooms, you almost forgot these.” She handed Glimmer’s boots to her. To which Glimmer returned a strained smile.

“Oh...thanks! You know let me go double chec-” Leo then started pushing us out the door. “Oh, come on!”

I decided to just follow along with Bow. I turned back to Catra giving her a wave, “Goodbye-

“See you later.” Catra interrupted.

I smiled, “See you later.” I felt the withdrawal hit ten times harder when the door closed behind me.

“Elizabeth.” Catra sighed as she turned to her mother. “It’s time we had that talk."

Chapter End Notes

In case it wasn't clear Cyra was not thinking clearly in their argument she doesn't feel that way about Catra at all and was acting out in anger not reason.

I love the headcanon that Adora does cat things and thinks they're normal because of Catra, no I will not be elaborating.

Cyra and Azar are switches and I have no regrets.

Esme can step on a Lego so can Edgar.

Also I love Vivianne and I fully intended to have her be a one off jerk but she captured my heart and I'm not sorry

The Aftermath

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Catra's POV

I was escorted to the main dining room with two guards on my ass and my mother's walking ahead.

I was already feeling claustrophobic.

Nobody spoke the whole way there, the most that happened were side glances between mom and momma.

The guards posted themselves on both sides of the door to the dining room while mom gestured to the room, and I rolled my eyes as I entered. If I thought this was dramatic before this is something else. There were two chairs on one side of the table and one chair on the other. I decided to sit on the other side. Not in the mood to be yelled at more than I am bound to be already. I sat down and I saw my mom talk with the guards for a moment before closing the door and leaving me to their mercy.

They both took a seat across from me and I did not even get a 'hello.'

"Let's just make this easy. Why did you suddenly just go to old Halfmoon?"

"I just wanted to." Mom raised a brow at me. "I'm not lying! I was upset about Adora leaving and I thought a change of scenery would cheer me up." Mom scoffed.

"Oh, so you just decided to break the law?"

"Yep." I didn't like her accusing tone, acting as if I was bull shitting every word. I'll give her credit; she seemed a lot calmer

today.

“Elizabeth can we please just have a civil conversation, without the sass.”

“I’m answering your questions! It’s not my fault you expected some complex answer.” Cyra rubbed her temples.

“Stars above.” Momma cut in.

“I think what Cy is trying to say is she wants this whole situation to be over. Then we can go back to how we were.” She gave a pointed look to mom.

“Right.” I crossed my arms as I sank into my chair.

Cyra sighed.

“I think the first thing I should do is apologize. I was... very angry. A lot happened all at once and when I saw that journal... I’m sorry about what I said.”

She meant what she said. You know she did.

Shut up.

“Yeah, whatever.” I dug my claws into my arms. “I’m...sorry about what I said too.” Momma clapped.

“Progress!”

I’m so tired.

“Okay, so I need you to tell us everything that happened in Old Halfmoon. Adora was with you right?” I nodded.

“Nothing eventful happened, we just looked around. Found some old pictures, and...”

That’s weird. I rubbed my head slightly trying to recall what happened. “There was... we started playing around in the castle,

being stupid...there was a room?" What's going on? Why can't I remember? I saw something. I think?

"Elizabeth?"

Everything was blurry and I felt like I was telling the story out of order. "No, we- we found your room and that's when I found the journal." Something made us leave. "I think we heard something, a crash. Adora ran to go check it out and I went to follow her, but she made me stay outside." I can still smell the room. "I was able to smell it though. We didn't process it but there were no bodies at all. From what Adora said all of them were in the room. Set up in a scene? Then-" I left, why did I leave?

"I think that's enough." Momma, was she there? I could've sworn- "Liz stop!" Why did I leave the hall? I smelt something. Memories began to overlap. Was there someone else there? Momma had blood going down her face. That... thing was going to attack her. No that's wrong. Me and Adora were the only ones there.

"Azar what's-" Momma grabbed my face, when did she get in front of me? She made me look at her.

"Tell me about yesterday." No something is missing. "Liz stop thinking about it, just tell me about yesterday!" Why did I leave the hallway! Adora told me to wait, and I didn't know why. "Look at me." Momma?

I smelled her. That's why I left. I thought I smelled her. I went towards it. My mind filled with flashes of memories. There was a curtain on the floor, that's where it came from. That curtain was ripped. I remember Momma tearing it off to protect me. That was a long time ago. My head was thundering.

I remember talking to Momma, then I was put to sleep...

I stared wide eyed at her.

"You took my memories away." Her ears downturned.

“Liz-” I shoved her hands away from me.

“You were fucking around in my head!”

“Just let me explain-”

“How many times have you done this? Why would you do that!?”

“This is the only time, and I was trying to protect you.” I stood up.

“Bullshit!”

“Elizabeth-” I ignored my mom's attempt to intrude. Momma stood over me.

“I swear to you-”

“Were you ever going to tell me? Or completely blind site me forever?”

“I was just about to tell you but you-”

“Azar-”

“But I what? How dare you try to throw blame at me for you taking away my memories!”

Mom punched the table causing a loud bang. “Will both of you be quiet!” Cyra took a deep breath as she smoothed her hair down. “Elizabeth sit.”

“But-”

“Sit!” I quickly sat down. Momma went to say something, but Mom just pointed to the seat next to her. “Sit.” She also sat down quickly. Mom sat down herself. “Yelling at one another isn’t going to solve anything. So, one at a time, we are going to have a conversation. A calm collected conversation! First things first, Azar you will return her memories so she can accurately finish telling us what happened at Old Halfmoon.” Momma stood up and walked to my seat with a glowing hand and placed it to my temple.

It felt weird, like déjà vu times a million. It also made me nauseous. I fell forward slightly, and Momma caught me. I tried shoving her away from me, but she didn't allow it. "You can be mad at me all you want but you need to take it easy, or you'll get a killer headache." I went to give a snarky remark, but I hissed when I felt my head begin to scream at me.

"Shit!" I curled in on myself and Momma began rubbing my head.

"It'll only be a second, shh..." Easy for her to say.

I couldn't tell how long I remained that way but by the time I could sit up on my own mom placed a cup of water on the table and was waiting for me to drink. I gulped it down.

"Better?" I shoved momma away from me. I don't want her anywhere near me.

"I'm fine." I saw her ears turn down, but she nodded and stood back up and sat next to mom.

"So, let's try this again. Tell us what happened in Halfmoon." I sighed, as I put some pressure on my head. I'm so tired.

"Me and Adora left, and we were looking around the village. I saw old pictures of you and Grell, so we went to the castle, fucked around with the thrones then went into a bunch of rooms. We eventually found your room and that's where I found the journal. We heard a crash and Adora went headfirst. I followed her but when we got to the room, she made me stay outside. As I said all the skeletons from the invasion were propped up in a fucked-up dinner scene. I then... I smelt momma. I wasn't thinking clearly so I followed it that's when... I found umm..." I didn't know how to say it without vomiting.

Momma seemed to understand when I glanced to her right side. "Okay, I get the idea." Mom seemed confused but Momma gave her the 'we'll talk about it later' look. Mom sighed.

“Alright now for the other problem. Azar, is there something you want to say to Elizabeth?”

“Sorry.” She had her arms crossed and her tone was ingenuine.

“Seriously?” She shrugged.

“I was only doing it to protect you.”

“More like protect yourself.” Mom stopped us.

“Both of you enough. Now about-”

“Wait you’re really just going to take that bullshit apology?” Mom rubbed her head.

“Can we please not argue about this?”

“So, she doesn’t have to be punished for taking away my memories, but I get punished because I left Halfmoon for a few hours!?”

“Elizabeth this isn’t a competition.” I rolled my eyes. This was all unfair. “Anyway, you will be escorted by guards everywhere, this is only voided if you are with me or Azar.”

“Mom-”

“I’m not done, they will remain until I see fit. Visitors are prohibited until further notice. You will also go back into lessons, of your choice, every Tuesday and Thursday to help fill your time. You will no longer be practicing magic, nor hand-to-hand combat. These are my rules.” My mouth hung open and even Azar looked stunned.

“Cy, let’s talk about this first.”

“This isn’t a negotiation.” She looked at me. “You wanted Azar punished so no more magic classes.”

“You know that’s not fair!”

“This isn’t permanent, just until I can trust you again.”

“What about you huh? What do you have to do until I can trust you again.” Mom sighed and rubbed her head.

“Elizabeth this isn’t a negotiation.” I scoffed,

“Yeah, no shit.”

I looked over at Momma and she just had her head down refusing to look up. I glared at mom.

“You realize what you’re doing is no better than the Hor-”

“Elizabeth, I recommend that you hold your tongue before you say something you’ll regret.”

I stood up and left. If she didn’t want me to talk then we were done. I slammed the door behind me and began a brisk walk to my room. I wanted to be alone.

The guard keeping up pace behind me didn’t get the idea. I turned around harshly. “Can you both fuck off for like five minutes?” They both just stared at me, as if I wasn’t worth a response. I tried walking away, but their footfalls were still behind me. I’m going to kill someone. The faster I walked the closer they followed. I wanted to rip my hair out. Or at least someone’s eye.

Once I arrived at my room, I glared at them both, I dared them to try and follow me in there. As I opened the door, they posted themselves on both sides of my door. At least they weren’t following me inside. I slammed the door behind me, as if that would offend the guards. I slammed my face into a pillow and screamed into it.

This wasn’t fair. None of it is. Mom is controlling my life and has guards that watch my every move to report to her. I began clawing at the pillow trying to get the frustration out of my system before I broke something. My head is still killing me, and I feel exhausted.

How long was this going to last?

I turned my head to stare blankly at the wall. My room was a mess from the previous night. Blankets thrown half hazardously on the floor. I sighed as I swung my legs over the bed and picked some of them up. I had to occupy myself with something or I would combust. I threw most of them in my closet, few I just put back on my bed. I gave the room a once over and it wasn't clean, but it was just tidy enough that I wouldn't be staring at the mess thinking about cleaning it up.

I walked back to my bed then cursed as I stepped on something small and hard. "Fuck!" I clutched my foot as I tried to take deep breaths. I growled as I pulled away the blanket that was hiding the offending foot killer. I audibly gasped when I saw it was a belt with a golden wing pin attached.

I looked at my hand and noticed that it wasn't a blanket I grabbed but a bright red jacket with a tan collar. I sat down on my knees as I grasped the fabric in both hands. "What an idiot." I hated the smile that crept on my face.

Only Adora could forget her own jacket, despite wearing it everywhere. She even asked if she could wear it during the celebration over her clothes and Glimmer had to wrestle it out of her hands. I tried to think back to when she could've left it here.

Maybe Glimmer accidentally grabbed it when she got their sleep wear and Adora forgot about it? I honestly didn't care. All I know is that this jacket is the one hope I have of seeing Adora again, there's no way she'll just leave it here. Even if she can't come retrieve it, I could probably sneak a note in the pocket and have a messenger send it to her.

I sighed and walked back to my bed, flopping onto the mattress. My head was still throbbing slightly, memories kept getting mixed up. It was hard to tell when my memories stopped and when Elizabeth's began.

I turned onto my side as I clutched the jacket. Adora’s blanket barley had her scent on it, lingering just enough. However, the jacket smelled so much like Adora. If I closed my eyes, I could fool myself into thinking she's right next to me. I remember that night when she lay next to me. I brought it up to my nose as I curled into myself.

I remember feeling something shift next to me and I was concerned Adora was having another nightmare until she just wrapped her arms around me and pulled me close to her, making me tense. I considered pushing her away but when she sighed in relief while she rested her head on my chest, I couldn’t even consider the idea.

I hadn’t realized I was falling asleep until I was already lost in the dream world.

“Cy, what was all that?” Azar waited till Catra was out of earshot.

“Discipline.” Azar rolled her eyes.

“You didn’t think to talk with me about it first? Not to mention you are pushing Liz away! You and I know that all those rules will do more harm than good.” Cyra took a deep breath.

“She needs to learn a lesson. This is the best way.” Azar scoffed as she pushed her chair out.

“Fine whatever, but don’t come crying to me when you see how miserable she is.” Azar left without another word. Cyra finally relaxed in her chair as she began questioning her decisions. She shook her head.

“This is for the best.”

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“Momma wake up!” Azar groaned as she felt the weight of her kit on her chest.

“Liz momma’s tired.” She tried pulling the covers over her head, however Catra pulled it away.

“Momma you promised we would go hunting today!” Azar thought about it for a moment then sighed when she remembered that today is indeed Tuesday. She was up late last night doing negotiations with Brightmoon and then Micha brought out the wine and to say she had a headache was an understatement. Azar opened her eyes and wrapped her arms around the kit.

“Wouldn’t you rather take a nap?” Azar yawned and Catra pouted.

“Nuh uh.”

“I think you want to take a nap.” Azar rolled them both on their sides Azar holding the kit down.

“Momma!”

“Shhhh, nap time.” Catra tried wiggling out of her mother’s grasp, but she didn’t relent. Azar then began to dramatically snore. Catra pouted then began to pull at Azar’s fur.

“Momma come on before everyone else gets all the birds!” Azar grabbed Catra’s hands to stop her assault.

“Birds don’t run out sweetie. They’ll still be there in an hour.”

“Nuh uh.” Azar raised her brow at the kit, urging her to continue. “Leo told me we must go early or everyone else will take the birds!” Azar felt her ear twitch, that piece of shi-

“Azar what are you still doing in bed? You and Elizabeth were supposed to leave a while ago, weren’t you?” Catra perked up.

“Mom!” She began fighting Azar again and she relented, letting go of Catra and she leaped into her mother’s arms.

“Hey, sweetie.” She kissed her ears making Catra giggle. Azar used the momentary distraction to try and get some more sleep, but Cyra was always watching closely.

“Azar gets up. Elizabeth has been waiting weeks for today. The least you could do is hurry it up.” She said in a teasing tone. Azar didn’t respond and dug herself deeper into the bed. “Oh no, Elizabeth it seems she’s not able to wake up.” Catra’s ears downturned in worry and disappointment. “There is only one way.” Cyra placed Catra down and went into the bathroom.

Azar’s ears perked up when she heard running water. Azar stood up quickly when she saw Cyra come out of the bathroom with a bucket of water. “I’m up, I’m up!” Cyra smiled down at Catra.

“Works every time!” She gave Catra a wink causing her to giggle. Azar groaned as she hastily got dressed.

“Damn you woman.” Azar mumbled to herself.

“What was that?”

“Love my woman!” Cyra dumped the bucket back into the tub and picked up Catra.

“Let’s get some breakfast, I had to go straight to my meeting when I woke up and I am starving!” Catra nodded eagerly.

“Pancakes!” Cyra laughed as she left the room.

“Hurry Azar or we might eat everything without you!” Cyra teased as Catra laughed.

Azar grumbled. “I swear everybody in this place hates me.” She changed clothes as she tried to wake herself up, almost tripping over the laundry she left on the floor. “Son of a-” She grumbled as she picked it up throwing it in the hamper and sighing.

“Today is going to be a long day.”

“Elizabeth, slow down you’re going to make yourself sick.” Catra didn’t respond to her as she tried shoving a whole pancake in her mouth. She spoke but it came out muffled. She forced it down then drank a glass of water right after.

“We need to leave quickly, we’re already late!” Catra said eagerly and turned around when she heard Azar walk in. She ran up to her and pulled on her sleeve, hopping in place. “Come on Momma we’re already late!” Azar allowed the kit to drag her to her seat.

“Azar, I know you think having short hair means you don’t have to style it, but can you at least brush it out every once in a while?” Azar sighed as she just ruffled it a bit and used her claws to get most of the knots out.

“Better?” Cyra rolled her eyes.

“Why do I bother?”

“Momma!” Azar laughed as she grabbed an apple.

“Alright, Alright, I’m going.” She gave Cyra a kiss on the cheek. “See you later.” Cyra laughed as Catra still tugged at Azar’s arm.

“Come on, come on, come on!” Azar picked Catra up and began walking.

“You are such a brat.” She said teasingly as she nuzzled their noses together making the kit laugh. Cyra suddenly stopped them.

“Hold on.” She had two dark green cloaks, she tied one around Azar and one around Catra. “It’s cold out right now. Azar rolled her eyes then Cyra looked at Catra. “Stay close to Momma alright? The whispering woods are very dense, and we don’t want you getting lost, okay?” Catra just nodded, not even looking at her. Cyra gently grabbed her cheek. “I’m serious Elizabeth. Stay close to Momma and listen to her, alright?”

“I will mom, I will.” Cyra smiled and gave her a quick kiss to her head.

“Okay I’m done, I love you!”

Catra giggled. “Love you!”

Azar pouted. “Where’s my share?” Cyra rolled her eyes and gave her a quick kiss.

“Love you too.”

Azar purred.

“Momma!”

Azar sighed.

“Okay we’re leaving.” Cyra gave a wave and Catra waved eagerly back.

Azar held Catra on her hip while she ate her light breakfast with the other and as she was walking through the village, she was barely allowed to say ‘hi’ to people because Catra said it was ‘wasting time!’

“Azar!” She turned to acknowledge who it was while Catra whined.

“Oh, hey Bowen.” He smiled then cooed as he saw Catra.

“Hey there little lady.” Azar laughed when she ignored him.

“She’s in a mood, we’re going hunting and she is convinced the birds will run out if we don’t hurry.”

“They Will!”

Bowen laughed. “Alright I won’t keep you just wanted to say hi.” He then redirected his attention to Catra. “What type of bird are you looking for?” Catra paused for a moment.

“One with wings?”

Bowen laughed.

“Good call, hey if you want to bring the family around you could join me and Yin for dinner? We still owe you for helping us with that giant bug thing.” Azar shook her head.

“You don’t have to do that-”

“It would be our pleasure! Besides, Liz could bring her catch to show off.” Bowen winked. Catra leaned forward.

“Will Yin make her special bread?!”

Bowen smiled.

“I don’t see why she wouldn’t.” Catra then gripped Azar’s cloak.

“Can we momma?” Azar sighed.

“I’ll have to ask Cy about it, but I think we can make it.” Bowen smiled.

“Great! Does seven work for you?”

Azar nodded. “Sounds great.”

Bowen clapped then gave a little fist bump to Catra.

“We’ll see you then. Better run along before the birds run out.”

“Don’t encourage her.” Azar said flatly as they continued their path to the whispering woods. The sun was still rising and there were still fireflies shining. Catra stared in awe.

Azar placed Catra down and crouched in front of her putting her hands on her shoulders. “Alright I know we were joking around but I need you to stay close. The woods can get very disorienting.” Catra gave a mock salute making Azar chuckle. “Alright, first things first.” She pulled up her hood and Catra copied. Azar grabbed her hand and took her through the undergrowth.

They walked silently until they were surrounded by trees, humming with chirps from the birds above. Azar spoke in a low whisper. “Alright the first thing you should do is pick which one you’re going for and stick with it. Put your focus onto that one only and don’t get sidetracked by ones you pass.” Catra nodded firmly, hanging off every word. “So, which one has the honor of being picked by you?” Catra hummed as she looked at all the birds of different colors, black, red, white, some even had all the colors. Though one caught her eye.

She pointed up, “That one!” Azar followed her eyes and cringed slightly. It was a small blue jay resting high in the trees.

“I don’t know Liz; those are hard to catch. They’re not your common bird they’re smart.” That seemed to make Catra even more eager.

“Perfect.” Azar sighed.

“Alright, we now have to wait for it to come down.” Catra stared confused.

“Why? I can climb up there.” Azar placed her arm around her.

“You can but the trees are their playing ground. You can’t be as agile in the trees as you can down here. Besides they would just go to the sky if you went up there. If they come down here and you mess up, they’ll just go back to the trees, and you can try again.” Catra had a smug look on her face.

“I won’t need a second chance.”

Azar chuckled. Catra’s eyes didn’t leave the blue jay for a second. always Keeping a watchful eye. Azar was impressed after a few minutes went by and Catra didn’t budge. Azar yawned as she watched.

She let her eyes close for a moment.

Catra wasn’t giving up. Around five birds had already dropped to the ground to get some worms, but she didn’t lose focus. The blue jay teased her by going down branch by branch, as it came closer, she remembered all the steps Azar told her weeks ago.

She remained patient as she saw the blue jay come closer to the ground, she looked over to Azar to point it out, but she passed out at some point. Catra considered waking her up but hesitated, Azar had a bad habit of doing it all for her and not giving Catra a chance to try on her own.

She could do this.

Sneaking out of her arm, while keeping light on her feet. She slowly crept out of the undergrowth. The bird was pecking at the floor and Catra crouched down not even blinking. Her tail swayed slowly in the air. She was holding her breath as she creeped closer. The blue jay was completely unaware.

She raised her hind legs as she got ready to pounce. Then there was a rumble in the ground. The bird was startled but Catra wouldn't let it get away. She grabs the bird, cutting one of its wings with her claws but it slipped out of her grip. “Get back here!” Catra ran after it not giving it a chance to hide.

“Elizabeth!”

She weaved through trees and ducked through branches, the bird trying to use its tiny size to compensate for its lack of flight.

It didn’t have time to register, it was at a dead end because Catra pounced on it gripping it tightly in her hands. “Aha!” Catra quickly bit its neck, making it as painless as her mother taught her. With blood dripping from her mouth, she smiled. “Momma I did it!” She stopped her momentary victory. “Momma?”

Catra heard a rustle in the bushes. She jumped slightly, clutching the bird in her hands.

“Fucking- stupid- Arrg!” A lanky woman in grey and green armor with long grey hair. Catra stared as she spat out leaves and was trying to detangle her hair. “I swear if we find out this place never existed Hordak is gonna have my foot up his-” She then noticed Catra standing there. “Oh... hi there.” Catra blinked at her for a moment then backed herself against the dead end. Noticing her hesitation, the woman crouches down. “Hey, it’s alright. I’m not going to hurt you.” The soldier noticed the blood on the kits hands. Catra glanced at the obvious weapon on her hip. She followed her gaze. Wordlessly she removed it and threw it out of her reach. She noticed Catra visibly relaxed.

“You’re a bit young to be out here on your own. Are you lost?”

Catra started crying as she nodded. The woman gasped. “Hey, it’s okay what happened?”

“I-I was trying to- to catch the bird and... Momma wasn’t behind me when I looked!” The woman got closer to her. “S-she’s gonna be mad at me, she- she told me to stay close and I didn’t!”

“Shh, don’t cry! She won’t be mad I’m sure she’s just worried.”

“Raven, where the hell are you!” Catra’s ears twitched under her hood at the voice coming from the woman's ear. She placed her hand to her ear.

“I found a kid; she’s lost and I’m going to help her find her parents.”

“What? No, we don’t have ti-” She clicked the earpiece again and the voice stopped. She stood up, dusted herself off, then offered me her hand. “Alright let’s try walking around calling for her and see if she shows up. If not, I can take you to a nearby village and you can try and write home to let them know where you are.” Catra took the woman's hand with her less bloody one and kept the bird in the other. She smiled. “My name’s Raven, what’s yours?”

“Elizabeth.”

“Alright Elizabeth, nice to meet you.” Catra nodded in acknowledgement.

“Momma!”

Raven didn’t feel comfortable yelling “Momma’ for someone else's mother but when she tried asking what her mom's name was. Catra shrugged and said, ‘It’s Momma?’

They both walked through the woods shouting for Azar the longer it took the more anxious Catra became. “I’m never going to see her again!” Raven was trying her best to keep her calm, but she was also anxious, she is actively ignoring her mission and as much as she wants to find this girl's mother.

“I’m sure she’s looking just as hard for you.” She looked to the horizon. They were scheduled to leave for the Fright zone soon. “Maybe we should start heading for the village. It’s getting late.” Catra had more tears running down her face but nodded. Raven offered her arms out for her. “Come on you’ve done a lot of walking for such a tiny thing.” Catra took the offer. Her legs hurt from chasing the stupid bird, not to mention she bruised her knee as well.

Raven was startled by how light she was. “Whoa, are you being fed well? I swear you feel like a kit-” Her eyes widened in realization when she saw a tail wrapped around her arm and was able to see into her green hood and saw two large ears coming from the side of her head. “Holy shi-”

“Raven!”

A group of soldiers and a tall blue scaled woman came into view. Raven pulled the hood over the kit’s eyes and pulled her cloak down to cover her tail. “Yes, Octavia.”

“Where have you been? I have half a mind to have you trialed for defection for abandoning your post!” Octavia then noticed the bundle being hidden in Raven’s arms. “What is that?”

“The kid I told you about. I was just about to drop her off at the nearby outpost. I’ll be right back.” Raven hastily tried to walk away but Octavia grabbed her shoulder.

“Hold it. What's the rush?” She stared suspiciously at the kit in her arms. Raven took a deep breath, then turned towards her. Octavia wordlessly pulled the hood away and gasped, then smirked. “Lucky you. This will lead us straight to that place the witch was talking about.”

Raven hesitated. “Octavia, she said she lived in the nearby village. Halfmoon is a rare place even amongst Magicats. She’s just a lost kid. Let’s just leave her-”

“We have been searching for weeks, then a one-way ticket comes and suddenly you want to just give up. Not a chance.” Octavia reached for the kit, but she hissed and scratched her hand. Raven gasped as she pulled back while Octavia held her now bleeding hand. “You little-” She raised her hand and Raven panicked.

Badly.

Raven punched her in the face, causing the woman to stumble back, her nose was bleeding. She looked up at her and had pure rage in her eyes. Raven pushed Catra to the ground.

“Elizabeth run!” Raven screamed as Octavia electrocuted her with a stun baton. Making her sink to the ground unconscious, Catra quickly ran.

“What are you looking around for? Follow her!”

Catra barley got ten feet away before she was scooped up. She began to scream but stopped when she heard a familiar voice. “Sh, it’s just me.” Azar kept Catra in her arms then placed her on her hip and scaled a tree with the other. Azar then stood on a branch and hid in the trees shadow holding her breath as she clutched Catra.

“I know you’re here!” Catra began to shake, and Azar just placed her hand on her head and pulled her to her chest. ‘Just breathe’ was the message. Octavia screamed.

“Come out now, by the order of Hordak and your death will be swift and merciful.”

Silence.

Octavia scoffed. then gestured for someone. “Fine let’s do this the hard way.” Raven was being carried by a soldier and when Octavia snapped, he quickly laid her down in front of her face down. Octavia grabbed her by her hair, unconscious. Octavia then pulled out a blade and put it to her throat. “Come out now or she dies. I’m not very patient.”

Catra tried to see what was happening, but Azar forced her head down. “Hold on to me and keep your eyes closed.” Azar said directly into her ear. Catra nodded wordlessly.

“3...2...” Azar took a deep breath and clutched Catra’s ears tightly. “1...”

It was quick and painless as the woman’s body fell to the floor, red pooling around her on the formerly green grass. She didn’t even gasp. Azar kept Catra right on her scent gland in her neck to drown out the smell. Octavia huffed as she walked away.

“Seems they’re more heartless than we intended.” The two accompanying soldiers stood up straight when she turned to them. “Let’s go the transport might already be here and Shadow Weaver doesn’t like to be kept waiting. Not a word of this leaves this group am I understood?” They saluted and followed briskly behind her.

Azar kept a tight grip on Catra as they left. A sudden whimper made her let go, not realizing how tight her grip had gotten. “Sorry sweetie. Are you alright? You’re not hurt, are you?” Catra shook her head. Azar sighed with relief. She then scaled down the tree with her in her arms walking away from the gruesome scene.

Once they were a good distance away, she placed Catra down. “What on Etheria were you thinking!? What did I say about staying close? Do you realize what could've happened to you if I hadn’t gotten you when I did?”

“I’m sorry.” Catra was looking down at her feet as tears ran down her face. “I'm sorry.” Azar sighed as she hugged her, she wasn’t heartless.

“I know, I’m not mad at you, I was just so scared when I couldn’t find you and then I saw skiffs nearby and... I was terrified that something happened to you.” Azar then gave a teasing smile as she made Catra look at her. “Are you trying to get me killed? Could you imagine what your mother would do to me if I lost you?” Catra gave a wet laugh then suddenly remembered something and pulled the blue jay out for her mother.

“I got it!” Azar stared wide eyed then smiled as she hugged her again.

“Good job sweetie! Though let’s keep this hunt between us, yeah? Your mother would gut me alive.” Catra giggled and then Azar’s ear twitched. She hastily pulled up her hood as well as Catra’s. She pulled her behind a nearby tree hiding behind it with Catra in front of her keeping a solid grip on her shoulders.

A little girl came out into the clearing chasing a butterfly, it made Azar sigh in relief, until a dark figure loomed behind her. Azar glared, prepared to jump in at a second's notice.

“Adora what did I say?” The blond-haired person turned around embarrassed, looking down ashamed.

“Stay with the transport.” The figure nodded and simply pointed in a direction and the girl walked towards it, Catra heard the child-like voice and tried stretching over to get a look, but Azar squeezed her shoulders making her pout as she was held still.

Azar didn’t like the uneasy feeling this person gave her. She held her breath when they looked in their direction. She counted the

seconds, her claws coming out and her mind racing trying to prepare a plan in case things went south. She was slowly pushing Catra behind her as the figure loomed towards them.

Suddenly a loud 'thunk' was heard then crying. The figure sighed then went towards what Azar assumed was the child. She didn't waste time running back to Halfmoon, the woods were swarming with Horde soldiers, and that meant something was about to happen.

Catra didn't understand why her mom was taking her the long way back to Halfmoon but was also too scared to ask.

When they arrived at Halfmoon Azar began yelling at the guards telling them to keep an eye out. Azar had Catra in her arms, walking briskly to the castle. Azar barley said hello keeping her head straight ahead on a mission.

When they arrived at the throne room Cyra was addressing someone. "Oh, welcome back I'll be with you-"

Azar interrupted her. "Cy this is serious, I need to speak with you immediately." Azar's eyes were intense as she begged with her eyes. Cyra sighed and went back to the Magicat.

"I'm sorry could we finish this tomorrow? It seems something came up." The Magicat gave a strained smile.

"Of course, my queen." As they left, they glared at Azar. She didn't mind them.

Once the door shut Cyra opened her arms for Catra. "How was the hunt?" Catra began trying to get out of Azar's arms and was placed down.

"Look!" Catra held up her catch proudly.

Cyra hugged her. "Good job sweetie!" Catra began to purr.

"Cy."

Cyra looked at her wife and frowned. Cyra then looked back down at Catra. “Why don’t you go show Leo? They should be with Bowen in the training yard. Me and Momma need to talk.”

Catra looked between the two then nodded. “Okay.”

Cyra gave her a kiss on the forehead. “I’ll come get you for dinner.” With that Catra gave Azar one more hug then ran out of the room.

Cyra looked back at Azar. “Now what is so important-”

“The Horde are in the whispering woods. We saw them, they can’t be more than fourteen miles away.”

Cyra gasped. “Did they see you? Were they heading this way?”

Azar sighed. “They saw Liz, but I got to her before they could get to her. Then I led them away, they said that their transport was already there, so they left. I’m sure the woods will change before they come back.”

“We need to evacuate. I don’t want them this close. We’ll hide underground until this blows over.” Azar grabbed her hand as she began to walk away.

“Wait, Cy we can’t just uproot everyone!”

“If we start now, they will have plenty of time to pack and we can start preparations.”

“Cy, hiding won’t do anything! What’s the point of our alliance with Brightmoon if we won’t fight back?”

“Azar.”

“Cy, I think we should ask Brightmoon for aid, have them bring in some extra guards so we can intimidate. Why should we have to give up our home?”

Cyra sighed. “Azar the Horde has more power than ever, and I have heard tales aplenty about villages being wiped out. I will not let Halfmoon be the next one.”

“Why do you insist on running away!?”

“Because I have a kit that I refuse to expose to war! Are you even thinking about what could happen if we can’t push them back? I know the Horde uses child soldiers from invaded kingdoms, look at what happened to the Scorpioni, I will not risk my kit’s safety for a piece of land.”

“Of course, we can still have the evacuation plan but why should we leave now? They had already left! We could use this time to improve our defenses, prove we aren’t to be messed with.”

Cyra scoffed.

“Don’t you get it? That’s what I’m worried about, if we prove to be an obstacle the Horde will wipe us out! It was risky enough we joined the rebellion.”

“We were running low on trade routes, an alliance was necessary!”

“Azar, I know you want to help but you can’t just refuse to retreat just because you want to fight back a losing battle.”

“Why do you keep assuming we already lost?”

“Because if they could convert a kingdom into the Fright zone in a few months imagine what they could do to Halfmoon!”

“Exactly! If they take Halfmoon they will have a base of operations in rebel territory!”

Azar and Cyra’s argument were cut off by the door slamming open and Cyra getting tackled by Catra, who was missing her bird and was cleaned from the blood stains. “I’m sorry mom it was my fault, don’t be mad at momma!” Catra sniffled.

Cyra looked at Azar in confusion. Azar shrugged.

“Elizabeth, what are you talking about?”

“I didn’t stay next to momma, and I got lost! It wasn’t her fault!”

“Elizabeth we weren’t fighting...about that.”

She brushed away the tears rolling down the kit’s face. It was times like this she hated how much Catra looked like Azar, her dark ears downturned and her eyes welling up with tears with her nose scrunched up with freckles lining her cheeks. Cyra sighed.

“Hey Bowen came by inviting us to dinner. Go change and we’ll head over there when you come back, okay?” Catra looked back at Azar then turned to Cyra.

“Is momma in trouble?”

Cyra smiled as she shook her head. “No, we were just talking, and we got into a bit of a... disagreement.” Catra nodded and Cyra gave her shoulders a small push. “Now run along.”

Azar ruffled her hair as she went past. “Thanks for the rescue.” Azar said in a fake stage whisper. Catra smiled brightly as she ran right back out the door.

Cyra sighed as she pinched her nose. “We will start preparations for the evacuation.” Before Azar could interrupt Cyra began. “I will also contact Angella to bring some guards.” Azar smiled brightly. “I will only agree to this if you show me an actual plan and if anything goes wrong you fall back. Understand.”

Azar nodded eagerly. “Whatever you say boss! You can trust me!”

Cyra rolled her eyes fondly.

She never should have agreed to that plan.

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wasn’t who she was talking about? Not to mention by the time I was confident in it I had already gotten the invitation from Halfmoon. You have to admit it was a nice surprise.” I smiled.

“Yeah.”

Glimmer then got a smug look as she elbowed Bow who was startled from his daze.

“I’m up!”

“Oh definitely, I thought for sure we were going to lose She-ra to Halfmoon when I saw Adora look at her all gushy.” she teased.

“I did not-”

“Said Catra has hips for days-”

“Shut up!”

Angella laughed. “So, am I to assume Adora might be a frequent visitor of Halfmoon?” The room went quiet. Angella’s laugh halted. “What’s wrong?”

Glimmer crossed her arms. “We aren’t allowed to visit her for a ‘undisclosed’ amount of time.” She did air quotes around the words the guards told us as we were escorted away. Angella looked puzzled until Glimmer stood up angerly and begun pacing. “We were so close mom! Cyra was going to let Catra visit here, and she was going to see Mystacore! It was going to be a big awesome surprise and then-”

“I ruined it.” I said shamefully.

“Adora, you didn’t-”

“Yes, I did. Cyra was going to let her come until she found out me and Catra snuck out to see Old Halfmoon.” It hurts to admit it. I should never have put the thought in her head, maybe if I

could've waited just a few more days it wouldn't have been a problem.

"Cyra is paranoid, in every sense of the word." I looked at Angella in confusion, but she continued. "Losing her first child was an indescribable pain and she has never been the same after that. When Catra was born despite all odds she became Cyra's whole world. She worshipped the ground she walked on and was constantly scared that one day she would lose her. Me and Azar we the ones who would convince her that everything would be fine and that she has no reason to be so paranoid. Then the invasion happened and that solidified every fear she had. So now that she has seen it happen, she's justified all of her actions because she doesn't want to lose her again. Though I fear she might lose Catra in another way if this keeps up."

That seemed to stun the table into silence. "Adora, I guarantee you that if you asked Catra if she regretted sneaking out with you, she would say no way." I smiled back at the queen. "Besides if anyone knows how hard it is to say no to Catra it's her mom's." That made me laugh a bit.

"You should visit her sometimes she said she missed you." Angella gave a forced laugh.

"I would if I could, but I'm not allowed in Halfmoon, which I can't complain about considering the Magicats might not wish to see me. Though I would just want to see what she looks like in person. I haven't seen her since she was six."

"I'm sure Adora would be happy to give you an in-depth description!"

"Glimmer!" I reached over the table at her and her sudden teleport made Bow jostle again.

"I'm up!"

1 month later~~~

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“Alright everything looks perfect. As for next Tuesday I would like you to read this one called “The Phantom.” Then we can have a discussion on Thursday and-”

“I’ve already read it.”

The striped Magicat stares dumbfounded through her green glasses. “There’s no way.” Catra rolled her eyes as she carved into the wood table. She hated lessons. She was given a choice on which one she could choose. Music theory, art, literature, really anything Halfmoon has to offer. Catra didn’t want to do any of them, they were just mindless distractions that wasted a perfectly good Tuesday and Thursday afternoon. The Magicat, Megan. Was hastily going through her papers. This happened every time. Cyra was bouncing Catra from lesson to lesson, Catra was serious when she said she read everything in the library that mixed in with her photographic memory there was nothing these people could teach her.

“Well that kind of throws off my plans.” She chuckled nervously. Catra sighed.

“Can we just have the discussion over it now and get it over with.” She just wanted to go back to her room and be left alone.

Megan looked sheepish. “I would but I myself haven’t finished it.”

“So, are we done here?” She looked back at the clock behind her. It was two hours before this lesson was supposed to end. She bit her lip then sighed.

“Well, I have nothing I can give you.” Catra didn’t wait for another word and stood up quickly.

“Great.”

“See you Tuesday!” Catra gave a halfhearted wave as she left the room, she was greeted by Cyra.
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“Oh Elizabeth, I was just coming to get you. Are you busy.”

“We just finished.”

“Oh.” Cyra looked at the clock. “So soon?”

“Yeah.” Catra began walking away.

“We’re having your favorite for dinner.” Catra didn’t stop walking.

“Okay.” The guards bowed slightly to Cyra before they followed closely behind Catra.

The clanking metal became a source of Catra’s frustration, she slammed her bedroom door in their faces. She tried playing by Cyra’s rules. She hasn’t done anything wrong and has followed her conditions to the T. Nothing has changed, at this point she’d be happy if she got to walk around the castle without having people breathing down her neck.

She considered smashing the two guards heads together just to be able to walk to the bathroom on her own.

A shy knock came from her bedroom door. She groaned, as she turned around and yanked the door open. When she saw it was Cyra she tried to school her features. “Yes?” Cyra gave a smile.

“I just wanted to ask you how the lesson went but you left so quickly I didn’t get a chance.” She gave a strained smile.

“It was fine. Anything else?” Cyra’s smile dropped.

“Elizabeth can we please just talk? Instead of you just giving me the cold shoulder.”

Catra scoffed. “Last I checked you told me to hold my tongue, I'm only doing what you ask of me.”

Cyra sighed as she ran a hand down her face. “Stars Elizabeth, why do you pick and choose what you listen to?”

“Pick and choose? I have been listening to every bullshit rule you’ve made! I do the lessons, I have guards follow me everywhere, I haven’t talked to any of my friends, what more do you want from me!?”

“Come to dinner occasionally, stop hiding in your room and stop giving Megan a hard time.”

Catra stared.

“Are you kidding me? I don’t come to dinner anymore because every time I do you make these passive aggressive comments about something that happened over a month ago! I stay in my room because if I go anywhere else, I have these two assholes breathing down my neck! Also, I’m not giving Megan a hard time, I have been the best student and I do every assignment asked of me. It’s not my fault that I get bored discussing books I’ve already read.”

Cyra pinched the bridge of her nose. “So, do you want to change your lessons again?” Catra growled in frustration.

“No-” Catra grasped her hair as she growled. “Never mind. You only hear what you want to hear and I’m tired of trying to talk to the equivalent of a brick wall.”

Cyra huffed. “And I’m tired of trying to make you feel better just for you to spit in my face!”

“You want to make me feel better? Could’ve fooled me!”

“Elizabeth, I swear-”

“Cy, enough.” The pair turned their heads to Azar. “Come on there’s no reason to continue this back and forth.” Catra crossed her arms in victory. “You too, Liz. Stop antagonizing each other.” Catra rolled her eyes.

“Fine by me.” Then shut the door, staying in her room. Cyra gawked at the door.

“I swear you-”

“Cy, come on.” Azar began dragging her away from the door.

“Are you really siding with her on this?” Cyra accused.

Azar took a deep breath. “If you keep acting like this then yes.”

“Tell her that! Honestly, she has been so rude and insufferable. Angry at every little thing!” Azar raised a brow.

“You mean like you?” Cyra glared at her wife. Azar was tired of all this arguing and this game of who can piss off the other. “Cy, what do you want from Liz?” Cyra stared puzzled.

“What do you mean?”

“She apologized to you and now she is actively following your rules despite her not wanting to. Obviously your still mad about the Halfmoon escapade, so what else do you want Liz to do for you to forgive her?” Cyra’s face fell.

“Well...”

Azar sighed.

“That’s your problem. I know you think Liz is trying to shut you out but she’s kind of doing the opposite. She realizes she hurt you, so she apologized and is trying to gain back your trust by playing by your rules, but she can see you're obviously still mad at her. So, she’s frustrated because she doesn’t know what else to do in order to prove to you that she is sorry. So, I’m asking you what do you want from Liz?” Cyra stared dumbfounded.

“I...” Finally, her ears dropped as she hugged herself. “I just want things to go back to normal.” Azar rubbed her shoulder.

“I’m sure that’s what Liz wants too, but one of you must take the first step. Not just throw insults to one another.” Cyra sighed.

“I hate when you’re right.”

Catra was frustrated. She wanted to scream, shout, and break things. Catra listened closely as Cyra, and Azar walked away.

The breathing of the guards outside her door were beginning to make her go mad.

There was a knock on her door and Catra growled as she pulled the door open. “Will you just leave me alone!” Catra stopped her yelling as she saw Vivianne standing dumb founded.

“Uh... is now a bad time?”

Catra backtracked. “Vivianne, hi... sorry.” Catra stepped back, inviting Vivianne into her room. “I was thinking you were someone else. Vivianne mindlessly followed, closing the door behind her. Vivianne has been Catra’s saving grace through the past month. Constantly visiting between her duties to try and cheer Catra up.

Vivianne stood awkwardly in the entryway as Catra threw herself at her bed. Mumbling something Vivianne couldn’t decipher, “You, okay?” Vivianne asked carefully. Suddenly Catra sat up.

“No, what is her problem! I have been nothing but perfect and she still is acting like she has a massive stick up her-”

“Not listening to that.” Vivianne said as she covered her ears. Catra rolled her eyes and stopped her barrage. She then pulled her legs up to her chest, wrapping her arms around them.

Vivianne frowned and sat next to her. “Have you tried talking to Azar? Maybe she can talk to Cyra for you.”

Catra scoffed. “I don’t want to talk with her either.” Vivianne startled slightly at that. Catra would go to Cyra for advice and Azar for help when she couldn’t talk to Cyra.

“Are you two fighting?” Vivianne asked.

Catra's eyes narrowed. "I found out she was fucking around with my head, she took a memory from me. I got it back but...who's to say she hasn't done it before? That she won't do it again?" Catra looked at Vivianne. "How am I even supposed to trust her?"

Vivianne took a sharp breath. "I- I don't know." Catra looked back at the ground. "But I know Azar loves you, and she would never purposely hurt you." Catra didn't respond. Vivianne smiled as she bumped their shoulders. "And if she does, I'll make you remember. I'm really convincing."

That got a small laugh out of her. "Thanks."

"No problem." Vivianne checked the clock. "Shit, I got to go. Duty calls. I'll try and see you tomorrow."

Catra laughed while shooing her away with her hand. "Yeah, I'll be here. Have fun."

Vivianne gave one more smile before closing the door behind her. Catra's smile fell as she lay down on her bed.

"Adora hurry up!"

"Hold on!" Adora rummaged through her dresser, her closet, even her vanity that she rarely uses. "Where is it?" Adora then hears Glimmer appear, groaning.

"Adora come on we're going to be late!" Adora didn't respond as she kept searching. "What are you looking for?" Adora sighed.

"My jacket, I haven't seen it in forever. I thought it would be here, but I still can't find it!" That jacket was the first thing that was truly hers and something she had for herself. She got it when there was a successful raid of a nearby village leaving the Horde with an abundance of spare fabric. So, each cadet had to get something, whether it be a spare shirt, pants, hats, etc. When Adora got that jacket, she felt as if she was her own person for the first time, no longer looking like every other cadet. Something that distinguished her from the crowd, and she lost it.

Glimmer sighed as she began to help. “When was the last time you had it?” Adora thought back.

“I remember having it in Halfmoon, and when I got my stuff that was already packed, I had my outfit laid out for me and my jacket wasn’t with it. I assumed it was in the bag, but I already checked there.” Glimmer dropped the clothes she was holding.

She suddenly was shaking Adora’s shoulders and smiling. “Oh Adora, you sly dog!” Adora stared confused as Glimmer hugged her tightly. “Of course, they didn’t suspect you! I didn’t know you had it in you, maybe you are an actor.”

“I’m confused.” Glimmer laughed.

“Good one Adora!” However, when she saw Adora she noticed she was in fact looking very confused. “Holy crap, you actually forgot your jacket...”

Realization crept onto her face. “Oops.” Glimmer chuckled evilly.

“This is perfect! Now we have a perfect excuse to go see Catra, I’m sure her mom has calmed down by now.” Completely forgetting about their scheduled shopping trip Glimmer began pacing.

“If we play our cards right, we can play it off as we were passing by and thought it would be a good time to pick up your jacket. Then we got in and got the jacket but then- Oh no! It’s so late we can’t be out in the lone dark whispering woods! Boom! We get a whole day with Catra and a chance to plead with her mom.”

“Glimmer, do you not remember the guard saying we were banned?”

“For an undisclosed amount of time...the time is now!” Glimmer smiled. She teleported and came back with Bow.

“Glimmer!”

“Change of plans Bow, we’re going to Halfmoon!” Bow raised a brow at Adora, silently asking for an explanation but Adora just shrugged.

“Glimmer I don’t think that’s a good idea-”

Glimmer gave a faux gasp. “But we need to get Adora’s jacket! It’s so important to her, just look how heartbroken she is.” Glimmer grabbed Adora’s face, pushing her cheeks together.

“Uhh-” Adora tried to speak but Glimmer continued,

“Heartbroken Bow!”

Bow grimaced. He didn’t think any of this was a good idea. Noticing him not budging Glimmer grabbed his hand. “Please Bow? If not for Adora, for me?” She batted her eyelashes at him. Bow tried to look away, he really did but eventually he sighed.

“Okay.” Glimmer jumped in excitement.

“Yes! Thanks Bow! Now come on we don’t have time to waste!”

“Glimmer wait-” Before Adora could protest Glimmer had teleported them to the edge of the whispering woods.

Catra woke with a start, her chest heaving and her head throbbing. “Fuck!” She gripped her head. Everything hurt and she was having a hard time knowing what was real or not. How many memories did she have left? It felt like with each new one she got she loses fifty just to make room. Catra groaned as she looked out her window, it was around dinner time. She looked down at Adora’s jacket lying on her lap. It was the only thing helping her sleep at night. She pulled it up to her nose and growled a bit.

It was already losing her scent.

“Liz?” A knock came to her door, and she quickly hid the jacket under her pillow.

“What?!”

“Instead of shouting through a door can you just let me in?” Catra rolled her eyes. The door wasn’t locked. It rarely was.

“Fine.” Azar opened the door and whistled when she saw the room.

“Wow and here I thought you were cleaning your room the whole time.” She gave a forced laugh, Catra just laid back down on her side. Azar frowned. “You mind if I sit?”

“Do what you want.”

Azar sighed as she sat on the bed with Catra’s back to her.

“I just wanted to...apologize- genuinely apologize about taking your memories. It took me a while to realize I didn’t do it to protect you but to protect your idea of me.” Catra looked over her shoulder. “Liz, I’ve done a lot of bad things. I should have just talked to you like you asked, instead I ran away from it and tried to pretend it never happened. You didn’t deserve that. No one does.” Azar took a deep breath. “I hope you can forgive me.” Azar suddenly had arms wrapped around her waist and a weight on her lap.

Catra gripped her tightly. “That’s all I wanted to hear.” Azar chuckled as she hugged her back. She then pulled back suddenly cradling Catra’s face.

“I promise I will explain everything to you when...when I’m ready.” Catra nodded in understanding and hugged her mother again. Shoving her face into her neck.

“You still love me, right?” Catra spoke weakly into her neck. Azar rubbed her head.

“Of course, I do.” She kissed the crown of her head. “I’ll never stop loving you.” Silent tears went down Catra’s cheeks. She never had unconditional love in her life before Azar and Cyra, it still

overwhelms her when they prove her doubts wrong every time. “Cy still loves you too. So much so it hurts her when she sees you so miserable.” Catra didn’t believe that for a second.

“Yeah right.” Azar lifted Catra’s head up. Catra refused to make eye contact.

“Liz look at me.” She relented and looked into the gold eyes that were uncanny to her own. “I know you don’t understand it, but Cyra loves you more than anything. She is just scared.” Catra scoffed. Azar rolled her eyes. “I know you think it's bullshit, and you’re tired of hearing the same speech repeatedly but this is Cy’s way of keeping you safe. Do I agree with it? Debatable but if you can try and see where she is coming from maybe that can help.”

“I know, I know! I tried apologizing, I’ve been doing everything she’s asked, and she still sees me as some inconvenience.”

“Liz, no. Why would you think that?” Catra pulled away slightly.

“She gives me lessons to keep me occupied then gets upset when I finish them too soon, she is constantly berating me about being in my room all day, and she always says something during dinner to make me feel like shit.” Catra crossed her arms.

“Liz, have you ever thought that she is upset because she wants you to be happy and doesn’t know what else to do?” Catra tilted her head at that. “She isn’t upset at you when you finish your lessons early, she’s upset because she doesn’t want you bored, and the lessons were supposed to entertain you. She hates that you’re in your room all day because she misses you, and while her comments at dinner aren’t justified, she was trying to get you to talk to her. And before you ask, I know this because she was harassing me all night long on how to fix this rift you both put between yourselves.” Catra stared, speechless. Then looked down.

“I hadn’t thought of that.” Azar shrugged.

“Well, the best thing to do is talk to her, no one likes it but in a stalemate like this someone has to take the first step.” Catra

sighed. “She’s in the dining room.” Catra nodded as she quickly stood up. If she was going to do this, it had to be while she still had the courage to do it. She opened the door and almost ran to the dining room.

Once Catra arrived, she barely hesitated to open the door. Cyra was sat on the far end of the table and startled to the door suddenly opening. “Oh... hello Elizabeth.” She gave a sad smile. How could Catra have been so stupid? She really thought Cyra would do anything to hurt her on purpose.

Catra’s lips trembled. “I'm sorry, for everything.” Catra looked at the floor as she hugged herself. Cyra stood up quickly and grabbed Catra’s face.

“Oh, sweetie I should be the one apologizing. I’ve been so unfair to you.” Catra fought back tears, she wasn’t going to cry. Cyra hugged her tightly and the internal war she’s been having with herself about her mother was washed away as she gripped her back just as tightly. “Elizabeth I never meant a single word I said to you. I have never seen you as anything less than perfect I was angry, and I took it out on you. This should’ve been done with when you apologized, I took it too far.”

“I never meant anything I said about you! I was just being a brat and- and-”

“Shh, I know.” She held Catra closer to her. Catra was biting her lip harshly trying to stop herself from crying. When did she get so soft?

Just outside the dining room doors, Azar approached the two guards that were stationed for Catra. “Good news. Cy has relieved you of your duties. Catra is free to roam as she pleases, without supervision.” Azar then handed them both a signed document with the royal seal. They looked at it then bowed as then dispersed. Azar planned on giving it to them when she first went to Catra’s room but when she ran off Azar decided it would be better to wait.

They both took the first step. Azar thought fondly as she entered the dining hall to see Catra and Cyra talking and smiling. She wished she would've done this weeks ago to avoid all this trouble.

"I hear laughing I hope it's nothing about me."

Cyra rolled her eyes. "Oh no you caught us." Cyra says teasingly. Azar smiles.

"I am a master spy after all." Azar ran a hand through her hair dramatically.

"More like a master dummy." Catra spoke and Azar grabbed Catra.

"What was that brat?!" She laughed as Azar threw her over her shoulder laughing.

"Momma put me down!"

"Not until you say uncle!"

"Never!" Cyra laughed as Catra gave a halfhearted fight as Azar teased her.

Cyra put her hand on Azar's shoulder, "Alright love, stop teasing. Dinner should be ready by now." Azar relented and placed Catra on the floor, who huffed at her mother. Azar just stuck her tongue out at her. Cyra flicked her ear teasingly. "Azar stop being a brat." She pouted. Cyra then grabbed Catra. "Come on, it's your favorite tonight." Catra's ears perked up as her tail swayed.

"Yes!"

"Glimmer I want it to go on record that I think this is a terrible idea." Glimmer put her hands on her hips with a smile.

"Noted and ignored!" Bow sighed and then Adora spoke up.

"Yeah, Glimmer as much as I want to see Catra again the queen did seem really mad." Adora still remembers the heat in her eyes

when she asked Adora if Catra would be in Old Halfmoon when she was looking for her.

“Pff, it’s been a good month she’ll be fine. In fact, she will be so excited to see us she might have already forgotten about it.” Just then as Glimmer walked through the cliff side, she was pushed out just as quickly. “Hey!” Adora held a breath when she saw two dark Magicats with blindfolds on. They didn’t speak as they walked right back onto the cliff side.

Glimmer stood confused. “Uhh..hello?” Just then Vivianne stepped out, she squinted as she adjusted her eyes to the sun then recognition came across her face as she saw the group.

“Oh, hey.”

Glimmer scoffed. “Hey, yourself. What’s going on?” Vivianne sighed.

“No one is allowed in or out of Halfmoon at the moment.” Adora’s thoughts began to click together. No wonder Catra hasn’t sent any letters or calls. They’re on a complete lockdown. Glimmer smiled smugly as she grabbed Adora.

“Well, my friend here forgot her jacket, so we just came to pick it up!” Vivianne rolled her eyes.

“You’re going to have to wait. We will have it sent to Brightmoon when we can.” Vivianne then turned to go back without another word.

“How long will that take?” She just shrugged.

Adora suddenly grabbed Vivianne’s arm. “Wait!” She glared over her shoulder.

“What?”

Adora let go. “Is Catra doing well? Can you at least tell us that? We’ve been worried about her ever since we couldn’t get a call to

go through.” Vivianne softened a bit, then sighed as she crossed her arms.

“Do you want me to lie to you?” One look at the group's faces and Vivianne got her answer. “Cyra and Lizzy have been fighting every day, so tensions are always high, she isn’t allowed to go anywhere other than her room without two guards on her, and she’s been hiding in her room ever since you guys left. So not great.” While Adora frowned Glimmer was seething.

“That isn’t fair!”

“What you think I don’t know that? Me and Azar have been trying to talk to Cyra about loosening up and she hasn’t budged. I know I can be a jerk sometimes but I’m not heartless.” Vivianne sighed. “I just hate seeing her so miserable.”

Silence consumed the group before Vivianne started again. “I’ll tell Cyra about it, but I can’t promise it’ll get you into Halfmoon.”

“Say I would like to talk to her. Just her.” Glimmer tilted her head at her.

“Adora what-”

“Please Vivianne.” She sighed as she nodded.

Stubbornly Adora sat on a rock burning holes into the cliff side with her eyes. “Adora?” Bow asked worriedly. “What are you doing?”

“I’m waiting for an audience with the queen.”

“Stop it!”

“Azar leave her alone.” Cyra responded to Azar trying to force feed Catra. Azar pouted as Catra stuck her tongue out at her mother.

“I remember when you wouldn’t eat unless I fed you!” Azar said upsettingly while hugging her. Catra rolled her eyes.

“I know that’s a lie.”

Cyra interjected, “Nope, It’s true. Stars forbid you ever ate for me...” Cyra sipped her drink as she spoke bitterly. Azar laughed.

“Jealous much?” Cyra scoffed.

“In my defense you were always running off and have you ever tried feeding a toddler who doesn’t want to be fed? I think I have a right to be a little bitter. Honestly you spent more time at Mystacore than here at one point.”

“Speaking of...” Cyra raised a brow. “Me and Liz made up and so she-” Catra elbowed her mother. “I mean... I was wondering if we could go back to magic lessons?”

Cyra went to say something, but Azar interrupted, grabbing Catra’s face and giving kitten eyes. “Please? Come on look at this face. Look at it! Liz do the thing!”

“The thing doesn’t work on her!” Catra said muffled. Cyra let their bickering go on for a while before she began to laugh.

“Azar it’s all up to her.” The bickering stopped as they looked at Cyra.

“Seriously?” Catra said suspiciously. Cyra nodded

.“Elizabeth, I meant what I said. I took things too far. As of now you have proven I can trust you, so no more lessons, no more guards, and I’ll return your tracker pad so you can communicate with Brightmoon again-oof!” Cyra was tackled by Catra, causing her to almost tilt her seat back before she settled.

Cyra smiled as she hugged her back just as tightly. Azar then placed herself on top. “My turn!” Cyra laughed.

“Alright you two knock it off! You’re going to break something.”

A firm knock came from the door.

“Come in!” Catra and Azar backed away as Cyra stood up.

“Umm, queen Cyra?” Vivianne came in timidly. Due to recent events, Grell was let go. Vivianne was then promoted to the general position in place of her father.

“Yes Vivianne?” She looked hesitantly to Catra.

“I need to discuss something with you privately.”

“Oh, yes.” She walked hastily out of the room, Vivianne holding the door open for her. The second the door closed Vivianne started.

“Adora is here and requested to speak with you.”
Cyra sighed.

“I’ll send a messenger to Brightmoon and she can send a letter.”

“No, I mean she’s here. Outside...waiting.” Cyra took a deep breath.

“Tell her to go home, Elizabeth is getting her tracker pad back anyway, so she’ll be able to talk to her.” Vivianne interrupted.

“With all due respect she made it a point that she wanted to talk with you privately.”
Cyra got a confused look on her face,

“What about?”

“I don’t know but she doesn’t plan on leaving until you speak to her.”

Cyra looked at the dining room door, if she strained her hearing, she could hear Catra and Azar laughing together.

“Escort her to the throne room, be subtle and this is between us. Tell her she’ll have thirty minutes.” Surprised, Vivianne nodded.

“Yes, your majesty.” She bowed as she hastily left.
Cyra rubbed her temples. She had a headache starting and she wanted nothing more than to sleep, yet it seems it will allude her again. She tried to steal her features as she entered the dining room but stopped short when she saw Azar reading a small book and Catra lying on her arms which were resting on the table. The pair perked up when they heard the door close behind her.

“Everything okay?” Catra asked curiously. Azar also waiting for an answer.

“Yes, I just have an emergency meeting tonight.” Azar cringed.

“This late? What can’t wait till tomorrow?” Cyra smiled at Azar.

“That’s what I said but they are very... stubborn.” Cyra said with annoyance.

Catra yawned widely and Azar jokingly touched her tongue. Catra spat, “Ew, mom!” Azar just laughed at her, as Catra shoved her. “You’re so weird!”

“You wound me!” Azar said dramatically.

Cyra laughed, “Alright enough you two. It’s late so go head to bed.” Cyra addressed Catra and Azar gave a smug smile.

“Yeah, Liz go to bed.”

Cyra flicked her ear. “You too, you are not staying up late again!” Catra snicked at her mother.

“Hush you!” Azar ruffled Catra’s hair.

“Stop it! Mom make her stop!”

Cyra sighed and pulled Azar back by her scruff, making her go limp. “I hate it when you do that!” Catra laughed as she grabbed Azar’s hand, making her hit her face.

“Why are you hitting yourself? Why are you hitting yourself?”

“Elizabeth, enough.”

Catra smiled sheepishly as Cyra let Azar go and she rubbed her neck as she glared at Catra, who just stuck her tongue out. Azar left the room with Catra close behind until Cyra stopped her.

“Remind me tomorrow and I’ll get your tracker pad for you.” Cyra winked and Catra nodded. She turned to leave but stopped short just to turn around and give Cyra a tight hug.

“I love you.”

Cyra laughed sweetly. “I know sweetie. I love you too.” She gave her a quick kiss, and Catra left swiftly.

Adora’s POV

“Adora, come on!” Glimmer was complaining as she leaned on Bow. “It’s been hours! She’ll send us a letter so let’s go!” I stood firm and remained in my seated position even as Glimmer tried to forcefully move me.

“You can leave if you want. I’ll be here.” I could hear Glimmer rolling her eyes. Luckily Bow stepped in.

“Glimmer why don’t we just go home and come back later? Adora will be fine, and you can take a nap and come back.”

“I don’t need a nap Bow! I need Adora to stop being stubborn and just-”

“Adora.” I snapped up when I saw Vivianne. “Today’s your lucky day. Cyra agreed.” Glimmer switched her mood immediately. Though Vivianne hardened her glare. “Just Adora.”

“What!?”

Bow held her up by her armpits. “Of course, we’ll be here!” Bow said quickly. Then he whispered to me.

“Just go I’ll watch over Glimmer. Tell Catra we said hi.’ I nodded and Vivianne rolled her eyes.

“Come on.” Vivianne turned back to Halfmoon, and I hastily followed.

“Coming!”

I walk through the chamber that put a pang of memories through me. Catra’s laughter rang through my mind, and I was in a daze as Vivianne led me.

“Lizzy misses you.” Vivianne’s sudden voice called me out of my temporary daze.

“Really?”

“Yeah, she even asked me to try and sneak you in. You should’ve heard her, ‘technically mom didn’t say anything about sneaking someone in!’” Vivianne smiled at the memory.

“Yeah, that sounds like her.”

“So, what was growing up in the Horde like?” My eyebrows shot up at the sudden topic change. “I was just curious. When Lizzy first came here, she was really skittish... It didn’t take much guessing to assume what it was like.” Vivianne sighed. “But it wasn’t all bad, was it?”

I gulped; it wasn’t.

“No, Catra made sure of that.” I laughed. “We would make up our own games to pass the time. Though Catra would always win, she played dirty.” I said in faux offence.

Vivianne laughed. “I can see that.”

“But I was stubborn. I never let her switch games until I won at least one.” I smiled as I reminisced. “I honestly think she just let me win whenever she wanted to switch games.”

“I doubt that. Have you seen how competitive she is? I think she just let you win because she likes you so much.”

I felt my face flush as I tried to laugh off the compliment. “I guess.”

Vivianne scoffed, “Oh please, she’s obsessed with you.”

This conversation wasn’t good for my heart.

“Let's not talk about this.” I say covering my face.

“You like Lizzy, don’t you?”

I swear I was going to have a heart attack. “Of course, I do!”

Vivianne smiled. “But just as a friend?”

“What’s that supposed to mean?” I asked.
Vivianne shrugged.

“Adora, I know you’re not blind. Being a princess and attractive are a dangerous combination. If you don’t make a move soon someone else will. Especially if you convince Cyra to let her out into the world, People love Magicats after all.”

“What does that mean?”

“We’re here.”

I blinked and we were still in what looked like the chamber to the gates and a door was in front of me. “Uhh..”

“I took you through the back way, Cyra doesn’t want to start a panic with you being seen so she said to take the long way around.”

“Oh, okay. Thanks for the help.”

“Don’t mention it. Really, if Lizzy finds out she’ll have my head for not bringing you to her first.”

I laughed as I motioned zipping my lips. The cave system of Halfmoon really is amazing I thought as I opened the door, and I was in the Castle. Luckily, I knew where I was, and I was able to direct myself to the throne room.

As I came to the door I hesitated. Should I knock? I should probably knock. This is so awkward and not to mention how late it must be. I keep forgetting about the stupid reverse night thing! Before I could debate with myself longer the door opened to reveal Cyra.

“You realize I only gave you thirty minutes to speak your piece and you’re wasting it by standing out here.” I jumped slightly, fighting the instinct to salute her.

‘Right sorry.”

Cyra’s annoyance disappeared as she sighed. She then walked back into the throne room, and I wordlessly followed.

It was kind of nice to see Cyra in regular clothing, no jewelry besides her necklace I’ve never seen her take off and wearing what had to be her sleep wear. She sat lazily on the throne.

“Alright Adora, what would you like to talk about?”

This was my time. While I was sitting and waiting, I had a script memorized I had one chance and I wasn’t messing it up.

“I-”

“Also, Elizabeth has been taken off punishment as of today, so she’ll be able to contact you, Glimmer, and Bow. As well as no more guard detail. So, if it has anything to do with that there's your answer.”

Shit.

Only Catra could throw a wrench in my plans like that, I now know where she got it from.

“Oh...” The silence lasted for less than a second before Cyra had busted out laughing. I frowned.

“I’ll be honest I had a whole speech prepared and half of it was convincing you to punish me instead of Catra.” Cyra raised a brow at that.

“You realize if I punished you, it would be tried as treason?” I stared worriedly. Cyra laughs again.

“Well, is there anything else you wanted to say to me?”

“Can Catra still come to Brightmoon?” That seemed to make Cyra pause. “I swear I would be personally responsible for her.” Cyra sighed.

“Careful handling her is... a challenge.” I smiled.

“I’m aware. Painfully aware.” I took a deep breath. “But Catra knows how to take care of herself. Glimmer wouldn’t let anything happen to her. Nobody in Brightmoon would want to see her hurt. Not to mention Angella would probably keep her hostage just to talk her ears off.” Cyra smiled longingly.

“No doubt.”

“I’m not asking for an answer. I just want you to consider it. I know you love Catra. More than anything. So, I won’t question you but please consider it.” I started fidgeting with my nails as Cyra sat with a hand on her chin, thinking.

“I don’t want Elizabeth in any part of the war nor the alliance. Could you assure me they will remain separate?” Cyra’s suddenly spoke. I nodded my head quickly.

“Of course, Angella will most likely see to it herself. Any sign of the Horde making a move towards Brightmoon we would send her right back safely.” Cyra was considering it. Her eyes showed an internal battle, but I could work with this.

“What can I say to convince you?”

Cyra stared at me, and her eyes narrowed, as if looking for a lie.

She found none.

She sighed exasperated. “I want you to promise me that if anything were to happen to her you would contact me immediately. Even if it would result in Eliazbeth being brough back home. Can I trust you to do that.”

“Yes. I promise.”

“Alright-”

“Yes!” Cyra stopped me mid celebration.

“I need to discuss this with Azar before anything. As well as Elizabeth. Nothing is set in stone.”

My heels were still off the ground. I nodded.

“Yes, of course.”

Cyra smiled at me again. “So, is that all?”

I suddenly remembered how late it was for Cyra. “Oh, yes. Sorry for coming in so late and... unannounced. I’ll just go.”

“Goodnight Adora.”

“Oh! Do you happen to know where my jacket is? I accidentally left it here.” I said sheepishly.

I didn’t like the smug look she had on her face.

“I believe it’s in Elizabeth’s room.” I flushed.

“Never mind you can just send it over whenever you can.” Cyra rolled her eyes.

“Adora if Elizabeth finds out you were here and didn’t see you, she will start a riot. I’m sure she’ll be ecstatic to see you.” I bit my lip hesitantly.

“I don’t-”

Cyra sighed, “Adora go.”

“Right! Thank you again!” I briskly walked out of the room, taking a confident left turn.

“Wrong way!” Cyra shouted from the room.

I flushed as I switched directions.

“Right thank you!”

Azar had just dropped Catra off in her room. Catra was already dressed for bed and was going to go straight to sleep but when she saw Adora’s jacket on her bed she got an overwhelming urge to draw.

It was thrown over her shoulders as she sat at her desk sketching a certain blond-haired person. She felt embarrassed, like any second someone would barge in and catch her being a love sick idiot. She blushed as she drew the almond shape of her eyes.

There were times she hated her photographic memory, the Horde being the biggest blame, but times like now she was grateful. She remembers every color that those eyes hold. Gorgeous hues of blue and grey. Her dark eyelashes looking absolutely gorgeous against her pale skin. That small arch of her brow, and the minuscule freckle right below her right eye.

Her face held so many memories, the slightest bend in her nose bridge from when she ran face first into the floor and the fait scar from when Catra scratched her out of anger. When Catra started sketching her lips her mind went slightly blank as her eyes dilated ever so slightly. They looked soft and rough at the same time. Scared from Adora biting her lip so often, but still somehow so plump from dumb genetic code Adora was blessed with.

Her jaw line was ridiculous in Catra's opinion. It was carved as if she was made from marble and almost always tensed from clenching her jaw in annoyance. Catra hated how absolutely everything about her was perfect despite being scared, if anything they only made her look betting her opinion.

Catra laughed as she began drawing the hair poof on her head. She jokingly made it huge just to spite Adora who was nowhere to be found and after a small laugh she erased it and started again. The hair poof came from the rash decision of cutting Adora bangs because she wanted to match Catra, they learned that day that different hair textures mean different results. It wasn't too bad though Adora seemed to love the dumb poof and still wears it, despite her bangs no doubt being long enough for her to just pin them back normal.

Her hair had grown out a significant amount, Catra remembering when she pulled down Adora's hair before they fell asleep. It was silk smooth in her hands and the strands looked as if they were hand-picked and sewed into her head. It was so soothing.

Catra stared longingly at the half finished piece, Adora changed so much and so little. She's missing her tooth gap, but her personality hasn't changed a bit. Catra frowned.

'I can only imagine the girls in Brightmoon falling over themselves trying to get a date with her' Catra thought bitterly.

She shook her head and laughed.

She knew Adora was as dense as a rock. Someone could flash her, and she would ask if the lady confused her for a doctor or something. Catra pulled the jacket closer to her nose.

Her scent was beginning to fade and Catra hated it.

She refused to go to her mom's room when she had nightmares. Adora's scent was the one thing that kept her calm. She probably didn't need it anymore anyway, after all she was talking with her mom's again, she could just run to them.

Though she knew it wouldn't be the same.

She wished Adora was here.

A firm knock came from her door in a familiar pattern. Catra leapt up from her chair, there's no way.

Catra almost tore the door off its hinges when she opened it and stared in pure awe.

"Adora?!"

She smiled sheepishly. "Yeah, sorry it's so la-" Catra tanked her into the room and shut the door firmly behind her.

"What are you doing here? How'd you even get in?" Cyra had upped security around the gate and nothing against Adora, but stealth isn't her forte.

"Well, I actually came because I forgot my jacket then I wanted to talk with your mom about punishing me instead of you, but then she told me that you're not grounded anymore, so I asked her about letting you come to Brightmoon and she said she needed to think about it and said I should visit you because you would quote "Start a riot."

Catra blinked as she tried to register everything Adora said. Then Adora looked down and got a smug look on her face as she crossed her arms. "I see you found it."

“What?”

Adora gestures down and Catra suddenly remembers the red jacket hanging off her shoulders. She ripped it off her and threw it at Adora’s face. “Shut up!”

“I didn’t say anything!” Adora laughed.

“I was just cold, and it was close by. Don’t let it get to your head, it’s big enough on its own.”

Adora rolled her eyes as she placed it over her arm. “I would never.” Adora was taken aback by how Catra’s scent clung to the fabric.

Adora then saw the drawing lying on Catra’s desk. Catra followed her eyes. Catra flushed as she snatched it and shoved it into a drawer. “Not. A. Word.”

Adora smiled. “Come on let me see! It can’t be that bad!” Adora tried to reach it, but Catra stood firm in front of it shaking her head.

“It's nothing.”

“Then why are you hiding it? Come on Catra you know I would never make fun of your work.”

That wasn’t what she was worried about. She tried pushing Adora back, but she stayed firm.

“It’s just something I had to do for a project nothing interesting."

“Then let me see.” Adora placed her hands on either side of Catra. “Come on please?” She gave her a big doe eyed look, Catra shut her eyes. Those blue eyes could always work wonders on Catra’s resilience. She shook her head again. Adora pouted. Then got an evil idea. She placed her hands on Catra’s waist and nudged her head to Catra’s ear.

Catra had to bite back a whine feeling Adora's breath on her ear. Catra's claws were digging into the desk behind her. Adora most likely didn't know what she was doing when she was blowing on Catra's ear, making it twitch. As a kit she hated when Adora did that and would do anything to make her stop. Now the closeness was something she was craving.

"Adora, stop it." Adora took Catra's strained voice as annoyance.

"Will you show me?"

Catra wanted to say no. Not only because of the embarrassment of the drawing but so Adora would stay right where she is. Though she knew that if this went on, she would only do something stupid. Catra huffed. She could always just tell her no and Adora would back off if Catra really wanted her to, but she didn't want to see a disappointed look on Adora's face.

"Fine."

The overconfident exterior evaporated and Adora clapped her hands. "Yay! Thanks, Catra."

'As if you gave me a choice.' Catra thought. When Adora stepped back so Catra could get to the drawer, she had to fight down the whine. She coughed to cover the sound. She threw the piece of paper at Adora and crossed her arms.

"Don't look too much into it!"

Adora looked at the piece of paper. "Catra..." She refused to look up at Adora. This was embarrassing enough. "This is awesome! You even got that crook in my nose from me falling on my face." Adora laughed.

Catra uncurled from herself slightly. "Thanks. It's mostly the photographic memory." Catra said humbly. Adora shook her head.

"You should come repaint the murals at Brightmoon Glimmer would love a big mural of my face in her room."

Catra snickered. “I might take you up on that.”

“You’ll tell me the second Cyra comes to a decision, won’t you?” Catra tilted her head slightly.

“What decision?”

“About you coming to Brightmoon.” Catra’s ears perked up.

“Wait, she was serious?”

“Yeah, I told you she’s talking to Azar about it now!”

Catra couldn’t believe her ears. Then a smiled broke out across her face. “What changed her mind?”

“I’m a great negotiator.” Adora said smugly. Catra rolled her eyes.

"You couldn't convince a fish to get into water.” Adora pouted then after putting the drawing and her jacket down carefully she tackled Catra and threw her over her shoulder. “Adora!”

“Cyra was right you are a handful.” Adora said casually as she threw Catra onto her bed. Quickly tickling her sides. “What am I going to do with you?” Adora teased as Catra laughed.

“Stop! S-stop it!” Catra tried shoving her off, but Adora lay on top of her giving her a tight hug,

“Aww, come on I thought you missed me!”

“Not even for a second!”

The pair laughed together as Adora rolled off of her and they laid side by side. “Thanks for coming to see me... and convincing my mom.”

“It was an honor. Not every day you get to see a princess.” Catra smacked her with a pillow.

“Shut up princess.”

Adora wrapped her arms around the pillow as they both looked up at the ceiling.

"I should probably head back. Glimmer and Bow are waiting for me."

Catra frowned as she turned to face Adora.

"Do you have to leave right now?" Adora began picking at her nails. Catra scoffed and placed her tail in Adora's hands. "Stop doing that you'll have bloody stubs for fingers." Adora smiled as she began to play with Catra's tail. She had a weird habit of it. Keeping her hands moving helped clear her head. Catra would always offer her tail during their classes to keep her hands occupied and focus on what was being taught.

Shadow weaver hated it. Though she couldn't deny the facts and the fact was whichever class Catra sat next to her would be where she would get the highest scores. After she was gone Adora began picking at her nails, chewing pencils, and at one point pulling out strands of her hair. She would most often chew on a pencil but unfortunately picking at the skin around her nails was her best substitute.

The soft motions of Adora fiddling with Catra's tail were calming and making Catra even more drowsy. She was fighting to keep her eyes open.

Adora soon noticed.

"Am I that boring to be around? I'm hurt Catra." Adora teased but Catra didn't respond, instead scooting closer to lay her head on Adora.

Adora held her breath.

"Can you just stay till I fall asleep...please?"

Adora brought one of her hands to Catra's head, leaning towards her slightly to rub against her hair. Adora knew she had to go see

Bow and Glimmer, at least to tell them she's alright but...

"Of course, I can." Adora can just wait a few minutes till she knows Catra is asleep then leave. She felt herself yawn.

'Just five minutes.' she thought until her eyes slipped close to a soft purr.

"Azar?"

Cyra walked into her room and didn't see Azar anywhere.

"In here." She said from the bathroom, Cyra groaned. She was really hoping she could see Azar in bed so she could go straight to sleep. Cyra walked into the bathroom and Azar was just washing her face, at least she was already in her nightwear. "You're back early. I expected you to be gone for hours."

Cyra laughed. "No, it was just Adora."

Azar jumped slightly. "Adora here? How?"

"Vivianne told me she wanted an audience with me, and I obliged." Cyra laughed slightly. "Though she was unprepared when I told her Elizabeth is no longer under punishment."

"I'm surprised you let her come."

"Well, I wasn't given much of a choice. She was waiting right outside the gate and refused to leave." Cyra groaned slightly as she sat down on her bed.

Azar laughed as she turned out the light in the restroom and came to sit beside her. "So, what I'm hearing is she is as stubborn as Liz."

"I didn't know it was possible." Cyra sighed.

"Better hope Liz doesn't find out she is here. She would start a riot."

“Oh, I couldn’t imagine. That’s why Adora went to see her before leaving.” Azar only hummed in acknowledgement, lying down next to Cyra. “She asked if Elizabeth will be allowed to go visit Brightmoon.” Azar tense slightly.

“Oh yeah?”

Cyra nodded. “I said I would talk to you about it.”

“You know I am only here to support you.” Azar scratched Cyra’s back softly.

“What do you think I should do?”

Azar sighed.

“I think you should make your own decisions.” Cyra huffed as she smacked Azar with a pillow, who in return laughed and continued. “Well, I think we deserve a break, from everything. So, why don’t we send Liz to Brightmoon for a week and meet up at Mystacore? That way we can all get away, and you and I get some much needed alone time.” Cyra rolled her eyes.

“That sounds like it benefits you more than I.”

Azar shrugged. “That’s just my opinion. Like I said your choice.”

Cyra fiddled with her braided hair. “I mean I guess it would be nice to get away from everything.” Azar nodded along as she draped her arm across Cyra. “Elizabeth would be happy, and she would see that I do trust her.”

“Mm-hm.”

Just as Azar got Cyra to start leaning down to head to sleep, Cyra jumped up. “I have to tell Adora to start making plans!” Just as quickly she began to run out of the room before Azar could say a word. She looked to the now empty bed.

“Damn it.”

Cyra didn’t even bother knocking, hoping she could catch Adora before she left. “Sorry to burst in but is Adora still...here...”

Cyra stared as she looked at her daughter sleeping on Adora. Cyra smiled and went to leave until Adora sat up quietly. She was squinting until she saw Cyra and relaxed slightly. She looked down at Catra and carefully snuck out of her grasp and both girls in the room held their breath as Catra moved slightly before sighing and going back to sleep.

Adora sighed and ran to the door grabbing her boots as she went. Adora closed the door behind her as Cyra stepped back. Adora looked up sheepishly. “Sorry I didn’t mean to stay long but...” Cyra just raised her hand.

“It’s not about that. I was actually running to find you before you left.”

Adora silently gestured for Cyra to continue, and she bit her lip as she fiddled with her hair, as if she was battling herself. Finally, she sighed. “I was thinking about what you said, and after talking with Azar about it we came to a decision.”

Adora subconsciously tensed up.

“Just so you know there will be rules in place to ensure Elizabeth’s safety-” Adora barely registered that as she began pacing in place. “-but I can let Elizabeth stay for a week then meet us at Mystacore.”

Adora smiled brightly. “Oh, my stars, thank you so much! I swear we will follow any rules you want!” Cyra laughed at her excitement.

“Yes, yes. I’ll let you go to meet Glimmer. Just be back here by...” Cyra did the math in her head. “12PM tomorrow, in your time, and she’ll be ready. Our scheduled Mystacore arrival is February 12th so just make sure she’s there by then.” Adora nodded along.

“Yes, of course!”

Adora’s eyes were shining and Cyra was having a hard time trying to keep her straight face. Cyra checked the clock in the hall. It was already so late, Cyra thought. She then grabbed Adora by the shoulders, who was thinking of all the places she could show Catra. “Alright run along, I don’t want Glimmer getting impatient and blowing up my castle.”

Adora chuckled. “R-right of course.” She had almost forgotten about Bow and Glimmer waiting outside. Cyra laughed at her nervous laughter.

“Vivianne is waiting just outside the throne room. She can escort you back.”

Adora nodded. “Thank you and we’ll be here! I promise Catra will be in great hands.”

“I know.”

Without another word Adora gave a quick bow and jogged slightly back to the throne room.

Vivianne was leaning against the side of the throne room door. She had her arms crossed and she was fighting falling asleep. Ever since her promotion hours became longer and longer and Vivianne was on the edge of consciousness when she heard Adora walking over. She expected to see her look defeated, but Adora had a glowing smile.

“I assume it went well?”

Adora nodded.

“Better than I hoped to be honest!”

Vivianne just smiled. “I assumed. I found out after you left that she lifted all the bullshit rules on Lizzy.”

“Well, we’re coming back tomorrow to pick her up.” Vivianne’s step faltered.

“What?”

“Cyra is letting Catra visit Brightmoon! Just for a week though and then she’s going to meet up with them at Mystacore. I’m so excited!”

Vivianne frowned. “Sounds like a dream for Lizzy.”

Adora nodded obliviously. They continued walking with silence hanging between them and it was then Adora noticed Vivianne’s sash around her waist. It used to be a red sash, but it is now an amber orange. Vivianne noticed her appearance.

“It shows I’m a general.” Adora looked up confused. “When you enter the royal guard, you start as glorified servant and work your way up. From green, blue, yellow, red, and then orange.”

Adora listened intently, she actually liked the fact there was a surefire way to know someone’s rank by just looking at them. Then Adora remembered Leo. “What about Leo? They have a brown sash.”

“Well, that’s because they are an outlier. A personal guard for the royal family. It’s not really a rank someone can achieve, it’s just given.”

Adora nodded in understanding.

They continued walking and arrived at the chamber gates. “Are you mad at me?” Adora questioned.

“What do you mean?”

“Because we are taking Catra away, I know you two are close.”

“Not as close as you two.” Vivianne said bitterly.

Adora frowned. “You grew up with Catra. I think you beat the four years I knew her by a long shot.” That got a small laugh out of Vivianne.

“In theory.”

Before Adora could ask about that Vivianne stopped. “We’re here.”

“Oh.” Adora hadn’t realized how far they walked. “Well, thanks for walking me.”

“It’s my job.” Vivianne said humorlessly. Adora laughed awkwardly.

“Still, thanks.”

Vivianne smiled. “No problem.”

Adora could hear Glimmer on the other side. “I better go get her she might start to get violent.”

“You mean she isn’t already violent?”

“You have no idea.” Adora joked. Vivianne laughed and turned to walk away.

“See you tomorrow.”

Adora smiled. “Yeah, see you tomorrow.”

Without another word Adora went out into the woods and was greeted by the warm sun. She didn’t get long before she was tackled by Glimmer. “Adora!”

She stumbled slightly then readjusted, Glimmer hanging off her neck.

“Glimmer you have to stop lunging at people.” Bow laughed.

“Adora you were gone for hours!”

Adora blinked confused. How long had she slept? Adora smiled sheepishly. “Sorry, I hadn’t realized. I talked with Cyra though. In fact, she had already dropped all the limitations just today so that was embarrassing and threw off my whole speech.” Adora rubbed her neck nervously.

Glimmer smiled. “So, we can visit?”

“Yep, and... we need to be here by 12PM tomorrow.”

Glimmer cocks her head in confusion. “What? Why?”

Adora crossed her arms smugly, finally having to clue in Glimmer and Bow.

“We have to come pick up Catra, obviously.”

You could hear the wind blow by as Glimmer and Bow stared.

“You mean-”

Adora nodded eagerly, “Catra’s coming to Brightmoon!”

Glimmer squealed and hugged Adora tightly. “Oh, my stars! Are you serious? How- I- what?”

Adora laughed as Bow tackled her as well. “Adora be honest did you use She-ra?” Bow teased.

“Nope, just...talked to Cyra... like I should’ve.” Glimmer gave her a proud look.

“Well, what are we waiting for? We have to get everything ready. Such short notice!” Glimmer began mumbling to herself. “I have to go to Jewels bakery and get some of that crab cake-” She continued talking.

“I’m proud of you Adora. I honestly thought you were gonna start a war.” Bow chuckled.

“Wow Bow, way to show your confidence in me.” Adora said with a sarcastic tone. Glimmer then suddenly gasped.

“We have to clean Catra’s room!” Bow then got a nervous look on his face.

“Oh crap, when was the last time someone went in there?” Glimmer’s face said a long time.

She teleported next to Bow and Adora. “We have to go!”

She teleported the pair to the edge of the woods and before she could even feel woozy, she started marching towards the castle. Bow and Adora rushed over to her.

“Take it easy Glimmer.” Bow said worriedly.

Glimmer went to argue then looked at Adora. “Uhh, Adora where is your jacket?”

Adora looked wide eyed then down at herself. She then blushed profusely.

“Oops.”

When Azar finally woke up, she was bombarded by hair in her mouth. She opened her eyes to Cyra lying on top of her effectively putting her hair in Azar’s mouth. She groaned groggily as she pushed it away and put it behind Cyra’s head. “Honestly you almost killed me.” Azar said but was only answered by Cyra’s deep breathing as she remained asleep. Azar smiled as she pushed stray hairs behind Cyra’s ear.

Azar carefully pulled herself from her grip. Cyra curled into the spot where Azar was, and she grabbed her pillow as well. Azar laughed as she kissed her head and then got dressed. She decided to let Cyra sleep in, she didn’t have any meetings today, a rarity it seemed, not to mention she was up late last night.

Azar was walking the halls aimlessly, as she hummed a tune to herself. Then she heard rustling and frantic steps.

Azar turned and noticed she was at Catra's room. Azar hesitantly knocked on her door. "Liz, everything alright in there?" There was more rustling until Catra yanked the door open.

"Momma! Perfect come here!" Before she could protest Azar was dragged into Catra's room.

"Woah." Azar stared at the ransacked room. She picked up some clothes from the floor. "What's all this?" She asked.

Catra turned around and had a bashful look on her face. "I'm packing for Brightmoon!" Her face lit up with a smile. Azar swore she was glowing in the amber light through her window.

Just like her mother, Azar thought.

Catra hummed a tune as she went through every piece of clothing she owned and would look at it for a while then toss it aside. Azar sat on Catra's bed smiling fondly as she watched her kit.

"You realize you'll only be gone for a week, right?"

Catra rolled her eyes dramatically as she turned around. "Right one week to show off my best at Brightmoon. Duh." She then went right back to her closet. Azar smirked as she got up.

"Uh-huh. So, you're stressing because you want to show off?"

Catra flushed slightly. "Why else?"

Azar then sat next to her. "Oh, I don't know. Maybe to impress a certain blonde." Azar teased. Catra scoffed, her face going red.

"I have no idea what you're talking about." Catra pointedly looked back at her clothes. Azar laughed and as she was debating whether or not to tease her but stopped when she saw a sad look pass her face.

“Hey, I was just teasing. I didn’t mean to upset you.” Azar frowned.

“No, it’s not that I just...was thinking too hard.”

“That’s never good.” Azar laughed.

Catra gave a half-hearted laugh. Azar suddenly grabbed her and pulled her up.

“Hey, what’s wrong?” Azar said as she brought her to sit next to her on the bed. Catra shook her head.

“It’s nothing.”

“I don’t believe that for a second.” Azar put a stray hair behind Catra’s ear. Catra leaned into the touch and leaned onto her mother. Azar laughed and wrapped her arm around her scratching her ear, making Catra relax into her hold.

“I’m just worried that... that something bad will happen and I won’t be ready for it.” Azar gave a breathy laugh.

“Liz if anything like that happens, I’m confident that you can defend yourself perfectly fine. Don’t tell your mother I said that, as far as she’s concerned, you see danger and run the other way. But I’m not, not saying to fight back.” She winked.

That got a small chuckle from Catra. Though she still seemed tense. Her eyes having a far off look in her eyes. Azar nudged her shoulder.

“That’s not what you were talking about was it?”

Catra sighed. “This is the first time I’ll be out of Halfmoon since...you know, and I- I just want to prove I can handle it.” Azar sighed.

“Liz, you will be fine. Think of it this way, you already spent a week with Bow, Glimmer and Adora, it’ll be the same thing, just at

a different location.” Catra hummed in acknowledgement, leaning into Azar. She debated with herself as she began her next sentence.

“How...how did you know you wanted to be with mom?”

Azar laughed heartily. “Oh, trust me it was an adventure that one. I honestly thought she was just some prissy princess when I first saw her. We did not get along what so ever. She was trying to just finish her business in Mystacore and go home. I was trying to get a rise out of her. I would scare her around corners and booby trap doorways, anything to get a rise out of her, but when I finally pushed her over the edge, I didn’t get my angry reaction she just looked at me with teary eyes and asked ‘why?’ I felt like such an asshole. She would always look on the edge of anger whenever I messed with her.” Azar laughed fondly. “She even had steam coming out of her ears. Then she would take a deep breath and walk away. I wanted to see her snap. And she did, it was then I realized I never wanted to see her cry like that again. I wanted to be the person that made her smile and took care of her.” Azar reminisced as Catra stared at her.

“Wow, that’s so sappy it’s gross.”

Azar shoved her. “Shut it you.”

Catra laughed and leaned back on her mother. She thought back to when she first left the Fright zone. The look of pure sadness on Adora’s face as she decided she would send Catra away. A child that young should never have had to do that.

“I think Adora feels the same.”

Catra jumped slightly at Azar’s voice. “What.”

“She literally snuck you out going against the law all to cheer you up.”

“It’s not like that. Adora is just a nice person. She would give an arm and a leg to anyone who needed it.” Catra pulled up her legs

and wrapped her arms around herself.

“You should see the way she looks at you when you aren’t watching. It’s sickening.” Azar joked. She hugged Catra as best she could. Then whispered in her ear. “But I’m gonna need you to hurry up that confession because I have a lot of money on you getting together sometime this month.”

“Momma!”

Adora’s POV

“Holy crap.” When I heard Catra had a room in Brightmoon I wasn’t expecting to walk into the room, and it looked as if someone took a room from Halfmoon and brought it into the castle. It was a stark contrast to the bright halls of Brightmoon compared to the deep reds and muted maroons.

Glimmer was teleporting like crazy trying to get all the cobwebs from the corners, while Bow was rushing back and forth with new bedding and fluffing all of the pillows and blankets.

“Glimmer quit teleporting, you know she hates the residue you leave behind.”

“I don’t have time Bow!”

I raised my hand silently. “Do you need my help?”

“No! Stand guard.” I huffed as I crossed my arms looking out into the hallway.

Apparently Glimmer wanted to surprise Angella with Catra’s arrival so trying to clean up a place that is obviously just for Catra would suspicious. Bow came back out with a pile of blankets, almost covering his vision entirely. “Bow let me help.” I tried, but he just kept walking.

“Keep watch!”

I sighed. I hated just standing here. I always hated being on watch. Everyone else is actually doing something all the while I'm just standing and waiting. I hate waiting.

"Adora?"

I look up and of course the one time something happens on my watch, it's now. "Angella! What are you doing here?" I began frantically knocking on the door. Signaling Glimmer.

"I was just taking a walk before my next meeting. What about you?"

How come I always got the job that requires lying. "Oh, I was uhhh..." Now would be a great time for Glimmer to be back.

"Adora, you don't have to lie to me." I tense. How did she know? Was my face that painful? Why am I the one always on watch! "You miss Catra."

I can work with that.

"Y-yeah, I've been worried about her." Angella smiled.

"Walk with me?"

Technically this way I would be able to distract her, and I would avoid having to stand outside a room uselessly.

"Sure." I walked with Angella calmly, with no destination. I was quite scared of Angella when I first met her but as of recently that fear has become respect. She still has authority, and I am hesitant to approach her, but she is also so kind and caring. I always wonder if Glimmer only got her mother's looks, because Angella always approaches issues with a regal calm that takes over a room. Glimmer on the other hand is the raging fire of passion that erupts the rooms in eager cheers. Maybe that's where the similarities end.

Angella looked up with a small smile. “You know when Catra first came here she would hide up in the rafters just to get Glimmer to stop following her.” Angella laughed. “You should’ve seen how high she jumped when Glimmer teleported behind her the first time.”

I laughed along with her.

“Back in the Fright zone me and her would play pranks on our bunkmates and one of them involved her hiding under a blanket and scaring our friend Kyle. Though the blankets there were super scratchy and so when she jumped out her hair was five times bigger due to the static. I swear Kyle peed himself when he saw her!” We both laughed, I could remember that incident like yesterday.

I decided to leave out what happened afterwards, Shadow weaver had walked in at the wrong time and Catra came back later that night with three new bruises.

“I wish I could’ve done more for her back then.” I said powerlessly.

“Adora, you were a child. You did more than enough for her. You had to make very hard decisions at a young age, you reunited her with her family. You might have saved her life.” Angella grabbed my shoulders, stopping our walk. “You should know that you were the best possible thing Catra could’ve had in that place and it’s obvious with how highly she talks of you.”

I stare confused. “She talks about me?”

Angella laughed slightly. “Mostly in our letters, but when she first arrived you were the first thing on her mind. When Shadow weaver... noticed she was gone she activated a spell on her that was going to eat away at her mind. Though when she woke up after Azar had stopped it her first thought was if you were okay.”

I bit my lip. “I had no idea.”

“Yeah, well Catra is known for her reputation, so don’t tell her I told you that.” Angella winked, making me smile back at her.

Suddenly we both heard a crash and saw Bow rubbing his head with pillows surrounding him.

“Bow?” We both said at the same time.

He looks up and smiles sheepishly. “Your majesty! How’s it going?” He said feigning casual conversation. Angella sighs.

“Do I even want to ask what you are doing?”

“It’s better if you don’t” Bow said.

“Alright, is it going to cause a mess?” Angella raised a brow.

“Nope!” Bow said proudly.

“Then I don’t want to know. Just stay out of trouble.” Bow gave her a mock salute.

“Yes ma’am.” He hastily grabbed the blankets and ran back down the hall. I watched him go and Angella waved her hand.

“I won’t keep you, stars above know I would rather you be there to supervise.”

I smiled and gave a quick bow. “Of course.” I stopped as I went to leave giving Angella one last look. “Thank you. I really needed that talk.” Angella smiled at me.

“Anytime Adora.”

By the time I got back to Catra’s room it already looked livable. I spotted Glimmer wiping down the large window.

“Way to leave me to your mom. You know I can’t lie.”

“You didn’t!” Glimmer turned, suddenly interested. I huffed.

“No, she changed the subject.”

“Oh, thank the stars.” She teleported back down with her hands on her hips with a proud smile. “What do you think?”

I gave the room a good look over and I was impressed. “Where was this Glimmer when we were cleaning your room?” I teased.

Bow finished making the bed as he interjected. “Well in her defense this room used to be Cyra and Azar’s, but they stopped visiting years ago, then Catra was here but only for a few days. So, it doesn’t have much here. Glimmer on the other hand is a hoarder.”

Glimmer gawked. “I am not!”

“Glimmer you still have a piece of trash at your desk.” I said dead face.

“It’s my lucky duck!”

“It’s a tissue that vaguely looks like a duck.”

Glimmer looked to Bow for support.

“Wel... I’m more concerned about the number of shoes you have. Some of them still have the tag on them.” Bow said hesitantly. Glimmer pouted.

“I feel betrayed.”

Bow and I laughed. “It’s okay Glimmer you’re our hoarder!” I teased. Me and Bow caging her in a death grip hug.

“Says the Horde soldier.” Glimmer grumbled.

She didn’t keep her pout long when we laughed, and she soon joined in. Glimmer teleported out of our embrace.

“Alright enough of that.” She glanced at the clock.

“Okay I must go pick up something from Jewels and when I come back, we can head to Halfmoon!” We both gave an affirmative and Glimmer disappeared in a cloud of sparkles.

Bow stretched, “Well looks like we’re relieved of our duty for the next thirty minutes.”

I began fidgeting with my nails. Why was I so nervous all of a sudden? It must’ve been obvious because Bow placed a grounding hand on my shoulder.

“You okay Adora?”

I nodded, “Yeah, just excited...and nervous.”

“I get that. Just try not to think about it too much.”

I gave him an unamused look. “That’s like telling a bird to stop flying.”

Bow gave a small laugh. “I really think you have nothing to worry about. Catra loves...the surface... and she’ll be excited just to get a change in scenery.”

I nodded. “You’re right, I know you’re right but... I just have an uneasy feeling about... being uneasy.” Bow grabbed my hands, stopping them from picking.

“Hey, let’s just take it one second at a time alright? There’s no use in worrying about things we can’t control and unfortunately the future is one of those things.”

I took a deep breath, I can do this and Bows right. There is nothing to worry about. Sensing me begin to calm down Bow smiled.

“Well, I’m going to go to the infirmary to get some nausea medication. If our surface vertigo is bad Catra’s will be too. And some sleeping pills in case she needs more help readjusting. You want to join me?” Bow offered me an outstretched hand. I smiled.

“Yeah.”

One morning. One morning of peace was all Cyra asked for.

“Mom!”

And it was always too much to ask for. Cyra groaned as she sat up, the door swinging open to reveal a frantic Catra with Azar pleading with her to stop talking. “What is so important that it couldn’t wait until I woke up for you to tell me?”

“Did you and momma place bets on me and Adora?” Cyra raised a brow and looked at her wife. Who was smiling sheepishly.

“No.” Cyra said firmly, but before Catra could relax Cyra continued. “Almost everyone in Halfmoon placed a bet on you and Adora. I just added a little to the pot.” Azar laughed as Catra’s face went slack.

“What?!”

“Azar you weren’t supposed to tell her, now it’s not fair.” Cyra said with a slight tease as Catra crossed her arms.

“You guys are the worst.”

Azar laughed as she wrapped herself around Catra. “Aww, we love you too!”

Cyra rolled her eyes fondly. “Is that all? Because I was having quite a good rest before you two. Speaking of Elizabeth, you should probably be trying to get some sleep. You’re leaving for Brightmoon at Midnight, and you won’t be able to sleep till late.”

“I’ll be fine.” Catra said casually. “I was packing.”

Cyra had a sad smile on her face. Just then Azar cursed.

“Shit I was supposed to meet Leo at the sparring grounds I got to go.” She gave Catra a big kiss on the cheek that she fought. “I

love you!”

“Eww, Momma!” Before Catra could protest more Azar began to hastily go down the hallway. Catra wiped her cheek dramatically. “Gross.”

Cyra laughed, then pulled back the covers slightly. “Come here Elizabeth, I want to talk with you.” Catra’s ears dropped. “It’s nothing bad.” That made Catra step more confidently to her mom. She stood by the bed, but Cyra didn’t budge. “Elizabeth you are about to be gone for a week, so come and lay with your mother.” Catra chuckled and got into the bed next to her. Cyra smiled and rubbed her face in Catra’s hair, wrapping her arms around her kit.

Catra smiled and curled into her mother, her head resting on her shoulder. Cyra sighed as she leaned her head back against her headboard, the curtain on her window, only opened a crack letting a single ray of light into the room.

“Are you excited?”

Catra nodded. “Yeah, thank you by the way...for letting me go. I know that decision wasn’t easy for you.” Catra said quietly, careful not to ruining the somber atmosphere in the room. Cyra began running her nails through Catra’s hair.

“You deserve it. Though I swear you better contact me at least fifty times a day.” Cyra said teasingly.

“Oh of course, I wouldn’t dare ask for anything less.” Catra said in a posh accent. Cyra flicked her ear gently.

“Where on Etheria did you learn such a disrespectful tone?” Cyra joked. Catra didn’t hesitate as she hugged her mom tighter.

“From my mom. She has quite the vocabulary.”

Cyra rolled her eyes. “Well played brat.” Catra gave a cheesy grin. Cyra then let her eyes close. “Seriously though you should be

trying to get some sleep.” Cyra began readjusting them, so they were now laying down.

“Are you sure this isn’t just a trick to use me as your body pillow?”

“Oh, you caught me!” She said as she snuggled the feline closer to her. Catra tried feigning annoyance, but her purr betrayed her. Cyra wrapped her tail around the kit. “Well now you’re trapped so you have to be my body pillow for all eternity.”

Catra rolled her eyes. “No way.”

“Alright I’ll cut you a deal because you’re cute. How about you be my body pillow every time my wife leaves?”

Catra hummed in contemplation. “What about arguments? Will I be needed then?”

Cyra nodded. “Oh yes. I almost forgot. So, body pillow when momma is away or being mean. Deal?”

“I guess if I must.” Catra said in a dramatic huff.

“Perfect!” Cyra said as she pulled Catra closer. Sniffing her kit. “I love your smell.” Cyra said sleepily.

“You’re weird.”

“Mhmm.” Cyra’s breathing began to level out. Catra stared blankly at the ceiling.

“Hey mom?” Cyra’s ear turned towards Catra. “Why did you stop traveling?” Cyra remained silent. Catra almost said forget it, thinking Cyra fell asleep.

“I was looking for a home.” Cyra said definitively. Catra stared at her mother in confusion. Cyra sighed as she opened her eyes again. “Halfmoon for the longest time felt...empty. I hated it. My friends would always tell me about how they wanted to stay by their family for the rest of their lives. I didn’t understand it.

Halfmoon never felt like home to me. So, I set out to find my own. A place I would love to be, a place where I never wanted to leave...then my parents died... well my father died. I was suddenly thrust into a life of meetings, pleasantries and dealing with the amber...which was infuriating. But I was even more motivated to leave. I would triple my work load just to get a week to travel. Then I went to Mystacore." Cyra looked down at her kit and saw her staring at her with wide eyes sucking up every word.

"What's Mystacore like?"

"Don't you want to wait till you see it for yourself?" Cyra teased, Catra responded with a huff.

"So was Mystacore your home?"

"No, I actually despised being there."

Catra stared at her confused.

Cyra laughed. "It was beautiful, and I loved their beaches and sights, but there was certain Magicat that made it her life goal to make me miserable."

Catra connected the dots then began laughing. "Momma told me about that."

"Oh, I'm sure." Cyra said bitterly. "But after I had an emotional breakdown, Azar felt bad so she would bring me gifts and anything that would cheer me up. She even turned herself into a squirrel. As much as I wanted nothing to do with the person who terrorized me for weeks on end, I found myself having trouble leaving. I stopped traveling and instead would visit Mystacore just to see Azar. I learned then that she was that feeling everyone was talking about. Azar was my home, and I never wanted to leave. So, when she moved into Halfmoon I had no reason to leave. I found home." Cyra had a dreamy look in her eyes, and she was looking far off.

"Wow you two are such saps."

“I’m aware.” Cyra laughed.

“Come on!”

“Glimmer I know sometimes you forget so let me remind you, we can’t teleport!” Adora said through huffs as she and Bow rushed to catch up with Glimmer. Bow was trying to keep a smile on his face, but Adora was not having an optimistic outlook right now.

Glimmer was rambling as she teleported from place to place in excitement but Adora was secretly hoping she would run out so she could know what it’s like to walk through the dense whispering woods. “You okay Adora?”

“Yeah.” Adora sighed as she slashed her sword through the underbrush. Glimmer had went far ahead leaving Bow and Adora to themselves. “So, did you find anything in those first ones records Catra gave you?”

Adora sighed. “Not really. Most of it is here say, there were some connections, but it was weird to see the first ones be the bad guys. I mean I don’t know a lot about them, but it just seems like they were fighting for no reason.”

“Maybe you should ask Catra about it.” Bow said.

Adora nodded, a ghost of a smile on her face. “Yeah.”

“Guys!”

“Coming!” They both said with different tones of frustration.

They came to the clearing with the hidden gate of Halfmoon, where Glimmer was waiting impatiently, tapping her foot on the ground just to show her annoyance.

Bow chuckled fondly at Glimmer while Adora was just annoyed.

Once the group caught up, they walked through the cliff face without hesitation, then went down the staircase towards

Halfmoon. Glimmer practically floating towards the gate.

“I can’t wait to show Catra around Brightmoon, she’ll love it. Also, my mom will no doubt be so impressed she’ll forgive me for that harmless prank from a while back and finally give me back my access to the armory!”

Bow and Adora looked at each other, both mutually agreeing that Glimmer shouldn’t be allowed anywhere near the weapons.

When they arrived Vivianne was waiting for them, Adora smiled. “Vivianne, long time no see.”

Vivianne rolled her eyes. “Not long enough, the queens have been expecting you.” She gestured down to let them go ahead of her. Glimmer clapped her hands in excitement. “By the way.” Vivianne started. “Please be mindful that it is late, and people are sleeping so, try to keep it down.”

The best friend squad nodded.

“As quiet as a mouse.” Bow said with a wink.

Vivianne sighed. “Alright come on.”

The group followed and while Bow and Glimmer were making quiet conversation with Vivianne, Adora was looking around the empty streets. It was weird to see everything so empty and quiet. Especially comparing it to the loud and abundant celebration that was just over a month ago.

Adora also took note of the runestone shining overhead. It was huge, way bigger than Brightmoons. Adora couldn’t help but wonder how Catra would look while using the flames Azar seems so confident with.

“It’s a shame Catra isn’t bonding with it.”

Adora jumped when Glimmer was suddenly next to her. “What?”

“I was talking with Cyra, and she said Catra wasn’t ready to bond with it. If I had a runestone like that I would take it first chance I got.”

Adora laughed, that sounded like her, she thought. Only Catra would be offered a power like no other and choose not to take it just because she doesn’t need it. It made a smile come to her face.

“Alright this is where I leave you.” Vivinne stopped at the palace gate, gave a small bow.

“Thank you Vivianne!” Glimmer said, followed shortly by Adora’s and Bow’s own thanks.

The group entered right into the throne room where Cyra was nervously pacing while Azar was trying to calm her down. Glimmer made a ‘ahem’ calling both queens attention to her.

“Glimmer, Bow, Adora. Is it twelve already?” Cyra said hesitantly.

“Cy, please.”

Catra popped out of nowhere behind the group. “Missed me?” The group jumped. Causing Catra to laugh.

Glimmer groaned. “You know what, never mind. Cyra you can keep her.”

“Don’t tempt me.” Cyra said strained.

Adora wasn’t paying much attention. Staring at Catra who was laughing. She then turned to Adora with a smug look as she held out her jacket.

“You seemed to have forgotten this...again.”

Adora rubbed her neck nervously as she took it. She then noticed Catra’s hair. It was up it a ponytail and she was wearing the mask Adora gifted her. “You’re wearing it.”

“Huh? Oh yeah, how’s it look?”

“Nice...”

Catra flushed slightly and shoved Adora’s shoulder gently. “Yeah, whatever”

The pair laughed until Cyra grabbed their attention. “Alright, as much as I know you want to run off, we have conditions.” Catra groaned. Adora smiled as the group stood in front of the queens. Cyra took a deep breath. “I already talked through this with Elizabeth, but just in case I want none of you to have deniability. First and foremost, Elizabeth will not be involved with the war and or war effort.”

“What about in terms of tacti-” Catra stated but stopped when Cyra gave her a stern look. “Yep, no involvement, you’re the boss.” Catra said.

“I would also like for her to stay well within Brightmoon’s borders.”

Glimmer then spoke up.

“Is there any way she can visit Plumeria? Just for a day! We have a surprise waiting there, No war involvement!”

Cyra hesitated till Azar spoke. “Come on Cy, Plumeria is full of hippies. Besides, I need a few things from there anyway and Liz could just pick them up.” Azar gave Catra a wink.

“I don’t-” Azar suddenly interrupted her.

“Liz, do the thing!”

“The thing doesn’t work on her!”

Adora looked to Glimmer for an explanation, but she just shrugged. Cyra sighed. “Fine, keep Catra within Brightmoon and Plumeria.” The group celebrated their small win with a shout. “I

also want at least one update a day from you Elizabeth. I'll keep your old tracker pad with me and just send me a message once in a while, so I know you're okay." Catra nodded along.

"Yes ma'am."

"And finally, if any and I mean any news of the Horde moving in on nearby rebel territory comes to Brightmoon Elizabeth is to be sent home immediately, am I understood?" The group nodded. "Alright, be in Mystacore by Friday and that's everything from me. Azar?"

"I think you covered it."

"So... can we go now?" Catra said as she picked up her bag that was sitting on the floor. Cyra bit her lip in worry.

"Absolutely not!" Azar said suddenly, Catra stared slack jaw.

"What, but-"

"Not until you give us a proper goodbye you brat." The group released a breath they hadn't realized they were holding. Adora took Catra's bag as she ran and hugged her mothers.

"I know I already said it a lot but, thank you." Catra hugged them tighter. Azar chuckled while Cyra was on the verge of crying.

"Every day alright? One message at least." Cyra said as she gripped her tighter.

"I know mom, I know." Cyra pulled back and caressed her face. "Promise me you'll come straight back if you even think there's something wrong." Catra wanted to joke but saw the extreme worry in her mother's eyes.

"I promise mom."

Cyra sighed, then pulled away with help of Azar.

“Adora!” Azar called suddenly, Adora turned towards her and beckoned her over. Azar leaned over. “I know the ‘not meeting.’” Azar gave a stern look as if asking, and Adora nodded honestly. Azar relaxed. “Didn’t happen but.” She handed Adora three viles of the potion Adora found familiar and another paper with a oicture of some kind of plant on it. “Just a precaution. Hand this to princess Purfuma and she should be able to tell you where to locate the plant.” Adora nodded an affirmation. Azar looked at Catra with a smile, then back to Adora. “Also make sure she is in bed no earlier than seven PM. Trust me any earlier and she’ll be bouncing off the walls and keeping you up all night.” Adora swore she could see the restlessness in her eyes.

“Yes, ma’am”

“Momma, leave Adora alone. We gotta go!”

Azar smiled at Catra’s all too familiar eagerness, “Alright, I’m done.” Adora smiled then gave one last look to Cyra bowing slightly.

“Thank you.”

Cyra smiled back. “Take care of her... please.”

“I will.”

“Adora!” That time it was Glimmer.

“Coming!”

Adora walked back to the group and Catra gave her mom's one last goodbye as they left the castle. Adora fighting over who carries Catra’s bags.

“You okay Cy?” Azara asked as she saw tears falling down Cyra’s face.

“No. I already miss her.”

Chapter End Notes

That concludes the first arc of "A debt repaid" So excited to get into the angst and pain.

That yawning thing where Azar put her finger in Catra's mouth is wholly based off my mom who does the same thing.

Just in case you didn't pick up on it Vivianne git Grell's job. After the whole proposal fiasco Grell was trialed for showing disloyalty and disobedience making him be stripped of his title leaving it for Vivianne. Who showed dedication to the happiness of the princess (Catra) over selfish desires.

Since Azar would always be bouncing back and forth to Mystacore when Catra was younger she got really attached and wouldn't eat for Cyra just so Azar wouldn't leave.

Vivianne did in fact say goodbye but didn't want to bring the mood down with her obvious disappointment of Catra leaving.

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